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1

Evola's *Tools of the Occult War*

1.1 Tactics of the Occult War

Be wise as Lucifer and as innocent as the Holy Spirit.

The tactics of the **Occult War** describe the third dimension of history, that of depth, beyond the dimensions of space and time by which we conventionally view things. Yet, those who can only understand in terms of facts, material causes, and visible leaders still think at the level of brutes. Even worse, many men, wishing to be seen as intelligent, deliberately cultivate this view, thereby blinding themselves to any deeper understanding.

Let no one be deceived into believing that this is a simple matter. Even among those who desire to, or claim to, follow Tradition, there are many who fall victim to the tactics of the occult war, including some whom I have known personally for some time and would have expected a bit more insight.

This War, at its most fundamental layer, as the battle between the forces of Order and the forces of Chaos. This necessarily assumes, with-

out question or dispute, that there is a Cosmic Order, which we have been calling **Logos** and obviously a force behind that Logos, which we have called **Providence**, in accordance with Guenon and other Traditional and Hermetic authors. Hence, two requirements are imperative for anyone who wishes to consciously engage in this War.

1. He must understand the Cosmic Order
2. He must align his Will with the forces of that Order

The dimension of depth is the province of the Spirit, apart from and beyond any physical or material considerations. Obviously, then, to begin such an engagement, the spiritual warrior must first of all wage that battle in his own consciousness. Specifically, he must understand his own inner constitution, above all, the various layers of his soul life. He must strive to bring them into harmony with the Cosmic Order by subduing the lower layers to the higher. He must learn to harness the erotic and thumotic impulses that, left to themselves, lead to a process of inner integration.

To understand Gornahoor, readers must keep this foremost in mind. On the one hand, we have striven to describe the Cosmic Order in many different ways, apart from any a priori ideological commitment or allegiance to any particular movement or institution. We also hope to inspire others to take up arms in this battle in the way they see fit. In addition, one must also understand the forces of Chaos. Those forces employs several tactics, which we summarize below. We have already written about some of them in detail, others we shall take up as the need arises.

Scientific Suggestion This tactic involves the suggestion that science and the commitment to the world of facticity is the only way to understand the world. For example, we have described Francis Bacon's jettisoning of the knowledge of formal and final causes[1] as the basis for science,

[1] https://gornahoor.net/?p=3468

to the point where an educated man no longer knows what they are and think it fantastic when they are explained to him.

Replacement When men are no longer satisfied with science, they may turn to abstruse philosophical or ideological explanations. Such philosophical systems are so complex and subtle that their adherents spend several years, usually in their youth, to fully grasp them. This commitment and one-pointedness prevent them from reaching the dimension of depth. We see this today, unfortunately, even among those who aspire to Tradition, but commit to philosophic ideas, often of French origin, a strange counterweight to Guenon.

Counterfeits When the effects of Chaos are too obvious to ignore, some may turn to Tradition, but more often a counterfeit of Tradition. For example, we see today those who commit to a form of neopaganism that never existed as a Tradition anywhere, any time. These counterfeits take up the visual symbols and residues of earlier Traditions, but lack the understanding of their spiritual foundations.

Inversion This tactic begins by attacking spiritual intuition and gnosis, replacing them by psychological considerations. The logic and rationality of metaphysics is abandoned in favour of irrational and subconscious forces. Hence, there is the rise of all sorts of neospiritualities, extolled even in some New Right circles, that reject the actual Traditions, which they consider too rigid and limiting. Just today, some woman tried to convince me that masturbation is the key to discovering God. It is certainly a democratic and egalitarian notion, although you would think that enlightenment would be universal by now.

Ricochet This occurs when the representatives of one Tradition oppose themselves to other Traditions. Gornahoor has taken pains to point

out how Traditions agree at the level of depths and has not opposed any real Traditions. Yet there are many who attack the dominant and most recent Tradition of the West, whether out of ignorance or malice, for a fleeting political advantage. In the attempt to attract committed adherents, they end up on the same side as their enemies. For example, neopagan groups use the tactics of their declared enemies to discredit the Medieval Tradition, thereby undermining Tradition itself. Th Ricochet is the best way to destroy every unity and solidarity.

Dilution The forces of subversion replace an idea that seems too radical at a given time, with a more diluted version that seems more acceptable.

Misidentification of Principle with its Representatives This has been a very effective tactic of the forces of subversion, since the mass of men are nominalists, meaning they cannot even understand principles but only individual things. Thus if some leader or member or adherent of a Tradition has betrayed his principles, men come to reject the principles themselves. This is all too common, even those I know personally who claim to be "Traditionalists".

Replacing Infiltrations Unfortunately, organizations and societies whose original impetus was to preserve and promote some aspect of Tradition degrade over time. The leaders, as well as members, of such groups become ignorant of their founding spirits, and instead grow accustomed to the material benefits and unearned prestige that accrue to such leadership. Such organizations are easily discredited along with the principles they had been created to uphold.

Simplification Instead of making the effort to grasp complex forces and multifarious phenomena, men are too easily attracted to overly sim-

plistic explanations. For example, the modern ideals of liberalism, socialism, scientism, and rationalism are the outcome of several historical antecedents among which are the Renaissance, the Reformation, French Revolution, Marxism.

Clearly, that is replacing a spiritual cause with a material one. Then there are those who are part of such subversive movements, yet beyond all logic, still expect a different result. Some see a superficial commitment to certain issues, and then assume they are natural allies. However, at the level of depth, nothing could be further from the truth. The most egregious example that bypasses 1500 years of Western history in a one sentence slogan, attribute all the modern deviations listed above to an alleged secularization of the Medieval Tradition. Yes, I have heard that from educated men, as I'm sure many readers have.

Based on writings of different authors.

Posted on 2012-01-25 by Cologero

1.2 The Tools of the Occult War

In this article from the January 1938 issue of *La Vita Italiana*, Julius Evola describes his understanding of the occult war and its tactics. This should clear up two widely spread misconceptions.

- The first misconception is that the occult war has something to do with so-called occult or magical practices. To the contrary, it is not a question of men employing higher, or transhuman, forces to achieve their aim, but rather of those forces using men, with or against their will, whether they are conscious of it or not, to achieve aims apart from the desires of men.
- The second misconception is that Evola is an adherent of conspiracy theories. Conspiracy theories restrict themselves

> to a two dimensional understanding of history, where some small group of men control events for their own ends. Evola is referring to something much deeper.
>
> The rest of the article speaks for itself and it is surprising how, today, such a view is barely comprehensible. This is despite the work of **Wilhelm Wundt**, who made a similar point from a purely secular point of view. Yet the rapidity of the way public opinion can be swayed ought to give one pause.
>
> Whatever Evola says about the occult war can only be understood by keeping in mind Guenon's writings of the anti-tradition, counter-tradition, and related topics. It may be surprising to some that Evola mentioned the Catholics as holding a similar understanding to his. That is understandable to those who only know the Vatican II church. But older writings do indeed describe an occult or spiritual war; the older Church and Evola even agree on the specific historical organizations or agents of the anti-tradition. We will, at some future date, reproduce some of those writings.

Part I The occult war is when the forces of worldwide subversion lead from behind the scenes, adopting means that almost always elude ordinary methods of investigation. The notion of an occult war belongs to a tridimensional vision of history, to a history considered not according to the two dimensional surface of apparent causes, events, and leaders, but rather one depending on the third dimension of depth, the hidden dimension, which retrieves the decisive forces and influences which are often not even ascribable to the simple human element, whether individual or collective.

Having used the adjective "hidden", it is necessary to make its importance precise, indicating that it is not a question of an obscure and irrational substrate of scientific history, of something that could stand in the known part of it, but in the same relationship by which the subconscious stands to the consciousness of waking in the individual. This

analogy is certainly exact, if considered from the point of view of those who, in this tridimensional view of events, appear not as the *subjects*, but rather of the *objects* of history: in their acting and thinking, they do not take into account the true influences which they obey and the true ends that are accomplished through them. They have their true centre more in the subconscious and unconscious than in their waking consciousness, yet, in this respect, we can certainly say that it is in the subconscious that the most decisive movements of the occult war develop.

But from the point of view of the true *subjects* of history, things are quite different, and we can speak, in this regard, not of the subconscious or the unconscious, but we must think of super-intelligent forces, forces that know perfectly what they want and the most appropriate means to realize what they want. To suppose that this substrate of history is accounted for by the "irrational", by "life", by "becoming", or by whatever else of those confused entities invented by modern historicism at the moment in which they thought they went beyond so-called scientific historiography, is among the most dangerous errors. We believe, on the contrary, that we see in that one of the suggestions prudently spread in certain circles typical of the aims of certain movements of the occult war in modern times.

We will explain ourselves more clearly in what follows. For now, it is enough to establish this point: we must not allow the third dimension of history to vanish in the fog of abstract and philosophical views, but we must consider it inhabited and occupied by quite precise "intelligences", whose expression and closest mouthpieces were almost always certain secret societies or organizations, but which must not at all totally express the intelligences, but just having their beginning and end in them.

Examining the various conceptions of history widespread in the West, perhaps it is the Catholic conception, out of all of them, that can claim views of the same type. It is typical of such conceptions, in fact, to see history not as a mechanism of natural, political, economic, or social causes,

but as the unfolding of a type of plan (the "providential" plan) opposed by adverse forces and their historical emissaries, forces that assume either the moralistic designations of the "forces of evil" or the religious one of anti-Christian forces or forces of the Antichrist. One such conception can already furnish a foundation when it is transposed from the teleological plan to a practical plan and if it makes its general principle through an interpretation deepened by events. In the second place, when it is generalized, establishing its susceptibility to still be of value in non-Christian civilizations, for which it will be well, in this regard and with reference to human institutions, to speak generically of forces of tradition and forces of the anti-Tradition, the forces of the spiritual hierarchy and revolutionary subversion, the forces of the cosmos and of chaos. In this particular case, the anti-Traditional forces will also appear naturally as anti-Catholic forces, insofar as, in the Catholic tradition, they are intended to combat the Traditional spirit in general, to destroy the basis of every hierarchy and to ruin their historical representatives.

In our time, we will never be able to insist enough on the necessity of penetrating a view of the type that must not be considered as one among the many possible "speculations" of philosophy, but rather as an indispensable organ for true action. We are pleased to reproduce here a passage of the famous Protocols, to which we had previously called attention.

> The purely brute mind of the gentiles is incapable of use for analysis and observation, and still more for the foreseeing whither a certain manner of setting a question may tend. In this difference in capacity for thought between the gentiles and ourselves may be clearly discerned the seal of our position as the Chosen People and of our higher quality of humanness, in contradistinction to the brute mind of the gentiles. Their eyes are open, but see nothing before them and do not invent (except perhaps, material things).

It is a truthfully alarming thing to think in how many cases such a judgment about the gentiles—who would be, this this special reference which makes Israel the principle agent of worldwide subversion, the non-Hebrews, but who can also be considered, in general, as those who we already called the "objects of history"—has still today a profound content of truth. The point of view of the greater part of the so-called "men of action", compared to those of the hidden adversaries, can certainly be said to be babies: they concentrate all of the strength on what is directly graspable with the hands, and are incapable of establishing the relationships of cause and effect beyond the range of an extremely limited zone and of a nature almost always grossly material. Moreover, there is a fundamental lack of principles, since they almost always believe that the point of view of action cannot be "dogmatically" subordinated to principles, but must be related to the "unavoidable necessities of the moment".

Unfortunately, this is still the level typical of most counter-revolutionary forces. It is a situation that can be compared to that of someone who finds himself perfectly equipped for the high mountain, with boots, sack, cord, and pick and then finds himself, after happily passing many tests, facing an expanse of water, at a lake or a sea, throws himself into it enthusiastically, believing that his equipment will still help him and lead him forward. Instead, it will only be of use to make him sink more rapidly to the bottom.

The occult war is exercised on that which, with an image drawn from positive science, we will call the "imponderables", or imponderable quantities. It is adopted fairly often to produce nearly insensible changes, from which sizable effects will proceed slowly but fatally. It almost never acts with forces opposed to other forces, but rather through an opportune direction of it, so as to lead to the desired effects. What Wundt called the heterogony of ends[2], plays a fundamental part in it: it is precisely about acting, while some forces or men believe they are willing and producing a

[2] https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Heterogony_of_ends

given effect, and it alone, in actuality, they will produce or prepare something else quite different from it, thus uncovering an influence and an intelligence that transcends them. It is for this reason that, on another occasion in *La Vita Italiana* , we said that the examination of the "differential" existing between the will and the event, between the principles or programs and the true consequences of it in history, offers the most valuable material for whoever truly wants to account for the true forces which history itself has obeyed.

But in this article we want to move beyond the general, and speak of a few of the most frequently used means, in our time, of the hidden powers of worldwide subversion to cover their action, to prevent that of their adversaries, and to continue to exercise their influence.

It is incumbent to point out that the idea here was often given by observations scattered in the various works of **Rene Guenon**. Guenon, in our opinion, has a nearly unique competence in all contemporary Western literature for similar types of problems.

Part II

> These are the first four of the eight tools of the occult war identified by **Julius Evola**. For readers unfamiliar with the philosophical currents of Evola's time, "positive" is usually called "scientific" today, at least in English. He also criticizes the philosophies of life (e.g., certain Germans, perhaps even Nietzsche as "life-affirming"), becoming (Bergson, Whitehead), and absolute spirit (Hegel, Gentile).
>
> As other manifestations of subversive forces, he goes on to mention a dilettantish "traditionalism" (which is rampant today) and even zoological racism (the "hipster racism" or "race realism" of today). Then there are all the New Age movements, which have only multiplied in the past 75 years. They hide the true Tradition and can be identified by their preoccupation with strange and unusual phenomena, rather than true spirituality; Evola calls

them demonic. We can add a certain fascination with the dark and the ugly, that some today want to identify with Tradition.

This is one topic that I hope will lead to many comments, discussing, identifying, and clarifying these tools of the subversive forces.

The Positivist Suggestion It is necessary to get used to thinking that the so-called "positive" mode of doing history and of considering events is somewhat less a spontaneous product and prejudice typical of a very limited mentality, than a *suggestion* spread methodically in modern culture by anti-traditional forces, with the purpose of "covering" their action. Whoever believes that history is simply made by men and determined exclusively by economic, political, and social factors sees nothing else. And it is exactly such a world that "sees nothing else" that is needed by whoever wants to act clandestinely. A civilization dominated by the "positivistic" prejudice offers the ideal condition for an action developing along the "third dimension": and this is exactly the case of the current civilization.

Previously, we mentioned besides "positivistic" interpretations, those having as their basis abstract ideas of becoming", of "life", or even of the "Spirit". In that we can consider a case of the application of a second tool of the occult war, which is:

The Tactic of the Surrogates It is followed, every time that the danger of an "awakening" is manifested and the energies seek to turn beyond the plan dominated by ideas, in the operation of which the occult game of the forces of subversion can easily take place. In the case now mentioned, these confused ideas of "becoming", "life", "absolute Spirit", etc., in fact, are only a decoy thrown at those no longer satisfied with positivistic patterns, and those whose gaze does not bring itself where it should. From the fog of such ideas, the field of action remains so well covered, as by the dark night of "positivistic" agnosticism.

The "tactic of the surrogates" develops, however, in a much more characteristic and effective way under the form of:

Tactic of Falsifying Substitution This is what we are talking about. When the effects of destructive action, appearing even on the material plane and giving rise to clearly visible phenomena, exhibit a degree hot enough to provoke a reaction, this reaction confusedly seeks symbols and myths to serve as the base for an engine of reconstruction, and can also find it legitimate and consistent with its goal. It is almost always about symbols and points of reference that, in their historical aspect, remaining in the traditional past, recalled from atavistic depths through the forces of an organism that feels itself threatened by final destruction. In these cases, the occult war does not take place with a direct action, i.e., not by opposing such symbols, but ensures that they do not circulate and are not worth falsifying or counterfeiting, inasmuch as the reaction either remains limited, or diverted, or even overturned in an opposite direction, on which they naturally move on to apply the same influences present in the evil against which they wanted to act and in the decadence, from which they wanted to rise up from and believed in good faith to be rising up from.

This tactic can develop in diverse domains, in the political as well as in the spiritual camp, and seems today to have a totally special efficiency. It is worth looking at an example.

The most typical is constituted by "traditionalism". The vague aspiration of a return to tradition, i.e., to a hierarchical and qualitative order centered in a transcendent spirituality and in an elite of its qualified and legitimate representatives, is diverted to in the form of "traditionalism", i.e., of vague assumptions of a dilettantish, or militant, character that confuses Tradition with custom and the routine, that leads into a narrow-minded particularism, that stops at given, handed-down forms, and knows nothing of their spirit. In such a way, they present an easy

game to their adversaries and provide a good decoy to those who, through the false goal of anti-traditionalism, bring their true blow against tradition and foment new developments of revolutionary subversion. So the reaction remains contained and the maneuver leads successfully to prearranged goals. What, in certain extremist circles, the idea of race threatens to become because of some assumptions in terms of zoological materialism, as so even the Nordic-Aryan idea and even the pagan idea, come back to a conjuncture of the type. It is about ideas that, if they were understood and represented in accordance with their true nature and their ancient spiritual and traditional content, could certainly carry out a creative and healing action within the limits of some peoples of the North. As they appear instead in the circles already indicated, first of all because of a lack of principles, then because of a profound incomprehension and deformation of the ancient "Aryan" world, and finally through the tyranny of immediate interests and irrational impulses, make us suspect the effect of a distorting action of the type indicated. In relation to the new Italy, one should make every effort that something of the type does not occur in certain re-evocations of Romanity. The idea of ancient Rome certainly exists among those who today could have the greatest reconstructive efficacy: it is necessary to see that this efficacy is not paralyzed by means of the reconstituted facsimiles or by mere rhetorical resurrections, or by academic, erudite, archeological and even simply juridical, political assumptions, to which naturally elude completely the central strength and soul of the Roman symbol.

Tactic of Reversal The secret forces of worldwide subversion knew perfectly that the fundamental premise of order to be destroyed was the supernatural element, spirit conceived not as a philosophical abstraction, but rather as a higher reality and as the means of a process of transcendent integration of the personality. The limited influence that, in such a regard, the Catholic tradition could still have (here we cannot stop to

analyze the means to come to that conclusion), the subversive forces had to try in every way to ensure that every new contemporary aspiration toward the supernatural, developing outside of the dominant religion, became distorted and paralyzed. The whole of what can be called neo-spiritualism, with allusion to the various theosophical, spiritist, Orientalizing, and "occultistic" sects can be considered the effect of one such maneuver. In all that, again, it is a question almost exclusively of deformation, counterfeits, and distortions of spiritual doctrine, due to the least qualified persons, who in this respect, seem often to be subjected to a truly demonic influence.

The consequent outcome is twofold. First of all, it provided an easy way of extending the general discredit into which those counterfeits had to fall, to the doctrines in themselves, with which they were practically put in condition of no longer damaging. We can mention that, in recent times, the maneuver has even employed political factors: and there are some circles that, in good faith, are able to see only "Masonry" (something that was made the synonym of revolutionary, anti-Christianity or international subversion) wherever one speaks of secret associations of esoteric symbols, even when such references lead back to ancient traditions, whose original spirit and aristocratic nature everyone should note.

In the second place, because of poorly understood theories and false practices, they are joined to channel all the forces that, constricted by the suffocating stranglehold of materialism and yearning for something extranatural, not toward the supernatural, but rather toward the subnatural, i.e., the subconscious, mediumship, and, in general, toward a world that, far from representing an integration of the personality, can only propitiate its collapse and disintegration, as much by making of it the tool of some of the darkest "influences". So with neo-spiritualism the danger constituted by true spirituality was contained and reduced to an almost inessential minimum.

Part III

Tools 5 and 6 of the Occult War. In the Ricochet, Evola warns against causing divisions for particularistic reasons, particularly against another Tradition. Unfortunately, this is not uncommon today. He warns against scapegoating a group or organization for all problems. The focus must always remain on the plan of the subversive powers; focusing on the alleged agents will distract from the fundamental task.

Tactic of the Ricochet Attack It consists in provoking one of the forces to be torn down because of their still traditional character to undertake an action, that initially was aimed against a similar force and apparently of value to strengthen and increase the first force, but that then ricochets against it, dragging it down into the same ruins that it had propitiated against the other. By means of timely infiltrations, the secret forces of worldwide subversion often incite the representatives of a tradition to defend it through the discrediting another: whoever is subject to such a maneuver does not notice that to attack the tradition in the person of another people or civilization, for particularistic reason or contingent and inferior interests, means to be condemned to see itself attacked, sooner or later, in their own home, through a ricochet motion. The forces of worldwide subversion very much count on this tactic, and therefore make every effort to put every higher idea under the subjection of particularistic interests, pride, ambitions, and proletarian tendencies. They know that this is the best means to destroy every unity and true solidarity and to propitiate a state of division, in which their game will be extremely easy.

In this case, on can also allow every Machiavellian utilization of revolutionary forces back in. Some statesmen of scant discernment believed that propitiating or helping the revolution in the nations unfavorable to them was the best means to sustain and defend their true interests. Without realizing it, they prepared the exact opposite result, while they

believed they served the revolution like an instrument, they themselves became tools of the revolution, which had to reach them after having passed over the body of their adversaries. We can say that the entire history of modern times, above all starting from the French Revolution, was the theatre of a subversion that tragically worked in such a way. We can never insist enough, in such regard, on the fact that only the absolute, ascetic, unfaltering adherence to an idea can serve to safeguard against the forces of the occult war. Wherever this standard is abandoned and follows contingent factors, the front of the resistance is broken and, with it, the possibility of a true autonomy.

We do not want to fail to mention a final appearance of an similar maneuver: the ideology characteristic of the "principle of nationality", the "self-determinism of the people", and imperialism, proclaimed by the Allies to mobilize every force against the Central Powers and then to beat them World War I , is exactly the best among the ideologies adapted to propitiate a general revolt of the nations of color against the great European powers and to overturn every supremacy from them.

Tactic of the Scapegoat When the hidden forces of worldwide subversion avoid the danger of being unmasked in some of their aspects, they see to it that all the attention of their adversaries is directed and concentrated on some elements, that only in part, or only subordinately, can be considered as responsible for their evildoing. All the reaction is then unloaded on such elements, becoming the true scapegoats. And the hidden forces remain free to pursue their game, their adversaries believing they have at this point identified the enemy and do not have to look for others. We repeatedly admonish certain anti-Semitic extremists to remain well attentive, so that, in their seeing the Jew everywhere, they do not end up by making themselves victims of a trap of that type. The same admonition could be applied equally to those who instead see everywhere Masonry or Protestantism, and so on, analogous processes being also verified in many

other areas. It is necessary to guard against every unilateralism, never forgetting the complex plan of the occult forces which we must combat.

Part IV

> The final segment of **Julius Evola**'s essay. The final tactic, the **Tactic of the Substitution of Principle to the Person**, is very important, as it describes the creation of the modern world from the Medieval period. As a corollary, it defines what can be meant by the **Right** in the relative sense: it is whatever resists the dissolution of a stage, and the **authentic Right**, in its only true meaning, is whatever works toward the stage prior to the successive degeneration of the castes.
>
> Evola concludes with the necessity of recognizing and indicating the tools used in the occult war. Only then can a man be called a *counter-revolutionary*.

Tactic of Dilution This is a particular case of the "tactic of substitution". To understand it, it is necessary to start from the idea, that the process that led us up to our current general crisis, had distant origins and various phases and that in each one of such phases—corresponding to specific forms of Civilization, State, ethics, etc.—the crisis was already present even in a less acute, more dilute, potential form rather than actual. The theory of "progress", or evolutionism, can be considered as another of the suggestions hurled by the subversive hidden forces into the general environment, in order to distract anyone from looking from the perspective of the origins and always pushing well beyond the process of falling, under the thrust of false mirages, and, above all, of that of the conquests of the technical-mechanical civilization. However, the hard experience of tragic events in recent times saw to it that such a hypnosis was no longer able to conserve its efficacy and was no longer able to prevent many spirits from recognizing that the presumed course toward progress was a course

toward the abyss and that a going back was imposed. The hidden front then put into notion every means to prevent any radicalism. One of the preferred methods was, above all, putting a prejudice against "anachronism" into circulation, against "that which is no longer adapted for the times", and then directing the forces that returned to look toward the origins, toward one or the other of those preceding phases, in which the crisis and evil were found in forms less advanced and, for that very reason, less visible. And even this trap had success. The leaders of worldwide subversion know naturally that, having come to that point, the danger is eliminated, because the whole was reduced to soon retrace the same path and to push, at the end of it, to dissolution even these forces that were awakened and that wanted to react and pull back.

We could also indicate many historical examples of this tactic, both recently and further in the past Above all, the political Leaders of current anti-subversive movements should not lose it from view. Let us say in all frankness—since in such a field a lack of frankness is certainly equivalent to a fault—there are aspects of contemporary nationalism that would merit being tested thoroughly. Anyone can note, in fact, the anti-traditional, anti-hierarchical, revolutionary character that, in the past, compared to the preceding ecumene of imperial and feudal civilization, had the notion of nation. Now, it is the nation that today predominantly challenges to combat the extreme forms of the crisis and subversion, represented by various red internationals communist parties . There is therefore the necessity to formulate a concept of the nation different from that which makes of it a stage of the path that had to lead to what today we must combat. Several years ago we provided the necessary points of reference to confront and resolve this problem, and to distinguish two nationalisms *La Vita Italiana*, Mar, 1931 . We must return to our essay.

Tactic of the Substitution of Principle to the Person It is undeniable that, in many respects, the decadence of traditional institutions

occurs through the decadence of their leaders and representatives. But this is not the only cause: in order to come to a true dissolution and involution, it is necessary that the tactic of the substitution of principle to the person be added to it, a new tool of the occult war, which works in the following way. When the representative of a given principle appears unworthy, a process against the principle in itself is set in motion in the person of this representative, or the process is extended from the person to the principle. They do not come to the conclusion that that representative does not measure up to the principle and must therefore be substituted with another person who can really represent it, but instead they go on to say that the principle itself is false or harmful and must be substituted with another principle.

In how many cases does the attack against this or that degenerate, vain, or vicious aristocrat get translated into the attack against the very aristocratic principle in itself and into a tool of demagogy? And perhaps the subversive and heretical action of Luther, having as his excuse the corruption of the representative of the Roman Church, had a different meaning? Again, history is rich with episodes of the type, equivalent to many other moments of the worldwide subversion. Let us remember that the ancient hierarchical system was constituted by a spiritual authority, under which stood the warrior aristocracy, then a bourgeois caste and then the working masses. The fall of this traditional system, in many of its aspects, had as its instrument the tactic here indicated. The warrior aristocracy rose up against the decadent representatives of the pure spiritual authority, not through substituting them with another, more worthy representatives of the same principle, but by drawing from that the pretense to be emancipated or lay claim for itself the supreme authority. In a following phase, i.e., in a following civilization, the Third Estate rises up against the degenerate warrior aristocracy not because it ceded the place to the true aristocrats, but to seize power for itself. In yet another phase, the process against capitalism and the bourgeoisie (i.e.,

against the Third Estate) in its destructive and negative aspects does not aim for a corresponding reform, but is only the excuse for the revolt of the proletariat and the usurpation of power—descending progressively from step to step—straight through to the party of the proletariat (bolshevism, communism).

Conclusion The fact that, for reasons of space, we only indicated some examples and we were concerned above all with the exposition of the principles, not to prevent—we hope—seeing what vast fields of application these principles can have and to that valuable results it could reach those who, adequately equipped, can apply them methodically in any field. Since one can assert without uncertainty that there is not a single area in which the occult battle of the forces of worldwide subversion are not in any developed way; and indeed these areas that would seem more unrelated to events of the type are those that, by principle, should be considered with the greatest wariness.

We repeat one more time that it is not a question of "philosophical positions", but of things much more real and that there is no leader or combatant at the front of the counter-subversion and the tradition that can be called mature and at the peak of its true tasks, before having developed in itself the faculty of seeing clearly in this subterranean world of cause and of indicating quickly the action of this or that invisible tool which our enemy does not cease to adopt in every epoch that, like the current one, sounding the prelude to the moment of final decision and the final battle of all, a cycle of civilization.

Posted on 2012-05-07 by Aeneas

* * *

Lyon on 2018-05-07 at 14:54 said:

Hmmm... Does this possibly dovetail with the work of E Michael Jones, specifically in his work titled, *The Jewish Revolutionary Spirit and Its Impact on World History*? Jones, in that work, describing the comparatively small portion of the iceberg that can be seen above the surface.

I've only recently been introduced to his writings via Fidelity Press and his culturewars.com website. Admittedly, both Evola and Jones are approaching our predicament from differing vantage points.

As for Evola, the only work of his I've read in depth (... studied and ruminated) was The Hermetic Tradition, Symbols and Teachings of the Royal Art.

My understanding of both Jones and Evola are still in formation. Any general guidance and cautions on either is appreciated.

`fractalkhaosstrikesonceagain on 2018-05-09 at 17:48 said:`

As usual with your Blog GornaHoor: Thanks a lot Cologero for OPENING OUR EYES : You help us to face our real(s) foe(s) ...

`jalexandermaximilian on 2020-08-18 at 21:08 said:`

I've been thinking lately, about the past decade or so, of these occult forces, which use men, men who appear as powerful but are really just pawns of these forces. It seems now more than ever "leaders" are not in control of their own thoughts and actions It seems the world of men is being propelled toward some finale. Can it continue in this manner without a finale, or will ot continue unto a whimper? This sort of understanding is why now I eschew all U.S. polytricks, the men you see are not in control of anything... even themselves. They may think they are. But their works and goals are all for another Thing. I seek God. Then wonder if I am my own Master? From where does even thought arise?

Lyon: Jews would merely be another group of pawns serving another more powerful force, they are certainly hardheaded and organized, but that seems to me to be a case of an external mind using them to its own goal with great success.

`veritycacciatrice on 2022-01-09 at 05:34 said:`

"For now, it is enough to establish this point: we must not allow the third dimension of history to vanish in the fog of abstract and philosophical views, but we must consider it inhabited and occupied by quite precise "intelligences", whose expression and closest mouthpieces were almost always certain secret societies or organizations, but which must not at all totally express the intelligences, but just having their beginning and end in them."

I witnessed this first hand less than a fortnight ago.

My son was doing some study on Garibaldi in Italian and he suggested I watch a video he'd seen on it (more for the comedy styling than the content).

I was following along and was surprised to see the most bloody battle location in the second War of Independence chosen due to its name.

Charlotte on 2012-05-09 at 07:53 said:

Yes, subversion – 'black magic' works by subverting and perverting the true spiritual forces, in no small part through 'bad practice'. Depending on the individual and their potential and actual power, this can indeed be disastrous. The abomination of the desolation, the breaching of the Holy of Holies. the rend must be fixed. The ancient forces tend to react badly – out of character, out of bed the 'wrong way' – when needlessly awoken (mediumship), roused for the wrong reasons. And yes, it is all too easy to be deceived outside the known framework, the 'safe zone, amounting to entering a labyrinth without the guiding thread which one follows in order to return. The severance of the silver cord is no laughing matter, one requires rescue!

logres on 2012-05-09 at 09:23 said:

Evola is unusually clear and prescient, and not so wordy, in these passages. Many thanks! I am interested in his idea that the Catholic Church (at that point, and perhaps still) could be made a bulwark against certain tendencies and currents. I fear that we may have moved beyond such a point, irremediably, although certainly the question cannot be decided on an empirical basis. My instinct tells me that the Church could still be awakened, that it slumbers, and that it is a sleeping giant. Who will awaken her?

logres on 2012-05-09 at 09:52 said:

Tactic number 3, falsifying substitution. Classic example of this would be the resurgent Confederacy of the southern states in 1865 – they thought they were fighting for altar and hearth – in reality, they were being used to provoke a frightful advance of the occult power, by obscuring the goal in the midst of a provoked reaction. I suppose 1938 Germany might be an even better example. Each time this "false start" occurs, it cements the overall process.

Charlotte on 2012-05-09 at 12:38 said:

Oddly enough I was compelled yesterday to revist one of Rudolf Steiner's stranger books, *Secret Brotherhoods and the Mystery of the Human Double*, in particular the lectures relating to Individual Spirit Beings and the Constant Foundation of the Universe.

I know there are no big Steiner fans here (unless they're hiding!), but in the present context he is very helpful and penetrates even further into the 'nature of the beast', as it were. I just transcribed a large portion of this work on Alchemical Weddings:

http://alchemical-weddings.com/alchemical-weddings/the-constant-formation-of-the-universe

One thing I've ommitted is the constant talk of 'post Atlantean epochs', be they fifth, sixth or whatever, as I've never really made sense of them, perhaps I don't like the labels.

Here is the end of the extract, which I think you might enjoy:

What lies in store for humanity is that cosmic forces will be won for humanity in a dual way that is wrong or a single way that is right. This will bring a genuine renewal to astrology, which is atavistic in its old form – a form in which it cannot continue to exist. Those who know about the cosmos will struggle against each other... .for the remainder of earthly existence the dead will collaborate with us to a high degree.

The moment you penetrate fully into all the secrets of the double, you will find yousrelf able to assess the value of brains that are merely lumps which you have placed on a scale, lumps which can be brought to life solely by the double.

You must come to realise that all the wishy-washy talk of 'cosmic religosity' or 'how powerful the yearning for it is', and so on is nothing other than a means of spreading fog over these matters which ought actually to be entering the world in clarity and which, above all, ought only to be carried in clarity into human life as practical moral and ethical impulses.

It generally sheds light on the nature of the occult war as it is manifesting now, very helpful I thought, along with Evola's texts. When occultists manage to agree you know you're onto something!

Also coincidentally, the recent talk of 'Saturn' made me think, firstly, that he was eaten by his children so we should really focus more on IoPitar? Also I was contacted by a group related to the Philosophers of Nature, so of course the memory of 'touching saturn' was revived. Interesting synchronicities from a personal point of view that may also resonate with others here.

logres on 2012-05-09 at 14:34 said:

Steiner was tainted with evolutionary worldviews, but "knew" better. That statement of his about religious "feeling" demonstrates such. Steiner was Goethe's heir, so he shared Goethe's failings. Just as there is a danger that the individual could "fail" and collapse in the postmortem state, so there is a cosmic danger that this world could implode, in more than a physical manner. Christians can "rest" in Christ's sure sacrifice, but this may entail complications which are unnecessary, not to mention enormous suffering.

Charlotte on 2012-05-09 at 14:54 said:

well I think it's tricky to find any occultist (human after all) who doesn't have failings, though? Evola, Guenon etc are routinely attacked for being 'fascist' or whatever – I think it's partly a hazard of the job and a consequence of the times they lived in. Even VT had, in my opinion, unfair ideas to do with shamanism, so I can't even agree with him on everything. Lots of wisdom to be learned from them all but we must always take care to show discernment and

think for ourselves... also to be heedful of the fact that we are at a different stage in history, esoteric or otherwise. Nevertheless, I do think Steiner's insight into the occult war are very illuminating in the present context, bringing a bit more spirt to the dryness of Evola, which I nonetheless found useful.

Angolmois on 2012-05-09 at 15:10 said:

Steiner may be helpful as you say Charlotte, but in reality the only reason why Evola is "dry" is because he doesn't stray into unnecessary or fantastic areas in his analysis of the occult war.

You are certainly right about thinking for ourselves. Many esotericists have a hidden need, sometimes even a vice, to rest upon the shoulders of this or that authority.

Charlotte on 2012-05-09 at 15:27 said:

I wonder how we should see the present wars around the world in light of all this... .

logres on 2012-05-09 at 22:25 said:

Charlotte, thanks for the quote, which I read in full at your site. I agree that Steiner is useful, just trying to place him in full context. As Cologero says, we learn from and (hopefully) in some sense, go beyond (in the sense of seeing their failings more clearly).

Charlotte on 2012-05-11 at 12:36 said:

I think we have to define 'fantastic' as it's a matter of opinion depending upon experience. From a rational perspective much of what Evola says is right, and yet I personally see a lot more depth in Steiner's analysis, which speaks to personal experience more concretely. Something is only 'fantastic' if you don't believe it's possible, but there are not the usual rules and boundaries in the 'other worlds', of time and space, for one, which are pretty enormous limiting factors on the physical plane. The rules 'on the other side' are different but the playing is just as hard. I agree, however, that one must learn to read Steiner in a particular way and not take everything to heart or on board, simply to scan for what resonates.

logres on 2012-05-10 at 08:34 said:

Ricochet – Luther thinks he is re-masculinizing the Church, but actually, the destruction of intellect & tradition leads to sentimentality. A warning... to me.

Angolmois on 2012-05-11 at 03:39 said:

... but actually, the destruction of intellect & tradition leads to sentimentality."

And it leads also to protestant capitalism, bouregous liberalism, and finally to "kulturkampf" and to the destruction of monasticism in the 19th century. Quite a ricohcet.

Charlotte on 2012-05-11 at 04:40 said:

so many actions and reactions in the course of history – eventually the balance will be found

Avery on 2012-05-10 at 23:52 said:

Substituting a principle for a person is a very interesting metaphor. It's really a process of the lower ranks being instructed that their superiors do not have special right but are only employing a general principle which can be understood by anyone, which leads them to think that the principle is more important than the person. They rid themselves of what their perceive as a useless middleman, only to discover that they are lost without a dedicated superior to guide them.

Charlotte on 2012-05-11 at 06:06 said:

'superior'... .hmmm... ..people have different qualities, in the ideal scenario they will take it in turns to lead depending on what is required – just like a team of long-distance walkers will take it in turns to keep the pace. This should of course happen organically and intuitive in a utopian sense, but in reality there tend to be infights and intrigues if there is no rigid plan to follow. It also supposes the basic equality of peoples, which I do believe in principle but in practice it doesn't always show through. Often people just need a chance to shine and being trapped in a rigidly hierarchical 'management structure' doesn't necessarily allow this. Nowadays people tend to be discouraged from thinking for themselves, one of the reasons I'm sure why alcohol is so widely prevalent, cheap and encouraged, whereas cannabis, for instance – something Americans could once pay their taxes with, and which it was compulsory for farmers to grow in England – is outlawed and demonised. Such is the fate of anything that interferes with the profit potential and control mechanisms of large corporations. I realise you guys probably hate this kind of talk and possibly I was missing the point of your comment, but I still felt moved to say this. Also it's true lol!

Cologero on 2012-05-11 at 08:38 said:

Sure, Charlotte, just as you allow your neighbours to "take turns" fixing your car, or providing you with healthcare.

Alcohol and marijuana are so popular because they are the great equalizers and levelers. In their "normal state", men differ considerably from each other, in their intelligence, wisdom, sanctity, ability ... in every conceivable way. But every drunk and every stoned-out person is exactly alike.

Charlotte on 2012-05-11 at 12:01 said:

ah well, too much of anything is a bad thing, but I'm not one for stereotyping. I do find it intensely ironice that an extremely useful plant is demonised whereas super strength alcohol and tobacco (a totally non-beneficial product) are considered acceptable. You obviously don't know the history behind 'wacky backy', but I can promise you it was once considered so useful that to grow it was considered helping the war effort. And no, that doesn't mean I spent all day 'stoning'. Apart from anything else I hate tobacco. As for the pros and cons of mind altering substances we could go on all day about this if we were of the HPB, Crowley or Gurdjieff school – as it happens I tend to think there are far more cons because abuse happens far more often than use. However, the Pythia of Delphi and others like her might well disagree, as might the rainforest shamens or other representatives of ancient tradition. Nothing new age about it. Unlike LSD, which was created by the Tavistock Institute to create mind-blown hippies and other enemies. I hate to have to point it out, but probably even the Essenes partook of holy moly, according to recent evidence that has detected cannabis oil around their settlements – the medicinal benefits of this plant are beyond dispute, it's prejudice that makes people blind to it. As it happens I don't keep a car, it's bad for the environment, but when I did the neighbour did help fix it more than once. Healthcare in England is free for all and we like it that way... .

Charlotte on 2012-05-11 at 12:04 said:

actually, the one thing you CAN say about stoners is they're total pacifists and adept at minding their own business, whereas alcoholics are invariably violent towards self and others.

Charlotte on 2012-05-11 at 12:12 said:

the reason alcohol and marijuana are popular is NOT because they're levellers, it's because in the case of the former it lowers inhibitions – good for social interraction – and stimulates the brain to produce dopamine, which is highly pleasureable. It is also very addictive, which leads to repeated use. THC and cannabidiol on the other hand are known neuroprotective antioxidants but the effects of smoking or ingesting it range from total euphoria, feelings of 'universal connectivity', increased empathy and other things that sound dreadful to some folk, to paranoia, nausea and delusions. Strong stuff. But I digress, let me get back to the study books.

Cologero on 2012-05-11 at 19:20 said:

You just stereotyped them, and proved my point. Drunks are all alike and stoners are all alike ... great levelers.

Charlotte on 2012-05-12 at 09:38 said:

what rubbish, I did no such thing!! I read Evola experimented a lot with hallucinogens – does that mean he's 'just like them' ?! :-)

Logres on 2012-05-13 at 00:30 said:

"... and always pushing well beyond the process of falling, "

I didn't understand the syntax here...

The overall thought that Satan leads men back in circles is a brilliant one. Tea Party? Reformation?

Cologero on 2012-05-13 at 08:23 said:

I'm open to suggestions to make it read more clearly ... the word is spingere: push, urge, drive. The idea is that the theory of progress is driving the process of the fall forward.

... by the way, recent high-level announcements and the instant worldwide reaction, seemingly coordinated, seem to demonstrate this tactic in action. So who can anticipate the next "thrust"?

Graham on 2012-05-15 at 23:26 said:

Re: the substitution of the principle to the person, there is a variant. It's interesting how modern popes and clergymen apparently recognize their own lack of spiritual authority, leading them to 'tone down' the principles they are supposed to represent. For instance, John Paul II rejecting the papal tiara was significant. Stated otherwise: conscious of their own lack of 'charismatic' authority, they seek to present the church as a bourgeois 'traditional' and 'bureaucratic' authority, something they feel at ease with.

2 Principle and Action

2.1 Chapter 1

In 1959 **Julius Evola** published a translation and commentary on the *Tao Te Ching* under the title *Il Libro del Principio e della sua Azione* The Book of the Principle and its Action . His interpretation is based on his knowledge of Tradition.

Many years prior he had written an alternative translation that was based more on his studies of German Idealism than on Tradition.

> The Tao that can be named
> Is not the eternal Tao
> The Name that can be pronounced
> Is not the eternal Name
> (As the) Nameless it is the principle of Heaven and Earth
> With the Name that is: determined as Heaven and Earth it is the origin of the myriad particular beings

So: the one who is detached
Perceives the Mysterious Essence
Which is obscured by desire
The gaze is stopped by the limit he sees only the phenomena of appearances of the Principle
Now of the two the Nameable and the Unnamable, being and non-being
One essence, only the name is different
Their identity is mysterious
It is the unfathomable depth
Beyond the threshold of the ultimate mystery

The two aspects of the Principle are indicated here, the one transcendent (unnameable, without form — equivalent to non-Being, the Emptiness, the unmoved), the other immanent (nameable, with form — equivalent to Being, fullness, the movable). Other Taoist designations: The "Former Heaven" (*hsien t'ien*) and the "Later Heaven" (*hou t'ien*). The first determination of the Tao (called also "the great Mutation") is Heaven-and-Earth which are cosmic symbols of the Yang and the Yin. This Dyad produces all the modifications, therefore the myriad particular beings, of their paths and of their destinies ("The Great Flux", the "current of forms").

The unmanifested and the manifested, the formless and the formal, the Former Heaven and the Later Heaven, are not distinct temporally (as if at a certain moment something similar to a "creation" intervened), but in logico-metaphysical terms. Transcendence is immanent, the fullness coexists with the emptiness, non-being is the source of being: identity, that constitutes the ultimate mystery of Taoist realization.

See *Lieh Tzu*:

> The chain of productions and transformations is interrupted, the producer and the transformer producing and transforming without it — the producer is unmovable, the transformer comes and

goes. And the motionless and the mobile endure always. ... Analyzing the production of the universe, the opening up of the sensible from the non-sensible, the seed of the calm generative action of Heaven and Earth, the ancient Sages distinguished these stages: the Great Mutation, the Great Origin, the Great Commencement, the Great Flux.

Chinese text and literal translation Chapter 1 (第一章)

道可道，非恆道； 名可名，非恆名。 無名天地之始； 有名萬物之母。 故， 恆無，欲也，以觀其妙； 恆有，欲也，以觀其徼。 此兩者同出而異名， 同謂之玄。 玄之又玄，衆妙之門。	The Dao that can be stated, is not the eternal Dao; The name that can be named, is not the eternal name. The nameless is the origin of heaven and earth; The named is the mother of the myriad things. So, By constantly having no desire one views its wonders; By constantly having desire , one views its limits. These two have the same origin, but they differ in name; Both are called Mystery. One Mystery plus another Mystery, is the source of all wonders.

Posted on 2020-03-12 by Lao Tzu

2.2 Chapter 2

For everything under this heaven, the beautiful conceived
The ugly is born (as correlative)
The good established
The not-good takes form.
Likewise: being and non-being mutually condition each other
The possible and the impossible are complementary differentiations
Large and small characterize each other
The high flips over to the low
Clear sounds and noise complement each other
Before and after or: ahead and behind follow each other in a circle
The True Man is like that
He endures in non-acting
He teaches without speaking
He directs without touching without commanding
He forms he makes happen, he leads to development without taking control
He accomplishes without doing without calling attention to the one who acts
Essentially: not residing in the domain of the correlative where the game of opposites unfolds
He always participates in the original force.

Commentary In the first lines, referring on one hand to the law of correlation of all human notions; then, on the other hand, to its ontological counterpart, to that which can be called the "dialectic of the real". Taoistically: the solidarity and action alternating as opposites, Yin and Yang, gives rise to modifications of the phenomenal world that now complete

each other, then pass one into the other.

This dynamism, previously in the *I Ching* given by the circle of the "Figures of Heaven", that is, the trigrams and hexagrams, does not touch the calm and undifferentiated essence of the Principle. Chuang tze: "The immobile center of a circle on the circumference of which crowns all contingencies, distinctions and individuals". From this, it describes the non-acting behavior of the True Man, of the *sheng jen*, insofar he reflects in himself the Principle in its aspect without name.

On the gnosiological plane, the relativity and the irrelevance of human distinctions is deduced from the principle of correlation of opposites; therefore, of all the current values which correspond to nothing in reality: "only great spirits are capable of understanding." (Chuang Tze)

Chinese text and literal translation Chapter 2 (第二章)

天下皆知美之美， 斯惡已； 皆知善之善， 斯不善已。 故 有無相生， 難易相成， 長短相形， 高下相傾， 音聲相和， 前後相隨。 是以 聖人處無之事， 行不言之， 萬物作焉而不辭， 生而不有， 而不恃，	If everybody knows what beauty is, then beauty is not beauty anymore; If everybody knows what goodness is, then goodness is not goodness anymore. Therefore, Being and nothing give birth to one another, Hard and easy are mutually formed, Long and short shape each other, High and low complement each other, Music and voice are harmonized with each other, Front and back follow one another.

功成而弗居。
夫唯弗居，是以不去。

Hence,
The sage focuses on non-action
in his works,
Practices not-saying in his speech,
The myriad things arise but are
disregarded
The sage produces but does not
own
Acts but does not claim
Accomplishes work but does not
focus on it
Does not focus on it, and thus it
does not go.

Posted on 2020-03-21 by Lao Tzu

2.3 Chapter 3

By esteeming in excess
Conflict is provoked in reaction
Emphasizing what is rare to possess
Creates guilty desire for appropriation
It weakens that which, in things, attracts
And the soul will remain calm
Thus: the True Man acting as leader
Moves without preference and appetites
He weakens his impulses the man of desire, the physical I , tempers his inner being his bones
Without a exterior knowing and without desires the guides the ten thousand beings
He confuses those who know

He avoids acting centered in the Self
And society will always live free in its order

Commentary Some translators have rendered the line "the *sheng jen* without knowing or desiring to guide the people" with "the *sheng jen* ensures that the people have neither knowledge nor will". In order to ignore the symbolic valence of the respective characters, in a modern Chinese translation the "without preference or appetites" then becomes "the real man empties his heart and fills his belly"!!! Along the same line, there are among sinologists those who have even interpreted the rule contained in these lines as "stupefying the people" (the 10 thousand beings) on the one hand and, on the other, as "repressing the most nobly human in heart and will (*hsin* e *chih*) and coaxing instead the most vulgarly bestial part — belly and bones (*fu* e *ku*)."

The internal logic of the whole chapter corroborates instead the lesson here adopted. Non-knowing and non-desiring (in the sense of discursive knowing and the desiring of the individual) are the traits repeatedly attributed to the True Man of the *Tao Te Ching* which in him are virtues insofar as they would be the opposite in laymen and the common people, that is, insofar as they would be unattainable (if taken in the positive sense, as virtue).

In other chapters it is said, yes to the utility of keeping the people in ignorance that safeguards their original simplicity (something different from "stupefying"). But for now, it alludes instead to a propitiatory desaturation of size and a distancing of tensions and disordered appetites (first lines of the chapter). As was said, one thinks that with his sole presence the True Man acts in such a direction over the environment, nurturing an ordered spontaneity in social life.

Chinese text and literal translation Chapter 3 (第三章)

不賢，
使民不爭。
不貴難得之貨，
使民不盜。
不見可欲，
使民心不亂。
是以聖人之治，
虛其心，
實其腹，
弱其志，
强其骨。
常使民無知無
　欲，
使夫智者不敢
　為也。
為無為，
則無不治。

Not to quest for wealth
will keep the people from rivalry.
Not to prize things that are hard to come by
will keep the people from becoming thieves.
Not to manifest what you like and desire
will make popular sentiments undisturbed.
So, in the sages' peaceful and tranquil world,
People's state of mind is calm,
People live with enough food
People's aspirations are lowered,
People's physiques are strong;
People will be unknowing, undesiring,
And even the knowing ones will never dare to act,
Action without action.
There is nothing not done.

Posted on 2020-03-27 by Lao Tzu

* * *

Geber on 2020-03-28 at 02:06 said:

"Someone who keeps on going from the shade into the sun and then back into the shade is a fool. A wise man stays permanently in the shade." Sri Ramana Maharshi

2.4 Chapter 4

The Tao is not substance, it is inexhaustible activity
Acting does not increase it
As it is unfathomable!
It is like the primordial source of all things.
It blunts the sharp
It clarifies the confused
It dims the bright
It orders the elementary parts "powder" (of matter)
It is elusive and yet omnipresent
How could it have been begotten?
It is anterior (and superior) to the Lord of Heaven

Commentary Insubstantiality ("emptiness") is emphasized, the pure activity of the Principle, that neither expands nor diminishes it (therefore in opposition both to the theory of "becoming" of the Spirit, and to that of its deterioration through emanation). The Taoist image is also that of a vase that, while turning continually, what it contains remains full and in order to fill itself, still remains empty. "Primordial source" is the abstract meaning of *tsung* in the text, which is literally ancestor, the original father. If the image is conserved, given the part of the regulator typical of the Chinese head of the family, in the fourth line, following some translations, the idea of an ordering power can also be included. Then a natural connection is established with the four successive lines that are about the action of the Tao.

For Taoist metaphysic, the two last lines are important, where the principle is called "without origin" — *wu yuan* — superior and anterior to the King of Heaven (the Shangdi[1]), i.e., to the personal God. In this passage a certain circumspect way of expressing itself was emphasized linguistically, due to the part that the Shangdi had in the cult of the

[1] `https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Shangdi`

State under Chou's dynasty, when the Tao Te Ching was composed. It is like that through a concern for that conception of exoterism. But in the Introduction, we noted the irrelevance of the personal, theistic and anthropomorphic conceptions of the divine to the primordial tradition of the Far East, taken up in its abstract, metaphysical orientation by Lao Tzu. Chuang Tzu (II,3) makes clear that one can admit the principle of a universal regulator (from which the principle of every unity, family, people, etc. derives through participation) but on condition that one does not make a distinct personal being out of what is intended "as an influence without a comprehensible form".

Chinese text and literal translation Chapter 4 (第四章)

道沖， 而用之或不盈。 淵兮，似萬物 之宗。 挫其銳， 解其紛， 和其光， 同其塵。 湛兮，似或存。 吾不知誰之子， 象帝之先。	The Dao is empty, But when using it, it is impossible to use it up. It is profound, seems like the root of the myriad things. Blunts its own sharpness. Unravels its own fetters. Harmonises its own light. Mixes with its own dust. It is unclear, but seems to have existed there. I do not know whose son it is, Maybe it was already created before the creator.

Posted on 2020-04-09 by Lao Tzu

2.5 Chapter 5

The Universal Heaven and Earth is not humane compassionate
All things (products) use them as means
True Men are not humane (*jen*)
Beings use them as means
(Like) emptiness between Heaven and Earth in its Virtue
The Principle is like a bellows
It is emptied yet unexhausted
Even if creating inexhaustibly with its motion
(Thus) it is vain to multiply words and projects (in the care for individuals)
Keeping in the middle is the best.

In the word translated as "means" (second and fourth lines) is literally "straw dogs" (*ch'a kou*), likenesses fabricated in ancient China for certain rites and then abandoned, thrown away. It wants to express that the Absolute considers individuals only as a universal function, i.e., as a function of that which transcends them, for every other verse, that is for what are simple ephemeral apparitions in the current of forms, the Principle not taking care of them (non-humanizing), against the religious conception of Providence and the God of Love.

Since he reproduces in himself the detached quality of the Principle, the True Man likewise ignores human concern, even as the Confucian *jen* (sympathy, sociality), from some Taoist comments called the "small virtue" or the "lower virtue". In the last two lines, in word and action in view of the particular as such, the action from the "center" is counterposed, that is to say, from a neutrality free from preferences and sentimentality, in view not of part, but of the whole, of the Universal. It makes the virtue of the Tao from the model, which even if producing inexhaustibly remains "empty" (image of the bellows), that is, pure simple, "free from

the I". See Chuang Tzu (V,2) who says, referring to Wang t'ai, whose influences "derive from its transcendence": Reaching perfect impassability "lf beings evolve according to their destinies and maintains himself as the immobile center of all fates" (as in another passage, II, e, it is said, of the Principle: "The immobile center of a circle on the circumference of which run all contingencies, distinctions, and individuals" since "there are two ways to consider beings, as distinct individuals or as all in a great whole". It is the imperturbability of a spirit that, "higher than heaven, earth, and all beings, lives in a body. Absolutely independent, he is lord of men".

There are those who have wanted to see the reflection of a cold Machiavellianism without scruples in the ideas just expressed. Also the descent down to the political plane that could be right only if the reference point was a powerful individual's will to dominate, that is, the intensification of a particular I who, on the contrary, is the first thing that True Men destroy in themselves.

About the last line, we read also in the Chung Yung: "To maintain the middle path is perfection, but there are very few in the world who can keep it". That is to say, the metaphysical meaning is opposed to that of moderation, of the practical "golden mean". About the noted relativity of the divergence of the views of Las Tzu and Confucius, we can cite, still in the same context, the following passage of the latter: "Who rules according to the virtue of Heaven resembles the polar star: it is immobile, but all revolve orderly around it" (*Lun you*, II, 1 Analects).

Chinese text and literal translation

Chapter 5 (第五章)

天地不仁	The sky and the earth do not care,
以萬物為芻狗；	They regard the myriad things as straw dogs;
聖人不仁，	The sage does not care,
以百姓為芻狗。	

天地之閒其猶
　　橐籥乎？
虛而不屈，
動而愈出。
多言數窮，
不如守中。

He regards people as straw dogs.
The space between the sky and
　　the earth, how much is it
　　like large bellows!
Empty but endless,
Just move and wind will be
　　produced;
Much talk soon comes to noth-
　　ing.
It is better to be in between
　　extremes.

Posted on 2020-08-22 by Lao Tzu

* * *

`Sensitive Ears on 2020-08-27 at 01:19 said:`
These posts would be improved by audio recordings of the Chinese.

`Cologero on 2020-08-27 at 06:19 said:`
Mr. Ears, you remind me of a bad girlfriend ... whatever I do is never good enough.
Do you prefer Mandarin or Cantonese for the recording?

2.6 Chapter 6

The energy of middle space the valley is eternal
It is the Mysterious Female
The gate of the Mysterious Female
Is the root of Heaven and Earth
Continuous and invariable
It acts and does not exhaust itself

There is a possible interaction in this chapter of the doctrine of the Tao with residues of the archaic conception of the primogenial maternal Feminine (*Magna Mater Genitrix,* i.e., Great Mother). "The Power of middle space" — literally in images: "vital force (or spirit) of the valley". The valley, understood as the space between two mountain ranges, goes back to the idea both of Emptiness and of the central space where the virtue of the principle is manifested, in the eternal emanation and transformation (contrary to the meaning of the valley — and of the feminine — in chapters 61 & 66).

The gate with two shutters in some commentaries referred to the Principle that acts through the Dyad, the yin and the yang. The whole does not become clear because here the idea of Virtue is superimposed, in a certain way, onto the idea of the Principle. Finally, it has to do with the etheric fluid (chi). This is one of the more convoluted chapters, explained in various ways. It is also about those things that were made objects of esoteric interpretation in operative Taoism, with reference to the human being occultly considered. Characters were used with technical significance whose meaning is difficult to track down. As a hint to interpretations of this type, the Mysterious Female is the principle or energy of the yin soul (*po*) from which those who seek corporeal immortality much extract and coagulate the subtle essence. The gate with two shutters alludes to the nose. The allusion to the technique of breath is learned from the last two lines: "for long, long stretches one breathes as if one wished to hold the breath, remaining immobile" (see J J M DeGroot, *Universismus*, Berlin 1918, pp 110-111). The Mysterious Female is the "interior woman": "she is continually in us", says Kuan Tzu.

Chinese text and literal translation Chapter 6 (第六章)

谷神不死	The valley-spirit will not die,
是謂玄牝	this is the primal mother.
玄牝之門	The gate of the primal mother

是謂天地根	is the root of the world.
綿綿若存	She unceasingly exists,
用之不勤	Her influence is without effort.

Posted on 2020-08-29 by Lao Tzu

2.7 Chapter 7

The Universe is eternal
It is eternal
Because it does not live for itself
Therefore: The True Man
By retreating, advances
By remaining outside, he is ever present
By not acting for himself, the center
Reaches perfection.

Although the characters used in the first line are "Heaven and Earth", here they express the idea of totality, and it is not the "nameable", qualified Principle, that is referred to here but to action that makes it eternal: it "is" in the transcendent sense since it is denied.

The word "retreating" = not to put in front of himself. Reproducing in oneself the way of the Tao, the True Man advances, rises transcendentally, as the absolute individual, in so far as he does not make his human individuality the center (it can also be translated: not having person — inclinations of person — becomes person, he obtains a persona). Technical Taoist expressions: "to drop the persona like a habit".

Chinese text and literal translation Chapter 7 (第七章)

天長地久。
天地所以能長
　且久者，
以其不自生，
故能長生。
是以聖人後其
　身
而身先，
外其身
而身存。
非以其無私邪？
故能成其私。

The sky and the earth / The universe is eternal.
The reason for the eternal of the sky and the earth/the universe
Is they are not being/existing alone,
So they are eternal.
Because of this, The sages put their selves behind all other people,
Yet it is before all others he shall eventually stand.
They were indifferent to the discomforts and dangers.
Yet it is he who shall thus survive.
It is none other than that they do not demand self.
Yet it is he eventually who shall achieve for self.

Posted on 2020-09-08 by Lao Tzu

* * *

roballenvalecourt on 2020-09-08 at 10:56 said:
enjoying your Taoist excursions... good to see you post the Chinese characters with your interpretations...

Cologero on 2020-09-08 at 19:52 said:
Actually, the interpretations belong to Julius Evola.

2.8 Chapter 8

The transcendent quality resembles water
Without resisting it assumes the form of each thing
It takes the lowest position that men scorn (because they are seeking the heights)
The farther one is from acting in common, the more one is close to the Way
Thus the True Man in the material domain holds remaining in the place he has as good
In the domain of feeling he holds the depth of the abyss as good
If he gives, he holds (impersonal) generosity as good
Speaking, he holds the truth as good
Governing he holds ordered development as good
Acting, he holds the watchful realization of the end as good
In the practical domain, he holds being at the right place as good
Really, even thanks to adapting without conflict
Nothing changes his being

Classical Taoist comparison of water for subtle acting and the "higher virtue" (*shang shan*). Adapting himself exteriorly to things and situations, he does not exalt but descends below (which means: beyond superficiality) in order to exercise the desired influence. According to another aspect: in this context the saying "fracture but do not bend" is tied to the mania of the I; "bending myself (=water) it fractures" could be contrasted. The whole of the behavior illustrated in this chapter is designated as *I hsing* (which is equivalent to "ease of nature"). The positive counterpart is also recommended: a spontaneous and essential mode of working, beyond opposites.

Chinese text and literal translation Chapter 8 (第八章)

上善若水。
水善利萬物而
有靜，
處衆人之所惡，
故幾於道。
居善地，
心善淵，
與善仁，
言善信，
正善治，
事善能，
動善時。
夫唯不爭，
故無尤。

The best quality/character is like water.
The water's goodness is that it benefits the myriad things but does not quarrel,
and it willingly goes to where others hate,
Thus it is almost like the Tao.
It is good to be/live on the ground,
to deepen a heart,
to love people while associating with them.
to keep one's word while talking,
to be peace while governing,
to do what one is capable of,
to act at a fit time.
Because of the non-fighting-over,
there will be no blame.

Posted on 2020-09-20 by Lao Tzu

2.9 Chapter 9

To preserve when one is filled up to the brim
Is not possible

To keep a blade very sharp
Is not possible.
One cannot, at the same time,
Possess and conserve.
Goods and power united to pride
Prepare your own ruin
To act and pull back = to pass into the shadow
Is the Way of Heaven

References, through images, to the law of converting everything that is joined at the extreme into the opposite. Decadence begins at the peak. For essential mastery and for control of the transformations, it is necessary to know how to abandon at the right point what is brought to completion. To be tied to, and especially to be associated with, the pride of the I, means to plummet. The inner meaning of these maxims must be placed before the social and political meaning, where it usually ended in banal terms (for example: not to accumulate riches and goods because they cannot be made secure — or rather: to retreat to an obscure life after having realized or gathered honors).

Chinese text and literal translation Chapter 9 (第九章)

持而盈之， 不如其已。 揣而鋭之，不 可常保。 金玉滿堂，莫 之能守。 富貴而驕，自 遺其咎。 功遂身退，天 之道。	Rather than pour into a cup overflowed, It is better to stop it. To hammer and to sharpen, it will not be long to be broken. One cannot keep in eternal hiding a hall brimming with riches. The man arrogant from enor-

mous wealth buries disas-
ter upon his road.
Removing after succeeding fits
in with the Tao/principle
of the universe.

Posted on 2020-09-27 by Lao Tzu

2.10 Chapter 10

Conserving the One to which spirit and body are joined
And are no longer separated
To make the fresh and subtle breath circulate (in the body)
Begetting the embryo.
To polish the secret mirror excluding every complex thought
To which the mind does not wear itself out
In relations with the others and ruling the State
To follow non-acting
The instability changeableness of fortune the opening and
closing of the Gate of Heaven
Is worth developing the receptivity of the soul = the virtue
of the feminine
With the essential vision that embraces every aspect the four
dimensions
To eliminate (discursive) knowing = to seem ignorant
In order to reach the development
To create without possessing
To act without appropriating
To rise without forcing
This is the Way

The first part of the chapter reflects the ideas of operative Taoism about the elaboration of immortality. The hint about the practice with breathing, vehicle of vital energy that, subtlized, was used as means for the secret unification of the spirit and body in the Origin. Spirit and body, *hun* and *p'o* (first line) – technically: yang soul and yin soul, spiritual soul and physical soul. The former is the non-terrestrial luminous principle, the other is the being of life. One could also say: the "being" principle and the "life" principle. The privileged condition of immortality is obtained through the union of the two principles, in the sense of a perfect compenetration of the *po* by the *hun*, by "life", by "being", overwhelmed and occluded from entering into the current of forms. The integration of the two principles of the One is compared to the formation of an embryo – the embryo of an existence distant from transformation. On these practices, beyond the already cited study of H Maspero, we can see the text also translated into Italian, in the *Secret of the Golden Flower*.

The starting point of such practices is also sketched out: detachment from the environment, the simplification and the calm of the mind, in order to conserve one's own completely pure and integral nature. In **Chuang Tzu**, the "abstinence of the heart":

> Do not listen with the ear nor with the heart, but only with the spirit. To block the way of the senses, to keep the mirror of the heart pure. To keep oneself empty. From the outside, do not let things that no longer have names penetrate inside (impressions liberated from mental translations). (IV, 1)

> The transcendent Man exercises his intelligence only like a mirror: he knows without following attraction or repulsion, without leaving any traces. In such a way he is superior to everything and impartial in the face of it. (VII, 6)

> The heart of the True Man, completely calm, is like a mirror that reflects Heaven, Earth and all beings. (XIII, 1)

All this, by reconnecting to Lao Tzu's "polishing the secret mirror".

The successive operative developments, liking joining the "decoagulant" of body and spirit, are attested also in Lieh Tzu (II,3; IV, 6) in these terms:

> The spirit is condensed little by little as the body is dissolved" (one "etherizes", one "rarifies").

We note the correspondence with the formula *solve et coagula* of the Western Hermetic-alchemical tradition, which is known also in the formula "Flesh out the spiritual, spiritualize the body, make fixed the volatile and volatilize the fixed" (Part II of *The Hermetic Tradition*, #16)

The second part of the chapter outlines the "non-acting" behavior of the True Man.

Chinese text and literal translation Chapter 10 (第十章)

載營魄抱一，	If soul have been keeping on
能無離乎？	not being felt by the body,
專氣致柔，	How can the body and the
能嬰兒乎？	soul not part?
滌除玄覽，	Trying lungs to show they are
能無疵乎？	delicate,
愛民治國，	How can they be like babies?
能無知乎？	Clean the mirror of ultimate
天門開闔，	source,
能為雌乎？	How can they not found their
明白四達，	defect?
能無乎？	To love people and to govern
生之畜之，	the country,
生而不有，	How not to appoint the Jih/Zhi/wise
為而不恃，	people?

長而不宰，
是謂玄德。

The gate of the heaven shuts
and opens alternately and
frequently,
How to act like females?
Have known all the causes and
effects,
How to keep doing only the
backlog of things?
Quicken them, feed them,
Produce and do not own.
Act and do not claim.
Raise and do not rule.
This is called profound virtue.

Posted on 2020-10-04 by Lao Tzu

2.11 Chapter 11

Thirty spokes converge in the hub
But the essence of the wheel is the emptiness of the hub.
The vessels are made of clay
But it is the inner emptiness that makes the essence of the
vessel
The wall with windows and doors form a house
But it is their emptiness that makes its essence.
In general: the being serves as the useful means
The essence lies in non-being in emptiness.

Various images are used to express the idea that the essence of the material and the sensible lies in the immaterial and the invisible, that

the "fullness" is ordered to "emptiness": a reference to the metaphysical plane ("emptiness"=transcendence) and a reference concordant with the nature of non-acting. The wheel with thirty spokes was that of an ancient sacred chariot.

In the esoteric interpretation typical to operative Taoism this chapter was also put in relation with the distillation of the subtle from the dense, the second being ordered to the first and having to be resolved in the first (in the yang soul) in the "solution of the form".

For the ambivalence of the Tao, see the expression: "It is as heavy as a stone, as light as a feather."

Chinese text and literal translation Chapter 11 (第十一章)

三十輻共一轂，
當其無，有車
之用。
埏埴以為器，
當其無，有器
之用。
鑿戶牖以為室，
當其無，有室
之用。
故有之以為利，
無之以為用。

Put thirty spokes together to
one hub,
The original empty space makes
the use of wheel.
Knead clay into vessels,
The original empty space makes
the use of vessel.
Shape door and windows for
a house/room,
The original empty space makes
the use of house/room.
So the things that are made
are only conditions,
What we are using is still the
original empty space.

Posted on 2020-10-11 by Lao Tzu

2.12 Chapter 12

The vision of colors blinds men's eyes
The perception of sounds deafens the ears
The taste of flavors dulls the mouth
Identifying in action darkens the mind
Prurient desire destroys the possibility of motion (being tied to the desired object)
Therefore: the True Man
Does not lose the I in the not-I
He keeps out of the exterior, he consists in the interior.

Aphorisms with possible initiatic significance, in relation to the discipline of avoiding the duress of impressions of the external world (see, also, the "closing of the gate") so that to develop a subtle sensibility (that, which in the first lines is said to be muffled or prevented) and to consolidate inner freedom, so that it is equivalent to a gradual movement of the center from the level of the *p'o* soul to that of the *hun* soul. It is indeed Taoist teaching that the natural use of the senses can be detrimental, when it is a question of protecting and preserving intact the "original simplicity" (*p'u*): the bursting of the multiplicity of sense appearances into the mind.

As an example of the distance, in the Chinese text, between the literal meaning of the characters and their abstract meaning: literally the penultimate line would sound more or less like this: "The True Man is for the belly and not for the eye". If it is that the eye is considered as the gate through which the external world penetrates into the I, it alters it and transports it, muffling the inner senses, while the belly is taken as the "empty" part of the body, therefore, transposing (according to the ideas espoused in the preceding chapter), to symbols of the essential and transcendent part of the human being.

The preeminence of the belly over the eye therefore signifies that the

True Man does not lose himself in the world that is revealed to the eye, i.e., in the outer world, in the not-I. Something generally unknown in the West, obesity, the "great belly" with which "Immortals" and Taoist sages, but also certain Chinese and Japanese Buddhas, were often portrayed, has a symbolic character based on the idea just explained: it alludes to the development that has precisely the "empty" principle in such beings, or the dimension of "emptiness" — the immaterial or transcendent element. The lower belly — in Japanese: hara. On its significance of the center in Japanese esoteric schools existing to this day, see K. Durckheim, *Hara, Vital center of man according to Zen* and its problems that are connected there in our essay: The Japanese Hara-theory in its Relation to East and West (in East and West, number 2, 1958).

Chinese text and literal translation Chapter 12 (第十二章)

五色令人目盲，
五音令人耳聾，
五味令人口爽，
馳騁畋獵令人
　心發狂，
難得之貨令人
　行妨。
是以聖人為腹
　不為目，
故去彼取此。

The beautiful colors blind people's eyes,
The appealing music stun people's ears
The delicious flavors make people's mouth numb,
To indulge in hunting makes people's heart wild,
To pursue rare treasures makes people's behavior improper.
So, as the sage attends to the inner world, not the outer world,
Throw away the latter and adopt the former.

Posted on 2020-10-18 by Lao Tzu

* * *

Gabe Ruth on 2020-11-18 at 12:41 said:

Bet my man Chesterton wouldn't have been so down on the wisdom of the East if he'd known about their attitude toward great bellies.

2.13 Chapter 13

Favors received injure as much as disgrace
Greatness weighs down the body.
What is meant by: "Favors received injures as much as disgrace?"
Favors received entails its own reduction
There is anxiety in waiting for it
There is anxiety in losing it.
What is meant by: "Greatness weighs down the body"?
To have a body person means to offer a hold
The body is the principle of heaviness
If you did not have it
There would not be possibilities.
Therefore: whoever is detached from greatness
Can freely rule the empire
Whoever is attached to the body as little as the empire
Can be entrusted with the empire.

The text of this chapter is somewhat corrupt. Thus there have been divergent translations. Instead of "favors received" one can also read: fortune, honors received; it refers, then, to depending on the cause of that, with the implicit lowering of its own more intimate dignity, which is

"disgrace". The ideogram for the body can also be rendered as "person"; then the possibilities given as terms of comparison for that to which the outer profane greatness shows, there are those inherent to being person, in the limitative sense: by varying this, with which the whole can agree equally by creating minor modifications, preserving the comprehensive interpretation given to the chapter.

Chinese text and literal translation Chapter 13 (第十三章)

寵辱若驚，
貴大患若身。
何謂寵辱若驚？
寵為下。
得之若驚，失之若驚，
是謂寵辱若驚。
何謂貴大患若身？
吾所以有大患者，為吾有身；
及吾無身，吾有何患？
故貴以身為天下，
若可寄天下。
愛以身為天下，
若可託天下。

To appoint the person that is ploughed under is the same as to surprise him ,
Respecting trusted subordinate is the same as respecting oneself.
Why to appoint the person that is ploughed under is the same as to surprise him ?
Because to appoint is to regard the person as a subordinate,
Getting appointed is being surprised, Being disfavored is also being surprised,
This is why.
Why respecting trusted subordinate is the same as respecting oneself?
The reason that I have these trusted subordinate is I care about myself.

If I do not care about myself,
what trusted subordinate
do I have?
So, If you can change respecting yourself into respecting the world,
then the world will be able to
be reposed in you;
If you can change loving yourself into loving the world,
then the world will be able to
be reposed in you.

Posted on 2020-11-08 by Lao Tzu

2.14 Chapter 14

One looks at it and does not see it, so that it is called invisible
One hears it and does not understand it, so that it is called soundless
One touches it and does not grab it, so it is called incorporeal
These three characteristics of the transcendent
Mix together and say one thing.
It is the negation of the higher luminosity
And of the lower darkness
It is immense and insusceptible of name
It returns to what stands before (and above) being
Its form is the absence of form
Its figure is the absence of figure
Undiscernible profundity

If you look ahead, you will not see the end
If you look behind, you will not see the origin
Primordial principle
In action now as in every time = perennially current
One follows the way of the Ancients
And one will know the eternal essence of the Principle.

The ninth line can be understood both metaphysically: The Tao is before and above being — as well as in these terms, referring to individual beings: the Tao brings them back from the current of transformations to that which is before and above being (in the pre-formal state).

In the first lines: the Principle, tangible but elusive. Non-being, which is not the not-existent. This passage of Kuan Tze (XIII, 36) will be interesting, for the meeting of the attributes of the principle with the technique of realization:

> The Tao is not far, yet reaching it is difficult ... Empty and non-being, incorporeity and immateriality, that is called Tao. Heaven is empty, Earth is calm, neither one nor the other struggles. The I is discarded and falls silent: then divine clarity will persist in you. Who understands silence (*p'u jen*) and immobility profoundly will understand the essential drama of the Tao... If (man) will renounce craving, the emptiness (*hsu*) will entirely compenetrate him; compenetrated by it, he will remain calm and non-acting; calm and firm, he will take up contact with the vital ether; whoever possesses the vital ether is detached (from terrestrial form); detached, he will radiate light like a god (*ming shen*).

Chinese text and literal translation

Chapter 14 (第十四章)

視之不見，名
　曰夷；
聽之不聞，名
　曰希；
摶之不得，名
　曰微。
此三者不可致
　詰，故混
　而為一。
其上不皦，其
　下不昧，
繩繩不可名，
　復歸於無
　物，
是謂無狀之狀，
　無物之象，
是謂惚恍。
迎之不見其首，
　隨之不見
　其後。
執今之道以御
　今之有，
　能知古始，
是謂道紀。

That which is looked at yet never seen is known as invisible,
That which is listened to yet never heard is known as soundless,
And that which is grasped yet never touched is known as intangible.
The origin of these three can not be observed, so mix them and form a unity.
Above, it is not lit; Below, it is not dark.
The Dao cannot be named by common rules, as it returns to its origin,
It is the shape of the original shape, the image of the original object,
This is blur and profound.
Step forward, cannot see its beginning; Follow it, cannot see its end.
Hold the ancient Dao to know the present things, and thus know the ancient beginnings,
This is the principle of the Dao.

Posted on 2020-11-17 by Lao Tzu

2.15 Principle and Action 15

Chapter 15

The Masters of ancient times
Were free, clairvoyant, mysterious, intuitive
In the vastness of the forces of their spirit they did not know of an I
This unconsciousness of the inner force gave greatness to their appearance.
To characterize them with images:
They were prudent, like those who traverse a stream of water in winter ice
Watchful, like those who know the enemy around themselves
Cold, like a stranger
Dissolving elusive , like ice that thaws
Rough, like rough-hewn wood
Vast, like the great valleys
Impenetrable, like turbid water.
Who today with the greatness of his light could lighten the inner darkness?
Who today with the greatness of his life could reanimate inner death inertia ?
In those men was Life
They were individuals and lords of the I
And their non-being their emptiness[2], taking, or filled up in the figurative sense
In them was perfection.

The characterization of the Masters of ancient times, models of Tao-

[2] non-grasping

ism, appear associated with the traditional idea of the regressive course of historical humanity, warned in a living way in the Far-Eastern world (a Chinese proverb says: "Antiquity was like a full laughter, we are like empty shells" — see also the reference of Lao Tzu to the "way of the Ancients" in Chapter 14.) It is about a teaching of general importance, and whatever in the Tao Te Ching reflects it, must not be related to merely local Chinese political conditions, to the decadence of the Chou dynasty, under which Lao Tzu would have lived, like the banal interpretation of different commentators or translators.

> A living light endangered high antiquity, but some of its rays have reached us. To us it seems as if the Ancients lived in darkness because we see them through the thick fog from which we are emerging. "Man is a child born at midnight: when he sees the sun rise, he believes that yesterday never existed" (Taoist text cited by R. Remusat). See Chuang Tzu (XXXIII, 1) "The ancients collaborated with the transcendent celestial and terrestrial influences, with the action of Heaven and Earth" (it is the concept, previously noted, of the Great Triad)

Because of their structure in the original, the last lines of the chapter are controversial. It essentially followed Ular's reading as that which connects organically such lines with the rest and that maintains them at the level of the whole.

Chinese text and literal translation Chapter 15 (第十五章)

古之善為道者，
微妙
玄達，深不可
識。

Once upon a time, those who
knew the Way, were a mysterious and subtle people,
Transient yet profound, tranquil yet utterly unfathomable.

夫唯不可識，
　故强為之
　容。
豫兮，若冬涉
　川；
猶兮，若畏四
　鄰；
儼兮，其若客；
渙兮，若冰之
　將釋；
敦兮，其若樸；
曠兮，其若谷；
渾兮，其若濁。
孰能濁以靜之
　徐清。
孰能安以動之
　徐生。
保此道不欲盈。
夫唯不盈，故
　能蔽而新
　成。

Since they are inexplicable, I
　can only tell what they seem
　like:
Cautious, as if wading through
　a winter river,
Wary, as if afraid of their own
　neighbors.
Grave, like the courteous house
　guests.
Elusive, as of melting ice.
Pure and natural, as of unchis-
　eled gems.
Wide and open, as of a deep
　valley.
Yet mysterious, oh yes, they were
　like troubled water.
Who can remain tranquil amidst
　troubled airs, that calm-
　ness may flow from within?
Who may remain at peace eter-
　nal, that motion would yield
　birth to nature?
For those who follow the Way,
　fulfillment has never been
　their aim.
Only as they are forever un-
　fulfilled, can such fresh-
　ness be ever renewed.

Posted on 2020-12-06 by Lao Tzu

2.16 Chapter 16

Whoever realizes extreme emptiness
Finds what exists unmoved and calm (beyond the changeable and the particular)
In the flux of countless beings
He sees them emerging passing into the formal state and proliferating
And like everything, they return to the root.
To return to the root means the state of repose
From such repose, a new destiny appears
This is the immutable law (of transformation)
Knowledge of the immutable law brings vision to clarity
Non-knowledge of the immutable law leads to blind and detrimental acting
Knowledge of the immutable law leads to detached impartiality
To be detached means to be superior
To be superior means to be regal
To be regal means to be like Heaven
To be like Heaven means to be similar to the Principle
To the eternal and identical
And he will forever be beyond harm.

Commentary The chapter often goes under the title *kuei ken* = "return to the root". The two ways of which we spoke in the Introduction are briefly sketched out. On one side, the eternal law of the flux of transformations, of the "entry" and "exit" of beings, happens through what in the commentaries the image of being exhaled (exiting, being born, in the sign of yang) and inhaled (return, die, in the sign of yin) is also used, or that of the forward and backwards motion of a weaver's loom (Lieh

Tze). On the other side, the contemplation of this law, contemplation that begins detachment, and the perception of the immobile substrate of the transformation, that leads back "to the root", makes the Real Man similar to Heaven and puts him outside of danger (only in the exoteric interpretation, from dangers and risks inherent in this unique way — esoterically: immunity in respect to that which may initiate the crises tied to the ontological changes of state).

It is good to emphasize that Taoism knows this double possibility, that therefore its horizon is not at all exhausted — as more than one commentary has held — in the eternal monotonous sequence of events of appearance and disappearance, of exiting and returning of beings, with a consequent fatalist indifference as the norm of wisdom. Lieh Tze (I,9) calls this "lower knowledge". The higher knowledge concerns instead the knowledge of the Principle and reintegration into the root (indicated by Lieh Tze, IV, 2, in these terms: first of all deep union of the body and spirit, then integration of such unity in the forces of the world, brought from "non-being", that is from transcendence. For whoever succeeds in that, says Lieh Tze (VI, 2), the existence in the current of forms appears like a long sleep, and death as the great reawakening from a dream (Chuang Tze, II, 8 and VI, 8: "You and I who are speaking in this moment, are like two unawakened dreamers.

Chuang Tze himself (XIX, 3, 2) says that those who, having the body and the spirit intact and united to nature, "having absorbed all its powers", "has reached the starting point of the transformations and continues there", to the self-production of the dissolution of the form "is capable of transmigrating". He is not dissolved but, "quintessentially becomes the cooperator of Heaven".

Chinese text and literal translation Chapter 16 (第十六章)

致虛極；守靜篤。	Immersed within the heart of the void, keep tranquility's

萬物並作，
吾以觀復。
夫物芸芸，各
　復歸其根，
歸根曰靜，
是謂復命；
復命曰常，
知常曰明。
不知常妄作，
　凶。
知常容。
容乃公，
公乃王，
王乃天，
天乃道，
道乃久，
沒身不殆。

essence.
The myriad things together
　arise,
I thereby perceive their return-
　ing.
Now things flower, and in flow-
　ering each one returns to
　the source,
The returning to the source
　is called tranquillity,
This is the returning to des-
　tiny,
The returning to destiny is the
　eternal,
To know the eternal is wisdom,
When one does not know wis-
　dom, disaster arises!
Knowing the eternal is wide-
　ranging,
Wide-ranging means open-minded,
Open-minded means royal,
Royal means heavenly,
Heavenly means the Dao,
The Dao means everlasting.
Bodiless and without form, can-
　not wither or perish.

Posted on 2021-01-26 by Lao Tzu

2.17 Chapter 17

The people at the beginning hardly knew that there were
(sovereigns)
Their successors (i.e., sovereigns) were loved and exalted
Their successors were feared
Their successors were despised
Their perfidy lacking loyalty destroyed all trust
The first, solemn, reserved in speaking
Fulfilled their function perfectly
And the ten thousand beings said:
"We are living according to our nature."

Commentary Up until recent times in China the "invisibility of the Emperor" (because, by custom, he rarely showed himself alone) was an outer symbol of the invisible "not-acting" government. The text indicates the successive forms, always more degraded, assumed by the type of the leader.

1. First of all "distance" fails (the first principle was: "he exercised an influence, only keeping himself distant"). The sovereign is visible and "popular": he loves popularity and needs it. This prestige is not based on the feeling of distance, but on that of closeness to him of the governed mass; for this reason he is loved.

2. In the next case the type of the prince follows, who governs only because he is feared.

3. We finally reach the leader who is feared and despised at the same time, failing every relationship of loyalism and mutual fidelity, and the structure of a State reaches the limit of instability.

The sovereign of the origins, "whose power derives from that of the Principle", was called "The Mysterious One" — says Chuang Tze. He transmits the influence of the Principle to all beings, making their natural capacities develop in them; at the origin his "politics" consisted "in leading the individual nature of being back to conformity with the universal acting virtue." (XII, 1-10) The general idea is summarized rather well by Granet (La pensée chinoise, p 547) in the following terms:

> For the benefit of all things, but without charity nor pride, he is limited to concentrate in himself an intact Majesty ... this sovereign Majesty is not distinguished from pure Power nor from integral knowledge (*i she*) ... An unknown Autocrat, he does his work without anyone noticing it, and this work is accomplished without affecting in any way the one from whom it emanates.

Chinese text and literal translation Chapter 17 (第十七章)

太上，下知有
　之；
其次，親而譽
　之；
其次畏之；
其次侮之。
信不足焉，有
　不信焉。
悠兮，其貴言，
功成事遂，
百姓皆謂我自
　然。

Great rulers are hardly known
　by their subjects,
Then come those the people draw near and praise,
Then those the people hold
　in fear,
Then those the people revile.
When one lacks trust, one
　finds no trust.
Reluctantly, without boasting;
Perform actions, accomplish
　deeds;
The people will say it hap-

pened naturally.

Posted on 2021-02-05 by Lao Tzu

* * *

`roballenvalecourt on 2021-02-05 at 23:09 said:`

I am constantly impressed with the Sicily connection in regards to Evola and the Western Esoteric Path...

2.18 Chapters 18 and 19

Chapter 18

The Way was lost
"Benevolence and righteousness" were put in its place
By skill and cunning (having lost original simplicity)
Great hypocrisy ensued
The chain of blood that was tied to the origin was broken
And was replaced with family sentiments
When the kingdoms fell into disorder
"Good ministers" became prominent.

Chapter 19

Remove (petty) wisdom, put prudence aside
And the advantage to the people will be very great
Humanitarianism and morality are not proclaimed
And a spontaneous solidarity = from the family will return
    to rule in society
Utilitarian goals will be devalued, self-absorbed action will
    be despised

And guilty acts will vanish in society.
(But even) these three particularly
Do not have to be followed to the letter
What is essentially necessary:
To be (oneself) in rough, natural, candour
Detached from particular ambitions, liberated from vain desires.

Commentary There is a visible continuity between these two chapters. Proclaiming "virtues" is for Taoism merely the sign of a corrupt society. See Chapter 38: "Superior virtues do not announce themselves as virtues." It speaks instead of the "non-virtues of virtues", the latter understood as artificial corresponding to a pedantic exterior that, more than restoring an integral life, will only increase the damage by favouring hypocrisy and cunning. The Taoist argument in that sense, not without reference to a second-rate or poorly understood Confucianism, often went beyond the sign. "Benevolence and righteousness" — *ren* and *yi* — are precisely the cardinal Confucian virtues. Even family sentiments reduced to conventional and obligatory behaviour are decadent. (Chapter 18) See **Chuang Tzu** (XIII,5):

> These concerns about benevolence and righteousness recall a man who beats a drum while searching for a fleeing son, with the only effect of making him flee even further... Unite your influence to that of the Principle rather than imposing artificial virtues, and you will be able to achieve something.

From the last line of Chapter 19 the positive reference point is clarified: conduct derives from being oneself, rather than reflecting a norm of society. The elimination of desires, as vain desires, must not be understood here in an ascetic, forced, or renunciatory sense. It is the fundamental idea of Taoism, that in man a complex of desires, tendencies and

interests is not at all "natural"; it is an error, it is something artificial and parasitic. One is truly oneself — and one is on the Path — when one is liberated from it. Then true virtues are also manifested. "Morality", far from restoring this state of natural equilibrium, moves even further from it, adding another stratification to a stratification . An effective image:

> The beginning is what I call the thaw (the dissolution of the concretion of the exterior I), after that the stream begins to take its course. (Chuang Tzu, XXIII, 3)

In a certain way, the same double application is reaffirmed in the chapter that follows. Among the excrescences in respect to the natural state, which one must prune, the world of intellectualism and of the social distinctions between "good" and "evil" is also included. However, in contrast, being oneself is what brings you quite far, along the line of the Transcendent Man in his closed and impenetrable form. The reference, as will be seen, is in the first person — it is almost the only passage of the *Tao Te Ching* in which the author speaks of himself: however, with the visible intent of sketching out a model.

Chinese text and literal translation Chapter 18 (第十八章)

大道廢，有 仁義； 智慧出，有 大偽； 六親不和有 孝慈， 國家昏亂有 忠臣。	When the Dao is lost, so there arises benevolence and righteousness. When prudence and wisdom appear, there is great hypocrisy. When family relations are not right, there is filial piety and paternal affection. When the state is confused and chaotic, there is loyalty and

faithfulness.

Chapter 19 (第十九章)

絶聖棄智，
　民利百倍；
絶仁棄義，
　民復孝慈；
絶巧棄利，
　盜賊無有；
此三者，以
　為文不足，
故令有所屬：
見素抱樸，
少私寡欲。

Abandon holiness, relinquish prudence; the people will flourish a hundredfold,
Abandon benevolence, relinquish righteousness; and people will return to filial piety and affection.
Abandon cleverness, relinquish gain; and thieves and robbers will not appear.
As I know such three to be no mere words,
Stay true to that which is reliable.
Recognise simplicity, embrace purity,
Lessen the self, diminish desires.

Posted on 2021-03-04 by Lao Tzu

2.19 The Kingdoms Fell into Disorder

Cologero has been channeling me for quite some time now and much of what he takes credit for is really mine. Nevertheless, he recently got a little huffy about it — or so it seemed — and he challenged me to write the material directly. Now the last thing I need is for a bunch of curiosity seekers attempting to invoke me. Cologero assured me that very few

people read his blog, so I decided to risk it. In particular, he asked me to explain Chapters 18 to 21, regarding the deterioration of a civilization (18 & 19) and the character of a Taoist sage (20 & 21).[3]

I know I have a reputation for being "inscrutable", although — in my opinion — that is due more to poor translations than to the difficulty of the material. In other words, it is the Tao that is inscrutable, not me. Unfortunately, any attempt to scrutinize the inscrutable is fraught with issues. Have you ever told a joke to your girlfriend and got nothing back but a blank stare? Eventually, she will protest, "I don't get it." After explaining the joke, she finally claims to "get it". Yet, at that point it is no longer a joke, but something else, something markedly inferior. A joke depends on provoking a sudden shift in perceptions.

Likewise, knowing the Tao works the same way. There is a sudden "aha" experience, a sublime and rapid change of viewpoint, or what is called "getting it". The danger of an explanation is that it may preclude that very aha experience. That is why I wrote:

> The (discursive, reasoning) intellect is the source of sorrow
>
> What consistency do dialectical distinctions have?

Once you get it, there is no point in explaining, debating, or analyzing it. Right? Or debating a joke? Wrong. I've heard that your civilisation will debate jokes incessantly. That's because you've lost the natural sense of what is funny, and that's not all you've lost. Following the Tao means a return to a natural primordial state. When that state is lost, then the discursive intellect tries to replace what was lost with something artificial and factitious.

In your society, there is a lot of talk about benevolence, justice, and so on. Now there may indeed be acts of benevolence and compassion,

[3] See Section 2.20 in this book for **Julius Evola**'s translation of and commentary on these chapters of the Tao Te Ching.

but there is simultaneously a lot of hypocrisy. There should be a natural connection with your ancestors and family. But even that is lost, and replaced with "definitions" of a family. Do you see what happened? What was natural and spontaneous becomes suddenly a matter for scrutiny and debate. The result is hardly a clarification, since no one is even sure what a family is any longer.

In the primordial state, the chatter about "humanitarianism and morality" will disappear, to everyone's benefit. Can anyone who watches your news shows for 10 minutes doubt this? Your partisans claim to have a monopoly on morality within the system, each party accusing the other of evil. Then as a whole, you boast about your high standards vis-à-vis the rest of the world. This is not a critique, but rather an observation since everything is a mixed bag. If you understood good and evil, there would be little discussion of it.

As I pointed out some time ago (really, what has changed since then, despite all the warning?), the mass of people are seeking little more than pleasant diversions. There is no morality in following one's vain desires, tendencies, orientations, and interests. Quite the contrary, although you would never believe it, the way people talk about it. I assure you, however, that there is nothing "natural" about them at all. Emphatically not, since the path to true liberation is to become free of such things.

Instead of liberation, those who become aware of those dangers, impose instead a moral code. But that is suppression, not liberation, just adding another layer on top of the already unnatural layer. It leads away from, not to, the natural state.

Following desires, seeking pleasure, defining morality, and rational thought do not lead to the Tao, then what does? I tried, in Chapter 21, to show, by way of personal example, the alternative. I am not moved by feelings, but live in the calm waters below their current. I am at home no matter the outward circumstances. While the world seeks excess, I seek simplicity. Those with superficial vision may consider me to be simple-

minded, incompetent, and impractical. I prefer to live in silence than in conversation, to be alone rather than in a crowd. I live like the ocean, wave after wave, without pause. Yet, since I am not battered about by desires, I am a Real I.

The manifest world is the exteriorization of the Tao. Although undifferentiated and unintelligible, it nevertheless contains all things as possibilities. Existing things are contained in the Tao, as well as their essences. The world cannot keep us safe, our safety resides in the Tao. The Tao does not change, yet everything proceeds from it.

How do I know this? Through direct "super-rational" intuition. Do you get it now?

Posted on 2017-06-25 by Lao Tzu

* * *

Fred on 2017-06-26 at 06:13 said:

Fun fact: when Eliphas Levi channeled Apollonius of Tyana the only answer he received was "death". I see Lao Tzu is a nicer person.

Also, according to Guenon's "the spiritist fallacy" you can't really channel the soul of a dead man, only his 'ob' (the word used in the Bible). Sort of a shade, but not his actual self. I don't remember the egyptian word, but it's that thing they tried to preserve inside mummies.

James on 2017-06-26 at 16:02 said:

Thanks for a great post.

THAT on 2017-06-28 at 07:13 said:

That's true about channeling. Certain kinds of deceased saints and sages, however, exist in states where they may easily interact with people in our world in a recognizable form. One should keep in mind that other beings of the subtle planes may masquerade as something they are not as a deception.

http://www.thejinn.net/ascended_master.htm

Aleksandar on 2017-06-28 at 12:50 said:

Regarding channeling and communication with sages, Goethe once popped up in my dream just to tell me that he achieved some kind of divinity, a "godhood" to use his own words. It was

a very vivid, unusual dream. I wonder if I was trolled by some astral being in disguise, or fell victim to my own mind's play.

Great text by the way. I'm reading "The Great Triad", my first serious introduction to Taoism. And Evola's commentary on "Tao Te Ching" somehow slipped me, until now. This site is truly full of hidden gems.

> Arthur Konrad on 2017-06-28 at 15:57 said:
> Two Taoists walk into a mechanized society
>
> THAT on 2017-06-29 at 06:51 said:
> 'Sufism and Taoism' by Izutsu is another useful study that I highly recommend.

2.20 Chapters 20 and 21

Chapter 20

The (discursive, reasoning) intellect is the source of sorrow
What consistency do dialectical distinctions have?
What is the difference between "good" and "evil"?
"To act like everyone else" — a norm based on fear.
No! (out of) this squalor.

People are carried away by a simple joy
A festival suffices for them
A panorama of spring which is seen from a terrace
I, instead, am anchored in the bottom of the current of sentiment
I remain serious and calm beyond joy like an infant who has not yet smiled
I live like this and go as if I belong to no place.
Everyone desires excess
While I am like one who possesses nothing
(I seem) ignorant, simple, without a practical spirit

Everyone lives in the light
While I am darkness
Everyone needs company
While I love only the solitary height
Indeterminable like the waters of the ocean
Like the wave I turn without pause
Everyone aspires to something
While I seem simple and incompetent
I am different from everyone
But, united to the original productive essence, only I am an I.

Chapter 21

The great Virtue which is manifested
Is only the exteriorization of the Principle
But the substance of the Principle
Is undifferentiated and unintelligible
Undifferentiated and unintelligible
It contains the seeds the archetypes, the seminal possibilities of beings, constituting their indestructible element, their "heaven"
Mysterious and incomprehensible
It contains existences = beings who have passed to the formal state
Deep and hidden
It contains essences transformed beings — "spirits"
As such it is the great Reality
The secure place (of all beings).
From the origin up to the present
It does not change its Name
The animating principle (of each thing) proceeds from it

What is the foundation of such knowledge?
This.

Commentary Beings do not cease to live in the Principle and to have in it their "secure place" in the triple state:

- In the preformal state "being part of Heaven and Earth" as archetypes or seeds (*logoi spermatikoi*)
- In formal existence or existence in its proper and limitative sense
- As pure forms.

Coexistence of the emission, of the eternal movement where those states and the mysterious, unintelligible, unmoved Unity follow each other.

To the unknowability and the unintelligibility which would be in the same way the predicate of the Principle is contrasted, in the last lines, with the form proper to a possible knowledge of its mystery: "this", the word refers to direct, metaphysical, and super-rational intuition (it appears again in Chapter 54). The expression *tathata* may be compared, which, when used with an analogous meaning in **Madhyamika Buddhism**, designated the content of the supreme, inexpressable experience.

Chinese text and literal translation Chapter 20 (第二十章)

	Discard conventional doctrines and be relieved from anxieties.
絶學無憂。	
唯之與阿，	Flattery or reprimand, what difference does it make?
相去幾何？	
善之與惡，	Good or evil, what difference does it take?
相去何若？	

人之所畏，
　不可不畏？
荒兮其未央
　哉！
衆人熙熙，
如享太牢，
如登春臺。
我獨泊兮其
　未兆，
若嬰兒之未
　孩，
乘乘兮若無
　所歸。
衆人皆有餘，
而我獨若遺。
我愚人之心
　也哉！沌
　沌兮！
俗人昭昭，
　我獨昏昏；
俗人察察，
　我獨悶悶。
忽兮其若晦，
寂兮似無所
　止。
衆人皆有以，
　我獨頑且
　鄙。
我獨異於人，
而貴求食於
　母。

Just because the people are at awe, you cannot be indifferent?
Ridiculous! Ungrounded!
When everyone is celebrating and joyous,
As if relishing a spiritual triumph,
As if enjoying a victorious feast.
I alone am feelingless! Contemplating the myriad future,
Dazed like a newborn child,
Seizing the moment! Pondering the uncertainties.
When everyone feels lavished,
I alone am hollowed.
I am a fool! Confounded!
When everyone seemed enlightened, I alone am in suspense;
When everyone is watchful, I alone am in confuse.
Enigmatic! Like the obscure twilight,
Desolate! Like the infinite universe.
When everyone is focused, I alone am stubborn and despicable.
I alone am different from the common,
I find refuge in the womb of this profound conception.

Chapter 21 (第二十一章)

孔德之容，
唯道是從。
道之為物，
惟恍惟惚。
惚兮恍其中
　有象；
恍兮惚其中
　有物。
窈兮冥兮，
其中有精；
其精甚真，
　其中有信。
自古及今，
其名不去，
以閱衆甫。
吾何以知衆
　甫之然哉？
以此。

Where the greatest Virtue resides,
Only the Dao may reveal.
Things that bestow the Dao,
Radiates such liberty, such easiness.
Eased! Liberated from its form, yet fashioned;
Liberated! At ease with its position, yet poised.
Mesmerizing! Mysterious!
Brilliance from within;
Its brilliance so enlightening, it exemplifies the truth.
Traversing through all times,
Its name is not diminished,
Amassing all marvels of human intelligence.
How do I know the essence of all marvels?
By observing things that bestow the Dao.

Posted on 2021-03-19 by Lao Tzu

2.21 Chapter 22

We continue today the translation of Evola's 1959 edition and commentary on the *Tao Te Ching*, published under the title *Il Libro del Principio e della sua Azione* The Book of the Principle and its Action .

To be whole in the fragment
Straight in the curved
Full in the void
Intact in corruption.
Gathered, one succeeds
Scattered, one fails
Therefore: the True Man preserves the original One
He thus becomes a model for the world
He does not put himself in the light, and so he shines
By not affirming himself, he imposes himself
Free of complacency, he becomes great
Because he does not contend
No one can attack him.
"To be whole in the fragment",
This ancient saying,
Could it be meaningless?
No: in the Way it is the truth.

Commentary The saying from the first line, repeated in the third-to-last — *ch'u tse ch'üan* — can be interpreted both in a normative sense ("to be whole in the fragment") and in an ontological sense (the wholeness of the fragment). Ontologically, it means that in the Way the fragment (the part) is the whole (just as the curved is the straight, the empty is the full, etc.). It is the idea of the "partial perfections" that, in their own way, reflect the Principle.

It must not be understood (as various translators have done) that the fragment will become the whole, etc., materially, through transformation or development; rather, it already is the whole, if seen in the light of the Way.

On the other hand, in the normative sense, that maxim ("to be whole in the fragment") refers to a specific Far Eastern concept of perfection: to

carry out each thing precisely and perfectly, with a natural concentration and without effort. Then, whatever activity is performed, one is in the Way.

Cf. in Chuang-tzu (XIX, 3): "Unify the intentions; have only one, which merges with vital energy" (cf. XIX, 10, 12). There is a connection between this idea and the one already explained, of the "original simplicity," even in its "magical" aspect.

Chinese text and literal translation Chapter 22 (第二十二章)

曲則全， 枉則直， 窪則盈， 敝則新， 少則得， 多則惑。	Bent, therefore whole. Crooked, therefore straight. Hollowed, therefore full. Worn, therefore new. Few, therefore gain. Many, therefore confused.
是以聖人抱一 為天下式。	Therefore, the Sage embraces the One and becomes the model for the world.
不自見，故明； 不自是，故彰； 不自伐，故有 功； 不自矜，故長。	He does not display himself — therefore he is seen clearly. He does not affirm himself , therefore he shines. He does not boast, therefore he accomplishes. He does not pride himself, therefore he endures.
夫唯不爭，故 天下莫能 與之爭。	It is precisely because he does not contend, that none in the world can contend with him.
古之所謂「曲 則全」者， 豈虛言哉？ 誠全而歸 之。	

The ancients who said, "Bent,
    therefore whole",
were these empty words?
No, they are truly whole and
    return to it.

Posted on 2025-04-13 by Lao Tzu

* * *

Juliano on 2025-04-14 at 10:35 said:

"To carry out each thing precisely and perfectly, with a natural concentration and without effort" – precisely the First Arcanum from Tomberg. I wonder if more people here is working with the recent book "The Taoist Alchemy of Wang Liping" from Nathan Brine, since Charles used to recommend "Opening the Dragon Gate" and Brine was authorized by Wang Liping to expose his inner alchemy teachings. I'm working with book one.

Tannheuser on 2025-04-14 at 22:14 said:

Exactly, Juliano. You'll also notice that Chuang-tzu's "Unify the intentions; have only one, which merges with vital energy" is identical to Tomberg's "moral purification of the will" (also in Letter 1), or Cologero's favorite saying that "purity of heart is to will one thing".

I haven't read either of the books you mention, although perhaps I will soon. You might be interested that Joscelyn Godwin is publishing a translation of Matgioi's "La Voi Metaphysique" early next year: https://www.innertraditions.com/the-primordial-tradition-of-ancient-china

Juliano on 2025-04-15 at 08:06 said:

Thanks, Tannheuser, I will certainly read Matgioi's book when it is available. Also beware of the new translation of the brazilian masterpiece *Grande Sertão: Veredas* (The Devil to Pay in the Backlands, now translated as Vastlands: The Crossing) by the genius João Guimarães Rosa. It is a masterful synthesis of Christian, taoist and alchemichal transformation in literary form. The old transaltion is quite bad, but this one looks good. It should be available next year.

https://pug-lynx-fgnj.squarespace.com/news/alison-entrekins-new-guimares-rosa-translation-sold-in-pair-of-auctions

Ginette on 2025-05-15 at 13:54 said:

Hello, great article! Could you tell me the source of the literal translation? Is it a book? Thanks.

Tannheuser on 2025-05-18 at 15:51 said:

For the literal translation, I am using a number of sources (for example, https://en.wikisource.org/wiki/Translation:Tao_Te_Ching), and applying some of my own limited knowledge to clean it up, also. I'm doing my best in this case since I am uncertain of which source Charles was using — the main value is having the original Chinese characters available here for those that can read them – as you can see, there are many different directions once can take when translating these to English. Evola himself published a very different translation and commentary on the Tao in the 1920s that was more focused on interpreting it through the lens of his philosophy of Magical Idealism, which Gornahoor will make available in the future.

2.22 Chapter 23

Speak little and act like nature
A violent wind does not blow all morning
A sudden downpour does not last all day
This impermanence is proper to nature itself = to Heaven-and-Earth
If even nature does not have the power to persist (in extreme actions)
Man still less can do so
Therefore: in life, imitate (by non-acting) the Principle
To become one with the Principle
Imitate (by acting) its Virtue (*tê*) to become one with it
Abandon yourself to transformations to realize in yourself its power
By aligning with the Principle, partake of it
By aligning with the Virtue, partake of it
By aligning with transformations, partake of them

(But in most) this inner security is lacking, hence incomplete trust.

Commentary The True Man aligns himself with the Principle and reproduces it in its dual nature: non-acting (the Tao in the proper sense) and acting (the Virtue of the Tao). The latter, as is known, operates in perpetual transformation. Thus, in all that is external, the True Man does not stiffen nor resist the instability that even Heaven-and-Earth, especially in its extreme manifestations, reveals to him; he follows the course of the transformations of forms, the immutable not being something to grasp or realize on this plane.

However, such a path requires inner security, something like intrepidity or "metaphysical trust" (in the Way): the art of an active letting-go, like one who abandons himself to the play of the waves without being submerged. This, indeed, is for the few (final line).

In the tenth and thirteenth lines, the character *shih*, rendered as "transformation," more commonly means "defect" ("transformation" would properly be *i*). The literal translation would therefore be: "to unite with the defect (*shih*) in order to partake of it (or enjoy it)." With "transformation" (referring to the instability and changes discussed at the beginning and which are the mode of the Way) instead of "defect," the meaning of the two lines aligns well with the rest. However, if one retains the literal meaning, the phrase could once again point to the principle of being whole within the fragment and of one's own nature: uniting with the defect is equivalent to embracing what exists within the limiting conditions of the formal state; through this alignment, excluding arbitrariness and the mania of the "I", one is in the Way.

Chinese text and literal translation Chapter 23 (第二十三章)

希言自然。	Less spoken, words speak for themselves naturally.

故飄風不終朝，
驟雨不終日。
孰為此者？
天地尚不能久，
而況於人乎？
故從事於道者，
道者同於道，
德者同於德，
失者同於失。
同於道者，道亦樂得之；
同於德者，德亦樂得之；
同於失者，失亦樂得之。
信不足焉，
有不信焉。

Therefore gusts cannot chill the exuberant day,
Showers cannot turn day to dusk.
Why is it so?
Even the heaven and earth cannot counter its own force,
Let alone people?
Therefore those engaged with the Dao take pleasure that,
The Taught is the Dao,
The Virtuous is the Virtue,
The perplexed is perplexity.
At one with the Dao, the Dao is welcoming;
At one with Virtue, Virtue be appreciating;
At one with perplexity, perplexity be gratifying.
Lack of belief,
Explains the disbelief in this futility.

Posted on 2025-05-06 by Tannheuser

2.23 Chapter 24

The effort of one who stands on tiptoe does not lead to rising

To splay the legs excessively is not walking
He who puts himself in the light remains in the shadow
He who believes he has arrived is pushed back
To put oneself ahead is to lose value
To esteem oneself is to decay
With respect to the Way, all this
Is nothing but excrescence and refuse
With respect to the goal, it is something to be disdained
Far removed from all this is he who is in the Way.

Commentary The path of one united with the Principle is marked by natural, impersonal spontaneity, opposed to all behaviors based on shifting and externalizing the center of oneself into the concretion of the small ego, mere excrescence (the text adds: "refuse") with respect to being. Any accentuation of the latter automatically converts into a diminishment of the former: a Taoist theme already familiar to us.

In the same line of thought, a still more drastic Taoist expression is: the ego is an abscess that bursts at death.

Chinese text and literal translation Chapter 24 (第二十四章)

	Ones who tip-toe do not stand,
跂者不立，	Ones who stride do not pace,
跨者不行，	Ones show off themselves do not shine,
自見者不明，	Ones that bias themselves with self-righteousness do not justify.
自是者不彰。	Ones self-asserted are without accomplishments,
自伐者無功，	Ones self-esteemed are not en-
自矜者不長。	
其在道也，	
曰餘食贅行。	
物或惡之，	

故有道者不處
也。

durable.
These according to the Dao,
Are called extravagance and
exorbitance.
which the masses resent,
Therefore those embracing the
Dao dwell not.

Posted on 2025-06-04 by Tannheuser

* * *

Luka Markovic on 2025-10-18 at 14:56 said:

Chapter 24 contrasts The Way, or the process of subtle inner maturation, with being merely intellectually acquisitive. The germ of wisdom ripens through cultivation.

3

Evola's Short Articles

3.1 Evola and Guenon

In an interview conducted in the mid 1960s —*Julius Evola: A Justified Pessimism*[1]— Evola provided a précis of his life's work. He answered all the questions very simply and it demonstrates how little his ideas changed in the preceding 40 years. This is how he answered the question about the influence of Guenon on his work:

Q In your book *Il Cammino del Cinabar*, where you laid out the genesis of your works, you acknowledged that the principal defender of the traditional worldview, Rene Guenon, exercised a certain influence over you, to the point that you have been called the "Italian Guenon". Is there a perfect correspondence between your thought and Guenon's? And don't you believe, concerning Guenon, that certain circles overrate Oriental philosophy?

A My orientation does not differ from Guenon's insofar as it concerns the value attributed to the World of Tradition. By the World of

[1] https://www.gornahoor.net/library/JustifiedPessimism.pdf

Tradition, we mean an organic and hierarchical civilisation in which all activities are oriented from above and are based on values that are not simply human values. Like Guenon, I wrote different works on traditional wisdom, studying their sources directly. The first part of my principal work, *Revolt against the Modern World*, is precisely a morphology of the world of tradition. There is also a correspondence between Guenon and me concerning the radical critique of the modern world. On this point, there are however some divergences between us. Given his "personal equation", in traditional spirituality Guenon assigned knowledge and contemplation ahead of action; he subordinated the royal to the sacerdotal. I, on the other hand, have endeavoured to present and emphasise the traditional legacy from the point of view of the warrior caste and to show the possibilities equally offered by the way of action. A consequence of this different point of view is that, while Guenon employs an intellectual elite as the base for the possible reconstruction of Europe, as far as I'm concerned, I am more inclined to speak of an order. The judgments that Guenon and I give to Catholicism and Freemasonry also diverge. I believe, however, that Guenon's formulation is not situated on the path of Western man, who is, in spite of everything, oriented especially toward action.

Commentary This leaves no doubt that there is profound agreement between the two thinkers, both on the nature of Traditional societies and their quarrels with the contemporary world. What is omitted are the Traditional teachings on the primordial tradition, the primordial state, the constitution of man as spirit/soul/body, the four phases of the cosmic cycle, and so on. But a careful reading shows that their "divergences" do not represent an insurmountable opposition, but rather reflect the same thing from a different point of view.

While Guenon holds that the primordial tradition takes different forms in different eras and cultures, he does not account for those differ-

ences. Evola goes a step further with his concept of the "race of the spirit", such that a form that is suitable for one race may not be for another race.

The other divergence is related to the castes and the different spiritual stances appropriate to each one. Thus, Guenon describes the contemplative type of spirituality proper to the sacerdotal caste and Evola describes the one proper to the warrior caste. Their only difference, then, is the question of which one should be dominant. Once again, this can be resolved by the "race of the spirit": the Eastern races are dominated by the spirit of contemplation and the Western race by the spirit of action. This is all consonant with cosmic law, and is represented by the teachings of Taoism, which Evola valued highly.

Bear in mind that what Evola means by action is more like the wei-wu-wei of Taoism — action/non-action — and not the frenzied activity of the modern world that was represented by Futurism, an artistic movement that Evola in his youth was associated with, but seems to have left behind. Evola ends his answer on this note:

> Unfortunately, what characterises the modern European world is not action but its falsification, that is, an activism deprived of a foundation that is limited to the domain of purely material productions. They are detached from heaven under the pretext of conquering the earth, to the point of no longer knowing what action truly is.

Posted on 2007-12-21 by Cologero

3.2 Evola on Christianity in Europe

Continuing the translation of the interview in La Nation Europeenne: *Julius Evola: A Justified Pessimism*[2]

[2] `http://www.geocities.com/Athens/Troy/1856/Muti.htm`

Q. Do you believe that the influence of Christianity was positive for European civilisation? Don't you think that having adopted a religion of Semitic origin has distorted certain traditional European values?

A. Speaking of Christianity, I often used the expression "the religion that came to prevail in the West." In fact the greatest miracle of Christianity was succeeding in asserting itself among the European peoples, even taking account the decadence into which numerous traditions of these peoples had plunged. Nevertheless, we must not forget the cases in which the Christianisation of the West was only superficial. Besides, if Christianity has, without any doubt, altered certain European values, there are also situations where these values were revived by Christianity, by rectifying and modifying itself. Otherwise, Catholicism would be inconceivable in its various "Roman" aspects. In the same way a part of Medieval civilisation would be inconceivable, without phenomena such as the appearance of the great Knightly orders, Thomism, a certain mysticism of a high level (e.g., Meister Eckhart), the spirit of the Crusades, etc.

Comment This is an important question and difficult to discuss due to certain subtleties and emotional attachments. On the one hand, the return to a decadent paganism, which can often take the form of a nature mysticism, must be rejected. On the other hand, an ignorant anti-Catholicism will make one miss those admirable phenomena mentioned by Evola.

These phenomena need to be studied from an Evolian point of view, though it is difficult to imagine who would be capable of it. For example, what was the animating spirit of the Knightly orders, particularly the Knights Templar (whose heresy conviction has recently been lifted)? Thomism represented a return to Greek and Roman philosophy. Aquinas pretty much replaced Hebrew law with the Stoic natural law. He also rejected the God of the Hebrews — the jealous "old man with a beard"– in

favour of a God more like that of Aristotle and Plato (even the Vedanta according to Guenon). The mystical trend of a Meister Eckhart was based on transcendence and the affirmation of a Self above the human world.

By understanding how these values were "revived" in a Medieval Christian form, it will be possible to understand how to revive those values again in the contemporary context.

I would like to add that in the "Sintesi di dottrina della razza", Evola writes about "the great Aryan civilisations of the Orient, to ancient Rome, to the Germano-Roman Middle Ages." (p 29)

Out of the ruins, will another arise?

Posted on 2007-12-28 by Cologero

* * *

Boreas on 2019-12-28 at 09:38 said:

A few nights back I saw a dream in which Evola said to me that "the Truth lies in Jesus". Maybe Evola-the-harsh-critic-of-Christianity has had some revelations in postmortem states.

3.3 Evola on politics, morals, philosophy

These are the first two questions and answers from the interview published in "La Nation Europeenne".

Q. *Do you believe that there exists a connection between philosophy and politics? Can a philosophy influence an undertaking of national or European political reconstruction?*

A. I don't believe that philosophy in the strictly theoretical sense of the term can have any influence over politics. In order to exercise an influence, it needs to embody an ideology or a conception of the world. It is what happened, for example, with the Enlightenment, with Marxist dialectical materialism, and with certain philosophic conceptions that

were incorporated in the conception of the world of German National Socialism. In general, the era of grand philosophical systems is over, now there only exist illegitimate and mediocre philosophies. In one of my early works from my philosophical period, I had included these words of Jules Lachelier actually, Jules Lagneau : "Modern philosophy is a reflexion that has ended by recognising its own impotence and the necessity of action that arises from within." The proper domain of an action of this type has a meta-philosophical character. Hence, the transition that can be observed in my books which speak not of "philosophy", but of "metaphysics", of worldviews, and of traditional doctrines.

Q. *Do you think that morals and ethics are synonymous and should share a philosophy foundation?*

A. It is possible to establish a distinction, if by "morals" you mean customs and by "ethics", a philosophical discipline (which is called "moral philosophy"). It seems to me, it is illusory to demand an absolute philosophical foundation for any ethics or morals. Without reference to something transcendent, morals can only have a relative, contingent, and social importance and can not overcome the criticisms of individualism, existentialism, and nihilism. I demonstrated it in my book "Ride the Tiger" in the chapter "In the World where God is Dead". In this chapter I also dealt with the problematic posed by Nietzsche and existentialism.

Posted on 2007-12-31 by Cologero

3.4 The Science and technology Question

The next question from the interview published in "La Nation Europeenne" deals with science and technology.

Q. Your judgment of science and technology seems, in your work, to be negative. What are the reasons for your position? Don't you believe

that material conquests and the elimination of hunger and poverty will lead to the tackling of spiritual problems with more energy?

A. As to the second point you brought up, I will say that, as there exists a state of degradation due to poverty, so there exists a state of degradation due to affluence and prosperity. The "Welfare State" in which on can no longer speak of hunger and poverty, are far from engendering an increase in true spirituality; on the contrary, there is established a violent and destructive form of revolt by the new generations against the system in its entirety and against an existence devoid of any meaning (USA, England, Scandinavia). The problem consists, instead, in setting a just limit, constraining the frenzy of a capitalistic economy, the creator of artificial needs, and freeing the individual from his growing dependence on social and productive mechanisms. It would be necessary to establish a balance. Just until recently, the Japanese have provided the example of a balance of this type; it modernized itself and didn't leave itself behind the West in the scientific and technical domains, while safeguarding its specific traditions. But today the situation is quite different.

There is another fundamental point to emphasize: it is difficult to adopt science and technology, while circumscribing them within the limits of a civilization's material means and instruments, that is, while preserving, in regards to them, a certain distance; on the contrary, it is practicably inevitable the it becomes impregnated with the world conceptions on which modern profane science bases itself, conceptions that are practically inculcated in our spirits by the methods of the customary methods of instruction and that has, on the spiritual plane, a destructive effect. The very concept of true knowledge is thus totally distorted.

> This speaks for itself. If not, see the Sorcerer's Apprentice.
>
> However, if science is merely instrumental, then what is the nature of "true knowledge". Can it, too, be "inculcated"?

Posted on 2008-01-06 by Cologero

* * *

CaseyAnn on 2013-07-03 at 14:06 said:

Excellent. This is always a struggle to explain to progressive secularists who see themselves as more charitable because they believe in an abstract brotherhood-of-all-nations void of any meaning.

Mark Citadel on 2015-02-08 at 15:17 said:

The best reason to be very wary about the goals of transhumanism, an element prominent within NeoReaction is pointed out by Evola. I would like to add another.

"Simply put, the technology that helps us survive has never kept up with the technology designed to kill us"

http://citadelfoundations.blogspot.com/2015/02/the-utopian-scientists.html

3.5 The European Empire

This is the final question from the interview of Julius Evola in "La Nation Europeenne".

Q. In the history of Europe, there have been different attempts to form a "European Empire": Charlemagne, Frederick I, Frederick II, Charles V, Napoleon, Hitler, but no one has succeeded in recreating, in a stable manner, the Roman Empire. What were, in your opinion, the causes of these failures? Do you think that the construction of a European Empire is possible today? If not, what are the reasons for your pessimism?

A. In order to respond to this question in more than a summary manner, we would have to arrange for more time than is available in an interview. I will limit myself to say that the principal obstacles, in the case of the Holy Roman Empire, were the opposition of the Church, the inception of the revolt of the Third Estate (as in the case of the Communes), the birth of centralized national States that didn't admit any superior authority, and, lastly, the non-imperial, but imperialist—politics

of the French dynasty. I would not attribute a true imperial character to Napoleon's venture. In spite of all, Napoleon was the exporter of the ideas of the French Revolution, ideas that were utilized against traditional and dynastic Europe.

As for Hitler, it would be necessary to make some reservations in the measure in which his conception of the Empire was founded on the myth of the "Volk", conceptions that covered an aspect of collectivisation and nationalist exclusivism (ethnocentrism). It was only in the last period of the Third Reich that the views were broadened, on the one hand thanks to the idea of an Order, backed by certain factions of the SS, and on the other thanks to the international unity of European voluntary divisions that battled on the Eastern front.

On the contrary, it would not be necessary to forget the principle of a European Order that existed with the Holy Alliance (whose decline was imputable in great part to England) and also with the project called "Drei Kaiserbund" at the time of Bismark: the defensive line of the three emperors that should have also included Italy (with the Triple Alliance) and the Vatican, to oppose the anti-European manoeuvres of England and even America.

A "Reich Europa", not a "Nation Europa", would be the only formula acceptable from the traditional point of view for the realisation of an authentic and organic European unification. As to the possibility of realising European unity in this way, I cannot be a pessimist for the same reasons that have led me to say that today there is little room for a renaissance of "Ghibellinism", there is no point of higher reference, there is no foundation to give firmness and legitimacy to a principle of supranational authority. One cannot in fact neglect this fundamental point and be satisfied with making the appeal to "active solidarity" of Europeans against anti-European power, going beyond every ideological difference. Even when one succeeds, with this pragmatic method, to make a unity out of Europe, there would always be the danger of seeing born, in this

Europe, new disruptive contradictions, in particular as far as it concerns the ideological differences and through the effect of the lack of a principle, regarded as primordial, of a superior authority. "Community of destiny" has value only as a word of order of a practical character.

Today it is difficult to speak of a "common European culture". Modern culture does not know borders; Europe imports and exports "Cultural heritage", not only in the cultural domain, but also in taste, in the way of life, it always manifests more a general levelling that, joined with the productive levelling produced by science and technology, furnishes arguments not to those who desire a unified Europe, but rather to those would want to build a world State.

Again, we clash with the obstacle constituted by the nonexistence of a true superior differentiating idea that should be the nucleus of the European Empire. Beyond everything else, the general climate is unfavourable: the spiritual state of piety, of heroism, of loyalty, of honour in unity, that should serve as cement for the organic system of an imperial European Order is today, so to speak, nonexistent. The first task to accomplish should be a systematic purification of the antidemocratic and anti-Marxist spirits in the European nations. Then, it would be necessary to be able to shake up the large masses of our peoples in different ways, both by making the appeal to material interests, and with an action of a fanatic and demagogic character that, necessarily, would stimulate the subpersonal and irrational layers of man. These means would fatally entail certain risks. But all these problems can not be treated in a few words; nevertheless, I had a way of speaking of it in one of my books *Men among the ruins*.

Posted on 2008-01-08 by Cologero

3.6 Evola on Spanish Falangism



José Antonio Primo de Rivera was executed by the Spanish left on November 20, 1936. Although we are a day late because we were only recently provided with the Italian text, we will provide this translation of Evola's evaluation of the Spanish Falangists. Intended for the general public, it was published in January 1937 in **Tratto da Lo Stato**. It was subsequently included in the book **Fascismo e Terzo Reich** ("Fascism and the Third Reich").

Please see *What is Spanish Falangism*[3] for the translated text.

> We believe that the state does not have to justify its behaviour at every turn, just as no individual or social class does, in so far as it holds to a guiding principle all the time. All the while the state is made out to be God by Rousseau's idea that the state, or the will of those it represents, is always right. What makes the state like God is the belief that the will of the state, embodied by absolute monarchs in the past and now by the popular vote, is always right. The monarch may have erred; the popular vote may err because neither truth nor goodness derives from an act or assertion of the will. Goodness and truth are perennial tributaries of reason, and to ascertain whether one is in the right it is not enough to ask the king—whose dictate seemed always just to his supporters—nor enough to canvass the people—whose decision is always right according to the disciples of Rousseau. What must be done rather is to verify whether our actions and our thoughts are in agreement at every step with a permanent aspiration.
>
> José Antonio Primo de Rivera

Julius Evola takes the opportunity to express his own ideas on counter-revolution, under the pretext of evaluating the program of the Spanish

[3] `http://www.gornahoor.net/?page_id=1202`

Falangists from the later part of the 1930s. First of all, he points out that a political soldier must understand the cause for which he is fighting. Ideas, not blind action, are the driving forces behind historical change. Thus, he would seem to support the publication of manifestos or programs and be opposed to the helter-skelter approach of a destructive revolution under the hope of trying to pick up the pieces.

The same applies to nationalism. Beyond any concrete manifestation, a nation is at its base a spiritual reality, that is, "a predestined, cosmic unity." Therefore, it cannot base itself on materialist categories such as race or territorial boundaries. Evola then digresses from this "particularism" and subtly brings up the idea of Empire as itself being a supranational spiritual reality. The Falangist state, therefore, is radically opposed to the liberal, secular, "night watchman" state.

As spiritual reality, the state is organic and results from "cells": the family, the local community, and common business and professional associations. It is hierarchical and opposes any class conflict.

After defining the state, the Falangists deal with the individual. Once again, Evola notes the Traditional idea of the Person: free, autonomous, ordered to eternal life, an absolute value in himself. The Person's freedom is legitimized from above and is opposed to individualistic self-assertion.

The Falange is opposed to materialism. Any movement based on biological determinism or race, and justified by empirical science is not a valid counter-revolutionary movement. They attach themselves to the Catholic faith, in reality, the only historical religion of Spain. Evola here comes very close the the Hermetic view of the Catholic religion. He sees in it a relation to the Primordial Tradition (the so-called "Church of John") while simultaneously entertaining an anti-clericalism ("the Church of Peter"). Evola concludes with a positive evaluation of the Falange.

One sees in this that Evola, despite himself, is really of the **Old Right**. He sees the Europe before the French Revolution as sane and normal.

He also writes approvingly of the masters of the Old Right, from Joseph de Maistre, to Donoso Cortes to José Antonio Primo de Rivera. Any group claiming to be based on "Evola" needs to always keep the principles enunciated in his review in mind.

Posted on 2010-11-21 by Cologero

* * *

`Will on 2011-01-10 at 14:06 said:`
There is some great footage of Jose Antonio, as well as general information about the Falange, here in this documentary:
`http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=yzum_CU44jk`

3.7 Christmas and the Winter Solstice

In 'Roma e il natale solare nella tradizione nordico-aria' (*La Difesa della razza*, 1940), Evola writes:

> Very few suspect that the holidays i.e., Catholic holy days of today, in the century of skyscrapers, radio, great movements of the masses, are celebrated and continue ... a remote tradition, bringing us back to the times when, almost at the dawn of humanity, the rising motion of the first Aryan civilisation began; a tradition, in which, moreover, the great voice of those men is expressed rather than a particular belief.
>
> A fact unknown to most must be first of all remembered, viz., that in its origins the date of **Christmas** and that of the beginning of the new year coincided, this date not being arbitrary, but connected to a precise cosmic event, namely, the **Winter Solstice**. The Winter Solstice falls in fact on December 25, which is the date of Christmas, subsequently known, but which in its origins had an essentially solar significance. That appears also in

> ancient Rome: the date of Christmas in ancient Rome was that of the rising of the Sun, the unconquered God, *Natalis solis invicti*. With that, as the day of the new sun — *dies solis* novi — in the imperial epoch brought the beginning of the new year, the new cycle. But this "solar birth" of Rome in the imperial period, in its turn, referred to a somewhat more remote tradition of Nordic-Aryan origin. Of the reset, Sol, the solar divinity, appeared already among the dii indigetes, that is, among the divinities of Roman origin, passed on from even more distant cycles of civilisation. In reality, the solar religion of the imperial period, in a large measure had the meaning of a recovery and almost of a rebirth, unfortunately altered by various factors of decomposition, of a very old Aryan heritage.

First of all, let us clear up a misconception of the date December 25, which some have believed represents an error on Evola's part. **Julius Caesar**, in his calendar reform of 46 BC, did indeed set the date for the Winter Solstice on December 25. Over the centuries, the subtle error in the length of the Julian year gradually moved the astronomical date backwards. When **Pope Gregory** reformed the Julian calendar, he began with a later year, corresponding to a Church council, rather than the original year of 46 BC. Thus, the Winter Solstice moved back to around December 21 instead of the original December 25. Thus, Evola was correct in his claim that the data of Christmas was set to coincide with the Winter Solstice.

In the article, Evola goes on to tie in the date with the birth of Mithras. He also points out that in ancient Rome, the "day of the sun" was also the "Lord's day", another tradition adopted by the Christians. He also ties this symbolism of the light with the prologue to John's Gospel.

> The true light that gives light to every man was coming into the world

Evola concludes the article

> In the Aryan and Nordic tradition and in Rome itself, the same theme had an importance not only religious and mystical, but sacred, heroic and cosmic at the same time. It was the tradition of a people, to whom the same nature, the same great voice, which I wrote about , at that date, a tradition of a mystery of resurrection, of the birth or rebirth of a beginning not only of "light" and new life, but also of Imperium, in the highest and most august meaning of the word.

Posted on 2010-12-28 by Cologero

* * *

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-12-20 at 13:22 said:
Magicians are supposed to rest on the winter solstice :-)

Cologero on 2011-12-20 at 14:53 said:
Thanks my plan, Charlotte.

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-12-21 at 04:33 said:
Happy Hannukah! May the spiritual lights burn brighter than ever in these days of darkness. Cxx

Attila on 2011-12-22 at 23:31 said:
I was informed by a neighbor that last night was celebrated as Shab-e Yalda in Iran- which ostensibly represents the turning point -where darkness starts to give way to light- probably in connection with the birth of Mithra- the Sun god of ancient Persia. It's a beautiful holiday in the line of other pre-Islamic Iranian celebrations such as Now-Ruz (1st day of Spring).

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-12-23 at 06:11 said:
Clearly a big day/night for the entire world and rest of the cosmos :-)

Perennial on 2012-12-20 at 03:12 said:
This is from a post I made on a debate on the date of Christmas in another forum I thought I would share: The feast of Sol Invictus began the week before, and as was common in the

traditional world the feast lasted several days. The day of the unconquered sun overlapped with the 25th, but did not fall on it. In addition, the feast of Sol Invictus was not widely celebrated until about 200 years after Christ's death, being popularised by Augustus Aurelian. In fact, it has been speculated that Sol Invictus was actually a rip-off of Christmas, and not the reverse. We know that the feast of Sol Invictus dates to no earlier than 274 AD at Rome. This was observed by Roman games every 4 years, evidenced by the surviving Chronology of 354, which lists the games as beginning on the 25th. However, Christmas, from ancient Martyologies, was already celebrated annually on the 25th in 336. In fact there is no reason to believe that Sol Invictus was observed December 25th prior to 354, a full 18 years after the Roman sacramentary records Christmas. In fact, scholars believe that August may have likely been the original month Sol was celebrated. Other works list solar game in October. Tertullian argued for December 25th being Christ's birth back in 198 AD, 76 years before Sol Invictus was even observed by Aurelian, so clearly none of this was new. As for the other nonsense, such as Saturnalia and the like, Saturnalia occurred in earl December, nowhere near Christmas, and ended before the 25th. Clearly, there is little connection between pagan deities and the Feast of the Nativity. The Holy Father rightly observes that Christ's birthday is dated 9 months after the Annunciation, when Our Lady conceived Our Lord. No mysteries here.

`Cologero on 2012-12-20 at 10:29 said:`

With all due respect, Perennial, you should be seeing mysteries everywhere; this is hardly the equivalent of a birth announcement in the NY Times. Please review your rosary.

Unfortunately, you are adopting the methods of "scientific" history, so praised in the documents of Vatican II, but whose effects have been quite corrosive. Expresssions such as "there is no evidence" or "there is no reason to believe" are far from establishing anything concrete.

The second mistake you make is thinking Gornahoor is like any other forums you may frequent. You may want to refute Saturnalia all you want, but I don't believe that was even mentioned in the post nor in Evola's text.

I suggest you read the chapter "The Limits of History and Geography" from "The Reign of Quantity" and try to rewrite your comment in its light.

Evola's, and Guenon's, point is that dates are not arbitrary. Pace, Evola, however, Christmas is not a decomposition, but rather a deepening and a recomposition. It renewed a decomposing Tradition, which we witness in the Middle Ages. It was such, also, that a poet like Virgil could anticipate the start of a new Golden Age.

`Perennial on 2012-12-20 at 12:56 said:`

I agree, Cologero. Obviously, this was written for a different context to be read by a different audience. I am not attempting to refute Evola, since i agree with him, and even though I do not believe that Christmas is based on the solstice, I also believe it is not arbitrary and the feast

occurs where it does for a reason. I do not think it is coincidence that all of these events occur in December, either. I shared this primarily to give some factual background to parallel the post, rather than compete with it.

3.8 Subterranean History

> On various occasions we have insisted on the necessity of a radical revision of methods and criteria with which, in the order of common teaching and of that culture that claims to be serious, history is made. We demonstrated that history of true history does not grasp that the two dimensions of the surface and leaves itself totally missing the third dimension, which is depth, where the essential meanings and the truly determining causes of so many events are hidden. Finally, we indicated the absurdity inherent today in insisting as much on the Roman tradition, on its symbols, vision of life, and at the same time to continue to consider the world of the Roman antiquity with the usual glance emptied of the erudite, archeology, philosophy, and of criticism.
>
> Julius Evola, Sulla storia sotterranea di Roma, from *La Vita Italiana* (February, 1939)

Evola was quite familiar with Rudolf Steiner through the Ur and Krur groups which had a few anthroposophists as members. In a review of a book, The Mystery of the origins of Rome, by one of them, **Duke Colonna di Cesaro**, Evola takes the occasion to distinguish between New Age movements and true tradition. The book's positive aspect is to avoid the modernist error of writing history from the perspective of a man of today while judging as "irrelevant, fantastic and inconsistent" every ancient tradition including "symbol, myth, legend, allegory" which fell in the center of traditional consciousness and was characteristic of the ancient savants and priests. Duke Colonna writes:

> Legend and history are connected. The former proceeds through interiorization and is communicated through images; the latter through exteriorization in facts and events. The images are the result of living formative forces ... The legend is the invisible of history and the root of history... The threads of the destiny of a people, are unraveled visibly in various ways in their historical development, ascending to the impulses and creative spheres with which the heroes of their legends were tied.

Evola explains that

> the hidden consciousness or memory of a mission are conserved in legends and is transmitted to those of later times who will be capable of recognizing what a people and a civilization had for itself on a superhistoric, spiritual plane.

But then the Duke ruins it all with his evolutionist perspective and tries to eat space. He does recognize the "*fundamental opposition of the myths, cults and symbols of an Olympic-Uranic, solar, virile, heroic and regal character to those of a telluric, chthonic, infernal, lunar, feminine, sacerdotal character*."

However, rather than understanding this opposition in an originary and absolute way, he regards them as mere phases in an evolutionary process of progress. Rather, the greatness of Rome does not reside in an innovation, but rather in a restoration and a return to the primordial state of tradition. So the seeds of ancient wisdom are not destined to perish as just a preparatory phase in the rush to modernity, but rather to be transmuted in a new cycle.

The Duke regards the worst aspects of Rome in its decline as on the contrary the sign of its historic mission. "Rome, in so far as it had an historic mission, became the instrument of ethnic chaos, leveling universalism, a cosmopolitanism fatal for the preceding, differentiating types of civilization." As for the true Rome, the Duke sees "*traditional residues*"

the debris of a past that refuses to die. Colonna then proposes that the function of Christianity was to play that role.

Here, again, Evola objects, writing,

> we see that Christianity became Roman with Catholicism: purifying itself of its originary anarchic, universalistic and humanitarian aspect, in the Middle Ages it gave rise to a civilization of a structured, hierarchic type, tied to traditions of caste and blood scattered with initiatic elements.

Duke Colonna had to relegate them to the past, to prechristian stages of evolution. Evola writes:

> Through such aspects, it is clear that in the Middle Ages a resurgence of the true forces already acting in Nordic-Aryan Romanity, *of a true solarity by a new contribution of Aryan blood*.

Duke Colonna, on the other hand, sees the Middle Ages as an obstacle, a stoppage of evolution, on the way that ultimately would lead to "progress" in the Reformation, Humanism, the French Revolution, liberalism, modern democracy, and internationalism. Only with the final collapse of the West can the Self be truly liberated. Traditions, blood, caste, traditional cults and dogmas will have become empty words, and the modern man will have become "self-conscious", detached from everything, ready eventually to create, out of nothing, a new civilization on the basis of a universal communion freely willed.

Evola concludes with some comments on Christianity:

> The question of the solarity of Christianity merits a comment. From what has seen said we can already foresee the way with which, from the traditional point of view, one must formulate the problem. Solar elements are without doubt present in Christianity (specifically, of course, in Roman Catholicism). But

> not in virtue of, but in spite of, those subversive and universalistic aspects, which were valued by Steiner and Cesaro, not to mention Buonaiuti and many other Protestant adorers of "pure Christianity". These elements are not to be considered as an achievement, but rather as residual fragments of the great primordial solar tradition, echoes of which, resonating in an historical environment never unfavorable to the goals of the effective protection of their purity and their deepest meaning. It is proper that to explain the fact that such solar elements in Christianity lost their originary metaphysical capacity and assumed only a religious or, at most, a theological capacity, and that they were no longer connected to the mysteries and to a pure hereditary priestly caste, but were only points of reference for a general faith and a legacy of a priesthood enlisted without any condition of blood or race.
>
> This difference is also important for its practical consequences. In fact, while the evolutionist, starting from their premises, even here will give themselves over to arbitrary digressions, dreaming up this or that new form of Christian initiation (and something similar claims exactly to furnish the anthroposophical doctrine of Steiner). Instead those who make themselves out to be traditional will measure the current value of Christianity and its possibility of contributing to a future spiritual reconstruction by the same standard of susceptibility, from part of the solar elements present in it, of integrating itself in the widest order of primordial solar tradition, to which it can be legitimately applied *quod ubique, quod ab omnibus et quod semper*. And in this order, undoubtedly, we will be able to verify an essential convergence of the positive element of Christianity with what was great, virile, Olympic both in authentic, primordial, sacred Romanity, and the greatest forms of the common Aryan and Indo-european civilization.

Although we shall refrain from commenting at this time, let us make clear that there is a great mass of insights in this extract from Evola's essay. Those insights, unfortunately, will remain invisible to those incapable of

seeing the third dimension of depth in history. I would expect the readers to comment on this material and its relationship to the most recent several posts, but in a more measured way than the previous frenzied discussion.

However, I would like to add an important footnote. We should now be able to see clearly the true mission of Valentin Tomberg. He abandoned anthroposophy for the retrograde (from their point of view) Catholicism of the Middle Ages. His mission was to gather those fragments of Tradition and tie them to the mysteries. Unfortunately, there are subversive elements who still attempt to sabotage Tomberg for their own purposes, as just an another element of the evolutionary process. They are much more vocal and organized than we are.

Posted on 2011-09-13 by Cologero

* * *

`logres on 2011-09-14 at 17:17 said:`

This is actually more than just helpful, on Steiner. Gurdjieff actually also took issue with Anthroposophists on just such an account (the belief that all men "automatically" have an astral body). See the Bachofen-Mommsen debate

`http://www.bu.edu/arion/files/2010/03/Paglia-Great-Mother1.pdf`

for an example of precisely how evolutionary subversion can often function at an organized, sophisticated level & even appear to be oriented towards Tradition. A lot of "traditional" websites openly proclaim an age of Feminine prominence in this vein. I'd personally like to pry Bondarev and Heindel out of their grasp, but Steiner may only be possibly used as a "vein" to mine.

If there is an earthly Church, there had to be a heavenly one. If the earthly one is sick and degraded, then the appeal has to go to the heavenly court.

`Max on 2017-09-05 at 07:53 said:`

Evola seem to be saying that the elements of Catholicism that are generally restricted to a religious understanding should instead be made the subject of metaphysical realization, in which case Catholicism would take on a solar character. A feminine religious universalism translates to a cosmic solar interiority, which is in order since the church is after all a feminine entity. Evola is inconsistent because the perception of Christianty becomes passive precisely

when seen through the kind of horizontal framework that he himself criticizes. If Romanity is judged through the third dimension of history, Christendom should be allowed the same privilege on equal footing, because if restricted to historical residues, there is certainly much to be critical of with the Roman empire as well. The catacombs of Rome are the catacombs of the Church beyond which lies the wilderness of forests and deserts, although Christian saints were no stranger to either.

3.9 Aztecs and Human Sacrifice

On the supposition that Greenland was larger and connected the Eastern and Western hemispheres, these Hyperboreans, related to the Cro-Magnon man, would have wandered as far as Meso-America. As evidence of a connection, Evola points to the Aztec claim to be from Atzlan (the land of light) and the Toltecs to Thule. Presumably, these migrations were mixed with Orientals and the Lemurians. Evola seems to waver on the solarity of the Aztecs. In Pagan Imperialism, he explains:

> from China to Greece, from Rome to the primordial Nordic groups, then up to the Aztecs and the Incas, nobility was not characterised by the simple fact of having ancestors, but by the fact that the ancestors of the nobility were divine, unlike those of the plebeians, and to which though it can remain faithful, also through the integrity of blood (in the caste system, the principle of heredity was valid not only for the higher castes, but also for the lower ones). The nobles originated from "demigods", that is to say, from beings who had actually followed a transcendent form of life, forming the origin of a tradition in the higher sense, transmitting to their lineage a blood made divine, and, along with it, rites, that is, determinate operations, whose secret every noble family preserved, which allowed their descendants to continue the spiritual conquest from where it had previously reached, and to lead it gradually from the virtual to the actual.

Thus "family values" do not refer to the bourgeois nuclear family as commonly assumed today. The Vedas show that the "family" encompasses generations.

> Thus, from the traditional point of view, not-having-ancestors distinguishes the plebeian from the patrician less than not-having-rites. In Aryan hierarchies, a single characteristic differentiated the higher castes from the lower: rebirth. The arya, as opposed to the shudra (the one who serves), was the dvija, the twice-born. The assertion of the Manavadharmashastra (II, 172), that the brahman himself, if he left out initiation, would no longer be differentiated from the one who serves, the shudra, is indicative.

Keep in mind here, that for Evola, the shudra are of a different race from the Brahmans, at least in terms of "race of the spirit". As for the Nordics, Evola writes:

> The Nordic nobles were noble because, in their blood, they carried the blood of the Asen, of the "celestial" forces in continuous struggle with the elemental beings. The nobility of the great medieval orders of chivalry — among which the most significant were the Templars — was also tied to initiation. One of the weakest points in Nietzsche's conception is precisely his biological naturalism, which, in most cases, diminishes and secularises his aristocratic idea, carrying it down to the level of the "blond beast".

Here we see again Evola's emphasis on the greater battle, waged within. As for the Aztecs, Evola expressed a somewhat different opinion in Revolt against the Modern World, where he seems to regard them as a decadent form, but anyone can read that, so I won't repeat. For a rather different take on this question, I'll refer to *The Battle for Amerindia* by the Traditionalist Catholic **Solange Hertz**.

> so-called "underdeveloped" peoples languishing in the lower stages of evolution have actually degenerated from higher cultures.

In one sense, she is referring to the Amerindians of Mesoamerica, although, in her view, they were not nearly as degenerate as modern Europeans who have lost connection with their own past. This is a sobering thought which should not be passed over lightly. To regard whites as somehow superior (in culture, creativity, productivity, IQ, and so on) and thus immune to the fate of other peoples, misses the point. Most of the literature of that genre focuses on inferior peoples being admitted into formerly white lands. Mrs. Hertz is claiming that perhaps it is the whites who, having abandoned their spiritual heritage in the pursuit of decadence and economic gain, are in truth the spiritually degenerate people. As for the sacrificial practices of the Aztecs, she offers this historical tidbit:

> Las Casas the Bishop of Chiapas even went so far as to maintain that the Spaniards had no right to interfere forcibly with the human sacrifices offered by pagan Amerindians, detecting in these, as would Joseph de Maistre two hundred years later, a perverted but profound religious instinct which did not flinch from surrendering to their deities what they deemed most precious!

Joseph de Maistre, by the way, was an author esteemed by Evola.

As a last comment which can either provide food for thought or be ignored totally, we can note, as did Evola, that Mesoamerica was dedicated to the Serpent. Mrs Hertz tells us that the Lady of Guadalupe who appeared to Juan Diego is a transliteration of the Aztec word *Coatlalopeuh*, which means the "Crusher of the Serpent".

At the very least, Mrs. Hertz provides a more nuanced view of the relationship between the Spanish and the Aztecs that what we hear from the hard left every **Columbus Day**. Bishop Las Casas was clearly against

forced conversions and was able to see what was best in the rites of the pagan Aztecs.

Posted on 2011-10-16 by Aeneas

* * *

`Will on 2011-10-17 at 07:53 said:`

Excellent post, but I don't remember Evola's view of the Aztecs being any different in Revolt, so I went back and checked. On pages 232-3, he says that the Aztecs, Toltecs, and Incas were the bearers of solar civilization, overcoming the Mayas and other telluric peoples. Historically this would seem to parallel the Aryan invasion of India and the Dorian invasion of Greece. However, by the time of the European conquest, these civilizations had indeed degenerated, and that is the decadent form to which your post refers. Analogously, the Spartans of the 3rd century B.C. were a far cry from those of the 6th.

The Catholics were not the first to 'crush the serpent' in Mesoamerica. The Aztecs built their capital Tenochitlan (now Mexico City) at the sight of an eagle holding a snake in its claws. The eagle is a traditional Olympian symbol, and here it would seem to symbolize the conquest of the telluric by the solar.

`EXIT on 2011-10-17 at 10:13 said:`

A.:"Maybe WN groups are seeking out initiations privately."

I'm no WN, but I don't understand how you can talk about initiation when gornahoor supports self-initiation (which Guenon and co. referred to as pseudo-initiation); hence gornahoor is in no better position than WN.

`James O'Meara on 2011-10-17 at 19:20 said:`

Still pasting Evola quotes into content-free arguments, I see.

WNs who are... ?

"Their goals... Which are... ? Have you ever, at any time on this blog, ever, ever named a "WN" or "their goals"? Of course not, then someone would be able to evaluate your arguments.

You could substitute "Americans" or "pawnbrokers" or "these damn kids with their rock and roll" or whatever and make as much a contribution to thought.

You're like one of those stuck-up Euros who deplored America's "racism" from safely White communities, until the Arabs started burning police cars in Paris and committing EVERY rape in Stockholm true fact! If you think America will have any 'initiatory rites' or 'esoteric Christianity' when the whole thing looks like Detroit, you're crazy.

If you think Evola would support importing millions of North Africans into Italy, you're crazier.

[

Although we never implied that, it follows the logic of the Left Hand Path. Choose the more difficult experience.

As for the program of the WNs, we've found someone to discuss that and it will appear on the Right Hand Path blog directly.

C!

]

James O'Meara on 2011-10-17 at 19:46 said:

Also, it's pretty rich for you to quote from Pagan Imperialism, a book that Evola wrote to suck up to the Fascisti, and then re-wrote, dropping the Roman stuff and lauding the Nordics, to suck up to the Nazis even, later, swanning around in a Gestapo uniform , in order to critique "White Nationalists."

[Yes, James, life is full of such contradictions. The trick is to foresee who to suck up to.

Glad to have you aboard again. C.]

Cologero on 2011-10-17 at 20:31 said:

To Exit:

Besides the Traditional Catholic initiations, whose validity is not accepted unanimously by the early masters of Tradition, I have been initiated by a Tibetan lama. I will make the documentation available online in the near future.

Cologero

Cologero on 2011-10-18 at 00:45 said:

Re Initiations

Besides initiations into Traditional Catholic and Buddhist forms, I have other initiations, whose regularity may be doubted by some.

The truth of the matter is that in the Kali Yuga much more can be accomplished by a man who knows how. As Jesus told us, "Be as innocent as the Holy Spirit, but as cunning as Lucifer." Heaven must be taken by storm in our age, a man must be clever and find his way by piecing things together.

The greater struggle is more difficult in our time. However, winning that battle will give us more strength, power and will than it would in more pacific times. Negativity and chaos can and must be transmuted into order and transcendence. The greater the negativity, the greater the possibilities of overcoming.

So, Exit, if you are expecting someone to take you by the hand like some kindergarten student and lead you into some perfect initiation, then you are not the type of man that Gornahoor is intended to appeal to.

For anyone interested, these are those groups; however, *a chacun son gout*. Whatever their demerits, they still teach experiential practice. By studying the more traditional practices, one learns to see what they are really saying. Furthermore, by tying personal experience in with a Traditional metaphysical teaching, they each reinforce each other. Given our situation today, it is what we have.

Transcendental Meditation

Gurdjieff Fourth Way work

Kaballah

Rune Guild (on my own as I never took formal initiation)

`Matt on 2011-10-18 at 02:31 said:`

Looking forward to the future documentation on the initiation by the Lama. Did it take place in the Himalayan region?

`Charlotte Cowell on 2011-10-18 at 17:52 said:`

This is tangential to your post on Aztecs, but the comment about initiation and rebirth caught my eye. I am presuming that most people will agree that true initiation is not conferred in a mundane ritualistic way by one human being upon another, as may happen in a 'secret society'. The right hand, after all, is not meant to know what the left is doing in order for such divine magic to occur. True initiation is (in my view at least), something that takes place via the vertical hierarchy of angelic forces and, ultimately, the Holy Spirit. (The identity of the initial 'psychopomp' is perhaps an absolute mystery, something which defies explanation and description, characterised simply by 'its' function). Most people would also agree, however, that as no man is an island, we are all dependent upon one another, to some extent, for the catalytic energy that might assist with our personal development. When it comes to the matter of rebirth in relation to initiation one must necessarily be dependent upon an awakening of memory – for how can one be conscious of past lives without remembrance. So I put the question to you, are we therefore dependent upon others (our 'karmic relations' if I might get Steinerish for a moment) for this reawakening? Even more – given the ultimately androgynous condition of the complete human entity, reflection of the divine – is it essential to encounter our 'soul mate' or 'twin flame' (or however one must define such beings and aspects of our self) in order to take certain initiatory steps forward? A Hindu or Buddhist might say no, it is possible to achieve this state by individual effort alone (albeit with intense scriptural meditation, which might possibly be seen as a form of programming), whereas a Kabablist might say yes... I wonder

what the 'acceptable' Christian position is on this given that reincarnation is still very much taboo (probably with very good reason) for the exoteric church... .

Perennial on 2011-10-19 at 03:47 said:

Charlotte, reincarnation, as it is generally understood, is taboo amongst the Traditionalists as well, denounced by both Evola and Guenon. They did believe in a form of "reincarnation", however. So when you say reincarnation, what do you mean by that?

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-10-19 at 12:18 said:

well Perennial, doubtless it's an immense mystery. One thing is for sure, exploration of the reincarnation idea can lead one right to the edge and beyond of the abyss, which is surely why it's taboo. A necessary part of pathworking? Perhaps, but fraught with spiritual, psychological and emotional danger if one falls into the Qlipoth, as human beings almost invariably will (must, given our imperfect state?). But I would still say that one should not 'go there' unless utterly compelled in some unavoidable way. ie, if one's soul is trapped in the 'eighth sphere' without hope of return unless one goes back to the beginning and starts again... maybe that's all of us at some stage or other.

But looking at it another way, the body is a temple for the soul/spirit, so who knows what and/or whom might walk through those doors, invited or uninvited? If you or I achieve a certain state of receptivity whereby our 'selves' (our ordinary ego selves) are turned outwards, a space is made within. In this context, one might experience many, many lives during one life on Earth. I might say without trace of irony, I've lived but once – this is the first and last – yet I'm not only Eve but Artemis, not only the Magdalene but the Jezebel. Marie Antoinnette and sea priestess, every woman in fact, while you are every man from Adam to Apollo, Jesus Christ and Caesar, and that's without even considering the animal kingdom. Is that reincarnation enough, or is there more? While I feel this is the acceptable and Christian line and also in fact the simple truth, there is more when we go through the looking glass (which perhaps we should not do. Probably we should not).

For many years following my conversion to Christianity I simply didn't think about reincarnation, I really didn't care if it was a fact or not, I considered it to be one of those things that one need not think about (along with Atlantis and Shambhala and all kinds of other 'grey areas' I was led to face in recent years). What made the difference for me is that after many years of what I'd describe as a dark night of the soul – a true lonely wilderness – I met another of those people that come into one's life from time to time and trigger a massive change. I have been in love before, but when I met this particularly person I was forcibly and instantaneously struck by the fact that we'd known each other forever, which is not something I'd ever experienced before.

We saw each other only very rarely and briefly over the next 3 years or so, but at some

point this (very materialistic down to earth) man said he felt like our relationship was magical, as if we'd known each other in a past life. This sounds very romantic and even slushy no doubt, but perhaps you can appreciate that for someone with a very traditionally Christian mindset this was an idea with revelatory power that opened up doorways (real or imaginary) that I never knew existed (he'd said what I had already been thinking for a long time, though I wrestled with the idea long and hard, wondering if it was just an illusion. As it happens, I probably did fall into the domain of Maya, but we all go through this so I'm not afraid to say it).

But even this is a simplification given that the Imperial task is to be fully human, with all the human loves and losses that entails. I am struggling a bit to define how my mindset began to change – or perhaps, how my perspective was altered – but my continual longing to be with this person had the effect of leading me to look backwards as far as possible to the start of time, as I explored the idea of soulmates and the originally unified (androgynous) being (human and divine).

Some aspects of this exploration posed me with no difficulties while others appeared as insurmountable problems. The quality of time, for instance, is not something that phases me, as from the very start of my esoteric spiritual journey I've been fully aware (and in no doubt) that it has no meaning beyond this dimension. It binds us 'here', but we are entirely free of it 'there', as it is for space, the other side of the same continuum. So in this respect 'looking back' has to be analogous with 'looking in', it's simply a matter of evoking the state one wishes to explore – ancient Greece for instance, or Genesis. (Of course one could not accomplish this without recourse to myth for our archetypal references).

So I had little difficulty drawing a conclusion about my 'past life' in ancient times with this individual, because whether or not we as personalities really were reborn again and again until the present age, the analogy still stood at an archetypal level. (even if it is only true in one's own mind, it is still a tool one might usefully use when navigating the road of return. We are born male and female together, and needs must comprehend our opposite side in order to get back to where we were. Whether another human can only ever be a 'best possible match' of anima or animus, or whether (as kabbalists would say), they truly are another half to the self, is probably a matter of opinion so far as the world today is concerned.

In the context of physics – quantum mechanics, superstring theory and so on – the Law of Vibration described by the Kybalion makes the association simple. Whatever really happens to the soul throughout earth ages, the resonance is real, the analogy works, the echo resounds and time/space are traversed, even escaped in an eternal sense. Reincarnation is almost a red herring in this context, as everything is already and always there in the realm of eternity, we only need remember it and find it within ourselves. Without going mad, losing our faith or killing ourselves/ each other :-)

Perhaps I am not explaining myself very well as there was so much emotional content to the experience (overwhelmingly so), but suffice it to say that this one person in particular fully

awakened my memory, leading me to believe that we had occupied a similar position in relation to one another at another point in the space-time continuum. Possibly more than once. So there is a powerful soul-mate element to all of this and again I think it's very Steinerish in flavour (not deliberately), in that the idea of reincarnation seems to be inextricably linked to karmic relationships.

So to answer your question, in the sense pertaining to Maya it is 'all in the mind', but in a concrete spiritual sense we are eternal and therefore contain the whole of time and space. If a certain note is struck within our souls it will vibrate all the way along that line from start to finish ad infinitum. it's a matter of comprehending the essence – the note – that corresponds to a certain archetype, past or future.

As an addendum, it's worth noting that some individuals under hypnosis have come out with detailed information from the past that only appears to be explicable in the context of either reincarnation or mediumistic practice.

EXIT on 2011-10-21 at 18:26 said:

C. wrote, "I have been initiated by a Tibetan lama."

Is this the same fictional Tibetan adept from whom Blavatsky attempted to derive her authority? Speaking of which the "society of independents" sounds quite similar to Encausse's "independent group for esoteric studies". But even if I give you the benefit of the doubt that you did get a Buddhist initiation, it is not as if one receives a simple initiation and automatically attains enlightenment. It takes years and years with a guru before one is even in a position to attain such, that I would not take anyone's word that he had firsthand knowledge of metaphysical states at face value. Seeing as though you do not practice Buddhism outwardly, at least not in your writings, I think it safe to say that this initiation was not that serious.

Cologero on 2011-10-22 at 16:51 said:

Exit, you are a special kind of idiot so dear to me, the *idiot savant*, someone who knows how to do all the calculations yet does not quite understand what they are for. You can start with what we wrote on *Madhyamika*[4]. An effete display of erudition is of no benefit to anyone; our intent here is to outline the lineaments of a possible future tradition, which will not be created by me, yet it will happen. The first step, as in the Madhyamika, is to overcome all points of view; without that, there is no point in proceeding. Hence, we have related it to many posts, particularly on the Evolean idea of the First Trial. Interested readers may also look up our posts on Josephin Peladan and see how they relate. It is important to read in depth, not just horizontally.

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-10-22 at 17:39 said:

[4] http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=299

To C! and Exit, firstly, I'd avidly love to hear more about the Tibetan initiation.

Secondly, my own view on initiation is that it is conferred by the Holy Spirit and one is able to perceive the presence of a guiding entity. Some might define this as the guardian angel, or as a psychopomp. Another that should probably be said is that it (initiation) comes in stages and one had most definitely better be ready, willing and able at all times to drop absolutely everything when required to take the next step.

Next, more pertinent to this particular point, anyone on the initiatory path – or the 'royal road' as a Sufi might say – is (from what I can tell, based on the experience of every true initiate I've ever known of), going to head towards India/Tibet in more ways than one. It's a simple matter of it being what happens.

You are right to point out the years of discipline required by way of preparation – it's easy to see how Buddha laid the carpet down for Christ in the direction of bodily control, right motivation and so on. But this is not all there is to it. The wisdom of the ages is to be found in all corners of the Earth and the Himalayan teaching is a one of these – gold is produced in this region, remember?

Also remember that the teachers of this region are masters in the art of telepathic communication, astral and etheric travel. Spend enough time in those realms and one will encounter Tibetan guides. Seek and ye SHALL find, but how ardently one must seek... ..well, it has to be longed for above all other things and override every other commitment in life.

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-10-22 at 17:52 said:

Exit, this comment of yours:

"it is not as if one receives a simple initiation and automatically attains enlightenment"

Well as it happens, these things DO occur in the twinkling of an eye and surely one will be amazed in that moment of eternity! Indeed, it will be a moment of such import that the impression it makes on the soul will be powerful enough to sustain that being through the trials that follow. It WILL constitute the defining moment of one's life. The light itself must be strong enough to illumine the way for many long and otherwise dark years, without it one would simply give up in despair.

Very specific to what is being described as a Buddhist initiation, from what I know I can say that it's certainly possibly to receive an instantaneous 'dharma transmission', the efficiacy of which depends on both the capacity to 'pass over' such knowledge on the part of the 'carrier', and the twin capacity to receive on the part of the neophyte, or pupil. Trust and purity of intention are fundamental to the success of this procedure and, I would suggest, an element of conducive personal chemistry is also required for such face-to-face, heart-to-heart, spirit-soul contact.

So yes, believe it or not, one IS transformed in a flash of light, praise be to God!

EXIT on 2011-10-23 at 09:32 said:

CC:"So yes, believe it or not, one IS transformed in a flash of light"
If you believe that you're only fooling yourself. How about Zen satori?

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-10-24 at 05:38 said:
'There are two ways to be fooled. One is to believe what isn't true; the other is to refuse to believe what is true' (Kierkegaard)
It was Jung who said that he didn't have to believe any more because he KNOWS... .

3.10 Germanic Rome

This translation is from the chapter on the theories of Count de Gobineau from Il mito del sangue, (The Myth of Blood). Although there is much to be said about this passage, I'll leave it to the readers to draw out some conclusions. In some respects Gobineau agrees with Evola: Rome declined and the Middle Ages was the recovery of Tradition by the joint efforts of the Romans and Nordics. After that period, the West declined, paradoxically a victim of its own success. For Gobineau, the spiritual aspect is irrelevant as only the race of the body accounts for everything. Hence, the choice between paganism and Christianity does not matter, at least insofar as the latter was purified of Semitic elements under the influence of the Germanics. What is of interest is Evola's concluding remarks; it probably explains why he had to reject zoological racism. Since this chapter is of significant interest, I hope to post more of it in the next week or two.

> Another product of the mixing of blood for **Count de Gobineau** would be the feeling for one's homeland and authority, that would arise from the union of Aryans and Semites, from a semitic mitigation of the Aryan predilection for isolation, independence and personality. We will see this theme taken up again by some extremist racialist writers in the sense of relating every

form of sovereignty and statolatry comprising the ethnic-national elements to something "semitic".

Moreover, the expression "Semitic Rome" comes up in de Gobineau to designate the imperial period of that civilization; that, "not in the sense that it indicates a human type identical to that which results from the Ancient Chaldean and Hamitic combinations: but in the sense that "of the multitudes scattered with Rome's fortunes over all the countries subject to the Caesars, the greater part was more or less stained with black blood and represented thus a combination not equivalent but analogous to the semitic mixing."

The predominant "black" qualities, well containted in certain limits and compensated by means of some white qualities were, for de Gobineau, essential factors in the development of imperial Rome. In more than one point, the position taken by de Gobineau in regards to Christianity seems negative: too much to listen to again, this popular belief, of "a religion of slaves, humiliating because pacifistic and egalitarian, and, in a word, unworthy of the races that still conserves any scintilla whatsoever of the Aryan flame." In any case, Christianity for him was purified little by little from semitic elements and the Greek made itself Roman (Catholicism) and then, from the Romans, it became Germanic.

For de Gobineau, the Germans and the other Nordic stocks of the invasions appear as the ancient races of pure Aryan blood. But, attracted by the mirage of the Roman symbol, it could not escape the destiny of being dissolved in the potent detritus of the mixed races of Rome, among which their energy and their blood had to decline. This assimilation therefore was not so rapid to drag society to the semitic point of departure typical of the low empire: initially, the Germanic elements were able to be absorbed, but not up to such a sign.

It is thus that the civilisation of "Germanic Rome" arises, that is, the Medieval civilisation. Every normal society, for de Gob-

ineau, is founded on three originary classes or castes, corresponding to distinct ethnic strata: "The nobility, an image more or less like the glorious race; the bourgeoisie, composed of metics similar to the great race; the people, a servile social class belonging to an inferior human type; black in the South, Finnish in the North." The Middle Ages still knew such a partition. But it revealed itself always more deprived of its racial base and therefore of its strength. So this hierarchical picture had to unravel little by little while the last veins of pure Aryan blood were snuffed out and scattered. This moves us towards the modern "repugnant atmosphere of the democratic muck."

The conclusion of de Gobineau's viewpoint, which is found in his principle work, the famous Essay on the Inequality of the Human Races, that was published between 1853 and 1855, is pessimistic. The dominant impulse of the white race, throwing itself over the entire earth, broke the last ethnic barriers, created a world in which distances no longer exist and where rapprochement, aggregation, and confusion of types are fatal and as rapid as ever. "Pure Aryans are no longer found". It is an inexorable law that any group that has the potency of civilisation attracts other races, extends itself, brings itself geographically further and further, dissipates itself, degrades itself. De Gobineau, at the end of his book, says that the history of the world turns ostensibly, through such a path, toward that "supreme unity" that, otherwise, he already declared that it was true only for the metics without race.

Posted on 2011-10-17 by Aeneas

* * *

`logres on 2011-10-18 at 08:44 said:`

Given the nature of genetics (on Gobineau's own assumptions) couldn't you always have a hidden persistence, then resurgence, of certain characteristics or traits?

Cologero on 2011-10-18 at 23:46 said:

Gobineau had no understanding of genetics, nor did any of the authors critiqued in the Myth of Blood. As for those traits, the question is whether they are simply genetic traits, or, more likely, related to qualities of the soul or spirit. What is really of interest here is Gobineau's description of the stages in the Christianisation of Europe.

Beginning with the decline of Imperial Rome, "Semitic Rome", Gobineau proposes the following stages:

I. Semitic (primitive Christianity)

II. Greek (Orthodox)

III. Roman (Catholicism)

IV. Nordic-Roman (Medievalism)

V. Nordic (Lutheranism)

This is how the later Nordic racialists, for example, Herman Wirth and H S Chamberlain, regarded it; reading Internet forums shows the persistance of this viewpont. These stages correspond remarkably to their views on race. They despise primitive Christianity as Semitic and the product of the lowest classes of Rome. Slavs, for the most part Orthodox, were not considered European.

They are more ambiguous about the Catholic countries of Southern Europe, not wholly approving nor disapproving.

However, in Gobineau's view, the Reformation was not a progressive development, but rather a symptom of racial decline. The Reformation undid the Nordic-Roman creation of a Traditional civilization. Paradoxically and incoherently, the Nordicists are attached to the Reformation, while we would make these points.

- Luther rejected the Medieval Church for its pagan elements.
- Luther claimed to be returning to primitive Christianity
- Luther rejected the Christian OT (Septuagint) in favour of the Jewish Masoretic text

This is what perplexed Evola. Instead of going in the direction of a continued repaganisation of Christendom, Luther set in motion the Semiticization of Europe. This movement became progressively stronger in Calvin, the Puritans, and especially now in the zionism of the neo-Christians today. In the other direction, as the force of the Christian element weakened in the North, there developed a philosophical naturalism that was just as opposed to the supernatural and traditional values of Christendom.

This has to be seen as a decline in the race of the soul of Northern Europeans, not in the race of the body. First of all, the Reformation took root in the North, where the effects of race mixing was presumably much less than in the South. I am not convinced by Gobineau's assertion that the North declined from interbreeding with the Finnish element.

Yet, this is what most WNs mean by saving Western civilisation: the re-semiticized Europe both spiritually and philosophically. Gornahoor intends instead, the recovery of Medievalism. The former group has demonstrated little capacity for dialogue on this central point, since it doesn't fit into their preconceptions.

logres on 2011-10-19 at 00:14 said:

Perhaps it was simply a case of occult forces playing one against the other, to the maximal detriment of both. A great argument for transcendence of self if there ever was one. Very helpful addendum, thank you. It seems Protestantism cast its lot in with the new money markets and materialism.

Cologero on 2011-10-19 at 00:54 said:

It is always a case of occult forces, the third dimension of history, which we have try to identify. The first step is the greater battle, that is, to recognize these forces within oneself. Then the lesser battle is to note the same forces in the external world.

The first is the struggle between cosmos and chaos, or hierarchy vs the undifferentiated mass. This appears as the contest between order and disorder. Insofar as disorder predominates, it indicates a privation, or lack of power and strength of will.

The battle now, however, is between supernaturalism and naturalism. The latter denies the third dimension of occult forces, so the true battle is never even recognized. Instead, there are many pseudo-struggles within naturalism that sap energy and resources. So, yes, it is an "argument" for developing the awareness of transcendence.

Izak on 2011-10-19 at 23:52 said:

"It seems Protestantism cast its lot in with the new money markets and materialism."

I'd say this is a solid understatement, if anything. Just look at how reliant Lutheranism was on the printing press, for instance. Without that possibility for mass dissemination of information, you would have none of the protestant insistence on people of lower orders to interpret the word for themselves. They simply wouldn't have had the means.

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-10-20 at 09:12 said:

'people of lower orders', who decides which ones fall into THAT category?! (anyone without royal blood, perhaps, would that mean most of us here?). Also remember that people of ahem 'higher orders' are more than capable of misinterpretation if their own egos are insufficiently

purified or they have personal agendas to pursue. The Holy Spirit speaks to the heart and anyone can listen if they're so inclined. No, I'm not a protestant.

Graham on 2011-10-20 at 17:24 said:

Charlotte I believe that's an emotional response to words you don't like. The Catholic point of view holds that the laity should not interpret Scripture for themselves; Scripture is intepreted by Catholic Tradition. Some members of the laity will possess qualifications, no doubt, but that isn't what's at issue when someone speaks against private interpretation.

Izak on 2011-10-20 at 17:31 said:

It's a moot point. The lowest order is the third estate, and they didn't interpret the word qua "The Word" because they were mostly illiterate and there was no means of mass circulation anyhow. The Catholic church provided images within the church buildings that illustrated the stories, so even the lowest order of all still had to do some degree of interpreting, or "glossing" of the images with which they were provided — and if you go into the ways allegory would be used in story-telling, they still had to do some leg-work there as well. The third estate was challenged intellectually in its religious interpretation, but in a way that suited it better.

But the fact of the matter is that a huge chunk of Protestantism was coming from the fact that the third estate, particularly the mercantile branch, was rising up, the printing press was a new invention, and materialism was beginning to pervade the West. I think Oswald Spengler put it best: while it is true that Protestantism did alleviate the peasant classes from the abuses coming from church authorities (and they were very real), it also put a great deal of weight on their shoulders by setting a mostly unattainable intellectual standard for them to pursue — most of it dealing with literacy and interpretation. No traditionalist would claim that the word of God should be presented equally to each estate or caste; it's a modern and quasi-democratic idea.

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-10-21 at 06:03 said:

Graham, no that wasn't an emotional response although I accept it may have come across in that way. I DO have emotional responses on a regular basis but that doesn't prevent me from rational thinking, I was expressing an actual viewpoint on what Izak rightly describes as an endlessly moot point. Catholic scripture is interpreted by catholic tradition, but the point I made about the 'ones in charge', still stands. I personally won't attend any church unless I can doubtlessly trust the priest in terms of sincerity, spiritual integrity and also general intelligence. In other words, unless I can truly accept that they ARE of a higher order. (this does happen of course, but not always). Given a choice I would normally choose to attend a Catholic church as I do in fact believe the catholic church is custodian in no small degree of the Christian ministry. Just to clarify my position, I was converted to Christianity by a Benedictine, I've visited the

Vatican twice, own a picture of the Pope and numerous icons of the blessed Virgin and was present at the angelic prayers offered upon the death of John Paul II. No fear of truth here...

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-10-21 at 06:14 said:

izak, thank you for the further explanation, as it happens I'm kind of in agreement with you and think very valid points are made. Perhaps after all there is some emotion in the response, as Graham suggested, but not to the point of irrationality. I'm frustrated at the deliberate mis-education of people – the deliberate dumbing down of society – that is being perpetrated in the world right now. However, at this point in time the church – Catholic or otherwise – certainly is NOT the culprit, it's very much a political problem. In the past the church was in control of this situation but that's not the case anymore – not in most of the western world at any rate. Where the catholic church was at fault in the past (in my view), is where they manipulated the Word in a way that suited political agendas, and used it to instill fear rather than love of God and Truth. There's no point denying this happened as people were forcibly converted – NOT the way Christ intended. In some cases however I agree that it is much better to withold information than to let people abuse it – by suppressing grimoires, for instance, but the Word of God is for us all, a small child can understand it perfectly. What happened during the Reformation was a necessary evil in response to sale of indulgences and so on – we all know what the Medicis and Borgias did, it can't just be accepted as having been acceptable, SOMETHING had to happen to stop it. As with so much of history the pendulum has swung back and forth violently as humanity has struggled to find its balance, but sooner or later it will happen and I do believe that the church is rising to the occasion right now. I just wish there was more stringent criticism of the violent imperial policies of the US, UK, France, etc. What I'm curious about at the moment is what conclusions the Vatican will publically draw on the matter of extra-terrestrial life – I believe they've been discussing the problem with NASA in the past couple of months?

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-10-21 at 06:28 said:

by the way, I would really appreciate some discussion of and insight into what happened during the Vatican II council as the questions to have arisen from this present me with a big stumbling block. If this isn't the right place then perhaps someone knows of where it's being discussed? I've looked into what Malachi Martin has to say as he appears to be very close to the source, what are your thoughts on him?

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-10-21 at 06:42 said:

Also (sorry, on a roll now), we shouldn't be afraid to express emotion in relation to a religion that is founded on Love, though certainly you're right in saying that we shouldn't let passion cloud judgement – the problems of the world make that clear enough. I like the assessment made my Khalil Gibran in the Prophet:

"Your reason and your passion are the rudder and sails of your seafaring soul. If either

your sails or your rudder be broken, you can but toss and drift, or else be held at a standstill in mid-seas.

"For reason, ruling alone, is a force confining; and passion, unattended, is a flame that burns to its own destruction.

"Therefore let your soul exalt your reason to the height of passion, that it may sing. And let it direct your passion with reason, that your passion may live through its own daily resurrection, and like the phoenix rise above its own ashes."

This is probably why your guys considered turning to Islam – the way of Beauty is more than compelling – but it's not incompatible with Christianity, there shouldn't be a conflict or dilemma. Moon and Sun, both with one Father and a sole creation.

Cologero on 2011-10-21 at 08:29 said:

Hola, Charlotte.

Gornahoor follows Tradition and is opposed to the alleged progressivism of the modern world. Vatican II, with its *aggiornamento* was a deliberate opening up to the modern world. So there is no debate possible between Tradition and Vatican II because the spiritual world views are so incompatible. There are many sites and forums opposed to V II, though, of course, the majority are in favour. Here is one example of the former: *Maurice Pinay*[5], and I can provide more if you want.

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-10-21 at 13:22 said:

Hola C!

Thank you for clarifying that, it confirms what I suspected, which is the depth of the breach. I'm not surprised, it is a big problem and as you know I share the concern... .the horror. That said, my attention has been called, by way of reminder, to the spiritual mission of JPII, who it seems descended into hell in order to perform certain tasks of atonement on behalf of the church. We can make of that what we will. Personally speaking I struggle with it all and have to accept there is an impasse. I turn up at my local Church and instead of going inside to join with the service, I sit in the garden and pray with the statue of our Lady, or wipe cobwebs from the crucified Christ. At Easter I took mass there and spent months feeling as if my Spirit might have been manacled into flesh and that the fairies had all died. Every cell in the human body is renewed in around 6 months. I noted on the next visit that they were keeping the wine in the middle of the church, up front so to speak, and took some heart – it seemed sweeter than before.

Hoo – Lord of Hosts, yes, but remember that the Christian community is a spiritual one and that the left hand doesn't know what the right is doing. It may not always be readily apparent

[5] https://mauricepinay.blogspot.com/

who's been so appointed and it should be well known to us all that angels can be entertained unawares.

Other than that, do you not agree with Origen's view of universal salvation?

As for caste, we must take care not to equate it with material wealth and be aware that powerful veins can be filled with black dragon blood.

We should have a think about the Dead Sea Scrolls some day, I heard they were owned by the Rockefellers, but it could be another one of those stories eh?

`Perennial on 2011-10-22 at 04:54 said:`

Charlotte, I have noted before elsewhere on here that many of the allegations of curruption in the Church in the past are either exaggerated or pure fantasy. Therefore, justifications against Her, like the protestant "reformation," are generally unjustified. The main example of the selling of indulgences, by the Dominican priest Johann Tezel, was a rare thing, certainly insufficient to start a reformation, which rebelled against both Church and Empire, as people often forget. Many practices, like the selling of indulgences, in fact, had already been condemned. The situation after Vatican II, however, is another matter. There is certainly much do be discussed there, even if Gornahoor is not the place to do it. Perhaps Vatican II and it's fruits will be mentioned on the Right Hand Path blog at some point.

`Cologero on 2011-10-22 at 09:29 said:`

Vatican II has been discussed ad nauseum and those committed to it are adamant. Nevertheless, a return to the *status quo ante* is insufficient ... a better discussion, I think, would be about what would have to happen at Vatican III to bring it into alignment with Tradition.

`Logres on 2011-10-22 at 11:21 said:`

I would love to rejoin the Catholic Church, except, I have no idea what I would be joining, and whether it would be out of the frying pan, and into the fire. The potential for a bad pope to show up and basically make VII irreversible is enormous (from my perspective), while what seems more likely is a slow and incremental giving way to modern pressure. But that's admittedly an outsider-perspective.

`Charlotte Cowell on 2011-10-22 at 14:51 said:`

what do you folks think about the catholic prophecy relating to the names and number of popes, which would indicate that the present Pope Benedict is either the last or penultimate?

To perennial, I agree sensationalism is unhelpful and that truth is often veiled by the reporting of history, but in the present context it's unhelpful to be in denial. The Church is, I believe, ready and willing to atone for its sins, and would make more progress if all her members

could admit the faults made. The Lord is merciful, the church has to truth in Him as much as any of us must in contemplating our personal salvation.

As for bringing it into line with tradition, how do you think this idea might relate to the 'magical circle' being transformed into a mystical spiral?

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-10-22 at 14:52 said:

trust in Him, I meant. To adopt the stance that 'we' (ie, the church) have been without sin while all others gathered spots and stains without end is unreasonable (and untrue)

HOO on 2011-10-22 at 15:05 said:

Vatican III: The Return of the Jedi!

Cologero on 2011-10-22 at 16:57 said:

Something like that. To be more precise, the return of the Mage. I'm thinking of a type of Aghori, although in a higher direction, yet still in revolt against the modern world. For example, *Antisocial Behaviour*[6], or some may prefer the Druid point of view: *Lesson in Practical Magic*[7].

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-10-22 at 17:20 said:

Return of the Jedi/Mage – I like the sound of that, it would be most welcome!

Perennial on 2011-10-23 at 02:43 said:

Charlotte, If by denial you mean to say I am using history to deny fantasy, then yes, yes I am. I am not even a member of the Roman Catholic Church, so I have no stake in it's defense. However, I do not abide by pseudo-histories masquerading as fact. The fact that you defend the possibility of such troubles me. It is the teaching of the Roman Church that the Church is a perfect society constituted by God (Immortale Dei, Pope Leo XIII) and therefore cannot sin. A collective, in fact, cannot sin. Otherwise, we should expect you to apologize for slavery and the Boer War. The Church therefore has nothing to atone for. I do not see other religious groups "atoning" for anything, except for the odd apology of the Amish regarding the Holocaust, nor should they. One should not apologize for things one did not do nor on behalf people. I disagree with this line of reasoning. I cannot apologize for your actions anymore then you can apologize for mine. Certainly, we must trust in His grace, but that is only by committing to positive action. Believing the Church has some backlogue of apologies elicites only sentimentality, and little more. In addition, these non-crimes the Church must "atone" for only help the enemies of Tradition, and

[6] http://www.meditationsonthetarot.com/antisocial-behaviour

[7] https://thearchdruidreport.blogspot.com/2011/10/lesson-in-practical-magic.html

therefore are even less worthy of discussion. Although I know your heart means well, Charlotte, I take strong, strong difference with the position you are taking, which was indentical to Paul VI and John Paul II. It is not the direction the Church should take in order to make that positive step forward.

> Perennial on 2011-10-23 at 02:47 said:
> Cologero, perhaps what we need is a return to innocence.

> Charlotte Cowell on 2011-10-23 at 07:04 said:
> well I do apologise for slavery and the Boer War and every other evil perpetrated by mankind... .aren't we supposed to pray for each other as well as ourselves? The collective power of prayer, as you know, is immeasurably strong if properly focused. And as for other religious groups (especially Christian), again and again on here it's pointed out that they're less perfect than the catholic church, so what more can we expect? But if the catholic church is true custodian of God's word on Earth, then the bar is set pretty high. Christ committed no sins whatsoever yet not only did he pray for us, he died for us. The church is charged with using Him as Her model for behaviour. Having said all that, I do take your point, which is that you believe the catholic church has done very little wrong in the past. the trouble as far as the world is concerned (which in this context is the salient point) is that this is a matter of opinion and very many people are enraged by what they perceive as wrongdoings (mostly past) on the part of the church. I don't think lambs should be thrown to mad dogs or pearls after swine, but there is a lot to be said for always standing on the moral high ground. (Actually I think Benedict is trying to reclaim this).

Your next comment interests me – actually it gives me hope, although I doubt this was your intention – with respect to Paul VI and John Paul II. I presume this is because they were 'modernisers'? (If not, then apologies if I now shoot off on the wrong track). As I've mentioned here before, I've experienced a terrible crisis of faith (in a catholic sense, which is the faith I was 'converted' into) as I learned about the changes made amid great resistance to the Church in the 60s. I don't ask you to plough through it all again here as I know you've 'done it to death', but suffice it to say that the melting pot of worms opened up by this controversy leads into pretty much every black conspiracy known to mankind – actual or imaginary – the real heart of darkness in our world. I used to be of a very nervous disposition and when I discovered the extent to which John Paul II – who I literally adored without reservation – was considered an antipope almost on a par with anti-Christ by some, it definitely gave me the fear. Not at first, but later in the 90s following all the child abuse allegations. I've no idea why they changed the mass, it can only seem like a bad idea and I don't understand it.

On the other hand, I thought of this last night with respect to the literal interpretation of universalism and the embracing of all other faiths that JPII in particular was (in)famous for. Firstly I will say that he managed to reach me at this point in time – I was (to all practical

intents and purposes) a pagan witch, although I drew the line at robes and pentacles because I certainly didn't have the patience for ceremonial at 18. So there you have one of the positive consequences of casting the net so widely, although it also should be said that he did not accomplish this alone, but via an 'outreach' worker – a Benedictine novice monk. This latter was far more instrumental than the former in my conversion, but nonetheless it occurred during JPII's ministry and I don't tend to see accidents in such things, I see a wondrous design. (Although there CAN be accidents, I realise).

Now, however, the world is faced with a spiritual problem of monumental dimensions as we move towards the next phase of human evolution. Which branch of the Y will we – as a race – choose: the left-hand path to grey oblivion on dead planets surrounded by gadgets, a race divided neatly into a mass of morons governed by ammoral elites, or the right road to the golden age that we all know is possible. There waiting for us in fact?

Well, we all know what we want and why, but how to achieve this. We're in a situation where there haven't just been wars on earth there have been terrible wars in heaven. The Holy of Holies has been desecrated, the House of God has been stormed by legions of Satan, and everyone on earth has been required to take a stand on one side or another, consciously or otherwise. What act of divine magic do you think is required of the hopeful citizens of New Jerusalem, followers of Michael? For many it is a matter of a passive end to wrong doing and total embracing of what's good and right. (This stands true for all of us as humans).

But do you think initiates, priests and warriors in God's army get off so lightly; to what end are magical powers to be directed? Who amongst us will take on the dark and bloodthirsty form of Quetzalcoatl so the plumed serpent settles on the right side? Who will observe that one of the world's largest and most powerful group of initiates (Tibetan Buddhists) is utterly divided (certainly astrally and etherically since WWII) into workers of light and those who've been converted to the dark side, and take steps to bring round the renegades? Who will take a compassionate stance before the followers of Hoodoo – reduced to the status of animals by neighbours and foreigners alike – in order to harness to great effect the magical elementals currently screaming in agony as 'Orthodox Christians' set the world on fire?

What does an alchemist do but take dark materials and transform them into spiritual gold? If the human race is to evolve as it should, towards a higher spiritual plane, the alchemical work must go into overdrive without reservation. This is a fact or everyone will sink into polluted Earth where freedom is nothing more than a memory. It may not even be a memory because the majority of people will be so utterly brainwashed that the collective unconscious will be shrouded forever by chemical clouds. This is why the church and all its children must be unified, no matter what's gone on in the past – it's a test of the powers of forgiveness, but we're all aware that in fact at the end of it all, after seemingly endless trials and lessons learned on the pillar of severity, genuine atonement brings us over to the side of mercy. In this respect I care much less who and what I'm apologising for, because I'm completley and utterly focused on the

transformation. Many Christians believe that the promised land won't come until each and every individual is ready for it, so it's a practical (not even altruistic) matter of hurrying things along as quickly as possible so we can all be bathed in eternal love and light once again!

But I don't know why they changed the mass, I'm working on that one. As for whether other religions also need rise to the occasion, unequivocally yes. I'd be more than happy to stand in front of the chief Rabbi of Jerusalem and say 'It's about time' – I've done it plenty of times and you know what, plenty of the devout Jews I spoke to about this were in total agreement that the chosen people need to share their truth and lead the world in the way they should, which is spiritual. As for the Muslims, the poor Sufis and other purely spiritual sects are having a rough time of it, something needs to make them get their acts together. If only handing over Jerusalem would make them see it might be worth it, but I fear that wouldn't be the case without divine intervention.

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-10-23 at 07:17 said:

Perennial, I hate to wave a new age flag right at you but there IS this with respect to Innocence:

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UYOVbUygRls

and this :-)

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NTozCB3cueA&feature=related

Perennial on 2011-10-24 at 01:08 said:

Actually, Charlotte, this is the video I was referring too! How did you know? :-) I think the lyrics say it all, do they not?

Perennial on 2011-10-24 at 01:35 said:

The Return to Innocence one, of course.

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-10-24 at 11:07 said:

Perennial, I am an unabashed lover of Enigma, I think most of their lyrics say it all – re the 'Stargate', try Morphing Thru Time, it works wonders!

I first heard their music during the Trinity term of my second year at university (1996). It was early morning and I was with my Benedictine friend, who was extremely musical and in fact helped me to 'hear' (rather than just feel) music for the first time. Hear the words that is.

Anyways, after being in silence for quite some time, out of the blue I asked him... .'Where do we come from?' (the question emerged out of nowhere). Then lo and behold, a second later, 'We came out from the deep... .' resounded in full stereo by way of response.

I've loved Enigma ever since – New Age or no, I do think their music is magical!

Sparrow on 2015-11-09 at 06:54 said:

It appears that there are many White Nationalists who follow Gobineau's line of thinking that caste equals biological race. I've never understood how they explain the fact there exists homogeneous Traditional civilizations around the world who have had racially pure (from a biological perspective) lower castes such as Britain and Japan.

Their worldview essentially means that caste means nothing. A shudra who is born with fair hair can become a kshatriya because of biology. The Nazis embodied this philosophy by emphasizing the purity of the peasants.

3.11 The Future Order of Nations

In the September, 1941 issue of *La Vita Italiana*, **Julius Evola** wrote a review of Das Reich der Völker by the German political theorist, **Hans Keller**. The first part of Evola's essay is a review of the book. In the second part, whose translation appears below (*ff*), Evola provides his own conception of the role of the Volk. Clearly, Evola cannot support Keller's naturalism nor the role of the Volk as the vanguard or the base for the political organization.

In the Traditional perspective, the Volk is lunar or passive and therefore has to rely on a spiritual and political hierarchy for its full development. Thus Evola must needs oppose any sort of nationalism on the basis of an ethnicity or a race. In rejecting that sort of neo-Nordicism, Evola will lead us back to the ideal of Romanity.

Part I *In primis et ante omnia* we cannot adhere to the mythology of the *Volk*, of the "people nation", so dear to Keller, who makes them the base of his juridical edifice. Mussolini once spoke ironically of the "mysterious entity that calls itself the people". "People", be it only as "Volk", is a simple myth that always and inevitably sounds like demagogy: of the type which is accompanied by intense polemical applications to disvalue and degrade the significance of everything that is the State, the formative

political force from above. Keller stands on the most naïve optimistic natural law: he believes that the people exist as a very precise entity, equipped with its own consciousness, its own will, determined by "eternal laws" superior to all political forms in which they are concretized, a depositary of determinate values. We can only speak of similar things to some naïve types for whom, today, the natural meaning of nationality (quite different from every "nationalism" and deprived of a "political" character) becames something extremely tenuous in the face of becoming the "mass" of the people and the advent of a civilization no longer based on truly traditional values. Hegel said, "the people is that part of the State that does not know what it wills". That is precise. Our fascist idea is that the people, the nation, exists only as the State, in the State, and in a certain measure, only through the work of the State.

But our State is not the end of Keller's artificial antitheses: it is not a juridical superstructure, a mere fact of "power", an external power without basis. Our State is ethical and spiritual. It has the value of an *entelechy*, i.e., of a formative force on the nation and the "people", who otherwise would remain a diffuse and unformed reality, vegetating on a naturalistic plane of life, without any metaphysical, ethical, or truly heroic tension.

Our point of view is detached both from the idea of natural law and the collectivizing of the people, as well as the abstract, juridical and rationalistic of the State. We are realists. We do not believe in the "people", instead we believe in a guiding, formative elite and, wherever it happens, leaders of the people. Keller has in mind the State only as *caput mortuum*, i.e., as that which became in some cases, when the political structure created by leaders and elites personifying living traditions depersonalized themselves, objectified themselves, created an excuse to justify themselves, giving to understand the existence of public autonomous powers and of neutral juridical forms or norms to order to obtain in that way recognition to which the direct affirmation and the prominent prestige by the high stature of the Leaders and by superior princes was not enough.

To reach the same goal, i.e., to hold it without exhibiting it, along other directions, therefore, it is joined to the creation of a myth opposite in appearance to that of the neutral "State", but in reality answering to the same end: the myth of the "people". Keller lets himself avoid the admission that the idea of the Volk was "discovered" in 1933. Even if the date is not for us so recent, having some precise antecedents especially in democratic nationalism and French Jacobinism, (in fact even in France, as the antitheses to an excess of *statism*, determined by the centralizing, absolutistic, and anti-aristocratic work followed by the kings up to Philip the Fair, it left, for the first time, the mystique of the nation, of the people as source of every law, not putting up with any authority from above)—even, therefore, if the Volk was not even discovered in 1933, only it stands in fact that the mythology referring to it is new, it was unknown by preceding civilizations and there came to life for precise political and propagandistic reasons: the "people" and *Volk*, far from being notions having, today, a real content, are two idea-forces, two myths taken up by a power to affirm a given political system, determined by circumstances, to capture and organize the forces—in themselves directionless and apt to follow very different suggestions—of the true people and to strengthen therefore a given type of political authority. For the less important socializing tendencies, it was not necessary to us in Italy to have recourse to this myth: to us the spiritual idea of the State, and moreover, the direct authority that proceeds from a Duce and from a Monarch were a sufficient base to lead to the same result.

Keller says that all the differences between *statute* law and law based on the idea of Volk lie in the judgment on human nature: in the first case, as in every idea of Reich and Imperium of Roman Catholic origin, it is pessimistic and does not have faith in human nature, while in the second case it has. But what is this "human nature"? We are not pessimists, but realists. We believe in human nature, but not of everyone, less than ever in the collectivity as the mass, whose psychology we know well. Instead,

we believe in that of the minority who create the States, who animate the peoples, who lead the collectivities to the heights which they could never reach alone. Neither statism, therefore, nor natural law, but the aristocratic hierarchical ideal, without the charade that is necessary only to demagogues and weak natures. That is what we mean by Roman and Aryan realism.

Keller says: "to the Romanesque people, only the State is important, even if they serve nationalistic motives in addition."

We say that we can even renounce the additive motives; we value the Mussolinian idea, according to which the people is something weak and blind, before they came to constitute a reality and a unitary will, compenetrated by higher meanings with the birth of the State. But we are not statists, because we do not make an idol of the State, as Keller and certain German jurists make of the Volk: because behind the State, in our view, there is somebody, there are Leaders, Monarchs—if you want, there is a "superrace", in which alone "nation", "people", "race", "tradition" cease to be abstractions. Every great "people" is always comprised of various influences, various racial elements, various traditions. It is the work of the elites to choose, to affirm, from among them all, a given element, to subordinate every other to it, leading back in that way to a precise order which otherwise would have remained heterogeneous and arrested in the form of a confused potentiality.

Part II

As Evola continues his analysis of the German legal scholar Hans Keller, we see recognizable themes. In particular, Keller comes surprisingly close to the New Right idea of Ethnopluralism. In Klemmer's scheme, each people is free to define themselves, to realize themselves, and live independently of each in their own enclaves. So, the "New Right" is not so new after all, as it merely resurrects stillborn ideas from the past. Evola rejects

this conception on several grounds.

The first and most obvious is Keller's naturalistic starting point. Evola points out that for every Aryan civilization, the authority of their law was based on its relationship to the supernatural, and the lawgivers themselves were considered "divine". So Klemmer, and by extension the New Right, have nothing at all to do with the self-understanding of the European peoples of the past. Keller regards such claims as fantasies and projections of earthly leaders onto an imaginary plane. Any rightist movement must be related to a transcendental tradition; the pseudo-tradition of neo-paganism would not qualify for reasons that will be made clear in Part III.

The second difficulty with Keller's thesis is the very problem of defining a "volk". Keller speaks of nations of destiny or becoming, without specifying their actual destiny or the goal of the becoming. As such, it is not very helpful. Furthermore, it implies that there will be nations in a lesser or greater state of becoming. Would the latter have to treat the former as minors and guide their development?

In common with similar ideas held by new right movements today, Keller blamed "inorganicity and leveling" on the preceding religious Regnum. This thesis, Evola rejects. Keller's ethnopluralism is itself deracinated, since it lacks any content, or principles, that a supernatural conception of the Regnum would provide. Relations between ethnocentric conclaves are *ad hoc*, relativistic and, contingent. In contrast, Evola envisions a suprantional Imperium, in which the superior power furnishes the structure to the others. This, he claims, is a real unity, opposed to the merely nominal unity defined by Keller.

The final objection is devastating. Keller sees a pacifistic union of separate peoples, each according to its nature. But Evola asks the question, "what if the nature of a people is to be a warrior race?" This, Evola claims, is an essential part of Indo-European

> civilizations. This will blow up the ideal of peaceful ethnocentric enclaves, since one (or more) of them will seek to establish an Empire over the others; this is an essential feature and not a historically contingent event that may or may not occur.
>
> We see the Germanic nations to this day adopting most of Keller's conceptions. The sight of 40,000 Norwegians singing together for peace will not convince another people, whoever they may be, who are of a warrior nature, to leave them in that desired peace. Evola's text follows:

Keller believes in immanent laws of the people, given by "nature", respected and followed in themselves, not originating from any power from above or however personified: in any case, having nothing to do with a "beyond". This is a "faith" like any other. In reality, it would be difficult to adduce a single legal system of ancient peoples, the Aryans included, for whom the authority of the laws was not related to a "divine" origin from above, and was not considered to have been introduced by legislators themselves "divine". But we already know Keller's point of view: instead of understanding the order proper to an earthly and temporal *Imperium* as the reflection of a transcendent order and, from another point of view, the secularization of law and authority as purely spiritual in origin, he tends to see in every idea of a spiritual *Regnum* a type of fantastic projection of the fantastic image of an earthly reign. This stands, more or less, at the intellectual level of Euhemerism[8].

On the other hand, Keller finds it particularly difficult to define the concept of *Volk*. In certain cases, it seems that he values the national socialist conception of it as the criterion and measure, corresponding to the formula *Volksgemeinschaft*. Where he says that the "community of nations", the hoped for supranational order, will not be able to be realized until all the peoples have been realized according to the Nazi totalitarian

[8] `http://www.etymonline.com/index.php?term=euhemerism`

social concept, expressed precisely by the formula mentioned. But on the other hand, he concedes:

> It is not important to see how the individual peoples conceive themselves, even if each one leaves the other free to form for themselves a given concept of their own essence and to live in conformity with it.

This is the conclusion of the analysis of the various ideas of the people, a conclusion that evidently leads to a full indifferentism and a pale norm of reciprocal tolerance on the international plane. The fact that Keller insufficiently acknowledges race to define the people; that he introduced the rather indeterminate concept of the "community of destiny" (this is a greatness that is defined depending on directions and many directions exist in the history of a great people); that, finally, he speaks of a "people in becoming", without being able to say exactly what will define the *terminus ad quem*, i.e., the definite form of such a becoming—all that goes to confirm the mythical and weak content of this conception of the *Volk*. The only coherent solution would be to assert dogmatically that nations as truly such do not exist before being "total nations" according to the national socialist formula of the *Volksgemeinschaft*.

Nevertheless, to assume this political form as a condition for the membership with full rights in the *orde nationum* is not, evidently, a falling short of the principle of respect of every "people", even to the point of judging them "as lesser peoples" and putting them almost under guardianship, even under a foreign State, when it has not reached such a form.

There is more. Keller, as we saw, blames the inorganicity and the leveling that would be typical of every Roman or religious conception of the *Regnum*, or *Reich* if one prefers, of the nations. Such an accusation is even turned against his own conception. In the logic of this, in fact, we don't encounter any obstacle to not end up in the utopian vision of an

order that takes up all the peoples of the earth. And we don't encounter any obstacle through the fact that this order is rather more abstract and deprived of content of that of the now defunct League of Nations. In it, would be a question of only taking care of the laws of each people, of teaching them, of maintaining peace and the balance of power—in summary, a type of administrative function that does not presuppose any specific vision of the world, no higher point of reference. But, in its turn, the particularistic conception, relativistic, and collectivistic of the Volk, is the cause of that. If the authority of higher values is not recognized, it is evident that among the various "national" unities, only extrinsic relations, "gravitations" and "equilibria" will be able to exist, which do not involve, at its foundation, anything essential. In every way for us, such an *ordo nationum* as universal order is absurd and undesirable: we conceive of the concrete, differentiated, supranational unity, decentered in a well-defined vision of the world and in well-defined values that give the tone and the internal unity to a given "imperial space". The superior civilization of a dominating race must furnish the reference point to a succession of political ethnic minors, in order that these, rising up from simply national values, and integrating such values, they find in them the basis to understand and to feel united to each other: to actually unite, and not in the style of an indifferent tolerance of belonging to the same club.

Therefore, these supranational unities, that will put a stop to the period of particularistic, schismatic, anti-European, as well as differentiated nationalism, will be able to even be combative. We see that Keller acknowledges war, but without recognizing in it any specific value, in the same way that he eventually acknowledges the State, in a transitional phase, as an instrument and pedagogue that may help tie "people" to realize themselves, finally, in a "total" form. The general intonation of his view remains pacifistic. Wherever he uses the word "power", *Macht*, Keller thinks only of oppression, tyranny, violence, distortion of the people. He

barely remembers Moltke's phrase: "universal peace is only a dream, and not even a beautiful dream."

Nevertheless, since every people, according to him, should be respected according to their own inclinations, we can certainly think that there exist peoples of a warrior race and calling—we noted everything that was said, starting from Klemm and D'Eichtal, about the typological distinction of "active races" and "passive races", "conquering races" and slave races", etc. Keller, it is true, on the other hand, refers to research on savage tribes, where he would demonstrate natural inclinations to reciprocal respect and peace, for the purpose of challenging the idea that the natural state is the war of all against all. But much more documentation would be necessary to show such a thesis, against which, all the great Aryan history already remains: it is true, not a history of eternal war and for war itself, but history, nevertheless, which is consistent with virile and dominating natures, capable of realizing superior values in battle— superior, often, to all that can come from a climate of peace of naturalistic harmony. Among the rights recognized by Keller for the people, he acknowledges the right to "their own development": it would therefore behoove us to ask why this development must be limited to the bourgeois domain of "culture and economy", with the exclusion of everything that refers to the "power" factor, where the natural inclination of such people was exactly that of the warrior and heroic type. We think instead that the heroic and warrior elements are of particular importance even as the common basis of an "imperial space", i.e., of a concrete and well-articulated order between a given group of nations.

Part III

> The organization of a block of the type like the European, Aryan, and Roman block is the only concrete task of our future and the only object of a serious consideration in regards to a new law and a new ordering of the people.

Julius Evola

In this final installment of the essay, please note these points.

- Evola declares that Tradition is Roman, it forms a union with preceding traditions, with the Hyperborean tradition as its beginning.
- The Volk is a modern invention, opposed to Tradition. Its roots are found in Rousseau and the French Revolution.
- The life and traditions of early Germanic tribes is poorly documented, relying mostly on some comments of Tacitus, and the Eddas, which were preserved much later by post-pagans.
- However, since the Germans were Aryans, we can surmise about them, based on what we know of other Aryan civilizations. The Roman tradition, particularly that of the Middle Ages, is much more fully documented. Hence, that is where we put our focus.
- The State organizes the people and relates them to spiritual reality. However, this is not a superstructure whose purpose is only to aggrandize its leaders and oppress the masses, as some in the New Right believe.
- This orientation to transcendent values is a feature not only of the Christian Middle Ages, but also the authentic pagan traditions.
- Some civilizations may expand, creating a supranational organization. But this is not merely an administrative function, hegemony, or acting as the "world police". Rather, it is to spread its vision of a spiritual, transcendental reality. Blocks of nations will arise, united by common transcendental values.

Finding it necessary, therefore, to draw a conclusion, only what refers to the polemic against an abstract juridical internationalistic normativism[9] is acceptable in Keller's ideas, after all, up to this point that is what the idea of State has assumed in certain cases in the modern world, in full settlement and against depersonalized "neutral" forms, deprived of a substrate of quality and true strength. The points of positive reference invoked by Keller against what are nevertheless as problematic as ever, and hardly acceptable from the point of view of a tradition, that we without difficulty declare to be Roman, in order to immediately add that it in its Romanity forms a unity with the traditions characteristic of every great past civilization, with that of ancient Aryanity at the head. In fact, as we said, this mythology of the *Volk*, of the people-nation as absolute source of every authority, is only a modern invention, that arose in Germany recently and that in Germany itself it now seems somewhat passé, through the same force of European events.

Keller's and other's efforts to relate it back to an ancient German tradition are artificial. We saw, as much, that Keller was constrained to condemn as non-German and "Romanizing" the very tradition of the Prussian State and to extend an analogy, he blamed the Medieval Empire. Perhaps he will be able to support himself on such a view of the primitive Germans. But such views interest us very little, because they cannot be authoritative: The "primitive" Germans are in fact only some isolated, dispersed and involute stocks of the Great Aryan tree, and we have to judge and understand their traditions on the basis of that which, in a rather more complete, precise, and documented form, present to us the great Aryan civilizations of antiquity, including the Roman.

In such ancient traditions, there are so many "myths", but of a more elevated and real content than the modern myth of the "*Volk*", which, as we noted, was essentially given to traditional and dynastic Europe by French Jacobinism and has a strongly collectivistic and anti-hierarchical

[9] http://fr.wikipedia.org/wiki/Normativisme

flavor. According to our traditional point of view, the "nationalities" can exist but on a naturalistic plane, not yet political nor properly spiritual: in place of certain spontaneous forms of sensibility and of certain customs where, however, the primary element ends up being less the "nation" than the race. The centre and the indispensable condition of the nation as political and spiritual reality is instead the State. The State is not a mere fact of "power" or a type of abstract juridical superstructure, but an ethical and spiritual reality and a formative and discriminatory force. This force, in its turn, is connected both to an elite, to a race of leaders and to the prestige proper to them, both to transcendent, to a certain extent, values (which are not necessarily only those of the Christian religion: ancient Iran, ancient Rome, etc., teach it) that legitimate them, because there is true authority only as authority from above.

The formative power of such principles, after having unified and animated a "people", can be projected beyond its borders and, in different ways, does not exclude those of war, can give rise to higher unities, i.e., supranational, but nevertheless well defined, and ordered by a determinate law: they are the "imperial spaces". The "rank" that goes to assure to a given nation the supranational directive function cannot be measured in materialist, administrative, bourgeois pacifist terms, and as quasi-police for collective security and peace. On the contrary, it is adherence to already noted transcendental values and to the corresponding faculty of animating, transporting, making capable of energy and commitment, capable even of confronting tragedy and misfortune, which is the sign of such a superiority. The logic of the system does not then lead to its extension to every nation of the world, but to its limitations and particular zones, as blocks of nations, blocks united by the same chain of an "Order", capable, where it occurs, of the same heroic unanimity of a "crusade".

Leaving aside both universalistic and nationalistic myths, *the organization of a block of the type like the European, Aryan, and Roman block is the only concrete task of our future and the only object of a serious consider-*

ation in regards to a new law and a new ordering of the people.

Posted on 2012-04-24 by Aeneas

* * *

Cologero on 2012-04-26 at 08:50 said:

Evola makes clear the difference between volkisch movements an authentic Tradition. It is absurd to make the people, or the folk, the ultimate judge of anything. According to Evola, it is the elite, by which he apparently means the ruling elite, who speak for the masses and animate them.

We can agree with that, as far as it goes, but, following the Master Rene Guenon, we assert that there is a spiritual elite beyond the ruling elite. The latter's task is to cooperate in disseminating the spiritual vision to the mass, through its rule and positive law.

Evola accepts the Catholic pessimistic view of human nature, but only for the mass. He believes that the ruling elite are different, a position he calls "realism". We think instead it is naive. Perhaps somewhere, at some time, the elite had achieved the Primordial State, but certainly not in recent memory.

Dominion on 2012-05-03 at 17:04 said:

Reading this, I'm reminded of two things:

The first is the French Emperor Napoleon. He used his power to spread the values of Liberalism across Europe and attempt to create a new order among the nations, even a new aristocracy. Apparently there can be an antitraditional "Imperium" as well.

The second is the European Federation envisioned by Guillaume Faye, where "Evola is reconciled with Marinetti."

But how, I wonder, is it possible to begin to create such an order? Certainly, the neofascist terrorist attacks of the 1970's did nothing to further the Evolian vision of certain members of that movement. Moreover, any hint of decline in the current order leads people to believe that we are not following the principles of the order itself (Liberalism, democracy, etc) properly. There seems to be no real chance in the near future of a spiritual order in the line of this essay being able to rise. How would you see this happening, given the current climate?

Cologero on 2012-05-03 at 20:57 said:

Evola claimed that Freemasonry was able to reorganize itself (after the chaos of Revolution) during Napoleon's reign, eventually leading to the formation of a Masonic Republic in France. As we shall see, despite appearances, that was not a source of order. Faye's "visions" are of no

interest to us, as they are prone to change every few years. There is no reconciliation between truth and error; men are willing to make such distinctions.

How can order arise from disorder? That fantasy we leave to biologists and free market economists. Yet we have the answer to your question which was given by the writers of Tradition. Does anyone take it seriously?

Guenon says it must begin with an intellectual conversion, that is, the knowledge of principles. If an elite of those who have undergone a conversion can congeal, there is a possibility of change. Evola explains that every great Western civilization began with a divine revelation; that is pretty much the same as what Guenon claimed, only that it is publicly acknowledged. That is, the elite through their Power and Will, can shape and form the people.

Either that thought rings true to you, and it motivates you, or it does not. You will never "see" this happening, unless you are among those are "making" this happen.

`Graham on 2012-05-03 at 23:18 said:`

"That is, the elite through their Power and Will, can shape and form the people."

To prevent misunderstanding, it should be pointed out that the formal cause here is inspired. The elite aren't just making it up as they go along.

`Cologero on 2012-05-03 at 23:45 said:`

Thanks, Graham, for making that clear. It is an elite that is chosen from above, not those who manage to grab power. That is what distinguishes them from the likes of a Napoleon, as Dominion mentioned.

`Dominion on 2012-05-04 at 02:46 said:`

"How can order arise from disorder?"

Isn't the whole process of Initiation one from evolving from a disordered and finite ego to a True Will and Eternal Self? Perhaps I misunderstand, but that seems to be exactly what is being described. The answer would then be that the path from disorder to order is one of following the correct process and being guided by the proper laws and forces.

`Graham on 2012-05-04 at 11:13 said:`

Dominium, in saying that initiation is guided by "the proper laws and forces" you answered your own question, since he couldn't be guided by an order that didn't already exist in principle.

3.12 Coomaraswamy on Evola's Revolt

The first translation of any of **Julius Evola**'s works into English was published in the prestigious Indian journal The Visva-Bharati Quarterly (Vol. V, Part IV, New Series, 1940), founded by the Nobel prize winning writer and poet, **Rabindranath Tagore**. **Ananda K Coomaraswamy** AKC wrote a brief introduction, which follows below, and the translation of the chapter "Man and Woman" from Revolt against the Modern World was made by his wife, Luisa Runstein. A few of Evola's essays appeared in the British journal East and West in the 1950s, but the full translation of Revolt did not appear in English until 1995.

For obvious reasons, Evola's book could receive more understanding in India than in the West. The modern deracinated Westerner is ignorant of his own past. Hence he can discern nothing recognizable in Evola's "remarkable presentation and exposition of Traditional doctrine" (AKC), which was characteristic not only of Indian civilization, but also of ancient Rome and the Middle Ages. Instead, he remains smug in the "pretenses" of the modern world.

AKC did point out a serious error due to Evola's misunderstanding of a text from the Aitareya Brahmana (VIII, 27, Page 341 of Arthur Keith's translation). In a Hindu wedding ceremony, the groom says to his bride:

> I am that, you are this, this you are, that I am; I am sky, you are earth.

When the King chooses his Purohita, i.e., the priest who offered sacrifices for the king since the gods would not accept those of the king directly, the purohita recites the groom's part to the king. Hence, in this regard, the priest is masculine in respect to the king. Evola assumed just the opposite, which led to the unfortunate characterization of the priesthood as lunar and regality as solar. Although this quotation was removed from subsequent editions of Revolt, this error persisted in Evola, even if inconsistently and ambiguously. This is AKC's note on that topic:

> We refer in particular to the citation of the conjugal *rajnah purohita-varana-mantram* with which the priest takes the king as consort, saying, "I am sky, you are earth". Evola, inverting the roles of the king and priest, does so in a way that it was with these words that the king directed to the selected priest and consequently that the priest was to obey the king! The true relations were recognized by the first Sanskrit scholars (Oldenberg, for example), by Guenon in Spiritual Authority and Temporal Power, by Hocart in The Castes and were recently discussed in a very recent article on the various aspects of Hindu regality (Spiritual Authority and Temporal Power in the Indian Theory of Government, 1942).

AKC's introduction to the translation follows.

> Revolt against the Modern World, which contains the chapter titled "Man and Woman", whose translation follows, constitutes perhaps the most significant among the numerous works of the Italian philosopher Julius Evola. Evola's "Revolt" is, fundamentally, the affirmation of the universal metaphysical doctrine that has given form to traditional social institutions: thus this study treats social hierarchy ("caste"), the meaning of regality and empire, the relationship between the sexes, the mystery of rites, and from the same point of view interprets history and makes a destructive criticism of the pretenses of modern "civilization".
>
> The book is not without defects: in particular he exalts beyond measure the importance of regality in relation to the priesthood (Kshatriya in relation to Brahma, raja in relation to Brahman), even erroneously interpreting Hindu texts to support his theses on this point. In addition, of everything amiss in a work of this type, in which the "serenity" of the heroic element results so rightly emphasized, he clearly shows an anti-Semitic prejudice, as can be seen in the superfluous characterization of Freud as a Jew. Nevertheless, this book constitutes a remarkable presentation and exposition of Traditional doctrine and could well serve

> as an introductory text for the student of anthropology and as a guide for Indology, especially for anyone who is interested in Hindu mythology and does not understand that, in the words of Evola, "the passage from mythology to religion constitutes a humanist decadence."
>
> The chapter "Man and Woman" was chosen for translation because of its clear, uncompromising, and, we can add, dense peroration of the principles, that are reflected in the institutions and ideals, such as that of *sati*, that are no longer comprehensible and that certainly are no longer held dear, not even as memories by our politicians and reformers who, "whether by force or consent, were led to the accept the models of the West".

That last quotation is from Peaks and Lamas, by Marco Pallis. AKC also provided ten footnotes to the translation, all but one of which supported the text with references to relevant passages in Hindu texts. The exception addressed Evola's claim that absolute "dedication" in love is typical for the woman in relation to the man. Giovanni Monastra describes AKC's objection:

> That, according to Coomaraswamy, is true in the limits in which the husband constitutes for the wife the "symbol of God". But, under the traditional aspect, in his turn the man also in relation to Divinity assumes a "feminine" role, rendering love with total dedication, without entailing any degradation, something different from what Evola means. Not even man can, therefore, be considered self-centered: the "internal sufficiency" which is mentioned in Revolt is a relative fact, not to be absolutized.

Traditional Mentality

> We have touched upon only a very few of the "motifs" of folklore. The main point that we have wished to bring out is that the whole

> body of the motifs represent a consistent tissue of interrelated intellectual doctrines belonging to a **primordial wisdom** rather than to a primitive science; and that for this wisdom *it would be almost impossible to conceive a popular, or even in any common sense of the term, a human origin*.
>
> Ananda Coomaraswamy

On a related note, I call attention to Coomaraswamy's perhaps misleadingly titled essay Primitive Mentality[10]. This version is missing the images from the original and most of the footnotes. I did include the most interesting footnotes, marked off in boxes.

Note that AKC refers to Evola twice in support of traditional society; this is certainly not a description of some fascist totalitarian dictatorship. Nevertheless, the traditional society is held together with a common mythology that orders their entire lives. Yet, within this structure, the individuals are free. When myth becomes religion, that is, it is compartmentalized into one aspect of life among others, then the culture begins to die.

AKC brings up the idea of a "common mind", without which an organic society is impossible. For the Traditional mind, based on transcendental principles, the idea of individual opinions is preposterous. Only in modern liberal societies is that conceivable. It does not make men free, but creates a atomized group of individuals who consider relationships as "contracts", not as living organic things. This is how the "folk" become the "mass".

Posted on 2012-05-28 by Cologero

* * *

[10] `https://gornahoor.net/?page_id=4279`

Avery on 2012-05-28 at 19:44 said:

Excellent sleuthing here. Evola's writing on Japan is similar; he intuits the entire metaphysical structure of the traditional Japanese nation, and indeed I am laboring to get his work translated over here, but sometimes his readings of specific elements are mistaken for lack of cultural context. I at first thought of Evola as a writer who is "right even when he is wrong", but I now realize that he can be wrong sometimes and still successfully communicate a powerful idea.

David on 2012-05-28 at 21:50 said:

I read Evola's work extensivly, but never "about" him. This little text begs question then : where else did he misread or made errors ? Personnally, after reading him and myths (either Edda, Saint Graal, Gilgamesh, etc.) I seems to end to the same conclusion as he did : superiority of the Regal Divinity over both priest and warrior caste. Am I wronged ? If so, could someone tell me where to read something that would clarify all this ?

Sati Shankar on 2012-05-28 at 23:02 said:

The male and female, king and priest,and the warrior, there is a mutual,(if this term can be used) overlap,one emerges from the other without any superiority of the either,... 'the Priest is the King himself, who appoints the Priest(Purohita)... .,without any numerical ordering... the opposing relation between as denoted is a conventional one,'not chronological or real order of coming into being', Fro example,the Son creates the Father as much as the Father the son... 'there can be no paternity without a filiation and vice versa,and that is what is meant by the 'opposit relation'.The perspective of tradition has to emerge, as it does, from within which leads onto its whole.

Charlotte on 2012-05-30 at 13:23 said:

Wow, mysterious kitchen talk about the planetary spheres, that's impressive... .and there was I thinking it mainly centred on bread and circuses :-)

'Now a voice so fair, ascending,
Fills the air with love unending,
Rises on the silver moonbeams
Woven from Apollo's sun streams.
' "Bold Orion, Starman leaping,
How my heart for you is beating.
I have set you there so thy fame
Lights the path of this, the sky-train!"
'Next she calls with gentle words

The creatures of her wooded world,
Speaks to them with tender charm
To keep the slightest safe from harm.
‘ “Sweet you are as honey, bee.
Bear and Stag, come follow me.
Jump with me across the river.”
Seeks she souls with bow and quiver.
Then the Goddess steps up on it –
Disc of night, the lamp of dreamers –
As the steeds with hooves of onyx
Take to flight with sweet Selene.

FoaL on 2012-05-31 at 20:08 said:

The Hero donned his solar face,
Departed from his holy place,
Armed and ready for a magic battle,
To defend and exalt his sacred cattle.
The phalanx of warriors will he lead,
The Gods to determine who shall bleed,
Ten thousand men all decked for war,
Rich in spirit, in money poor.
The women cry and halt their men,
Sayeth fair Charlotte “We rather you remain in our love's den,”
“That leader of yours is too like Helios,”
“Aye”, affirmeth a wizened sage, “I've said so many a time; too serious!”
But the fathers scoff at this hesitation,
“This world is for us procrastination!,”
“Your priority is procreation,”
“We are concerned with a higher calling,”
“Our enemies to see a-falling!”
In bursteth a champion, his name was HOO,
“Wenches, save your chatter for the kitchen or the loo.”
“On the morrow we commence our tour,”
“You are my lovers, but my destiny is Gornahoor.”
By night the chariots pass the wall,
After a day of feasting at the town hall.
The women gather to make solemn sacrifice.

Noble sun appeareth, come morning,
Cold as ice.

Angolmois on 2012-06-01 at 04:50 said:

"What is this supposed to mean?"

That he scorched himself in the solar plexus. The Sun burns and kills as much as it illuminates and gives light and life. Solar heroes have transcended all this to a supra-personal plane and that is why they shine without burning.

Sati Shankar on 2012-06-17 at 00:37 said:

Friends, I hereby acknowledge all the participants of this thread that i will be referring to and using the information contained herein, in a Conference paper I am preparing. Due acknowledge will be cited in the paper also.

Regards,Sati Shankar

Michael M on 2021-05-29 at 10:00 said:

"AKC brings up the idea of a "common mind", without which an organic society is impossible. For the Traditional mind, based on transcendental principles, the idea of individual opinions is preposterous."

A common mind is indeed necessary for organic society. An interesting statement at first, I believe many would object to such a commonality between persons as somehow impinging on their individual freedoms. Again, this doesn't actually follow because the choice to be an idiot or evil while possible isn't precisely what someone wants for their lives as "free", especially when constructing or advocating for a society in which that "freedom" deters true freedom. Accepting wisdom isn't a punishment but a path to liberation and then all things flow from it, organically. Unfortunately, it does not appear we have hit "rock bottom" yet, accepting wisdom does indeed cause some pain especially in the beginning.

The idea of common mind has always struck a chord with the true essence of Catholic or what some thinkers were trying to put forward in Sobornost. Something common and universal to all that guides the people and gives boundaries to keep them together. The idea of such a common mind would be the representation of the sphere – a vertical axis of principles that which all horizontal living revolves around with its own set of rules and regulations. Politics don't exist, because the principles cannot be debated, simply debated is the way to make decisions. But maybe I'm just romantically imagining life as a modern Beguine and Beghard in the countryside.

While societies cannot go back to such a mythology, the task at hands seems to incorporate the levels of mind common to all traditional societies. I don't mean synthesizing across societies, I mean appropriate to each society as the roots present are necessary for development. While

the intellectual era of modernity has caused havoc, it is necessary to incorporate together. All functions of the human need to be acknowledged and then set to principles, I believe this is the task of the Christian, Christianizing all things with the Spirit. Maybe the virtue for the modern era is Chastity, which would be able to subdue the Lion (desires / consumption) and allow for Strength to come forth... Godspeed to everyone to convince others of such a virtue, let alone oneself.

3.13 The Modernity of Hobbes

Julius Evola's review of Carl Schmitt's monograph on Thomas Hobbes originally appeared in Lo Stato, January 1939. Together, they expose the mentality of the modern mind in the political realm. This article will appear in two parts. This part is Evola's review of Schmitt's essay. Given the length of this piece, and its depth, I will provide my own commentary at a later time. Its relevance to the failure of the "right" and "conservatism" to gain any traction in the modern world will become obvious.

According to **Carl Schmitt**, three thinkers, after a long period of ignorance of the meaning and value of their doctrine, due to the dominance of the rationalistic mentality in vogue up until recently, seem now ready for a new valuation. The first is **Vico**. The second is **Machiavelli**. The last is **Thomas Hobbes**.

We recognize today in Vico the precursor of a new historical method, the exploration of the world of origins and "myth", conceived as a fundamental element in the primordial life of nations. The period of new European political activism has liberated Machiavelli from unilateral and discredited widespread interpretations and recognized in him the adversary and overcomer of moralistic lies and political cant, the defender of the style proper to a "heroic realism". As for Hobbes, Carl Schmitt himself intended to rehabilitate and to clarify the true meaning of his political

doctrine in a very recent monograph titled *Der Leviathan in der Staatslehre des Thomas Hobbes* (1938), a monograph so rich with interesting and also urgent points, to merit a special examination.

The political doctrine of Hobbes, as is well-known, is centered in the symbol of the Leviathan, reminiscent of the Bible. It speaks of the Leviathan for the first time in chapters 40 and 41 of the *Book of Job*, where it is described as the most powerful and indomitable of the beasts of the sea. It is certain that, from this, his adversaries drew a precious inducement to jump on it, discrediting and maligning the Hobbesian doctrine, describing it as that in which the State becomes an omnipotent beast, a monster that devours and crushes everything. But in truth things, in respect to the Leviathan, are quite different.

Leaving aside, for the moment, the symbolic aspect, and limiting ourselves to the theoretic, in the Leviathan Hobbes sought to depict an almost mystical type of political totalitarianism, the State as a being that is simultaneously man and god, machine and beast, and that claims for itself the supreme authority and supreme law. Thus, as it is depicted in the cover of the original English edition of Hobbes' book, the Leviathan had none of the traits that could recall the biblical marine monster. It appears in it instead as a majestic human figure, crowned, holding the sword in his right hand and the staff in the left, i.e., the symbols of the double power, the temporal and religious. The union of these two powers is a fundamental point of Hobbes' doctrine. It would have been a single thing at its origins: essentially due to the Hebraic-Christian conceptions this unity would have been lost. It must be restored. The State, for Hobbes, must return to being a *deus mortalis* mortal god , something "transcendent". But already here the point that invalidates all of the Hobbesian doctrine is betrayed, and that had to cause the end of the same historical Leviathan: as Schmitt notes, Hobbes thought that the distinction of the two powers was foreign to pre-Christian conceptions, something, hitherto, correct: "since for him, religion was a part of the political", something incorrect.

The opposite is in fact true: the foundation of the totalitarianism exhibited by all the great traditional political unities was in the fact that the political was a part of the religion, and not vice versa. And it is not about a subtlety, but a fundamental divergence: as we will soon have to see.

According to Hobbes' political sociology, the originary state is the state of nature and specifically that of *homo homini lupus*[11] and *bellum omnium contra omnes*[12]. From the anxiety at this stage and the need for security, peace, and order, the State draws its origin and, in truth, in an almost contractual way. There is no doubt that, in this regard, Hobbes belongs already to the "modern world" and is in severed antitheses with the preceding, medieval conception. Schmitt makes this point clearly: "The sovereign is not the *defensor pacis* Defender of Peace[13] as a peace relating to God; he is the *creator pacis* creator of peace, only an earthly peace. The process is the inverse of the "divine right": since the power of the State is omnipotent, it assumes a divine character only for this reason. But its omnipotence has an origin totally other than divine: it is a human work and is actualized through a contract stipulated by men." Schmitt continues:

> The decisive element here is that such a contract does not reflect, as in the medieval conception, the reality of a collective entity created by God, a natural preexisting order: on the contrary, the State, that order and collective entity, is the result of the intellect and creative human power and comes to life only through the contract. This contract is conceived in a completely individualistic way. Individuals, as atomic entities, encounter each other in their anxiety, until the light of the intellect penetrates them, and then a "consensus" arises in terms of a general and unconditioned submission in the face of the supreme power.

[11] Man is wolf to his fellow man

[12] War of all against all

[13] `http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Defensor_pacis`

It is thus that in the armed and crowned figure of the Leviathan his body is represented as composed of an infinite multitude. We witness, here, an almost magical transformation (we will see that this attribute can assume in this the entirety of its significance): the absolute rises from the relative. Individuals conjure up the Leviathan, recognizing in it the only way for salvation, security, peace: but with that they conjure something transcendent, something that is greater than their sum and the individuality of each contracting party, something, in respect to which they, hypothetically speaking, no long have any power.

Hence, the image of the Leviathan as "machine": *machine magna, machine machinarum* machine of machines . For the mentality of Hobbes' time, still far from the technico-industrial era, the machine represented something mystical, not to say, magical: a human construction, it seemed nevertheless to possess its own life, expressing itself in its function. For which Hobbes' Leviathan appears as "machine" as well as God, man, and beast. Hobbes, as Schmitt points out, is the first to have systematically exposed the idea of the State conceived as a *magnum artificium* great artifice , created by men and technically perfect, as "a machine" having in itself, i.e., in its function, its "truth" and its "right". We reach, by that path, the Hobbesian formula expressing the extreme, but purely logical consequence of all this theory: *auctoritas, non veritas* authority, not the truth . It is the formula — it should be said, "exquisitely modern" — of irrationalism and political pragmatism.

Schmitt attempts, to tell the truth, a mitigation, saying that at the base of Hobbes' view is the fact the he "no longer poses any distinction between authority and truth, making the *summa auctoritas* highest authority from the *summa potestas* highest power ", where that formula would express only the norm of a way of technical and realistic thinking, neutral in regards to "values" and "truth", separating the metaphysical and religious notion of truth from the idea of command and political function, to confer on the latter a primary and undisputed autonomy.

But how then not to see that the Leviathan would become only the symbol of temporal hypostatized power and that each of his pretenses to rule not only the sword, but also the staff, to encompass in itself not only the fortress, but also the temple (that is also found in the figuration) would be usurpatory and the abuse of power?

In order to understand a theory, such as Hobbes', in its true significance, it must be considered not in itself, in the abstract, but in its operation in its historical "place". At the time in which Hobbes lived the crisis of the type of State we call "traditional" was more than visible and that the Middle Ages had known, to a certain extent. Here authority drew its absoluteness from the pretense of coming from above, of reflecting "truth" itself and putting in *fides* faith the fundamental cement of every political unity, it shaped this very unity to the elements of an essentially spiritual, and mediately religious, nature. In Hobbes' time the animating force for a State of such a type had already failed: its structure survived, i.e., a State that sill conserved the absoluteness and the pretense of the supreme authority, previously conferred on it from reference to principles of a super-political order: metaphysical or a least religious.

Leviathan is the attempt to save and preserve these surviving forms by grafting on them a new principle of life. In a situation in which there no longer existed men capable of reawakening in individuals the heroic capacity for obedience and recognition on the base of super-individual and super-material principles, we look for a new myth and a new foundation: the contractual one with the related theory of the "state of nature". They seek, i.e., to persuade individuals that the supreme authority can be accepted regardless of the "truth", for its intrinsic utility in regards to exigencies, now, of a materialist and anti-heroic nature, like those that are at the base of the needs for security, peace, and order on the plane of purely human and contingent reality. It is such that, while the Leviathan is presented as a "machine", i.e., only a human construction, and its body, its substance, appears now constituted by the mass, except that it conserves

some traits typical of the ancient traditional State; it claims for itself the unity of the two powers. The State is divine, although the "divine right of kings" is denied. Divine—"more than merely secular", according to the ancient English formula, *God's Lieutenant*—is for Hobbes the same sovereign, although his authority is now destitute of every foundation from above and the replacement by an acknowledgment on the part of individuals on the basis of reason and convenience. An amphibious form, therefore, and, in its depths, contradictory.

Can we prescind, in regards to the Leviathan, from this historical placement? And then what must we think about this ambiguity? What import has the very contractualistic myth have in it?

It is clear that, once the State is secularized, the Leviathan becomes a colossus with feet of clay. Its absoluteness can still linger for a certain period, by inertia. Through the conditions of its life, it then goes on to have a fatal distinction, reproducing fundamentally the distinction between the two powers that the Leviathan had tried to surpass. And the distinction between the modern external world, in which, for various reasons, by chance or other, the individual subordinates himself and recognizes the "divinity" of the State, and a type of inner forum, in which the individual feels himself free and inviolable. This distinction is announced already with the "*cuius regio, eius religio*" whose realm, his religion[14] of the Reformation, religion becomes thereby a politically conditioned fact; it was exacerbated in the period of Baroque absolutism, reached its critical stage with the so-called theory of the "positive" State or State "by right". But with this condition necessary to conserve its "neutrality" and its absoluteness independent of any "truth" whatsoever, the Leviathan began to dig its own grave. And what Schmitt himself thinks in the political realm, without however stressing that it is a question of the result of a fatal logic. He says,

[14] http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Cuius_regio,_eius_religio

> at the moment in which we admit the distinction between interiority and exteriority, the superiority of the former over the latter, therefore even that of the private sphere over the public sphere, it is already decisive. An external power, as far as integrally, specifically, and even loyally recognized as only a public and exterior power remains nevertheless something empty and dispirited. Such a terrestrial god has only the appearance, the *simulacra*, of divinity. There is nothing divine that can be imposed from the outside. *Non externa cogunt deos* Nothing divine lets itself be externally enforced.

In these words the essence of the process is understood that, by stages, has led to the individualistic, liberalistic, and rationalistic erosion of the true State. Having come this far, when even the State conserves leviathan-like traits of an absolute power, transcending the right and the strength of every individual, it is deprived of true autonomy, it becomes fatally an instrument of what Schmitt calls the "indirect power". Characteristic of such a power, according to Schmitt, is the distribution of the relations between political command and risk, between power and responsibility, between protection and obedience: it is a question of a masked, and absolutely indirect, act that gathers all the advantages of power without explaining to anyone the risks naturally inherent in it. We easily recognize, in this precision, the nature typical of the forces that had, and have, the real power in the "agnostic" States of an apparently democratic of liberal type. The State becomes in effect a neutral machine that obeys the game of the "indirect power" more strongly.

Such a type of State therefore came into crisis, and new political forms arose, characterized by an abrupt aversion for every form of "indirect power" (up to the anti-Masonic and anti-Semitic country of the "single party" State), by a new love for political totalitarianism, for pure authority. By way of these new forms, what must one think, as in a certain measure seems to be the idea of Schmitt, of a "currentness" or "modernity" of

Thomas Hobbes' political myth?

> After reviewing **Carl Schmitt**'s monograph, **Julius Evola** moves on to his own unique interpretation. At least, I am unaware of a similar interpretation. Rather than viewing Leviathan as the beginning of the modern political world, he sees it as the residue of the Traditional world, the remnant of a civilization that has lost its connection to transcendent principles and is left only with its forms of authority.
>
> Here, drawing from some ideas of **Donoso Cortes**, Evola sees the possibility of a recovery of Tradition from the stage of the Leviathan. Facing Europe in revolution, Donoso postulated the arrival of a "man on a white horse", a dictator who would restore order and tradition. Of course, Donoso had in mind a Catholic state, but that doesn't alter the essence of Evola's view.

After touching on all that, it is rather awkward to respond to a similar question: in particular, why, if we must respond in the affirmative, would it be necessary to see if the correspondence, in the end, is resolved in a valorization of Hobbes, or in grounds for suspicion of other aspects of the new political forms? This point merits a brief examination.

For that, it is necessary to state beforehand that the connection of the Leviathan with the myth of the contract must be considered absolutely inessential and contingent. Schmitt demonstrates a sensibility of everything particular when he states that when an author makes use of an image, like the Leviathan, he enters a domain where it is no longer a question of verbal formulas, dialectical abstractions, or mere "values", but instead they act and dominate forces and powers, thrones and agencies, which reminds us of these words from J. G. Hamann: "There is just one step from transcendental ideas to demonology". It is about something "elementary": the substance of the Leviathan is essentially irrational, and when individualistic and utilitarian motives can also serve, in a preliminary phase, to lead toward a similar form of State that, in its actualization,

calls to life something else, attests to an evocation, a really magical deed, no longer having anything to do with the rationality and the utility of individuals.

From a collective whole something transcendent can come to life, susceptible of manifestation in a center of pure irresistible power: power that, only as such, is truth and authority: the center the vortex. This is Leviathan.

We have already come to know this Leviathan as a phase of an involutive process: it is the survival of the ancient traditional State, whose absoluteness moved from the level of *veritas* to that of simple *auctoritas*. That, therefore, is in a retrospective vision. Let us now consider, instead, the possible return of the Leviathan to political developments beyond the acute phase of the crisis, i.e., beyond the complete individualistic breakup of the State. It should always depict a sovereignty deriving from the galvanized collective, therefore from forces of a prepersonal and irrational nature. It is not the collectivism of Marxism and bolshevism, since these movements, at least in their "myth" (and here, regarding "evocations", the myth is not to be disregarded), oppose every form of sovereignty and are centered in a completely materialistic and uniformistic vision of the world. Instead, it would deal with every anti-individualistic and anti-rationalistic movement, that profess again a conception of the State as "*dio mortale*", that fuels this symbol with potent forces of faith and sacrifice, but unfortunately without surpassing the stage that Keyserling would call "telluric", i.e., the stage at which authority suffices and truth is superfluous; in which myths, and not true principles, are the best instrument to capture and organize collective forces; in which the miracle of an exceptional personality, of a "man of destiny" saturated with the "numinous", and not a pure "divine right", founds and legitimates sovereignty and command and confers a transcendent character to the idea of the State.

Seeing things this way, we can speak of a certain modernity of the

Hobbesian Leviathan. But even in its new appearance it can claim so little, as in its emergence in the descending, involutive process to the character of a stable, definitive form. In the descent, once it reached the Leviathan from the true and traditional State, it was not possible to stop it, i.e., not to descend still even lower. In the new processes, we will necessarily find ourselves, sooner or later, facing an alternative. Either the new totalitarian movements will not succeed in surpassing their purely activist and vitalistic irrational phase: and now it will be difficult for the new Leviathans to be able to completely secure itself in the face of "indirect powers"—with which they no longer mean the irresponsibility of parties or some secret associations, but influences of a deeper elusive nature, always capable of infiltrating wherever they do not find the way barred by the presence of authentic principles and in a firm, abiding truth: and such forces do not have as a goal the maintenance and the intensification of worldwide anti-traditional subversion. Or else, we will enter into a new phase in which the Leviathan, so to speak, will become the body formed to make possible the incarnation and the manifestation of a principle and a higher order: with that, the collectivistic and irrational aspect of the principle of totalitarianism and authority will be surpassed and will again implement a type of truly spiritual and traditional hierarchical organization.

We can already point out that an analysis of the purely symbolic aspect of the Leviathan would nearly lead to the same result. Once the affinity of the Leviathan with the dragon the other mythical characters is ascertained, Schmitt tries to demonstrate that symbols of the type would have negative and evil meanings especially in Semitic civilizations, while in others the dragon often appeared among the regal, imperial, and metaphysical symbols. That is not completely exact or, better said, this interpretation must be subordinated to another more general and essential one. Not only for the dragon or the serpent, but for many other ancient symbols, they assumed two opposed meanings, in relation to two different periods. When a power, in its positive, superior spiritual origin,

falls and through regression becomes the tool of obscure, "elementary", and "demonic" influences, in the symbolism of the various peoples, the symbols, once unknown, come to acquire a negative quality, while the positive ones that were originally proper, are transferred to other symbols, alluding generally to a restorative function. That also fits exactly the Leviathan and confirms its ambiguous, double nature. And this duplicity, according to everything we said, reflects an alternative that will be decisive for the ultimate result of the forces of worldwide revolution.

Posted on 2012-07-05 by Cologero

* * *

`Golgonooza on 2012-07-06 at 07:01 said:`
Very interesting article, thank you.

`Mihai on 2012-07-09 at 04:25 said:`
This description of the "leviathan" corresponds very well with Plato's tyrant, of which he gives an ample description in the "Republic". As the "leviathan", the tyrant is an inverted image of the "philosopher-king", the latter being an image of superior principles, with knowledge of higher realities and laws, while the tyrant is an incarnation of the collective, inferior strata of the human psyche, being raised to power to represent the animalistic desires of the masses, in himself, the tyrant being the sum of ignorance.

In Christian terms, such a rule can be called "the reign of the Antichrist", though not necessarily in an absolute sense.

3.14 To Be of the Right

This essay by **Julius Evola** was originally published in the journal "Roma" on 19 March 1973 under the title "Essere di Destra".

Right and Left are designations that refer to a political system already in crisis. In traditional systems of government, they were non-existent,

at least if taken in their current meaning. In them there could be an opposition party, but not a revolutionary one, nor one that put the system itself in question, but rather it was loyalist and, in a certain way, workable. So in England, where one could speak of a "very loyal opposition of His Majesty". Things changed after facing the subversive movements of more recent times, and it is known that at their origin, the Right and the Left were defined on the basis of the places the opposed parties respectively occupied in parliament.

Depending on the level, the Right assumes distinct meanings. There is an economic Right based on capitalism, not without legitimacy if it does not abuse its power and if its antithesis is socialism and Marxism.

As to a political Right, it strictly acquires its full significance if a monarchy exists in an organic State: as was the case especially in central Europe, and also partly in conservative England.

But we can also disregard institutional presuppositions and speak of a Right in terms of a spiritual orientation and vision of the world. Then to be of the Right means, beyond being against democracy and every "social" mythology, to defend the values of Tradition as spiritual, aristocratic, and warrior values (in a derivative way, also with reference to a strict military tradition as, for example, happened in Prussianism). It means more than nourishing a certain disdain for intellectualism and for the bourgeois fetishism of the "cultured man". (The representative of an old Piedmontese family paradoxically had this to say: "I divide our world into two classes: the nobility and those who have a university degree" and Ernst Jünger, in support, valorized the antidote constituted by a "healthy analphabetism").

To be of the Right means also to be conservative, although not in a static sense. The obvious presumption is that there is something of substance worthy of being conserved, which however puts us facing a difficult problem. In reference to what constituted the immediate past of Italy after its unification: the Italy of the nineteenth century has certainly

not left us a heritage of superior values to preserve or deeds to serve as the base. Even going further back in Italian history, we encounter only sporadic positions of the Right; it lacked a formative unitary force which existed in other nations, solidified over time from ancient monarchical traditions of an aristocratic oligarchy.

However, in affirming that a Right must not be characterized by a static conservatism, we mean that there must be certain values or certain ideas based on solid ground, but that different expressions must be given to them, adequate to the development of the times, in order to not let them be bypassed, in order to take back, control, and incorporate everything that little by little is manifested in changing situations. This is the only sense in which a man of the Right can conceive "progress"; it is not a simple movement forward, as too many often think, especially among the left; Bernanos was able to speak aptly of a "escape forward" in this contest ("imbeciles, where are you fleeing ahead?"). "Progressivism" is a foible foreign to every positions of the Right. It is also because in a general consideration of the course of history — with reference to spiritual values rather than to material values, technical achievements, etc. — the man of the Right only recognized a descent, not progress nor a true ascent. The developments of current society can only confirm this conviction.

The positions of a Right are necessarily anti-corporate, anti-plebeian, and aristocratic; thus their positive counterpart will see value in the affirmation of the ideal of a well-structured, organic, hierarchical State, directed from a principle of authority. In this last regard, they therefore overlook the difficulties with regards to that from which such a principle can draw its foundation and its blessing. It is obvious that it cannot come from below, from the *demos*, in which, without offending the Mazzinians of yesterday and today, it does not express in the least the *vox Dei* voice of God , and if anything, the contrary. And one must also exclude the dictatorial and Bonapartist solutions, which can only have transient value, in emergency situations with contingent and short-term goals.

Again, we find ourselves compelled to refer instead to dynastic continuity, provided we keep in view at least what was called "authoritarian constitutionalism" in monarchic regimes, that is, a power that is not purely representative, but also active and regulatory. This is on the level of that "decisionism" which De Maistre and Donoso Cortes had previously spoken about, in reference to decisions constituting the last resort, with all the responsibility tied to it and which must be assumed in person, when one is found facing the necessity of a direct intervention because the existing order has entered a crisis or new forces push onto the political scene.

Let us repeat however that the rejection in these terms of a "static conservatism" does not concern the level of principles. For the man of the Right, principles always constitute the solid base, the terra firma in the face of change and contingencies, and there the counter-revolution deserves a precise catchword. If we want, we can refer here instead to the formula, paradoxical only in appearance, of a "conservative revolution". It concerns all the initiatives that are imposed through the removal of negative factual situations, necessary for a restoration and for an adequate revival of what has an intrinsic value and cannot be an object of discussion. In effect, in conditions of crisis and subversion, it can be said that nothing has a character so revolutionary as much as the renewal of such values. An ancient saying *usu vetera novant* the use of old and new , and it emphasizes the same context: the renovation that can actualize the revival of the "ancient", i.e., the unchangeable traditional legacy.

With this, we believe that the positions of the man of the Rights are sufficiently clarified.

Posted on 2012-10-29 by Cologero

* * *

Logres on 2012-10-30 at 20:33 said:

I corresponded briefly with John Michael Greer (Archdruid of North America) over a comment he made re: Evola, and here is what he said (reposted with permission)-

Question – "Would be interested in your take on Evola's "garbling" of celestial/telluric currents... "

Greer:

"I doubt it will be congenial to the Gornahoor audience. Druidry shares much in common with traditional Taoism – I can say this with some basis in experience, having studied with a Taoist master and put a decade into one of the old temple styles of t'ai chi ch'uan – and the sense of the nature of polarity is an important piece of this common ground. The notion that any polarity ought to be resolved by the conquest of one extreme by the other , in both traditions, is simply wrong – and this is all the more true as Evola's hypothetical Uranian and Demetrian Traditions are at best, dubiously historic reifications of eternal spiritual realities. I'd point out that in alchemy, the King does not rape and enslave the Queen – not unless you want your alchemical working to misfire from the very beginning and produce a poison rather than an elixir. Instead, the King and Queen marry, mate, and fuse into the twofold Rebis, from which the living Stone is born. In the same way, yin and yang, the solar and telluric currents, the Uranian and Demetrian principles are incomplete and unbalanced when separated from one another, and produce not only balance and harmonious change but a new, third thing when brought together in the right way. Evola's problem, as I see it, was that he was too heavily influenced by the popular intellectual culture of his own time – his ranking of warriors above priests, for example, was taken straight out of Nietzsche, and the whole Uranian/Demetrian dualism is a projection of ideas borrowed from Weininger's Geschlecht und Charakter – most of the radical Right in his time was influenced by Weininger, which makes it all the more curious that nobody reads Weininger at all these days. It's all too common for those who believe they've found a timeless tradition to define it in terms that will look profoundly dated a generation or two thereafter!"

I'll note that Cologero has read Weiniger, and that it is in the library. Although I find his comments useful up to a point, it seems to me to miss the point: Evola was a subtle and complex character addressing a specific time and danger – Greer seems to be engaged in polemics here, just like a typical modern. All the same, if anyone has pointers as to what to write back to him, I would be much interested...

Cologero on 2012-10-31 at 01:14 said:

I don't know what you want to say to him, Logres, since we have often criticized Evola here on similar grounds. Although Evola himself was versed in Taoism, even publishing an Italian translation of the Tao Te Ching, his duality of Solar and Lunar as Good and Evil is off the mark. He was too influenced by the likes of Bachofen and Weininger. It is one thing to use them to illustrate points, but quite another to inject them into his system. Part of Evola's "complexity" is the result of his prejudices. Evola should always be read in the light of Guenon, whom Evola

acknowledged as the Master of the 20th century.

As we have amply documented, to his dying day, Evola preferred his own philosophical system to proper metaphysics. I am aware that that makes him more "exciting" to certain casts of mind, but to read Evola without a firm foundation in Guenon (or even one's own traditional teachings) will lead to serious misunderstandings.

Avery M on 2012-10-31 at 09:30 said:

Cologero, if you were to expand that single comment into a pamphlet or an ebook, it would make a fine introduction to reading Guenon and Evola side by side. One can eventually glean this stuff on one's own, especially if one tries to struggle through Evola's monstrous *Metaphysics of Sex* or Weiniger, but I think people would prefer a guide so that they don't have to do that.

Logres on 2012-10-31 at 15:33 said:

Agree with Avery. As to reply, agreed also that Evola ignores the feminine for purposes of constructing his world (that's clear enough from Metaphysics of Sex, one of the few Evola books I've read cover to cover). The problem is that he's "constructing" at all – however, his emphasis on Monotheism & the Empire is something the Druidry revival would eschew; and he doesn't so much "garble" celestial and teluric currents as separate them arbitrarily in order to purge what he doesn't have a use for. But this is exactly what Druidry does with paganism and monotheism. Or so it seems to me...

Saladin on 2012-10-31 at 19:57 said:

I am not sure if one MUST "read Evola in the light of Guenon". Just as there are many different manifestations of the Primordial Tradition, as religions, there can be different variations in interpreting that same Sanatana Dharma! Personally, I am indebted to both of them but I can see why Guenon should be given precedence.

As for replying to Mr. Greer: Please make clear to him that there exists two fundamentally different Taoisms. The Traditional one is the Taoism of Lao Tze and Chuang Tze (which in our era is almost impossible to find in any organized or initiatory form) but the other Taoism is nothing but a degenerate form of Shamanism. What is known by Taoism in Taiwan (and in mainland China if any remnants have survived the vicissitudes of Communism) by the term Taoism is a disparate practices of third rate Magic and popular superstition. "It is a set of ancient religions, ancestor worship, animism, shamanism, and magic, mixed to varying degrees with Buddhism, Confucianism, and Traditional Taoism." It appears what Mr. Greer refers to is the latter.

aperion on 2012-10-31 at 20:03 said:

No Avery, that would be too easy, nay, a a cop out. I mean is it really that difficult for modern youth to read a Weiniger (tempted to tap a double "g" but won't) through and through or even a

very comprehensible "Metaphysics of Sex"? To hell with guides, both books are entirely coherent to anyone outside of specialist academic categories for those who care to actually read and comprehend books. Basically you want a summery or even care i day a Sacrament(!)- why do we even bother some my cry- , so you can avoid the pain of study. My diagnosis: man up beotch.

Logres on 2012-10-31 at 21:17 said:

In fairness to him, he states he reads the original texts (maybe in translation?) – the man has a first rate mind and is a gentlemen.

3.15 Historiography of the Right

This essay by Julius Evola was originally published in the journal "Roma" on 7 August 1973 under the title "Storiografia di Destra".

In developing some considerations on the European meaning that can be attributed to Donoso Cortes, the Spanish thinker and an interesting type of the political man, who developed his activity in the period of the first European revolutionary and socialist movements, a noted German historian, Carl Schmitt, pointed out that while the left has systematically elaborated and perfected their historiography as the general background for their destructive action, nothing similar happened in the opposed camp of the Right. There the whole is reduced to some sporadic example in no comparable way, through consistency, radicalism, and breadth of horizons, to that which Marxism and the left possessed for some time.

To a large measure, this is correct. Actually, the only noted history that had more influence, excluding that of Marxist intonation, is essentially of liberal, illuminist, and masonic origins. It relates to those ideologies of the Third Estate that served only to prepare the ground for radical movements of the left, having itself an essentially anti-traditional foundation. An historiography of the Right still waits to be written, and that constitutes one of our signs of inferiority in respect to the ideologies

and actions of unrest of the left. In particular, the so-called "homeland history" *storica patria* in vogue cannot fill the lacuna, because apart from certain of its possible national colorations and the moving re-evocations of events and heroic figures, it itself is affected, in a large measure, by suggestions of thought that is not of the true Right and, especially, because it cannot stand in comparison, as far as the breadth of horizons, to the historiography of the left.

This is the fundamental point. In fact, we must recognize that the historiography of the left has been able to take the view on the essential dimensions of history: beyond conflicts and episodic political developments, beyond the history of nations it has been able to see the general process and realized fundamentals in recent centuries, in the sense of the transition from one type of civilization and society to another. That the basis of the interpretation was, in such regard, economic and classist, does not take away any of the breadth of the description of the whole treated by that historiography. That, as the essential reality beyond the contingent and particular, indicates to us, in the course of history, the end of the feudal and aristocratic civilization, the arrival of the liberal, capitalist, and industrial bourgeois civilization and, after this, the announcement and incipient realization of a socialist, Marxist, and finally communist civilization. Here the revolutions of the Third Estate and the Fourth Estate are recognized in their natural causal and tactical concatenation. The idea of higher level processes which, without intending or knowing it, served the more or less "sacred" egoisms of the people, the rivalries and ambitions of those who believed they "make history" without leaving the field of the particular, such ideas are certainly considered. They study exactly the transformations of the whole of the social structure and civilization that are the direct effect of the play of historical forces, rightly relegating the history of nations to the simple "bourgeois" phase of general development. (In fact, the "nations" did not arise in history as its subject but started from the revolution of the Third Estate and as its consequence.)

Measured by the historiography of the left, which is characteristic of other tendencies, it therefore appears superficial, episodic, bi-dimensional, sometimes even frivolous. A historiography of the Right should embrace the same horizons as Marxist historiography, with the will to gather the real and essential elements of the historical process developed in recent centuries, beyond myths, superstructures, and also ordinary news. This, naturally, by inverting the signs and the perspective, i.e., seeing in the essential and convergent processes of recent history not the phases of a political and social progress but rather that of a general subversion. As is logical, the economic-material premise also needs to be eliminated, recognizing *homo oeconomicus* and the presumed inexorable determinism of the various means of production as mere fictions.

Much vaster, deeper, and complex forces were and are in the action of history. The particulars and even the myth of so-called "primordial communism" must be rejected and must be countered by the idea of organizations based predominately on a principle of a pure, sacred, and traditional spiritual authority as the civilizations that preceded those of the feudal aristocratic type. But, apart from this, we repeat, an historiography of the Right will recognize, not less than that of the left, the succession and concatenation of general distinct supra-national phases, which regressively led up to disorder and the current subversions: and this will be, for it, the basis for the interpretation of individual facts and upheavals, always attentive to the effect it produced in the total picture.

Here it is impossible to indicate, not even with any examples, all the fecundity of such a method, the unsuspected light that it would throw on a large number of events. The political-religious conflicts of the imperial Middle Ages, the constant schismatic action of France, the relations between England and Europe, the true meaning of the "achievements" of the French Revolution and little by little up to the episodes that particularly interest us, as the effective turn of the revolt of the Communes, the double aspect of the Risorgimento which national movement, triggered

however by ideologies of the Third Estate, the significance of the Holy Alliance and the efforts of Metternich (that last great European), then that of the first world war with the ricochet action of its ideologies, the discrimination of the positive and negative in the national revolutions that recently have been asserted in Italy and in Germany, and so on, in order to finally reach a vision in conformance with the naked reality of the true forces in battle today for the control of the world. Here is a choice of suggestive arguments, among so many, to which the historiography of the Right could be applied, revolutionizing the views that most people are accustomed to have on everything through the effect of historiography of the opposite orientation, and acting in an illuminating way.

An historiography so formulated, looking at the universal, would then be especially at the height of the times if it is true that, through the effect of objective irreversible processes, alignments increasingly stand out today that are not just ethnic and particular political and closed unities. Except that unfortunately only from the hoped for historiography would an increase in consciousness come. Its effectiveness as well as practice could have with difficulty, in the current state of things, the goal of an action, of a global and inexorable battle against the forces that stand for sweeping away what little that still remains of true European tradition. In fact, it could so happen that, as an opposing party, an international of the Right could exist, organized and equipped with strength like the communists. Now, unfortunately we know that through the lack of men of high stature and sufficient authority, for the predominance of party interests and small ambitions, for the lack of true principles and not through the lack of intellectual courage, a unitary alignment of the Right so far has not been possible to be constituted not even in our Italy and that only recently have initiatives of this type been announced.

Posted on 2012-11-05 by Cologero

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Cologero on 2012-11-05 at 21:34 said:

Since this essay was written, there has been no progress on this proposed task. The historiography of the left is accepted as obviously true: to wit, history, or at least modern history, has been the progressive growth of knowledge, freedom, and tolerance; it has overcome a series of enslavement, oppression, and discrimination.

Opposed to this, Evola expresses the counter-view of Tradition. Modern history has been the decline from a spiritual, heroic, hierarchical civilization to a materialist, undifferentiated, meaningless existence. The cause is the "degeneration of castes".

He assumes that current events will be understood in this light, at least by the few who are up to this task. Are there any takers?

Nowhere, even with the micro-surge in the interest in Tradition in some quarters, is such an historiography being written. I assume the global right that Evola referred to was GRECE, or the New Right as it is more commonly called. Unfortunately, the perspective of this movement is far from what Evola is describing here.

Mihai on 2012-11-06 at 04:47 said:

Here is part of a comment I wrote elsewhere concerning the new right:

"The new-right claims to abhor modernity's reduction of everything to quantity and to promote quality and principles. Yet, their methods are as quantitative as those of the left and they believe that the key to victory is to "convince" as many people as possible and to have greater numbers than their leftist opponents. It seems that, for the new-right, the way to quality is to have the largest quantity on its side. Perplexing.

Last, but not least: The new-right claims to stand for solid principles and a superior vision of life. Yet, reading the likes of Alain de Benoist one only finds there a curious mixture of "rightist" jargon, a few Nietzschean slogans perpetuated mechanically, some vulgarized ideas from Evola and loads of mystifications.

Worst of all, the new-right is greatly infiltrated by all sorts of pathetic neo-paganisms, crowleyan occultisms, new-agey type of naturalism and, worst of all, darwinian evolutionism, this last being the main pillar on which the modern mentality is built.

Now I do not doubt that this right that is at stake here may, in the future, gain some political support and even find itself in a position of power. Fortunes are always changing. But then what ? Are we to replace the current lie with some even more dangerous half-truths? Because this is what the so-called "principles" of the new-right amount to. And then we'll replace the caprice of the mass and of the lowest common denominator with the caprice of a single individual or that of a small circle of a pseudo-elite. Nazism was something like this, to be honest.

Graham on 2012-11-06 at 11:41 said:

Plinio Correa de Oliveira's 'Revolution and Counter-Revolution' could serve, at least, as a starting point for such a project.

aperion on 2012-11-10 at 18:40 said:

GRECE is old news, the manifestations of the "New Right" (both in Europe and in the U.S) have come a long way and are open to ideas aligning with Tradition. what's more is that there is an audience for this material. What is lacking is leadership, outreach and the willingness to get knee deep in the mud by engaging with people both real and online. Evola hints at the prospects of networking with sympathizers in MATR (or what was politically possible at that time), as it is true that men are more often won over by example then sterile dialectical intercourse.

Now the time has come for Cologero to begin such a historiography of the Right, in a publishable print format.

Ulysses on 2016-11-06 at 15:03 said:

"Are there any takers?"

I had been trying to write a book titled "Catholicism and the Causation of the Modern Deviation", but I didn't have the necessary knowledge. By the time I do insha'Allah, I may have a new title, like "Genghis Khan and the Making of the Modern World". https://www.amazon.com/Genghis-Khan-Making-Modern-World/dp/B005D60UOC

Cologero on 2019-06-26 at 19:53 said:

That's not at all on the "right track" ... there is nothing about the "third dimension" of history.

Stay away from Bolton, or else stay away from here.

3.16 The Defeat and the Future of France

The following essay by **Julius Evola** was published as "La disfatta e il futuro dell Francia secondo l'Action Française" in *La Vita Italiana*, in April 1942. Due to its length, it will be posted in two installments.

This essay may be of historical interest to some, since, given that history is written by the victors, it offers a rare glimpse into

the thinking of the losing sides in World War II. Evola is reviewing a book by Maurras that deals with the quick and humiliating defeat of France by the Germans.

There are recurring themes that repeat today. First of all, Maurras distinguishes between the real and the legal countries[15]; the first is organic, consisting of those elements who embody the soul of France and the latter a strictly legal entity comprised of all those inhabiting a geographic area. Maurras derives many of his concepts from Medieval social theory. If contemporary Catholic are embarrassed by this, it is only because they are preaching a different religion.

Maurras points to partisan interests and party politics as a cause of weakness. We will simply point out, as does Maurras[16], that Right without the force to back it up is worthless. There are advantages to winning and consequences to losing. In the second part of this essay, Evola will develop his own critique of Maurras.

First part In a recently published book that quickly reached its 29th edition, Charles Maurras sought to penetrate the meaning and the causes of the tragic destiny that weighed on his country if only to indicate the ways along which France will be able in the future to bring itself back and restore itself, drawing solutions from the hard trial. *La seule France, Chronique des jours d'épreuve*, France alone, Chronicle of the days of trial, 1941 We believe it is not lacking interest, for our readers, to reproduce the principle theses of this book, given the personality of its author.

First of all, about the causes of the disaster. There are internal and external causes. Regarding the internal causes, Maurras flatly opposes the thesis of those who speak of a morally degraded France, physically degenerated, and decayed military virtues. The country of Joan of Arc,

[15] https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Maurrassisme#A_political_model_based_on_the_.22Real_Country.22_.28pays_r.C3.A9el.29

[16] https://gornahoor.net/?p=5247

who already overcame the trial of 1914, should have been able to demonstrate, not less than any other nation, Germany included, the possibilities of a national exaltation of a heroic impulse. About this last point, in a special chapter, Maurras remembers, on the contrary, a series of cases of warrior and heroic virtues of the French army, recognized, in this war, by the enemy himself, but demonstrated sporadically and in disparate circumstances, through the lack of all the conditions of a not unequal battle.

After making the distinction between the *real country* and the *legal country*, Maurras instead believes that he indicates the principle internal cause of the French defeat in the split and, then, the division and denationalization between these two countries. The natural resources of France will be divided through the split nature of its own government. While in Germany, a political factor that united and multiplied every force had the upper hand, in France an similar factor served only to break it up: power was in the hand of politicians dedicated to parliamentary discussions and chaotic successions: fifty ministers in twenty years and one hundred ten in seventy years. Moreover, this government was something superimposed on the real country, having in view mostly the interests of the part and the party—apart from the influences of international powers—than those of the nation. So while in Germany there was an intensive culture of patriotism, in France it was always more neglected and rhetorical. While in Germany there was an improvement and a concentration of all the forces of the State, in France there was deliquescence and dislocation.

Maurras was opposed to the idea that authoritarianism would be something German:

> In the country of Louis XIV and Richelieu the concentration of the State would have been equally conceived and pursued according to a model of the most straightforward and most original French method.

The principle internal cause of the French disaster would therefore be in that. But, to tell the truth, Maurras forgot that the French recovery of 1914 happened even without such conditions, having instead democratic and parliamentary France as its antecedents. Therefore other causes are also looked for: that Maurras forebodes when he speaks of the "constructed" character of the French war and indirect powers that determined it, by means of a type of hypnosis exercised on public opinion, after all those national elements that would have been able to oppose the manoeuvre were paralyzed. According to Maurras, it would have been up to the French nationalists to prevent the war in 1935, during the period of sanctions, then in 1936-1937 on the occasion of Spain and in September 1938, on the occasion of the Czechoslovakian crisis. But in August 1939 all the measures were taken to prevent public opinion from being influenced in a direction contrary to what was wanted: seven or eight days before the declaration of war a decree was issued that "blocked" the press and authorized the immediate suppression of all these newspapers that intended to oppose the warmongering tendencies. "What is visible in this war," Maurras writes:

> ... is the constant progress of a plan, the development of a patiently hatched plot, to attract a herd of idiots in the trap constructed by the wicked... the declaration of war of September 3 was obtained on the basis of everything there is in the *demos* that is soft, vain, empty, absent, and nonexistent; it had to cross—and it crossed—the empty spaces of hesitation, imbecility, incoherence, and a more than animal stupidity: mineral—that of the billiard ball and whatever other heavy body provided with any mobility.

If the origin of such a declaration of war

> was covered by vapours so sooty, it is fated that it was so rapidly dissipated.

Then, the lack of reaction of the national French soul after the first moment and, especially, after the first period of the listless and only nominal war on the Maginot line. If we could oppose to that, that the awakening would nevertheless have had to be manifested once that, France being at this point at war, its national territory was directly threatened, Maurras indicates, here, the other technical and external causes relative to the French military unpreparedness and English treachery.

For example, he points out a typical case of deceit to the country. In the Chamber, with respect to aerial armaments, an engineer made a display showing that against 4000 German aeroplanes, the French could oppose only 800 and almost all of them fighters. The Head of the Government and the Minister of Air rushed to deny this assertion, demonstrating that the French air potential was instead about 2300 aircraft—making use however of inexact data, and referring simply to "naked" aeroplanes, far from being functional. Moreover, it counted on the help of the "English aviation power". This is one of the many cases of the blindness and irresponsibility that, from the technical side, had a great weight in the French catastrophe, so that Maurras speaks of a true betrayal of the leaders vis-a-vis the French nation, except the remaining military honor.

Maurras held the idea that the only path that an intelligent and national government in France should have taken, especially after the events of 1938, was that of Rome. He accused France of not having followed the real national interests, but of being left to take part in a mere ideological war. It should have been clear that France was not able to do anything at all for Poland. Also suddenly initiating a serious war on the Maginot line, that would have been, says Maurras, to try to break through a wall with one's head to help someone who was being assassinated outside of it. Other accusations were made in regard to the advance in Belgium, something that again would have obeyed suggestions of the English, concerned to maintain the coasts of the English Channel, more than the true strategic reasons for the French defense.

On all these points we cannot therefore be fully in agreement with Maurras. The way toward Rome, for France, would have been possible only in the supposition of a preliminary upheavel in the national sense, at least to not reduce the whole to a simple compromise with its precise mental reservations. But in spite the efforts of Action Française and similar organizations, in France there was not ever a trace of such an upheaval, the predominant mentality being in fact far from the ideas of Fascist renewal. So as things stand, one cannot dispute that those who wanted to give to the war an essentially ideological character are not right—from their point of view, naturally. It is useless to hide it: sooner or later, with the front line of the democracies, plutocracies, and Bolshevism, it should have come to daggers. A new Monaco in 1939 would have only meant a new respite. Given the direction of the dynamism of the "fascist" nations, we believe it is difficult that it would have been able to reach a true and durable pattern of balance without a violent solution and to give Europe a new shape.

The intervention of France, therefore, in my opinion, returns perfectly to the logic of those who were leading it, at least as to the legal country, if not the real country. From such a point of view, a Frenchman should instead have accused the indefensible and incomprehensible blunders that the democratic front committed, beginning with Versailles, in the sense of not taking all the measures to thereby prevent the enemies from being revived. Instead of taking it, for ideological reasons and essentially for masonic and anti-traditional hatred against the Hapsburg Empire, it should have sought to dismember Germany and, at the time of the occupation of the Ruhr, to act without hesitation. Step by step, the demo-masonic front instead allowed the enemy to gather strength. Therefore, the only reasonable accusation to make, instead, would be that which, after arriving at 1939 and having "swallowed" the annexation of Austria, the division of Czechoslovakia, the weakening of the Little

Entente[17], and the definitive strengthening of the Axis Powers, it was by that time too late to do anything with the assurance of success: it was rather, especially for France, heading for suicide, because of the instinctive reaction awakened by an anxiety complex.

Second part This is Part II of the essay by **Julius Evola** that was published as "La disfatta e il futuro dell Francia secondo l'Action Française" in La Vita Italiana, in April 1942.

> This piece is of historical interest since the issues in 1941 are still in play in 2013. We also get an "inside" look at certain thought processes when both Evola and Maurras expected victory for their side. Philippe Pétain and Charles Maurras had been well respected figures in France before the war but then ended their days in disgrace.
>
> The scission in France referred to was between two generals: Charles de Gaulle and Petain, the former representing the Republic and cosmopolitanism and the latter, identitarianism. I don't know the specific features of the laws against the Jews; unfortunately, neither Evola nor Maurras admits that France was under the thumb of Germany, so that France's internal "Jewish problem" was more far-reaching as many were sent off to concentration camps. This policy resulted in the discrediting of identitarian movements to this day as they stoke up that very real fear.
>
> Defeat has consequences, so the victory of the Allies has established republican and cosmopolitan values as the default position of the West. Jewish and Masonic values are now considered part of the mainstream of Western thought and beyond debate. The third element, that of foreign immigration, is still contestable, although the opposition is weak and unconvincing.
>
> The words must have stuck in his throat, since Evola could not quite name the "spiritual and traditional authority". On the

[17] `https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Little_Entente`

> other hand, I doubt anyone in the Vatican II church would be happy to know that the Catholic Church was at the spiritual center of Vichy France. This shows how much the spirit of the church has changed in the intervening 70 years, since it was then considered compatible with nationalism. Although it is now more cosmopolitan and its sophisticated social teachings are now little more than "Marxism light", this has not led to more acclaim by the modern world as the architects of Vatican II had hoped, but instead has led to its marginalization.

However, that does not prevent what Maurras documents and says about English politics, which had not the least regard for French interests, from being completely fair. Maurras takes a truncated position against De Gaulle. He, on the contrary, dedicates a chapter to demonstrate that England, basically, continued to be even in more recent times, in spite of appearances, the enemy of France, jealous of its colonial empire: it has always done everything to impede them from taking the rank that was due to them. Maurras fears that England seeks to exploit the French disaster to realize definitively their hidden ambitions, indeed making use from De Gaulle for this end, and stoking the internal French schism by every means.

For this reason, Maurras exhorts his compatriots to convince themselves of the absolute necessity of an internal concentration on the government of Marshall Petain as conditions for any recovery of France, after such a hard and tragic experience. So he devotes the second part of his book to highlighting and developing everything that the new Government tried to do. Maurras, although a realist, is pro Petain, because he eventually moved to establish a personal, national, authoritarian government, saved from parliamentary bedlam. France must, in that way, rediscover the true idea of the State: the State connected to the real country, freed from international influences, strong and disciplined, but against every leveling centralization.

Having such a State in mind, Petain had already begun to act to return France to the French: and here Maurras illustrated the new laws intended to build a dam against the influx of foreigners, metics, and immigrants that previously had found in France a type of promised land. Laws against Jews and Masons followed. Regarding the Jews, Maurras made the French point of view clear: they do not originate from an antisemitic hatred, but from the fact that a Jew can only be considered to be an alien, who as such cannot be equated to the citizens of a country and moreover must accept the conditions that are imposed on whoever desires to be a guest. Maurras however correctly observes that French legislation on the Jews conveys mainly a juridical point of view, inspired by effects more that by causes: Maurras' central point is to understand that a style and a hereditary mentality, a tradition and indelible custom will always make the Jewish substance something inassimilable and corrosive. Maurras recalls that France seized a large number of significant Jewish refugees, starting with the five Rothschilds. It advanced a sensible proposition: to appropriate such fortunes for the restructuring of rural debt, i.e., of those contracted or to contract for the acquisition and cultivation of land. That would mean to strengthen the class which more must be counted on for the reconstruction of a nation. As to the anti-masonic battle, Maurras brings to light the danger inherent in proceeding, in this regard, with a direct and practical action, extremely difficult where it is about a secret association. They can have effective results when they have complete possession of the State. As Mussolini did, only then will it be able to little by little paralyze the Masonic influence. The first step, i.e., the formal prohibition of Masonry, was already accomplished by France. What followed is:

> to promote a moral publicity without rest and carry everywhere the tip of its fire.

Maurras then alludes to social reforms: the question naturally arises

the reconciliation of classes and social justice. But, in this regard, Maurras also makes a rather appropriate point:

> If the protection of the poor is the natural duty of the State—when is not exercised spontaneously by some powers worthy of their strength—it must however also defend isolated, but just, powers against certain coalitions of "the poor" who gain an enormous voice, capable of crushing everything under the darkest and most brutal tyranny.

And France, which first had the Revolution (revolution, says Maurras correctly—is still so stupid to be called French, being instead the most cosmopolitan of all of them), has from historical experience everything that it needs in order to understand, better than any other nation, the timeliness of a similar warning.

After some other specific points, Maurras addresses the reform of education in France, indicating what was already done and what still is to be done. The fundamental need is that the State in France is made truly father of its schools by proceeding systematically in the formation of a new mentality in the next generations. In our opinion, this is really the crucial point, on which almost everything else depends. The French mentality still needs to be detoxified from the deleterious effects of ideology, which in that country has existed for a while and had a characteristic diffusion, in width as in depth. And that, in good measure, must happen through the schools.

Maurras indicates here correctly a point that, in the current state of reform, was not sufficiently considered; i.e., that which is not limited to a more or less autonomous moral teaching, but at whose center the principle of a spiritual and traditional authority is returned, the only one that can make well understood all the errors and deviations in which France has incurred: the return to the classical spirit, the battle against romanticism and humanitarianism, the decisive antithesis to the Revolution and

all the phenomena of degeneration, decadence, and anarchy that were its consequences.

In one point of his book Maurras develops some rather important considerations in connection to the idea that the French disaster of 1940 seems to be the ultimate effect of a chain of causes that go back far in time and of that only some are of general rule.

> The mass that constitutes an avalanche is formed of sand and stone coming from the most various rocks, something that however does not prevent the observer from understanding the small movement or the smallest human push that detached the first lump of snow—thus, before the evidence of any accusing traces (an impression of human finger), before the still visible trajectory of any suspicious footprint (explicitly oriented, clearly directed), the watchful eye discovers in the right point the impulse and the form of a criminal act—that waits only to be identified with the name of its author.

This is an observation which demonstrates, in Maurras, the right orientation to truly deepen the secret history of his country and therefore even to identify the premises of a true reconstruction. Here we are in the area of what we call the "science of subversion": in regard to which perhaps no country in the world offers such precious research material, as does France.

If we have to indicate any defect in Maurras' book, it is that it does not touch at all the problem of the new European order and the corresponding supernational arrangement. We can well understand, in Maurras, the need connected to the formula: *France alone first*—he himself indicates as much its provisional nature, when he says that, if there is going to be a European "concert", it is first necessary to make France able to play its part in it. But this image makes clear exactly the gap noted: a single part can be played correctly only by taking the movements from the central motif

of an entire symphony. We therefore propose to French nationalism the further task of also taking this point into account and proceeding to an action of mental formation in the sense, as soon as the more immediate needs of reconstruction and internal recovery are realized.

Posted on 2012-11-19 by Aeneas

* * *

Logres on 2012-11-20 at 12:47 said:

De Gaulle gained his authority from being in charge of one of the few military counter-successes against the Germans, which actually happened at a few points – French arms were not inferior to Germans, whose military equipment was not at all overwhelmingly superior. Does Maurras have thoughts about De Gaulle? France is still a strange country – on the one hand, they banned the burka, but on the other, seem willing to tolerate the multicultural hordes seeping into their body politic today. One can't help but think that the Allies were punished for their open support of the Red cause in Spain during that terrible civil war, for spreading bloodshed amongst the Catholics, who were really fighting for their lives (although Franco wasn't exactly a solar king).

Jason-Adam on 2012-11-20 at 17:53 said:

This is indeed a very interesting piece and I thank Cologero for the translation.

In reading it my symapthies tend toward Maurras' thesis and not Evola's criticisms... this line struck me "Given the direction of the dynamism of the "fascist" nations, we believe it is difficult that it would have been able to reach a true and durable pattern of balance without a violent solution and to give Europe a new shape." Is Evola advocating agressive warfare ? Not only is intra-Christian warfare morally wrong, it's also stupid when Russia was looming to swoop in and enslave all to pick fights over modern borders. If he really wanted a heroic sacred war, a new crusade, why not call on all Europeans and men of Tradition to unite as one and take up arms to destroy Communism ? The success of Spain & Portugal showed that neutrality was an option for France. An aquaintance of mine who is very much in the know told me once that if Italy had stayed neutral, she would have emerged the strongest nation in Europe after the war and fascism would have been extremely attractive then to all the ruined nations... ... .the way I see it, allowing the Protestant nations to blow themselves up while the Catholic nations rested in peace would have made a far more frutiful world from a Traditional standpoint.

Franco was a hero, the living example of a dictator in Donoso Cortes's thoughts – a man who acts with power to hold back the tide.

What Catholics are criticising Gornahoor ? I haven't seen anything here that contradicts the magisterium of the Church. If you mean Modernists you must remember that they are not Catholics, they are heretics and condemned by Catholic dogma. Even if he wears a mitre if a man teach error he is a heretic and a true Catholic must stand up to defend the Faith.

Logres on 2012-11-20 at 18:46 said:

Several Catholics have argued & then left the site over what can only be described, the best I could tell, as a refusal of Cologero to speak certain phrases, or refrain from making other suggestions. This despite all efforts being made to accommodate. But that's my perspective, & I didn't follow it closely.

Jason-Adam on 2012-11-20 at 19:05 said:

I can not speak for others, but I am a Catholic and find nothing in Gornahoor that opposes the Faith.

Cologero on 2012-11-20 at 23:42 said:

De Gaulle was earlier associated with Action Francaise. Obviously, the war separated them, Maurras becoming a collaborator and de Gaulle the leader of the Free French.

There is an important point made in this piece, and its consequences will be clear in the second part. Was the war to serve French national interests or was it an ideological war. Petain, and Maurras supported him, saw it the first way and implemented policies whose purpose was to promote and protect French interests. However, in retrospect, we see WW II as an ideological battle, viz., as a war of the free democracies (good) against totalitarian Fascism (evil). This view still dominates the self-understanding of the West to this day. Thus, we will see that Petain's policies were reprehensible by today's standards. Mircea Eliade reminds us of the eternal return and we will how this ideological war is still being played out in Europe and North America. To understand this essay will be to understand what is happening today.

Cassiodorus on 2013-02-03 at 14:30 said:

Off topic... Has anyone seen the recent debate between William Lane Craig and the atheist philosopher Alex Rosenberg at Purdue university?

It seems to me that Craig soundly defeated yet another representative of our free-thinking sophisticated intellectual elite.

Cologero on 2013-02-04 at 12:39 said:

Will all due respect, Cassiodorus, I'd prefer to stay on topic, although I see there is little interest in this topic.

As for that "debate", we can't even accept its premises. There is a distinction between philosophy (or what counts for it now) and metaphysics (at least what it used to mean). The former like "debate", the later prefers knowledge. So it is not a question of proving a "reasonable belief in God, but rather in "knowing" God, as the catechism says.

Keep in mind that there can be no "rules" for a debate such as those proposed, other than to be logical and keep your facts straight. A termination point must be agreed to otherwise there is endless chatter. Decision is necessary. Has any participant in similar debates suddenly "resigned" by being convinced by his opponent? No, these debate are more like chariot races with their fans taking sides before the first word is even spoken.

Another point is that the participants make a career out of such debates; that makes them more like sophists than true philosophers. As for Mr. Craig, we don't accept the existence of the being he calls "God" anyway (at least as far as I understand him), so I don't know how he can "win". Consult *this*: `https://edwardfeser.blogspot.com/2009/11/william-lane-craig-on-divine-simplicity.html`, for example.

`Jason-Adam on 2013-02-04 at 13:25 said:`

I find it interesting that Evola finds himself in accord ultimately with Maurras and he does see nationalism in a positive light as a necessary first step in the battle against subversion. Quite a contrast from de Benoist's critique of nationalism which while correct vis a vis the concept of the empire winds up supporting the communist destruction of all identity.

`Cologero on 2013-02-04 at 17:50 said:`

True, Jason-Adam, Evola's only objection is that Maurras did not address the question of a super-national arrangement, although it is not clear to me what Evola himself may have had in mind. Perhaps Evola was not familiar with Maurras' 1922 essay on Latinity which did address that question.

I really am not familiar with Benoist's critique. What I don't see among the neo-pagans is how they address the issue of the spiritual and traditional authority which must be at the heart of any future return to Tradition; this would order the socio-economic systems. Does Benoist have a complete socio-economic position of his own?

`Jason-Adam on 2013-02-04 at 20:52 said:`

De Benoist has said that he is not a Traditionalist in the sense of believing in a Philosophia Perennis so it iz puzzling that anyone could see him as a successor to Guenon or Evola.

He supports direct democracy and has stated that democracy is part of the Greco-Roman pagan tradition which Christianity destroyed so puts him right in line with the anti-mediaeval critique of the modern world and against the aristocratic conservatism of a de Maistre or Cortes which Evola supported.

I think the main similarity between Evola and de Benoist is simply their Germanophilia, other than that they are widely divergent thinkers.

Logres on 2013-02-04 at 21:12 said:

It's interesting that the neo-pagans and the proto-Fascists, despite having abundant intellectual energies and keen insight into certain aspects of Modernity, as well as having a will to resist, have not been able to coordinate among themselves an effective consensus, except at the highest intellectual levels (Evola, Maurras, etc., who all read each one another), and that decades ago. It's almost as if the impetuous rush towards Chaos in the energies of Modernism has infected the adherents of these insightful and courageous intellectual giants. I really need to find more translations of Maurras in English. Especially the essay on Latinity (which is probably not available in ghetto-English). It might be worthwhile to define the "Classicism" of France (and also Europe) as something over against the supposed "Classicism" (or Republicanism/Grecianism) that dominated the events of 1789. Evola seems to allude to that in his "material for study" remark concerning those events.

Cassiodorus on 2013-02-05 at 16:27 said:

Cologero,

I basically agree with you. I am certainly no proponent of theistic personalism; It's definitely the classical theism of the Thomist for me. As far as the "debates" go, I have mixed feelings. Of course, you're quite right about the "chariot races". Nevertheless, I think Craig's efforts can bear some good fruit. To hear an analytical "philosopher" effectively challenge the "default" modern worldview of materialism and relativism in large public venues could be persuasive for our largely agnostic culture.

Cologero on 2013-02-06 at 07:33 said:

Maybe you know something I don't, but I don't see these debates persuading anyone. There may be some poaching at the margins in both directions, but no large scale movements. To change the default modern worldview would require a change in body biochemistry which is more than an argument is capable of. Now all Craig tries to do is to show that belief in his god is "reasonable". However, I don't think his belief is reasonable at all ... it is too close to a "Mr God" or even to the Mormon conception.

What may be more useful is a series of debates between Feser and Craig ... effort is better spent at this time, I think, to reduce the number of heretics rather than to convert the heathens.

Cassiodorus on 2013-02-06 at 11:37 said:

A series of debates between Craig and Feser- Yes! That would be be excellent. In fact, I think some folks have even suggested that on Feser's blog. Cologero, I have taken note that the

Aristotelian-Thomistists practically short circuit when the Divine Principle of "beyond-being" is brought into the conversation. I've been reading David Bentley Hart lately in an effort to understand the exact nature of the "dispute" between the Christian West and East.

> `Cassiodorus on 2013-02-06 at 11:40 said:`
> Did I say, Thomistists? Wow.
>
> `Cologero on 2013-02-06 at 23:06 said:`
> Cassiodorus, perhaps you can comment on this: *Orthodoxy and Aquinas*[18]
>
> `Cassiodorus on 2013-02-07 at 14:50 said:`
> I'll check it out.
> Many thanks!!!
>
> `Jason-Adam on 2013-02-08 at 15:08 said:`
> The book on Orthodoxy and Aquinas is worthy of reading, it is quite the case that in the Middle Ages the eastern church was not so hostile towards Aristotle and scholasticism as one would expect, even the arch-anti-west Patriarch Gennadius was a strict Scholastic and hated the neo-platonism of Plethon.
>
> This proves to me more and more that we can not understand developments in philosophy without understanding geopolitics. The Orthodox Church in Russia had to become anti-west in theology to justify Russia's sense of non-Europeanness and unique culture that is opposition to the west.
>
> Which is why I question that, even if somehow Europe returned to Tradition, there would still be enmity between the 1st and 3rd Romes until one prevails.

3.17 Mohammed and Charlemagne

Julius Evola's review of the book "Mohammed and Charlemagne" by Henri Pirenne, originally published in 1939.

People have often spoken of this book, especially since the recent release of the French edition: they attributed to him the merit of having

[18] `https://easternchristianbooks.blogspot.com/2013/02/marcus-plested-on-orthodoxy-and-aquinas.html`

upset the current idea of medieval civilization and its origins, thanks to his new and original views. This appreciation seems to us somewhat exaggerated. Certainly, we believe strongly that a history of the Middle Ages and its origins still needs to be written, given the numerous deformations and misunderstandings due to the rationalist and secularizing mentality of last century, which continue to prevail today on this subject. But to tell the truth, it is not in that sense that the Belgian researcher brings us new lights, just the opposite: after having begun his studies in the atmosphere of the economist school, the source of the doctrine of historical materialism, Pirenne depicts a further enlargement of its horizons which still feels the effects of the fundamental limitations of that school. We therefore find again in him an inclination to consider as the determining historical cause what, in our opinion, can have value at most as an accidental cause, so that to emphasize the economic and incidental period, conferring on it the greatest weight in the genesis of the forms of civilization.

This is the fundamental thesis defended by Pirenne in this, his final, work. That admirable construction which was the Roman Empire had an essentially Mediterranean character. The Mediterranean was its base and center. The sea, in all the force of the name *Mare nostrum*, carried and spread ideas, religions, merchandise; it is the spiritual and material crucible of the North and the South, of the West and the East, under the sign of Rome, while the outer provinces are only a buffer against the Barbarians. The totality of life is concentrated on the shores of the great Roman lake. That said, according to Pirenne, the Germanic invasions did not put an end either to the Mediterranean unity of the ancient world, nor to what one can consider to be the essence of Roman civilization, as it still was in the fifth century, that is, an epoch where the Emperor of the West no longer existed. Byzantium/Constantinople assumes the patrimony of Rome as the Mediterranean capital. In spite of the havoc and diverse losses, that transfer did not determine the appearance of new guiding principles, neither in the economic order nor in the social order,

nor in the state of the language, nor in those of the institutions. What remained of civilization was Mediterranean; civilization was conserved along the shores of the sea and it is from there that the new phenomena arise. The establishment of the Germanic barbarians in the Western provinces of the Empire produced nothing original; they did not intend to destroy the Empire nor to exploit it. Far from despising it, they admired it. Starting from the time of their establishment, all the heroic and original traits of the barbarian character have disappeared, according to Pirenne, absorbed by the Roman and Byzantine lands. And again following Pirenne, it is a fable to say that the Germans brought their morality of the young people, that is, of the people in whose heart personal connections of fidelity won over those of respect towards the State and was opposed to the cosmopolitan corruption of ancient civilization. That is the opposite which was produced and was true: the barbarians masterly knew how to adapt themselves to the Byzantine corruption, even contributing to aggravating it. Their structures were secular, they did not furnish any spiritual support. Constantinople remains the equivalent of the fallen Roman center. In the year 600, the world did not take a qualitatively different appearance to what it had in the year 400, and that principally because of the survival of the Mediterranean character of that civilization. The rupture with ancient Tradition and the Middle Ages (as a new civilization) begins therefore later than what is commonly supposed.

It is not the barbarian invasions which constituted an instrument of action, but rather a new phenomenon: the appearance of Islam with its rapid and unexpected progression. The consequence was the separation of the East and the West and the end of Mediterranean unity. Some countries like Africa and Spain, which had continued to be part of western civilization gravitated from that moment around the orbit of Baghdad. Islam represents a new religion and a new, unassimilable, aggressive, and irreducible civilization. By becoming a Muslim lake, the western Mediter-

ranean ceased to be the route of cultural and economic exchanges of the Roman-Byzantine world, and the West found itself blocked and constrained to live folded in on itself. It is thus that the axis of the life of the world was displaced from the Mediterranean towards the North: not because of the effectiveness of spiritual and racial factors, but essentially as the result of that contingency. That provoked the crisis of the Merovingian regime, up until the appearance of a new dynasty originating from the Germanic countries of the North, the Carolingian dynasty. The pope was allied to it, detaching himself from the Emperor of the East, who, absorbed in the battle against the Muslims, was no longer in a position to sustain and protect him. A Rome detached from Byzantine could not avoid looking north. It is thus that the Church prepared the new order of things. It had assumed the symbol of Rome, and its authority became greater than the State, not succeeding in maintaining a strong centralized administration, it let itself be absorbed by feudalism which came to take on a particular importance, for the same reason of the paralysis of Mediterranean commerce and exchanges.

Dominated by the Church and feudalism, Europe is going to take on a new appearance. The Middle Ages begins in a birth which, according to Pirenne, occupies the century between 650 and 750. It was a period of anarchy where the ancient tradition was lost and where new elements got the upper hand. The evolution ceased in the year 800 which sealed the definitive rupture of the West and the East, the former giving itself a new Roman Germanic Empire, now detached from the old Roman Empire prolonged by Byzantium. It constituted a new civilization and a new civil community whose symbol and instrument was Carolingian Europe, on the base of a Germanic element Romanized by the Church. Even when political unity disappeared, there subsisted an international unity of civilization which was followed up to the Renaissance, an essentially Carolingian imprint.

These are the basic theses of Pirenne's book. This quick and easy

note suffices to let the reader take account of the part that the materialist mentality and an extrinsic consideration of history plays in these theses. And, as always in similar cases, what could have been a necessary cause comes to be considered as the sufficient cause and as the *conditio sine qua non*, from which the aberrant deductions arise. "It is rigorously true," says Pirenne, "that without Mohammed, Charlemagne is inconceivable." We have here the image of physical determinism according to which, for example, a thrust contains exactly everything that can explain the movement to which it passively constrained the inert body which receives the brunt of it. Pirenne doesn't even seem to suspect the *active* causes of history.

The thesis asserted that the Roman event has survived much longer than believed in the invasion and the influence of the barbarians, that it had not disappeared at the end of the Empire but that the Mediterranean unity had continued to live, under the sign of Byzantium, from the fifth to the eight century, before being finally swept by Islam, and certain flattering for us and something to please us.

But, as the translator correctly points out in the preface, in order to sustain that thesis, it is not necessary to look beyond the façade, that is, to stick to the social and administrative structure of the ancient world, because behind that beautiful relatively intact appearance is found the putrefaction or something else from which the seed of that putrefaction emanates. It is a fact that, in order to assure the survival of the Roman event, Pirenne deliberately confuses it with the Byzantine event. He believes totally seriously that the process of the Byzantification of the Mediterranean world, which is produced up to the time of the Arab invasion, was able to truly assume the validity of the longevity of the ancient heritage.

A heritage which, in fact, had already undergone a fundamental alteration with the Christianization of the Mediterranean world. In order to not take that alteration into account, the author is again constrained to limit his considerations to the exterior, hierarchical, and political part

of the Church, neglecting the properly spiritual factor. In reality, the survival of the Mediterranean unity had only a material and economic character, circumstantial for the most part. And it is just for that reason that an equally contingent circumstance, like the Arab invasion and the control by the Muslims of the maritime routes of the Mediterranean, was able to easily break it. That is in fact elsewhere than where one finds the positive forces preparing the coming of the new age, in which something of the purity of the ancient world had to truly survive invisibly.

One must certainly recognize, with Pirenne, the necessity of moving the date of the beginning of the Middle Ages, considered as a civilization having its own appearance, from the instant of the fall of the Western Empire to that of the creation of the Holy Roman German Empire – that is, to move it ahead at least three centuries. These three centuries don't have a well-defined appearance. One could qualify them as the centuries of the interregnum. They do not yet correspond to a specific type of civilization. It is no longer Antiquity, but not yet the new times. Pirenne is however incorrect in not presenting the forces in gestation which already exercise a muddled action, in order to take ascendancy afterwards. He can be agreeable to us to hear him affirm and to see him struggle to demonstrate that the Germanic races lost their characteristics during their long entry into the Roman world and were "Romanized". But from nothing he can take nothing. It is not necessary to forget that, for the author, Romanization has often, we repeat, the meaning of Byzantization, consisting of assuming the vices and corruption of Byzantine decadence. At the point that he considers that what happened under the dynasty of the new Romanized barbarian States in the western basin of the Mediterranean was the decadence of a decadence. The author emphasizes almost tendentiously that corrupted, or at least passive and negative, aspect in order to be able to note the purely formal survival of Antiquity, while he ignores, at least in appearance, what there was positive in it.

He purely political deduction of the birth of the Holy Roman Em-

pire is totally insufficient: he can expound it only to some minds located under the narcosis of materialism applied to history. To underline a fundamental point, Pirenne insists, for example, on the purely secular and profane character of the States and dynasties characteristic of the Germanic races up to the end of the Merovingian period – it is only with the Carolingians and by the intervention of the Church which itself had been pushed by considerations of propriety that the royal power had assumed a sacred character. A more inexact affirmation that it was founded on an ambivalence making him believe that secularism exists everywhere where there is no indirect consecration granted by a distinct organization, that is, by the Church. In the same perspective, it would be necessary to deny the sacred character to a great part of the theocratic powers of Antiquity, and today even to those of the Japanese sovereign. In all these cases, it is an effect of tradition that a dynasty given can be sacred in itself and for itself, in virtue of some enigmatic heredity or destiny. Now, Pirenne seems to not know that what had already appeared, at the time of the invasions, in numerous "barbarian" tribes: among the Goths, they called the kings *Asen* ("divine heroes") and *Amals* ("celestials") because they believed that in the difference from the other tribes (or *Sippen*), their line drew its origin from the mystical *Asgard* and that their blood was not of a human nature. Certainly, we find these traditions in a state of involution and degeneration in the course of the period that we have called the interregnum, but not at the point of preventing, under certain conditions, a resumption, an awakening, a galvanization. That is exactly what happened, thanks to the tradition already mentioned and to a certain heroic morality, when an historic conjuncture led to the formation of the Holy Roman Empire. Here, the Roman symbol was the common reference of a supernatural order proposed by Christianity, which acted, so to say, as a catalyst on the manifestation and the survival of spiritual and racial forces latent and diverted in the course of the preceding period of Byzantization. Without admitting that latent survival of forces which then had to blos-

som under the form of a civilization having many affinities with the first Aryan societies, including the primordial Roman society, one could then explain the conflict between the Empire and the Church, between the Roman Ghibelline symbol and the Roman symbol of the Guelph. Or then, in Pirenne's manner and of so many other myopic historians, one will be obliged to explain that conflict only as the function of temporal interests and ambitions, thus missing the true essence of the conflict, the essence that we have often had the chance to bring to light in several of our works.

What it comes down to, if up until Mohammed the positive element had been only the Roman-Byzantium component, how does he explain that once the Mediterranean unity was swept away, the besieged West did not elaborate a civilization of the same type? Pirenne says that the Carolingians had no concern with a situation created from all pieces, but they drew parts from fortuitous circumstances, and that the coup d'état which replaced the Merovingian dynasty, the only one which survived after the invasions, is explained only by the closing of the Mediterranean by the Saracens. Even if he could truly justify such a coup d'état, that would never explain the genesis of the new type of civilization by which the Middle Ages took its own appearance and which, in its great political-social structures, reproduced essentially the distinctive traits of all the Aryan civilizations of Antiquity.

On this last point, one must likewise note that Pirenne expresses, it would only be incidentally, the judgments which would not receive our agreement: in his opinion, the passage of an almost cosmopolitan economy of exchange, credit and commerce, favored as it was by the Mediterranean routes, to an essentially agrarian and feudal economy which had to leave its imprint on medieval society properly called, signifies regression and decadence. For us, it is on the contrary the civilization not pursuing mercantile objectives which represents a value. And in that case also, the emergency provoked by the irruption of Islam in the Mediterranean

acted like a stimulant, but not as a determining cause: as it happens, an exterior contingency served only to compel something superior, which was latent, to become manifest and take over. Beginning with the Carolingian period, the traffic of merchandise and commerce, with the mobility of riches, became the prerogative of the Jews, and only much later, that of the new centers foreshadowing the democratic and oligarchic-bourgeois corruption, so that the healthiest and purest forces of Germanic-Roman Europe separated themselves and developed their possibilities in a normal direction characteristic of a heroic, differentiated, and spiritual civilization.

Posted on 2016-02-28 by Cologero

4

Excerpts from *Sintesi di dottrina della razza*

4.1 Against the Neopagans

On the Internet, there is an essay, attributed to Julius Evola, going by the title of "Against the Neopagans." Since it has been so widely disseminated, it is impossible to know its source or the motivation behind it. In fact, it is the translation into English from the German translation of three chapters in *Sintesi di dottrina della razza*. After Italy's ill-fated alliance with Germany in the late 30s, Mussolini felt compelled to come up with a racial policy to match that of Germany; previously, neither racism nor anti-semitism had been part of Fascist ideology.

Since Evola had been critical of German racial theories, Mussolini authorized the translation of Evola's book into German *Grundrisse des Faschistichen Rassenlehre* as representing the Fascist position on race. I've compared the two versions and it seems the translation was not exact, but rather tendentious. Understandably, it leaves out passages that would only be of interest to Italians. What is more interesting, however, is that it omits passages that portrayed German thinkers in a negative light. For

example, these three paragraphs are omitted:

> Regarding the anti-ascetic prejudice of neo-paganism , we already said: neo-paganism redoubles the incomprehension demonstrated by Nietzsche. The Aryan would not have known asceticism in the normal way: his true mysticism would have been on this side: he would never have thought about a supernatural fulfillment of the personality.
>
> Superstitions, residues of the dark ages or of Estruscan magic, lies and instruments for the tactic of temporal dominion of the clergy selling indulgences: that how they regarded everything that is a sacrament, rite or supernatural power. This shows they do not know that all of the life of ancient, Aryan, and specifically pagan Roman, civilization always had a ritual character, the rite accompanying every form of collective and individual life, not in the sense of an empty ceremony, but as the instrument of a real connection between human and supernatural forces. Opposed to that, H S Chamberlain attributed to the Aryan spirit the conquests proper to the so-called free thought and modern profane science.
>
> Naturally, when one believes that Lutheranism represented an awakening of the spirit of the Nordic race see *Foundations of the 19th Century* instead of representing, as it in fact did, the inducement for a further spiritual involution of the race and to a large extent its semitization: *incomprehension can only be added to more incomprehension*. Thus there was something ingenuous, as Guenon rightly noted, in the scandal that Protestantism felt when faced with the claim of infallibility that, in the order of transcendental knowledge (in the West, we say: in matters of "faith") was accepted pacifically by ancient Aryan civilizations not for one man alone, as in Catholicism, but **for every member belonging legitimately to the brahman, that is, the "solar caste" of spiritual leaders**.

Posted on 2011-03-26 by Cologero

4.2 The Misunderstanding of Paganism

In order to illustrate some of the points made recently, we have invited an old friend, Tony Ciapo, to provide translations, with commentary, of some of Evola's works from *Sintesi di dottrina della razza*, *Defesa della razza*, and Evola's commentary on the Fascist movements of the first half of the 20th century. By exploring certain movements from the perspective of Tradition—which are far from any modernist misunderstandings—, we expect to point who are in **Solidarity** with the few remaining men of Tradition left today and which viewpoints are in **Continuity** with Tradition itself. Tony will continue this task as long as interest is expressed and intelligent discussion ensues. The initial section is the fourth in the chapter "La razza aria e il problema spirituale". His commentaries will appear inside boxes or between square brackets. There is no implication that either Evola or myself would have accepted all such.

The Misunderstanding of the new racist Paganism Having made the problem clear in such a way, it is perhaps appropriate to point out the misunderstanding—a misunderstanding of no small moment— characteristic of those contemporary extremist racist currents that believe that have resolved it in terms of a neopaganism. Such a misunderstanding, in truth, is already apparent precisely in the use of terms such as "pagan" and "paganism". We ourselves had at one point adopted them and sincerely regret it.

This section follows the section "Ex Occidente Lux — The Religious Problem" (to be translated next), which is alluded to in the first sentence. There he discusses Catholicism, in particular its

> teaching of a primordial revelation of the Fathers. Attentive readers of Gornahoor will recall that Catholicism regards itself as the latest manifestation of the primordial religion. Evola digs deeper to the pre-Christian religion of the **Ancient City**, whose lineaments we have been at pains to point out. In order to avoid the ambiguities and attendant misunderstandings of the term "paganism", we will henceforth refer to it as the "**Old Religion**". It should be obvious that the "contemporary currents" he opposes include the amalgam of racism and neopaganism associated with the theoreticians of National Socialism. There is no need to name names, as Evola means all of them. The book he sincerely regrets is Pagan Imperialism.

Certainly the word, *paganus*, appears in ancient Latin writers such as Livy with no special purpose. But this does not alter the fact that with the arrival of the new faith, the word *paganus* took on a decidedly pejorative meaning, adopted for use in early Christian apologetics. *Paganus* derives from *pagus*, meaning a village or slum, so that *paganus* means what is characteristic of a country hick or an uncultured, primitive man. In order to profess and glorify the new faith, a certain Christian apologistics, following the the vice of overvaluing themselves through the discrediting of others, proceeded to a systematic and often conscious disparagement and misrepresentation of almost all the earlier doctrines, forms of worship, and traditions, which were made to correspond to the combined and pejorative designation "paganism". Naturally, with this goal, it took care to highlight everything that, in the pre-Christian religions and traditions, lacked any normal or primordial character, rather than the clear significance of degenerate and decadent forms. Such a polemical *animus* then led, in particular, to attributing indiscriminately an anti-Christian character to everything that, prior to Christianity, could also simply be non-Christian and could not constitute an irreducible antithesis.

Evola is making the point that the Old Religion, much older

than Christianity, was not, and could not be, explicitly anti-Christian. Therefore, we have to distinguish the former from the paganism prevalent at the beginning of Christianity. By then the Old Religion had been largely forgotten and even when its rites and traditions were followed, it was done with little understanding. The Roman priesthood had been reduced to a formalism, while the aristocrats were more likely to adopt one of the many prevalent Greek philosophies or dabble in the so-called mysteries. As was recently pointed out, it was the plebs, initially without a religion, who were the "pagans" of the era. The first Christians came either from among the Hellenized Jews or the Romans who had converted to Judaism whether formally or by adopting their beliefs and ways. (Note that the Judaism at the time was quite different from the contemporary religion that goes by that name.) These would have been predominantly the third caste working as artisans, traders, and other pecuniary occupations.

Of course, the neopagans, following Nietzsche, now return the favor, by claiming it was really the Christians who were the "hicks". Such mutual name-calling is unhelpful and pointless. Instead, *pace* the early apologists and neopagans, we follow **Valentin Tomberg** 's Hermetic maxim, *we must love our pagan past*, provided we understand by that the Old Religion.

On such a basis, it is therefore necessary to think that there is a "paganism", meaning something essentially and tendentiously constructed. That is, it lacks any true correspondence to historical reality. We mean, correspondence to what the pre-Christian and especially Aryan world always was in its "normal" forms, and not only in decadent aspects or that were refashioned from the degenerate residues of older civilizations or inferior races.

Recommended background material:

Fustel's *The Ancient City* is, by his own admission, indispensable

to understanding what Evola means by the pre-Christian Tradition.

For the history of the Early Christians and Jews, I rely upon the works of **Ernest Renan**.

Neopaganism and Naturalism Keeping all this in mind, we come today to discover a peculiar paradox: to wit, such a paganism never even existed but was constructed by Christian apologetics. Yet some "pagan" and anti-Christian movements of racism and extreme nationalism very frequently accept it, thus threatening to make it become true today for the first time in history. No more and no less than that.

This critique is devastating. Instead of recovering the primordial religion of their ancestors, these neopagans are adopting a caricature of that religion. It is obvious that the primary characteristics of neopaganism (anti-Christian, racism, nationalism) had no analog in ancient times and are purely anachronisms.

What are the principle traits of the pagan outlook on life, as its apologists believe and popularize?

Naturalism First and foremost: **naturalism**. All transcendence is totally unknown to the pagan view of life. It would remain in a mixture of spirit and nature, in an ambiguous unity of body and soul. There is nothing to its religion but a superstitious deification of natural phenomena or the energies of the races, elevated as so many idols. From this, in the first place, a particularism, a polytheism conditioned by blood and soil. In the second place, an absence of the spiritual personality and freedom, a state of innocence that is simply characteristic of beings of nature, of those not yet awakened to any truly supernatural aspiration. This "innocence": license, "sin", and the delights of the flesh. Even in other domains,

either superstition, or a purely "profane", materialistic, and fatalistic civilization. Apart from certain "anticipations" considered insignificant, it is with Christianity that the world of supernatural would be revealed for the first time, that is, the world of grace and personality, in contrast to "pagan" determinism and naturalism. With it a "catholic" ideal (in the etymological sense of universality) would be affirmed; a healthy dualism, permitting the subordination of nature to a higher law, and the triumph of the law of the spirit beyond the law of flesh, blood, and the false gods.

> Here Evola identifies Naturalism as the primary trait of the neopagans. This is true for the most crude attempts at revival such as Wicca or Asatru, as well as the more sophisticated systems. To deny this, and thus to affirm supernaturalism, freedom, and personality, would draw neopaganism closer to Christianity, at least in a common metaphysical perspective. We should point out that Evola opposes Christianity on completely different grounds from those of the neopagans, who simply repeat the slogans of the Pharisees and the Enlightenment, sworn enemies of Tradition.

These are the most typical traits of the predominant conception of paganism, i.e., of everything that is not specifically the Christian worldview. Anyone who possesses any direct acquaintance with cultural and religious history, however elementary, can see how inaccurate and onesided this attitude is. Besides, some early Church Fathers often demonstrated a greater understanding of the symbols and cults of preceding civilizations. Here we highlight just a few points.

> Here Evola's frustration is showing: even an elementary knowledge of history and religion would suffice to refute the bases of neopaganism, yet we cannot even count on that today. The Church Fathers showed a deeper understanding of the Old Religion than do our own neopagans. Regular readers of Gornahoor will find many references to this.

Posted on 2011-07-17 by Aeneas

* * *

Perennial on 2011-07-18 at 01:17 said:
Great stuff! Look forward to reading subsequent installments.

James O'Meara on 2011-07-19 at 23:42 said:
So, Evola rejected the crude "paganism" of an Alfred Rosenberg. Apart from already knowing that, what does all this effort provide me with? Even Hitler agreed "When the Greeks built temples, we were living in mud huts. Why does Himmler insist on digging all this up?" Evola collaborated with Nazi pagans, which the modern PC types will never accept, no matter what "distinctions" you can find. As far as 'racism' and 'true Christianity' go, the bottom line is that Evola would have sent M L King to a death camp without a second thought, so what have you proved about his "sophisticated" versions of racism, paganism and state power?

AS for "Evola regretted his book Pagan Imperialism," well, yes, he was unable to influence Mussolini so he turned to the Nazis, hoping to "rectify" Path of Cinnabar their crude racism and paganism. Again, Rachel Maddow isn't going to 'friend' him, so what's the point?

As for your sneers I won't call it a 'critique' against Nietzsche, Fred spoke about 'intellectual conscience.' Anyone with an intellectual conscience would point out that while Evola may have 'regretted' Pagan Imperialism, his last book, Ride the Tiger, is based on the idea that all honest modern thinkers 'intellectual conscience' again will take Nietzsche as their starting point. Since he lists Nietzsche as his most profound teenage influence, we can see that Evola was consistently Nietzschean from age 16 to his death. Now there's integrity!

BTW, my own reflections on Nietzsche, the Greeks and the function of religion can be found here:
http://tinyurl.com/3glcsx9

Cologero on 2011-07-20 at 00:02 said:
It takes considerable effort, James, to provide original translations and context to the masses. You could take the high road and thank us.

Perennial on 2011-07-20 at 00:36 said:
Goodness James, bit negative, are we not?

Aeneas on 2011-07-20 at 08:19 said:
Consistently a Nietzschean? Pas de tout! Evola writes in Cinnabar regarding the early influence of Nietzsche:

"He fed a basic tendency, even if in confused and partly distorted forms, therefore a mixture of positive and negative."

Evola also refers to the "ambiguous character of many view of Nietzsche".

Regarding Nietzsche's personal life, Evola attributed it to the "awakeing of the elemnt of transcendence without its conscious and active assuption." Evola refers to the ideal of the Superman as the "worst of Nietzsche."

So that is the worst of Evola, that he tries to be "hip" with references to Nietzsche, while admitting what a mixed bag he really is. Evola's position was to critique the false ideals of his time and Nietzsche served that purpose. That task having been accomplished, we at Gornahoor are delineating the characteristics a the Tradition to follow, where there is no need or room for Nietzsche. As for "intellectual integrity", a "scholar" needs to take into account the entire corpus of an author. We have access to thousands of pages of Evola that few "Evolians" bother to familiarize themselves with. Hence, we try to make them available via translations and commentaries. Those with intellectual integrity will appreciate these efforts. As for the others, perhaps we can straighten them out.

I on 2011-07-20 at 08:54 said:

"As far as 'racism' and 'true Christianity' go, the bottom line is that Evola would have sent M L King to a death camp without a second thought, so what have you proved about his "sophisticated" versions of racism, paganism and state power?"

James, this is not true. Evola was firmly and consistently against violent treatment of political enemies and ideological opponents. This is something that made him un-popular among some high ranking fascists and nazis of the social darwinist type, who believed in the "Nietzshean" myths of the blond beast of prey etc. It is true that he would have made and accepted all serious efforts to remove the kinds of ML King from places of influence and (political) power, but he would not have suggested a death camp or execution for them. This is not because he had felt any humanistic empathy for them, but he could see where such actions would inevitably and objectively lead – to disaster and ruin.

Max on 2015-04-19 at 06:24 said:

Tradition is lived in a specific time and place, but some treat it like existing in a vacuum outside real societies, humans and events, without which it becomes just another mental construct blocking our view. This is the instance of a mind that only goes backwards but not forward. A fault in the "thinking" of modern people is that they start with the effect, and then try to work out which cause lead to it which means they have to make it up, rather than to start at the beginning and align ourselves with that which is given.

Visionsofglory14 on 2011-07-22 at 04:13 said:

Perhaps he was referring to your claim that Neo-pagan critiques of Christianity parallel those of the Pharisees and the Enlightenment thinkers. Care to extrapolate?

Cologero on 2011-07-22 at 12:48 said:

Mr. Vision, is there some specific point you want to address? First of all, the neo-pagan new right, in its criticism, aligns itself with those said forces of revolution; thus it is not traditional, and not even of the right. I translated Evola's objections to Catholicism (what he and we mean by Christianity) and it is available on this web site. Unlike the crude critiques that are all too available on the www, Evola accepts the possibility of miracles, defends the concept of infallibility, and even the idea of a High Priest (or pope). Furthermore, unlike the neo-pagan new right, Evola defends Charlemagne and regards the Middle Ages as an age of tradition.

I sent out to the mailing list the next installment of the translation of Sintesi, where Evola writes:

> Once all that has been established, the suggested possibility of "transcending" certain aspects of Christianity would become real. According to its strict Latin etymology, to transcend means to surpass while ascending. In principle, it is not a matter – it is good to repeat it – of rejecting Christianity or of showing the same incomprehension towards it as Christianity itself has shown, and largely continues to show, towards paganism. It would instead perhaps be a matter of integrating it into something much larger, omitting some aspects, for which it is little in accord with the spirit typical of some of the renovating forces of today, of the transalpine type, in order to accentuate instead other more essential aspects which such faith cannot contradict the general conceptions of Aryan and Nordic, pre-Christian and non-Christian spirituality.

Has anyone in the neo-pagan new right mentioned the idea of "transcending" Christianity?

Cologero on 2011-07-23 at 00:07 said:

How many times do we have to make myself clear, Eddie? Just one more time. Point 1. Evola was not at all pro-Christian ... he could not relate to its theology at all. But neither was he anti-Christian. Rather, he was non-Christian, as though it never existed for him. Point 2. When we use the word "Christian" at Gornahoor are referring specifically to the Church of the Middle Ages, especially when it was undivided. By that standard, there are precious few "Christians" around today. Let's not be confused about labels; we're trying to penetrate deeper. Even failure is worth the attempt. That is one reason that we don't write much about theology proper, which is, as you say, in its contemporary manifestations to a large extent sentimental. I can well understand that it does not appeal to many today. Nevertheless, we need to understand why it did appeal

to many a millennium ago, and was the guiding spirit to the last traditional civilization in the West.

A corollary is that we try to transcend the "us vs them" attitude, that is all too common among the neo-pagans. Any careful reader can determine that we are not distorting Evola. However, it seems to us that the neo-pagans distort him while claiming him as one of their own. I'll summarize what I see are the specific differences. If there are any wise pagans who address these issues, please point them out to us.

The real paganism is that of the Ancient City about which Gornahoor has devoted several posts. It is not the decadent form of the late Empire. The real paganism was theocratic and was led by a priest-king until its subsequent degenerations. All of life was regulated by duties and rites.

The real paganism was not a hedonistic, sensualistic, naturalism.

The Christian kings and emperors of the Middle Ages, such as Arthur, Charlemagne, Frederick II were exercised legitimate authority.

The Church of the Middle Ages (and the civilization that grew up alongside it) was not Jewish creation initiated by "Saul". It was the creation of the Nordic-Roman spirit.

The end of Tradition in the West did not begin with Constantine. It began 1000 years later with the Renaissance, Reformation, Enlightenment, French Revolution.

The Church of the Middle Ages was hierarchical, not in the least democratic and egalitarian.

Those are some points. Evola's view is the first of each item. Every neo-pagan I've read has adopted the second. So, this is not meant to be a "court case" between Christians and pagans, if only for the reason that few Christians today would even recognize themselves in this characterization. The issue is to determine the spiritual forces at work and to understand the flow of history apart from angry and ignorant polemics.

Perennial on 2011-07-23 at 02:38 said:
Bravo!

Eumaeus on 2011-07-26 at 16:42 said:
New to this forum. Excellent conversation.

Indeed many of the early Church Fathers did have a superior understanding of the Old Religion in part because they practiced it prior to conversion. The process of integration of the new religious idiom with the old was an important part of the project of the Fathers although the work was not acknowledged as such. In Exoteric religion they generally do not give much attribution to where they have taken their ideas and indeed the official stories may conceal deeper connections outside of historical traditions. For example the Zoroastrian and Hellenistic inputs into Christianity even at the level of the Gospels are obvious but not footnoted. They are acknowledged by allusion– the appearance of the Magi at Bethlehem; references to the Lake

of Fire – and the very notion of incarnation already so well recounted for many Greek heroes. And at the core: equation of Christ as Logos.

These are also symbols and markers within the Gospel which betoken the expansion of Christian mission from tribal to universal – by reference to those two traditions that were already beyond tribal particularism at that point in time – Zoroastrianism and Hellenism.

4.3 Further Misunderstandings of the Pagan Worldview

Evola continues his critique by pointing out that the goal should be to transcend Christianity by integrating it into something more comprehensive that incorporates the essential elements of the genuine antique paganism. This is actually *analogous* to the Catholic position as described by Fr. **Heinrich Denifle**:

> The Catholic Church is the religion. As the supernatural does not destroy the natural, but rather presupposes it, so the Catholic Church does not annul the natural religion but embraces it as a necessary supposition and foundation.

Thus, Christianity as understood by its ablest apologists is not averse to embracing the authentically Traditional elements of the earliest religions including the Vedanta and Western paganism.

Once all that has been established, the possibility we suggested of "transcending" certain aspects of Christianity would then become real. According to its strict Latin etymology, to transcend means to surpass while ascending. In principle, it is not a matter – it is good to repeat – of rejecting Christianity or of showing the same incomprehension towards it as Christianity itself has shown, and largely continues to show, towards paganism. It would instead perhaps be a matter of integrating it into

something much larger, omitting some aspects, for which it is little in accord with the spirit typical of some of the recent transalpine innovations in order to accentuate instead other more essential aspects by which such faiths cannot contradict the general conceptions of Aryan and Nordic, pre-Christian and non-Christian spirituality.

> Unfortunately, the neo-pagans fabricate a sham spirituality that rejects the Traditional elements of Christendom while recovering little from genuine antique paganism. He points out the anti-Catholicism of the neo-pagans links them to the elements of the anti-Tradition. As for the historical references: the 1870s was the time of the unification of Italy under a secular Republic on the French model. The Fascists, on the other hand, declared Catholicism the official religion of Italy and restored religious education to the public schools. Evola seems to have moderated his view (in 1941) from the views expressed in Pagan Imperialism (1927), some of which he regrets. Instead of the return to the antique religion of the pagans, what he witnessed was the rise of neo-paganism. More than once, he conceded that those neo-pagans would be better off as Catholics.
>
> Evola is in an odd position: while devoid of any faith and lacking any sympathy with Christian belief, he nevertheless defends Christendom, even referring to it as the time when well-born men held sound beliefs. In this paragraph, for example, he opposes those the Church regarded as "rebels and heretics". I would recommend Revolution and Counter-Revolution[1] for a reading of history that, apart from its theological orientation, has many points in common with Evola. Specifically, they both see the Renaissance, the Reformation, the Enlightenment, Revolution, democracy, and so on, not as the Progress that most believe them to be, but rather as causes of the end of a phase of Tradition.

[1] `http://www.pliniocorreadeoliveira.info/UK_RCR.pdf`

Unfortunately, as we pointed out, the path taken by the extremist racist neo-paganism is totally different. Falling into a snare almost deliberately set, these neo-pagans, end up by advocating and defending ideas more or less reducing them to that sham, naturalistic, particularistic paganism, lacking light and transcendence, and even pervaded by a misunderstood, pantheistic mysticism, which was created polemically from the Christian misunderstanding of the pre-Christian world, and which is based, at most, only on isolated forms of degeneration of the regressions of such a world. And as if this were not enough, they often resort to an anti-Catholic polemic which, *mutatis mutandi*, whatever its political justification, in fact drags out certain arguments and clichés of a purely modern, rationalist, protestant, and enlightenment type that were the weapons of liberalism, democracy, and freemasonry. This was already the case, to a degree, with H. S. Chamberlain. It appears again in a certain Italian racialist movements, which are inspired by Gentilian philosophy, that is, the philosophy of personalism through which Fascism would be the continuation of the anti-Catholicism of the 1870s, Roman re-enactments would be a silly rhetoric, and the Italian tradition would tend to coincide more or less with the opinions of a series of rebels and heretics, Giordano Bruno until now.

Generally, what we just indicated is recognized when the new paganism gives itself up to the glorification of immanence, "Life", "nature", seeking to create new, superstitious mysticism, which is in the sharpest contrast to every higher Olympian and heroic ideal of the great Aryan civilizations of pre-Christian antiquity. What are we to think about assertions like this one? "Faith in a super-sensible world beyond this world of sense is something schizophrenic: only schizophrenics see double"[2]. Or about another, according to which every distinction between spirit and body is only a product of the anti-Aryan degeneration injected by oriental races.

[2] E. Bergmann

> Evola defends the immortality of the soul. He mocks the idea of immortality understood as a genetic continuation, an idea that today is expressed in concepts like the selfish gene or human biodiversity.

Denying this distinction, such racialists, as a consequence, come to deny immortality itself: if the soul is inconceivable separately from the body, one cannot think of a survival in the afterlife, but only of immortality meant as self-continuation through one's descendants. An immortality, which a massacre, earthquake, or epidemic naturally enough would be sufficient to destroy.

> Whatever his admiration for Nietzsche may have been, Evola shows he is a rather inconsistent Nietzschean. Evola consistently criticizes Nietzsche's incomprehension of the ascetic life.

Regarding the anti-ascetic prejudice, we already said: neo-paganism redoubles, in this regard, the incomprehension already demonstrated by Nietzsche: The Aryan would not have known ascesis in normal life: his true mysticism would have been for the afterlife: it would never have thought of a supernatural fulfillment of the personality.

> Evola points out the importance of rite and ritual in the **Ancient City**. Evola points to the example of infallibility to demonstrate the untraditional nature of the neo-pagans. Many claim to be anti-egalitarian in theory, but in practice they chafe at the notion that one man's thoughts may be superior to another's.

Superstitions, residues of the "dark ages" and "Etruscan magic", lies and instruments for the tactic of temporal control by the clergy in the commerce of indulgences would be, for the others, everything that is sacrament and rite and supernatural power. Thus, they show they do not know that all life in those ancient Aryan and specifically of the Roman

pagan civilizations, always had a ritual character, the rite accompanying every form of individual and collective life, not in the sense of an empty ceremony, but as the instrument of a real connection between the human and super-sensible forces. On the other hand, Chamberlain already went to attribute to the Aryan spirit the achievements typical of so-called free enquiry and modern profane science. Naturally, when one believes that Lutheranism represented the awakening of the spirit of the Nordic race instead of representing, as it did represent, the incentive for its further spiritual involution and for its eventual semitization. Elsewhere, in the German edition of Revolt against the modern world, we justified this view to an incomprehension that can only be added to incomprehension. So there is something ingenuous, as Guenon correctly pointed out, in the scandal that was demonstrated among the protestants in the face of the claim of infallibility in the order of transcendent knowledge (in the West it is said: in matters of "faith"); for the ancient Aryan civilization infallibility was instead recognized as belonging not to a single man, as in Catholicism, but to every member belonging legitimately to the brahman, to the "solar caste" of spiritual leaders.

> Evola mentions the possibility of a return to antique traditions. However, this poses an insurmountable obstacle even to those pagans today who understand this critique and to whom it may not apply. There is no way today to reconstruct those rites and rituals. Furthermore, their source is of divine origin and tied to their ancestors, blood, and soil. That cannot be done *di nuovo* by fiat without some divine sanction; in particular, one cannot be a pagan by oneself apart from an hierarchically organized community led by a high priest. Those "sacred and spiritual origins" are lost in time.

In the face of such confusions, we can always put very clearly the alternative: either return to the traditions and their sacred and spiritual

origins, or continue to gamble with various combinations and inclinations of modern and secular thought. Another example: what is that "nature" that in certain racialist circles is so exalted? It would little suffice to notice that it is not in the least the nature that ancient man saw, but a rationalist construction of the period of French Encyclopedism. The encyclopedists created, with precise subversive and revolutionary intentions, the myth of a good, wise and provident nature in contrast with the corruption of every "culture". Thus, we see that the optimistic naturalist myth of a Rousseau and the encyclopedists went hand in hand with "natural right", universalism, humanitarianism, egalitarianism, and the denial of every positive form of State and hierarchy.

> Evola criticizes the very notion of a return to "nature". This applies *a fortiori* to contemporary and subtle variations based on zoological racism. The intent of Sintesi is to develop the spiritual notion of race, not to defend any biological understanding of it.

Even in regard to the natural sciences one could say the same. Every honest scientist knows that in his researches, whose goal exclusively consists of the formulation of abstract uniformities and mathematical relationships, there is no place for "nature". As for biological research, the very science of genetics, and so on, we already emphasized the errors and the one-sidedness in which they fall, in believing definite laws that are of value only as a partial and subordinate aspect of reality. There is not a trace of what people today consider to be "nature" in the meaning that nature had for the man of the origins, for the traditional and solar man characterized essentially by his Olympic and regal distance. Since Italian racialism has not yet moved into those area, it is therefore well to pay attention, and as we said, to value someone else's experience.

Posted on 2011-07-27 by Aeneas

4.4 Objective and Impersonal Knowledge

Yesterday, we saw that **Julius Evola** claimed both knowledge and action as the two basic elements. Let's be clear about what is meant by knowledge. This is not the scholarly knowledge of the professors nor is it related to any discipline like comparative religion. Rather, this knowledge is a gnosis, that is, a direct, intuitive, more than personal knowing which brings absolute certainty. In the snippet translated below the horizontal line, taken from Chapter 2, Section 2, of Sintesi di dottrina della razza, Evola begins his explication of race as based on the traditional understanding of man. It is insufficient to know that the Greeks and Scholastics taught the same view. The one thing necessary is to know oneself as a being consisting of Spirit, Soul, and Body. A man must know and be able to disntinguish these parts of himself within his own consciousness. I know first hand that developing this knowledge is a difficult and arduous process, more difficult than any university class or perfecting a skill in combat or the arts. Even when this knowledge is attained, it is yet more difficult to maintain one's awareness as spirit on a consistent or permanent basis. Many speak of spirit; few are spirit. The risk of taking this path is the overturning of one's cherished beliefs. The risk of not taking it is to continue to live like an animal.

The Three Levels of the Doctrine of Race Since we want to clarify the doctrine of race from the traditional point of view, of course we will assume, as a premise, the traditional conception of the human being, according to which, man as such cannot be reduced to purely biological, instinctive, hereditary, or naturalistic determinisms: if all that has one of its parts, ignored by a dubious spiritualism, exaggerated by a myopic positivism, it still remains a fact that man is distinguished from animals insofar as he participates in a supernatural, super-biological element, by virtue of which he can be free or himself. Between the one and the other,

as an intermediate element, in a certain way he remains an animal. The distinction in the human being of three different principles, namely, the body, soul, and spirit, is fundamental for the traditional view. In a more or less complete form, it is found in the teachings of all the ancient traditions, and it continued up to the Middle Ages:

- The Aristotelian and Scholastic conception of the three souls: vegetative, sensitive, and intellectual
- In the Hellenic trinity of *soma*, *psyche*, and *nous*
- The roman conception of *mens*, *anima*, and *corpus*
- The Indo-Aryan of *sthula-sarira*, *linga-sarira* and *karana-sarira*

And so on: these are all equivalent expressions of it. It is important to emphasize that this view must not be considered as one particular philosophical interpretation among so many others, to be discussed, criticized, or debated, but as an objective and impersonal knowledge, conforming to the very nature of things.

Posted on 2011-08-11 by Aeneas

4.5 Greater and Lesser Battle

Just to give readers something to live for today.

> The battle differentiates, distinguishes, and creates hierarchy, especially when — to use some traditional expressions — it is not the small battle, but the great battle. It is not the battle of man against man or against the environment, but the battle of the supernatural element of a man against everything that within him

> is nature, sensation, materiality, anxiety, turmoil, a mirage of vain greatness.
>
> *Against the chaos and the anti-race that are within him, before they are outside of him.*
>
> *Posted on 2011-09-01 by Cologero*

* * *

> `Charlotte Cowell on 2011-09-01 at 13:13 said:`
> you may well be right about that!

4.6 Race and Death

Since we now have 50 people in the entire world interested in reading more of Evola, I am releasing another section. It may be of value to compare it to Mircea Eliade's description of the Legionary movement[3], from which the following quote is taken.

> Being a profoundly Christian movement, justifying its doctrine on the spiritual level above all – legionarism encourages and is built upon liberty. You adhere to legionarism because you are free, because you decided to overcome the iron circles of biological determinism (fear of death, suffering, etc.) and economic determinism (fear of becoming homeless). The first gesture a legionnaire will display is one born out of total liberty: he dares to free himself of spiritual, biological and economic enslavement. No exterior determinism can influence him. The moment he decides to be free is the moment all fears and inferiority complexes instantaneously disappear. He who enters the Legion forever dons the

[3] `http://ia600700.us.archive.org/1/items/Liberty_7/Liberty.pdf`

> shirt of death. That means that the legionnaire feels so free that death itself no longer frightens him. If the Legionnaire nurtures the spirit of sacrifice with such passion, and if he has proven to be capable of making sacrifices these bear witness to the unlimited liberty a legionnaire has gained. "He who knows how to die will never be a slave." And this doesn't concern only ethnic or political enslavement – but firstly, spiritual enslavement. If you are ready to die, no fear, weakness, shyness can enslave you. Making peace with death is the most total liberty man can receive on this Earth.

The Evola text now follows. Note again that he opposes biological determinism and insists that the personality transcends all elements of race.

* * *

Given how much has now been clarified, we will now pause a moment to make precise, in particular, the limits of the personality's membership in a race. Let us immediately say what is, in this respect, the view that is unacceptable from the traditional point of view. It is that of those who, once race is conceived as a purely biological-human, historical, and only terrestrial entity, holds that in such an entity lies the purpose of every being that belongs to it, that nothing exists higher than race, since race is the wellspring of every value, and the idea of a task and a super-terrestrial destination of the individual is illusory and pernicious: "to remain faithful to the earth and to the race."

We have already dealt with this conception and criticized it more than once. In the face of it, after all, one can resort to the racialist criterion for the appreciation of the "truth"; depending on the various "races of the spirit" we have, particularly, as many conceptions of the same race, and there is no doubt that only for a telluric race can that conception be "true", only the telluric man can suppose such limited horizons as

absolute. In this telluric vision of the race, the mentioned supposition of those neopagan racialists also comes back, according to whom the only conceivable immortality would be that of survival in blood, in earthly descendants.

It is true that similar positions, today, are presented less according to a theoretic value than according to a practical and political one. With it we aim to consolidate the unity of the people-race and to concentrate every spiritual energy of the individual member in the temporal and historical tasks that this being has to resolve. But it is otherwise true that the ancient Aryan civilizations, even in regard to earthly, heroic and political realizations, had their greatness without, however, perceiving the need of resorting to these myths, recognizing instead rather different truths. It is clearly evident, in fact, that our view of race carries back to the pitryana, to the "way of the South" and that it is opposed to the "divine way of the North" (devayana) that stood alone to define the highest Aryan ideal.

The theory of "double heredity" reconnects to such ideals. Personality, we said, is not exhausted in historical-biological heredity or horizontal heredity. It appears rather as a principle that, while manifesting itself in the race (here, as always, race in the restricted sense), in itself stands beyond race, therefore cannot be exhausted in it. To recognize race, as by now has been clarified in principle, does not mean to damage the personality: the personality owes the living and articulated material for its specific expression, for its self-manifesting and acting, to the race and as much as earthly heredity collects. In that there is a conditionality that however is not passive and one-sided. Every individual also reacts on race and on his heredity on the basis of his own most intimate nature, processes the substance in which he manifests himself, ultimately the form, and it is such that interracial differentiation and that diverse purity or completeness of types is realized, which we previously mentioned and now return to, in regards to its social reflexes. It is a giving rather than a receiving. In the points in which a supreme balance and a supreme

adequacy are reached (a balance, according to our tripartite view of the various components of the true race), we have as a peak, beyond which the personality has nowhere to go — it has nowhere to go on the horizontal, terrestrial line. To this line its work, its being, and, physiologically, its lineage remains and belongs. But the personality itself, if it has reached such a peak, is "free" and can now turn to a properly supernatural perfection.

This is exactly the most ancient Aryan conception, relative to which it does not belong specifically to the group of spiritual leaders, a conception that is also found again in the views and various legends of the Western Middle Ages. The dharma is established, the scrupulous observance of worldly laws of race, caste, and so on, up to a full adaptation. Such laws require also the assurance of a lineage: life, which is received at birth, before death must be returned with its own imprint to another being, and it is for this reason that the first-born son is called "the son of duty". After that, after the "active life", according to the Aryan law, he must withdraw to an ascetic-contemplative life. And the Ario-Iranian saying is rather expressive that recalls the true task to be, not just to procreate on the horizontal plane of terrestrial descent, but also towards the higher, on the vertical ascending direction. In the Western religion all these views were confused. Above all, what is of pertinence to the active life was separated violently from that which is the contemplative life and almost always the truly traditional solutions were forgotten, according to which the law, that in not of this earth, prolongs, completes and empowers that of this earth. But still more harmful than such confusions are the little noted telluric racist views, in case they have been taken seriously and have a future. According to the traditional teaching of the Aryan peoples, it remains instead firm that the supernatural is essentially the goal and the dignity of the personality: this goal, therefore, acts as the highest driving force and the deepest animating force in the bosom to the expression that race gives to the personality, thereby uplifting simultaneously the race, up to a limit beyond which, after having left a sign of greatness, the same force

liberates itself and tends to make it so that death is precisely a finalization, a *telos*, a new birth, the third birth of the indo-Aryan teaching.

Only the mediocre and the losers, among the beings who do not know how to realize the law and earthly duty down to their foundation, can think that they don't have an afterlife, that they have for a destiny a redissolving in the mixed vitality of the race, in the collective and earthly substance of blood and heredity, only in that way surviving (in a somewhat relative meaning of the word) the destruction of their physical individuality, and transmitting to others the task for which they were inadequate.

Posted on 2011-09-06 by Aeneas

* * *

HOO on 2011-09-06 at 22:20 said:

This translation work is appreciated.

Although this was already our doctrine, the text, e.g. because of the way it is written, enlightens our own understanding. In the superior or complete worldview there is no divorce between holistic racialism and spirituality.

Meta-physical, extraphysical, or supernatural racism is the expression of the core of the religion of the Hyperborean-derived peoples — liberty, hierarchy, personality; differentiation & unity; — and vice versa.

Jason on 2011-09-07 at 14:57 said:

Cologero, in regards to your disappointment that so few have expressed interest in reading Evola, Traditionalism as such is meant for an elite, an elite is never a large group, and in this modern world the number of elite souls is much smaller than it would ever normally have been... ... ... .we do not know what the future will bring, and perhaps in the future there will be many who will be thankful to you for bringing out this important book in English. It is important that THE DOCTRINE OF RACE be translated if only to debunk the various "Neo-Nazi" interpretations of Evola common in many circles and to show the Baron's thoughts as they truly were. I for one, an admirer of Evola who cannot read Italiano, am very grateful for this project.

4.7 The Mystery of Birth

> To allow such traditional views to act on oneself, until they awaken precise interior forces, means to progress on the way that leads to a spiritual level from which the significance of life constitutes something absolutely different from what it means for the rest of men: a significance of clarity, absolute force, and incomparable certitude.
>
> Julius Evola

In *Sintesi di dottrina della razza*, Evola addresses the mystery of birth and how it relates to one's destiny. After discussing the notions of the races of the soul and spirit, he raises the question and addresses some objections to his view:

> What blame does a man have if he was born in one race and not in another? Is he perhaps responsible for the fact that his parents and ancestors are Aryans, Jews, blacks or Amerindian? Has he perhaps willed all that? With your theory of race you remain, in spite of it all, in a purely naturalistic point of view. You turn a natural event into a destiny and construct above your system, instead of bringing attention above all to those values in which it can truly enter into play, and be considered imputable, as a human responsibility.

He regards these objections not as weird or artificial, but of a real importance to avoid reverting to materialistic and collectivist degradations of the doctrine. The traditional point of view stresses the values of the person over any of its manifestations.

Evola asserts that only pre-christian conceptions of man and life can satisfy his requirements. We prefer to deal with concepts rather than labels, so we need to reformulate Evola's argument somewhat. In a subsequent post, we will show how his views challenge both the traditional

right and its modern alternatives. Evola describes the Christian solution to the mystery of birth this way:

> The Church had to reject the idea of pre-existence that the preceding traditions always recognized: that is, it denied that the spiritual nucleus of the personality pre-exists terrestrial birth and, naturally, conception. In Christian theology things in this respect are not so simple, as far as this denial could be believed. Nevertheless, the fundamental Christian view is that each human soul is unique and is created by God from nothing at the moment in which it is breathed into a body or embryo read to receive it. That a man is born in one race rather than another becomes then a theological mystery: "God willed it" and, often, it is admitted that the divine will is inscrutable.

In that paragraph, there is something true, something false, and something ambiguous. It is true that the human being exists from the moment of conception, so, here, Evola is more Catholic than the pope. It is false that Catholic doctrine teaches that the soul is infused into the embryo at some point subsequent to conception. That is the Cartesian view that presumes a duality of soul and body. What is ambiguous is the meaning of the pre-existence of the soul. The common misunderstanding is that the soul exists in time prior to conception. This is the view of Plato of all systems deriving from Theosophy, and even popular views of oriental religions such as Hinduism or Buddhism.

To clear up the latter point first, Evola makes it clear that this pre-existence cannot be conceived in a temporal sense, since the human Self is transcendent to the world of space and time. The Thomist view, then, is not as dissimilar as Evola would like. The soul is the form of the body, which cannot exist without the soul. So the soul is pre-existent in the ontological sense and the physical aspects of the body are the reflection of soul qualities. This is really Evola's point, and should be the Catholic viewpoint, had the understanding brought by Thomas Aquinas allowed

to be further developed instead of being petrified at a certain point. Evola explains his doctrine:

> The view of ancient Aryan humanity was totally different and it alone permits us to overcome the objections indicated... According to that view, birth is not by chance nor a fact willed by God; neither fidelity in regards to one's own nature signifies a passivity, but rather testifies to the more or less clear knowledge of a profound connection of one's Self with something transcendental and otherworldly, to be able to act in a transfiguring way. This is the essence of the doctrine of karma and dharma, a doctrine that must not be confused with the idea of reincarnation.
>
> It is necessary to distinguish a double heredity. That which stands before the individual in the temporal non-transcendental, sense is the heredity of parents, the gens, the race, a certain civilization, caste, etc., therefore, more or less, everything that commonly is meant when speaking of heredity. But all that does not exhaust the spiritual reality of the individual, as materialism and historicism claim: as determining and essential it must rather be considered an intervention from above, a principle assuming and utilizing, as its material of expression and incarnation, everything that this heredity has gathered with its laws and determinism. Moreover, it must be thought that the historical-biological heredity of a given line is chosen and assumed when it can be approximately worth as a type of expressions analogous to a transcendental heredity.
>
> That is why in every being two heredities meet and join each other, the one terrestrial and historic, in good measure positively detectable i.e., known to science (tr) , the other spiritual, otherworldly. To establish the ties between the two, is therefore to determine the synthesis that defines a given human nature, and intervenes in an event represented in various traditions with various symbols... Basically, as noted, a type of law of elective affinity acts here. Wishing to clarify with some applications, we will say that a

> man is not of a given gender, race, or caste because he is born that by chance or through the will of God, or through a mechanism of natural causes, but vice versa. He was born that way because he already was a man or women, of one race or another, etc., naturally in an analogical sense in the sense of an inclination of vocation or deliberation transcending use, through lack of adequate concepts, we can present only through its effects. In a certain way, one has therefore the interference of horizontal lines and vertical lines of an earthly heredity and non-earthly. At the point of crossing, according to traditional teachings, birth occurs, or better said, the conception of a new being, an incarnation.
>
> Race, caste, etc., therefore exist in the spirit before manifesting in terrestrial and historical existence. Diversity has its origin from above, and what refers to it on earth is only a reflection and symbol. As one willed to be on the basis of a primordial nature or a transcendental decision, so one is. It is not birth that determines nature, but vice versa; it is nature, in its widest sense, because common words are inadequate, that determines birth.

It is this point of crossing that accidental, or contingent, qualities intersect with transcendent, or essential, qualities. Clearly, the modern conception ignores the transcendent, by its nominalism and denial of formal causes, hence every quality is accidental. The Aristotelian-Thomist scheme agrees in principle, yet is limited by its commitment to the genus and species distinction, so it is forced to define various types of accidents. We will address these issues subsequently, after we translate another section on the impact that Evola's conception has on ethical theory. But first we will repeat some quotes from Plotinus and Plato that Evola relies upon.

> The general plane is unique, but divides itself in diverse parts, in a way that in everything there are distinct places, some more pleasant, others less so. And souls, also unequal, come to inhabit these

> distinct places that correspond to their own diversity. In such a way, everything is arranged and the differences in their situations correspond to the inequality of the souls.
>
> Plotinus

> It is not the demon that chooses you, but you yourself chose your demon. You yourself choose the destiny of that life to which you are irremediably connected.
>
> Plato

Mystery of Birth For the presentation of the directive principles of this part of race theory it is however necessary to make a few remarks related to the problem of birth, and a final clarification of what has been said about heredity.

Even when we have worked out all the principal objections against the doctrine of race that are made from an immediate, practical or intellectual point of view, whether in good or bad faith, there remains one that is insuperable but decisive. They can say: good, everything affirmed is correct. But with everything taken into account, what fault does a man have if he was born into one race and not in another? Is he perhaps responsible for the fact that his parents and ancestors are Aryans, Jews, blacks or Amerindian? Has he perhaps willed all that? With your theory of race you remain, in spite of everything, in a purely naturalistic point of view. You turn a natural event into a destiny and you build above your system, instead of paying attention above all to those values in which human responsibility can truly come into play, and be considered imputable.

This is, in some way, the ultima ratio of the adversaries of race theory. And it must be conceded that such an objection is not artificial and farfetched, but of a real importance, if it does not support the materialist and collectivist deterioration of the doctrine in word and is posed instead

from the traditional point of view, which always emphasizes the values of the personality. Nevertheless, to consider that objection certainly means confronting the problem of birth. From a higher, spiritual point of view, the justification of the race idea depends on the problem of birth and its solutions.

In this regard, arriving at some firm points is still rather difficult, as long as it remains in the ambit of views introduced by the coming of Christianity into the West. And that is not by chance: race and superrace, cult of blood, arianity, etc., are all concepts that were formed and affirmed essentially in pre-Christian civilizations. It is therefore necessary to look in such traditions and in their knowledge for the elements of the solution of the problems, that the recovery of those ideas today are going to raise. Every reference in more recent conceptions of man and life can only furnish us incomplete and often inadequate points of view.

Thus we must not be surprised that the problem of birth is remarkably obscure in the Christian vision of the world. For precise and certainly not arbitrary reasons, that we cannot discuss here, the Church had to reject the idea of pre-existence that earlier traditions had always recognized: that is, it has denied that the spiritual center of the personality pre-exists terrestrial birth and, certainly, even conception. In Christian theology, things in this regard are not as simple, as this denial can be believed. Nevertheless, the fundamental Christian view is that each human soul is unique and is created by God from nothing at the moment in which it is breathed into a body or human embryo ready to receive it. That a man is born into one race rather than another therefore becomes a theological mystery: "God willed it" and it is usually admitted that the divine will is inscrutable.

The view of ancient Aryan humanity was totally different and it alone can overcome the indicated objections. For a complete explanation, we must again remind the reader of our work Revolt against the Modern World. Recapping, here we limit ourselves to say that according to that

view, birth is never by chance, nor a fact willed by God; nor does fidelity in respect to one's own nature signify passivity, but rather it gives evidence to the more or less clear consciousness of a deep connection of one's own Self with something transcendent and otherworldly, to the extent of acting in a transfiguring way. This is the essence of the doctrines of karma and dharma, which must not be confused with the idea of reincarnation. As we have shown in other works, the theory of reincarnation is either a conception foreign to "Aryan spirituality, essentially characteristic of pre-aryan, telluric, matriarchal cycles of civilization, or it is the effect of misunderstandings and deformations that certain traditional views have undergone in some contemporary theosophical circles. And if, in the traditional world, even in the Aryan, seemingly clear evidence in favor of the belief in reincarnation, in reality, it is only about symbolic forms that a superior knowledge had to disguise in regard to the people and the uninitiated.

In any case, for the problem that concerns us here, it is necessary to refer, not to reincarnation, but to the doctrine that the human Self, as I having my own given nature, would be the effect, the production, the mode of appearance under certain conditions of existence, of a spiritual entity that preexists and transcends it. And since everything that is time, sooner or later, is just something inherent in the human condition, so strictly speaking we cannot speak of anything preexisting or antecedent in the temporal sense.

We are getting into a rather difficult field, precisely because conceptions and expressions cannot be applied to it that we are formed in the existence of this world and that, applied to a different reality, they can easily lead to distortions and deformations. We say, in any case, that It is necessary to discern a double heredity. What stands before the individual, in the temporal, non-transcendental sense, is the heredity of parents, the folk, the race, a certain civilization, caste, etc., therefore, more or less, everything that commonly is meant when speaking of heredity. But even

that does not exhaust the spiritual reality of the individual, as materialism and historicism claim: rather we must consider an intervention from above as determining and essential, a principle assuming and utilizing everything that this heredity has accumulated as its material of expression and incarnation, with its laws and its determinisms. Moreover, it must be thought that the historical and biological heredity of a given line is chosen and assumed when it can be approximately be considered as a kind of expressions analogous to transcendental heredity.

That is why two heredities meet and join each other in every being, the one terrestrial and historical, positively detectable to a great degree i.e., known to science (tr) , the other spiritual and otherworldly. To establish the connection between the two, and thereby determine the synthesis that defines a given human nature, an event intervenes, represented in various traditions with various symbols, which we cannot examine here. Basically, as noted, a type of law of elective affinity operates. In order to clarify with some applications, we can say that a man is not of a given gender, race, or caste because he is born that way by chance or through the will of God, or through a mechanism of natural causes, but vice versa. He was born that way because he already was a man or women, of one race or another, etc., naturally in an analogical sense in the sense of an inclination of a transcendent vocation or deliberation, which we, because of the lack of adequate concepts, can indicate only through its effects. In a certain way, we therefore have the interference of horizontal lines and vertical lines of an earthly heredity and an otherworldly. At the point of crossing, according to traditional teachings, birth occurs, or better said, the conception of a new being, an incarnation.

Race, caste, etc., therefore exist in spirit before manifesting in terrestrial and historical existence. Diversity has its origin from above, and what relates to it on earth is only a reflection and symbol. As you have willed to be, based on a primordial nature or a transcendental decision, so you are. It is not birth that determines nature, but vice versa; it is nature, in

its widest sense, because common words are inadequate, that determines birth.[4]

The Mystery of Birth Explained

> The general plane is unique, but divides itself in diverse parts, in a way that in everything there are distinct places, some more pleasant, others less so. And souls, also unequal, come to inhabit these distinct places that correspond to their own diversity. In such a way, everything is arranged and the differences in their situations correspond to the inequality of the souls.
>
> Plotinus

> It is not the demon that chooses you, but you yourself chose your demon. You yourself choose the destiny of that life to which you are irremediably connected.
>
> Plato

After the quotes from Plotinus and Plato, **Julius Evola** next discusses various supernatural beings from Tradition, which Evola accepts as real entities and essential for his ideas on spiritual races. However, there is no reason to restrict their influence to antiquity; they are present and fully active today.

> This expression "demon", from Plato is particularly interesting for us, since here the concept of demon has nothing to do with

[4] For further reading, see "The Doctrine of the Castes" in *Revolt against the modern World*, "Man and Woman" in *Revolt against the modern World*, *Life of the Spirit* (`https://gornahoor.net/?p=2163`), *Law of Attraction* (`https://gornahoor.net/?p=1664`).

> the Christian idea of a wicked entity, but instead has a close relation to the deepest forces of races, both of the soul and of the body. Even here, we cannot delve into the traditional doctrine in regards, but only to recall that, likewise, the demon, the lares, the penates, the "doppelganger" *doppio*, which is a synonym for "subtle body", are entities that in antiquity interfered in and reflected the precise knowledge of the true roots of the differentiation of bloodlines, *gentes*, and ultimately the individuals themselves on the basis of a totalitarian vision of the world, including the invisible and the visible, and not of that mutilation of the moderns who only know material and psychological processes. From such testimonies which could be multiplied with reference to the traditions of all peoples, the idea of transcendental, or vertical, heredity therefore is confirmed, and of the choice that on the base of analogous correspondences, determines the connection of it to a horizontal, historical, biological heredity. The consequences of all the in regards to the justification of the racial ideas are clearly visible.

Since we have already discussed the notions of Angels and Demons[5], we will move onto the other supernatural beings. The lares[6] are protecting spirits of dead ancestors. They kept watch over the affairs of the family. Many pious people today are aware of the watchful presence of their ancestors. In addition, there are lares to protect broader domains such as neighborhoods, cities, states, livestock, and so on. Obviously, we still know these spirits, but they are now called patron saints or guardian angels. The principalities are the guardian angels for the various nations and countries, as accepted by Muslims and Traditional Christians, as well as the ancient pagans.

The penates[7] more or less serve the same function as the lares. Since

[5] https://gornahoor.net/?p=2995

[6] https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lares

[7] https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Di_Penates

Evola accepts demons, lares, and penates as real beings, we should expect their presence to be made known, at least to those of the proper disposition and sensitivity. That they are called today the spirits of one's ancestors, patron saints, or angels makes no difference for their reality.

By "double"[8], doppio, or doppelganger, Evola means the subtle body, i.e., the soul. In ancient Egypt this was called Ka. In the *Ancient City*, **Fustel de Coulanges** describes the state of the soul after death, as related in Hindu, Greek, and Roman traditions. Since we have previously discussed this on several occasions, and in the future we want to compare it to the state of the souls in Limbo according to Dante, we will move on.

So it should be absolutely clear now what Evola means by the "third dimension" of history. The modern mind can only see material or historical processes, which correspond to gross and subtle manifestation. However, the vertical dimension includes a whole array of beings who are involved in the creation of nations, peoples, and individuals. The actions of these beings are invisible to the modern mind which can only attribute them to material and biological causes.

Given this, we are in a position to better understand the existence of man in the light of Tradition. As Evola points out, the difference between Essence and Existence is a matter of degree. Here we understand man's Essence as who he is in himself, his Spirit, his karma (what he carries into the world) and his dharma (his task or destiny in the world). His Existence, then, is the meeting of this Essence interacting with the horizontal forces at the proper time and space suitable to him, by the Law of Elective Affinity. This is not a bipolar process between Essence and Existence, but rather an emanation involving higher beings and influences. If you look at the diagram from *Spiritual Beings*[9], this process takes the being through the angelic influences which determine his race, nation, family, and so on, then through the astral and planetary influences, and

[8] https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Doppelg%C3%A4nger

[9] https://gornahoor.net/?p=1941

finally through the four elements. This is the birth of man in the vertical direction.

Posted on 2012-04-05 by Aeneas

* * *

Temenus on 2012-04-06 at 06:39 said:

The Plato quote is taken from RepubliC,Book 10, 617e. Here is an other translation of the whole passage that I found (I think that the translation of greek "daimon" as divinity and deity can be misleading) : 617e No divinity shall cast lots for you, but you shall choose your own deity. Let him to whom falls the first lot first select a life to which he shall cleave of necessity. But virtue has no master over her,and each shall have more or less of her as he honors her or does her despite. The blame is his who chooses: God is blameless. "So saying, the prophet flung the lots out among them all, and each took up the lot that fell by his side, except himself; him they did not permit.And whoever took up a lot saw plainly what number he had drawn."

http://www.perseus.tufts.edu/hopper/text?doc=plat.+rep.+10.617e

golgonooza on 2012-04-09 at 15:39 said:

In 'Lazarus, Come Forth' Valentin Tomberg discusses the second miracle of John's Gospel, the healing of the nobleman's son, and the sixth day of creation in terms of two types of heredity – 'vertical' and 'horizontal'. The Fall is seen by him as the substituting of the vertical heredity of creation in image and likeness of God for the horizontal heredity of ancestral traits, original sin etc. The healing of the nobleman's son placed him into direct relationship with Christ allowing the heredity of the father to be subsumed into the 'vertical' relationship. This seemed to me to be very similar to what Evola is saying here – am I right?

Cologero on 2012-04-09 at 17:46 said:

Thanks for reminding me of that passage. Yes, it is the same understanding although Evola would avoid using the words "God" or "Christ". Of course, Tomberg is drawing on the same tradition as Evola from Hermes to Plotinus. However, Evola is too polemical and eager to see differences, where Tomberg and Guido de Giorgio see continuity and a deeper development.

Logres on 2012-04-09 at 22:56 said:

Ortega y Gasset cites the Chinese custom of worthy deeds ennobling the ancestor. Transferred to a spiritual plane (vertical plane), is this also the same thought?

Angolmois on 2012-04-28 at 13:55 said:

Ancestors and God should be brought together in one's worship, not to separate them, but of course the Divine, the vertical should have a pre-eminence. (For the record, I'm not implying that this would be recommended here, just mentioning it.)

What is the most presumptuous and hypocritical comment one hears alot in favouring multio-racialism and multi-culturalism nowadays is that Aryans and Non-Aryans come in all colours and nationalities. This has never been in doubt anywhere in world's traditions, but somehow these modern idiot's seem to think they're wiser and that all the world Aryans should mix with each other everywhere and then we'd have the grey-black-brown globalist utopia they hunger for. Spit and shame on them.

Cologero on 2012-04-28 at 17:37 said:

Angolmois, I think you mean that as the One is manifested, it becomes more and more differentiated, not less. The modern mind, denying the supernatural *de facto*, even if they confess the opposite, believes instead that the One must appear on the material plane. Hence, they deny all differentiation and hierarchy in the face of all evidence.

40,000 Norwegians singing together a communist inspired song for peace changes nothing. Moltke said: "universal peace is only a dream, and not even a beautiful dream."

There are still some who are willing to combat; they may even have an inkling of their enemy (the negative pole). But they will not be effective unless they know precisely what they are fighting for (the positive pole).

Angolmois on 2012-04-29 at 03:08 said:

Yes, that is what I meant with my comment. The differentiation of the divine and its multiple manifestations in the form of different races, colours etc. should and could be a compliment for representatives of different races, nationalities and traditions – separate yet unified – but instead the modernists have made it an insult with their dis-honesty and linguistic / semantic plays. For example, "a negro" is a four letter curse word nowadays, whereas it was a compliment and a honorary title for the representatives of their race before. It has nothing to do with "hate speech" or anything like that for sure.

Timotheus Lutz on 2013-01-08 at 22:52 said:

Evola wrote: 'In a certain way, one has therefore the interference of horizontal lines and vertical lines of an earthly heredity and non-earthly.'

I wonder if Francis Parker Yockey, noted American Axis-sympathizer, read and was influenced by the Synthesis. The characterization of spiritual and physical race as horizontal and vertical appeared in his book Imperium, although if I'm remembering right, the words were switched.

4.8 Men of Destiny

Remembering oneself, discovering the true will, following one's Dharma, can all be summarized by the ancient call to *know thyself*. This is what defies every attempt to define or limit Tradition. It is not a question of reading the next book, knowing about Etruscan fertility goddesses, or adopting the very next craze. It is irrelevant to a debate about which religion is traditional or not. It is not about adhering to any particular political program. Tradition is not reducible to a formula.

There are very specific spiritual states: detachment, a calm mind, mental strength, or a feeling of deep-rooted security. That is the only standard and the necessary pre-condition to understand Tradition in any meaningful sense. If you are anxious, if your mind is scattered, if you react emotionally, then you need to follow some spiritual practice that will lead to such the state of awareness he describes. Becoming a pagan, or Buddhist, or Hindu, or thelemite is insufficient in itself, and those who convert often reveal a disheveled, superficial mind. **Julius Evola** explains:

> Yet that is not enough. It is not by chance that the formula, "know thyself", which, in its deepest meaning, refers exactly to such teachings, was itself written on the Delphic temple of Apollo, i.e., the Hyperborean God[10]. Letting such traditional truths act on oneself, until they awaken precise interior forces, means to proceed along the way that leads to a spiritual level at which the meaning of life constitutes something absolutely different from what the rest of men think: a sense of clarity, of absolute strength, of incomparable security.
>
> But to have an inkling of all that, to glimpse a "character" in whom a type of indomitability is united to the feeling of detachment of "those who are joined from afar" and to an interior inaccessibility; in whom, therefore, there is simultaneously a superior

[10] `https://gornahoor.net/Hyperborean.htm`

> calm, an aloofness, and a readiness to attack, to command, to absolute action—to have demonstrated this "character", means also to have foreshadowed the mystery of the primordial Nordic race, or Hyperborean race, as the race of the spirit. Such is in fact the olympian and solar mode of being; the popular imagination refers to them today as the so-called "men of destiny" and yesterday referred to them as the vanished types of great leaders—in reality, in that it is now about the last echoes or flashing of what was characteristic, in general, of the great Hyperborean super race, before its dispersion and alteration. One remembers Plutarch's expression about the members of the ancient Roman Senate: "They sit like a council of kings."
>
> Hence, a further consequence: if a civilization of the "classical" type, in the olympian and virile sense, not in the vulgar aesthetic and formulaic sense, reflects something of the Nordic race of the spirit, every romantic and "tragic" civilization, as opposed to it, will instead be the certain mark of the prevalence of the earlier influence by races and ethnic residues of a non-Nordic, pre-Aryan and anti-Aryan nature.

Despite all the talk about the Law of Cycles, it is poorly understood. It means that the material and historical circumstances have deteriorated to a certain level. By the Law of Elective Affinity, certain spirits will be attracted to that world and will feel very natural in it. Coincidentally, as the Wheel turns ever so slightly[11] to begin the next cycle, there will be attracted a smaller group. Their task is to be the spiritual elite for the next cycle, the men of destiny. To do so, these men will have to make special efforts to remember, to recall the distant past, to truly know themselves. Those who recall their Past will create the Future of Tradition.

Posted on 2012-04-12 by Cologero

[11] `https://gornahoor.net/images/circlespirito.jpg`

* * *

Cologero on 2012-04-17 at 17:37 said:

The few readers who take this seriously may be interested in comparing this passage from *The Consolations of Philosophy*. Here, Sophia is speaking to Boethius:

> Now I know the other cause, or rather the major cause of your illness: **you have forgotten your true nature**. And so I have found out in full the reason for your sickness and the way to approach the task of restoring you to health. It is because you are confused by loss of memory that you wept and claimed you you had been banished and robbed of all your possessions. And it is because you don't know the end and purpose of things that you think the wicked and the criminal have power and happiness. And because you have forgotten the means by which the world is governed you believe these ups and downs of fortune happen haphazardly. These are grave causes and they lead not only to illness but even death. Thanks, however, to the Author of all health, nature had not quite abandoned you. In your true belief about the world government–that it is subject to divine reason and not the haphazards of change–there lies our greatest hope of rekindling your health.

4.9 The Demonic Element in the Anti-Race

In this chapter from *Sintesi di dottrina della razza*, **Julius Evola** takes up the question of the mismatch between one's spiritual and biological race. It is hopeless to understand what Evola is saying in normal terms. "Race", for him, is a spiritual quality that seeks to be manifested. However, there are other forces in play that may impede this process. In this regard, and also in terms of the differences of historical periods, he is closer to a Rudolf Steiner than to more conventional views. Here he admits the existence of demonic spirits.

In relation to that, and to complete the argument, it is time to consider the following. As a follow-up to the preceding objection we could call attention back to the fact that, in reality, the types at this point are not

so differentiated, to be able to establish that aforesaid principle of fidelity to oneself; in the second place, the doctrine in question does not seem to give any explanation of the fact there exist types that are dilacerated and affected by serious conflicts, so much so that not all are "their own type" and not all feel themselves to be "in their own home".

On the basis of the general principle that everything that appears here is the analogical reflection of a reality existing above; in order to explain such cases one must think of everything that the aforesaid freedom of the individual without roots can do and likewise of the action of special historical conditions and social collectives; but above all, one should suppose, for such cases, some corresponding prenatal circumstances. Close to the central force that led to a given human manifestation, lesser and divergent forces can also have influences which, nevertheless, precisely because they are weaker, were, in a manner of speaking, overwhelmed and led to create expressions corresponding to elements of a unfavorable and discordant, biologico-historical, "horizontal" heredity.

The cases in which the "race of the soul" and the "inner vocation" do not correspond to the race of the body, such as those of every romantic laceration, in the final analysis, are to be explained in such a way from the metaphysical point of view. Even modern psychology knows, at this point, about so called "split personalities". And the more the minor forces diverge from the central direction, the more we will have, as the effect, men in whom the physical is not in accord with the soul, in whom the spirit contrasts with the body and the soul, whose vocation does not correspond to race or caste, the "personality" is in disagreement with tradition, and so on.

In similar cases, "classical" ethics, shaped by the ancient Nordic-Aryan norm of life, evident in a still more distinct way in its active and creative aspect, because it requires that the various divergent elements of these natures must obey a single, iron law on the basis of an inner decision, that cannot fail in the face of a negative example: and, as we will see, activist

race theory must arouse precisely such a decision in the greatest number of individuals of a nation, as the base for all the rest. To exalt the romantic instead, the tragic, anxious soul, always in search of new "truths", is essentially something from a civilization sick and damaged in its race. Calmness, style, clarity, command, discipline, power and the Olympic spirit are instead the points of reference for every formation of character and life in the Nordic-Aryan sense.

But if even in the world of causes and metaphysical meanings we must presume the existence of natures and vocations manifesting a diverse degree of unitariness, we must also think that not all civilizations, and not all periods, offer the same possibilities of incarnation and expression to any of the forces that tend to an earthly form of existence. It is said that in every birth two different heredities interfere. The earthly and the historical gather, in a type of bond, certain biological, anthropological, and in part even psychological elements, a tradition, eventually also a caste, a given point in time and place in space, etc. Now, there are civilizations in which everything "is in order", so to say, in which life, at its maximum, develops around a great unity and organicity of all these elements of "horizontal" heredity. Other civilizations are instead characterized by individualism, anarchy, the destruction of every limit, and every difference deriving from race, blood, caste, tradition, nationality. From what was said about the law of elective affinity and analogous correspondences that act in birth, obviously the civilizations of the former type are those that, in order to offer them circumstances and possibilities of adequate expression, attract unitary natures and pure and decisive forces. The chaotic civilizations of the latter type, for the same reason, will become instead, so to speak, the "exact place", or the meeting place on earth, of every "otherworldly hysteric".

This curious expression is the least alarming that one can use to give the meaning of the thing. In fact, on the metaphysical plane, hysteria, the internal contradiction, can appear only as the quality of those be-

ings, "who say no to being", to a greater or lesser measure. But such a quality is exactly that which Christian theology attributes to "demonic" forces — now meant in the current sense of the term or to the "creatures of chaos", the will to incarnation of those, wherever situations arise that, for analogous reasons, evoke them, have thus a meaning as precise as it is alarming, that cannot be developed here. Typology, physiognomy, a type of transcendental psychology in the whole of a race theory examination of the first and second degree applied to the most typical figures of revolutionary and still outer, popular leaders of the frontlines of worldwide subversion, both political-social as well as cultural and spiritual, could lead, in this regard, to some impressive results.

We are not saying however that such chaotic civilizations accommodate these forces exclusively: unitary natures in themselves can also arise, which however will be particularly at a disadvantage and, in order to hold firm and keep faithful to a vocation, which in such cases often has the sense of a true mission, are condemned to dissipate a quantity of energy to face the conflicts between soul and body, race and character, inner dignity and rank, etc., that are typical of such civilizations and that the make them, in a normal way, the homeland of all other vocations. But in these cases it is necessary not to forget **Seneca**'s words, who correctly understood some unhappy circumstances in which a higher spirit can find himself involved in the discomforts and dangers to which he is exposed, or who is in a risky mission or in the line of combat: the most courageous and worthy are chosen for such tasks, while the cowardly and weak can be left to the "comfortable life".

It is not necessary, in any case, to emphasize the importance that the preceding considerations, although unusual for the common mentality of modern man, have for the racial idea and, in general, for the philosophy of civilization, once these exceptional cases are put aside. If a destiny of millennia has led the West to circumstances in which it would be difficult to still find something truly pure, intact, differentiated and traditional,

to establish firm limits again, by any means, even with the harshest, is an endeavor whose beneficial effects perhaps at first sight may not be perceptible to everyone, but that nevertheless will not be found lacking in subsequent generations, through the effect of the secret way joining the visible with the invisible and the world with the "superworld".

Posted on 2014-03-19 by Aeneas

* * *

andrew on 2014-03-23 at 17:40 said:

Although I do not understand all of what is being said, nevertheless it touches me. I would appreciate some practical guidance on what can be done by those who do not feel themselves to be "in their own home".

4.10 The Solar and the Demetrian Races

> **Julius Evola** begins his discussion of the spiritual races in his *Sintesi di dottrina della razza* with the Solar and Demetrian races. He gives and almost Heideggerian take on the *avidya* teaching of the Vedanta. To recast it in these terms: The Hyperborean experiences a feeling of homelessness, arising from the ignorance or forgetfulness of Being, and finds himself thrown among beings.
>
> This homeland, from the North, should be understand in a metaphysical, rather than a temporal, sense. Evola repeats the error we pointed out about the ritual between the priest and the king as described in the Brahmanas. Certainly the priesthood can decay (or has decayed) into a lunar type, but are (or were) there not sages or wizards with the solar powers described?

In order to move onto something more specific, we will say that the doctrine of the third degrees of race must essentially limit its researches to the sphere of influence of a given race of the spirit and of its primordial

tradition, following its developments, the mutations (paravariations) and also the distortions in the cycle that coincides with them and in which they act and react in the confrontation with the influences of different races or new environmental conditions. Once research is circumscribed that way, we arrive at a more limited concept of race, corresponding to that of the various differentiations or articulations of the primary element of such a cycle. It is natural that likewise we cannot think of an atomic separation of the various "races of the spirit": their differences are not such as to exclude relationships not only of derivation, but even of different hierarchical rank.

We already outlined the typology of races of the spirit, as far as it concerns the specific human cycle of the hyperborean race, in the second part of our work *Revolt against the Modern World* (with special regard to the properly traditional and spiritual aspect), both in the choice of the writings of J. J. Bachofen, and in the related interpretation of them in a racial sense, as understood in the previously mentioned volume we edited under the title *La razza solare*. For a fuller treatment, the reader is therefore referred back to these two works. Here we will give only a brief schematic synthesis, necessarily lacking any justifying elements.

The solar or Olympic-solar race, corresponding to the hyperborean lineage and tradition, is to be considered superior and anterior to all the others in the cycle in question. It has as characteristic a type of "natural supernaturality"; spirit and power, calm dominance, and readiness for precise and absolute action, a sense of "centrality" and of "unshakeability", and in its exterior effects, that virtue to which the ancients attributed a "numinous" quality (from *numen*), as superiority that imposes itself directly and irresistibly, that awakens simultaneously both terror and veneration, are marks of this "race of the spirit", by means of which it is naturally predestined to command and, at the limit, to the regal function. Fire and ice are united in it as in the vague symbols of the original Nordic homeland and of the cycle in which it is eminently and primor-

dially manifested: ice, as transcendence and inaccessibility; fire, as the radiant specifically solar quality of the beings who give, who awaken life, and generate light, but always from a supreme distance and almost with indifference, as in the wake of a boat, not through zeal, inclination, or human concern.

The ancient symbol of gold always had connections with this form of spirituality. In the political forms of the origins, it acted as the substrate to sacred, or divine, regality, i.e., to the union of the two powers, of the regal and priestly function, the latter understood in a higher sense that will soon be made clear. The symbolic designations of the "divine" or "celestial" race for it must refer to the absence of the dualistic sentiment in relations to supernatural reality, something that however is quite distinct from everything that, in the modern sense, is immanence or Promethean velleity: it is not about men who believe they are gods, but of types who naturally, through a still not dim memory of origins and a condition of soul and body that do not cripple such a memory, feel they do not properly belong to the terrestrial race, to the extent of believing themselves men only by accident, or through "ignorance", or "sleep". The two terms *vidya* and *avidya* of the ancient Indo-Aryan teaching, that mean respectively "knowledge" (of the "supreme identity") and "ignorance" (that leads to the self-identification with one of the forms or modes of being of the conditioned world), are to be understood exactly in this connection: when these are applied to a different human condition and a different race of the spirit, that is, when turned into "philosophical" terms, they lose every meaning and give rise to misunderstandings of various types.

The most recent "spiritual races" of the cycle, to which our contemporaries also belong, have as a prerequisite a division and a separation of the two elements of "spirituality" and "virility"—and also "transcendence" and "humanity"—that are synthetically reunited in the solar race. First of all, let's specify the lunar race or demterian race. According to the analogous relation, while the solar element is that which has in itself its own

light and, in general, its own principle, the sun being, in such regard, the center of a given planetary system, the lunar element is that which instead receives or draws from another its light and principle. In the lunar race the sense of spiritual centrality is therefore lost, or through degeneration (the moon as the sun extinguished), or through passive crossbreeding with races of other cycles, of the "telluric" type, that have degraded its originary solar quality. The moon, as Bachofen points out, was also called the "celestial earth" by the ancients. There is therefore a sublimation of the law of the earth, the fate that is disclosed under the types of cosmic harmony and natural law: man here no longer feels himself the active center of spiritual reality: he is not this same reality, but rather the one who contemplates it, who studies its laws, who surpasses material action with contemplation and "tellurism", but still does not reach spiritual action. The adjective "demetrian", that we likewise give to this race, refers to a spirituality of a diffused, pantheistic, less dominating character that is pervaded by the sense of cosmic naturalistic laws and by a sacredness placed essentially under the feminine sign: spirituality that was precisely typical of the ancient demetrian cults. By extension, the priestly man is lunar in opposition to the regal man, he is the man who in the face of the spirit behaves as a normal woman facing a man, i.e., with a sense of submission and devotion. It is then interesting to note that the ancient traditions associated what today would be called cerebrality or intellectuality with the moon, labeling instead the heart with the sun and referring higher form of consciousness to this. The lunar type is in fact also intellectual, the man of passive reflection who, as the word says it, moves only among "reflections", among shadows of ideas and of things.

Therefore the characteristics of the lunar race are varied. In the political camp, wherever a division between the temporal and priestly powers is perceived, the lunar spirit inevitably arises. The lunar is the dominator who receives the supreme consecration of its power from the other, from a distinct priestly caste, which it does not give it to itself. In gen-

eral, the lunar man has spiritually feminine traits. He lacks the feeling of centrality. In correspondence to the races of the body, he has the predominant nature of the demetrian race which is of the stock we called Atlantic-Occidental, in its prehistoric forms that lead us, e.g., up to the Pelasgic, Minoan-Mycenaean, or Etruscan civilization and to its last revival, among which Pythagoreanism returns. Such a race represents a decay of the hyperborean spirituality which appeared suddenly in the regions of Atlantis through processes of action and reaction, causing a series of other changes. Lunar elements can moreover be observed in the race of the man of the East (Alpine-Oriental) by some racialists—the psycho-anthropology of Claus designates this race as the "race of evasion" — *der Enthebungsmenschen* — something that corresponds visibly to a characteristic of the lunar man.

Posted on 2014-03-26 by Aeneas

4.11 Race and Death

In this short segment on death and race from *Sintesi di dottrina della razza*, **Julius Evola** returns to traditional doctrines. As expected, he makes clear that personality transcends race, i.e., the person creates race, but the race does not create the person. That is because the person transcends his material and biological conditioning, and has a dual destiny. On the material plane, he continues the race with his first-born son, the "son of duty". Yet he also has a supernatural destiny. Hence, at a certain stage of life, a man may abandon, after having fulfilled them, his family duties and dedicate himself to that spiritual destiny.

He condemns biological racism as "telluric", since it is restricted to the material conditions of life. Furthermore, such views are associated with the denial of an afterlife. This is the path of darkness, the southern path, unlike the path of light, or northern path,

> described by Evola. His last line is quite harsh: " they pass onto others the task for which they were inadequate."
>
> Those commenters who would dismiss us as just another "traditionalist" site saying the same things, are not very careful readers (as already has been demonstrated). On the contrary, few such sites adhere to traditional principles and promote lifestyles in conformity to Tradition, as this chapter demonstrates.

On the strength of what should be clear at this point, we would like to pause a moment to make precise the limits of the membership of personality to its race. In this regard, we will immediately point out the view that is unacceptable from the traditional perspective: it is the view of those who have conceived race as a purely biological-human, historical, and, to sum it up, only a terrestrial entity, and who now think that such an entity is the goal of every being who belongs to it, that nothing exists superior to race, since race is the origin of every value and they consider that the idea of the extraterrestrial attainment and purpose of the individual is illusory and detrimental: "to remain faithful to land and race."

We have already encountered and criticized this conception more than once. Opposed to it, moreover, we can appeal to the racialist criterion for the evaluation of the "truth"; according to the various "races of the spirit" there are, in a particular way, similar conceptions of race itself—and there is no doubt that the conception we just pointed out can be "true" only for a telluric race, only the telluric man is able to support unconditionally such limited horizons. Furthermore in this telluric vision of race the assumption, that we have sketched out, of those "neopagan" racialists also comes into play, since for them the only conceivable immortality would be that of the survival in the blood, in terrestrial descendants.

It is true that similar positions, today, are presented to us less on the basis of a theoretical value than of a practical and political value—i.e.,

they seek to consolidate the unity of the race of the people and to concentrate every spiritual energy of the individual into temporal and historical tasks that this entity has to resolve. But it is likewise true that the ancient Aryan civilizations, even with respect to terrestrial, heroic, and political achievements, had their greatness without feeling the need to appeal to these myths, recognizing instead rather different truths; it is quite evident, in fact, that this view about race recalls the *pitryana*, the "way of the South", which we previously mentioned, which is opposed the *devayana*, the "divine way of the North", that stood alone as defining the highest Aryan ideal.

And the theory of "double hereditary" is also related to such an ideal. Personality is not fully accounted for in historical-biological or horizontal heredity: instead, it appears as a principle that, in order to manifest itself in race (race meant here in the restricted sense), stands in itself beyond race but cannot be exhausted in it. To recognize race—as has been made clear on principle—does not mean to diminish the personality: personality owes the living and articulated material for its specific expression to race and to as much as terrestrial heredity includes, through its self-manifestation and action. However, there is a conditioning that is neither passive nor one-sided in that. Every individual also reacts on race and his heredity, on the basis of his own most intimate nature; he develops the substance in which he is manifested, the form beyond, and it is in that way that interracial differentiation and that diverse purity or completeness of types are realized, things which we already mentioned and to which we will now return, with regard to its social effects: here it is a giving as much as a receiving. At the points where the highest equilibrium and adaptation are reached (equilibrium, according to our tripartite view spirit, soul, body , between the various component of the true race), there is as a culmination beyond which the personality has nowhere to go—it has nowhere to go along a horizontal or earthly line. His work remains and belongs along this line and his child is physiologically his lineage. But

personality itself, if it reached such a peak, is "free" and can approach a perfection that is now properly supernatural.

This is precisely the most ancient Aryan conception, pertaining to those who do not belong properly to the group of spiritual leaders, conceptions that can also be found in the various views and legends of the Western Middle Ages. The scrupulous observance of the earthly laws of race, caste, etc. is prescribed, i.e., *dharma*, to the point of complete compliance. Such laws also require the assurance of a lineage: life, which is received at birth, must be given back before death, with its own mark, to another being, and it is for this reason that the firstborn son is called the "son of duty". After the "active life", according to Aryan law, one can retire to an ascetic-contemplative life. And the Iranian-Aryan saying is rather expressive: the true task is not only to first procreate oneself on the horizontal line of terrestrial descendants, but also upwards, in the ascending vertical direction. In Western religion all these views were confused—above all, what is pertinent to the active life was sharply disconnected from the contemplative life and almost always the truly traditional solutions were forgotten, according to which the law, which is not of this earth, prolongs, completes, and strengthens the law of the earth. But even more harmful than such confusions are the "telluric" racist views alluded to, in case they should be taken seriously and have a future. According to the traditional teaching of the Aryan peoples, the idea instead became fixed that the destiny and the dignity of the personality is essentially supernatural; this goal, however, acts as the highest motor impulse and the deepest animating force at the heart of the expression that race gives to the personality, therefore simultaneously raises race up to a limit, beyond which, after having left a sign of greatness, the same force is liberated and tends to act so that death is precisely the fulfillment—*telos*—a new birth—the third birth of the Indo-Aryan teaching.

Only the mediocre or failures among beings, i.e., those who are unable to completely fulfill the law and earthly duty, who perhaps think

that they do not have an afterlife, that they have for their destiny, the self-dissolution into the confused vitality of race, into the collective and terrestrial substance of blood and heredity, surviving only in that way—in a rather relative sense of the word—to the destruction of their physical individuality, and passing onto others the task for which they were inadequate.

Posted on 2014-03-30 by Aeneas

4.12 The Group of Aryan Races

In this section from *Sintesi di dottrina della razza*, **Julius Evola** describes the third migration from the Hyperborean regions. This was the incursion of the Germanic tribes into the Roman Empire. He points out that they were a degenerate remnant, and were unable to continue the civilization of the Roman Empire. It took several centuries for European civilization to reemerge, beginning with **Charlemagne**.

Evola then sketches out the various branches that followed from the Hyperborean migrations. As we see, his understanding of "race" is more in line with the UNESCO understanding of a race as an "ethnic group". As such, the Hyperboreans, or "Aryans", include the inhabitants of the Indian sub-continent, ancient Egyptians, Persians, and even Amerindians and Eskimos.

By "race of the first level", Evola refers to the race of the body, which is how most people conceive race. Of course, there are also two higher levels: the race of the soul and the race of the spirit. He rejects so-called "scientific" racism, since it deals strictly with the race of the body. For Evola, genetics cannot explain the soul and spirit of the various races.

As justification, he refers to the philosopher Emile Boutroux[12],

[12] https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/%C3%89mile_Boutroux

who denies that even the physical world is deterministic. This type of philosophizing is virtually unknown today, but was a dominant perspective among French and Italian philosophers at the time.

A fortiori, man, as a free spirit, can hardly be fixed and determined by his body or genetic makeup, despite certain tendencies or habits. Any attempt by "science" to "fix" a given race to predetermined characteristics or behaviors is ultimately deleterious.

The most recent of all is the emigration of the third voyage which followed the north-south direction. Some Nordic lineages had previously traversed this direction in prehistoric times; they are those, for example, who gave rise to the Doric-Achaean civilization and brought the cult of the Hyperborean Apollo to Greece. The last wave was that of the so-called "migration of the people" which happened at the fall of the Roman Empire and corresponds to the race of the Nordic-Germanic type. In this respect, we must make a very important observation. Those races that spread in the north-south direction descend more directly from the Hyperborean lineage who last left the Arctic regions. For that reason, they often display, from the viewpoint of the race of the body, a greater purity and conformity to the original type, having had fewer possibilities of encountering different races. The same however cannot be said from the viewpoint of their inner race and traditions. Their self-maintenance, further from the sister races, in the conditions of a climate which had become particularly harsh and unfavorable could cause in them a certain materialization, a one-sided development of certain physical qualities and especially of character, courage, resistance, tenacity and inventiveness, having, however as its counterpart, an atrophy of the truly spiritual side.

That is seen previously among the Spartans: to a greater extent, however, in the Germanic peoples of the invasions that we may continue to call "barbaric"; barbaric, however, not in relation to degenerate Roman civilization, in which those people appeared, but in relation to a higher stage, from which those races had fallen by that point. Among the proofs

of such an interior degeneration, or spiritual darkening, is the relative facility with which such races converted to Christianity and then to Protestantism. For that reason, the Germanic peoples in the first centuries after the fall of the Western Roman Empire, up to Charlemagne, were unable to oppose anything of importance in the spiritual domain to the crepuscular forms of Romanity. They were enchanted by the exterior splendor of such forms and easily fell victim to Byzantinism, they were unable to reanimate much of Nordic-Aryan existence, in spite of everything, in the Mediterranean world, that by means of a faith corrupted, in more than one aspect, by Semitic-Southern racial influences as soon as they later on gave form to the Holy Roman Empire under the Catholic sign.

Thus even some of the German racial theorists, like Gunther, had to recognize that, while trying to reconstruct the vision of the world and the type of spirituality characteristic of the Nordic race, had to refer less to the testimony included in the traditions of the Germanic peoples of the period of the invasions – fragmentary testimonies, often altered by foreign or decadent influences in the form of popular superstitions or folklore – than to the superior spiritual forms characteristic of ancient Rome, ancient Greece, Persia, and India, i.e., of the civilizations derived from the two first waves.

For the combination of the races and traditions generated by these three currents, the first transverse (Ario-Nordic lineage), the next horizontal (Nordic-Atlantic or Nordic-Occidental lineage), the last vertical (the Ario-Germanic lineage) we can apply, not so much for true conformity, but rather on the basis of a usage that has become current, the term "Aryan". In order to take into consideration the races defined by the most noted and recognized of racial theories of the first level, we can say that the trunk of the Aryan race, having at its root the primordial Hyperborean race, is differentiated in the following way. There is first of all, as the blond race, the branch called Nordic in the strict sense, that some differentiate into Teutonic-Nordic, Dalic-Falic, and Finno-Nordic sub-

branches. The same lineage in its mixing with the aboriginal Sarmatian populations then gave rise to the so-called East-Europid and East-Baltic types. All these human groups, from the point of view of the race of the body, as was noted, preserve great fidelity or purity in respect to what can be presumed to have been the primordial Nordic, or Hyperborean, type.

In the second place, we must consider the races that are most different in relation to the original type, whether in the sense of its phenotype, or form, which the same dispositions and the same hereditary genes caused under the action of a different environment, or of mix-mutations, i.e., mutations produced by more accentuated mixing. It is a matter of predominantly brown types, of smaller stature, in which the dolicephalous is not the rule or is not too pronounced. We mention, using the terminology that is more in vogue, the so-called race of the man of the west, the Atlantic race that, as Fischer defined, is already different from it, then the Mediterranean race, from which, in its turn according to Peters, the variety of the Euro-African man, or African-Mediterranean is distinguished, where the dark component has greater prominence. Sergi's classification, according to whom these last two types more or less coincide, must be rejected and, from the point of view of practical racial theory, especially the Italian, is among the most dangerous. Equally dubious is calling the Mediterranean race, as Peters does, the Pelasgic: in conformity with the meaning that the word had in Greek civilization, it is necessary to consider the Pelasgic type, in a certain way, in itself, especially in terms of the result of a degeneration of some very ancient Atlantic-Aryan stocks established in the Mediterranean before the appearance of the Hellenes. Particularly, from the point of view of the race of the soul, this meaning of the "Pelasgics" is justified, among whom the ancient Etruscan people also are included.

In a certain way by itself is the Dinaric race because while it is very close to the Nordic type in certain aspects, in others it shows characteristics in common with the Armenoid and desert race and, like that which

some racial theorists define properly as the Alpine or the Vosgic race, is prevalently shown brachycephalous: the sign of crossing that happened along other directions. The Aryan race of the east has, again, distinct characteristics, both physical and mental, through which it is distanced substantially from the Nordic type.

There is nothing contradictory, from the traditional point of view, in assuming in the doctrine of race of the first level the clarifications that the various authors make in relation to the physical and, in part, mental, characteristics of all these branches of Aryan humanity. Only it is not necessary to create too many illusions on the importance of all that, in the sense of establishing rigid limits. Thus, although neither white nor blonde, the superior races of Iran and India, and, although not white, many ancient Egyptian types can moreover be included in the Aryan family. Not only: authors like Wirth and Kadner, who sought to utilize recent studies on blood groups for racial research, were led to believe that some North American Amerindian and Eskimo stocks were closer to the primordial Nordic type, than the greater part of the Indo-European Aryan races just noted. And in this kind of investigations, for example, it indicates moreover that the primordial Nordic blood in Italy has a percentage close to that of England, and certainly higher than that of the Germanic peoples. It is therefore necessary to not be fixated on rigid schemas and to think that, except for rather rare cases, the "form" of the original super-race, more or less latent, obstructed, overpowered, or exhausted, subsists in the depths of all these human types. Under certain conditions, it can reappear as predominant and shape a given type from itself, which proves them equivalent, even where it is least suspected, that is, where the previous races according to the schematic and static conception of race, would have instead made the appearance of a type of race, let us suppose, Mediterranean, Indo-Afghani, or Baltic-Oriental, seem probable.

Emile Boutroux, in one of his classic works *On the contingency of*

the laws of nature has compared the regularity of phenomena that permits relatively exact scientific predictions, to the course of a river, whose waters follow a riverbed that however it itself hallowed out, so that they can modify it and in exceptional circumstances even abandon it. He considered natural laws as a sort of "habit" of things: what originally was also able to be a free act, in repeating itself, automatizes and mechanizes itself and ends up appearing to be a necessity. If that is valid for the laws of so-called inanimate, physical nature, it is of greater validity in respect to races. The proper description of racial theory of the first level, that, in certain authors, leads up to distinctions of an almost scholastic pedantry, fits in the measure to which the forces of races, so to speak, follow a type of law of inertia that automatizes them and fixes them in the state in which, at a given moment, they find themselves being. In these conditions the models drawn for each of the Aryan race fit, determinisms are verified, and sciences observe. At the moment in which the most original forces begin to advance, these constructions demonstrate their relativity and an excessive attention conceded to racial theories of the first level and its "scientific" results can even end up bringing damage to the creative and evocative task of race theory.

Posted on 2015-04-15 by Aeneas

* * *

Mark Citadel on 2015-04-15 at 09:47 said:

Often with these writings on the Hyperborean Race and its various branches, I feel the need to break everything up and draw diagrams. The run-on sentences get a little too hard to follow. Its one of the troubles I had with a few of Evola's chapters. Excuse me while I go and decipher what is no doubt enlightening information that there is no way I comprehended with just one read.

Aeneas on 2015-04-15 at 12:43 said:

Please let us know of the most confusing passages. Evola does not write very pretty Italian. We've already had to break up several longer sentences into shorter ones in the translation, but perhaps that was not enough.

Bill on 2015-04-15 at 13:34 said:

Wouldn't it be more accurate to say that Evola doesn't reject scientific racism, but recognizes it as subordinate to the higher aspects of race?

Aeneas on 2015-04-15 at 17:05 said:

Bill, if you can provide some exact quotes to support your "more accurate" understanding, then we can discuss. But first of all, you'll have to explain what you mean by "subordinate". You may also want to comment on the paragraph about Emile Boutroux.

obscure on 2015-04-15 at 20:38 said:

Let us just say that the distinction between 'phenotype' and 'genotype' is, from the highest point of view, superficial since both 'types' are phenomenal. The gene is just as much a symbol as the facial structure, but it possesses a certain technical value with regard to material analysis and the overall program of techno-science. If one starts from this point of view, the real discourse begins with this question: What is the intelligible essence 'behind' the symbol? In other words, how does one really 'substantiate' the phenomena?

The materialistic racist errs especially in his individualistic viewpoint. For individuals are always understood within some holistic structure. I couldn't study a race unless I studied them as a nation and not just a nation constituted in terms of 'culture' (or what the anthropologists mean by 'culture'), but in spiritual terms. Ultimately, this leads to the understanding of a people as a spiritual corporation. If one goes far in this direction then the type of 'evolutionary psychology' which amazes the multitude and the cliques will be seen in its full vapidity. But, to take such an intellectual path requires a certain individual decision which is not in the least bit suitable for all.

Mike on 2015-04-15 at 21:06 said:

Thank you so much for this.

Since you were kind enough to offer some clarifications, I am having a difficult time with this passage:

"... that proves the corresponding even where it is least suspected, that is, where the antecedent, according to the schematic and static conception of race, would have made instead the appearance of a type of race, let us suppose, Mediterranean, Indo-Afghani, or Baltic-Oriental, seem probable."

What is the "corresponding" and the "antecedent" that Evola is referring to?

And so I know I'm on the right track, in the first half of this passage (sentence), Evola is stating that for Aryans, a return to exact Hyperborean form (race of the second and third levels)

is impossible to them, since they have all, to varying degrees, parted from the Hyperboreans in terms of race of the first level. Am I correct in this understanding?

obscure on 2015-04-15 at 22:00 said:

And to Cologero,

Thank you for publishing all of these items.

Aeneas on 2015-04-16 at 00:09 said:

Mike, I tried to clarify that passage a little bit with a re-translation. Curiously, that entire passage is missing from the German translation and replaced with a totally different one.

I believe he is saying the opposite: specifically, the qualities of the original race can reappear, often unexpectedly. We are all trying to pull too much out of one section. Evola will discuss Mendelian genetics (whose scientific validity he doesn't deny) as well the the problems with crossings, and so on.

Mark Citadel on 2015-04-16 at 14:37 said:

"They were enchanted by the exterior splendor of such forms and easily fell victim to Byzantinism, they were unable to reanimate much of Nordic-Aryan existence, in spite of everything, in the Mediterranean world, that by means of a faith corrupted, in more than one aspect, by Semitic-Southern racial influences as soon as they later on gave form to the Holy Roman Empire under the Catholic sign."

You really have to pick this apart to find out what is actually being said. I'm sure everyone appreciates all the effort you put into translation. This is invaluable stuff.

Max on 2015-04-19 at 13:52 said:

The Nordic-Germanic wave were unable to continue civilization writes Evola, however their intent was to keep civilization alive in face of roman degeneration and they managed to restore the monarchy with new northern blood. Evola says they descend more directly from the polar center than the remnants of the earlier migrations. They were physically pure, but "asleep" from long periods of dark isolation. The material conditions took its toll, a certain heaviness in the inner life of the nordics. They are sometimes prone to materialistic cults of the body or external phenomena, often a type of spiritual lethargy can be seen as counterpart to an outer activity. It is then a question of illuminating the shadow cast on the north.

Evola does not equal Hyperborean to exclusively Indo-european, so it makes one wonder if the Indo-european speakers should actually be regarded as part of the same wave to a degree, or if a classification according to language is irrelevant. In the case they are seen as the third wave spread out over several millennia, the chronology should move back in time to make the origin of the earlier waves prior to the end of the ice-age. The Germanics represent the

most northen population and consequently exhibit some tendencies developed to an extreme. One of the characterisitics is a high degree of individuality, whose negative shadow manifested in northern protestantism. Individuality could be seen as a fault or virtue depending on the expression it takes and we should strive to bring out the positive quality in each "character flaw" while remedying its negative. This particular flaw actually seems to be highly developed in Evola himself, for better or worse. In a positive expression, rather than just denying authority, it could for example take the form of an inviolable accountability before God above else, the northern ideal of every man being his own King, or a healthy disregard for false authorities.

There is definitely an anarchic tendency in the northern soul, explored by Jünger for example, but it is coupled to a strong social conformity advantagous in sparsely populated areas. The modern world brings out the negative side of both, so what gives rise to a democratic leveling by "conforming" should instead be realized in a higher state by humility, a certain concealment in a calm and ordered behaviour and distaste for expressing every whim arising from below. A negative development would be to repress all impulses becoming almost mechanical as is a Germanic stereotype.

Many ethtnicities and physical races contains the "higher" race latently, and contrary to earlier periods it does not express itself "naturally" and integrally. We have to distinguish various influences acting upon us and uncover some that have been obfuscated. This is a practice in ordering ourselves. We can not simpy accept everything as "a part of me" undiscriminately as is the modern habit, but have to consciously explore our "parts" and choose the higher over the lower. It means that race is not something we just posess passively but have to acquire through effort and introspection. It would not be surprising if an inner change shows in outer appearance too, not necessarily in hard facts and measurements but as the subtle expression that is impossible to calculate or catalogize. It is said that initiates tend to recognize each other, supposedly not due to hair colour or the shape of the nose though.

I am wondering if the classical civilizations of the ancient world could actually be attributed to a "recombination" of different Hyperborean voyages sharing a common past to then reunify after being separated for a long period. In any case, the Germanics were those stubborn enough not to migrate much south, but stay and gradually be surrounded by darkness rather than subject themselves to the violent revolutions of the south; it has to be admitted as some form of asceticism.

4.13 The Sexes and Race

In this and in the following section, **Julius Evola** deals with the traditional view of the sexes. He will justify the notion that the

division into sexes has a corporeal, psychic, and spiritual component. His opinion is quite "politically incorrect". Oddly, he had to deal with PC in his own time: the German translation omits all references to Germany or Germanic people.

Text On the bases of the above-mentioned ideas, it would also be necessary to return to the question of hybrids, bringing the sexes into the discussion. Even here we encounter a curious contradiction in race theory, that such questions are almost never posed. Contradicting this principle, claiming the differences of all human types as subjected in equal measure to the same biological laws that race theory considers in the same way, so it seems never to have been considered that normally the inheritance and the power of race can have a different weight according to whether it is about a man or a woman. Anyone who faced this problem had to resolve it directly in reverse, by supposing, again on the basis of simply biological considerations, a greater power of conservation of the race and the type in the woman.

From the point of view of traditional doctrine, it is exactly the opposite that is true in the case of normal humanity. This doctrine, if worthy of the rather minor attention of what today some of the most theatrical and insignificant grant to biological considerations, would furnish some rather useful suggestions for a problem of no small importance, which is the technique for the elevation of relatively inferior breeds through various cycles of heredity. Thus, in the most ancient Indo-European code, the Laws of Manu (Manava Dharmasastra), the transition of a non-Aryan into the caste of the Aryans is possible after seven generations of crosses maintained on the male line. This number seven also reappears in other traditions in analogous circumstances, while, in regard to the cycle of an individual human life, it is the number of years that are necessary for a periodic rejuvenation of all the elements of the body according to scientific research.

In this situation, the Laws of Manu stipulate what must be considered as a cornerstone for the question from the traditional point of view: male inheritance cannot be put on the same level as the female, because, in principle, the former has the "dominant" quality, as it is called in Mendelism, and the latter is "recessive". Therefore, when the woman is of the higher race, her higher inheritance is overpowered in the mixture, while the superior male inheritance, in the opposite case, is not necessarily contaminated, except in limit-cases or exceptions, and except what we will say about being man. "Whatever are the qualities of a man with whom a woman is united by legitimate rite, she acquires them like the water of a river united to the ocean" (Laws of Manu IX, 22).

And again (IX, 33-36): "If one compares the creative power of the male with that of the female, the male must be declared superior because the ancestor of all beings is distinct from the male characteristics. Whatever type of seed that is thrown in a field prepared in the appropriate season, this seed is developed in a plant with particular qualities, which are those of the male seed."

> By sacred tradition the woman is declared to be the soil, the man is declared to be the seed; the production of all corporeal beings takes place through the union of the soil with the seed. In some cases the seed is more distinguished, and in some the womb of the female; but when both are equal, the offspring is most highly esteemed. On comparing the seed and the receptacle, the seed is declared to be more important; the offspring of all created beings is marked by the characteristics of the seed. Whatever seed is sown in a field, prepared in due season, a plant of that same kind, marked with the peculiar qualities of the seed, springs up in it.

Completing the image, all the more, we can concede that when the field is not prepared and the season is not suitable, the male quality will be obstructed in the descendants or will wilt, or certainly it will dry up,

but it could never happen that the seed of a palm might come from a juniper plant through a miraculous power of the soil or season – i.e., by analogy, of the woman and the psychic conditions of a sexual union. As we have deliberately revealed, as long as we have the normal world in view, that is always presupposed by every traditional teaching.

Thus, in order to know what one must think today in this regard, rather than consulting the biologist, it is necessary to clarify the extent to which the modern world can indeed be called normal in regard to the condition of the sexes. The answer, unfortunately, can only be negative. The modern world no longer knows what it means to be a man or a woman in the higher sense. It is moving toward a lack of differentiation of types that is already very visible on the spiritual plane and, from it, here and there it seems to be translated onto the physical and biological plane giving rise to worrisome phenomena. In the West, masculinity and femininity are considered as things simply of the body, instead of qualities, above all, of the inner being of the soul and the spirit. In this respect, in the West, little more than nothing has been known about the polarity, the gap, the different function and dignity of the two sexes for some time. And so, very important problems regarding race are today considered in their exterior and consequential aspects, rather than in their internal and substantial aspects. For example, they are very concerned with the demographic problem and they create every type of institution for hygiene and social assistance and the increase of the race in the strict sense, but they ignore the fundamental point, which is the meaning of the relationship between the sexes and the precise imperative that whoever is born a man, is a man, and woman, a woman, in everything and for everything, in the spirit and in the body, without mixing and without attenuation. Only in this case the traditional teachings have validity and open up almost unlimited possibilities for the initiatives of selection and elevation of the races through adequate crosses and hereditary processes. Certainly not in the case in which, like today, we see in regard to being man or woman,

a still more oblique mixing than in regard to being of one race or another: in which some beings are men in the body but feminine in the soul or in the spirit, and vice versa, while being silent about the spread of sexual and psychical inclinations of a really pathological character.

But at this point we have to remind the reader of what we already wrote about it in Revolt against the Modern World, while touching on the death of races. Since descendants are not formed through combinations of hereditary elements made in a laboratory or in appropriate state institutions, but derive from the unions of men and women, it would be logical that, as the premise to every active conception of race and every discrimination of one race or another, the race of the male and the race of the female be defined and separated, in the same corporeal, psychic, and spiritual completeness, by which we formulated the theory of the three levels of race theory.

Moreover, we note a unique circumstance which confirms the fact that races, which have biologically preserved more of the Nordic type, are sometimes found inwardly at a greater level of involution and degeneration than others of the same family: we mean that some of the Nordic peoples—Germans and Anglo-Saxons—are those in which the traditional relationships between the two sexes have been greatly subverted. So-called woman's emancipation—which only means her mutilation and degradation in reality—has in fact begun from those peoples and has had the greatest hold in them, where in the Roman peoples, even if only due to bourgeois and conventional reflexes, something of the normal and traditional way of relating is still preserved, in this regard. The height then is reached when some foreign theorists exalt the triviality of terms like *compagno* and *compagna* and so-called "respect for woman" as an alleged characteristic of the Nordic race, not suspecting in the least that by doing so, they simply echo an abnormal state of a relatively recent date, while they assume every conception based on the proper distance, polarity, and different dignity of the two sexes as the Asiatic prejudices of

the inferior races of the South. It is necessary to recognize that if such distortions are assumed as principles, the path taken would lead not to the reawakening and the reintegration of the pure Nordic type, but to a further involution—in the direction of a trivialization of an inner leveling of the types—of what still remains in the Germanic peoples.

Posted on 2015-04-23 by Aeneas

* * *

Cologero on 2015-04-24 at 08:03 said:

Feminism in Norway[13] confirms what Evola wrote in regard to the feminist movement in the Scandinavian countries.

argusandphoenix on 2015-04-24 at 21:23 said:

It's interesting that the British Empire had its two "greatest" sovereigns, Queen Elizabeth & Queen Victoria, as the apex of their monarchy. The males seem to have been largely forgotten or vilified. I remember coming across a reference to this, vis a vis Evola and "race", and will try to find it. Contrast this with the Middle Ages, in which "Good King Richard" or Henry II are far more important figures. The ancient sources I'm familiar with do indicate that the Teutonic races, when encountered by Rome, had differing conceptions of male-female relationships. I think Caesar remarked on the power and influence held by women among the Celts, as well. It's troubling that the roots of this stretch back almost to pre-history. For what it's worth, Caesar in the Gallic Wars comes across as mild and even-handed and "frank" by comparison with the perfidious Celtic tribes which were migrating around Western Europe.

Mark Citadel on 2015-04-25 at 15:53 said:

"In this situation, the Laws of Manu stipulate what must be considered as a cornerstone for the question from the traditional point of view: male inheritance cannot be put on the same level as the female, because, in principle, the former has the "dominant" quality, as it is called in Mendelism, and the latter is "recessive". Therefore, when the woman is of the higher race, her higher inheritance is overpowered in the mixture, while the superior male inheritance, in the opposite case, is not necessarily contaminated, except in limit-cases or exceptions, and except what we will say about being man."

[13] http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Feminism_in_Norway

Fascinating. So even during miscegenation, the male genes overpower regardless of race. This presents an interesting study for the various combinations of miscegenaic birth.

@Cologero – Say it ain't so that you're actually throwing in the towel on Gornahoor! May I ask why? Have you simply run out of material to work with, or just a general moving on. I've found your analysis of Evola's work to be invaluable to my own.

Cologero on 2015-04-26 at 00:28 said:

Mark, I don't believe Evola is referring to biological heredity through "genes", but rather the inherited soul and spirit of the race. The next section of Sintesi might expand on that idea.

There is no lack of material, quite the contrary. I'll make clear soon why it is necessary to end one phase and begin another. Moreover, the actual personal work with the Gnosis group is much more important, so it needs to be expanded.

Nexist418 on 2015-04-26 at 23:55 said:

Will these be collected together? Were they released in order? If not, will a table of contents be provided?

Cologero on 2015-04-27 at 07:54 said:

Yes, Nexist418, the chapters will be collected together and published as a book. They are not being released in order, and there is a table of contents online if you bother to look for it.

Can you tell us what value this work has for you?

Nexist418 on 2015-04-27 at 13:31 said:

I wanted to read it in order. I did not find the TOC when I looked, but I will look again.

Lu Dongbin on 2015-04-28 at 09:36 said:

Strange situation regarding the Germanic relationship between man and women and the overall masculinity and heroism of the Germanic people in relation to that of Southern Europe, Italians, etc. which Evola himself commented on in many places. From his writing on Disraeli and the British Empire:

"England possesses a monarchy, an almost feudal nobility, and a military caste which, at least up until very recent years, showed remarkable qualities of character and of sang-froid."

Or from Seyyed Hossein Nasr recounting his meeting with Evola:

"While he extolled the ancient Romans and their virtues, he spoke pejoratively about his contemporary Italians. When I asked him what happened to those Roman virtues, he said they traveled north to Germany and we were left with Italian waiters singing o sole mio!"

So how is it that the masculinity, heroism, and Roman virtues Evola admired are at once concentrated to a greater degree among the Germanic people since the Fall of Rome, and yet

these same people have a degenerated relationship between the sexes in comparison? What would be spiritual source or cause of this odd state of affairs?

It seems that Evola was certainly correct about his overall view on the matter, especially regarding "further involution" when we take a look at the current state of affairs in the Western world today and especially in Germanic and Nordic countries regarding feminism, etc.

4.14 The Masculine and Feminine Races

In this chapter of *Sintesi*, **Julius Evola** demonstrates that the male and female are equivalent to different races. This is not simply the obvious corporeal differences, but extends also the the soul and the spirit. The female spirit is undifferentiated whereas the male spirit is differentiated.

He appeals to **J J Bachofen**'s writings on ancient gynocentric civilizations which had "promiscuity, communism, mother right, general equality as their characteristics". He mentions two possible outcomes:

- an awakening, a reaffirmation, and a vivification
- dissolution and debasement

From this perspective, the Western nations are moving toward a more gynocratic form. This is not *imposed*, but rather accepted and even chosen, by a race in decline, that is, those who have followed the second possibility. There is still the first possibility.

The Masculine and Feminine Races The notion of the "race of man" and the "race of woman" is not a totally gratuitous extension of the concept. We believe, in fact, that in order to truly take these things into account one should not disregard at all the observations made in Otto Weininger's notable work[14], especially in two points. The first is in the

[14] `https://www.gornahoor.net/library/SexAndCharacter.pdf`

determination of the type of the pure man or pure woman, as the basis for measuring the "quantities" of one or the other that are found in each individual and then to govern oneself in a compliant way. The second is in the daring idea that the existing relations between true man and true woman correspond analogically to those that exist between the Aryan and Semitic races. For Weininger, man is to the woman as the Aryan to the Semite. Weininger did the research on feminine qualities that appear as an exact match to those typical of the Semite and the Jew. One such research is tendentious to a great degree. Weininger, being half-Jewish, was began especially to lose heart and degrade even without wishing it—he did not find the true value of the woman where he should have found it. Nevertheless, his views are still valid; the idea that, from the point of view of a normal and differentiated conception of the sexes, man and woman almost manifest as the expression of two different races, if not pure opposites. It is therefore a serious defect of descriptive and typological racial theory to not take that into account when making the effort to identify and describe the characteristics of each race, while not asking if certain qualities, normal for the masculine type of a given race, continue to be so regarded when applied instead to its feminine type.

In order to remedy this defect, naturally we need to consider the sexes also in their psychical and spiritual aspect. From that point of view, it is certainly absurd to conceive, for example, as normal that the "Nordic" woman embodies the same values typical of the pure Nordic man—that is to say, everything that is calm and dominating superiority, solarity, sense of distance, active detachment, connected to a readiness to attack and whatever else we find out. Without directly referring to the Semitic people (unlike Weininger), if we do not want to end up at leveling and therefore mongrelization, it is instead desirable and normal that the same Nordic woman has her own psychical and spiritual qualities, which have a central position in different, non-Nordic races.

Moreover, once the race of the body, or anthropological race, where

the female racial differences are well-known and obvious, is omitted, the distinctive characteristics of the women of the various races are much less pronounced on the level of the race of the soul than in the case of the male. In fact, then, at the level of race of the spirit, there is often a true undifferentiation. The real support of the race of the soul and, especially of the spirit, is the man. It is especially in him that the principle of differentiation falls, while the principle of equality is reflected more in the feminine element. Not by accident did the ancient traditions associate, in cosmic analogy, the feminine element with that of matter or unformed power, hylé, dynamis, and the masculine, instead, with the celestial principal of order and individualization. Still less is it an accident that the ancient gynocratic and matriarchal civilizations, as an immediate consequence of the preeminence accorded to the feminine principle in its various, maternal or aphroditic forms, had promiscuity, communism, mother right, general equality as their characteristics. See The Solar Race by Bachofen Strictly speaking, opposite to every man worthy of this name, the true woman that our ancestors considered significantly as "woman of race", had to present herself as something dangerous, as a foreign principle that attracts, insinuates herself, and demands an inner action: almost the same type of reaction of which we said speaking of cross-breedings, where foreign blood puts the type to the test and gives rise to two possibilities: either to an awakening, a reaffirmation, and a vivification, or else to dissolution and debasement. In the first case, the man maintains himself at the peak of his purpose and, according to traditional teachings, his qualities permeate and persist intact in his progeny, as the "dominant" character. In the second case, in a form more or less disguised, he will undergo at least an internal degeneration of the type. Uncontrollable forces will take the upper hand in the processes of heredity, the protection of the race will become something problematic, until the limit-case is realized, that is, the return, in new forms, to the spirit and promiscuity of the gynocratic civilizations formed by the anti-Nordic races and from the degeneration

of the Nordic race.

Posted on 2015-04-29 by Aeneas

* * *

Boreas on 2015-04-30 at 10:04 said:

The Gornahoor wordpress site seems to have been made private; what do I need to do to be able to read the article?

Cologero on 2015-04-30 at 12:12 said:

Boreas, we plan to leave it open for certain windows. Eventually, it will probably be made private for those interested. Since only 20% of readers are clicking through, it really doesn't matter.

Mark Citadel on 2015-04-30 at 18:11 said:

Correct me if I'm wrong, is Evola saying here that a 'race of the sex' dichotomy is spiritually present during the procreation event and that in Modernity a feminine, degenerative descent is occurring rather than a masculine, heroic descent (that being proper to Tradition.)

If so, what is the solution to this problem, which is obviously not medical or genetic? Will this simply return to the old masculine sexo-racial line of descent once the World of Tradition is restored, or does something active have to be done as it pertains to child-bearing and conception?

Átila on 2015-05-15 at 11:38 said:

Read the book "The Myth of Matriarchal Prehistory" By CYNTHIA ELLER

Cologero on 2015-05-15 at 12:35 said:

Sorry to have to make a public example of you, Atila, but that is not how to write an intelligent comment. If you want to help your fellow human beings, you would have mentioned specific points from the book and then applied them to the post you are commenting on.

I read the amazon page for the book as well as some comments by those who actually read the book. As one reviewer wrote:

"Firstly, it must be understood that Dr. Eller was not out to prove that prehistory was in any way universally patriarchal. Dr. Eller is certainly aware of the many matriarchal, matrilineal and matrifocal prehistorical societies."

This more or less confirms, or at least is consistent with, Evola's thesis.

4.15 Race of the Soul

> There are many cases of people who are exactly of the same race of the body, of the same tribe, sometimes even, brothers or fathers and sons, of the same blood in the most real sense, but who nevertheless fail to understand each other. A barrier separates their souls, their way of feeling and seeing is different, and the common race of the body and common blood can do nothing about that. A possibility of comprehension exists, and therefore of true solidarity, of deep unity, only where a common "race of the soul" exists.

Since man is an ensouled body, his outward physical characteristics, or race of the body, are insufficient to determine him. That is, the body is neither a chunk of matter, nor an animal, so DNA will fail to define him. Keep in mind that by "race", **Julius Evola** does not mean how it is understood in the USA, with its emotionally charged history of slavery, apartheid, and civil rights. Rather, it is much more specific, so he can speak of a Nordic race, an Italic race, and so on. This is more obvious in languages like Italian or German, since the word for "race" in those languages is also used to refer to "breeds" of animals.

Applying phenomenology to the experience of race, we see, as did Evola, that sharp and deep divisions separate even those of the same physical race. These are not merely accidental qualities, but are constitutive of the person. These divisions often make mutual intelligibility impossible, without the effort to transcend such differences on a higher plane. There are two all too obvious consequences to this. First of all, any attempt to appeal to some racial solidarity of the first level will necessarily fail. Secondly, these divisions at the soul level will not be resolved by discussions or "debates". **Fabre d'Olivet** confirms this:

> Nature does not make men equal; souls differ still more than bodies.

From the esoteric perspective, what is of interest is why people hold certain views, not the views themselves. For example, a convinced materialist or atheist holds his view with a passionate intensity, since he is unable to conceive of, or experience interiorly, any other possibility that makes sense to him. Bracketing out for the moment the possibility of a spiritual or intellectual conversion, people remain locked into certain fixed patterns of soul life.

Evola also provides a different understanding of "purity". Physical purity is impossible, or at least, undesirable. There is a small, but not negligible, mutation rate in any population. Since most mutations are deleterious, an endogamous population will decline over the centuries. Purity, then, can only mean the adequation of corporeal and psychic qualities. Thus for example, on the one hand he can praise certain Nordic qualities, while also mentioning the degeneration of the Nordic race. Note that these qualities are all on the plane of the soul and spirit, not the body.

The takeaway is that successful movements depend on a core group of "like-minded" people, if that is your goal; great leaders instinctively understand this. As Evola explains,

> A possibility of comprehension, and therefore of true solidarity, of deep unity, exists only where a common "race of the soul" exists.

For example, desirable qualities may include "calm and dominating superiority, solarity, sense of distance, active detachment". Those that have such qualities actively can then identify those who may have them virtually. However, an indiscriminate mixing, a "big tent", won't come to much beyond putting some people in positions of power for its own sake. The telltale sign of degeneration is the failure to differentiate, which is also the hallmark of the Kali Yuga. Differentiation at the level of the soul is more important than the body. Evola concludes:

> it may happen that a person gives us the clear impression by his way of acting that he "is of another race" and, then, there is no longer anything to do with him; relationships of a various nature can exist with him, but always with an inner reservation and inner distance. He "is no longer ours".

A leader needs to make that determination. Of course, the most fundamental differentiation is that between a man and a woman, who relate to each other not just physically, but more importantly at the soul and spirit level. Nowadays, even that differentiation is losing force. Many, today, even fail to differentiate between humans and animals. The text follows.

Let's now return to the clarification of the three levels of the doctrine of race. We consider a theory of the race of the soul and a typology of the soul of the races as the doctrine of the second level. Such a doctrine needs to identify the elements, in their primary and irreducible modes, that act from the inside, causing groups of individuals to manifest a consistent mode of being or "style" as far as acting, thinking, and feeling are concerned. With this we arrive at a new concept of racial purity of a given type: it is no longer about, as in racial doctrine of the first level, seeing if a given individual manifests a specific group of physical characteristics or even character traits, that makes him conform to the inherited type, but it is about establishing if a given individual's race of the body is the adequate expression or confirmation of his race of the soul, and vice versa. If that is confirmed, the type is pure also in the sense of the investigations of the second level.

That then complements the results of the of the first level, because it no longer considers the various corporeal characteristics in the abstract, in a simple classification, which could even be disguised, instead of in living faces and individuals. It seeks instead to understand their secret, that is to say, what they express, the function for which they are used and by way of which, from case to case, they might even mean something

different. As we already noted, a nose of a given form and an elongated, dolicephalous skull can meet both in a type of the races derived from the Nordic stock, or in an exemplar of the African race: but it is obvious that the two cases do not have the same significance. Besides, it is quite possible that a given type has predominant characteristics, e.g., Mediterranean in the anthropological race of the body – so much so that the racial doctrine of the first level would assign him precisely to the Mediterranean race of the man of the West: nevertheless the latest research may notice that these Mediterranean traits, in the type in question, are assumed in a different function from what would normally be expected. The type that we are talking about uses them instead to express a soul, an internal attitude that is not Mediterranean, but, for example, Nordic or Near Eastern. That gives an absolutely different expressive value to the same traits and leads sometimes to certain distortions or alterations of the exterior Mediterranean element that are almost imperceptible in the research of the first level or are considered irrelevant and unimportant, while for the research of the second level they represent many ways to understand the "inner race". Here physiognomy, the study of the meaning of the human face, has an important role: it will however develop in a different direction from the preceding, which conceived each individual separately instead of as a member of a given superbiological community, of a given race of the soul.

On this higher plane, anthropology and paleoanthropology become valuable aids for the research into the original racial elements that entered into composition, were superimposed, or clashed at the dawn of civilizations. For the highest tasks of the race theory, it is insufficient to have considered the presence, for example in Italic origins, of a given number of typical skeletons and skulls and, integrating such researches with the archeological ones, to be able to affirm fundamentally the existence of an ancient pure Nordico-Aryan Italic human type. That would not get beyond an area of a museum. It is necessary, furthermore, to make this

type speak, to penetrate into what a given corporeal form expresses, or what a given human structure is the symbol of. This is impossible without taking into account the field of the racial doctrine of the second level, and even to a certain extent the third level, disciplines that work with other methods of research and utilize another order of documents and evidence.

We can consider the so-called *Rassenseelekunde* or psychoanthropology of L. F. Clauss as racial theories of the second level, insofar as it concerns his methods and general criteria. The necessity of such research was made clear by Clauss with convincing examples. For example, he considered the phenomena of comprehension. Actually, there are too many cases of people who are exactly of the same race of the body, of the same tribe, sometimes even, brothers or fathers and sons, of the same blood in the most real sense, but who nevertheless fail to understand each other. A barrier separates their souls, their way of feeling and seeing is different, and the common race of the body and common blood can do nothing about that.

A possibility of comprehension, and therefore of true solidarity, of deep unity, exists only where a common "race of the soul" exists. Subtle elements of an instinctive sensitivity come into question at this point. While for many years nothing was suspected, in a given circumstance it may happen that a person gives us the clear impression by his way of acting that he "is of another race" and, then, there is no longer anything to do with him; relationships of a various nature can exist with him, but always with an inner reservation and inner distance. He "is no longer ours". Usually, they spoke of character in this case. The expression is vague. There is not, in fact, a "character" in general but there are different modes of appearing of the dispositions of character conditioned by the inner race. For example, the way of being "faithful" of a Near Eastern people is different from that of a man of the Nordic or Dinaric race. The way of conceiving heroism by a Mediterranean man is different from

that of a Japanese or a Russian, to use generic expressions and while not getting into precise classifications inherent to a doctrine of the race of the soul.

Posted on 2015-05-10 by Aeneas

* * *

Alistair Fraser on 2015-05-11 at 06:38 said:

"it may happen that a person gives us the clear impression by his way of acting that he "is of another race" and, then, there is no longer anything to do with him; relationships of a various nature can exist with him, but always with an inner reservation and inner distance. He "is no longer ours". "

Is it possible that by the power of early conditioning , the impulse that exists to express the genuine race of ones soul can be hindered greatly , so some people appear to be one type but are actually a repressed other type imprisoned withing their societal cage , but yet even as their true expression has been overwritten, blocked and given little room to sprout, still there may be signs of it that seep out through gesture and energy presence perceivable by others of similar ilk and so the "virtually quality " confirms

Paulo on 2015-05-11 at 15:49 said:

well being born and raised in brasil,the eye of the hurricane kali yuga

i cant fail to notice the effects of this kind of mix

mix of the body,mix of the soul and mix of the sexes really,destiny had put me in a position were the chalenges will not give up on me!!!

4.16 Origin of the Race of the Soul

In formulating a theory of the origin of the race of the soul, Julius Evola points out that "soul" (or psyche) does not mean "subjective activities" in the mind as contemporary psychology understands it. Rather, it is a distinct entity, which he relates to the traditional teachings of the "subtle body". In other words, it is not reducible to material, physical, or biological factors. Hence, scientific methods cannot be applied to understand the race of the soul.

At its origins, the soul and the body may have been in harmony, but that is seldom the case today. Hence, there are really two levels of heredity: the biological and the psychical. Moreover, psychical heredity is nondeterministic since the factor of elective affinity comes into play.

Addendum A commenter mentioned that this chapter seemed "arbitrary and even dangerous." However, I believe this chapter is significant, at least in some aspects, if not in toto. For example, I believe it offers an explanation for the transmission of what is called "original sin". In times past, the method of transmission was debated, e.g., whether it came through semen, etc. However, such biological and material explanations make no sense to anyone today. Were that true, there would be an "original sin" gene. Then, presumably, gene therapy could someday reverse the effects of original sin.

On the other hand, Joseph Ratzinger's description of original sin as more like a psychological matrix that we are unavoidably born into makes more sense to people today. It can be understood and even observed. Nevertheless, it is still weak since a means of transmission is never specified. The notion that there is a psychical heredity, therefore, answers the question of transmission. Moreover, psychical deformations even spill over onto the body, with ill effects. This is just a starting point for understanding that doctrine.

Postscript The German translation has some interesting additions. In it, Evola refers to the "Nordic-Roman" race rather than the "Nordic" race.

He also quotes Alfred Rosenberg, with whom he otherwise had significant disagreements:

> The body is the externality of the soul and the soul is the race seen from the inside.

Origin of the Races of the Soul Where do the races of the soul come from? Clearly, in the limit-case of completely pure races from a single stream, if one could assume it, they represent the psychological expression of the same particular formative power that is expressed on the physical plane by the specific and typical characteristics of the anthropological race of the body which forms the base of their inseparable unity, while belonging in itself to a still higher plane. According to the ancient traditional teachings, the soul is not simply what modern psychology believes, that is to say, an ensemble of phenomena and "subjective" activities, unfolding on a physico-biological base. For that teaching, the soul is rather a type of being in itself; as the *linga sharira*, or "subtle body", it has its own existence, its real forces, its laws, its own heredity, distinct from the purely physico-biological.

From such a point of view, it is necessary to consider that the races of the soul are subject to vicissitudes similar the race of the body, except that, to indicate such vicissitudes, and therefore in order to know about the genesis of the races of the soul, about their essence and laws as conditioning their development and their integrity, it would necessarily be by means of immaterial research previously known by the ancient traditional sciences, but now unknown to modern culture. Although a deformed recollection of it is found in certain theosophical and occultist circles, there is however not even a suspicion of it in so-called "scientific" research. So as things stand today, it is necessary to proceed in an inductive or intuitive way, rather than from a clear body of knowledge.

In any case, bear in mind the important methodological foundation of the principle that two distinct lines of heredity exist, one of the body and the other of the soul, lines which may even diverge after races and traditions have lost their original purity from prehistoric times. While the line of biological heredity has a visible and identifiable continuity because it is based on the process of natural generation, we have to assume that the line of the heredity of the soul instead has its continuity only on

another, no longer visible, plane and can therefore connect individuals who might have nothing in common in space and time. We will return to this point in discussing the problem of birth. Here we observe the complexity that previously the problem of physical heredity itself presents in these terms, even if it not is considered as positivistic myopia. In fact, since the soul has a relationship of reciprocal action with the body, in the case of the divergence of the two heredities, there will arise in physical heredity, through the influence of the other, modifications insusceptible to explanations that biological and anthropological research will never be able to ascertain within its domain.

However, this is not the suitable place to discuss such topics, because it presupposes knowledge of the traditional conception of the multiple states of being, that substitute for the way that all the greatest problems related to man, life, death, and the world are considered today. Let's return to the point from which we started in order to say that, when you are faced with a state of racial mixing, the races of the soul should be considered as the result of three factors. The first, which is essential for it, is precisely the race of the soul as a distinct entity. The second is the influence that a mismatched body of race may have exercised over it and, through this body, which is the positive center of the relations with the outer world, an unsuitable environment. The third is the influence that a still higher element, i.e., the race of the spirit, may have exercised in the case of a new divergence between the soul and spirit, beyond that between the soul and body.

Since the unity of the various elements does not happen by chance and automatic laws, but on the basis of analogous and "elective" connections (this will also be clarified later), in spite of the divergences, we can admit, as a working hypothesis and a likely criterion, a certain equivalence. For example, out of the hundred types that demonstrate racial purity as race of the body, let us suppose, of the Nordic type, we can presume that a greater number of cases are found where, a psycho-spiritual congruent

qualification also virtually corresponds to it, than between a hundred types whose race of the body is neither Nordic, nor of Nordic origin. The misgivings of making such assumptions follow. First of all, the one just made by saying "virtually", since, as we saw, there were cases of pure races that are half-extinguished or have declined in terms of the race of the soul. In the second place, because it is necessary to consider the cases of "propensity" – the law of affinity may have made the manifestation of a given type of personality prefer a certain race of the soul, however in accordance with such a circumstance, made to pay for this choice with the reception of a non-matching race of the body (for example, in cases of reanimation of the race in the second of the forms considered in part 2, chapter II, the elective affinities would even lead to a manifestation in mixed forms more so than in pure, but interiorly decadent, forms). In the third place, because "analogy" and "elective affinity" are terms that refer to not simply human states of existence, so that through it criteria apply which may not match the way the common mind has been led to suppose and to believe natural, logical, and desirable.

Posted on 2015-05-17 by Aeneas

* * *

Paulo on 2015-05-17 at 23:08 said:

Other important aspect that should be demonstrated,is the influence of the land that we are born.In Carl Jung's book,"civilization in transition"in chapter XXII he mention a certain professor Boas,that have made studies that shows that the sons of european imigrants born in the United States,had a different anatomy then their ancestors.Later in the same chapter,Jung mention some primitive people that belives that the children born in the land usurped by their fathers from native americans,africans or whatever be the case,shoul"inherit the spirits"of the land.He see some truth in that!!!

In the same chapter Jung writes extensively about the psychological differences between americans and their europeans counterpart!!!

Jacob on 2015-05-18 at 13:26 said:

Thank you for the translations.

How does this relate to Tomberg's reincarnation as psychological fact or does it?

Cologero on 2015-05-18 at 16:35 said:

That's a good point, Jacob. The two Hermetists agree that there is biological and psychic heredity (bracketing out spiritual heredity for the moment). Tomberg discusses this in Letter X. However, Tomberg relates psychic continuity to "reincarnation", while Evola denies reincarnation. It probably comes down to a verbal disagreement. Tomberg denies the crude teaching of reincarnation in which "I" am being punished for something "I" did in the past.

What he is asking is that if "I" am Peter and "I" have a memory of Paul, does that mean I am both Peter and Paul? It can't mean that Paul reincarnated as Peter, since the "I" is transcendent to the experience of either one.

Nevertheless, Tomberg wants to call that an "identity" of some sort. Evola expresses it differently: Peter has an "affinity" with Paul, so Peter is born within the psychic current that included Paul. In other words, the experience may be the same, but the concept of affinity explains it better than the concept of identity. Guenon objects that an "identity" means that two things are the same in every aspect, but clearly Peter and Paul are different.

Coomaraswamy's essay on the One and Only Transmigrant may be helpful. Ultimately, there is the One I, manifesting in different ways.

4.17 The Eternal Race

In *The Eternal Race*, **Julius Evola** explains the doctrine of the "**race of the spirit**". Unlike the race of the soul, which is contingent and changeable, the race of the spirit is transhistorical. The way to access it is through the originary symbols and myths of a people. Evola describes the method, dangers, and value of this type of research.

Although the context is much different, this is not essentially much different from methods described by **Valentin Tomberg**; this undoubtedly arises from their deep and comprehensive knowledge of Hermetism. Remarkably, it is not unlike the "phenomenology" of **John Paul II** in the *Theology of the Body*. The latter treats the first chapters of Genesis as the myth of the origins of the entire human race.

For Evola, however, the goal is to determine the spiritual roots of specific peoples. He expects a "super race" to arise, which is really Guenon's "elite" who, by recovering the original spiritual impulse of a people, will inaugurate a new civilization.

What follows is some background information for understanding the text.

Evolutionism Evola rejects "evolutionism" because it assumes that man evolved from a lower state to a higher state. This is a false metaphysical claim, although most people today assume it as a biological fact. What is too often called the "theory of evolution" is a misnomer; "neo-Darwinism" is a more accurate term (although there are alternatives), since it is based on the addition of Mendel's work on genes as the mechanism to explain heredity in Darwinism. However, strictly as science, there is no direction or aim to it. Humans can arise from apes just as readily as an ape from a human (and the latter is more observable.) There is only a problem when science oversteps its bounds.

Klages and Jung **Carl Jung** is easily misunderstood. In his autobiography, he explains that qua scientist, he can only make psychological claims. This is what Evola objects to. However, Jung also said that the archetypes have more than a psychological significance.

Ludwig Klages is a different story. **Lucian Tudor** describes Klages' philosophy of biocentrism in this way:

> Biocentrism posited an essential distinction between Seele (Soul?) and Geist (Spirit), which conflict each other in human life. The Geist is the nous, the pneuma, or the logos ... what we would call in ordinary speech the intellect, the reason, the spirit, the mind... . The Seele corresponds to the Greek psyche. It is the living principle, the vital spark ... and one with the body, soma. Biocentrism is a romanticist and anti-rationalist philosophy which poses the

> Soul as positive and the Spirit as negative. According to Biocentric theory, human beings had originally – in primordial, ancient times – lived ecstatically in accordance to the principle of Leben (Life, which is held as the ultimate value, to be distinguished from mere existence) and in a harmonious relation to the cosmos and the sensual world of images.
>
> In Biocentric theory, at some point in history the force of the Spirit intruded into life and caused humans to use abstract, conceptual (as opposed to symbolic) thought and rational intellect, thus beginning the severing of body and Soul ... Biocentric philosophy also attacked Judeo-Christianity as a Logocentric religion opposed to Life and upheld ancient Paganism (which has a Dionysian character centered around vitalistic, feminine values) as the Biocentric religion of Life.

Obviously, Biocentrism is absurd from a Traditional point of view, so, for Evola, it is not only false but dangerous. However, it is implicit in much of neopagan reconstructions, which seeks to live in immediacy with no sense of the truly transcendent.

Positive Sources Evola mentions **Fustel de Coulanges** and **Bachofen** as being of fundamental importance. Evola's work will be understood better by those who have read those authors.

Text Let's now say something about research into the third grade of race, having the races of the spirit as its object. This is really the research of race at its ultimate root, wherever it is a question of normal civilizations and higher human lineages; the root, already connected to superpersonal, super-ethnic, metaphysical forces. For such research, the specific mode of conceiving both the sacred and the supernatural, as well as the relationship of man in respect to it, the vision of life in the highest sense, moreover, the entire world of symbols and myths constitute material as

positive and objective as that of the racial features of the first degree such as facial features and cranial structures. Essentially in this area, the "signs" of "vertical", super-historical heredity are perceivable, which we said earlier; the special importance of this new research is confirmed from that point of view.

This, on the other hand, has more vast and precise possibilities of exploration of the origins and therefore of indicating the primary elements of races, than the other two degrees of race. The documents on which it is based can actually date back to the most distant prehistory, to that period which is precisely called "mythical" and which for this reason, is erroneously considered uncertain and deprived of importance by "positive" history. Furthermore, while the anthropological, archeological, and paleontological materials in themselves are mute, and while those of the research of the second degree are particularly subject to change, the myth and the symbol, in their atemporal and ahistorical nature, instead have an essential character of immutability, and therefore can often transmit elements conserving their original purity to a great extent. But naturally to reach that point, the entire trunk of prehistoric researches and whatever is connected to it, is to be sketched out by the new doctrine of race on a basis absolutely different from what applies to the older: on a pure, sacred, and no longer profane basis. It is necessary to proceed therefore to a complete revolution in the order of criteria and preconceptions that predominate in such a field, which, according to the usual trick, claim to be the measure of everything that may be considered "serious" and "scientific". And for the first thing, we repeat, it is necessary to get rid of the evolutionistic myth in all its forms, since it is evident that if one continues to believe that the further one goes back in time, the more one sinks into the horror of a bestial barbarity, the presumption of obtaining the points of reference valid for the present from the investigations of prehistory and of the mythical periods of origins, would be something insane. Wherever any evolutionistic premise is in use, to investigate the

origins and to give prominence to the principle of heredity would lead fatally to aberrations like those of certain psychoanalytic exegetes such as Freud's *Totem and Taboo*.

From the point of view here considered, we must say that the domain of the symbol and the myth, among us, is almost virgin territory. Giambattista Vico certainly did not create a school in Italy: rather, only secondary and often minor aspects of his theories have been adopted. Our official and unofficial culture, the one that calls itself "serious" and "critical" and that unfortunately is also largely represented in general education, considers symbol and myth to this day either as an arbitrary creation of prephilosophical knowledge, or as something pertinent to inferior religious forms, or as a figurative and superstitious interpretation of merely natural phenomena, or, finally, as the formation of folklore—not to mention the discoveries of psychoanalysis and so called sociological schools, both typical creations of Judaism, that were introduced to us.

All these limitations and preconceptions must be overcome; otherwise, one must give up the fruits of the most fecund research in regard to race and primordial traditions. It is necessary to go back to conceiving myth and symbol as ancient, traditional man conceived it, i.e., as the characteristic expressions of a super-rational reality, objective in its own way, and almost as the sign, recognizable through every expert eye, of metaphysical forces that act in the depth of races, traditions, religions, and historical and prehistorical civilizations. Penetrating into the world of origins, while assuming such a point of view, is—we willingly concede—something not immune from dangers, because such a domain eludes the common means of control and criticism and, given the general lack of preparation in the field, every arbitrary and fantastic interpretation could have the right of citizenship in it. Germany has not failed to provide some examples of that. Without the armor of solid traditional principles and special qualification, quite different from that required for a "critical" research or for "philosophical" interpretation, move evil than good can

come from the exploration into the question through deformations and corruptions.

In regard to general principles, if we want to profit from other people's experience in this aspect of research of the third degree, we must prevent an error, of which Klages and, in a certain measure, even Jung, can be considered the most significant proponents, which, by only recognizing the value of the symbol and myth as the object of a "deep science", it sees in them only a type of projection of the soul of the race, conceived irrationally as an expression of simple "vital" forces: "Life" (with the capital L) or the "Collective Unconscious" would be manifested in symbol and myth. That is false. And it is dangerous because it implies a romantic-naturalistic and rather one-sided conception of what race is, and must mean, for us. When it is a question of superior races, we repeat that the notion of race must be strictly joined to that of tradition, and in tradition, in its turn, the presence and the efficiency of meta-biological, metaphysical, not sub-rational but super-rational, forces must actually be recognized, acting formatively on purely physical and "vital" evidence and constituting the mystery of everything that, through race, assumes a fixed, unmistakable nature. Symbol and myth are signs of such deep forces of race, of which we just spoke, not of a type of irrational, instinctive and unconscious substrate of the ethnic group conceived in itself, a substrate that would be really make us think of the "spirits" or the *totems* of primitive communities. In the face of confusions of this type, it is appropriate to recognize that some accusations against racial doctrine manifested as a type of new "totemism", a return to the spirit of the primordial horde, harmful for every true value of the personality, have a certain degree of justification.

Symbol and myth in our doctrine of race instead have the merit of documentary evidence through their capacity to lead us into the primary super-rational spiritual element of the races, to what is truly elemental in the world of origins. This element constitutes the leading thread for

complementary investigations of various types. Custom, ethics, ancient law, and language certainly furnish other signs for the investigation of the third degree of race and for the racial interpretation of the history of civilization. But, even here, in order to obtain valid results it is necessary to remove the limitations of the modern mentality and to recognize that, in the ancient world, ethics, law, and customs were only chapters dependent on "religion": i.e., they reflect meanings and principles characteristic of a super-rational and sacred order. It is necessary to pick out the central point in this order, capable of conferring on everything else its own correct significance. When the investigation is closed to those forms taken in themselves, i.e., ethics, customs, law, language itself and art in the abstract, rather than as expressions above all of a given race of the body and the soul, then, by means of this, as applications or reflections of general meanings typical of tradition, the spiritual and animating force of race—when it is closed to that, again, it would remain in the are not of the original, but of the derived, not of the essential, but of the ancillary. In the face of so many of today's works, discouraged and losing themselves in the labyrinth of specialism and criticism without principles, the fundamental work of Fustel de Coulanges, like others of the same period and those of Bachofen, maintain, in this regard, in spite of all the imperfections dependent on the period in which they were written, a fundamental importance and are worth indicating the right direction for a series of studies that integrate them with the specific consideration of the race element.

Let us point out right now that to emphasize this original, spiritual element hidden in traditional myth and symbol, that, in races, goes beyond their merely biological, material and, fundamentally, even human, aspect, is very important even from the practical point of view. With it, actually, from what is conditioned by time and history and that, therefore, could only give rise to never experienced re-exhumations, almost "commemorations", one moves into the order of what, as essentially atemporal, is not

to be considered of "yesterday", of a given "history" or "prehistory", but of a perennial relevance: to the eternal race. And it is exactly this race that can converted to an idée-force, capable of facilitating, through an awakening, by means of the law of attraction that attracts the similar to itself, the practical and creative tasks of applied doctrine of race, which is: the actualization of the "super-race" in the heart of the "race" as people, as the common type defined by a certain ethnic mixture, the re-emergence of the higher elements to the pure state and their formative reaffirmation, repeating the same mystery of the origins, in a new cycle of civilization.

Posted on 2015-05-24 by Cologero

* * *

ja on 2015-05-25 at 13:44 said:

Klages philosophy is clearly derived from Nietzsche. ..a lot of neopaganism is just Nietzscheanism as opposed to a revival of Greco Roman thought.

Lucian Tudor on 2015-05-26 at 18:50 said:

A more complete and effective exposition of Klages's thought can be found in the essays (available online) by Joseph Pryce and Lydia Baer. While I believe that authors like Ludwig Klages (or Jan Stachniuk, to cite a somewhat similar thinker) are useful for understanding Paganism as well as Lebensphilosophie, I think it is invalid to view their thought as the only representative form of Pagan philosophy. It is quite clear from Pryce's work, for example, that Stefan George and Klages had differing focal points for their Paganisms. Furthermore, I believe that more academic authors, historians of religion, such as Mircea Eliade provide the most true understanding of Paganism and its approach to the Sacred. However, it is best to compare and balance out a variety of viewpoints.

Cologero on 2015-05-27 at 07:38 said:

Mr Tudor, we would certainly include Bachofen and Fustel de Coulanges as primary sources to understand the pagan mind and spirit. I disagree with your encyclopedic approach of comparing and balancing a variety of viewpoints. Either there is a standard of truth or there is not. Our primary interest, therefore, is whether a particular viewpoint adheres to or opposes that standard.

Lucian Tudor on 2015-05-27 at 08:57 said:

Cologero, I definitely agree that there should be a standard of Paganism; a clear definition of what truly defines Paganism in all of its various forms across the world, which allows one to properly separate it from non-Pagan ideas and religions. What I meant by my remark is that to actually ascertain what Paganism truly is is not a simple task and can only be attained by reading a variety of authors' works, and attaining the ability to distinguish what is valid and invalid in each author after attaining an understanding of the essence of Paganism.

I believe that the more Biocentrist authors (Klages, Stachniuk, D.H. Lawrence, etc.) all grasped some truths about Paganism's defining characteristics, but Biocentrism misunderstands Paganism because it condemns all transcendence in favor of pure Life, whereas, by contrast, at the essence of Paganism is a complex, merged valuing of Life and Transcendence. Therefore, it can help to read authors like Klages to understand Paganism, but just reading these authors ultimately leads to an invalid understanding. Sure, Bachofen and Fustel de Coulanges should included in our list of authors that should be read in the study of Paganism, but recall that these are both academics from the 19th Century (and it is always proper to compare the works of different academics who have disagreements on the facts, as opposed to only reading one academic perspective on a subject) and they are also imperfect because different studies and facts have emerged since that time. It is necessary to include in one's study of Paganism modern intellecutals/scholars such as Eliade, Gilbert Durand, Nigel Pennick, Christopher Gérard, Alain de Benoist, etc. I cannot imagine a proper understanding of Paganism in the global sense being achieved without studying several different authors to some extent.

Mark Citadel on 2015-05-27 at 17:08 said:

I am unsure as to how completely Evola rejects Evolution. Does he contend that the entire theory and its evidences are junk science, or is his claim more nuanced, positing his own historiography on the eternal race as a more purely metaphysical account rather than one rooted in what scientists would call 'evidence'?

I'm leaning towards the former, that Evola considers the theory of evolution to be absolute junk, and affirms man created in present form.

Cologero on 2015-05-27 at 21:24 said:

This is Evola's alternative to evolution: *Esoteric Origin of the Species*[15].

As we pointed out, the "Theory of Evolution" is a poor choice of words, since it implies a "direction" of evolution, from more primitive to more advanced. That is NOT what science qua science can show. Nevertheless, that is how it is viewed in the popular mind. Obviously, the

[15] http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=6261

Traditional viewpoint is that there is a degeneration over time, not a progression. Moreover, science has not proved, nor will it prove, a material cause for the human spirit.

`mleow on 2015-05-30 at 17:36 said:`

Of interest i believe, the lost/last interview of Evola from french television has been published here:

`https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QiCtdi5nCoA`

`Cologero on 2015-05-31 at 12:45 said:`

Here is an interesting experiment to see if a contemporary political movement can be based on Traditional principles: *The Esoteric Voice of Gabor Vona's Spiritual Mentor*[16]

4.18 Fire and Ice: The Solar Race

This is the first of several posts about the various races of the spirit described by **Julius Evola**: The Solar Race. Evola owes his typology of spirits of the race to **J J Bachofen**'s study of **Mother Right**, although with a creative misreading of the text, Evola extracts a deeper meaning from it.

Bachofen delineated a historical process of cultures from haeterism to matriarchy, culminating in patriarchy, which he admitted was

> the highest calling, the sublimation of earthly existence to the purity of the divine father principle.

Bachofen traces the patriarchal system in the ancient world to Athens and to the Roman Imperium. In them, there was Solarity.

As we have seen, however, Evola rejects any notion of "progress" in history. Rather he sees a degeneration. Certain ancient peoples were feminine in nature, and hence endured various matriarchal systems as described by Bachofen. On the other hand, the Hyperborean, or Nordic,

[16] `http://budapesttimes.hu/2015/05/29/the-esoteric-voice-of-gabor-vonas-spiritual-mentor`

peoples, were originally masculine, or equivalently Solar. Subsequent racial degeneration has led to the situation of the present era.

Although Evola gives us a very brief outline, he entire oeuvre is dedicated to the description of the Solar race. Fire and Ice are the paradoxically conjoined symbols of the Solar qualities. The Solar beings are described by Evola as being in this world, but not of it: they feel themselves as strangers in a strange land. Only ignorance or a waking "sleep" keep them bound to specific modes of being in the world. Gnosis, or awakening, what Guenon calls the Supreme Identity, liberates them from attachment to the world. Evola claims that such doctrines of awakening can only apply to the Solar race; attempts to extend such ideas as universal can lead only to misunderstandings.

This series, we hope, should make clear that the problem of the modern world is not a problem of thinking but rather of being. The error of the intellectual type is the belief that thinking the correct thoughts will somehow rectify things. Hence, there is incessant chatter and debate, which, apart from a few random conversions, always ends up in aporia.

The fundamental thing that matters is a change in the level of being.

Text The doctrine of the third degree of race must fundamentally limit its researches to the sphere of influence of a given race of the spirit and of its primordial tradition, following its developments, mutations (paravariations), and also distortions in the cycle that coincide with them and in which they act and react in the confrontation with the influences of different races or new environmental conditions. Once research is circumscribed that way, we arrive at a more limited concept of race, corresponding to that of the various differentiations or articulations of the primary element of such a cycle. Along the same lines, we cannot of course conceive of an atomic separation of the various "races of the spirit": their differences do not exclude relationships of descent or even of different hierarchical rank.

We previously sketched out the typology of races of the spirit, as far as it concerns the specific human cycle of the hyperborean race, in the second part of our work *Revolt against the Modern World* (with special regard to the properly traditional and spiritual aspect), and in the selection of the writings of J. J. Bachofen, and in a re-interpretation of them in a racial sense, included in the volume we edited under the title *La razza solare*. For a fuller treatment, the reader is therefore referred back to these two works. Here we will give only a brief schematic synthesis, necessarily lacking any justifying elements.

The solar or Olympic-solar race, corresponding to the hyperborean lineage and tradition, is to be considered superior and anterior to all the others in the cycle in question. It has as characteristic a type of "natural supernaturalism"; spirit and power, calm dominance, and readiness for precise and absolute action, a sense of "centrality" and of "firmness", and in its exterior effects, that virtue to which the ancients attributed a "numinous" quality (from *numen*), as superiority that imposes itself directly and irresistibly, that awakens simultaneously both fear and admiration, are marks of this "race of the spirit", by means of which it is naturally predestined to command and, at the limit, to the regal function. Fire and ice are united in it as in the ambiguous symbols of the original Nordic homeland and of the cycle in which it is eminently and primordially manifested: ice, as transcendence and inaccessibility; fire, as the specifically radiant solar quality of the men who give life, who awaken life, and generate light, but always from a supreme distance and almost with indifference, like the wake of a boat, not through enthusiasm, inclination, or human concern.

The ancient symbol of gold has always had connections with this form of spirituality. In the political forms of the origins, it acted as the substrate to sacred, or divine, regality, i.e., to the union of the two powers, of the regal and priestly function, the latter understood in a higher sense that will soon be made clear. The symbolic designations of the "divine" or "celestial" race must refer to the absence of the dualistic sentiment in

relations to supernatural reality, something that however is quite distinct from everything that is immanence or Promethean arrogance in the modern sense: it is not about men who believe they are gods, but of the type of men who naturally, through a not yet dim memory of origins and a condition of soul and body that do not cripple such a memory, feel they do not properly belong to the terrestrial race, to the extent of believing themselves men only by accident, or through "ignorance", or "sleep". The two terms *vidya* and *avidya* of the ancient Indo-Aryan teaching, that mean respectively "knowledge" (of the "supreme identity") and "ignorance" (that leads to the self-identification with one of the forms or modes of being of the conditioned world), are to be understood exactly in this context. When these terms are attributed to a different human condition and a different race of the spirit, that is, when turned into "philosophical" terms, they lose all meaning and give rise to misunderstandings of various types.

Posted on 2015-05-31 by Cologero

* * *

Mark Citadel on 2015-06-03 at 11:20 said:

Interesting how today's Nordics are some of the most spiritually degenerated in the world. Does the fish rot from the head, or is there a special historical sociohistorical reason for the total implosion in Tradition for countries like Sweden and Norway?

obscure on 2015-06-03 at 18:18 said:

Mark,

One the one hand, there is the Protestant tendency against any established authority or hierarchy; a tendency which prevents a community from being more than incidental. On the other hand, there is the current incidental cause operating on Northern Europeans in general i.e. post-WW2 race-guilt. These are the two general causes which are readily conceivable. One may also note how easily a certain self-concept may be diffused throughout a sparse population.

Lastly, wherever a hierarchy cannot be established which actualizes otherwise abstract principles, then there will be a tendency towards some form of political hedonism. Such hedonism may be quasi-moral and egalitarian or individualistic and egoistic, but it certainly won't be

representative of true principles except accidentally i.e. insofar as all reality is dependent upon some degree of truth. This last observation should mean that there are in fact 'seeds' present in the North even though the ground appears barren.

aegishjalmer on 2015-06-19 at 23:14 said:

Also, let's not forget that the Nordics were the last to be Christianised generally in Europe (c. 1000 in Iceland) and this was of limited success and depth. Hence they were quick to embrace an outlook that was anti Roman (Protestantism) and eventually, modern paganism in various ways, such as Asatru and general modern hedonism. The Nordics also have a strong culture of individualism in many ways, and are very transparent and open to other cultures historically, both in their exploration and contact, and in allowing others in. I don't think these ideas cover all there is to it, but national culture is one aspect.

Aleksandar Gueric on 2015-10-16 at 11:18 said:

I just received a book "Among the Hyperboreans" by Miloš Crnjanski. This interesting autobiography consists of a series of ruminations and meditations clothed in multiform melancholy on Europe at the end of 1930s and early 1940s, when he worked as a diplomat in Rome.

When Miloš Crnjanski, one of the greatest Serbian poets and authors of the last century, visited Nordic countries hoping to see a miracle of mid 20th century Socialism – in Denmark, Sweden and Norway, he realized that there was all along something else which brought him there. It was the North itself. So he headed further, to the shores of the North sea, wanting to dissolve in its waters. In his own words, ' 'something' ' changed all those who searched for the North, and he wants to discover it's secrets.

His life embodied that ' 'stranger in a strange land' 'concept. Exiled from communist Yugoslavia after the war, he spent life journeying through Europe, examining events, people and his own beliefs – finding errors in general ideas of civil rights, liberalism and democracy, who only began to take forms in that time, while carefully waiting his return to Ithaca. Little known fact is that he supported Musolini.

After the fall into despair and melancholy caused by the sickness of every day reality, what is left for us than to search for that Ideal, where Love, Death, Life, Dream and Hope unite? Will you struggle in the mud, and, if you are aninmal in human clothing, you certainly will enjoy it, or will you reach for the stars? For the Absolute, Sacred Center?

Milos' travels gravitated around two poles – Rome and Scandinavia, horizontally; vertically – between Hyperborea and Sumatra, which I, mythologicaly, recognize as Lemuria. This is Solar and Lunar dichotomy expressed often in poet's tendencies towards abstract Lunar spheres of the mind. He was, afterall, still a Romanticist, thus all the Moon, autumn and death imagery in his writings. But behind poetic expressionism, his was of a Solar race. Many Solar individuals mantle different personas. Romanticism and it's ideals, for example, often lie at the beginning

of a path in those born within a Solar race. It's an early, raw stage of awakened Primordial Man. Ecstasis of war, death and Platonic love is truly titanic, but not Olympic, so it often entraps those desparate souls at the very beginning of their search for a way out of the Mundane into the Golden. This is why so many Romantics celebrated war and even took part in some of them, from Spain to Greece, seeking heroic death in the Age when heroic death (or life) is almost unknown. This is the echo of their Solar origin. Even Novalis, archetypal Romantic, who venerated Sofia and Mother Night, once said that ' 'Man is a Sun' '. Little did he know (or perhaps he did), that this Man is quite rare. Solar Man is a man of Tradition, one and Perennial, and Novalis, as a man of Tradition, saw in French Revolution death of Europe.

Friedrich Hölderlin was a priest of Helios. This is a common Romantic naivette. If only he went further along the path of Solar Man, he would ascend to a priesthod of Apollo.

Crnjanski, like Evola, felt at home both in Rome and in Nordic countries. Eternal Mother Amor, the ever nourishing Fountain and distant North, Solar and Virile heroic coldness, parents of the European, Aryan Soul. Evola, on the other hand, felt no affection (unlike Guenon) with the Sumatrian – or Lunar center.

A symptom each Solar Man, a ' 'stranger in a strange land' ' will share is subtle Melancholy, expressed through a desire, deep rooted yearning towards the Absolute, while world is seen through the eyes of mono no aware. This isn't some pathetic sadness and infantile escapism but (supra)natural effect of a Soul awareness elevated from the Animal and connected to the Higher Center. It pulls towards the Transcendental, above the mass and material. Gravity of this Higher Center can break the Promethean chains, but only through the endeavor worthy of Herakle himself, meaning we must already have a divine potentiality. What happens when Olympian Fire is shared with everyone, both worthy and unworthy, we know through the myth of Prometheus. Sadly, modern Europeans, even some calling themsleves Traditionalist or ' 'of the Right' ', follow the Promethean path.

Heraklean labors, just like Odysseus' journey, are part of the Heroic, Solar Path. I don't share common opinion that we all inherently have our own, personal Odyssey, or, carry our own cross or hang from Yggdrassil. Or, that we are all immortal souls. That comes later, after accepting a call and undergoing a path. Most people don't follow any path but just pave a road.

In the end, all that's left is to wander these mysterios roads and gravitate towards different spiritual centers, according to our curent inner balance of psychic energies.

Tyler on 2018-05-22 at 12:59 said:
Why is the moon masculine and the sun feminine in Germanic mythology?

Dark Worship on 2020-01-14 at 18:51 said:
I believe the "high culture of individualism" is when people seek easy going and mediocre life(i for exemple, think in this way). It's not every person that has enough will to go to a war,

a guerrila warfare etc People will die on the same way, being killed by migrants on street or being killed in war. There's no escape, i dont believe in superhumans. Maybe the individualists just want peace being locked in home.

`Alice on 2021-11-05 at 08:10 said:`

While Evola tries to differentiate the concept of the Promethean and the Solar Race, the latter comes across as the Anti-Christ and the epitome of what Dostoevsky calls Man-Godism. Human beings can never approach God's level because God is the Supreme Person and we exist as His servants, whereas Evola derides Bhakti as inferior and "lunar." This doesn't seem any different from Theosophy or other New Age religions.

`S.P. on 2021-11-05 at 10:54 said:`

I disagree, although it is a common confusion. What Evola mentions does not consist in the identification of the human being as an individual man with the supreme God, but rather the self-knowledge / realization of the I, which implies the overcoming of the human state and therefore of the egoic individuality.

4.19 Shadows and Reflections: The Lunar Race

Julius Evola begins the topic of the Lunar Races with *The Demetrian Race*[17]. First, let's clarify Evola's method and its relationship to Mother Right by **J J Bachofen**.

Bachofen's book is a diachronic study of various cultures over time: their origin and evolution. Each one is guided by a different spiritual type; Bachofen is heavily dependent on the use of myth. Evola converts that to a synchronic study. That is, he recognizes each type as active and manifesting at the same time. The myths, then, describe the characteristics of various types of people, which Evola identifies as the "races of the spirit". As such, the specific historical and pre-historical manifestations of soci-

[17] See Section 4.20 in this book.

eties of a given type are not the major concern, except for purposes of illustration.

The Demetrian race does not recognize transcendent spirituality. Its focus is on the earth, matter. It lacks a spiritual center, so is prone to pantheism and universalism. Its concern is with the laws of nature, agricultural cycles, and cosmic harmony of the "we are all one" type. Since, for it, everything is "natural", it fails to recognize anything as deviant.

The Lunar Race is not self-effulgent. That is, it can only reflect the light from an external source. This is characteristic of the intellectual type who can only study or contemplate nature. This is also the Hermetic teaching. **Valentin Tomberg** identifies the 18th Arcanum, "The Moon" with "materialistic intellectuality". This then eclipses the "creative light of consciousness" for human intelligence.

In Arcanum XIX, The Sun, Tomberg goes on to say that the "task of human intelligence is to liberate itself from the magical enchantment which separates it from spontaneous wisdom ... to arrive at *intuition*." This intuition is the spontaneous wisdom of the heart, as Evola also points out.

You can take this as a warning, if you like, against incessant chatter and infinite discussion. What is necessary is a higher realization, not to waste your time among the "**shadows of ideas and things**".

Posted on 2015-06-07 by Aeneas

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`aegishjalmer on 2015-06-08 at 03:15 said:`
Thank you, this is something I needed to hear

4.20 The Demetrian Race

The other "spiritual races" of the cycle, to which our contemporaries belong, have as their premise a division and a separation of the two elements

of "spirituality" and "virility", and also "transcendence" and "humanity", that are synthetically united in the solar race. First of all, we point to the lunar race or Demetrian race. As to the analogous relationship, while the solar element is that which has in itself its own light and, in general, its own principle, the sun being, in such regard, the center of a given planetary system, the lunar element is that which instead receives or draws its light and principle from another. The sense of spiritual centrality is therefore lost in the lunar race, whether through degeneration (the moon as the extinguished sun), or through passive mixing with "telluric" type races of other cycles, that have degraded its original solar quality. The moon, as Bachofen points out, was also called the "celestial earth" by the ancients. There is therefore a sublimation of the law of the earth, the fate that is manifested under the forms of cosmic harmony and law of nature. Lunar man no longer feels himself to be the active center of spiritual reality: he is not even this reality, but rather the one who contemplates it, who studies its laws, who surpasses material action with contemplation and "tellurism", but still has not reached spiritual action.

The adjective "Demetrian", that we also give to this race, refers to a diffused, pantheistic, less dominating spirituality that is imbued with the sense of cosmic naturalistic laws and by a sacredness placed essentially under the feminine symbol: a spirituality that was precisely typical of the ancient Demetrian cults.

By extension, the priestly man is lunar in comparison to the regal man, he is the man who in the face of the spirit behaves like a normal woman facing a man, i.e., with a sense of submission and devotion. It is then interesting to note that the ancient traditions associated what today would be called cerebrality or intellectuality with the moon, instead associating the heart with the sun and attributing higher forms of knowledge to it. The intellectual is indeed also the lunar type, the man of passive reflection who, as the word indicates, moves only among "reflections", among the shadows of ideas and of things.

Thus the lunar race has varied characteristics. In the political field, wherever there is a division between the temporal and spiritual powers, the lunar spirit inevitably arises. The lunar ruler receives the highest consecration of his power from someone else, from a different non-regal priestly caste. In general, the lunar man has spiritually feminine traits. He lacks the feeling of centrality. In correspondence to the races of the body, he has the predominant nature of the Demetrian race which is that of the nations we called Atlantic-Occidental, in their prehistoric forms that led up to the Pelasgic, Minoan-Mycenaean, or Etruscan civilizations and to its further revival, Pythagoreanism. Such a race represents a decay of the hyperborean spirituality which appeared suddenly in the Atlantean regions through processes of action and reaction, causing a series of other changes. Lunar elements can moreover be observed in the race called the man of the East (Alpine-Oriental) by some race theorists—the psychoanthropology of Claus designates this race as the "race of evasion"—der Enthebungsmenschen—something that corresponds visibly to a characteristic of the lunar man.

Posted on 2015-06-07 by Aeneas

4.21 Impulse and Instinct: The Earth Race

Prior to the lunar or Demetrian cultural stage and the patriarchal, or solar, cultural stage, **J J Bachofen** identified, through the study of ancient myths, and even earlier stage which he called "hetaerism". **Julius Evola** gives the name "Telluric Race" in the Sintesi to the guiding spirit of that age. (Full text follows below)

In such periods, marriage is unknown and women held in common. Bachofen explains:

> Woman is not endowed with all her charms in order to grow old in the arms of one man: the law of matter rejects all restrictions,

> abhors all fetters, and regards exclusivity as an offense against its divinity.

Unlike the Demetrians, who developed agriculture, the Tellurians were associated with the natural flora and fauna of the marshy lowlands, as well as swamp cults. This life is represented by witches, who were involved with herb collecting and concoctions using lower life forms like toads and lizards. The battle between the Telluric and Solar impulses is demonstrated, for example, in the Nordic legend of the Virgin Spring[18], with Ingeri as the exemplar of the former and Karin of the latter.

The struggle between the Titans and the Olympic gods can also be understood in this context. The mlecchas were a degraded Telluric warrior caste, which the avatar Parashurama[19] came to destroy.

The Telluric Race The third race of the spirit that can be identified on the basis of ancient traditional symbols is the "telluric" or "titanic" race. It is a way of being that reveals itself by the adherence to life in all its immediacy, instinctiveness, and irrationality. The mind is today instinctively led to think of seismic phenomena by the term "telluric", more than recalling its etymology (from the Latin *tellus*, which means the earth), an assimilation that, in some respect, could even have some justification. The telluric race is that of an explosive impulsivity, from sudden changes or from absolute identifications. As intensive as it is, it is equally gloomy, however without the depth and detachment necessary to also be tragic. Sexuality has a considerable part in it in its most elementary aspect: naturally, not just phallic, virile sexuality. In this regard, apart from truly inferior races, it can actually be said that it can rather more easily appear in a woman than in a man, in accordance with an entirely telluric nature. The feeling of the personality in the telluric man is poorly

[18] `https://gornahoor.net/?p=1416`

[19] `https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Parashurama`

developed, the collective element predominates, in the sense that the ties of blood are always manifested in him in a material, atavistic, fatalistic form, something that can be clearly recognized in some typical aspects of the feeling of race and blood characteristic of the Hebraic people. In its appearance, not in primitivistic stages, but within a civilization previously formed by other human types, tellurism bears witness to the phase of the final decomposition of this civilization: it corresponds to the liberation and the unleashing, in a state of new freedom, of forces previously restrained by a higher law.

Through the appearance of sudden upheavals, one can recognize a telluric element in the race called "desert" by some race theorists, and also of a particular inner instability in the "East Baltic" race,. Through its gloomy and fatalistic side, the telluric man is then recognizable in the Etruscan race, in light of Bachofen's masterful description of it. Of course, the Mediterranean man generally, where he wants to form his own life according to a Nordic-Aryan style, has much to combat against this telluric possibility, even today. We then note that the telluric attribute was used by Keyserling, and not wrongly, to indicate an indisputable aspect of the so-called contemporary "world revolution".

In the cycles of primordial traditions, the titanic race appears as the natural antithesis to the race of Demetrian man, at the point where the original solar synthesis was lost. There we must then consider, above all, the degradation of the virile quality that now appears in a terrestrial form and makes its own not only the forms of a savage and violent assertion, but likewise some elemental forces of lower nature, tied, in times past, to the symbolism and the cult of Poseidon, for example. And one could in this regard, speak even of the promethean race, in as much as another distinctive trait of certain characteristics of such a race of the spirit is the attempt to usurp the dignity originally possessed by the solar race: from this arise the well-known myths of the battle of the Titans against the Olympic forces, or the memories contained in the Indo-Aryan tradition

in regard to the mlecchas, the warrior race humiliated in the immense revolt by Parashurama, the representative of the oldest and highest spirituality when the ancestors of the Aryan conquerors of prehistoric India were still inhabiting the Hyperborean region.

Posted on 2015-06-14 by Aeneas

* * *

Mark Citadel on 2015-06-30 at 10:30 said:

Would these societies have been highly primitive? I cant imagine any kind of actual civilization emerging from this.

Cologero on 2015-07-02 at 07:30 said:

Yes, they are degenerate versions of Demetrian societies. What sort of "civilization" do you think will arise from movements like Femen or FreeTheNipple?

4.22 The Telluric Race

The third race of the spirit that can be identified on the basis of ancient traditional symbols is the "telluric" or "titanic" race. It is a way of being that reveals itself by the adherence to life in all its immediacy, instinctiveness, and irrationality. The mind is today instinctively led to think of seismic phenomena by the term "telluric", more than recalling its etymology (from the Latin *tellus*, which means the earth), an assimilation that, in some respect, could even have some justification. The telluric race is that of an explosive impulsivity, from sudden changes or from absolute identifications. As intensive as it is, it is equally gloomy, however without the depth and detachment necessary to also be tragic. Sexuality has a considerable part in it in its most elementary aspect: naturally, not just phallic, virile sexuality. In this regard, apart from truly inferior races, it can actually be said that it can rather more easily appear in a woman than in a man, in accordance with an entirely telluric nature. The feeling of the

personality in the telluric man is poorly developed, the collective element predominates, in the sense that the ties of blood are always manifested in him in a material, atavistic, fatalistic form, something that can be clearly recognized in some typical aspects of the feeling of race and blood characteristic of the Hebraic people. In its appearance, not in primitivistic stages, but within a civilization previously formed by other human types, tellurism bears witness to the phase of the final decomposition of this civilization: it corresponds to the liberation and the unleashing, in a state of new freedom, of forces previously restrained by a higher law.

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Posted on 2015-10-05 by Cologero

4.23 Civilizations of Space and Civilizations of Time

The remaining traces, often still only in stone, of some of the great civilizations of the origins often contain a rarely noticed meaning. In the face of what remains of the most ancient Greco-Roman world and then that of Egypt, Persia, China, eventually reaching the mysterious and mute megalithic monuments scattered among deserts, lands, and forests as the final emergent and immobile vestiges of submerged and hidden worlds—and, as the boundary in the direction opposite to the course of history, including some forms of Medieval Europe: in the face of everything that comes from asking if the miraculous resistance to time of such civilizations, due to a favorable concourse of exterior circumstances, does not also include a symbolic meaning.

This feeling is reinforced if we focus primarily on the general character of the life of the civilizations to which in a great part such traces belong, that is on the general character of life called "traditional". It is a life that has maintained the same through centuries and generations, in an essential fidelity to the same principles, to the same type of institutions, to the same vision of the world; in the face of calamitous events, also susceptible to adaption and external modifications, but unalterable in its nucleus, in its animating principle, in its spirit, in its unanimity.

Such a world seems to bring us back especially to the Orient. If you think of what China and India were up until relatively recent times, and

even the Japanese up to recently. But, in general, the more you recede back in time, the more you feel that living, universal, and powerful type of civilization, so that the Orient must be considered only as the part of the world where, through fortuitous circumstances, it was able to subsist longer and develop better than elsewhere. In such a type of civilization the law of time seems to be, in part, suspended. More than in time, these civilizations seem to have had life in *space*. They had a "timeless" character.

These, according to the formulation current today, would therefore be the "stable", "static" or ultraconservative civilizations. In reality, they are the civilizations whose material vestiges even seem destined to live longer than all the monuments or all the ideal creations of the modern world that appear powerless to endure more than a half century and within which the words "progressive" or "dynamism" mean only a compliance to contingency, to the movement of an incessant change, of a rapid ascent and a likewise rapid, vertiginous decline. Processes that do not obey a true internal organic law, that are not contained within boundaries, that atomize themselves and take the hand of those from whom they were favoured: that is the characteristic of this different world, in all its sectors. That does not prevent it being made a criterion of the measure for everything which in the eminent sense should be called "civilization", in the field of a historiography for which the other types are judged to have arrogant and pejorative values.

In this regard, the misunderstanding is typical that confuses immobility with something that had a rather different meaning in traditional civilizations: unchangeability. These civilizations were civilizations of *being*. Their strength was manifested precisely in their identity, in the victory they achieved over becoming, over "history", over change, over unformed flow. They are the civilizations that descended into the depths, beyond the fickle and treacherous waters, and established solid roots in those depths.

The opposition between modern and traditional civilizations can be expressed this way: *modern civilizations are devourers of space, traditional civilizations were devourers of time*.

The former, or modern civilizations, are vertiginous from their frenzy of motion and spatial conquest, generators of an inexhaustible arsenal of mechanical means capable of reducing every distance, shortening every interval, contracting everything that is scattered in a multitude of places into a feeling of ubiquity. The excitement of a need to possess; dark anguish in the face of everything that is detached, isolated, deep, or distant; the impulse to self-expansion, to circulate, and to be associated and to find itself in every place, outside as well as inside. Science and technology, promoted by this irrational existential impulse, in their turn reinforce it, feed it, exacerbate it: trade, communications, ultrasonic speeds, radio, television, standardization, cosmopolitanism, internationalism, unlimited production, the American spirit, the "modern" spirit.

Quickly the matrix extends itself, reinforces itself, perfects itself. Terrestrial space has hardly any more mysteries. The pathways through the earth, water, sky are opened up. The human gaze has probed the most remote heavens, the infinitely great and the infinitesimally small. One no longer speaks of other lands but of other planets. On ours, action is carried like lightening far and wide. The tumultuous confusion of a thousand voices blend little by little into a uniform, atonal, impersonal rhythm. They are the latest effects of what was called Western "Faustianism", which is not unlike the same revolutionary myth in its various aspects including that technocratic formulation in the field of a decadent messianism.

In contrast, traditional civilizations were vertiginous precisely in their stability, their identity, their unstoppable and immutable existence in the midst of the current of time and history: so that they became capable of expressing a shadow of eternity even in sensible and tangible forms. They were islands in time, bastions in time; they acted as forces consum-

ing time and history. Precisely because of this characteristic, it is imprecise to say that they "were"— it would be more correct to say that they simply *are*. If they seem to draw back and almost vanish in the distance of a past which sometimes has even mythical traits, that is only the mirage to which anyone is necessarily subject, when he is transported by an irresistible current that increasingly distances him from the places of spiritual stability. Moreover, this idea corresponds exactly to the image of the "double perspective" given by an ancient traditional teaching: the "immobile lands" retreat and move for those who go with the waters, the waters move and retreat for those who reside solidly in the "immobile lands".

To understand this image, relating it not the physical plane but the spiritual plane, means to perceive also the right hierarchy of values, wherever our gaze is carried beyond the horizon which encloses our contemporaries. What seemed to be the past makes itself present, through its essential relation of historical forms (contingent as such) to metahistorical contents. What was qualified as "static" is seen to be saturated with enormous life. *The others*, they are the fallen, the decentered. The philosophy of becoming, historicism, evolutionism, and so on appear as the intoxications of castaways, like the truth typical of those who flee ("*where are you fleeing to, idiots*?" Bernanos), and of those who do not have inner consistency and who do not know what inner consistency is and not even the source of every true height and every actual achievement—of the same achievement that cannot be limited to the intangible and the often invisible spiritual heights but were in fact expressed equally in epics, in cycles of civilizations that, precisely, even in their mute and dispersed vestiges of stone, seem to conceal something supertemporal and eternal. To which are also added traditional artistic, monolithic, rough, and powerful creations, alien from everything that is subjectivistic, often anonymous, almost extensions of the same elementary forces.

Finally we must recall what the conception of the time itself was in

traditional civilizations: not an irreversible linear conception, but cyclic, in periods. From a combination of customs, rites and institutions characteristic both of higher civilizations and of echoes existing in some peoples described as "primitive" (in such regard, we recommend the same material gathered from the history of religions by Huber, Mauss, Eliade, and others) the firm intention is to bring time back to the origins (whence the cycle), in the sense of destroying what in it that is simply becoming, of restraining it, of making it express or reflect metahistorical, sacred, or metaphysical structures, often connected to myth. In such terms—as a "moving image of eternity"—time acquired a value and a direction, not as "history". Returning to the origins meant a restoration, drawn to the fountain of perpetual youth, confirming spiritual stability, against temporality. The great cycles of nature evoked this attitude. "Historical consciousness", inseparable from the situation of "modern" civilizations, only sealed the fracture, the fall of man into temporality. But it is presented as an achievement of the last man, that is, of crepuscular man.

It is not unusual that, even within the field of presumed scientific objectivity, certain discoveries, the origins of general conceptions destined to revolutionize an epoch, have the character of a sign, so that their happening in a given period, and not in another, should not be considered accidental. Referring, for example, to the science of nature, it is more or less known to anyone, according to the latest voguish theories of Einstein and his disciples, that it is an indifferent thing to affirm that the Earth moves around the sun, or the opposite: it is only a question of preferring a greater of lesser complication of astrophysical calculations in the fixing the relational systems. Now, it seems rather significant that the Copernican discovery, with which it ceased to be "true" that the Earth is the solid and immobile center of the celestial entities, and it becomes "true" instead that it moves itself, and through its law is wandering in the cosmic space, as an irrelevant part of a dispersed system of expansion into the indefinite. It seems, let's say, rather significant that this discovery hap-

pened more or less at the time of the Renaissance and humanism, that is, at the time of the most decisive upheaval for the coming of the new civilization, in which the individual lost little by little every connection with that which "is", he degenerated from every spiritual centrality to the point of making his own the point of view of becoming, of history, of change, of the irrepressible and unpredictable current of life. The most remarkable upheaval was instead the pretense—the illusion—of having finally discovered, of affirming and glorifying "man", hence the term "humanism". In fact this was reduced to that which is "only human" with the impoverishment of the possibility of an opening and an integration into the "more than human".

This is not the only one of the symbolic revolutions that could be mentioned in this matter. Using the example we made, one point must be made precise about the "Copernican revolution": in the traditional world no so-called "objective" truth was important. Truths of that type could be also be incidentally considered, in the sense of their actual relativity on one hand, and of their human value on the other hand, bearing in mind the criteria of opportunities in regards to the general mode of feeling. A traditional theory of nature could therefore be also "incorrect" from the point of view of modern science (in one of its stages). But its value, the reason for which it was superior lay in its susceptibility to act as a means of expression of something true on a different and more interesting plane. For example, the geocentric theory was that the world of sensible appearances grasped an aspect suitable to act as a support for a truth of a different and unassailable type, to the truth regarding "being", the spiritual centrality, as principle of the true essence of man.

This will suffice to clarify morphologically the contrast between the civilizations of space and the civilizations of time. From that, it would also be easy to deduce the corresponding typological and existential contrast between the man of one civilization and the man of another. And if we are to move on to the problem of the crisis of the present epoch on the

basis of what was already said, the uselessness of any criticism whatsoever, of any reaction, of any velleity of rectifying actions should appear in a rather clear way before an internal change of polarity, a metanoia, to use the ancient term, in man himself or, at least, in a determinate number of men in positions of exercising a decisive influence, is produced: in the sense of a shift toward the dimension of "being", of "that which is", a dimension gone missing and dissolved in modern man so that very little is any longer known about what internal stability and centrality are, and therefore also calm and higher security while instead a hidden sense of anxiety, of restlessness, and of emptiness is diffused ever more in spite of the systematic use on a large scale and in all the domains of the anesthetic spirituality recently invented. From the sense of "being", of stability, also that of the limit, as principle, it could not originate in a natural way, even in a more external domain, for the reaffirmation of forces and processes which have become stronger than those that put them recklessly into a movement of temporality.

But to consider the civilization in its entirety, it remains absolutely problematic where solid points of leverage can be found in a civilization like the modern one that is in every way, to an extent unprecedented in the past, a civilization of time. On the other hand, it appears quite obvious that, more than a correction, there would be the end of a form, the origination of a new form. Thus, logically, at best, we can think only of different orientations in some particular domain and especially in that which, almost like an awakening, a few differentiated men can still propose and implement invisibly.[20]

Posted on 2019-08-25 by Aeneas

[20]The differentiated type, defined by the possession of the dimension of being, is contrasted to the existential orientations suitable to a period of dissolution, like the current one, as we formulated in *Ride the Tiger*.

5

Guido de Giorgio

5.1 An Introduction to Guido de Giorgio

Guido Lupo Maria De Giorgio, pseudonym "Havismat" (San Lupo, October 3 1890 – Mondovi, December 27, 1957) was an esoterist and Italian writer.

After graduating with a degree in philosophy, he went to Tunisia where he worked as a teacher of Italian. There, he came into contact with Islamic esoterism through a local brotherhood. He then moved to Paris after WW I, where he got to know Rene Guenon. He backed his friend, collaborated with him by writing articles for the two major French esoteric journals of the time: *Le Voile d'Isis* and *L'initiation*.

He returned to Italy in the 1920's and participated in the *Gruppo di Ur*, writing under the name **Havismat**. In 1930, he joined with **Julius Evola** in promoting the journal *La Torre*, in which he came up with a theory of a type of Sacred Fascism with the effort to universalize the Fascist movement in an esoteric way.

In *La Tradizione romana* (*The Roman Tradition*), de Giorgio ac-

cused Europe in the aftermath of WW II of have become scientistic and of stifling the spiritual research of man. The solution, according to de Giorgio, lay in returning to an ancient conception of spiritual and temporal authority. A typescript version of this work, whose original title was "The dead badge of power. Introduction to the doctrine of Roman Sacred Fascism", was given to **Benito Mussolini** for Christmas in 1939.

In *Dio e il Poeta* (*God and the Poet*), de Giorgio poured out his mystical experience arising from his ascetical practices.

None of his works was published during his lifetime, some posthumously and others still unpublished.

Julius Evola In *Cammino del Cinabro*, Julius Evola describes Guido de Giorgio.

> He was a type of initiate in the wild and chaotic state, he had lived among the Arabs and personally knew Guenon, who held him in high esteem. He was a man of exceptional culture, he knew several languages, but he had a rather unstable temperament and strong passionate positions, emotive and lyrical almost like Nietzsche.

Evola goes on to describe de Giorgio's erratic personal and love life, his strong personality, then describes their collaborations and even trips together to the Alps. (They both loved the mountains.) Evola conceded that towards the end, they grew apart somewhat due to de Giorgio's "indulgence in a sort of Vedanta-ized Christianity".[1]

From La Tradizione romana

> The restoration that we propose, taking up again the thought, aspiration and ideal of **Dante**, is a return to the spirit of Rome,

[1]Apparently, Evola was unaware of *La Tradizione romana*, which was never published during his lifetime.

> not the pure and simple repetition of the past that would unrealizable, because nothing of the contingencies of the world ever repeats itself, but the adhesion to those eternal principles of truth that are contained in the Sacred Books and expressed by ancient symbols. To save Europe and the West from catastrophe, it would depend not as much on the external material things that are of scant value in themselves, but on those deep, internal, spiritual values ... the catastrophe of the life of the spirit, the collapse of the truth.

References:

- Wikipedia article[2]
- "Il Cammino del Cinabro", by Juius Evola
- La Tradizione romana[3], by Guido de Giorgio

Posted on 2010-12-18 by Cologero

5.2 The Constitution of a Traditional Society: The Capo

The Supreme Leader

> This is the concluding section of **Guido De Giorgio**'s description of the establishement of a traditional society. Here, he develops the idea of the supreme leader, above the three castes, whose primary duty is the maintenance of Tradition.

[2] `https://it.wikipedia.org/wiki/Guido_De_Giorgio`
[3] `https://it.wikipedia.org/wiki/Guido_De_Giorgio`

> This section, as a whole, needs to be compared to the similar efforts by Guenon, Coomaraswamy, and Evola to describe the respective roles of Spiritual Authority and Temporal Power. However, De Giorgio's work comes from a completely different place, from a deep understanding of the principles involved. The other three try to make an "argument", by referring to various scriptures or historical situations. Guido De Giorgio speaks from the heart, from what he knows; he can be judged on that basis. That is how Tradition is to be recovered.
>
> Interspersed within the main topic, as always there are various spiritual gems to be recovered. We can call attention in particular to the notion that a man creates his own life. Also, pace those who want to create a superman, De Giorgio believes that man qua man must vanish in order for something higher to appear.

We could repeat at this point the exhortation that Homer put into the mouth of wise Ulysses when the Greeks appeared to abandon the Trojan adventure and that even Aristotle cited at the end of Book XII of the Metaphysics: "let there be one ruler." There is first of all the great law of analogy according to which the only leader in time must correspond to the supreme unity in eternity and since God is pure contemplation and only the cognitive fruition of aseity can be conceived in Him, so the Leader inversely will make a pure activity of his life dedicated to the maintenance of his command on the earth.

He holds temporal power, exercises it uncontested, and is the supreme authority whose domain embraces all the active life in its multiple aspects and over which he is the regulator and judge. His function is therefore integrative and his work is strictly dependent on Justice, the highest of the virtues.

If on the one hand, while being the supreme leader, he is above all the prince of the Warriors, his power is exercised over all indiscriminately in the temporal environment because he could not go beyond it without

failing in his task and his purpose.

Although he arose from the Warrior caste, in order to carry out his task he is above the three castes and so must, while remaining strictly within the scope of the active life, serve as the harmonious base of the development of the first two castes, from the first receiving consecration, and serving for the protection and the maintenance of the traditional order of the second. In order to preserve inviolate his sovereignty, he will have to guard the Temple that is the foundation of every tradition and defend the Priests who nourish with their spiritual influence the body of the truths accessible only to the contemplatives. While depending spiritually on them, he is absolutely autonomous in his domain and the Priests in this owe him obedience as all men belonging to the other two castes, nor can or should the spiritual insert itself into the temporal and compromise the pure sphere of contemplation which does not have to undergo profanation of that sort.

The unity of command represents the centralizing equilibrium of the active life that loses in the Leader its particularistic and widespread character in order to rise to a level analogous to the Edenic state where everything is put before man who is truly the king of creation. Therefore the Leader vanishes only before God where his sovereignty is annulled in the Lordship of all the lords: everything in this life, he will be in the other that which he will have merited according to the meaning it will have had from God. "Caesar I was, Justinian I am…" [Dante, Paradise vii]. In the face of God the greatest victory will be that which he will have been able to bring back on himself and on what he will have accomplished on earth, nothing will matter for him except the works of justice, rectification, equilibrium, and peace. Since the Leader must always seek peace for his subjects in analogy with that same thing that in the contemplative order is the foundation of every realization and all aspire to that type of activity that develops them. The maintenance of this equilibrium is reserved to the Warriors who will always make war an instrument of peace

and not of pure and simple conquest. The unity of the empire avoids the unproductive diffusions of the active life concentrating its energies toward a single end where all disparities and partial imbalances are evened out, therefore if in the Warriors, as was said, inner asceticism is the necessary base for the development of their activity, this is even more strict in the Leader who must annul in himself any individuality whatsoever in order to make justice triumph and the rule secure the empire.

He knows that he is the supreme ruler of the active life and that the active vibration emanates from him that, in analogy with the divine, is extended to all the branches of humanity of which he constitutes the propelling and purifying center through which the backward wave [onda di ritorno] obtains new energy for new possibilities of development in a perpetually mobile and fecund circle of flux and reflux.

We are purely in the sphere of action in which all men necessarily live and to which none are exempt except those who can and must dedicate themselves to the contemplative life: what each man accomplishes in it, and the way in which he accomplishes it, has a very great importance for the equilibrium of human perfection that would be maimed and amputated if an element is removed from that current of active homogeneity that constitutes temporal modality.

All traditions in fact reserve the contemplative life to those for whom it is appropriate and who are worthy of it, while they condemn asceticism and separation from the world for those who lie outside it obeying a sense of inadmissible egoism: those are the weak and the lifeless and they avoid the responsibility of worldly life through real insufficiency. It will be well to insist on that: everyone brings and creates, so to speak, his environment and by this word we do not mean only the closest circle, but the entire temporal extent of human life with everything which is positive and negative in it for the individual. Making use here of an image, we could say that every man has a passage of existence that is not only his world, but all the world that is for him what he is for the world itself:

in this passage that starts from the center of a circumference and is contained between two divergent rays which, having as base a segment of the circumference itself, form a cone, there is everything that man wants and that he does not want, his fortune, his misfortune, his battle, his dispute, his victory or his downfall. The essential thing for him is to rise up in ascending planes from the circumference to the center, from the base of the cone to the vertex that represents the greatest of the minimum, i.e., God, while reassimilating all multiplicity gradually into a point only in which he is annulled, because he, dispelling ignorance, will recognize himself in everything, even and above all, in that to which he is most opposite and will recompose in a perfect equilibrium all the antagonisms up to the point of extinguishing them in the highest vortex of his asceticism, or better said, of his recovery, which is God.

When we employ this term, we mean everything that is truly of God in God, truly and not fallaciously, i.e., all the superhuman states of union with God that man can realize only starting from himself in order to reach that which is no longer himself, man before, no longer man afterwards.

The terrestrial level is one experience and not another, that is necessary to start from a base of disablement in order to reach an apex of absolute immutability: these are the two greatest terms in the sphere of that which appears in the seat of human relativity: a fallacious reality, man, a genuine reality, God, the former only illusory, the latter, supreme certainty. But placing oneself at an integrative point of view, one is reality, God, who is no longer a goal which one reaches except through a dissipation of ignorance, as whoever believes real the phantasms of the fog that are non-existent provided the sun dispels and dissolves it.

The Role of the Leader

In this second of three parts, **Guido De Giorgio** expands on the role of the Leader in a traditional society. It is instructive to compare De Giorgio's point of view with Evola's idea of the state;

> De Giorgio includes the spiritual or contemplative aspect which brings in some subtle changes. Nevertheless, Di Giorgio also recognizes that the active life can also be a path to realization.
>
> The emphasis on the law is also important, such Guenon pointed out that the western medieval tradition did not have a sacred law. There was, and is, canon law, but that is at a lesser level. What De Giorgio is describing is more akin to sharia law in Islam, or the complex rituals and requirements required of Hindu castes, and even the ancient Romans whose daily lives were regulated by rites and taboos. Abandoning such laws, in his view, does not lead to more freedom, but rather to is opposite: it leads to servitude to one's passions and lower nature.

On the other hand, by not knowing himself man does not know God because only the knowledge of his illusory existence permits him to realize the essential truth of God in a process that moves from negation to affirmation, from human nothingness to divine wholeness, not from a fragment to a totality, but from a non-totality to totality, from illusory human unity to real divine unity, not from duality to unity, but from non-duality to unity. This knowledge entails an effective realization that in its turn annuls the earthly sphere, the environment in which man lives, putting all its elements on a plane of absolute equivalence, i.e., neutralizing, dissipating the sense of otherness that derives from the possessive conceit concluding in the ontological absurdity "I am I".

The process of realization instead denies the first person, affirms the second, unifies the first and third, and definitively puts itself beyond this union, in what we could call the Fourth Sublime, the Fourth Absolute.

This is the ideal plan of transhumanization presented as a fieri while it is an esse, and it is the decisive model of everything in principle and therefore also and above all of the Leader who is not such if he does not take on the experience of his subjects in the purity of the distributive standard and in the unification of sovereign power. Therefore his function

is, so to say, the restoration of hierarchy, the consecration of the human body whose members are the subjects while he is the vivifying center that accomodates the innumerable expressions of the active life, purifies them in the renovating power of traditional principles whose deposit the Priests hold and returns them almost equipped with a more intense rhythm and clad with the united seal.

In this sense he the first and the last of his subjects because his subordination to divine principles is dependent on his capacity to centralize the forms of active life while expending his personality in a decisive totalization. The relationship between the Leader and his subjects consists in this, that he is in all and all are in him with an absolute reciprocity that makes of the entire active life a veritable sacrifice, i.e., an imperfection made sacred through the gift that is made of it to God in the person of the Leader. He accepts and gives, and what he offers is always himself: he is responsible for how much his subjects accomplish because in him everything merges in order to receive the supreme consecration. The asceticism of the Leader is in a sense superior to that of the Warriors because it is vaster and more integral, accomodating in himself all the developments of the active life in order to maintain them within the traditional ambit with the spiritual authority of the Priests and the power of the Warriors, from the former, the conscience, and from the latter, the personality so that ascetically the last in front of God is the first in front of men. His activity, obeying the law of justice, is thus purged of any personal motives whatsoever because, by becoming Leader, he consecrated himself to the coming of peace on earth and governs in order to make it respected and he provides the harmony of traditional society with a constant effort of rectification. As God is the ruler of all the worlds, he is the ruler of the earth and of the men who inhabit it, the supreme regulator of their activity without passing beyond his domain which is that of the active life, without which he could be in open conflict with his function and purpose as temporal leader occupying the contemplative sphere that is

to the Priests reserved. Harmony must precisely consist in the separation of the two powers that, on earth, and on earth alone, where activity is in force, conserving two distinct spheres while it no longer exists in an ultra-worldly stage that is the starting point for the integral realization of the divine.

The subjects owe the Leader obedience and respect; obedience because he directs human affairs, analogously with God who rules the creative universality, and respect because his function is the application of justice, i.e., the rectification of the disparities produced by the multiformity of men's actions and protects them and guides them to the realization of happiness in whose terminal and plenary stage is Edenic perfection.

Human activity when brought back to the purpose of rite is purified from every contaminating egoism and the man who has fulfilled his temporal stage in prefect adherence to the norm of justice, regains the absolute preeminence over the other beings of whom he becomes again lord and he enjoys the Great Peace in the exercise of his liberty released from every abuse. It is the Leader's precise function to tend to this reintegration of the divine state, directing all the forms of earthly activity toward a progressive purgation and acting so that man can fulfill what is granted to him on earth without actions limiting and precluding contemplation but, regulated and ordered, more than a snag and a chain, is itself a mode of liberation. And he can become it only if conducted according to justice which is the greatest of the virtues, especially for the Leader who must prefer it more than any other virtue because his action neutralizes the will leading every form of activity back into its channel, preventing abuses of power and giving true liberty to the subjects, i.e., the spiritual practice that is gained with obedience to the law.

Here man is liberated by obeying and not otherwise: whoever does not understand that will always be subjugated. In fact, in order to obey it is necessary to understand the value of the law that is placed to redeem

men from the appetites that enslave and to make him able to exercise his freedom effectively. The Leader must be vigilant in respect to the law in order to facilitate the gaining of freedom and he himself will be liberated to the extent he maintains the limits of his temporal function without ever passing beyond them. The law in itself does not know how to nor can it make itself respected, but it needs whoever establishes it, and since it is a pure norm higher than men, it must be imposed: in this sense strength accompanies justice, nor can it be separated and the Leader must make the law respected with strength. But from submission to the law, freedom is born that, being purely of the spiritual order and belonging to the contemplative life, arises only from the perfection of this, like a crowning achievement, an apical stage that is the triumph of man over himself.

Man calls himself free only when he again becomes the son of truth and does not recognize subjection other than this to the point of confusing himself, identifying with a further state which will be that of pure unity. But in the domain of the active life, it is not possible to be liberated other than by obeying the law personified in the Leader who must make it respected with strength, not through an affirmation of supremacy—which is to be excluded in a traditional society—but to prevent the subjects from falling into servitude by breaking the law. The temporal power is inclined to the achievement of freedom and is established for this, so that, by imposing the law, the immoderate will is avoid, the bestial part in man is restrained, and it is started precisely to be free. To regulate the active life can signify nothing other that is positively fertile than to permit contemplative practice in the measure conceded to each one by his spirit. In civil life, freedom is therefore obedience and in the contemplative life it is liberation: up to this point it is understood that man is not so much born free as he becomes free, and better said, born free, he can maintain his freedom or fall into servitude: most men, by forgetting freedom, which is a divine gift, prefer servitude to their passions, and this

they call freedom and are opposed to the monarchical regime because they see in the Leader a man like them and not a model who, in order to make himself respected, must necessarily personify himself: one is not liberated, but becomes liberated, and naturally he becomes it because he is it, but ignorance prevents him from knowing why man is born free: only for the fulfillment of his earthly experience and not for the exaltation of that which is least human in him. He was free at his birth as the son of God, but, straying in order to follow his impulse, which he fallaciously calls freedom, he has become again a slave: in order to become free again, i.e., a son of God, he must put himself under the regulative norm of the active life and to regain the freedom of the contemplative life.

Conclusion

> This is the conclusion to the role of the Leader in a traditional society. It needs to be read meditatively, and not with the intent to refute or falsify it. If read in silence, without the infusion of personal opinions, something very different may be heard.

We said that man first denies himself and then affirms himself: he denies himself in the law and affirms himself in love, which is only the supplementary knowledge of the truth. Now the active life cannot be abandoned to the disordered will of the appetites which would make it an end in itself, while it is only a means whose purpose is clearly determined by the temporal power embodied in the Leader. In order to be truly such, it is necessary that this power be employed by a single man so that every subject contemplates himself in his sovereign, his better part, to whom he must submit himself, the reason that regulates every activity restraining them within their limits and preventing them from gravely obstructing the attainment of the pure values of the spirit.

If the natural end of man is heaven, the starting point is the earth, so that the necessity for making its foundation organized by a liberating

action that acts especially on the obstructing element, the body, which abandoned to itself, precludes every possibility of overcoming and attainment. That which is corporeal remains subordinated to the psychic element that is transparently vague through its elusiveness and diffusivity: the virtues inherent in the active life, that the Leader rules and directs, have as their field of action the psychic complex that must be contained and limited by reason as if by a supreme command. But reason is in a certain sense two-edged to the extent that on the one hand it dominates and restrains the lower faculties and on the other, it inserts into a higher order of reality where the intellect extends and, while being human, is the mediator between the human and the divine: likewise the Leader rules in the sign of justice so that a higher stage becomes a reality, whose domain belongs more specially to the Priests, but it is necessary for the Warriors to facilitate this perfection.

Given that, it indicates that war is the condition of peace as long as it is truly conducted by those for whom it is their only given mission and within the limits that make it justifiable and necessary.

In the earthly and human domain, law must make use of force and the symbol and the means of justice is two-edged sword, one of which strikes and points toward the lower, which the other points higher and is bloodless, the point representing the peak of unification of the higher and the lower, the supreme acme, death, or resolution Thus what seemingly appears cruel, is not always so in reality, and the justice that imposes itself with force is often the necessary vestibule of the highest sphere of love. The activity of the Leader in human and earthly life is analogous to that of God, whose direct instrument he is, in order to coordinate the modes of activity pursuant to justice, truth, and love. No one more than the Leader knows that by punishing others he punishes himself and that with an act of justice he fulfills an achievement of love and truth: if he does not know this, if the ignores his purpose, he is not truly a leader, but a slave of his own cupidity, since he cannot command if he is not aware

of the raison d'.tre of his authority, of the divine character of his mission.

A Warrior among the Warriors he must be an ascetic among the ascetics: so he will reach the point to rule others by how much more he will rule himself and to defeat his enemies by defeating himself, and to fight the small wars by fighting the Great War, and to achieve external peace by how much more profoundly and perfectly he will have achieved interior peace, knowing that earthly life is only a stage, but the most important of all, of which he is the orderer. His responsibility is very great before men but especially before God since by betraying his creatures he betrays his Creator and by neglecting justice in order to follow his own impulse he contradicts the nobility of the position that he occupies and abuses the power that is given to him: then he will truly be last among men and servant among the servants. Since there is no justice without a judge, so the Leader is also judge among men and here his task is still more serious and difficult: he must be very attentive and not exceed the scope in which his activity unfolds, since as judge he can affect the case, but not the knowledge of those who have accomplished it. He knows in fact that everything that happens may not happen and that there is nothing open to censure that others accomplish that he himself cannot accomplish, since men are the mirror of man and he, as Leader, is the mirror of the time in which he lives and is also the supreme responsible man for it.

His more or less great adherence to tradition is measured by the degree of greater or lesser spirituality of the era in which he lives and of which he is the judge. He must dematerialize the world, bring active life back within its normal limits, to make action a means and not an end, and contemplation an end and not a means, and force the pure expression of law and power, the assertion of his humility before God, and justice the implacable rectification, and the gift of himself the constant offering.

He is in the world to redeem it, to purify it in the name of God, for the love of God, because he, with the Warriors, is the protector of the

Temple and his mission is the respect of the sacred law to which he is subject and through which he is the Leader, since everything that comes from God must return to God, and what is accomplished on earth is only for the dignity of the true man who is a son of God. His true glory, his true conquest will have facilitated it, prepared it, realized the coming of the kingdom of God, having transformed life in a rite redeeming man from his state of servitude, leading him to liberty through to liberation, making of the active life a connecting bridge to the beatitude of contemplation where the divine is only realized, ransoming not oppressing, spiritualizing not materializing.

Only in that way will he be the God's chosen and his power will receive that consecration from which all authority comes. He knows that man and the world are of God and that everything must flow into the great traditional axis that is sustained by sacred knowledge of which he is the most pious and aware supporter. The active life that he rules and normalizes must be contained within the limits that permit each man to rise to the sphere of contemplation where true life begins, the divine life, and his mission unfolds in the temporal sphere for eternity, on earth for heaven, the center of the innumerable efforts that flows from every point into a single wave, in a single rhythm, for the glory of the one before Whom everything is nothing and the nothing is all.

Supreme bundler of fasces [Fascificatore], the Leader redeems the transience of man and the world with the vivifying rhythm of tradition of which he must be the most intransigent defender in order to establish the constitutive unity of castes, the harmony of principles, the respect of standards, the convergence of all the efforts in the fulfillment of his very high mission, so that the world is truly the mark, the crown, and the sign of God.

Posted on 2013-07-21 by Cologero

* * *

Jason-Adam on 2013-07-21 at 12:26 said:

In the Christian tradition, the capo existed in the form of the Byzantine Emperor, and later the Russian Tsar who was the absolute ruler over both spiritual and temporal realms…….in the East the Emperor protected defended the church but the church was still subject to his laws. In the West the Capo never emerged due to conflicts between the Popes and the Emperors……

Cologero on 2013-07-22 at 13:07 said:

J-A, do you suppose that Guido De Giorgio is proposing a thought experiment along the lines of Plato's Republic? Although the domain of the Capo is activity, unlike God, he can never be pure act, so there is always non-being or privation associated with his rule. The stronger Leaders can come closer to the ideal.

JA on 2013-07-23 at 12:16 said:

Of course de Giorgio is discussing an ideal, but it is our task to make the ideal real….if not now then when the time is right…….

It is also a good question whether or not the Capo could ever actually exist, perhaps Justinian or Charlemagne came close ?

JA on 2013-07-29 at 10:42 said:

From my first readings de Giorgio's ideas read very much like that of the Byzantine-Russian practice of symphonia where church and state were separate but linked in that the Tsar was anointed by the patriarch and expected to be a good Christian at the risk of losing his legitimacy from God, but while subject to the church in spiritual matters the Emperor was ruler of the church in temporal realms.

In the western history I'm trying to understand if Roman Catholic doctrine would allow for a Capo or would the Pope claim too much power in temporal affairs that an absolute monarch would never be able to exist ?

Cologero on 2013-07-29 at 12:39 said:

Tomberg addresses this very question, as it is enshrined in the arcana of the Pope and the Emperor.

For example:

"The authors of the Middle Ages could not imagine Christianity without an Emperor."

JA on 2013-07-29 at 14:17 said:

Tomberg follows the Catholic conception but is his vision of the Emperor the same as de Giorgio's ? I'll have to read this essay several more times before I am able to conclude for sure but now it's seeming to me that the Capo has more power than the Holy Roman Emperor (for

example the priests are subject to him in the temporal sphere, whereas the Church claimed that a King or and Emperor had no power over a clergyman, the clergy answer to the Pope alone, hence no state could be absolute because the clergy constituted a caste that was not in service to the monarch) – later on the arrangement changed more in the Kings favour (Spanish Baroque period, France under Louis XIV) but that was the decline of Catholicism already…..

basically my worry about the Catholic system of government is that the duality of heads is unstable (Pope vs Emperor) and allows for rebellions of kings (as what happened with protestantism). The Orthodox model seems more stable but then its problem is that it become too national (greek church, russian church all under their own Tsars) and fails to create an Imperium as Rome was meant to do…

Logres on 2013-07-30 at 10:27 said:

The Orthodox apparently have a tradition that St. Feodor of Tomsk was Alexander I, who staged his own assassination.

http://www.johnsanidopoulos.com/2012/11/was-saint-feodor-of-tomsk-really.html

Logres on 2013-07-30 at 10:53 said:

Would de Giorgio's doctrine imply that, even in our time, such a person necessarily exists, however hidden or concealed? It seems to me that it would – God would be sustaining his link to the world through the sacred body of the King. King Alfred seems like a close approximation to the ideal, in the West.

scardanelli on 2013-07-30 at 11:57 said:

Logres,

You jogged my memory, and I recalled that I read of this same concept in the introduction to Sedir's Initiations:

"There is a Prince of this Earth –delegate of Lucifer; and there is also the Lord of this Earth –delegate of Christ…[T]he Lord of the Earth is the one among the servants, soldiers or friends of

Christ who possesses the qualities and the right quantity of Lights most suited to link our terrestrial life to the Word directly. He receives the orders of Christ, executes them, then transmits the hopeful aspirations of the earth's inhabitants to Him."

Ash on 2013-08-02 at 01:58 said:

An essential question to ask here must be, who judges the Capo? Or rather, can anyone decide when he has failed in his role? Presumably it would be the duty of the Contemplative caste to make these judgements and of the Active (warrior) caste to carry them out and replace

the Leader. We might think of what happened during the Empire when Emperors such as Caligula, Nero, and Elagabulus were killed by the Praetorian guard (admittedly, money and preservation of power had more to do with those than concern for Traditional principles). A troublesome situation arises when the Capo begins to feud with the other two higher castes, such as Henry VIII and the Catholic Church. While it is obviously not de Giorgio's principle, I must admit to some unease as much of the language used here could easily be hijacked to justify totalitarian and decidedly anti-Traditional forms of ideology and tyranny. There are many out there eager to grab the reigns of power and ignore the voices of those who remind them that this power is meant to be exercised within its proper dominion and no further.

Cologero on 2013-08-03 at 14:01 said:

Perhaps, Ash, tomorrow's conclusion will clarify some things. However, it seems you are thinking in terms of the modern mind and the examples you give are hardly traditional. It's true, there is literally no one to judge the Capo since he is God's representative and no one can judge God. Of course, the modern mind regards that as a trick, some kind of ruse to keep the people under control, the opiate of the masses. The modern mind denies the very possibility of God manifesting through some particular man, whereas the traditional mind can see things no other way: the cosmic order is in continuity and harmony with the social order.

Jung made an interesting point, for example, that the Pharaoh was the only individuated person and the mass was undifferentiated. The latter state would have been more like that described by Julian Jaynes and thoughts would have seemed to them to originate from the outside, from "gods". Hence, the command of the Pharaoh would have had the same force. We may suppose that the consciousnesses of the scribes and priest were similar to the Pharaoh's to some extent. Jung and Serrano claim that the "persona" is more marked in the West and that may account for the turmoil.

In the Ancient City, the leader was a priest-king with divine authority. Unfortunately, we don't have sufficient documentation, but Fustel de Coulanges claims that at some point the function of the Chief Priest and King got separated as the Warrior caste asserted more control. The relevant period for Rome was the Kingdom. For example, the second king Numa also led the Priests. It is interesting that the way the King was selected is nearly identical to the way Popes are selected today. Again, that documentation was lost, to the extent that in the Republic and the Empire, the ancient laws became incomprehensible.

I guess the point is that the traditional system is not simply one alternative among many, as some sort of political party among many others. It would require an intellectual conversion, a real change in consciousness.

Ash on 2013-08-03 at 18:51 said:

Cologero, would you not say there is a concern to address in terms of the abuse of such

authority? Clearly the boundaries of the Capo are defined and as such the truly differentiated man would be following them, but we also have accounts of corrupt Emperors and Pharaohs. I suppose in some ways this question is very cart-before-the-horse, since presumably a traditional force in society would establish itself before the question of a Capo ever arose. But if, as de Giorgio says, the priests consecrate the Capo even as he comes from the warriors, that would seem to mean that they can prevent unworthy individuals from attaining such position, and would it not simply be a further fulfillment of this role that they act as a check on the Capo (if ideally an unnecessary one). To put it more plainly, I think we are all generally suspicious of individuals claiming that they are God's representative and that they must be followed as His own voice, precisely because they are generally scammers and anti-Traditional. We, as students of Tradition, must strive more than anyone to be sure that those who guide and teach are authentic and acting in accordance with their duties and the Truth.

On the point of the King I can provide some assistance, as I did some in depth studying on the religious heritage of Rome for university papers last year. My main secondary source was a book called Religions of Rome (Beard, North, and Price). It makes the case that the political Rex and the Rex Sacrocum were always separate positions in the regal era. During the early Republic and onward, the Rex Sacrocum was a member of the Pontifical college and as such himself under the authority of the Pontifex Maximus. This is however a new development, as it was previously assumed by many that the Rex Sacrocum at some point simply took over the religious duties of the King. Your example of Numa is ideal though: assuming separate functions, Numa would seem to fulfill the role of Capo and thus the Rex Sacrocum would be subordinate to him, being the head priest.

Cologero on 2013-08-03 at 19:34 said:

If the Capo has the qualities that De Giorgio describes, then there is no abuse. The Roman king selection followed an interesting process. The Senate elected the King from among them, so presumably they should know him well. He was presented to the people who could refuse him. Finally, the priest had to wait for the omen to indicate the new king had divine authority. So the king required approval from the three castes. Is that not sufficient for you? In your studies on the Roman Kingdom, why did it eventually fail and get replaced by the Republic?

Ash on 2013-08-03 at 21:12 said:

That would seem more than sufficient for choosing the ruler, yes. I am thinking more about degeneration over time (as the castes themselves face as well). Perhaps it would be useful to reflect on past incidences of this degeneration. Keeping Rome as our example, the last King was remembered as a tyrant who forever swore the city off that system of government.

As to why the Kingdom fell…the simple answer is that historians are left in many ways to guesswork. We know of the story of the rape of Lucretia and the fall of Tarquinius Superbus,

but I would personally think that the "other" myth of Romulus' death may provide insight. In this account, Romulus is murdered by the Patres, the body which became the Senate. They then dismember his body and attempt to hide the murder by claiming that he became a god, who was worshiped as Quirinus. We know that the Kings were generally chosen from outside the Curae, the collections of families from the Roman population. Thus the six legendary Kings consist of Latins, Sabines, and Etruscans, none of whom directly succeed fathers. This suggests that conflict always existed at some level between the Patres/Senators and the Kings who were meant to deliberate among them as outsiders, as would be expected. As an aside, we also know that the senatorial and priestly bodies were overlapping to a great extent, and that the major priests would often also be major political figures, particularly in the later Republic.

Having derived these points, and knowing that the Republic was established following a rebellion of the Senatorial class against a King who had become considered tyrannical, we may conclude that this conflict came to a head. History being written by the winners, we may assume that the Senatorial patrician classes decided that they were better off with the familial competition than regal moderation. If we are to examine this with de Giorgio's vocabulary, this means that the warriors (the Senators and Equestrians alone had the property and wealth to be able to train and arm themselves to protect Rome) overthrew the Capo who had been previously approved by them. We do not know who the "people" (the plebs and plebeians) supported in this struggle, though later generations remembered the overthrow as a great event and shared the Senate's hatred of Kings. Perhaps the previously mentioned defeat of the rebellion of the Kshatriyas in the Hindu epics is an example of a similar conflict which was won by the other side.

Saladin on 2013-08-03 at 22:28 said:

Ash@ "We do not know who the "people" (the plebs and plebeians) supported in this struggle"

Ash, I am sure you meant Plebs and Proletariat, right?

As you said, it's not too much of a stretch to think that "Senatorial patrician classes decided that they were better off with the familial competition than regal moderation" and they replaced a degenerate king with a Republic. As for the masses, I don't think their taking side would have made that much of a difference at that period of time. Even though "bread and circus" was invented for them much later, during the Empirical period, a different version of "bread and circus" was enough to keep them preoccupied during those early Republican period.

Ash on 2013-08-04 at 00:24 said:

Saladin, I did mean pleb and plebeian. The two words are not wholly interchangeable, as pleb and proletarian would probably be. Pleb means a labourer and man without property who is working in labour or perhaps a trade, whereas plebeian simply denotes one who is not part of

the original patrician families. The patrician/plebeian distinction actually lost importance rather early during the Republic, when the "nobiles"/new man distinction between those who had held consulships and those who had not gained importance. Many major figures during the Republic and almost all of those in the Empire were plebeian, but not plebs as they had attained high standing. Augustus' familial links with the Julians aside, there were no real patrician Emperors. It's just a distinction between terms and sometimes gets confused with catchalls like nobility or aristocracy, and for here I wouldn't worry too much about it.

Avery Morrow on 2013-08-04 at 05:09 said:

Ash, Fustel de Coulanges distinguishes the concept of rex from tyrannus, a king who rules without religious affirmation. All Emperors were tyranni because their authority came from the secularized SPQR and not the patrician faith. (They weren't categorized that way by their contemporaries but they would have been recognized as such in the preclassical city — a great demonstration of how much Rome changed over the centuries.) Regardless of whether rex and rex sacrocum were different positions, it should go without saying that they both had the symbolic quality of rex.

A comparison to the Far East is interesting.

5.3 The Establishment of a Traditional Society: Priests

In *La Tradizione Romana*[4], **Guido De Giorgio** dedicates a section to the question of the reestablishment of a traditional society. It includes four chapters: *The Priests*, *The Warriors*, *The Workers*, and *The King*. This is the first part of the chapter on the priests. De Giorgio provides some very precise indications which are very demanding and ought to be taken with some seriousness.

Introduction

The general lines that are given here about a society established along the norms of a tradition truly such, can serve as the model and example for

[4] *The Roman Tradition*

leading the current West to a normality that it has lacked for quite some time, which could, however, be gradually and prudently restored without great difficulties by the return to those principles and to that spirituality of thought and life that are indispensable to the very existence of men. Therefore it is a question of a general type according to which Europe could be oriented and hence the world with the necessary adaptations to change conditions of life while avoiding a violent and radical dissolution that would jeopardize, through its rapidity, the reintegration of a normal state.

If a return is possible, if a rectification is still possible to save the world from spiritual and material ruin, it entails a change of direction that must absolutely proceed from the inner to the outer and not otherwise. First of all, spiritual conviction of a similar change is necessary, and this conviction must be founded on a *purely intellectual realization*, i.e., without any sentimental infiltration whatsoever, of principles that rule a traditional society, and, since it would be useless and childishly utopian to believe that the entire people and the masses can achieve it through an instant process, it would be sufficient that a few at the beginning would constitute a formative nucleus with an increasingly more efficient operative irradiation leading up to the reintegration of a nearly perfect form. These few would be animated by a single force, that of truth, and guided by a single goal, that of making it triumph, and not to give in to any concession toward oneself of others, but to become true and proper centers of salvation for men misled and corrupted by centuries-old errors. If such men do exist, the return to normality would again be possible and the truth could still triumph over ignorance.

A change of this type entails the pure and simple rejection of all the prejudices that have debased Europe for centuries, of all the errors that the Anti-tradition has been amassing for hundreds of years to corrupt thought and life, impoverishing the mind and paralyzing those spiritual forces promoting the true and only good, the fruition of the Truth in a

superhuman order where it alone resides and where it is necessary to have the courage and the strength to maintain it. These men could save Europe and the world, leading the people back into the great traditional channel, toward the light of those principles that are the very basis of existence. But a great energy is necessary to conquer pessimism and skepticism which are opposed to any reestablishment on the one hand, and superficial optimism, on the other, that considers apically reached that which is a simple degree of transition. Above all, great detachment is necessary, strict intellectuality, the absolute absence of that pseudo-mysticism so much in style at the present time where spirituality and sentimentality are equivalent, where enthusiasm and faith are placed on the same level, where the darkest and murkiest impulsiveness is believed to be an expression of strength, where the external is not only excessive, but tends to destroy the internal, where agenda kills true development, where finally all that is inferior and illegitimate is affirmed with an immodesty which the world has never known before now even in the most acute periods of decadence.

But above all, great courage would be necessary in these men and a great faith to conquer so much darkness of ignorance, to break up so many false bridges, to facilitate the return to the comprehension of the truth, to give back to thought its dignity and to life, its justification. Many currently in Europe are aware of the mud the world gets mired in every day, but their conviction is half-hearted and imperfect: it is more about a pessimistic and skeptical attitude than a true and proper conviction. None of those would be able to indicate the remedy or to show the way to return to true life, which, before all else, reconfirms the values of the spirit that are divine, but do not neglect the necessities of existence, orienting them along the purely traditional axis.

Every traditional society entails the organic allocation of labor and the assignment of tasks to various categories of men adapted to their nature and their possibilities. Even currently, in the agonal state of Europe and the world, this allocation exists, but it is false, arbitrary, unnatural,

temporary, not founded on traditional norms, i.e., according to a strictly and purely hierarchical order that derives from the very meaning of the term *hierarkhia* = high priest in Greek, whose sacred character should not elude anyone. Since every tradition is sacred, the allocation of labor must be imposed only from deference to the truth that is the divine order; therefore, the priests would stand at the apex of a traditional society, who are the bearers of the divine order, the divine knowledge. We could say Ascetics, but we prefer to preceding term because it better highlights the precise character of the nature and the office assigned to the bearers of supernatural truth. This caste includes those who do not participate in active life, who lack every responsibility of the profane, temporal order and are the leaders of traditional society, but in reality, through the very character of their mission, occupy a marginal place in respect to the practical act of existences, but one that is central, determinative and indicative for the maintenance and the development of traditional society. They are the poor of God, the voluntary renouncers of the world, the truth givers, the Spirit lovers, the last because the first, whose life is devoted to the realization of the great divine norms that constitute the traditional body. No confusion is possible regarding their nature and their missions which are of a purely spiritual order, without any worldliness, extending into the pure regions of the Spirit of God who governs the world invisibly.

Process of Degeneration

This is the second installment from **Guido De Giorgio**'s chapter on the priestly caste from *La Tradizione Romana* **The Roman Tradition**. He sees the process of the degeneration of the castes as beginning, not from the revolt of the Kshatriya, but rather from the failure of the Priests to fulfill their divine mission. Nevertheless, Tradition may be forgotten, but never lost, so there are always some solitary men who continue to maintain that sacred knowledge. De Giorgio moves on to the topic of faith which, he says, is

necessary because a man must believe before he knows.

Therefore, they constitute the caste of the invisible ones because their continuous, untiring, hidden action is of the sacred spiritual order and is spontaneously fulfilled through the very force of the soul, the purity of their life that must be a rite, an offering, a sacrifice. We insist particularly on the character of the priestly caste to determine the modality of the hierarchic power and the efficacy of the revelatory mission entrusted to them. They are the leaders of traditional society, but invisible leaders because the sacred knowledge of which they are the depositaries is not a purely dogmatic system nor a dead body, but a living, perennial fire that they must nourish, living continuously in communion with the spirit of God, acting so that His truth is towering at its peak, in isolation from His profound virtue, in the active and effective development that only the contemplative life allows to be realized.

They are the great hermits and they descend among men, the bearers of the graces of the truth, but, even if living in the world, they are really on the outside and dominate while not dominating, act while not acting, illuminating with their light, they save with their presence, strengthen with their example. Their hierarchy and their organization, the traditional type to which they are tied, the value of the character of their mission are absolutely determined by their having freely and consciously chosen not a career, not a profession, not a job, but the way of God, that by leaving from God leads back to God, and of having chosen it not only for itself, but rather with the precise task of showing it to all. They sacrifice themselves and they sacrifice: it is reflected carefully in the value and in the immense importance of these two expressions when led back to the precision of their etymological meaning sacrifice=make sacred. The Priests cannot not be sacred themselves, they cannot not make sacred everything that they touch and go near because they were born for that, they were destined to that and their choice, in embracing the holy ministry, is an absolute match with the inherent possibilities of their nature.

They cannot deviate if they are truly priests, they cannot, if they deviate, not fall into the lowest abjection because they have betrayed God, they failed in their vows, and by abjuring, they contaminated themselves and men. If the value and the height of the task entrusted to the Priests is fixed and well understand, one will reach some conclusions to which the modern world, having become anti-traditional, is no longer capable of elevating itself. Let us outline one of them.

Since the Priests are the holders of sacred knowledge and constitute the insuppressible base of a truly traditional foundation, they are to secure its normality, they are to maintain the unity with their invisible spiritual hidden work and therefore are responsible for the general defection of the traditional spirit, because no one can fall if the priests themselves do not fall, no one can fail if the priests themselves do not fail, no one can be banned against the truth of God if the priests do not betray it first, no one can corrupt the world if they do not corrupt it first, abandoning their sacred mission for the concerns of the temporal order, passing from the contemplative life for which they are destined, to the active life that is not absolutely the place of the development of their activity, with falling short of their caste, their obligations, and especially the divine principles whose radiating virtue they must keep intact. How many are capable of understanding how *the current state of abjection is due to the defection of the priestly caste who are responsible for it* because they alone, the Priests, maintaining contact with the divine not only by means of their action over men, but above all with the constant realization and efficacy of their interior ascesis? Just as God's strength is mysterious and invisible, so is the Priest's occult and hidden: contemplating they act, fulfilled in God, they work in the world, sacrificing themselves they sacrifice, praying they save, although their mission is genuine and not the unholy profanation of God's laws.

If one can with absolute certainty impute to them the state of current Europe, whatever defection of this caste, whatever decadence of human-

ity is not attributable to the traditional form to which they are reconnected and of which they could be the authentic representatives. Tradition is invulnerable, inviolable, unassailable, it is God's truth and is kept intact because, even if betrayed by His ministers, He always finds those who preserve its sacred character, those who, among men not belonging to the priestly caste, become its legitimate and authorized carrier. And almost always those, priests among men, carry out their mission more dangerously than if they belonged to the officially recognized caste, because they have to fight against a profane force that tends to suppress them, that of those who have betrayed the faith, repudiated tradition, abandoning the divine for the human and the sacred for the profane: those are the false priests who are no longer such, i.e., holders of sacred knowledge. Reflect on the importance of what we say, and you will be able to understand how the solitary Ascetics, those who we will be able to call "hoi exo" the outside , in all the periods of decadence of the priestly caste, have kept alive the perennial fire of tradition against the deceit, the hatred, calumny of those who failed in their mission.

The self-establishment of ascetic groups outside the priestly caste, the presence of Masters, i.e., of solitary Ascetics, in all the period of decadence is explained precisely by the abandonment of tradition by parts of those to whom its deposit was entrusted, and the necessity—of the divine order, we insist—that others seek to keep contact between man and God, purging the sacred ways of the profane dross that the false priests amassed, i.e., the most ungodly deniers of the supernatural world. Dante *docet*... It is necessary, to avoid misunderstanding, to insist on the nature and character of this definition, of this contamination that takes place in the ambit of the priestly caste in the periods of decadence. The divine truths that constitute the sacred body of tradition has a purely metaphysical, or transcendent, character: they are superhuman, eternal, and to approach them, it is therefore absolutely necessary to pass beyond the human condition and bring oneself with the intellect into that sphere of

pure actuality where the divine reality is developed beyond the domain of Forms and Rhythms in the silence of its ineffability. Faith prepares this transition from the human to the divine, in fact, it is its essential condition, that which cannot elude anyone through the elementary analogy with so many human and contingent situations. It is necessary to believe that one knows, because one knows only by knowing that one can one know before knowing, i.e., before having acquired the wisdom and having already completed the passage from the human to the divine in order to do so that only the divine is.

Faith in whom? In God, in the Master, so say all traditions that insist on this absolutely necessary condition for the effective realization of the divine. One believes in the truth before reaching it, i.e., before being there and being it, and the intensity of faith is in direct relation with the efficacy of the achievement.

Faith is therefore the rail, the bridge, the isthmus between the human and the divine, between what man is not and what he really is when he is no longer, when he surpassed and passed over forever the human condition. But since this is the fruit of ignorance, faith is the necessary condition for the dispersal of ignorance and the reaching of wisdom.

It annuls every human limitation in man, abolishes individuality, opens all the passages of Infinite possibility, considers the chains as untied so that they are really so, it works a type of preparatory radiation of individual faculties, because one believes in things other than oneself, in the sacred text, in the hidden value of the rite, in the minister, in the master, in other words, in whatever passes beyond quotidian reality, the illusion of the world ordinarily experienced in the ambit of all sensible and rational limitations, it denies resolutely the tangible whole and affirms an invisible reality.

To have faith means to believe in what one does not yet know, one does not know, it is the most noble and desperate attempt to bring oneself face to face with the threshold of mystery and to affirm that beyond

it there is an unspeakable reality, that which is revealed. Even for those who cannot pass over this threshold, it is enormously positive that they succeed in bringing themselves to the extreme limit connected to their strengths with an act of faith that leaps over error, the visible presence, the world and things, in one stroke, to genuflect in the face of the Invisible Presence, God and His Names still concealed precisely because they are absent, asserted, and believed and not known. Faith is therefore superior to any human knowledge whatsoever, to any conquering activity of the human alone, because it passes beyond it, considers it as ancillary, negligible, negotiable, even nothing in the face of the divine that it recognizes as the invisible venerable root through its invisibility, real through its apparent unreality, divine exactly because not human, not tangible, not discernible with the senses, and analyzable by reason, placed in a sphere of this the good ones, those who believe, will be able to enjoy, if it will be pleasing to God, only after the dissolution of the human compound, i.e., *post mortem*.

Faith works this miracle that those who cannot reach by an operational effort and aware of the threshold of the divine, attain it with the rapid and direct contact that can be fecund with greater results: compared to those who know, that are beyond the threshold, they find themselves very far, but compared to those who do not believe, to the small men of the small world, the affirmers of the minimum in the minimum and lovers of the shadows, they are in a clearly privileged position because they are distant from just as far as the spirit surpasses the flesh and intelligence surpasses imbecility.

Conclusion

This is the third and final installment from **Guido De Giorgio**'s chapter on the priestly caste from La Tradizione Romana **The Roman Tradition**. He continues the discussion on faith. He points out that when the priesthood deteriorates, it gives rise to

> priesthood of solitary Ascetics. Although they maintain traditional teachings, these solitary men do not have the authority to maintain traditional society. Furthermore, they find themselves opposed by the decadent priests. The priests who go astray need to be punished in order to prevent scandal. In the contemplative life, one's own thoughts and desires are emptied and the Invisible Presence begins to manifest in one's center in an endless number of stages. By losing his life in this way, his life becomes more real and more fulfilled.

Those who are called "geniuses" by men of today, so tied to the human to see them through the greatest irony, even the superhuman, enclosed as they are in human and terrestrial limitations, are greatly inferior to the most humble of believers because they hypertrophy a nothing, man and the world, and they make everything from this nothing, while the believers deny the nothing, man and the world, and reaffirm it only putting it back on God, i.e., in the supreme cause. Those who do not believe see the effect separated from the cause, which is absurd, while those who believe see the effect in the cause, which is conformed to truth: those who know even abolish the effect and this is the truth. Deepening this last point, one will be able to come to understand, first of all, the triple attitude of man in the face of the truth in accordance to what is subhuman, human or superhuman, and consequently the way in which the principle of causality must be considered in the transition from the profane to the sacred, from the human to the divine, according to what the schema of death, life, and liberation makes of it. This triple schema can be more crudely formulated in connection to these possibilities: *without God, with God, God*.

Faith is therefore the traditional base for excellence since it is the necessary anticipation of the means through which the path begins from the human to the divine and it resolutely builds a bridge that is fixed on the other shore without seeing it but only knowing it as revealed: tradition

works this fixation in the divine that constitutes for the believers the invisible *ubi consistam* place to stand , the fulcrum of its elevation to the threshold of mystery.

We note that God, precisely because He is believed but not known, is affirmed in His deepest reality, that of the Unmanifested Principle, and that simple faith pronounces itself more positively than what would appear to a superficial examination, since by affirming the unknowability of the destination, it admits implicitly that only a realizing knowledge can attain it with an effective becoming. This knowledge follows faith, it passes over the threshold of the divine to carry oneself into the same mystery.

It is the most interior part of the Temple where the sacrifice is performed, that altar where the Priest resides.

So if the whole temple constitutes the domain of the sacred and we have the profane only outside of it, in the temple itself among the altar and the rest, there is a clean separation, and while the altar constitutes the active realization of the divine and therefore it is the true domain of the sacred, the rest of the church is reserved to those who are present at the sacrifice, they participate in it, *but do not perform it themselves*, therefore they are always only the profane because there is a barrier between them and the divine truth. This is the relationship between faith and knowledge, between the faithful and the Priests, between those who only believe and those who know and should know, between the throng of the *called* and the and the rank of the *elect*, between passive love that genuflects and pulls back outside of the sacred threshold and the active love that performs the sacrifice directly with a gesture that is a benediction, a voice that is of God, an altar that is the very throne of the Eternal.

From all that it is easy to reach this conclusion that the Priests, as the bearers of sacred knowledge, must really possess it by means of a realizing knowledge in order to be able to perform on the altar the highest of the sacrifices, the divine sacrifice, through which they strengthen the faith,

reconfirm it in its strength, and reach the hope that it can, by crossing the threshold, reach the sphere of *charitas*, of divine love.

If the Priests do not attain this realizing knowledge, they are not such, they cannot be the sustainers of Tradition, the princes of a traditional society, those who maintain the contact between the human and the divine in a permanent current, who secure life and the justification of life itself, placing it back in God. This is the true sin which a Priest can incur, of not having attained the realizing knowledge, of performing a rite with knowing its value, efficacy, and meaning, of not knowing, in other words, the sacred knowledge and of reducing it to a simple babbling of the lips or to an idle formulation that, in the scope of realizing knowledge which should be that of the Priest, is an absurdity because the one falling short puts himself beneath the believers, the profane among the profane and the profaner among the profaners.

Tradition remains untouched however, even in such a case, the intangible rite does not diminish the efficacy that it had on believers, on the faithful, some of whom can even substitute, if not in fact, in a reality that even leaps over the fact, the Priest, performing for them the rite and becoming for them the transient or permanent deposits of God's truth. If this defection does not harm Tradition in itself, it harms enormously the basis of a traditional society, it invalidates the principle of authority that is absolutely necessary to the maintenance of the two orders, the human and the divine, the profane and the sacred, that of faith and of knowledge, of those who believe and those who know, but what is more serious, it gives rise to the *priesthood of solitary Ascetics* who, by God's will, maintain the traditional secret with their work reserved to a minority, they safeguard it, they protect it against profanations, and they end up being opposed by the priestly class that fears in then its same knowledge, that which they themselves abandoned and betrayed. These deplorable clashes always occurred at the expense of sacred knowledge, giving rise to upheavals and conflicts of every type contrary to the maintenance of

traditional order.

In making the Priests the depositaries of sacred science in in considering so these various questions, we thinking of a traditional form that more is adapted to nature and the spirit of the West where the sole ascetics should be the Priests, where they along should truly safeguard the traditional body realizing effectively in itself the doctrine with the deep knowledge of everything that constitutes the divine truth.

The Priests besides being deprived of real knowledge of sacred things can also come up short of the decorum that is imposed on their caste. The accusation of immorality is too noted and too usual because one has to insist there, instead of this were derived incomprehensible devaluations of tradition itself, which is truly absurd, giving rise to the sect, schism, heterodoxy. We will immediately and clearly say that the morality is for knowledge and not the inverse and the purely moral side of a question of any fact is the least act for make it comprehend and valued its meaning. The first and only sin is ignorance and one is responsible more for not knowing or poorly knowing than to act evil. As to judge conscience, we do not believe that his is not only a very arduous and insolvable task, but directly a sacrilege, because from God alone and in the name of God consciences are judged and where it never than the so called more judgments are given in God and in the name of God? One reflects attentively that and one will see that only the facts can be judged in the customary place as the condition capable of determining others and therefore, if harmful, condemnable.

Therefore what must be judged, condemned, and punished is the deed when it is visible, it is "active", it leads to imitation, it is the example, the seed of other deeds, it corrupts: what must be condemned is scandal in all forms, in all classes, and this is the healthy principle of a truly traditional ethic that maintains the privilege of the conscience in action as God's privilege, and represses the infraction not because the motives are condemned, but to prevent the repetition, the example.

And since there is a vast range in the intensity of the propagation of an offense, i.e., in the immortality of a deed, a truly civil society should adopt all those natural, external, brutal, repressive measures that punish, from the death penalty up to the torture and flogging, but *they do not judge*, in beating the man, what he has that is the most external, i.e., the flesh.

A truly civil society, readopting all the old measures of physical, outward coercion, returns to the truth of the traditional river-bed, obeys scrupulously God's truth, and at the same time enriches the number of true, real reasons for action, creating a game, an alternation, a reciprocity between the crime and the punishment, fruitful in sensations beneficial to life, fertile in expansions and the surpassing of the brutal fact. Capital punishment, the various types of torture publicly inflicted with their tragedy, are always considerably effective and instructive and they can even determine true sources of purification, positive complexes, whose importance does not elude those who are equipped with sense and truly constructive imagination and not esthetically and softly deviators. But there is another consideration of a deeper order: the crime has degrees integrally subordinated to human passionate nature, i.e. to the darkest complex that dominates ordinary men undisputedly: it is therefore necessary that hierarchically or analogously proportionate penalties correspond to these levels, penalties determinate by an impersonal justice that strikes in the flesh, abstracting from any experimental character: thus only a reward and a rectification reaching a balance is established; this is the indicator of a true and proper traditional society.

The Priests can and must be blamed only if they fail at their task through total or partial incomprehension of traditional truths: their existence, on the purely exterior side, i.e., from the moral point of view, is reprehensible when it offers matter for scandal and then only if they submit to a tribunal that can be constituted only by men belonging to their caste. In fact from what has been said thus far, it results that real

knowledge, i.e., integrative and realizing, belongs to the contemplative, and not the active life. The relationship between contemplation and action is of the greatest importance for the maintenance of the traditional idea because their imbalance constitutes a rupture, a hierarchical inversion, a veritable deviation that, prolonged for centuries, was the origin of the current abjection of the West. Contemplation stands to action in the same relationship as the divine to the human, the sacred to the profane, the eternal to the ephemeral, since their range is distinct and cleanly circumscribed by the two different types of activity. In contemplation there is an activity of a special order that is accomplished in the eternal place, beyond time and space in the sphere of transcendent truths, in an apparent retreat and in an interiorization that in reality are a veritable translation from the human to the divine and a cancellation of the human so that only the divine remains in its absolute autonomy.

In this sense, contemplation and revelation are synonyms because the divine truth can be revealed only in man becoming a temple, i.e., the refuge itself of the truth, the empty temple of humanity founded on earth and elevated to heaven in a verticality symbolically reflecting the lifting up of all being to the totalization of the higher states for their inclusive and intensive integration.

If in the Primordial Tradition the world itself was the temple, with the successive degeneration of humanity, the sacred enclosure was established to separate the sacred from the profane and maintain the distinction between the two orders in the way that the higher directs and guides the lower. The temple is the symbol and more than a symbol, it is the place of peace, of absolute interiority where, every individuality is denied, annulled, or distanced from every human dross, the realization of the divine is accomplished, the theophanic cycle of all its effective fullness.

Whoever contemplates—and contemplation is only of the divine order, therefore it must be judged absolutely inappropriate to any order, especially to the esthetic order which is visibly inferior—not only sepa-

rates himself from others, but from himself, that which is the essential, and it empties his heart making it the center of his being where the Invisible Presence is manifested in a progressive irradiation whose levels are without end and constitute the hierarchy of divine stages. This term therefore cannot be, nor must be, applied to another that is not the real, effective achievement of higher states not passively glimpsed as though from the outside, but actively realized in one's interiority of the great temple which is the purified heart, cleansed, made a receptacle of light, the holy chalice where the divine mystery is completed. Everything that is purely and clearly human—like art in the profane sense and philosophy especially in the modern meaning—is excluded from the contemplative field that is the divine and not human life, reality and not illusion, truth and not ignorance. Philosophy that is an impaired wisdom and art that is a purely exterior infatuation for their very degeneration, are excluded from contemplative life and represent an artificial interstructure that the current abjection established between contemplation and action, small spurious world where weakness and imbecility produced by the ignorance of external things is depleted.

If contemplation is therefore reserved to the Priests who are the bearers of divine wisdom, what will be the relationship between the contemplative and active life? It is identical to that which rules the divine order and the human order: the active life must be oriented in accordance with a vision that can be determined only by those who live contemplatively, In fact, if man and the world in themselves are nothing when separated from their cause and not put back in it, i.e., in God, they acquire instead quite another meaning when they are integrated in the real order because they represent the same place where one of the divine possibilities is fulfilled. Reflect attentively on this: the contemplative life is a larger circle that includes in it a smaller one, the active life, the integration of these two modes constitute the traditional unity. Affirming the superiority of the contemplative life, we postulate the necessity of the active life pro-

vided that the latter is included in it, i.e., it remains hierarchically subordinated in order to shape it and procure for it all its operative efficacy. One, contemplation, works in the eternal, the other, action, works in the ephemeral, which is the symbol of the eternal: one, contemplation, is the domain of the sacred, the other, action, is the domain of the profane that becomes sacred only if it receives light from the former. To be more explicit: the contemplative returning to life properly called, i.e., to external existence, sees it under another aspect, different from that of the common man, therefore it is logical and natural that he seeks to consider it not as separate from the divine truth, but as effective preparation for that, the vestibule, the pre-position that rules and determines a final development realized only in the place of pure contemplation.

The harmony between contemplation and action is necessary for the complete integration of human possibilities so that man could be truly such, rich in every development, judge of his own destiny, capable of elevating himself from earth to heaven in a progressive expansion of all his faculties. But that is possible only if contemplation dominates action: in the reverse case we have the hierarchical revolution, the annulment of the traditional axis, the impoverishment of man demasculinized, made ugly, victim of all those inferior forces on which he can have the upper hand only if he is guided by the spirit of God.

It is up to the Priests, besides, to act so that the spirit of God reigns in the world and sustains the forces of man and truly dignifies him because man is everything with God, nothing without God, and his action deprived of any traditional content is a groping in the lower darkness, a wicked shadow among wicked shadows, sterile bedroom activities *fornicatoria* that impels him from illusion to illusion, from error to error in the great detrital riverbed, the hellish, subhuman, ghostly, and lemuric world.

But if instead the active life is regulated along the traditional axis, as a rite, then all the apparent imbalances are annulled while counterbalanc-

ing each other, all the varieties of human espression and deviations are arranged and are resolved in an integrative homogeneity. It is necessary to insist on what men have completely forgotten in the collapse of all traditional values: the active life is so much richer the more it is subordinated to the contemplative life, because in a truly traditional society there is an amplification of human possibilities, an infinitely more fertile development of their most various activities, in the modern world, they are completely wasted. For a law of analogy that regulates the parallelism of the two orders, we will say that the more intense the contemplative life is, the richer is the active life, as much as God is exalted, so much more is man valued, and that in a truly traditional society, everything profane is something sacred *in fieri* pending and all aberrations are recomposed in the equilibrium between the divine and the human, love and hate, wisdom and ignorance, war and peace, virtue and vice, good and evil, in a full, integral, oceanic confluence, are harmonized, surpassed, and twinned, in the great traditional river-bed.

But because this takes place, it is necessary for the Priests to truly be the supreme club-bearers and that their life be purely contemplative, as the bearers of divine truths, the great fee men of the eternity that they keep watch on the bastions of time, intermediaries between the higher and lower waters, between the divine and the human, between the cosmic and the hyperuranium where the Platonic ideas reside, knowers of the light that is the only light emanating from God.

* * *

Janus on 2013-02-10 at 21:53 said:

This is essential, and something many "political" traditionalists should read. There is an unfortunate trend toward restoring the forms of Tradition before its essence. Seeking out a spiritual or religious discipline would probably be the most important thing for those of a contemplative (brahminic) nature to do at the current time. Providence may yet provide teachers in surprising places.

That said, the essence is gaining more ground in surprising places. While being aware of the somewhat ambivalent attitude of many on this board to Dugin, it would be worthwhile

to look at the Against the Postmodern World conference held in Moscow some time ago. No national bolshevik rally this; Shaykh ʿAbd al Wâhid Pallavicini was among those who saw fit to attend. Behind the petty racialists, neopagans without understanding, new right and national revolutionaries seems to be a stirring of some who are ready to look beyond the political form and see the inner life it is meant to reflect, be they of a contemplative or active nature. I'm especially interested in seeing what follows here. For those interested, here is an article from Dugin's conference: it is by Claudio Mutti and entitled "The Doctrine of Divine Unity in the Hellenic Tradition". Cologero, I'd love to hear your thoughts on it. http://against-postmodern.org/node/127

Logres on 2013-02-11 at 11:40 said:

Iamblichus would say that "courage" or "daring" is the Dyad – the warrior – the feminine principle: hence, the purely "political" is the Dyad without the Monad, doomed to futility. Very lucid article!

David on 2013-02-11 at 22:44 said:

«A Christianity that is largely without doctrine and sacrament is a Christianity of slogan and extravaganza. A "Churchless" Christianity is simply, a heresy. It is a strange reading of the New Testament with conclusions as novel as they are effective. It is also destructive of the long term health of the Christian faith. Many who grow tired of its slogans and extravaganza do not turn elsewhere – they turn nowhere. The fastest growing religious group in America is the unchurched.

The truth and richness of the Christian faith is only found in the deep-woven fibers of the historic Church. The life of sacrament, rooted in a thoroughly Christianized network of families, parishes and monasteries, is the normative existence of the Christian faith. This is the faith that converted the Roman Empire and the barbarian ancestors of people like myself. From it grew a great civilization, one that has been challenged and dismantled at many points, but which has yet to disappear.»

– Ft Stephen. http://glory2godforallthings.com/

I.e., the Church is Tradition. Priest are part of a tradition and we need it back.

This author is very interesting for those who are Christians.

Jason-Adam on 2013-02-12 at 14:46 said:

Guido de Giorgio's book is amazing and I wish a full translation of it existed. Cologero, do you know of a link to the full text in Italian online ?

As for Dugin, I know the man personally and can say that he does not act like an aristocrat – meaning that he does not discuss and debate logically and cordially, the way that Cologero, Avery, Logres and all the folks at Gornahoor do, insteadhe expects one to accept his words without

question and obey them, if one raises an objection or merely asks for further clairification of what he means, he gets angry and then starts calling names like "reactionary" "CIA agent" and down the line..... I ultimately broke with the Dugin camp after I realised that, at least in the west, he is totally uninterested at all in monarchy, Catholicism, anything from the west's past, he only wants to talk to communists, neo-nazis and those ilk.....

Senkosmos on 2013-02-12 at 21:00 said:

I need to agree with all of you: Cologero, David, Logres and Janus. Priests are the backbone (so to speak) for the preserving of tradition, and an instrumental tool to the intellectual elite (if they are not the elite themselves) to put the West back in the right track.Today, most agents of tradition are more concerned with political action than individual/local action, and more important, contemplation, spiritual non-acting action. All attempts to a "back to roots" without a "back to the Absolute source" is futile and ridiculous. Great post!

caseydeann on 2013-02-12 at 23:13 said:

Great comment, David. Thank you.

Logres on 2013-02-18 at 11:07 said:

This is an immensely penetrating article – I can see why Guenon regarded him as a peer. It's interesting that, like Kukai (the Japanese master), he places those of "faith" far above the secularists and agnostics, as pilgrims on the ladder up to heaven who have begun the ascent, which will bear fruit in time, or out of it. Did Giorgio consider himself part of the priest caste?

Cologero on 2013-02-18 at 12:26 said:

I suspect he sees himself this way, as he described:

> Reflect on the importance of what we say, and you will be able to understand how the **solitary Ascetics**, those who we will be able to call "hoi exo" the *outside* , in all the periods of decadence of the priestly caste, have kept alive the perennial fire of tradition against the deceit, the hatred, calumny of those who failed in their mission.

Certainly, he understands the nature of the priestly caste. When we get to the warrior caste, we will see that he describes them in terms very much like Evola. However, Evola was tone deaf to the contemplative caste and never understood it or its true role. That is why he saw the Ascetic and the Warrior on the same level. De Giorgio, on the other hand, will make their real relationship very clear.

Tosti on 2013-02-18 at 14:59 said:

As was intimated in your earlier posting passion is clearly evident. Can this passional orientation lead one astray? You are privy to the full work, as yet unpresented so we will have to wait and see but a question arises in dealing with a pure faith as mentioned with regard to the solitary ascetics: are we to assume that Evola's concept of Initiation is superior to Guenon's? Will we assume that a solitary ascetic(whose practice may reflect either the exterior or the interior-without the discernment of a traditional caste we can never know) can preserve Tradition without any other reference? How are we to make a determination. And is it possible that there has been a continuity so subtle that those of the second function will have difficulty determining its existence in an extant structure without the help of the first function(who may be already embedded within such an expression)?

Cologero on 2013-02-18 at 15:58 said:

I don't see where he is saying anything of a sentimental nature or advocating the "passions" as somehow superior to intellectuality. On the contrary he writes:

> Above all, great detachment is necessary, strict intellectuality, the absolute absence of that pseudo-mysticism so much in style at the present time where spirituality and sentimentality are equivalent, where enthusiasm and faith are placed on the same level, where the darkest and murkiest impulsiveness is believed to be an expression of strength, where the external is not only excessive, but tends to destroy the internal, where agenda kills true development, where finally all that is inferior and illegitimate is affirmed with an immodesty which the world has never known before now, even in the most acute periods of decadence.

The unassailable "reference point" would be the "truths of God" or Traditional teachings; that is the standard to judge by.

Tosti on 2013-02-18 at 16:11 said:

Perhaps it was just the general tone. That may be subjective on my part..my Anglo-saxon temperment.

Janus on 2013-02-18 at 22:44 said:

I can see what de Giorgio is saying when he speaks about the central importance of faith. However, I don't understand how he can say that faith is superior to knowledge. He begins by saying (as I understand it) that faith is good because it allows the one without knowledge as yet to move forward in the path, giving him strength and courage. But surely that means that, when knowledge is attained, then faith has fulfilled its purpose? And this seems to imply that

knowledge of that which faith led us to pursue is superior, though no less essential, than faith itself.

It also makes me wonder how many priests or ascetics need to arise before a turning of orders can begin. Surely there are some left in Europe, in the old monasteries or as hermits who fulfill this role. But apparently, these few have not prevented the decline, any more than did the Russian hermits in the early 20th century before Bolshevism. Does that mean there was a decline or betrayal among these priests? Who knows... but apparently this function must be fulfilled in a specific function or grow to a certain size before its affects are more generally recognizable. Perhaps this is the distinction between Ascetic and Priests proper? "Lord, if there is but one righteous man in the city... ?"

David on 2013-02-18 at 22:57 said:

@Janus : I cannot answer for De Giorgio, but I don't think we can ever attain perfect knowledge of Reality without being in perfect union with Reality, i.e. God. That is, faith will always be there, because there will always be knowledge. Someone can correct me if I'm wrong.

Cologero on 2013-02-19 at 00:13 said:

Janus, please show me where you think De Giorgio says that faith is superior to knowledge... it means I need to make the translation clearer. Here is a quote I have in mind, which says the opposite of the impression you have:

> Faith works this miracle that those who cannot reach by an operational effort and aware of the threshold of the divine, attain it with the rapid and direct contact that can be fecund with greater results: compared to those who know, that are beyond the threshold, they find themselves very far, but compared to those who do not believe, to the small men of the small world, the affirmers of the minimum in the minimum and lovers of the shadows, they are in a clearly privileged position because they are distant from just as far as the spirit surpasses the flesh and intelligence surpasses imbecility.

Specifically, *compared to those who know, that are beyond the threshold, they find themselves very far* means those who believe are far from those who know, but those who believe are superior to those who neither know nor believe.

As for your other question, let's wait until I get the final part up which addresses some of those issues.

David, perfect knowledge is perfect union as you point out. But I don't understand the other point: where there is knowledge, there is no need for faith.

Janus on 2013-02-19 at 03:25 said:

This is the passage:

"Faith is therefore superior to any human knowledge whatsoever, to any conquering activity of the human alone, because it passes beyond it, considers it as ancillary, negligible, negotiable, even nothing in the face of the divine that it recognizes as the invisible venerable root through its invisibility, real through its apparent unreality, divine exactly because not human, not tangible, not discernible with the senses, and analyzable by reason, placed in a sphere of this the good ones, those who believe, will be able to enjoy, if it will be pleasing to God, only after the dissolution of the human compound, i.e., post mortem."

Perhaps I'm not understanding it correctly. Is he saying here that faith is superior to human knowledge in terms of "merely human" ideas about the Divine (it might be useful here to think of the Orthodox doctrine that all human attempts to describe God, while they may be good enough for Man, are ultimately lacking)? I doubt he means the higher Knowledge of gnosis, as that contradicts the passage you mentioned and your point about union and perfect knowledge. The passage you mentioned says what I would have expected, that gnosis is greater than faith, which itself is greater than ignorance.

Cologero on 2013-02-19 at 08:20 said:

Not specifically human knowledge about the divine (if there can even be such a thing), but in general. Human knowledge is never more than opinion or a likely story. It does not survive death, as De Giorgio points out, whereas faith certainly does.

David on 2013-02-19 at 18:47 said:

My question can be rephrased : how can we attain perfect knowledge if not for perfect being, that is, God, while still here, in the temporal and therefore imperfect realm (on a dualistic gnostic view, or a monistic one) ? I'm just trying to understand, thank you. To me, union with God can be but partial. Or maybe I'm mistaken ?

Janus on 2013-02-19 at 19:49 said:

Well, it might help to remember that this unity is in many ways a process of realization of a reality which already is. "Thou art That"... the singularity of Atman and Brahman. The true Self is the Atman realizing its manifestation and source of being. Thus, a complete awakening, difficult as this might be, should constitute a unity that is total and conscious, and that seems to be whole instead of partial.

Cologero on 2013-02-20 at 08:11 said:

David, the rephrasing of the question is better since a response can be split. First of all, there is the question of the possibility of "perfect knowledge" or union with God. To that the answer is "yes", since what the Intellect knows is ideas or possibilities. That possibility has been described over and over, as there is no shortage of literature. Here on Gornahoor, we try to summarize that literature and re-express it contemporary terms.

Nevertheless, that does not conclude the story, since what you are interested in is the "actuality" of the union (theosis), i.e., its realization, not merely its possibility. But that is a question for the Will, not solely the Intellect. Apart from the various claims, there is no scientific way to determine someone's "state of realization". We have the testimony of St John Climacos who says in his Ladder of Divine Ascent that theosis is not complete in this life. So perhaps your opinion is aligned with his. Even De Giorgio admits that the steps on the ladder are infinite, so a finite life cannot achieve it.

However, if you are called on that path, that is no excuse to not begin. St Mark the Ascetic in the Philokalia mentions three great enemies:

1. Ignorance
2. Forgetfulness
3. Sloth

Ignorance is the fist thing to overcome, and obviously Gornahoor readers probably have subdues, or are subduing, that enemy, if they refer to the text we write about. We have addressed the topic of forgetfulness over and over. Never forget who you are, why you were born, what you need to accomplish, what your real life is. For the several hundred daily readers here, we hope, if nothing else, to be their reminders to stay on track, although there are many other resources. Of course, most humans prefer to drink from Lethe, the river in Hell that causes them to forget.

The third enemy is sloth, and in that regard everyone is on his own. No matter how much you know, you cannot expect George[5] to do it for you. So you will never really know what is possible unless and until the right efforts are made.

David on 2013-02-20 at 16:58 said:

That answers it. I will look into St John Climacos to see if I can clarify my mind on the matter. Thank you.

Saladin on 2013-02-20 at 20:18 said:

[5] http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Let_George_Do_It_(radio)

Excellent piece! Loved it! Thanks Cologero! I think De Giorgio is very clear so I don't know why some people are confused. He never says that "Passions are superior to intellectuality" (Per Tosti) and neither does he declare the superiority of Faith over TRUE Knowledge (as claimed by Janus). He says Faith is infinitely (Guenon would object to my choice of word here) superior than any worldly (read Philosophical and Scientific) knowledge but at the same time miles away from True Knowledge (i.e. Gnosis). That's what he says, and it's all clear.

I really loved the passage where he lays the blame for degeneration on the Priestly caste. That's a simple fact and needs to be acknowledged. Just as blaming women for Feminism is completely inaccurate: For it is the duty of the Best to insure everything is according to Order (and where the teaching is different, there the Best is lacking!

Olavsson on 2016-04-05 at 11:24 said:

Yes, the degeneration of the First Caste of contemplatives is at the origin of the regression of the castes. So if one's true nature, function, purpose and providential destiny (completely without regard for a relative and conditioned, illusory self-will based on forgetfulness) can only be perfectly realized by giving oneself heart and soul, with all one's might, to this path, and even still one chooses to ignore the call in order to invest one's energies in false interests and desires, one is failing in one's true task and responsibility and consequently a serious part of the problem. Too many who potentially (hence not actually) belong to the spiritual caste waste away their lives within profane domains at best producing bourgeois triviality, or at the very worst leading to catastrophic and demonic scientific "advances." My advice can only be: Leave that to the fallen ones—they are many and have no need for you. IF you do in truth have the nature of a contemplative, your true path should already be mapped out clearly: The example to follow is the sages of old, not the profane functions honoured, respected and admired most highly by the modern system. How many more of us can we afford losing to such games falling short of the unworldly super-caste's true principles and agenda? The spiritual conquerors of the contemplative life who uphold the bridge between time and Eternity are fewer with each passing year, whereas the profane classes from high to low have a never-ending supply of new recruits ready to feed the monstrous machine of modernity in whatever way. So it should be obvious enough which task is the most important one for our kind, not only in view of our own spiritual destiny, but in view of the needs of humanity as well.

Indeed, dear De Giorgio is utterly correct regarding Faith. Even a quintessential jnanin-ascetic like Buddha Shakyamuni, founder of a tradition which is as known for its emphasis on Gnosis as any other, many times stressed the great importance of faith, and the superiority of the man possessing unswerving faith as compared to the one who doesn't. Likewise, he listed DOUBT among the most serious obstacles to progress on the Path. In our absurdly degenerate postmodern world, doubt is not seldom glorified almost as if it were a sign of intelligence. But if one lacks the ability to have complete, unfailing and permanent faith as strong as diamond

in the truths that are derived from the very Divine Wisdom of the sagely masters, prophets, and avataras, we will never have sufficient determination to go all the way and attain direct and illuminating Knowledge. As far as orthodox essential principles are concerned, starting with sacred metaphysics, there should be no room for doubt if we are serious about our sacred endeavour—such doubt is nothing but a profane weakness hindering absolute resolve on the upward path, and you hardly need complete illumination in order to attain absolute certainty as to the impossibility of every modernist, profane and materialist worldview, upon which the profanely skeptical scientist unbelief-ideology is based, when recognizing its fundamentally flawed principal assumptions. Doubt must be conquered and destroyed long before we can attain complete integral Knowledge. Without perfect faith, we cannot even begin the journey. And without perfect faith in God, in the Supreme, there is only unreality, not even a distant reflection of light.

reader on 2013-02-20 at 13:09 said:

"Those who are called "geniuses" by men of today so tied to the human to see them through the greatest irony, also the superhuman... "

"also the superhuman" = "as the superhuman"?

Cologero on 2013-02-20 at 13:26 said:

I opted for "even the superhuman"... the phrasing is a little awkward. If anyone else wants to give it a shot:

Coloro che sono chiamati "geni" dagli uomini attuali cosi legati all'umano da scorgervi per suprema ironia, anche il superumano, chiusi come sono nell'ambito umano e terrestre, si trovano di gran lunga inferiori al piu umile dei credenti perche essi ipertrofizzano un nulla, l'uomo e il mondo...

5.4 The Constitution of a Traditional Society: Warriors

The Role of the Warrior Caste

This is part I on the role of the Warrior caste in a Traditional Society. Here Guido De Giorgio describes the role of the warrior caste and its relationship to the priestly caste. He then relates that to the Great War and and the Lesser War.

In the active life, they are the bearers of power and therefore constitute the second caste of traditional society whose duty is the maintenance of activity guided by virtue. We say power only in the arena of the active life because in the contemplative life, true power is manifested in its highest reality, from the invisible to the visible, from the divine to the human, and thus represents the supreme authority that belongs to the priestly caste. Power in the active life is realized by giving a sacred character to every manifestation; hierarchically organized, the Warriors sacrifice themselves in order to remove the purely contingent aspect from human activity and to make it a kind of need that is accepted by consciously sacrificing themselves for the fulfillment of divine reality. They are the hosts of the earth and choose the most difficult path in it, keeping the sanctity of the intent unbroken in the pang of the most intense activity by virtue of a continual ascesis that is a purification and a preparation for glory. Since the Warriors reach glory that makes them the victors of the time in perpetuity that is immortalized for ages and their name is preserved as the constant example of sacrifice. They choose to be victims to affirm the victory of man over death even where death reigns: voluntary and active victims, arbiters of their destiny, aware of the transience of the flesh and the perpetuity of their example. As everything pivots on the contemplative life for the Priests, so for the Warriors everything is based on the active life because they constitute its summit and its law. In fact, the active cycle reflects the contemplative, and as the death of the human is the prelude necessary to the fruition of higher states, so the Warrior lives in order to die in the awareness that everything is vanity except victory over death, which is also the seal of glory.

They obey a purely interior discipline that purifies the passions, exalts them, and directs them toward a single end, the affirmation of power in the intensive deployment of a force that acts materially, but has its origin in the world of Rhythms. As the spiritual and the noetic dominate in the Priests, in the Warriors the psychic dominates, the hidden network of

Rhythms that heighten human possibilities creating the heroic turmoil which, like a flame, nurtures the great warrior virtues.

No one, more that the Warrior, is averse to Silence, to the world of the Spirit, because he voluntarily chose the active life in its most violent form to set his strength against it, to defeat it with his own violence, exalting his hidden energies and carrying the Rhythms to such a high tonality that it encroaches on the Forms and bends them integrally, surpassing them. We observe that this overflowing of strength cannot be absolutely effective without a true and proper ascesis, a self-denial in every moment for self- assertion only in victories, unless this assertion has the aspect of rhetorical jubilation, but rather it is like the blossoming of now equalized warrior virtues, recognized in the flower of all the activity precisely because surpassed and triumphant. While all other men compromise, they are the intransigents, those who make the obstacle the prize of their strength, for which the cement is the sanctification of man: they know that only death can placate them, so in confronting it, they escape it, and in escaping it, they confront it because it comes only when the peak of power is reached in the peak of abandonment.

In this sense, peace is their war and war is their peace. They are appointed by the Priests who sanction them the sacred character of their activity with the rite, which is uniquely directed to self-sacrifice as an offering of all of the active life on the threshold of contemplation, a sacrificial purge of the existence that is continued even after death, and even after death. While the contemplative death that is faced by the Priests can neither be seen nor understood by the masses of men who, as we said, believe but do not know, they do get a glimpse of, but do not understand, the degrees of integrative knowledge, while the death faced by the Warriors is visible to all; it reflects, in an active place, the former and is carried out, analogically like the former, with a sacrifice whose value for men is as much higher as it is more apparent. But while this sacrifice is fixed plastically for the masses that relive it in its most conspicuous phases, its secret

rhythm and intimate character elude them. In the Warrior the active life asserts itself by exalting itself and in the fierce heroic heat, it denies itself: in fact, the force that animates the Warrior is love in its most destructive capacity and devotion in its most constructive form: love and devotion constitute the warrior cycle which is that of triumphant virility. While knowledge dominates for the Priests, for the Warriors, love dominates, because all their strength is a type of offering in a continuous dissatisfaction that is satisfied only with death. While they cannot know the divine world, they love it and tend to it, climbing over human limitations with a constant overcoming of Rhythms over Form, of the psychic over the organic that it sustains, it increases a hundredfold the resistance to the obstacle and the force that surpass it, establishing a formidable aura of secret flashes that the ancients symbolized with the real, but invisible, divine assistance of the heroes.

The Forms, in heroic action, undergo a greater or lesser inflection in accordance with the intensity of the Rhythms that make them jump, by encroaching on them, replacing them, fringing them, so to say, with an imprecision that makes them more indefinable, while the Warrior himself is dragged, aware only of the sanctify of his sacrifice, in an always more overwhelming turmoil that is crowned, while filling up with death. But we can say here that love defeats death as glory defeats time, not in the absolute sense that is realized only through the knowledge and in the knowledge which dissolves every duality in the integral fulfillment of the divine.

It is necessary now to speak of the great and the small war to make precise the two fields of active contemplation and heroic activity.

The Great War is the development of the being in the surpassing of human conditions that are first confronted and then surpassed, destroyed, transformed, and resolved only in the divine sphere: the enemy to defeat is the man who must be struck centrally in himself: the field of action is his own heart that must be emptied of every dross: victory is that

of truth over ignorance, of divine reality over cosmic and human illusion that is dispersed with the realizing knowledge just as the fog breaks up in the sun without residue, and that which disappears had never existed in reality. Victory in the Great War is Divine Solitude, the decisive summit of every ascesis where nothing remains except pure aseity and what in Him is absolute ineffability. The starting point of the Great War is the non-duality of the human and the divine: the destination is divine unity: but since what vanishes is not a reality but only ignorance, once this is dispersed, only what always was remains, that cannot be said of the transient, but only and uniquely of the eternal.

Now this victory, which is the only real and definitive victory of Life over death, which, for simplification, we say call the resolute peak, while in the reality of its development it is manifested as a difficult complexity of states, it requires such a concentrated force, a task so resolute of the whole being who must be transfigured in a succession of progressive realizations, from being able to be produced only in externally favorable conditions, not that these are the necessary principle, but practically they become so. Hence, the isolation of the Temple for the priest, of the remote place for the ascetic, the hermitage and finally an ensemble of conditions that favor and facilitate this which is the highest and the holiest of all rites, the most heroic of all actions, and the most perfect of all tasks, the killing of man in the Law of God, the real abandonment of Rhythms and Forms dissolving in the allness of Silence. Now evidently whatever type of action is contrary to a similar achievement, and every rhythm must be recomposed, every whirlwind assuaged for the achievement of the Great Peace that is the true Victory of the Great War. The enemies to defeat in fact are so numerous, so terrifying, the dangers to avoid, the states to revive so repetitive and successive, that only the integral cessation of every activity can make victory possible. It is about surpassing the human and the cosmic in all their forms and in all their rhythms, to remake the creative process in the reverse path, to lead to where God formed man

with His breath, to be able to initiate the paradisiacal cycle. This is the model barely noticed for the Great War that constitutes the traditional secret, the sacred deposit held in trust by those who know, i.e., the Priests.

One can understand from that how much this caste surpasses all the others and is not, almost the truth, a caste, but a true and proper supercaste, because of its absolute preeminence. Thus its supreme authority, its consecrating, legitimating power, the dependence of the three castes on it, the justification of their existence, because nothing that is accomplished by men has value in reality if it is not sealed by the divine spirit.

Now the Warriors themselves are consecrated by the Priests, nor can they not be, without ceasing to belong to their caste since the war that they fight must represent a reduced version of the Great War in order to be legitimate, it must lose, i.e., the external character and conquer a deep meaning that justifies its attainment. The Warriors therefore submit themselves to an inner discipline, to a true and proper ascesis that will consist in their depassionalization so that by killing, they know how to kill themselves, by defeating, to defeat one themselves self, by considering the enemies as victims, in the sacred sense, and not as flesh from the slaughterhouse, by respecting them as themselves, by passing over the carnage with the love that redeems, over the contaminations with the purity that justifies, over death, and over atrocity of death with the consciousness that nothing can die because nothing can be born, only the eternal existing in its inaccessible reality.

The Devotion of a Warrior

> It seems to me that **Guido De Giorgio** and **Julius Evola** agree on the role of the Warrior caste, with some fundamental disagreements. The first obviously is that Evola fails to understand the relationship of the warrior caste to the priestly class. The second is more difficult to express. Evola is "cold", i.e., for him, the warrior is cold and detached. We could say that for De Giorgio, the

> warrior is hot: he loves, he is devoted, he is faithful. For Evola, the warrior fights as it is in his nature. For De Giorgio, too, it is in his nature, but he fights for his family, his land, his Temple, his lord. We can note here how the notion of bhakti yoga has been sentimentalized and the understanding of devotion trivialized. There is something else, more subtle, to consider, but since it is not part of De Giorgio's purpose, I'll save it for another time.

The Small War acquires a deep ascetic significance and imposes on the caste, only to which it is reserved, not slight surpassings that have, as we said, love and devotion for its foundation. The Warrior is guided by his love for the Divine Principle that is close to him, almost accessible and even distinct, in which he centers himself when the heroic peak happens and the confluence of Rhythms generates the supreme passion, that of dedication to God of the carnage: then a super-action of the normal human faculties operates, that adapt, raising himself in the highest development of the consuming fire and the Warrior becomes the great sacrificer, the *victimarius*[6],

and the baptism of blood is a catharsis that renews him, freeing him with his violence from human brutality, redeeming him as in a purifying basin Ex 30:18 that cleanses horror with piety at every death. Piety in fact pushes him to sacrifice of himself and of the enemies in each one of which he catches sight of his own effigy; in the clash of a fight, he seeks to beat back the resurgent duality, the terrible "thou", the shadow of himself, the eye that looks askance at him, the hand and the arm that threaten him, the love in which his own love is mirrored, the "other" who blocks his vision of the Supreme Unity. He kills and gets killed in the name of God, in the name of God he defends his lord and his land since his weapons are blessed and he is invested just as his lord is, and his country is the place fixed by God for the conquest of heaven, the support, the base of

[6] http://referenceworks.brillonline.com/entries/brill-s-new-pauly/victimarius-e12204070?s.num=0

his ascension, and he must defend it in order to keep God's law in the world, as long as the enemy does not deprive him of God by snatching his land, home, temple. His caste is the guardian of sovereign power in which the virtues are combined, that when entirely followed, lead man to the Edenic fruition, restoring his eternal and original country to him, whose necessary starting point is this land. The king and the country are made sacred by the radiant vision of divine Glory since in loving it, the warrior loves God, and in protecting it, he defends God's possession.

Note that the realization by means of warrior ascesis is always indirect, while the priestly ascesis is direct or final: the former is accomplished through the world of Rhythms, the latter in the Silence, the former remains in duality, the latter reaching unity from non-duality. This difference is essential and eliminates whatever arbitrary reduction that would subvert the traditional order. The warrior caste obeys its own law that is justified only through a higher law which, originating in the divine, extends it. In fact, if the Primordial Tradition is taken as the starting point, the castes are reduced to just one, that of the Priests, nor is it put there for others because in this stage only the contemplative way exists which excludes any action: there is no caste in reality in the Primordial Tradition in which *human unity* is realized in its most absolute expression. The King here is the high priest and one can speak of regality only in the sense of cognitive absoluteness. But in successive traditional forms, the distribution of human possibilities is necessarily carried out, because we are already in a greater state of decadence and complexity through which life assumes a internal and external double aspect; in this stage, the priestly class assumes an absolute position that puts it back in the Primordial Tradition, that of the Warriors is internal in respect to the purely exterior Workers but, considering the whole tradition in its triple aspect of Silence, Rhythm, and Forms which correspond to the Priests, Warriors, and Workers, the second caste occupies an intermediate position of equilibrium between the two extremes and serves to maintain the

traditional unity because its attribute is power.

Representing the traditional boundary circularly like a fortified city, we will say that the center, the Temple, corresponds to the priestly caste, the periphery, i.e., the ramparts, to the Warrior Caste, while the workers remain in the middle. Considering such relationship, the Warrior caste occupies the most dangerous place in the traditional defense, the one most exposed and, if one understands the value of this depiction in relation with what has been said, the Warriors are the lords of Rhythms and the art that is most appropriate to them is Magic.

Whoever is capable of reflection will understand without difficulty how, this caste living in the paroxysm of action, must necessarily be involved in the wave of hidden forces that are unleashed especially when the rhythm of the active life is intense, so that the warrior ascesis has as its principle goal the knowledge of the world of Rhythms, of the laws that govern it, and the defense from the traps of the field of shadows. That appears more clearly to those who consider with attention life and the work of the great conquerors where one easily sees how materially infinitesimal elements have engendered inevitable imbalances. What is true for every man is doubly so for the Warriors who live intensely in order to confront the most terrible enemies, those who are invisibly close to us and of which the visible enemies represent a type of material duplicate.

Speaking of this caste we implicitly asserted the necessity of war, but not less implicitly we asserted the need that it is uniquely entrusted to the true and proper Warriors that they have the legitimate use of it. Now as one does not become a priest, so one does not become a warrior, and the contamination of castes has unfortunately produced the current degradation since, with democratic leveling, introductions of every type have taken place, distorting the traditional order and engendering the fall of a truly civil society. A return to normality worked with discernment, progression, and measure would permit the restoration of the sole and true hierarchy in the attributions of caste conformed to the nature of man, to

his possibilities, and to the effective development of his more specifically productive activities.

The warrior is the ascetic of the active life and hits discipline is purely interior: whoever cannot kill himself will never be able to kill or, better said, in killing he will profane life and death because his cause is not holy. Now a man kills himself by his own hand or with the sanctified arm in a way that the enemy is visible and close, otherwise a true assassination is accomplished and not an act of purification. If war, as we said, is justified only as the symbol of the Great War, it is inconceivable that the battle be not focused, faithful, open, frontal, because only by knowing oneself can one dominate himself and only in seeing his own enemy can he be surpassed without the battle and the carnage having the bestial character of the battle and anonymous, unholy, and sacrilegious carnage. If one is capable of developing all the aspects of the question when placed in its true light, one understands that war must be made by warriors and not by the entire democratically leveled people and violently carried back in great conflicts to the state of savage desperation: it follows from it that war must be normally conducted man to man and, in its most typical expression, brought back to the preliminary dispute, to the duel.

We said that the Warrior caste is founded on a dualistic base that the Latin term *duellum*, the ancient form of *bellum*, expresses with perfect obviousness: war is the expression of this fundamental duality of which love and hate—the latter reducible, if you reflect on it well, to love—represent two extremes: in the event a traditional restoration is produced, which is difficult but not impossible, and which, in every way, only modern devirilization can gravely obstruct with its two most typical expressions, pessimism and skepticism, war should be led back to its fixed normalizing function, i.e., to exist permanently for the single caste of the Warriors. The duel that so called civil society of the West, barbarous in reality, repudiated with satanic thoughtlessness while they turn current conflicts into a hellish game of machines that work the foolish and most

ungodly destruction, would be the essential condition of the return to normality in case it was led back to its natural, spontaneous, i.e., effective, form and not to that modern parody that stands to the duel as the courtier stands to the knight.

If normal arms were only in the hands of the Warriors, the duel would take back its traditional value and would constitute the customary standard training of the caste, developing the sense of honor that has now faded in the heart of men. The duel with cold weapons[7] *arma bianca* is the most noble, the purest, the highest expression of the warrior caste because it establishes a reciprocity of force, honor, and love in two men confronting each other, who are saved by killing each other and sanctify themselves by being killed. One observes that duality remains before and after: before life against life, after life in the face of death. And this duality is precisely the permanent indication of the warrior caste and is the basis of its purpose. War in a traditional society is the amplification of the duel, but other factors intervene: family, country, lord. It should have led back to normality, limited to the only caste that can do it without involving entire peoples, working that chaos that compromises the very existence of a civilization. Brought back to clarity, to the brutality of the ancient wars, although circumscribed and delimited, it should be, if not permanent at least frequent, giving in that way the acceleration necessary to the rhythm of life that makes it deeper and more fertile for revelation.

Modern wars—and for us, this "modernity" lasts for centuries—are the products of the democratic degeneration that has leveled humanity substituting for the Warrior caste a fictitious hierarchy in times of peace, even chaotic in times of conflict when every citizen must become what he never was, i.e., a soldier. The soldier obeys external discipline while the warrior obeys the inner: the warrior is always a warrior, the soldier can occasionally become a warrior through force, not by choice or by natural inclination. But there is a more important consideration. The

[7] `http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Cold_weapon`

Warrior is the refusal of sentimentality and among the ancients it did not exist: only modern degeneration has created through the monstrosity of democratic conflicts the romanticism of war, because in these conflicts in which all the people participate, there are only mediocre warriors, while the mass is constituted by a type of human gelatin that trembles with pathetic oscillations at every twisting that violates his nature. Instead, war reduced to lesser proportions, but with a more intense and more frequent rhythm, because it is entrusted only to men and not to machines, to Warriors and not to other castes, would be an indispensable element of a full and fecund life if led back to the traditional type, i.e., sanctified by the rectitude of causes that would give rise to it. Its delimitation would constitute a permanent and normal base of the activity to paralyze by no means all the people, but to intensify the rhythm of the active life with a continual contribution of strong and decisive reflexes.

Conclusion

> This is the final segment on the role of the Warrior caste in a Traditional Society. Here we see that the point of war is to establish peace. The respective spheres of influence of the priests and warriors are made clear, although caste conflicts can still break out for the reasons specified. **Guido De Giorgio** then relates the roles of the castes to contemporary events circa 1940 : when priests are no longer the bearers of the holy science, there is a state of perpetual war and democratic leveling, then spiritual ruin results, as man is left to his own devices.

The return to normality restores the people's strength established of the Warrior caste which abides by love and whose sacrifice, different from that of the Priests, comprises an ascent of psychic energies oriented in the direction of heroic glorification. As action is subordinated to contemplation, so the warrior is subordinated to the priest, without however

this subordination equalizing or confusing the two domains that are autonomous and separated and which constitute the spiritual authority and temporal power. These two jurisdictions are as cleanly separated and distinct as eternity is from time, therefore the two domains are unmistakable through the impossibility or reducing the first to the second or of extending the second to make it correspond to the first, since the eternal cannot be contained in the transient, nor can the transient cease to be such and to coincide with the eternal. This only consideration suffices to show that the temporal regiment is independent of the spiritual without however opposing it in any way, but rather in parallel turning to itself up to what is the maintenance of traditional unity that contains the both together and harmonizes them.

If in the primitive phase of perfection, with life being only contemplative, we can acknowledge a true unity of development oriented toward purely spiritual ends, this is not possible in the subsequent traditional forms where action appears immediately next to contemplation, temporal activity next to the spiritual, from which arises the separation of the two domains.

But this separation is necessary for the purity of the ends to which activity and contemplation tend: a fusion or an overpowering in part by one of these jurisdictions would constitute a true anomaly because it would confuse the divine with the human, the spiritual with the temporal, the sacred with the profane without reaching any profitable result. When we spoke of subordination we meant it only hierarchically, i.e., from the unique, traditional point of view that embraces and contains the contemplative life and the active life: in this sense one cannot escape anyone that the temporal is subordinated to the spiritual as and in the same measure that the human is subordinated to the divine from which it derives, and the existence and the justification of existence.

The Priest consecrates the Warrior and arranges that his action returns to the traditional sphere, but in his sphere the Warrior is autonomous

and he neither can nor must collide with the Priest since his activity does not oppose the spiritual activity carried out in the bosom of the first caste. In a traditional society every dispute between the temporal and the spiritual is resolved in the unity the encompasses them; if, in fact, there is conflict, this must uniquely be ascribed to the temporary deviation of one or two domains due to essentially individual, and therefore unimportant, factors.

As long as the Priest remains priest and the Warrior, warrior, no conflict is possible because each one of them will understand he belongs to a sphere whose activity is clearly separated and distinct: this knowledge, this awareness, must guarantee the harmony between the temporal and the spiritual. But whenever, through complex circumstances that are not always easily discernible, a serious conflict between the two powers may happen, it is necessary to come back to the principles that safeguard traditional unity and then they will be resolved hierarchically in the seat of pure spirituality to rectify the deviations and annul the deflections that can be produced by one side or the other, with leading the two castes and therefore the two powers each back to its own domain.

The elimination of the purely individual factors will produce the placation of the dispute, because unfortunately these will take place only through the surpassing of certain personalities who respectively break the law and the norm which regulate activity and establish the limits of the two castes. The relationship between the two powers is very delicate and the development of Europe shows how often the disputes between the spiritual and the temporal have assumed immense proportions up to the point of becoming outright hostility. There is a reason for all that: the imperfect realization of the traditional unity, that must be ascribed to the defection of the priestly class which can always make its authority matter, with well understood spiritual means, provided they don't distance themselves from sacred knowledge and in this, it only demands the defense of the highest values of the spirit. The temporal cannot un-

dermine and diminish the eternal, and therefore the temporal power, in any way whatsoever and by whatever means, will not be able to harm the spiritual authority which will always know how, when it wishes, to withdraw from the world and allow it to deteriorate because it is deprived of divine help. Reflect very attentively on that in order to understand what is happening in Europe and in the world.

Nevertheless the bearers of sacred knowledge must at all cost maintain contact with traditional principles and undergo whatever duress, submit to any violation, in order to continue to save men by getting them back in touch with the eternal. The spiritual authority asserts itself with quite other means than those with which the temporal power asserts itself and we think that, in case of conflict, through oppressive or destructive that is the deviation and the overpowering of the temporal power, the spiritual authority will always have the upper hand, if it obstinately remains in its domain and does not descend into open battle with the temporal on the terrain of activity properly assigned that is not absolutely of its sphere.

We think instead that as much as it will stay in its domain, so much more effective will its own work be because therefore, as was said with the greatest absoluteness, it assumes its authority from God and not from the world, and its strength, nourishing itself fervently on the divine, will not be able to triumph over hidden dangers, incomprehensions, suppressions, and apparent collapse. Because if in addition the deviation of the temporal power assumes such proportions by becoming absolutely antitraditional and sacrilegious and the Warriors, forgetting themselves, insulting the principle of love, which is the foundation of their existence, were exceeding their deplorable actions, compressive of every traditional spirituality, know that nothing can touch, profane, and be admitted to God's Truth that is not God himself and that also the ruin of the world would leave perpetually together the Silence or where the divine mystery unfolds.

But we are convinced that the dispute between the two powers is almost always due to a remote deviation in the very heart of traditional unity and above all in the priestly caste whose members have often forgotten what is their only and great strength: sanctity. Whenever the spiritual authority, without any concession to the profane, takes up its true function, the maintenance of God's truth in the world for its salvation, and the Priests, who are its bearers, may not fail in their task which is contemplation and not action, effective realizing knowledge and not pure external, literal science of holy things, the traditional unity would harmoniously include the two distinct powers, but in parallel tending toward a single end, the return of man to God, through time, into eternity.

The temporal power in fact, of which the Warriors are the bearers, offers as terms the realization of the divine through time, in a concert of all the faculties tuned by their own equilibrium. Until now, in regard to this caste, we have spoken of war, but it is now necessary to consider the positive aspect of war, i.e., peace. War is an imbalance that produces a balance which in its turn is broken through the intermittent character of human affairs: but if one considers that in analogy with the spirit whose domain is eternity, war appears as a renewal, a purification, radical emendation, followed by the achievement of a state of absolute and permanent pacification that represents the fruition of beatitude.

As much as equilibrium is superior to disequilibrium, so peace is superior to war of which it is the crowning achievement. No consideration of aesthetic order may contaminate the vision of the truth in the seat of pure spirituality. The Warrior yearns for peace since his war is holy only if it leads to a permanent and definitive peace. War represents the germinative suffering, and peace, the flower and the coronal fruit. If intermittence is a type of destiny of human and temporal affairs, it must never be considered as a cyclic law on the part of the Warriors and the Leader, meaning to say by that, that each war must be completed for the end of the disequilibrium and the realization of peace. That intermittence exists,

but it does not make law, this is the foundation of the right and healthy development of temporal power. If, as we said, war is in analogy with the Great War that represents the permanent conquest of the divine, it must tend to peace and this must be the true and holy goal of the Warriors: only a soft and superficial esthetic, ignorant of the profound truths of certain analogies and the symbolic relationship between the temporal and the eternal can consider war as the end in itself, a spastic state, fascinating for its own anomaly; only when true peace is not realized, can the nostalgia of war be felt, this very dubious sentiment of order because it belongs to the purely sentimental sphere.

In order to prevent this anomaly, it would be necessary to avoid, above all else, the wars that are not decisive, considering them as imperfect actions, true and proper permanent crises that contribute to the crumbling of traditional societies.

What has happened and is happening in Europe must be considered under this light and then one will understand the gravity of the current situation in which, through the confusion of castes, through consenting to an absolutely bestial democratic leveling, the detachment of the human from the divine takes place and therefore the very end of man is prepared. When we speak of the end, we mean the true and proper end that is certainly not that of the flesh, as every person gifted with the most elementary good sense can comprehend, but the spiritual ruin, the collapse of those bridge that connect the world to the Superworld, of which follows the instantaneous formation of the hidden ways that connect the earth to the darkness of the Underworld. If humanity does not want to become an immense and sterile hell, it is necessary that it brings back the great traditional ways by which only will new bases be found for new developments.

The Warriors must participate with the Priests for the restoration of order because these two castes are the bases of traditional unity: from their concordant action everything can be made smooth, the one being

the bearers of sacred knowledge, i.e., of wisdom, the other the judges of power; the one, if you will, the club bearers, the others the fasces bearers. The harmony of the spiritual and the temporal can rebalance the world against all pessimisms and skepticism so acute and stupidly brayers of the current times; in no mode will be realized a permanent arrangement of the world without the cooperation of the spiritual authority and the temporal power because the return to normality must be effectuated from above to below, from the higher to the lower, and not the other way around.

For centuries the masses flounder in bestial tumults and will still flounder as long as the Priests and the Warriors permit it: that if these two castes feel the enormous weight of their responsibility and have the awareness of their respective domains and their true obligations, no one could prevent the restoration of traditional unity, the new equilibrium that would reopen the great passageway to eternity for the glory of God in heaven and the peace of men on earth.

Posted on 2013-03-04 by Cologero

* * *

Saladin on 2013-03-04 at 22:19 said:

Wow! That was intense! Cologero, you mentioned in your earlier post that comments have declined by 50% since you started posting translations of de Giorgio. If everyone is like me, it may be due to being awestruck after reading materials like this. Thank you for making these translations available!

Logres on 2013-03-05 at 12:45 said:

Seconded – I believe there is not much to add, and the meditation may take a lifetime. The Trinity is partially ordered after caste, with the Father as the archetype, or Person without which Godhood does not exist, the Son as the executor or warrior (this is more clear in Revelation), and the Spirit as the silent partner who upholds everything. A case could be made for switching Spirit and Son, depending on how you view it. If God has caste-like orderings, what hope do mortals have to escape from it?

This was a beautiful translation.

Pickman on 2013-03-05 at 18:07 said:

Ever since reading that brief introduction to De Giorgio in Evolas' "Road of Cinnabar" (under "My Explorations of Origin and Tradition") I have hungered for De Giorgio translations of "outraged and aggressive letters, strewn with brilliant insights". My praise extends to Cologero for his selfless task in making these works a possibility.

I get that sense of magic once more when reading this mans work, whose absolutist spirit is most congenial to my own character.

David on 2013-03-05 at 18:42 said:

Di Giorgio is a genius, and those translation are a gift from the Holy Spirit. Thank you.

Jason-Adam on 2013-03-06 at 01:04 said:

Personally, I find little reason to comment on De Giorgio's writings because they are so full of wisdom I have nothing more to add than to just nod my head and learn from him.

Max on 2016-04-01 at 07:14 said:

Gandalf in a powerful scene that was not included in the final movie adaption of "The Return of the King":

"A thousand years this city has stood. Now at the whim of a madman it will fall. And the White Tree, the tree of the king, will never bloom again."

"Why are they still guarding it?"

"They guard it because they have hope. A faint and fading hope that one day it will flower. That a king will come and this city will be as it once was before it fell into decay. The old wisdom borne out of the West was forsaken. Kings made tombs more splendid than the houses of the living and counted the old names of their descent dearer than the names of their sons. Childless lords sat in aged halls musing on heraldry or in high, cold towers asking questions of the stars. And so the people of Gondor fell into ruin. The line of kings failed. The White Tree withered. The rule of Gondor was given over to lesser men."

In Tolkien's world the race of Men represents the warrior caste, and the Elves the priestly caste. As the end of the world approaches, many men become corrupted by their own mortality which would have otherwise been a source of great heroism and glory, and the Elves do not wish to take action but prefers to withdraw and isolate themselves contemplating what is eternal as if no external events concerns them. The Elves come to believe that the worlds destiny is inevitable and that resisting it is pointless, however man at the brink of destruction, by remembering the meaning of death as a gift of men, sees that there is nothing to loose and everything to win, with the fate of men's souls unknown even to the wisest. There are no shortages of battles, and

even the "living dead" – believing in nothing – out of the despair of what they have become, are bound to answer the call of the Emperor where he to return. A role of the still remaining Elves includes awakening the King to his quest and to help provide the sign and means by which to conquer, reforging the broken sword that they have safe kept throughout the ages.

Aryayana on 2016-04-07 at 15:19 said:

I think there are some good scenes dealing with the relationship between the First (spiritual elite) and Second (warrior nobility) castes in the Japanese movie 'Zen' about Master Dogen. See, for example, the part starting from 1:28:24 and lasting until Dogen returns to his temple.

https://youtu.be/8s5Uz8XSc-Y

Notice how the Zen master's non-acting spiritual power prevails over the Shogun. The warrior-leader had the power even to kill the master if he so desired, but in the end it is the latter who wields the purest authority and who, indeed, is the true master of the former in terms of the essential hierarchy, and who may save him when he goes astray.

J on 2018-05-11 at 20:09 said:

What would a Warrior in today's world do, given that there's (seemingly) no legitimate path for them to fulfill their destiny, and they can't just withdraw from the world like a Priest? Asking for a friend.

Avery Morrow on 2013-03-07 at 11:12 said:

" The brutality, although circumscribed and delimited, of the ancient wars, it should be, if not permanent at least frequent... "

Guido De Giorgio seems to be gunning for Evola's role as "greatest comic book supervillain of all time". Too bad he looks more like Richard Feynman in the few photos available of him online.

Cologero on 2013-03-07 at 13:03 said:

Yes, and it may discourage some warriors if they think they could be called out on a duel at any moment. Do you think his justification is incorrect? ("giving that acceleration necessary to the rhythm of life that makes it deeper and more fertile for revelation") In other words, to live without the thought or awareness of death: does that also hide the rhythm of life and diminish the possibility of revelation? He is getting at something ... he may be right or wrong.

Does it relate to this: *Noble Savages*[8].

[8] http://www.nytimes.com/2013/02/19/science/napoleon-chagnons-war-stories-in-the-amazon-and-at-home.html

graham on 2013-03-08 at 14:45 said:

As a woodworking apprentice nowadays, I'm looking forward to the part on workers and forms, it may be helpful in the task of discernment.

Logres on 2013-03-08 at 21:58 said:

There is an interesting tale, here, about "Deadwood Lighter", a Cherokee medicine man who used dream magic to win against a deadly raid from a neighboring tribe. Would this be an instance of magic employed by a warrior culture (even though these tribes had "degenerated")? http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Townsend,_Tennessee

Avery Morrow on 2013-03-08 at 23:58 said:

Of course, the crux of his argument is that modern, conscripted life gives a different meaning to war than traditional gentleman's duel, and it's hard to argue. But to use the concept of *war* itself instead of valor and a readiness to duel more generally, and then putting it in the imperative form, can't help but arouse amusement.

Cologero on 2013-03-09 at 01:23 said:

The final segment will make things clearer, I presume. De Giorgio is not promoting war for its own sake, unlike others.

Caleb Cooper on 2013-03-09 at 11:25 said:

I tend to favor an expansive use of the term magic (I perturbed my RCIA deacon by insisting that the Mass was a magic ritual and the Eucharist Blood Magic), but this sounds more like the guardian Archangel of the community initiating communication with it's representative before heaven. Magic to me seems to imply some intent or desire in the operant setting subtle forces in motion.

Jason-Adam on 2013-03-10 at 21:00 said:

I am interested to know how de Giorgio would have explained the conflicts between the Popes and the Emperors in the Middle Ages... ... .

also, if the spiritual and temporal realms are autonomous of each other, does that mean the two swords (spiritual and temporal power) that Boniface VIII claimed the church had is a wrong idea ?

Cologero on 2013-03-10 at 21:58 said:

Didn't De Giorgio explain the conflicts in this segment? He certainly alluded to them. The causes may be the weakness of the Priests who no longer are the bearers of sacred knowledge, or occasionally individualistic or egoistic factors.

De Giorgio is not refuting Boniface VIII. He emphasizes that the Warriors are subordinated to and consecrated by the priests; that is how they derive their power. The doctrine of the two swords does not mean that the priests are actively engaged in temporal affairs, just the opposite. In *Unam Sanctam*, Boniface VIII wrote:

> Both, therefore, are in the power of the Church, that is to say, the spiritual and the material sword, but the former is to be administered for the Church but the latter by the Church; the former in the hands of the priest; the **latter by the hands of kings and soldiers, but at the will and sufferance of the priest**. ... one sword ought to be subordinated to the other and temporal authority, subjected to spiritual power

So the temporal power is indirect, not directly controlled by the spiritual authority. But bring this up in the chapter on the Capo.

The question is does Vatican II reject Unam Sanctam, which it certainly seems to have done.

`Jason-Adam on 2013-03-10 at 23:00 said:`

Ah, you've cleared some things up – so far De Giorgio's thoughts are in quite exact agreement with the teachings of the Church. I eagerly await the chapter on the Capo as I think it's the most important one in the book.

I am currently trying to understand the decline of Christendom – we all know the events of history – but I am more interested in the whys... ... so essentially the decline began in the Church, I suppose de Giorgio means, which is why Boniface was not able to control Phillipe ? but what caused the qulaity of the priests to descend from their former level ?

`Cologero on 2013-03-10 at 23:32 said:`

De Giorgio gives his interesting take on it in one very telling paragraph (beginning with "The elimination of the purely individual factors ... "). Certain personalities (e.g. Phillipe) will bring in individual factors. He ends with a cryptic claim, if anyone has any thoughts on it.

To wit, the priestly class may choose to defect, since the priests should always be able to control the temporal power through spiritual means. Obviously, actions in time cannot affect the spiritual ("gates of hell"), which can also be found in Guenon. That is why the latter objects to Evola's raising of action to the same level as contemplation. So the priests may "withdraw from the world and allow it to deteriorate". De Giorgio concludes with this:

"Reflect very attentively on that in order to understand what is happening in Europe and in the world."

How do you deal with that, Jason-Adam? Is the Church self-destructing as the secular media believes, or is there a deliberate withdrawal? Didn't Benedict XVI says there will be a contraction in the church? And De Giorgio mentioned the "apparent collapse"; is that true or is the collapse real? And who are those "solitary ascetics"?

Jason-Adam on 2013-03-11 at 00:06 said:

If I understand him correctly, De Giorgio is saying that the spiritual centre has not degenerated but is voluntarily withdrawn from the world allowing the tides of history to take their courses ?

The solitary ascetics are the priests... ... whose true nature is hidden... ... ..

Cologero on 2013-03-11 at 00:59 said:

That is the way I read him. Of course, many structures have indeed degenerated, but no material action can destroy the spiritual center. It may be forgotten by many, but it can never be lost. Some day I'll have to tell the story of the book's publication. The manuscript was found several years after his death. The original editor had to use a pseudonym, although the book seems pretty tame today.

Synodius on 2013-03-11 at 06:45 said:

Interesting, I just finished reading Rama Coomaraswamy's Destruction of the Christian Tradition where he mentions a quote of Paul VI about 'auto-demotition' and the whole book favors the version of destruction. Also it seems they are not only dismantling the Church but actively pushing for NWO. Doesn't look 'apparent' to me, but what do I know? Can you please provide some context to what Benedict said about contraction?

Saladin on 2013-03-13 at 22:39 said:

The Spiritual Center(s) never degenerate. It is only castes (and before all others the Priestly caste) that degenerate. There is little doubt that the priestly caste in Christendom has declined to the point of non-existence. Therefore it is only the solitary ascetics who carry the flame and enlighten humanity (albeit in a subliminal manner) in this darkest of ages.

And, no! The solitary ascetics are not priests, although priests can be solitary ascetics. Guenon, De Giorgio, ... are fine examples of solitary ascetics but there are many more whom we have never heard of!

scardanelli on 2013-03-14 at 13:42 said:

This seems also to relate to the post on Evola and the intitiatic centers of Tibet falling to the communists. The church retracts materially in the face of the modern world just as the Tibetan Lamas would not act to safeguard sacred centers against communist invasion. Yet perhaps what

seems like a loss only appears so from the perspective of action, for " t he spiritual authority asserts itself with quite other means than those with which the temporal power asserts itself."

Perhaps this retraction is what leaves so many dumbfounded and bemoaning the lack of a spiritual path in the west. They are looking without, rather than within. As De Giorgio states, the bridges to the superhuman may be crumbling, but the way remains open for those with the eyes to see.

So what looks like a retreat is actually a safeguarding, an attempt to "maintain contact with traditional principles and undergo whatever duress, submit to any violation, in order to continue to save men by getting them back in touch with the eternal."

If I am not misunderstanding Tomberg in this regard, would this be a retraction of the church of St. Peter in order to safeguard the church of St. John?

Max on 2015-02-16 at 15:35 said:

De Giorgio states that what provides meaning and legitimacy to war is peace. If the situation is such as that can not be achieved the only viable option is withdrawal to prepare and await the conditions that allow victory since we can not aim for anything other than the Greatest Peace. The Romans never fought any battles if the signs were not auspicious -corresponding to the will of the gods. Continuing the thought of "the roman": when is the tiger tired? The Augurs silently gazed into the heavens.

When anti-reality fought reality it became increasingly unreal while reality stayed the same. The separation widened until un-reality could no longer recognize what is real or not, starting to fight its own shadow. For unreality every sky became cloudy, but Reality will make itself known like a lightning from the eternal clear sky.

5.5 The Establishment of a Traditional Society: Workers

Metaphysics of Castes. Workers

> This is the chapter on the workers from *La Tradizione Romana* [The Roman Tradition] by **Guido De Giorgio**. In this part, De Giorgio reviews the metaphysical foundations of the notion of castes and prepares the groundwork for the discussion of the specific functions of the workers. In his understanding of the degeneration of castes, De Giorgio says here what Nietzsche should

> have said, had he had the proper background. What De Girgio describes as the "principle of freedom" is an essential point to understand.

They constitute the third and final caste that corresponds to the domain of Forms in the sphere of the active life. They should really form the penultimate caste, the last begin the Servile workers, but from the median and reconciliatory point of view in regards to a true and proper return to the spirit and traditional form most easily realizable in the current conditions of humanity, we adopted the threefold formula while knowing that in a more perfect traditional society the number of castes must be raised to four in analogous correspondence with the full realization that, as we pointed out, beyond Silence, it includes a state, the supreme, absolutely undefinable, state designated, in the most complete tradition, with the name of "Fourth" and that is the domain of Absolute Ineffability.

This state comprises and resolves the threefold formula—Silence, Rhythms, Forms—in an integrative indistinction that distinguishes it precisely from them as the mystery of the irreducible unity in its ineffable essentiality. In it the divine cycle is completed totally and integrally. From here the analogous necessity of a fourth caste that would include the Servile workers whose activity assumes the most austere, most elementary, most terminal form.

The constitution of castes must be understood in this way, according to the great law of analogy, i.e., in relation with the divine cycle and not from a purely human and partitive point of view that would have no reason to exist through its fragility and inadequateness to the truth. It is not despotism that creates the castes and especially the servile caste, but rather a necessity of development inherent to the mirroring in the human world of a divine complex that is the one and only reality. The current state of humanity, the apparent abolition of castes, corresponds to the erroneous and confused vision that men make themselves of the divine world: the Divine Principle is currently for men everything they

want it to be, i.e., an indecisive and vaguely imminent fog, as men, having abolished caste distinctions, are likewise everything that they want.

The vision of a divine chaotic level corresponds to the leveling human chaos where all pseudo-mysticisms, philosophies, and nontraditional currents flow together, constituting the impure bundle of solidified forms.

But the abolition of castes is unrealizable and they exist even if not explicitly admitted and recognized: their hidden, invisible existence, over which democratism has stratified a leveling haze, creates an incongruence that should strike every person equipped only with good sense. Everyone know that men are not currently in their place and that the division of the active life is arbitrary and unjustified, because everyone is pushed, constrained by circumstances, by his own impulse and not by a conscious force of order, of the state, and of duty. Everyone knows that there are servile workers who dominate and masters who serve, and that even in the two first castes there are atrocious anomalies and that in the third caste these are furthermore still more remarkable: that is due to the absence of the traditional spirit, to democratic leveling which believes it can enslave those who cannot be enslaved, the determinative characteristic of the inalienable and indivertible human person.

This lasts for centuries and the current confusion is only the result of a slow and progressive degeneration due to the purely apparent superiority of man over the divine, of servitude over freedom, of confusion over order, and disorder over true hierarchy. What determined this fall must be ascribed to the incomprehension of that which constitutes the nature and the form of freedom, confuses with the arbitrary, and forces on everything the humanizations of reality that is actually of an absolutely divine order. Now the constitution of castes is based on the true concept of liberty considered in its four essential forms: absolute liberty in the Priests, conditioned liberty in the Warriors, conditionality in the Workers, servitude in the Servile workers. The two extremes are represented by the first and last caste in as much that what is affirmed in the first is denied in the

last and vice versa: they constitute the alpha and omega between which the distinctive qualification exist. Reuniting the two extremes in the unification of the absolute principle that is God, one reaches the integral equalization that cannot be realized unless in the divine place, which is definitely affirmed by all traditions. One will easily understand that by reflecting on the true purpose of castes, to arrange the imbalances in a hierarchy where every element is contained in its own sphere in a way to constitute a homogeneous whole in which nothing introduced disturbs the traditional linearity. Seen from above, the constitution of castes is not presented as a scale that goes from the higher to the lower, by as a system of concentric circles around an absolute point that is the traditional unity.

All the castes are therefore to be considered on the same level and is unfortunately the incomprehension of this elementary truth that has produced the democratic illusion and error. Instead of putting themselves at the higher point of view that is the divine order, men have descended into the human level that has no value when it is cut off from the divine and thus the revolt has happened in the sense of the same caste which, going beyond its limits, has flooded like a river that runs over the banks and violently levels what it floods. Then, after having cut off the human from the divine, with a logic of free will whose unconsciousness is truly stupefying, the divine plane is confused with the human and what is equal in the eyes of God, they want to transform to equality in the eyes of man, not knowing that equalization is possible only through a being who is beyond the plane considered and, as such, through His own summit, glimpses a unique level while this level does not exist below. They even go back to the sacred texts in order to justify this error of perspective, interpreting it in the most absurd way, overturning every traditional order, abandoning the true God to create a god in man's own image and likeness. It is seen in the abolition of true order, that distinctive, determinative and determined order of castes, the affirmation of the principle

of liberty, not knowing that this in the absolute sense exists only in God, while in man it is conformity to the law of God. According to which every element of creation must remain absolutely in its place in order to be the normal element of nature. But since this democratic leveling was unnatural and restrictive, the castes were transformed into classes and the activity generally understood as a complementary way in the unity of tradition and contemplation, was transformed into work, i.e., into pain, coercion, since such is the meaning of the Latin word.

That explains the class warfare that is the degenerate form of disputes between the castes, which, as we said, is always limited to the first two for reasons of quite another order then those who fuel the claims of the current lower classes. Now "work", properly called, can be applied only to the caste of Workers if this is considered as the last for the reason already mentioned, and not to the Warriors and Priests whose activity is absolutely of a totally different order. The latter are tutelary of the divine constitution, the former protectors of the human constitution, and neither of the two castes therefore leads by its activity to the satisfaction of its own needs: therefore in a truly traditional society, it is necessary that the last caste provides the maintenance of the first two, neither the Priest nor the Warrior, being able to work, and that in an absolute way, since work would impede the fulfillment of their very difficult task, the maintenance of the traditional order.

Referring to the circular symbolism which we just mentioned, if this represents the traditional world as a circle whose center is constituted by the Priests and the circumference by the Warriors, the very close relationship of these two castes in a perfectly organized society will appear: the Warriors represent the centripetal convergence that binds all the points determining them in the univocal axis. They, with their power, defend the traditional purity, which cannot be accomplished materially by the Priests who are contemplatives and who must be protected in the external order by the Warriors. In the convergence resulting from the harmony

between these two powers, the two greatest energies of the traditional world, true, integrally solid, power is achieved, the forest of swords that protect God's enclosure. We recommend to everyone to achieve in its fullness the results that would be obtained from the harmony and the cooperation between the spiritual authority and temporal power through the true destinies of humanity brought back into the great traditional riverbed.

Divine Nature of work and art The Worker[9] caste includes every assignment operative in the individuals who do not belong to the two preceding castes which constitute the base of traditional society: authority and power. When we speak of activity, for this last caste, we mean every type of labor both of the strictly material order like the crafts and of those seemingly more elevated like the professions, since both are remunerated individually. In the two higher castes, we do not speak of truly individual activity since their members work constitutively for the maintenance of the two higher powers, while here, in the last caste, it is a question of an active personal determination whose fruit, however, remains limited to the individual order, while contributing to the general order. We are in the domain of Forms, the last determination of visible reality whose essential characteristic is individualization. In this caste, as in the two higher castes, persons can be included who in reality should not belong to it, which is the indication of the current disorder due precisely to the lack of traditional unity whose most obvious characteristic is the arbitrary distribution of wealth. But in a truly traditional society in which the castes are rigorously established, remunerated labor should be limited to the majority, i.e., to those who neither know how to nor can do otherwise, incapable of the pure contemplation of the Priests and the pure activity of the Warriors.

It is therefore necessary to insist on the analogy between the various

[9] I have translated the root lavor- as labor and oper- as work to be consistent.

castes and the three degrees of reality, i.e., Silence, Rhythms, and Forms, in order to understand their true purpose. If the Forms constitute the most exterior part, that does not mean that their determination does not reflect, in a thousand aspects, the invariable unity that is the one true reality. Every form is a symbol and every symbol is the vehicle of a profound truth whose importance must never be forgotten. So-called objects, things, are likewise mirrors that variously reflect the unity of the creative rhythm in multiple aspects. Man, in ordinary life, makes use of tools that he himself constructs but whose symbolic meaning is currently unknown, while in a traditional society this meaning is precisely what is more important because it provides all the value to the thing without which it would be deprived of universal purpose. Hence, the necessity that the tool be patiently constructed and not serially, with an individual labor that itself is the symbol of the effort through which it is elevated to a higher reality of an absolutely spiritual order.

It will be easy for everyone to distinguish the value of an object, the fruit of patient and assiduous work, quite different from that accomplished by a brutal, external, artificial, and sterile process like an assembly line. Hence, the artistic beauty of the most humble tools of an era and the banality of what is produced in modern times by the machine. Previously, there was art, the profound meaning of symbolic correspondence, and the indicator of this was exactly the care, the commitment with which every object was constructed by the strictly personal work of the craftsman with a diligent technique, in strict analogy with the spiritual renewal wrought in the contemplative and ascetic domain. Every craft then symbolically represented the fixation, in Forms, of a process of an absolutely spiritual order related to a higher reality of which the material world is an appearance, in the strictly etymological sense: man, the creator, makes use precisely of so-called matter—not neglecting the etymology of this word—that is the last, final concretion of reality, in order to redeem it from its apparent blindness and lead it to the transparency of an analogi-

cal correspondence with a higher world. So that while in the already made Forms among which man lives, that are the patterns of the Rhythms, are likewise found mirrors of the higher reality, the objects, the things, the tools that man constructs are new forms and represent the work that he must undertake laboriously in order to liberate himself from his humanity and restore in himself the divine state. Ars et labor: art is the knowledge of the analogical relationships that govern Forms, by means of Rhythms, and achieve them, i.e., make them porous, transparent, to the breath of God who expresses them, while labor is exactly this effort of enucleation of the deep, hidden, veiled reality, protected in matter from which it must shine through to reveal itself to man. There is thus a contact between the interior—man—and the exterior—nature—which is resolved in a single reality of realized and experienced expression, therefore abolished in its crude materiality and restored to its true origin and purpose.

Thus understood in its profound meaning that justifies it and makes it necessary, art is a redeeming purification that reestablishes the creative rhythm obfuscated and neglected by the preoccupations of ordinary life. This life, in an absolute way, is a death, not a life, i.e., the avulsion of the world and man from the true reality of the world and of man realizable only if hidden in divine reality whose origin it symbolically expresses.

Tools, the most common objects of use, were not created for the satisfaction of our needs, but only to express the analogical relations between appearance and reality, between what appears and what is, between the world and God: their practical efficiency is of the second order and is of value only for true serfs, i.e., for those whose intellectual myopia is so widespread that it results in the exclusion of every truth beyond the environment of their terrestrial life. If, in a state of primitive perfection, it is necessary to think of the exclusion of every order in order to reach or extend what was already given, if man, in this state, gathered the fruits of the earth and fed himself with them and did not complete, with his

work, what naturally surrounded him, in later stages, distancing himself from this original standard, he had to reconstruct the access to the divine from which he had fallen and thus a new necessity: art.

To those who know how to examine in depth what we said, the relationship between art and life will appear evident, initially unified so that art was the life itself considered as a rite, then increasingly more discordant, life was reduced to its lowest function and art limited to those who cannot decide to reject truth, up until the current time in which life is really death and art, deprived of every sacred and realizing character, is an expressive monstrosity wherein all the misery of the world and man is reflected.

Art is not redeemed by making of it a need of the spirit: the spirit, and in an absolute way, is nothing if not the Spirit of God, i.e., the breath that is in life, that penetrates and informs the whole man, that makes him feel, act, think according to God, not according to his own humanity. What is human remains human, therefore purely bestial and inferior, which is the level of this humanity, just as everything that is iron remains iron from the most common utensil to the most refined artistic product, both able to lead back to the unity of origin when their exteriority is removed. In fact, what constitutes art for modern men is precisely exteriority instead of the sacred, symbolic content, what this exteriority expresses by relating to a reality of a transcendent order in the absolute meaning of the word and to a truth of divine order.

Man, in the development of his human faculties, remains man, i.e., nothing: what he feels, lives, accomplishes, thinks, if not beyond the human environment, is destined to perish because it cannot extend beyond time that is succession and beyond space that is materiality.

He remains closed in this prison that he adorns with the most lavish funereal pictures, so that to the extent he embellishes it, so much more will the tomb will exist for him as long as he lives: but, after the dissolution of the body, who is there to take care to lead him into the place of truth,

dooming him eternally to that death that he had already experienced in life by rejecting every effort for the surpassing of human limitations. Homo humus: as long as he remains earthbound, he will be doomed to fecundate the earth and to perpetuate the lucifugous illusion that is the detrital, lower world: it is necessary that he clear up the illusory obscurity, due to ignorance, in the light of truth and that he expresses from himself what is hidden, i.e., the other half, which could mean the passage from the archaic word hemi, referring to the general meaning of half, to homo, where the circularity of the o represents the realizing universalization of all the human faculties transposed into the divine and integrated in a essentially superhuman plane. Art is the expression of this transposition that is a true and proper transformation, i.e., a surpassing of the form that is obtained by replacing it in the plane of its normal purpose as symbol of a higher truth. But it is necessary that art is in everything and not in part, that it is not exiled from life and that it does not represent only what we could call the kingdom of fringe utopias, but rather it imprints on the most humble of objects, tools, the seal of its symbolic purpose.

This is craftsmanship, these are the crafts: to depict in every material substance, with a labor of diligent understanding, the intimate, symbolic value, expressing a truth of a higher order, from agricultural instruments and those of the weaving mill, from the most common objects of wood and earth to the construction of house and temple. They are various modes of expression of a unique reality that signify as all the ways lead to God if truly it is God who is sought and not a simple derivative human more or less dressed up and idealized for the use that one wants to make of it.

How Science Displaces Work and Tradition Hence, the corporations also originally represented modes of realization of the divine organized in a regulatory body that established its purpose. This is the real and deep significance of art, craftsmanship, professions, corporations, and let

us not pretend that they all come to fathom it, but what is important is that the pauci optimi [the few of the best], who ought to participate in restoration of tradition, understand what is hidden under the appearances of "utility" and "activity", expressions so dear to those who understand nothing because they realize nothing beyond the illusion of the world and man, both considered without relationship to divine reality. If man is one half, he has to search for the other in order to be made whole, i.e., to be truly man—hemo homo—and one could say, without making a game of words, that he then will truly be man when he ceases to be so. Likewise the world—if it concludes its etymology—that is attired, ornamented, under which the truth of God is hidden, then it will truly be the world, i.e., the place of purification and resurrection, when it is the world, purified from every ignorance, likewise it also will become—the lapis manalis[10] removed—the wide abyss for the precipitation in the spectral kingdom.

From everything that we have mentioned, one easily understands how and why—not for simple purely aesthetic reasons, therefore negligible in themselves—the machine, in all its forms, represents a veritable profanation of labor, because it removes every sacred character, every profound meaning, violating its secret, denaturizing its purpose, suppressing all those seeds of redemption that constitute the raison d'.tre of manual work and of art.

The return to a traditional society would entail a prudent progressive normalization that would be, for the ignorant mass, a true and proper regression but which could be accomplished gradually without creating catastrophes. It is enough that the pauci optimi understand, to their full extent, the absolutely positive consequences that would result from a comparable return to normality: it is a question here, more precisely, of the human dignity that would be restored and reintegrated in all its hierarchical development, in all its expressions, in all its aspects, in all its

[10] `http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lapis_manalis`

fields, in all the castes, in all men.

In order to become sacred, labor must be accomplished by man and not by the machine that, as is clearly observed, takes revenge on man, destroying him in the most blind, bestial and inhuman way, violently and fatally. A renovation worthy of the name entails the return to the norm of human labor, a restitution of those conditions of existence suitable for the development of the great energies that lie buried in man and that can permit him to reach and truly integrate the divine world of reality.

Labor, once connected to its necessary base of meditative concentration, of patient meticulous contact with the world of Forms, in order to perceive the Rhythms and realize the Silence, would again become sacred for all men and each one could, according to his possibilities, accomplish what he is destined to do and that he is strongly removed from that outrageously superficial and profaning modernity.

May the earth, the sea, the sky be restored to their elementary purity, returned to their symbolic purpose, the earth in order to construct house and temple, the base point for the elevation from the human to the divine, the sea to the navigation between the two shores that separate the transient from the divine, the sky to the penetrative flight into the reality of God that is the only reality, and that the machines are gradually, prudently reduced and eliminated in order to make a place for man and put him visibly, without intermediaries, in the face of the difficulties of his celestial task on the earth. Because he cannot escape from the earth if he does not know it, if he does not penetrate it, if he does not make it transparent, letting the holy spirit of the real achievement pass there, returning to labor and art, enriching again the impoverished world, mutilated and profaned by the machine. This was created by the lowest part of man, from what in man is the negation of man because it is the negation of God. We allude to profane science, to that which for so many centuries gives itself the false privilege of redeeming humanity from the chains of materiality.

Here a position of the absolute level that does not admit subterfuge and loopholes is necessary. There is only a single science, sacred science, in an absolute way, i.e., the knowledge of true man restored to his elementary function, to his base, to his centre, to his reason to exist, to his life; to his being, to his purpose, to his perfection, to his universality, to God. This is the only science, the only power derived from the knowledge of his own limitations—it is well established—and of exceeding the limits of terrestriality for the effective realization of the divine possibilities: in this sense only scire est posse [to know is to be able] and not otherwise.

One goes to God with and in the spirit of God, becoming again sons of God, be it formulated in the integrative fullness that does not admit secondary residues and disturbances. All traditions affirm it, with different expressions, in various forms, but with an intentional unity that no one can misunderstand and confuse. Ars una species mille. What is sacred remains such in every tradition of truly divine order and every race is given a tradition conformed to is possibilities, to which it must remain faithful in order to not make the task of traditional integration difficult, while it is permitted only to very few to return to the Primordial Tradition that is in direct contact with the divine plane.

The true science is therefore that contained in the traditional body and has as its goal the return of man to God in all the forms, through all the levels, and according to all the possibilities. Sacred science is the true absolute and definitive knowledge of man and the world in God and comprises various planes of development according to the domain to which it is applied, each one of these planes, however, not able to, nor ever having to, be considered in itself, but all in convergence, in accordance with the unity of the traditional axis, into a single point. This was maintained in antiquity and in the Middle Ages. Science instead is of the exclusively profane order and considers visible reality exteriorly, as it appears not as it is, by integrating itself in such a case in the invisible reality and, taking as the base point exteriority itself, it determines laws.

Therefore, while sacred science is fixed, immutable, eternally constituted and causes stable and permanent traditional societies, profane science is mutable, unstable, progressive and, with its development, gives origin to anti-traditional, precarious, and transient societies.

The domain of sciences is the visible, i.e., therefore, the superficial that, as such, separated from the body to which it belongs, is illusory and as nonexistent; the successive development of scientific hypotheses shows the inanity of an effort destined to remain sterile, unproductive, since truth indefinitely postponed into the future, i.e., never realized, is not a truth. What is concrete and positive for science is truly the ephemeral and the negative, i.e., the phenomenal appearance considered in itself, because as we said, when brought back to its invisible root, it reacquired another meaning, another attribution, and another reality.

This sign in the theoretical field can suffice: how much then is the development of the so-called western civilizations the most conclusive demonstration of the practical advantage derived from the applications of science? One thinks of the misery, the precariousness, the frivolity of current existence and one will understand what results science applied to life can lead to. It is not allowed to insist on that without falling into the realization that every reasonable man can currently make, considering the shortness of the duration of life, its sussultatory character, the rising devirilization of humanity, the precariousness of everything, the spasmodicity of every bond, the insecurity of every system, finally the instability that is the indicator of a permanent abortive process due to the absence of traditional fixity.

Science, having become secular, i.e., popular, became the dominion of everything because it is accessible to everyone through its exteriority, superficiality, and facility and was the principle stimulus to the so-called servile awakening, to the progressive democratization of Europe since, after eliminating every true traditional knowledge and excluding every spiritual surpassing, it leveled hierarchy and, with its practical industrial

applications, it amazed the foolish and caused libertarian unrest in the masses, of which the current world is the strongest and most authentic expression. Humanity let itself deviate by easy explanations, by immediate practical applications and has forgotten to ask itself up to what point could it reach such a pronounced deviation from the traditional axis. First of all, science has infinitized so-called nature, divinizing it and exalting its mysteries as if there could be other mysteries outside the divine, then it made a stir on a problematic god who follows with his benevolent eye, approving, the progressive contaminations, and finally, acting autonomous, was proclaimed the guide of research and master of life. Man, destitute of all his power, i.e., the very surpassing of his own humanity in order to reach higher and decisive states, was given instead a false creativity in the world of exteriority that lasts as long as his life and is prolonged as long as he is ignorant.

Conclusion Even those who say and believe they adhere to a tradition have accepted science as the expression of an achievement that, according to them, would not collide with the truths of the divine order; more impure and blind than the others, they implicitly repudiate every spirituality and show they do not know the fundamentals of sacred science: this is exclusive of every knowledge that does not replace the elements of creation in the circularity of dependence by a unique center of which they are only appearances. Men, accustomed to the separative visions of things, in considering elements and forces, distanced themselves from integrative contemplation for which everything loses precisely that material and determined consistency that is the foundation of scientific investigation. Science rises when traditional knowledge no longer succeeds in maintaining supremacy through the disintegration of its own unity: philosophy, also secular, has substituted for sacred wisdom.

It is a fateful cycle that is fulfilled and whose origins must be traced back to the very nature and the frame of mind of the people of the West in-

capable of maintaining intact the traditional solidarity in order for them to be brought to the exteriority of the active life. With the progressive dimming of sacred motifs secular motifs arose and the attainments that man was no longer able to accomplish in the domain of the supersensible were limited to those that were easy and exterior for a childish craving for visible concreteness. While the creative process starts from the internal to the external, the scientific process comes from the external, which does not exist as such, to a purely nonexistent and ideal internal subordinated to that which does not exist except as depending on appearance: hence the scientific hypothesis claims to be the standard of method.

The current condition of humanity and antitraditional blooming are due in great part to science, to the scientific spirit, but also to philosophy that, with science, has substituted for sacred science. Philosophy, subordinated to Revelation, is a preparatory and necessary stage to higher truths that must be integrated, experienced, in order to be known: without revelation, it is sterile and false and is transformed into veritable diverting nonsense. Philosophy is based exclusively on reason, which presupposes a revelatory light in order to be guided to truly decisive ends be it only in the theoretical sense: isolated from this, it cannot find any absolute point of reference, because the absolute is beyond reason and beyond man in the sense that these cannot approach it unless ceasing to be it, which does not prevent them from passing through his terrestrial existence, as everyone will easily be able to convince himself considering that Ascetics and the Saints, those, i.e., those who from this life have reached a permanent state of beatific vision that is fulfilled in eternity, certainly not able to be realized within the limits of time and space. Philosophy is a preparation to sacred science and can constitute its theoretic side only if it is subordinated to it, because otherwise it is nothing: it would not even be of interest to show how and why, from the Renaissance on, modern thought unwound following a direction that is ever more antitraditional in order to be liberated from sacred science that necessarily must precede

it because it is focused and productive.

To what extent can Pascal's famous phrase[11] suffice to denounce the incongruity and inadequacy of the god of the philosophers and poets. Divine reality is revealed and no philosophy, if it remains such, can realize it: this possibility is to be excluded in an absolute way: all the acrobatics of human reason will never succeed in grasping that which, being simple, original, and absolute, offers itself from itself through direct realization and cannot actualize itself through a discursive process that is only direct and mediated. Moreover, after what has been said, in the domain of divine unity there is only divine unity itself and what is human is not excluded from it as simply nonexistent, or, better said, as existing only as long as ignorance lasts: this dispelled, and sacred science tends precisely to that, true and proper realization is initiated that, as unitary and passing beyond what is produced and generated, can rigorously be called metaphysical and metarational. We could also call it "intuition" although no psychological quality is given to this term: the psyche in fact is below the spirit, the intellect, the heart—these three terms denoting, under three aspects, the same type of integrative activity of the divine. The spirit expresses the direct integration whose absolute type is the divine breath, the intellect expresses the cognitive permeation, the heart expresses radiant receptivity: by means of the first, one is elevated, with the second, absorbed, in the third, one is welcomed and realizes himself. Representing here a vertical axis, the spirit is the peak, the intellect the base, the heart the center that gathers the two extreme points and extends them, prolonging them horizontally, hence the Cross as radiant symbol of universality and unifying centrality.

No one will dare assert that philosophy can be elevated to this sphere which is of an integrally revelatory order because it is superhuman in the absolute sense of the word. These truths constitute exactly the traditional

[11]God of Abraham, God of Isaac, God of Jacob — not of the philosophers and scholars.

body, the sacred science, whose transmission happened in a divine way: this knowledge is the true knowledge for the absoluteness and legitimacy of the efforts accomplished in the same axis of truth.

If the Priests are the depositories of it, all men, even the Workers, must extend themselves by giving to their activity a sacred intention and not considering it as the pure satisfaction of their needs and desires. These cannot be, in the seat the truth, distinct in the lower and higher, material or spiritual, in the absolutely erroneous meaning that the moderns give to the last term when they apply it to that which is called the cultural environment. Culture is a profane thing and does not come close to true spirituality: we admit that it perfects the sensibility and develops the intelligence, but it rests completely outside of that which is sacred and real precisely because it is sacred. It is something empty and superficial and is reduced to a vision of life where all the prejudices of the modern era flow into each other, from so-called historicity to linguistics, all exterior sciences that leave intact the domain of the true reality which evades any separative analysis and false constructive synthesis. As behind the Forms there are Rhythms, so behind the visible there is the invisible and as modern sciences stop only at what is expressed but not at that which expresses. Actually, cultural prejudice contributed to the current decline with a dense network of loci communes [commonplaces] which is applied indiscriminately to the present and the past, all being considered sub specie alteritatis in its own function and not as the reflection of a quid that eludes exterior analysis. This is not the place to insist on modern deviations which have behind them a centuries-old preparation which led to the current madness. Nevertheless many symptoms of nausea, fatigue, and glut bring hope that a radical change can still be produced in a progressive way and without too violent perturbations. This rectification can and must happen from the inside to the outside, i.e., it is necessary that the orientation of thought changes and determines the progressive return to normality: let us say "return" meaning especially a restoration

of the traditional spirit because the exterior forms can never be reproduced; the cycles do not renew themselves and do not return backwards, repeating developments already accomplished. Nor is it possible to predict how this traditional return will happen if first it is not really initiated with stable foundations and with roots that sink into the very core of the integrally restored traditional unity.

The sad anomalies of current life, the discomfort of individuals and peoples, all the previous misunderstandings serious in themselves but fueled by freedom granted with impunity to those who are not worthy of it, the impoverishment, the progressive cover-up of existence, the vanity of facts, the lack of a secure direction capable of satisfying not only the small needs of small men, but above all the needs of integral man in his true revelatory function of the divine essence—all that brings hope that an awakening can and must be accomplished provided that the pauci optimi, conscious of this necessity, does not let itself be submerged by the ignorance of the anonymous and profane crowd.

But if we start from the divine truth as the basis of orientation and we restore the axis of convergence integrally, an endeavor to which the Priests and the Warriors must contribute to, consciously united as being truly the sustainers of tradition, it unites them because the former contemplate and by contemplating realize, the latter because they liberate activity from its contingent utilitarian character developing it in protective adherence to what is sanctified in the Temple through the maintenance of the sacred deposit, then truly the last caste, which is the most numerous and constitutes the great mass, will also reclaim the Sacred Path where every feeling, symbol of a higher purpose, is established in a single direction like a river from a thousand ripples contained within the same banks, and will be reconstituted, with the fascification of all the energies turned to a single end, the new trunk on the old roots which are still alive and ready to regerminate because revived from the eternal breath of God.

Posted on 2013-06-30 by Cologero

* * *

Graham on 2013-07-02 at 00:12 said:

There are three points somewhat unclear to me.

(1) He speaks of a 'Fourth' state which unifies the others in ineffability, and of an analogous 'fourth' state of Servile Workers. Am I correct in understanding that they comprise those who are 'outside' the caste system, the former by being above it, the latter by being beneath it?

(2) Later he speaks of work versus activity. Am I right in taking this distinction to have some relationship to the principle of freedom? With respect to the circular symbolism he employs, do the rings nearer the centre 'act' in a higher degree, while those approaching the periphery 'work'. It is unclear to me. AK Coomaraswamy writes that the artisan's activity is composed of both contemplation (in conceiving the work) and servile labour (in executing it). Personally, I have found that purely intellectual endeavours feel more nearly like work (in the sense of pain and toil) than do endeavours where 'theory' flows into manual activity.

(3) The meaning of the principle of liberty escapes me. Man's liberty is conformity to the law of God – so far so good. Caste forms a part of this law, self-evidently, so we can say that far from being oppressive, it is most free — a man is most free when he occupies the station conforming to his nature. But can we still say that the upper castes, insofar as they are closer to the centre, have 'more freedom' than the lower castes? There is something quantitative about this thought, and which is incongruent with my experience of being more free when operating within my natural capacities.

I do hope that the next installment will have more to say about the role and possibilities of the Workers. As an aside, for those who may have forgotten, Guenon's Reign of Quantity has several excellent chapters bearing on the crafts and their spiritual possibilities.

Avery on 2013-07-03 at 21:41 said:

Graham:

(1) By analogy of India, the fourth caste is part of the initial caste system and is not outside it. Arguably the creation of outcastes is unbalancing and therefore undesirable in Tradition.

I wonder if this missing fourth has anything to do with Plato's Timaeus and Critias, where the fourth is a necessary part of stability in three dimensional geometry, even though fourths constantly seem to go missing in those dialogues.

(2) Can we get the original word Giorgio is using here? He doesn't seem to be talking about work (opus) but labor. Labor, in both its masculine and feminine meanings, is a necessary task but one that requires less intellect than work.

Now some writers claim that work is supposed to be inferior to philosophy. Hannah Arendt places both contemplation and politics above work in classical civilization, and only contemplation in medieval civilization. In my opinion, though, an opus is something that, despite being physical, rises above the animal need for labor, as reflected in the ornate work put into all physical objects at the height of great civilizations.

Jacob on 2013-07-03 at 22:26 said:

This discussion reminds me of Josef Pieper's "Leisure, the basis of culture". If you guys have time it's worth picking up. Fairly short, but very good.

Cologero on 2013-07-03 at 23:54 said:

RE (2), this is the sentence: "le caste si sono trasformate in classi e l'attivita' generalment intesa come via complementare, nell'unita' traditionale, di quella contemplative, si e' trasformata in lavoro, cioe' in pena, in costrizione, poiche' tale e' il sense del termine latino"

Rather than the normal word "lavoratore", he calls this class the "operarii", a neologism.

Why would Arendt put the nobility with the workers in the medieval era? They didn't think so.

The worker's freedom is conditioned since he works with forms as an individual, unlike the Priests and Warriors (although the difference between "conditioned" and "conditionality" is unclear, at least in English.) The Priests tries to transcend form, and the freedom of the warriors is conditioned by his necessary activity in the world, but not by individual forms, they deal with the whole. That does not mean the worker is not free.

The labor of the animal is always natural. The work of man is transcendent and is the reflection of a supernatural reality.

Avery on 2013-07-04 at 01:09 said:

Thank you for the original quotation. Giorgio's creation of a neologism shows that he understands and maintains the essential distinction between labor and opus.

"Why would Arendt put the nobility with the workers in the medieval era? They didn't think so."

If the caste system functions as an order then no part can be disregarded; the whole thing is equally traditional and must remain in balance. I made a very bad summary of Arendt on the way to that point. She was not trying to lump workers and nobility together, but rather show how politics was degraded from a formerly sacred status. Classical politics was seen as part of the pursuit of the sacred, while medieval secular power became distinct from spiritual authority, although it aimed for harmony between the two. (Modern politics, of course, is even worse!) The classical philosophers focused much of their efforts on trying to perfect the earthly city, but

Augustine told us to abandon the earthly city and seek the divine. Obviously Arendt's argument was way more complex than this but my memory works best with concrete examples.

Michael on 2013-07-04 at 20:29 said:

Has there ever been a culture that has gone from being like ours to having castes? I can't think of one in recorded history, but there might be something in mythology that speaks to moving from a dark age to a traditional society.

Cologero on 2013-07-05 at 09:18 said:

Following the dissolution of the Roman Empire, there was a concerted effort (documented in Georges Duby's "The Three Orders") to re-establish society on the basis of the three functions described by Georges Dumezil.

Logres on 2013-07-14 at 22:23 said:

This is fabulous; particularly the passage on the cross being the symbol of heart, intellect, & spirit united. I think there are many "workers" who know something is wrong, & are working, with the hope that the Priests & Warriors will begin to act in time.

Michael on 2013-07-17 at 21:13 said:

This is a bit off topic but related since de Giorgio is talking the three orders. To what extent is membership in one of the orders by birth? Evola talks about the priestly caste being twice born, but that would mean that some of the upper caste (or the priests or nobility) are not really of that order if they are not initiates. I think of the nobility of today and it does not seem that they are particularly noble except for birth.

If being twice born is the criteria, then who makes the call?

I apologize if this has already been answered elsewhere.

Cologero on 2013-07-18 at 23:39 said:

Michael, the three castes that Guido De Giorgio wrote about should be "twice born" as they still are in India AFAIK. Not so long ago in Europe, the priests obviously had their orders, the nobility would probably belong to some order of chivalry, and the workers had their guilds.

5.6 Deification of Man

In **Guido de Giorgio**, we often find the best from **Rene Guenon** and **Julius Evola**. Yet, the "personal equation" is qualitatively different. Guenon

is cold and logical, the path of the jnani whose goal is the Truth. Evola sometimes writes with a deep passion, but is often wordy; his is the path of action, with the Good as its goal. De Giorgio, on the other hand, seems to speak as a man of conviction, arising from an inner knowing, while avoiding the sentimental and the merely personal. He is a poet and mystic, following the highest path, that of Absolute Beauty[12].

Guenon and Evola, for all their virtues, are ultimately escapists, Guenon to the "traditional" East and Evola to the long forgotten Ancient Rome. But De Giorgio offers a different way. Unlike Guenon who seems to regard the various Traditions as discrete and independent, Evola and De Giorgio see a continuity in the Traditions of the West, from the Hyperboreans to the Medieval era. Yet Evola wants to stop part way, and even to reverse it, while De Giorgio wants to continue and complete the rectification that Evola described.

Taking Guenon's claim seriously that **Dante**'s Divine Comedy is a blueprint of the path for initiates, he describes a vision for the reconstitution of Tradition in his La Tradizione Romana, under the aspects of the Divine Cycle, the roles of the castes, the role of the Leader, the spirit of the Roman tradition, and its fulfillment in the Comedy.

In the following passage from Aforismi e Poesie (Archè Milano, 1999), De Giorgio describes the process of Deification, drawing on Traditional notions. From Guenon, we see that "man" is just one of the states of being, but does not exhaust all the states. From Evola, we see the theme of transcending man as such, and the way to know God is to be God[13]. But we suspect, however, that De Giorgio is saying the same thing, not as an abstract theory, but rather from his own interiority. Readers can judge for themselves. De Giorgio's text follows:

> To lose consciousness of oneself, to become conscious of God. To become conscious of the nothing that I am in order to

[12] https://gornahoor.net/?p=3537

[13] https://gornahoor.net/?p=1875

> have consciousness of everything that is God. One does not take a step toward God without this preliminary negative. What I am not, God is.
>
> Man makes himself God in the measure in which he is no longer man, that is, when his transparency, in the absolute sense, is such that God passes through him. This is the deification of man, not human imperfection arrogantly divinized—a haughtiness absolutely outside the place in life that leads to God—but man annulled, abolished, dissipated, so that God alone is because God alone is God and no god is god except God.

Posted on 2012-05-03 by Cologero

* * *

`Farid Othman al Deenari on 2012-05-04 at 02:50 said:`

"Guenon and Evola, for all their virtues, are ultimately escapists... "

We object to this characterization. In fact, it is the world around us that is 'escapist', whilst we, in such a milieu, are automatically faulted for being anchored in the realm of knowledge. This realm, being ever present and not subject to temporal conditions, namely space and time, does not allow one to escape from it; nor could we escape to it, for it is all that exists, both theoretically, and practically to those who possess effective consciousness of it.

Insofar as the West deviates, the defender of truth can and will be misrepresented as an 'escapist' by simply holding his ground.

`Cologero on 2012-05-04 at 05:23 said:`

Farid, I did not intend "escapist" as a personal insult to those men, but rather in the sense that, on a personal level, they abandoned (i.e., "escaped" from) the West. Whatever you may think about not being subject to temporal conditions, as a stark matter of fact, Guenon did indeed translate himself in Space, and Evola was nostalgic for a different Time.

Those of us who choose to hold our ground — in the West at this historical moment — cannot limit ourselves to their choices.

`Angolmois on 2012-05-04 at 13:53 said:`

De Giorgio quote reminded me about the initiatic experience of being a complete human personality with all traits intact while witnessing also at the same time the universal consciousness.

Astrologically speaking this would mean the dual experience of Leo (integrated personality) and Aquarius (universal consciousness). De Giorgio seems to be taking a stance for the universal consciousness ('pratyeka'), while Evola was more of an alchemist and a hermetist in this regard, since he "remained in the cosmos and got back to it" instead of choosing to escape from it through the Capricornian gate.

Cologero: I find it hard to see either Guénon and Evola as escapists, yet I understand what you mean with it. And after all, did not Evola describe the way you mention in your last post in his 'Ride the Tiger' with unfathomable precision? "A way out, further in" etc.?

Charlotte on 2012-05-04 at 19:09 said:

woah, rewind, Capricorn gate, say more bro – I've been there!! It's in Atlantis, it's scary, at least I was scared... .panic stations, password, aaarrggg!!

Charlotte on 2012-05-04 at 19:58 said:

deep at the bottom of de-nial!!

Angolmois on 2012-05-05 at 04:39 said:

Concerning Atlantis and escapism, did not the Masters of Light leave the degenerated Atlantis when they saw that it is too late and futile to save it wholly; the preservation of the core of the primordial tradition clearly outweighed the saving of a few souls who do not even recognise the need to be saved.

Charlotte: I've been in the temples Atlantis also in my dreams. Finely arranged beautiful temples and amazing surroundings, that's all I can say. The water was in a very important role in the surrounding gardens, and the whole scene was very beautiful. Although this is my personal fantasy, it certainly reflects the stories told about the Atlantean tradition.

Charlotte on 2012-05-05 at 06:44 said:

well that's kind of right, but an essential factor is missing there. The Atlanteans, as you probably know, were of one mind – not of 'scattered' consciousness such as humanity experienced after the destruction of the Tower of Babel. This enabled them to do extraordinary things in terms of building, for instance, and the manifestation of 'gods' in what is perhaps best understood in terms of the literary myths we now have. They were also very 'in tune' (understatement) with the forces of nature, which is what led ultimately to their downfall. The power they had access to became corruptive within their souls and they began performing ever more extreme feats of power to do with the weather, for instance, and fire – the discovery of nuclear energy, in particular. They also became very interested in sex and started to enhance their bodies in order to maximise sexual pleasure (hence their association now with the dolphin race, which is the most sexual creature on earth, humans included). This is why there are such uncanny resonances

with the modern world, which is staring into its mirror at Atlantis – a magical future prophecy as much as a past 'legend', or buried memory (for 'weather modification', read 'HAARP'). As far as I'm aware the memory of the flood and all that went with it was so traumatic that humanity collectively wiped it out of its consciousness, leading to the state of 'slumber' experienced by the mass of humankind. And yes of course it was the 'elite', as ever, who largely escaped the consequences of the group actions, of which they – as the ones in power – were must culpable. Another parallel with modern life in which the 'elites' – all that means now is those with money – are more able than most to escape the horrific consequences of 'the fall'... .to a point... .there's only so far one – even a privileged one – can go along that road, be sure of it. There's more than one reason why the princes Buddha and Jesus renounced their wealth. The escape of the elites is a plan that has once again been activated, but this time around more people are aware of the situation – more people whose memories of Atlantis are NOT buried. The priests weren't quite the only ones who escaped. They planned their exodus, but others simply survived and were washed up on other shores. A lot of these have ended up as 'new agers' because of their resentment at the way the priestcraft handled the catastrophe – causing the problem then saving themselves. So even though they 'know' the hierarchy holds truths about God and man, there is a reaction against the hierarchy and a drive to make known what was formerly kept secret, so that everyone has a chance to survive. A lot of those who imagine themselvs to be elite now are not really 'in the club'. They have been given a certain amount of information and this in itself is so monumental that for the most part they are content to simply indulge their password potential, opening of the magical doors and access to the other world. In this way are some of the greatest minds and initiates kept a degree lower than they are really able to achieve, because if they were to attain to the highest orders they would then understand the terrible side of the truth and comprehend the extent to which they have been fooled. The key at that point is to break open the closed circle by invoking the name of Jesus Christ and through love and compassion (Happy Birthday Buddha!)throwing one's lot in to help the children in the nursery to survive, to awaken, in other words. Tangentially, the swastika goes back to at least Atlantean times. It is still possible to go there in the astral so your dreams, if lucid, are most likely to be true. I've pestered Cologero about this so many times I see no reason to break the habit and hold back now – here is my story :-)

http://alchemical-weddings.com/alchemical-weddings/atlantis

http://alchemical-weddings.com/alchemical-weddings/half-man-half-fish

http://alchemical-weddings.com/alchemical-weddings/swastika

http://alchemical-weddings.com/alchemical-weddings/ancient-script

http://alchemical-weddings.com/alchemical-weddings/pisces-capricorn

Charlotte on 2012-05-05 at 06:55 said:

this isn't just 'altruism', by the way. Humanity is bound together by its collective karma, so it's essential that the 'weight' of this is light as a feather, that the balance is tipped towards ascension not sinking. United we'll stand and divided we fall... .

mleow on 2012-05-05 at 09:52 said:

I also find the notion that "Evola was nostalgic for a different Time" is misleading. At least that is not the sense and understanding i get of the man and his writing, as Angolmois said "Ride the tiger" is perhaps the best example that Evola was in fact the one from the "traditionalist school" with the least escapist/nostalgic notions trying to cope with the modern reality as it is and all its destructive tendencies as incitments to inner awakening, instead of trying to conjure up artifical paradises, medieval, roman or whatever. The word "Good" in this regard also seems a bit strange, he always mentions the "Unconditioned" as the highest goal to steer ones compass to. Would you care to elaborate or refer to parts of his writing as regarding claims for this goal towards the "Good"?

That said, im hoping to see more of these Giorgio translations. In what form has his writings survived is it merely texts from various correspondences or has he also written books on esoteric topics?

Cologero on 2012-05-05 at 10:28 said:

The object of Action is the Good, otherwise action would be purposeless. Please think of it in the Traditional sense as a transcendental. For Plato, the Good itself was the ultimate. But as transcendentals, the Good, the True, and the Beautiful are ultimately unconditioned and One. How else could Action "lead" to the Unconditioned?

How is "riding the tiger" not passive? You are basing your judgment of Evola only on what has been made available to you. We have undertaken the effort to show the Evola of the 30s and 40s to demonstrate that he was decidedly not "riding the tiger", but engaged in the political situation of the time. A man may have to ride the tiger, when historico-material conditions are unsuited to him. But our position here is that conditions have changed, so to ride the tiger is no longer an option. *A fortiori*, the time is come for the elite to arise and create the proper conditions. It is your option to *cope* with conditions, and continue to whine about the modern world, but the point is, as someone once said, to change it.

De Giorgio published nothing while he was alive. *La Tradizione Romana* existed in manuscript form in the 30s, presumably a copy was sent to Mussolini. It is systematic and describes the lineaments of the constitution of a future Traditional society. At that time he was associated with Evola and presumably they were trying to influence the political situation in the early 1930s toward a more Traditional direction.

At some point, De Giorgio withdrew, living a solitary life in the mountainous part of Italy, where he traveled a more mystical path. He left behind notebooks of poems and short essays, but nothing systematic; these have been gradually published after his death. I will translate more of the Roman Tradition on Gornahoor to show that Tradition is more than nostalgia. I will translate the more mystical and devotional texts elsewhere, since they may not be suited to the more analytical tone of Gornahoor. For example:

Woman: `http://www.meditationsonthetarot.com/woman`, from *Aphorisms and Poems*.

`Charlotte on 2012-05-05 at 11:08 said:`

So what course will the 'elite' take in trying to improve conditions in the present world for one and all, because a political party or philosophical school won't achieve this? What is required is positive practical action, of that there can be no doubt. Who is prepared to give up home comforts, abandon the supermarket in favour of small stores, cut out food additives, quit supporting big businesses, to cease buying into the system, to desist from believing the lies of politicians, to understand that the corporate tapeworm economy is strangling the world – who can and WILL break free of the matrix-net surrounding us, be they elite or otherwise? Acknowledging with searing honesty who the desposynic heirs really are – and what it really takes to partake of the promised spiritual truths – is a difficult but necessary first step to achieving the desirable goal of saving the world. A leap of faith is required by almost everyone, plus individual determination to reform the self as a microcosmic alchemical procedure that brings about the cosmic renewal. Really there is no point denying it!

`Angolmois on 2012-05-05 at 15:06 said:`

I have personally understood Evola's 'Ride the Tiger' precisely as a path of action and positive change in-side the modern world. In Evola's own words it is meant for "the elite", but only as a handbook and a manual for individuals who may perhaps have no apparent connexion between each other. If this is out of the question for you Cologero and "not enough", I think that Gornahoor and websites / blogs like this one are one of the best way for the eventual organisation and appearance of the spiritual hiearchy of the earth that will change the world "in an instant" when the time is ready. Right now "we" are still scattered around and largely unorganised, not the least because of petty infighting among those who should first and foremost have a mutual understanding and the spirit of co-operation in their hearts.

`mleow on 2012-05-06 at 04:11 said:`

That makes it more clear.

I have read all of Evola's work that are available in english and the few snippets of translations made avaible on Gornahoor has not made any drastic revelation or revaluation about him

or his work on my part. Well please remember that "ride the tiger" was one of his later books so its quite natural that he did not pursued that path of apoletia etc under the war and fascist years, where at least the possibilty and "humanmaterial" existed to change and influence the millieu in a traditional direction. I dont whine much really anymore about being born in this declining world. I accept my situation and embrace it as Evola would say, as a spiritual test, try to see things according to truth and don't succumb or waste my life trying to cut of hydraheads ie spend my time on any vain action, as a spiritual master once said "Who has improved the world? People have improved themselves and then gone."

You say that the conditions have changed and yet in your next sentence you say that an elite will arise to create the new conditions? Sounds paradoxical to me. From my point of view i don´t see it as realistic that a spiritual elite will spring up and take control, could you please specify as concretely as possibly and not merely in the abstract how the current conditions seems apt for such an event to occur? How will this legion of beermongering footballcrazed pursuit of pleasurist sentimentalist secular cynical rationalist people ever recognise ,not to mention obey or need such an elite??

Charlotte on 2012-05-06 at 04:34 said:

Let's keep it real shall we? the actual spiritual elite are out there right now saving lives, with no time to sit around chit-chatting, hampered mainly by the refusal of the super-rich and super-powerful to either offer support to the solution or cease working against God and for themselves only

Cologero on 2012-05-06 at 12:56 said:

Evola's subtitle for Ride the Tiger was this: "orientamenti esistenziali per un'epoca di dissoluzione". Apparently, it was the American publishers who added: A Survival Manual for the Aristocrats of the Soul. Does anyone suppose that aristocrats of the soul publish "how to" manuals in mass market paperback editions? As the real Marcuse wrote, everything is co-opted by the system.

No, mleow, I cannot describe in detail, because it involves a singularity, the end of one world and the beginning of another. However, *contra factum non est disputandum*, and the facts point to traditional civilizations, or new spiritual movements, arising seemingly out of nothing. But I agree with you about avoiding vain action, or disputing with the ignorant.

Charlotte, you do true religion a disservice by trying to restrict it to moralism and humanism. That has never been the case.

Charlotte on 2012-05-06 at 15:09 said:

Since when did keeping it real mean doing 'true religion' a disservice – maybe the truth hurts? I thought works were the ultimate proof of faith – the royal road is one we all love to

tread, but the greatest Masters preach and practice poverty – how can this be denied? I'd be the last one to discount the power of prayer but I'm not seeing much of that either and I don't like hypocrisy – talk about 'elites' makes me cringe and like it or not, it IS the humble practioners who tend to be the most touched by God's grace, you can see it shining from them. Not that I'm counting myself amongst this saintly group, just pointing out basic facts – we are looong past the theoretical stage of forming the 'new world', Utopia was good enough. Now it's time for implementation and in my opinion it's beyond urgent, but people are wholly resistant to change for the better if it means disrupting their own comfortable lives even by one iota. And I'm not a humanist, you know I am not, there is no need to be bitchy – something about not shooting the messenger? Apologies, however, if I've over-moralising, I know that can be very annoying... .chit chat is fine, I'll butt out :-)

Cologero on 2012-05-06 at 18:51 said:

I sense a severe communications breakdown here, but I'm not sure what it is. You speak of "Masters", who are, I believe, what we mean by *spiritual elite*. Didn't Tomberg say somewhere that at the necessary moment, someone will appear to right things? I believe he mentioned by name St. Francis and St. Ignatius. Do you cringe because we single them out as "saints"?

We have no objection to spiritual and corporal works, but please keep in mind the story of Martha and Mary. The present danger is a man-centred religion, when it needs to be God-centred. The contemplative life has always been primary and everything else flows therefrom.

Angolmois on 2012-05-07 at 03:17 said:

I believe there is no need to despair if things seem to be currently out of hands concerning making things right again. The world will dissolve and break apart, that's the very promie of all scriptures, and then the "elite" or "the masters" – who are preparing themselves as we speak – will come out of the hermetic closet and reveal the real "new world order" and the new age "in the spirit of Lif and Lifhtrasil"; life, light and breath of the spirit(ual hierarchy).

Having battled with this issue for years in desperation and in the dark night of the soul I simply some day realised that it actually requires quite little in reality for things to change for the better again. It requires the change in the hearts and minds of men, and for this we all must aim our prayers and deeds. The Good One is still in charge no matter how it looks like right now.

Blessings of The High One for you all.

Charlotte on 2012-05-07 at 05:10 said:

Well I think it's the focus on Rome I'm finding difficult, but I accept that this is a large part of what Gornahoor is about so fair enough because it is your website. I certainly never said mention of 'saints' made me cringe, the opposite in fact, I said mention of 'elite', I don't like the connotations of that word, it reminds me of the nazis. I accept, however, that it may not be

meant in the way I'm reading it. I believe true 'Masters', like St Francis, practice poverty and love humanity, the notion of a superstructure of 'more brilliant' minds and people controlling the ignorant masses is what 'elitism' speaks of. I also think I make a valid point about works – the 'Masters' of the ilk of St Francis literally went out and healed people, as did the ultimate Master, Jesus. Perhaps I sense my own 'lack', for want of a better word, in the face of people who are able to put into practice more of what they know, or who know 'less' but do more to help humanity. Put it this way, a starving child needs prayers for sure, but also something else, right? Maybe I'm just reaching the stage of my spiritual journey where I'd like to put the food into their mouths more often, rather than 'just' praying. Which again, is not to discount the power of prayer, more collective positive thinking in the world could work miracles, but in the meantime there are multiple crises that need tackling on multiple fronts. Another example of a 'humble' soul of the kind I was referring to might be America's own George Washington Carver – having read something of his life for the first time quite recently he certainly emerges as a 'Master' initiate of sorts, so in this respect truly 'elite'. Perhaps the real issue, then, is one of defining precisely what constitutes this 'elite'. Maybe I've been misunderstanding by thinking that people here are singled out as being 'elite' simply for having adopted a certain political/religious philosophy and going on to write about it? And yes, I do believe there is a Messiah who rights things, ultimately there is only one Master, the great leveller... .I agree the change must come in the hearts and midns of all humans, this is what I'm meaning by 'grass roots' level action, whereby all individuals take responsibility. The time of teaching has been going on for a long while, it's time to put these things into practice. As for 'New World Order'... .well, we had a recent discussion about the Georgia Guidestones. Unfortunately most of those who might think of themselves as 'elite' in this context are simply rich and powerful. Any esoteric knowledge they might have gleaned has come from decidedly suspect angles, OTO, etc – and all mixed in with the influx of nazism into America following WWII. They never really lost the war, you know?

> Charlotte on 2012-05-07 at 05:13 said:
> I also refer to Einstin: 'those who know have a duty to act'

> Cologero on 2012-05-07 at 08:19 said:

Perhaps, Charlotte, you could read *The Second Precept of Love*[14], particularly what he says about the prehension of the All or Unity. We tend to experience the world in discrete pieces rather than in its totality. This applies to Time as well as Space; in other words, the panorama of History is also the unfolding of a divine Plan, not just the work of men.

Guenon complained about the change in the word "elite" from the way he first used it. It

[14] http://www.meditationsonthetarot.com/the-second-precept-of-love

may be better to think of it as the "elect", as in "many are called, few are chosen (electus)". So, it is not something a person may claim for himself, but rather something that is assigned to him from above. Your Master also speaks of the leaven in the bread, so we are entirely faithful to that message. The change must come from the elect, long before it comes "in the hearts and minds of all humans".

Who are you, Charlotte, Martha or Mary?

Cologero on 2012-05-07 at 08:36 said:

As for the focus on Rome, that is due to its central place in the history of Europe, a fortiori, the very creation and self-understanding of Europe, not once, but twice. Aeneas, the spiritual founder of Rome, brought the Wisdom of the East to the West, of which Rome was the center. Dante, in De Monarchia, points out the Divine Plan for Ancient Rome, and I assume everyone is familiar with that.

Then we see the central place of Rome in the Tarot, in the Arcana of the High Priest of Rome and the Emperor of Rome. As their influence wanes, the world falls apart.

By the way, there are no Nazis in USA, quite the contrary. USA is the heir to Cromwell's England and the British Freemasons. OTO is a British, not a Nazi, organization.

Charlotte on 2012-05-07 at 09:04 said:

Yes I know, from Crowley, but a lot of the 'magick' employed is similar to the way the nazis achieved their dark spiritual aims. A lot of nazi scientists, as you know, escaped to America, they were taken on board by the government. When I say 'they won', I mean in terms of the technological/material emphasis in the world today, in particualr the warcraft. Hitler took heart to some extent – for his racial theories, at least – from the American wars against the Indian, and he was also fairly admiring of the English, it's all tied up together as I'm sure you're aware. What is helpful, however, is a clarification of what is meant by 'elite', thank you – as this is a term that's often bandied about these days in a very negative sense.This is an open website so who knows what casual readers might think? (To some extent I'm one of those, if also regular). I still maintain, however, that the change has already come from the minds of the 'elect', the forerunners, and it is up to us now to implement this in some way. To bring it out of the world of formation and into the world in a way that is recognisable to all. The way of salvation. Rome, well, I'm 'Greek', as I think you also know – my tutor was very snooty about Roman history in comparison and I agree with him almost entirely on this point! The answer is to revive the Mysteries, drink from the lake of memory – here! http://alchemical-weddings.com/alchemical-weddings/lake-of-memory-2

Angolmois on 2012-05-07 at 10:52 said:

For the sake of clarification, Charlotte & others, what I meant by 'the new world order' has certainly nothing to do with what is meant by it today. I used it simply to refer to the emerging Tradition in the ruins of the current world, a transcendental order and a new golden age, the age of Saturn.

The Elite defines itself and *shines*, its activity is salvific in all orders of life according to the dharma of the particular practicioner or order. The crown and the sceptre, on the other hand, always move only further away from those who seek and yearn for them.

5.7 The Instant and Eternity

This is an article by **Guido de Giorgio**, titled *The Instant and Eternity*, first published in Diorama Filosofico in 1939.

The Myth of the Future We can say that the sacred is distinguished from the profane in what is essentially oriented toward the past to fix the stages of a procession which necessarily finds its culmination in a "present". This "present" is the metaphysical point where eternity throws itself, where the worlds dissolve in a fullness without limits, a duration without rhythm, a bliss without end. The present is eternity, the past is only the vestibule that leads toward, which inserts into eternity. To repeat, to retrace the whole cycle which is realized in the point means to carry with oneself the experience of the centuries, all cosmic evolution to unravel the framework in the pupil of God.

Faust could not stop the instant because he knew only the caducity of the instance, the immediate iridescence of illusion, the vertigo which submerges instead of transfiguring, the "shadow of the flesh", the labile and evanescent phantasm, not that which in God resides an infinite momentariness which is the mystery of the eternal now. Such are the two aspects of the "instant", according to which one places himself on the human or divine plane; it is about two apparently opposed and divergent points which mark two worlds, two rhythms, two realities, of which one

is absolute, true, the other fallacious and illusory. Faust's words "stop, you are so beautiful!" is only a not very original lyrical substitute in the face of the unfathomed plenitude of the Ineffable where the mystery of the divine gestation takes place. The myth of purification through aesthetics is only the very fragile bridge thrown by modern imbecility onto the momentariness of the human-cosmic illusion in order to evade the positive certitude of the mystery, an impassable wall or else by the dizzying passing of the wing, i.e., of the Spirit of God.

That is why the modern world oscillates between a dead past and a nebulous future, between what is no longer and what will never be, except in the hope that anticipates and builds. Traditional wisdom, on the contrary, turns toward the past, lives it, enriches it, *updates* it, inserting itself in it to lead it fully into the present and renew it in the *ver aeternum* eternal spring which the Ancients attributed to the Golden Age, pointing to the perennial germination of the Truth, the multitude of transfiguring states, life which knows neither birth nor death, for it uncoils itself in the bliss of the realizing consciousness. But for moderns the past is past, dead, finished, concluded, closed, irremediable: "le déjà vu, le déjà vécu" already seen, already lived , says Bergson, according to a psychological orientation that clearly manifests all the nostalgic sentimentality of the small man horribly enslaved by his small world. So that between a dead past and a future not yet born, the twilight present swings, at once a cloudy waning and a too pale dawn, in sum a veritable pause in agony. And from this erroneous vision the *myth of the future* is derived, the tension toward what is not, toward what will never be because in reality only the present, in absorbing the past, is the dynamic point, *the whole bow of the ship* which faces the horizon *but never reaches it*.

The Past as Death and Life

This is the second section of **Guido de Giorgio**'s essay The Instant and Eternity. Here de Giorgio compares modern and tra-

> ditional man. He brings in many themes previously covered here: the continuity of the past; the notion of depth in the flow of history, i.e., "subterranean history"; the past understood in the interiority, not as something external. Moderns can never rest, they can never "be", because they are always becoming, looking to the future to pass judgment on them. But the moderns of the future will despise them as much as the moderns of today despise their own roots, heritage and past.
>
> Burying beetles bury the carcasses of small vertebrates such as birds and rodents as a food source for their larvae. This is the perfect description of modern man as a beetle. Although the essay was written in 1939, it is even more applicable today.

Modern man can be compared to a burying beetle nécrophore that longs for the day that never comes: the cadaver that he carries is the past, his inert, sterile heritage, and the day that he awaits is the future, the imaginary descent, the glorious completion of a chimeric unfinished childbirth. We will remark that all modern men, the "great men of history", wait for a definitive judgment of the future on their oeuvre, for perhaps they feel, consciously or not, that nothing of what they made relates traditionally to the royal stream of the past, not is it capable of resisting the movements of the magnetic needle of the present, the brief and momentary instant having an impact on many abysses other than the insignificant trace of the passing cloud. That is why ancient man is a bearer of worlds: he did not leave the past behind him, but harvests it and carries it along, in such a way to construct in reality a single incidental point, the sole present, the current time, while modern man, discarding a heavy burden for his not very virile shoulders, is light, inconsistent, and through fear of being thrown to the earth by the blows of the crosswinds, clings to the machine, which is both his cradle and his tomb. For the myth of the future is associated with the myth of speed which—if we consider its function, its interior plan—is the abolition of the past in the already traversed, the imperceptibility of the present minimized in the permanent expectation

of the future. The readers who would like to deepen these insights in a penetrating manner will find more than one way leading easily to the comprehension of some major truths. We desire to establish here, with a certain insistence, only some critical reflections whose development perspective will turn out to be clearer and surer.

We therefore understand that modern man and ancient man are absolutely opposed and like the antipodes, in the literal sense of the term, the one by relationship to the other: tied to a same line of descent but turned toward different heavens with different constellations, although the same impassible sun throws light on that line of descent in what for one is day for the other, night. For the Ancients, in effect, the past is everything, for the moderns, nothing, even when they have the illusion of absent mindedly looking in the past for solutions to the questions of the present—what are called the "warnings", the "teachings" of the past–, around sentimental fantasies exploited with a cynical opportunism according to the circumstances and proposed to the credulity of the naïve for the most pitiable perpetrations. Rhetoric, which triumphs today as never before in today's cloudy and swampy Europe, has recourse to the most bestial ruses to obtain the consent of the plebes as the audience and makes use of the past as a remedy against all illnesses, the universal balm, the supports of the present, but of a momentary usage as if to ward off the *Vae soli*! Woe to him who is alone, Eccl. 4:10 Modern man, in reality, is already frozen in the past, no longer lives it, and takes from it only dust and ruin: he studies it, classifies it, ignores it. The more detailed the inquiry is made, the more it becomes sketchy, each one seeking subsequently to make life blow over these bones asleep in the slumber of death. Thus, when they turn toward the past to study it, the moderns then succumb to the same illusion as when they believe, for example, that the photograph is closer than the truth, although it is denatured totally in being fixing in the momentariness of something already passed. But independently of study, let us see if the moderns use the past according to

life. Who says past, says tradition, i.e., interior, dynamic unification, not exterior adhesion, not opportunistic sympathy, not simple position or situation; in other words, there should be between the past and the present, *continuity*, *immutability*, or, better said, a rhythmic development so regular, permanent, internal, that it would appear to be indifferent. Antiquity, in fact, is characterized by a constant tonality which endures, immobile, from one epoch to the other; there is and must be a change, but it takes place in depth, in the interior strata, invisibly, we are tempted to say, in a way to not disrupt the regularity of the rhythm.

The Meaning of the Past

> This is third section of an article by **Guido de Giorgio**, titled The Instant and Eternity, first published in Diorama Filosofico in 1939.
>
> I am constantly struck by so many people today who only perceive darkness, ignorance, or intolerance in the past. They tell me about dictators oppressively their people, who must be saved; some unfortunates who cannot afford this or that without a new government program; some marginal group that must be accepted; and so on. They long for some mythical future when all will be well with the world. Yet they do nothing for their own family, their own children and grandchildren; they assume their current life will continue, just as it is now. They cannot conceive that someday they will be oppressed, impoverished, or marginalized, with nothing to hope for. Those who cut their ties to the past don't have a future, because they don't even know what it is.

We said many times that ancient cultures are immobile or seem to be such; but that is precisely their greatness, that fundamental stability that removes all contrasts, integrates all rhythms into the central vein, to the *traditional type*, who alone remains in the wholeness of its formative efficacy. That is why whoever intends to remain in the pure domain of

traditional truth, always turns, logically, toward the past, to retrace the stages of certitude and add them to his experience. This, under that angle, is then recapitulative and conclusive: it is not an exterior repetition, but grants its rhythm to that which is none other than is own face, today still ignored, from now on found again and vivified. It is very difficult to explain certain things to those who hold onto dualist positions and who think that there is something besides the Truth, which is God eternally present. Truth: there only can *one become what he is*, i.e., one transcends the sphere of human limitations to live the same beat of the infinite.

When we say *ancient* we mean everything that is valuable, perennial, traditionally authentic in the past of the East and the West, whether it is about a distant or near, doctrinal or poetic, past: it matters little, provided that it reflects, in the truth of its expression, the great light of the Superworld. Beyond the Sacred Books, there is Poetry and sacred Art. There is finally all the forms of activity which, in the past, always relate to a truth of a higher order, be it in a modest utensil, and in the fabrication and the destination of objects of current usage. That past, as we mean it, and all those who are searching only for the truth of God should mean it, is life, creative rhythm, an inexhaustible deposit of wisdom which renews itself each time it is actualized by a new experience. But it is especially the reality of a vibrant life because vivified by the perennial breath of traditional energy. Moderns consider the past as a relic whose ruins they borrow and around which they prowl with the curiosity of photographers and archeologists: who, among them, accepts the past totally, assumes it in all its fullness, not in order to seize form it some fragments and exalt them, but in order to integrate it in one's experience of life while recapitulating it in a creative manner?

The Tangible Immediacy of the Present

> This is final section of an article by **Guido de Giorgio**, titled The Instant and Eternity, first published in Diorama Filosofico

in 1939.

How many of Dante's admirers are there who are not content in glorifying his verses or expression—something absolutely exterior and superficial—but who in applying the doctrine, the knowledge on all the planes of being to which they relate and in the totality of the Heavenly Voyage.

The past is nothing if it is not integrated, lived, validated by personal experience, by life, if it is not totalized and exalted in the great shaking of the eternal now. The moderns, when they are not fornicating in the past like the thieves in a necropolis, turn their backs on it, contemplating then the hypothetical "sun of the future" which will never shine, because the future exists only as the last evanescent border of an arduous vision, a mirage and nothing more, a fallacious projection stained by the spasms of their own insufficiency. The "non-achievement" in the face of the Truth, the incurable sentiment of one who does not know nor wants to know, does not know how to nor wants to carry with himself all the weight of the world, to assume it in the divine instant, created the myth of the future. Turning obstinately their backs to that which is, they wait with curiosity for what is not, for what will be, and they long for the confirmation of a dream by an illusory reflection of the dream itself, in a nocturnal march of phantoms that alone engender the present, by the spontaneity of its flux and its mirage. Strange speculation on the future, which makes them forget the treasures of the past and the tangible immediacy of the present. For they are really only in the present, with all worlds, in the essential unity of the point, jewel of all jewels, the eternal eye of God!

We would like to still say some other things, but we prefer to conclude with the words of **Zarathustra**:

> To these men of today will I not be light, nor be called light. Them, will I blind with the lightning of my wisdom! Put out their eyes!
>
> Friedrich Nietzsche, *Zarathustra*

Posted on 2012-06-12 by Cologero

* * *

Egemen on 2012-06-12 at 04:51 said:

A nice dealing about the sacred past of civilization. I want to share a song and poem of one of the esoteric orders of the that is bekta?ilik (http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Bektashi_Order), (http://it.wikipedia.org/wiki/Bektashi)

And this is the youtube link of song; http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=m-aWLCGLCNo

And these are the lyrics which will translate and explain by me later...

Ondort bin yil gezdim pervanelikte
Sidk-i ismin buldum divanelikte
?ctim sarabini mestanelikte
Kirklarin ceminde dara düs oldum
Guruh-u naci'ye özümü kattim
?nsan s?fatindan cok geldim gittim
Bülbül oldum firdevs baginda öttüm
Bir zaman gül icin zara düs oldum

I had travelled in space for fourteen thousand years (pervanelik means space or outer space and also pervanelik means planets; if a object turning around another thing, you can say for object; it is the pervane of other thing)

I had found the true meaning of your name (sidk-i ism) in madness (divanelik means madness or extacy)

I had drunk your wine at mestanelik (mestanelik means a place which people is getting transcendence state of mind)

I had forced to be brought to book at forty's court (in ancient asian tribes or little orders there was a court that call sometimes "gathering", which judges some problems of society. Forty's are prophets from Adam to Muhammed)

I had put in the forty's to my essence (güruh-u naci is the persian idiom of Forty's)

I had come and gone from the presence of human (or Adam Kadmon), (that means i had many experience of transfiguraiton, transformation or metamorphism...)

I had had form of nightingale and sing at the vineyard of Firdevs... (Firdevs is the highest level of the heaven; maybe as mentioned in Dante's Comedia)

i had fall to a garden for rose, for a moment... After all this explanations, there is a little story about origins of that song:

Before Islam and other monotheistic religions, ancient central asian nations had their pantheons, their celestial beings as elohim in torah. One of them called as "Gabriel, Cebrail or Cibril, most probably after influence of Islam, and this Gabriel is humanlike creature of the god.

This human's breed was in danger, because of their green sun which Gabriel's home planet rounds around it (pervanelik), had come to hers ver end of life.

If Gabriel could not hade found a way to rescue his breed, they will have been destroyed with their planet. Hereby, Gabriel or Cibril had get a quest for a new planet to live on. And Cibril had prepared his spacecraft and hit on the roads of outer space, after that he had met with the god. And god asked to the Cibril:

"Who are you and who am I?"

Cibril answered was a little bit defiant;

"You are You and I am me"

God had not liked that answer and He punished Cibril by rampant traveling in outer space about fourteen thousand years.

In this punisment era, Cibril was getting into the madness and suddenly God appears and ask his same question again:

"Who are you and who am I?"

After all these hard years, Cibril had come to his senses and answers:

"You are the Creator, I am the creation"

After being excused, Cibril encounters a blue planet, they land to that planet and search of the lands and waters. They recognize, a creature that has similar genetically similar to them is living that blue planet. They decide to make a mergence between their breed and that creature. They had get some of these creatures with them and return their home planet.

At the Forty's Court; they had made some genetical experiments about mergence of breeds and they found a new species that are similar to them. After that, the creators of human generation had get that new species and return to the blue planet and so on as you know.

P.S. I listened that story in 1987 from a Bektasi person. After several years, I met with Zecharia Sitchin and his Works

`http://www.sitchin.com/`

After some research about that story, I found it is not only belongs to Bektashi order, and you can find similar stories in Dharma and Ancient Chinese Traditions...

5.8 Tradition & the General Law

Before beginning this post, several definitions of terms peculiar to Boris Mouravieff's work:

A Influences: sensate pressures and resulting spiritual tendencies, along with the cosmic hierarchies which keep them in "tutelage" (see St. Paul in *Galatians 4*)

General Law: the karma which keeps the men in bondage to the above from ever escaping the spiritual entropy of their own lusts. The General Law aims for the common good – it "uses" mankind to accomplish aims which it itself, by itself, cannot accomplish. General Law is itself subject to Higher Laws, which are "B Influences".

What this essay will postulate is that submission to Authority (A Influences at first, then B influences, if man succeeds spiritually) is the only way according to Tradition that the "masses" can be helped (primarily, by avoiding a cataclysm of fiery judgement, but also by making "quiet lives of godliness and peace" possible through the organization of man. The Revolution, on the contrary, postulates that Authority does not exist, or (if it does or is "felt") ought to be "broken". Thus, a third definition:

Revolution: the idea/ideal that A Influences (and by extension, B Influences as well) can be "broken" rather than transcended or undone. Mouravieff takes pains to explain that "The Great Game" means that A Influences are legitimate, & that they can only be overcome through purity of heart (forgive your enemies, turn the other cheek, etc., all of which has esoteric meaning as well). It is not possible to defeat Satan by reifying Evil as Authority, and attacking Authority. Saint Paul concurs: "the weapons of our warfare are spiritual, not physical". "Love the brotherhood, Fear God, Honor the King".

So a reading of Mouravieff's Gnosis[15] makes clear that Christian Es-

[15] http://www.scribd.com/doc/4549935/Gnosis-Book-I-Boris-Mouravieff-Exoteric-Cycle1

otericism is not an *ersatz* for those wishing to avoid other traditions or authority, nor an escape for those who want to remain purely exoterically Christian, without ever advancing (or preparing to advance in the post-mortem state). One cannot substitute political "Revolutionary" progress in external matters for inner development. To explain this, he notes after a long discussion of man's "three centers" (head, heart, motor) and how they inter-relate with the higher centers which remain (for him) unactualized , that "practically speaking" for most men, the only break upon their unbridled self-domination of the false I of their mini-personality is actually the "links" or "shocks" which this personality induces upon the other parts of him which are (at the moment) not acting, or not directly involved in the instantiation of the false I. Mouravieff then links this with the General Law – in the absence of self-government, men come under the "General Law" (which he later specifies is the Adversary, cosmologically). So, since the "fear of God" is missing in these people, their governments reflect the "brakes" or links within their own *chakras*, which are all that is holding them back from *publicly* proclaiming themselves to be as God. Therefore, strong

government is required to hold them in check. Penalties and checks are required to restrain them, because (and he is clear on this) "morality alone" cannot restrain the extreme and anarchistic tendencies of the unbridled false I/personality. Mouravieff is saying that Revolution by itself (and that is the definition of Revolution) is "Hell on earth". The Revolution destroys little Satans, & sets up even bigger Ones. How is this Progress?

This is precisely the ancient, traditional doctrine of government, endorsed by none other than the apostle Paul in Romans 13, when he proclaims the secular arm or Caesar to be the "sword of God", whose purpose is to bring terror to evildoers. Christ taught this also – "render unto Caesar".

Bondarev's interpretations of Steiner are accurate here, in that the

Counter-Initiation will seek to proclaim an Anti-Christ, which will counterfeit the Kingdom of God and the integrity of Tradition, falsely liberate man, and suck all of Creation (or at least the earth) into a black hole (since the Lie can only live until the "fullness of evil" is reached, after which, it will implode). Mouravieff teaches that Peter warns against this in his own epistles – either redemption (the rise of a Christian elite, or "salt and light"), or another cataclysm.

It is not difficult to connect this with either the French Revolution or with the modern ideal of Progress: in fact, Mouravieff explicitly states in the early pages of *Gnosis 1* that "progress" (as such) can have no absolute meaning at all, in the slightest. In fact, there is no "progress" in material affairs, when measured by the yardstick of true Enlightenment. Material man is subject to Death, and this is all. *The Earth returns to the earth*, says Scripture. The "straight line" of Progress goes against the Logos, because only the spiral (in accordance with the Rays of Creation) can resist entropy, which is Christ's mission. Tomberg would call these "vertical energies" which transcend the Serpent's eternal horizontal circle of purely physical reality. Satan offers man the chance to "die" by refusing self-government and embracing Revolution (Lust). Thus, he promises life without Life, life through illusion: "sorcery-States". Man can, therefore, stay as he is, as he wishes to be and remain. This is an illusion, the General Law will still win – thus man is eternally frustrated in "Revolution".

It should be un-necessary (here) to connect these teachings with the Anti-Christ. That is not our concern for now, instead to defend the idea of a Christian knighthood. In fact, "Superman" is a term which Mouravieff says applies properly only to a "new elite" (pages 185ff in *Gnosis 1*). If the false elite succeed in spreading this corruption (and find fertile ground for it), the Scriptures promise a baptism of avenging fire for the earth, rather than a redemption. Christ (says Mouravieff) warns of many wolves and false shepherds.

It is not hard to draw the conclusion that almost every trend in the modern world (I say almost, because Mouravieff also makes clear that the "transmissions" of B influences from God-ward towards man never cease, nor does Providence's spirals of upwardness) is towards the sensate or "New Man" of the Revolution. In Mouravieff's terms (as we shall see) this is an evolutionary "dead-end" (Tomberg) or a "one-sidedness".

Mouravieff's work, when read alongside of Evola's treatises, or without them, should point us towards the idea that our stand on behalf of mankind has to be made, and can be made, only upon the path that has been revealed – that of individuals who attain higher levels of Being which render them immune to the general process of A influences and the Counter Initiation. The other option is a "Progress" that substitutes for legitimate victory over A influences (the Serpent) *through collective slavery to the endless cycle of A influences in their totality, a totality which still amounts to a Zero*. The General Law, in fact, rewards those whose "go along". Brilliant careers, much money, fame, fortune, good reputation, etc. Their esoteric energies (teaches Mouravieff) are preyed upon by higher powers in order to "feed the Moon" (evolve a new world for the common good, which will one day be inherited by the "meek of the earth" who resist A influence and opt for personal revolution over exoteric activity).

This is the reason that Donoso Cortes and Oliviera, as well as Taparelli[16], van Prinsterer[17], & also even someone like Althusius[18] should be studied as models for practical men of action seeking to understand against what they are struggling. Evola is useful for the very same reason.

And what do these good gentlemen have to say?

> We are living in a condition of permanent revolution ... rev-

[16] http://bonald.wordpress.com/2010/07/19/taparelli-dazeglio-forgotten-founding-father-of-the-right/

[17] http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Guillaume_Groen_van_Prinsterer

[18] http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Johannes_Althusius

olutions are here to stay and will grow much worse in scope and intensity unless men can be persuaded to return to Christianity, to practise its precepts and to obey the Gospel in its full implications for human life and civilized society. Barring such a revival, the future would belong to socialism and communism, which on this view were but the most consistent sects of the new secular religion. To Groen, therefore, the political spectrum that presented itself to his generation offered no meaningful choice.

In terms of his analysis, the 'radical left' was composed of fanatical believers in the godless ideology; the 'liberal centre,' by comparison, by warm believers who warned against excesses and preached moderation; **while the 'conservative right' embraced all those who lacked either the insight, the prudence, or the will to break with the modern tenets yet who recoiled from the consequences whenever the ideology was practised and implemented in any consistent way**. None of the shades or 'nuances of secular liberalism represented a valid option for Christian citizens." Groen called for a rejection of the entire available spectrum of political positions, calling for a "radical alternative in politics, along anti-revolutionary, Christian-historical lines

Harry Van Dyke, Groen van Prinsterer, *Lectures on Unbelief and Revolution* (1989, pp. 3-4)

Here is the same thought, from Clement Maria Hofbauer[19]:

"Almost as a postscript to the heavenly warning issued at Fatima in 1917, Saint Maximilian Kolbe, two years later, reviewed the three Great Evils of the latter times, noting: "In 1517, the Protestants rebelled against the Church; in 1717, the Freemasons rebelled against Christ; and, in 1917, the Communists rebelled against God."

In a single sentence the Polish martyr had exposed common origin and natural succession of each of these Apocalyptic nightmares.

[19] `http://www.catholicism.org/clement-maria-hofbauer.html`

What Christian esotericism (Tomberg & Mouravieff) does is offer a way that explains this in terms that most modern people are capable of understanding and accepting, at least in their saner moments and if they are trying to understand (granted, which assumes a lot), thus re-linking exoteric Christians to the Tradition. *The peculiarly Christian hope that exists here is to make the process less dangerous*, both in terms of premature or unnecessary rejection or going astray down a side alley. Whatever else it does, it reaffirms Tradition's *veredictum* upon the French Revolution – this was not (at least) a permanent way to help the "masses". The "masses" are to be trained and educated into being a "folk" and a "people"; the creation of the "masses" was itself a diabolical act, and no good will come of it, either for the false elite who did it, or those who wish to accept it as a *fait d'accompli*.

Many other points throughout *Gnosis I* make this clear:

> As for the ordinary man of the new era, he will continue to live outside the Truth, as he does today, as long as he can dissimulate his thoughts. The latter will however be easily read by any person who has attained a degree of culture which can be compared, all proportions maintained, to those who give University teaching today.

This reading of thought will no doubt be intrusive & uncomfortable – it might even allow an "upper hand" (in many maneuvers) by the "elite". And what is the implication of knowing the ordinary man's thought? A countervailing action will be taken, at the least, to make provision for his duplicity, and perhaps it will simply be made known what he is. Is this in accord with "human rights", as understood today? It is not.

Mouravieff concludes, & does not hesitate to speak of an elite:

> Esoteric Tradition teaches that any civilization is none other than a projection of the consciousness of the 'I's of elite man onto the exterior world. The 'I' of the intellectual already differs from

> that of a knight. In the coming civilization, characterized by Art inspired by the sacred, the elite man will possess an 'I' consciousness altogether different from the three preceding epochs. He will have, as has already been said, the consciousness of the real 'I', of a permanent and unshakable 'I', not that of the personal, unstable and composite 'I' which our times accept and glorify. Thus the edifice of the future civilization will not be built by the elite on sand, but on the rock[14] of the onsciousness of the real 'I', the spark.

Mouravieff even puts his finger on the problem of the ruling class of our time:

> For man 3 in a 'world 3', this is much more difficult. For his mental[16] constitution, reinforced by education, instruction, and the intellectual environment, ends by making a perfectly onesided being of him. This is the underlying cause of the weakness of the governing class, which today is not able to stabilize and equilibrate the life of human society even though technical progress offers all the necessary material means to reach this end.
>
> Man 3 (intellectual man) lives in an excessively intellectual age. Thus, we have the global age of the manipulator and technocrat, the best of whom are undoubtedly aware of what is happening. It is their one-sided (my noted added: one might say, in Tomberg's words, "evolutionary dead-ended" development) which propels them to power & renders them an obstacle to world peace at the same time.

Man 2 (emotional or heart-driven man) is at a disadvantage, and cannot attain power, but the Ray of Creation is turning the wheel back to the heart, in order to "recalibrate" human nature. In the coming Age, those who rule will be those who are obviously superior (a spiritual elite).

Even the masses will turn to them, just as they turned to the intellectual to end the age of rule by overt physical force. The Revolution is not eternal, Progress (as Mouravieff also states) is not a straight line. Nothing in Creation is a straight line, because straight lines attain their goal, and thus come to a natural end.

Here is a warning for those who want to "go Modern":

> It is the same with the woman who, in this modern world, is endowed with refined emotions, and finds herself in conditions which permit her to realize rapid progress on the esoteric plane. In fact the tendency to develop the intellectual qualities in our civilization favours the equilibrium of her centres, on condition, however, that even if dazzled by science she does not lose her feminine emotionality and does not become too calculating. For her, this preservation of her femininity is an obstacle, a competitive test by which selection is automatically made. She must beware of acquiring a masculine mentality and identifying with this. A male mind in a woman's body excludes the possibility of esoteric development. This type of woman is unfortunately widespread in our days, as is that of the effeminate man, representing what the Tradition calls the neutral sex. Union between these people who have thus deviated from the normal represents the opposite pole to the Androgyne, the summit of deified human power. The Kingdom of God is closed for them.

The Kingdom of God is closed to them. Tomberg makes precisely the same point, more gently, when he warns of becoming over-developed in one aspect, in *Meditations*. The only way, according to Tradition, to overcome Authority and General Law, is to gain victory over the Self. Any other path sets the stage for impurity of heart and delusion, and an actual triumph of A Influences & General Law.

To be continued, with more on "General Law" and overcoming it...

Posted on 2012-06-16 by Logres

* * *

apeiron on 2012-06-16 at 11:14 said:

A good article on the reactions we often encounter from Men who were witnesses in their day to the early onslaught of Satanic decline. While they offered hints and examples of how they lived and brilliant analizations of our circumstances, they have also left us as lone soldiers without an army. No impermeable institutions/orders have lasted their passing on.

"The only way, according to Tradition, to overcome Authority and General Law, is to gain victory over the Self."

Now what of the disciplines, actions and practices to prepare for the postmortem states, to overcome the self and to attain the kingdom of god? No one here has a word to say about these. If you do, then please state them, because it appears that Tradition today is studied, contemplated and over-rationalized from every angle other than lived by the most important and foundational issue at hand: What actions to take.

Logres on 2012-06-16 at 13:33 said:

I understand the frustration, yet unfortunately, it is a lot easier to "do" what is wrong than what is right – therein is the rub. Mouravieff, if you interested, has many instructions in Gnosis for spiritual exercises, including postures, breathing, etc, as well as directions for discerning A influence in your life. This is the first, most vital element – "detoxifying". Only then can one act with comparative safety of attaining the goal. He also offers guidelines for marriage, as well as explaining the reason behind differing castes and characters of men. This is in addition to a cosmology interpreted by Tradition (Tomberg also has small hints and practices buried in Meditations, including how to use the sign of the cross). However, all of these practices are geared towards preparation – they are preparatory, and thus, not on a grand "world saving" scheme or in the nature of direct action. Their intent is merely to "clear ground". If you interested in more "direct" rituals, you should read Magic:

http://www.amazon.com/Introduction-Magic-Rituals-Practical-Techniques/dp/0892816244

But read it in conjunction with Meditations or Gnosis, because it has spiritual dangers. Personally, I would say that almost all "action" in today's world is necessarily "hidden" or "occult" – otherwise, it invites the retribution of General Law on a grand scale. Are you prepared for that?

Logres on 2012-06-16 at 20:25 said:

Apeiron, your question is a fair one. Mouravieff actually teaches that faster means are necessary, & in Volume III (which I haven't read lately, I finished the first two) talks about "polar beings". The situation is unsatisfactory; I'd be interested in what Cologero or others have to say.

HOO on 2012-06-17 at 14:50 said:

The masses shall return to the tortured bowels of the earth from which they came, they malformed subhumans. Begone, and good riddance. Now Godspeed the First Men.

logres on 2012-06-17 at 22:39 said:

Actually, the "masses" will never do anything good on their own, or even with leadership, until they are made into a "folk" or a peuple or a commoner. But if there is an elite that is ready when Rome begins to burn, then individuals from lower castes will be drawn to them.

Cologero on 2012-06-18 at 12:25 said:

The masses shall return to the tortured bowels of the earth from which they came, they malformed subhumans. Begone, and good riddance.

This is the sort of ersatz machismo that passes for "virility" really has no place in Tradition. The Traditional organization of society must be understood as organic, with the different segments interrelated in a hierarchical manner. The Kshatriya rules and fights not for their own end, but rather for the whole. Disdain for those who butcher our meat, bake our bread, mow our lawns, or care for our children needs to be replaced by the ideal of magnanimity.

The "masses" are driven by the passions of eros and thymos, unchecked by reason. Without the spiritual authority to provide that check, their fate is the first rings of hell. The deeper levels are for those who act out of deliberate malice, i.e., the higher castes who know better.

scardanelli on 2013-04-16 at 10:30 said:

After getting a bit further into Mouravieff while also learning a bit about Orthodoxy, i'm curious as to how those in the Orthodox church react to Mouravieff. Is his work seen as basically in line with the church or as heretical new age speculation? I suppose i'm wondering how those in the church view his claim that his work represents a synthesis of esoteric knowledge and practices found scattered throughout the writings of the Church Fathers. It seems that many Orthodox writers strongly recommend the help and advice of a spiritual father from within the church. Would the work of Mouravieff be something to discuss with this spiritual father, or would it be frowned upon and better kept to oneself? Is this perhaps an instance where one would remain silent lest he provoke the General Law?

scardanelli on 2013-04-16 at 10:46 said:

I know that one must take into account the differences that exist between the esoteric and the exoteric, but it seems that the exoteric Orthodox church has a well developed esoteric and ascetic tradition, and i'm curious as to how this tradition regards Mouravieff.

5.9 Death

> This is the chapter "La Morte" from *Dio e il Poeta* by **Guido De Giorgio**; this is the first of two parts. The influence of neoplatonism is obvious. De Giorgio has several excellent turns of phrase; I hope I have done them justice.

There is an interruption, a withdrawal, a fracture: Death. Universal, necessary, conclusive, that everyone knows, everyone is present at it, it is continuous, hammering, unforeseen. It gleans madly, one could say disorderly, most times against justice, with a cruelty that often offends the petty human calculation that does not know and overlooks the mysteries of divine justice and rails and springs against the hard law of necessity, as if God were imperfection, casualism[20], vindictiveness, and not intelligence, perfection of justice and above all of mercy, of love! They do not think that everything is measured, ordered, foreseen in creation but in a sphere and an abundance that passes beyond common human discernment, beyond every egoistic partialism, every eudemonistic calculation. They do not think that one dies because one must die, that human existence without death would be folly, desperation, pure and simple impossibility. If death did not exist men would pray to God for it, as a liberating escape, as a flight that finally interrupts the existential desperation derived from the *taedium Vitae*, from the disgust of life.

What is death in reality? It is the abandonment of form, of the visible, of sensory concreteness and the passage to something that is unknown, i.e., that which cannot be made precise, fixed, defined. In the human, no one can assert or deny what we will be when we no longer will be and men could conjecture nothing without the Sacred Scripture that—in every religion—speaks above all of death and of that which begins when terrestrial existence terminates. One should say instead that all the religious dynamic puts death in the first place as the limit-point for the intelligence

[20] `http://www.merriam-webster.com/dictionary/casualism`

of the divine and the attainment of true wisdom, that which leads to God. The various philosophies, instead—with the vacuity that characterizes them—disregards death, as if it did not exist, as if it fell into the ambit of an experience too common to be considered important, as if its necessity were the indicator of fatalism of becoming, universal recurrence, that it does not depend on the human will, that it is not explained, and is only accepted, coasts along, ignoring it. Yet it a culminating point in the evolution of man that he is viciously split from it with a hurling into the void, the terrible abyss of what is not known and is feared to be known.

Why does Religion make death almost the center of the true vision that man must have of life? The answer is simple: because only religion *sees* after death, sees what follows earthly existence and puts men on guard and admonishes and orients them to this existence in accordance with the necessity of death. To live thinking of death, to always comport oneself in life in view of the end and only in respect to this abrupt void that suddenly spreads wide in front of our soul, our only soul since the corporeal shell is separated and motionless forever and is returned to the earth.

The "force" no longer exists, the pneumatic-psychic-somatic unity is ruptured and what remains can, furthermore, constitute a shadow that begins the voyage of eternity. The detachment will not be rescinded: in the first days the soul of the dead will desire to return to the immobile skin and will roam ravenous around the cadaver then, after every attempt to take back possession of the corpse is rendered useless, he will being his judgment, his examination and—according to a traditions of the Orient—he is placed facing a great light, in front of which most will close their eyes. His destiny depends on the degree of light that the soul is able to support. The symbolism is obvious: the light is the divine truth and the degree of splendor is the level at which the soul stopped on earth, hence the judgment by which the soul will be fixed for eternity.

The value of prayers and funereal rites that sustain and help to passing over is immense, they serve to facilitate the escape to give the soul in

pain the strength necessary in order not to be extinguished, to not lose consciousness of himself, to not let himself go to the vertigo of the void. It seems that the whole cohort of the Saints and archangels is invoked to salvation and it makes the crown of the soul that abandoned the body and that remains fearful, without a home. Only the Saints and the Just who are already *dead* in life do not fear the detachment but instead wait for it with joy because the flight toward God is more certain.

Sanctity is above all the experience of the voluntary death through the realization of the divine and the certain flight of the soul in the formless void. In order to do that the Saint already has prepared himself, by this earth, the wings in order to not be afraid of the void and to be freed in the immensity of the "world without people". Whoever, while still in life, has habituated himself to the detachment of the soul from the body, who has glimpsed his naked transience from the contemplative height, who lives of the soul, does not fear death and once this happened, he is "placed" in the order of the spirits who are assigned to him by the Divine Will and that he himself had chosen on earth renouncing every vain desire of choice to conform to the will of Heaven.

For the greater part of men instead, death is a leap, a fearful leap into a bottomless abyss, a laceration, a shout, a falling without knowing how or where one falls, the tragic epilog of a sterile life, and a life without a reason. Even if these men adhered tepidly, superfluously to a Religion in which they did not truly believe, who accepted it as a norm transmitted secularly, as an inert formula, a dead weight, a useless heredity, and difficult to access.

To a life not sanctified by prayer, by thought of God, by the gaze of the heart gathered in Him who alone is true, to a human, only human, life, there follows a poor death, the death of those taken by the throat by the cruel bite of necessity. They have no excuse: on the one hand human reason alone is sufficient to make them glimpse the necessity of a higher, divine Order that justifies the cruelty, the insanity, the enormity

of our earthly existence, always hoping but never reaching, a rejoicing, a thinking about the *void*, a construction that is abandoned forever, a love to be what we will never again see, a hooking on walls that fall on us with us but beyond common reason, they have the Religion that extends a hand, supports, explains the precariousness of this world in view of *another* which invites us with songs of hope, expectation, joy.

Religion aims at *everyone*, it has hope wisdom, strength for everyone, it has its rites, its prayers, it extends a very valid hand to all, from birth to death, it has an exercise of ministry that dispense the word of God in order to understand what does not need instruction, study, quality of criticism, only the will to participate, the will to believe, the will to hear, the will to recognize, suffice. To understand does not count, is not important, is not worthwhile: it is enough to *feel*, to love, to give oneself: in the night darker than ignorance, the most alive stars shine, the holiest wisdom is offered, the most resolute certainty, because the things of God are so different from the human, just as sacred wisdom is different from the profane. For the things of God only love, only faith, only the gift of oneself to the Truth is demanded, the Good, Love that everyone believes, that everybody supports, that is lowered to everybody, who gives himself to all, who runs, gallops, flies, rises up, gives himself in.

To refuse the help of Religion means to blaspheme against intelligence, reason, light, it means to dehumanize, to descend to the level of the brute, the filthy beast, the stone, to have a heart of stone, *cor lapideum*, insensible both to what is in life and to what is beyond life. They are the men who don't even know they are men, who believe, by rejecting and disdaining Religion, they are elevating themselves to a rigorously higher vision of life, they who collect only the more infantile detritus, refuse, and illusion, admitting the real existence of matter which is less real, denying being to spirit which is more real, without which there is nothing that is.

The illusory materiality of matter is sufficiently proved by the miracle that breaks its laws, that is a fracture, a suspension in the realm of

necessity that it annuls the most rigorous laws temporarily and subverts any certainty of causal link, definition, norm. This and nothing else is the reason for the miracle, to show men like lightening, through twinklings, that matter is an illusions if its laws can be violated, even if only for a few instants. They are warnings, rebukes, that the Lord throws to men of good will because they see, they understand, they put judgment, they become aware that outside appearances there is a reality that they don't know, but it is not to be denied outside of their ignorance, if the best men, those equipped with sacred science, affirm its existence.

Miracles are for those who do not believe, do not see, do not want to hear the word of the wisdom of God. The miracle in an instant beats down the illusory structure, falls through material matrix, makes redeeming action pass through it that it gives back to God what is of God, showing that from God who is Spirit, nothing can come that is not spirit and that materiality is not other than the illusory condensation of spirit that is denied and is hidden because the world is the mask of God and it is opposite to Him just as, in some way, the mirror is opposite to the image because it is reflected in it. If matter truly exists, the miracle would not be possible, but especially the liberation of the material yoke of those men would not be possible, who not only deny, but actively supplant the cohesive laws of terrestrial nature, living supernaturally in the same nature, penetrating the impenetrable, dissolving the ordinary, solidifying the subtle, crossing the uncrossable mountain, and annulling temporarily the iron web of necessity. Whoever does not want to be convinced of this remains in his error where Death, the tardy revealer, surprised him.

Death and Deliverance

> This is second and concluding installment of the chapter "La Morte" from Dio e il Poeta by **Guido De Giorgio**. Here we see De Giorgio moving past salvation to liberation (or deliverance as Guenon translates it). Evola draws upon similar traditional teach-

> ings in his distinction between the path of the ancestors and the path of the gods. For liberation, even Heaven is a prison. De Giorgio is forced to use apophatic language[21] to describe this process of deliverance. He leads us to the God beyond God, non-Being beyond Being, or in Vedantic terms, Brahman behind Ishwara.

Divine knowledge is like a voice that passes by and does not return: whoever does not subscribe to it in freedom, will have his own negation as fate, i.e., the darkness, the void, death. And we arrive in this way at the crucial point: what is Death? Is it truly a cessation *in toto*, an irremediable end, a no longer existing, or a simple, even if complex, break in the natural process of transformation? For common belief, it is the end, the stop, which follows what is not known nor does it want to be fixated on it, but that is, in sum, a not-life, a no longer being what one was. This opinion is common as much to the deniers of God as well as to the lukewarm adherents of Religion. But for Religion, instead, Death is only a crucial point from which another life begins, one more certain, more secure, and truer than that false life that is experienced in the world, the world being a bridge, a necessary passage that conditions the future destiny of man who, we affirm it, is its judge to the extent he *wants* to be it.

How, in fact, could there be light for the man who obstinately rejects the light and how would there be salvation for the man who is convinced that he must be saved from nothing and nobody has to be saved in the inexplicable drama of life? Certainly, when a man passes from the essence of God, from His being all that is, to men's *post mortem* destiny, to the diversity of that destiny and above all to the rather vast exclusion of most from the life in God, he is seized by doubts, he is chased by protests, he is here ontologically out of place, as in the face of the partial negation of a total Affirmation, to an exclusive part of the All, to a tragic void in an absolute fullness, to an inexplicable residue of the divine Universality, to a clashing collision, to a radical injustice. But that depends on the

[21] `http://orthodoxwiki.org/Apophatic_theology`

limitations of our vision that is only human, and therefore is in a certain sense *passionate*, and of our reason that is confined to fixed fields of logic.

One thinks only that God offers Himself to those who want Him and denies Himself to those who deny him and that, at least and only in this, that "reciprocity" is manifestly just, in asking and giving, as a man can claim nothing, if, when he returned home in the evening, he did not find what he didn't want to find, rejecting the unpopular guest to whom he always denied access to his own home, slamming the door in his face.

God cannot give himself to those who do not want Him, to insist with those who are deaf and blind. Religion requires men of good will who adhere to and want to adhere to the Law of God. Whoever rejects it is judged by himself before being judged by God. This personal way of seeing things can be very useful only to those who adopt it, even if necessarily limited and partial. Because, examining the thing from a higher and truer point of view, the problem of his own salvation vanishes in the face of that more universal idea of *liberation* which is the dissolution *in toto* of the human-cosmic illusion in God. It corresponds to what St Paul says; when he speaks of the crucifixion of the world, he alludes precisely to the entire and universal process of liberation that is a definitive escape from every limitation, even the supernatural, for the realization of God in the negation of everything, even of Paradise.

But this integrating God in oneself and for oneself, this centering Him in His purest Essence, which is the exclusion of every perfection, for the perfection of all the perfections, this ontological rarefaction that is the negation of every affirmation, this surpassing of every praise, of every eulogy, of every superlative, is truly the intuition of the True God, of the Deity about Whom nothing can be said, not even that He is, if being is only being, and if beyond being, there is the unthinkable absolute, the unintelligible absolute, the absolute ineffability of the Ineffable. In this total super-eminence, God is more than God, since even God is surpassed in the vertiginous exclusion of every perfection. The realization of so much

muchness that coincides with the mininumness of every minimum, it is the highest degree of divine realization and it is the silence of silence in silence: here God says of Himself: *Ego sum quod non est*, the neuter absorbing in his indeterminative infinity every personal veil, every aseity, every formulation is only tautological.

There is no more mirror—*Ego sum qui sum*—not even of God in God, not a name, not a voice, not a song: nothing. The Being that is, is the non-being that is. It suppresses the last, the universal determination, which is that of being, of aseity, nothing remains if not the Nothing, the non-Being, the Ineffable of the Ineffabile. This is liberation and those who attain to it will find "that even Paradise is a prison" and that there is no longer anything to attain for those who ask for nothing because they can have nothing more. This is not an absurdity of words, but rather a radical absurdity, a divine absurdity that climbs over every limit, every peak, that fills up every chasm, that sinks in the intimate, hidden beauty of the Infinite. For so high a liberation, so total, Death is nothing, barely a transit, not even a passage, but the door through which the Wise, the Saint, abandons the cosmic prison, climbs through all the heavens, and penetrates into the ultimate, *Coelum Coeli*, where God is more than God, He is the infinite totality of negation. Here all the songs are silent and the Abyss alone is silent.

Death is a great master of wisdom and virtue if it is known like that, to what sublimities and what terrible ruins it leads, if one familiarizes oneself with its advent, if it is obtained from God who prepares us to receive it as the necessary means for the exodus from this "false world" and the access point to the highest degrees of Being, to the boundless possibilities of new worlds where the soul can sing its loftiest victories. God's true wisdom prepares us to accommodate it as the liberation from the corporeal burden, as the abandonment of the cadaver that we drag on earth, since the life of the multitude, deprived of God's light, is foolish, dull, a worthless necrobia, a dragging of artificial superstructures that

hide vermin, the putrefaction of a dead man who dreams.

Dying before dying prepares us for death, feeling oneself a cadaver before becoming one, separating before detachment, sanctifying the corpse, purifying it, making it the marble temple of the Living God. The sanctification of the body is the sanctification of life and the sanctification of the soul that only the Holy calls Holy, i.e., God in us. The divine integration, the knowledge that God alone thinks, feels, and works in us, is the most certain means to attain freedom and serenity at the transition.

Whatever pain, whatever sacrifice, St Paul says, is nothing in the face of the infinite richness of the prize that is now pure of God in comparison to the meager and false earthly riches. Freeing oneself from the tyranny of the I, one can gradually and laboriously attain to peace, to the triumph of the eternal in us, when all the interior springs flow with fresh water. It is a type of progressive denudation, of spiritual desquamation, of the gradual frustration of transience, of no longer feeling the demon that roars in us, the tormenting hammering of the I that arrogantly grabs the openings of the soul and twists them to pain, to crash, to laugh, to tears. To empty life of every content, to give it back to God, through contemplation, prayer, invocation, pneumatic elevation, radiant of Love, the inward conversation with Saints and Masters who become our Guides, our helpers, our mirrors of virtue. This reducing oneself, this abolishing the inner thunder, this listening to the perennial sources of peace flowing, this flowing of silence, this caressing the void in its fullness, this perceiving the darkness of oneself until the Light bubbles, this darkening, this crumbling and incorporeal re-emerging, this confident abandonment in God, this acceptance of all only for the love of the Lord, this No to the world and this Yes to God, this reflecting oneself in other-than-oneself, no longer recognizing one's own face, and ignoring everything except for Him, here is how rebirth is realized after the end, when Death, death killed, is the triumphal song of the soul that rests in God.

Posted on 2013-02-26 by Aeneas

* * *

Izak on 2013-02-27 at 16:21 said:

This really is very beautiful. I realize that your 'musings' posts get more comments, but I think the reason is because these translations are harder to digest and demand a higher degree of contemplation, so everyone risks looking like a fool so much more before saying anything.

But I think everyone appreciates these very invaluable translations, perhaps more than anything else on the site. The fifth paragraph is especially nice. I'm assuming that its poetry is even more strong in the original Italian than it is here.

Cologero on 2013-02-27 at 22:12 said:

I appreciate your interest, Izak. As you may imagine, it is not necessarily easy to translate, to find the right word, to be sure that the meaning is correct. It is actually a transformative process to do so, and I hope the readers of the translation will experience the same process. It is important to avoid being presumptuous, i.e., by assuming the meaning is obvious and clear cut. Some facebook comments claim the text is "life denying"; if so, their lives must be quite spectacular.

george on 2013-02-28 at 00:22 said:

The perspective is so thoroughly antimodern that it is hard to contemplate without letting go of modern perspectives.

Izak on 2013-02-28 at 14:49 said:

Yeah, I'd say you did about the best translation that the English language can permit, at least for that paragraph. I can get a sense of what Guido was doing with language.

It's really nice to see Guido de Giorgio in English either way. I can see why people would call this passage "life denying," but real metaphysics always kind of does walk the tightrope, doesn't it! It's very hard to say the truth without appearing Manichaean or pessimistic or whatever. Not to totally switch topics, but I always did appreciate when John Woodroffe took pains to explain that "maya" does not mean "illusion" in the way Westerners think about it, with negative or moralistic connotations. If only more people could be alleviate of such confusions!

Cologero on 2013-03-03 at 08:00 said:

Someone called me last week and in the course of the conversation, he claimed that "God would not send him to hell." At the time, I thought it was an odd comment from someone who frequents Gornahoor, not least of all because of the rather blasphemous view of God as some sort of remote "sky god", occasionally poking around in the world rather arbitrarily and even unjustly.

Coincidentally, since this particular post was scheduled, rather than attempt to answer him directly, I asked him to read this post when it appeared to see if it addressed his particular concern. I assume it has or else he lost interest. De Giorgio claims that in the post mortem state, the soul will itself seek its own level based on how much "light" it can bear. He claims to be repeating traditional teachings.

It is true that Plotinus said that different souls would exist on different levels, reflecting their large diversity, Dante mapped out these levels in the Divine Comedy. It seems obvious that a soul attached to a certain vice will have an affinity to a certain level of hell. It is pointless to put him on a higher level since he will just fall back to his own lever; there is no need to "send" him there as though it were against his own will. This is not a theory, it can be verified in your own consciousness, at least for those who have achieved the proper level of self-awareness.

To avoid such a fate, the important issue is to understand the "light". It is well worth the effort. According to traditional teachings, the Self is self-effulgent.

`Michael on 2020-03-24 at 10:14 said:`

Just the way GdG forms this writing is amazing, even more so is his light which the writing attempts to convey.

And yet he gives us the parts of a process, specifically the last two paragraphs. All of the statements made there convey exercises to be done by us the reader. Perhaps more can be elaborated on them, will sit with them to digest.

5.10 Ascesis and Anti-Europe

> This is authored by **Havismat** (**Guido De Giorgio**), from Volume 2 of Introduction to Magic. We see more of the paradoxical style of his writing. He reveals some personal details about his time in Tunisia and his experience with Sufis. See Short Note on Woman in East and West[22] for an interesting note that was in the early editions, but not the final edition of Introduction to Magic.

Regarding expression. There is the traditional one, the doctrinal one, the personal one. The first is integral, complete because of a pure intuitive

[22] `https://gornahoor.net/?p=6420`

order (Upanishad): the second is rigorous and complete, but presupposes the first: the third is poetic, strong, *poignant* — in the Sufi, for example — these three forms are totally complete and definitive in spite of the enormous differences: in one word, orthodox, in the etymologically rigorous and therefore true meaning of the term. These three forms of expression are superior in adhering to the inexpressible, eliminating everything that, as individual, alters and makes this same adherence opaque. These three forms of expression are absolutely innocuous: for those who neither know nor intuit, they are like water between the fingers; for those who intuit, they are cast, fleeting and revealing; for those who know, they are bends of teaching, they are support, discoveries and, in ascesis, stellar vertices.

Beyond all the hesitations, efforts, breakthroughs, perpendicular invasions, or serpentine vortices of personal labors of resolution and culmination, the metaphysical domain of the great Tradition shows an absolute, very clear transparency. In everything, one can deceive and be deceived— and the more one knows, the more one realizes that — except on that level that can be intuited, through convergences, or "integrated", but does not cease being what it is: a point, a knot of points of continuous connection that remains an unfathomable and intangible heaven, but only heaven, for those who intuit, that-cannot-be-said for those who know.

If poetry is the marginal game that opens the cracks of the Illusion, so the Poet, who opens and closes his eyes, is to be preferred to a minor expert and to a false mage; he is true — flashing, cultured, and lost depths — but always on the true axis, on the axis of the truth. This is why a tradition (in the integral sense) admits and justifies, without disdain, the one who knows and who does not know as long as the *axis is unique*, as long as there is no prevarication, as long as the one who does not know or who only intuits says: "It is here, it is absolutely here, also and *especially* (and this is the enormity of the Orient) if I will not have it and blessed are those that have it and who proceed."

India has achieved that integrally, extraordinarily: I refer in a special way to the Dharmanga and Acrama, that is, to the integral tradition in the totality of its accomplishments and the resolution of the accomplishments. The West does not know that: there can be no true resolution, "asceticism", accomplishment, if Illusion is not placed in its own domain, i.e., if its members are not recomposed in a way that everything converges in that which is the Root of Illusion.

Elite, that is good: they are provisional means. The martyrs of the West have not moved the overturning of the West by a millimeter: the tradition, through a thin thread, of the West, has not subverted this cadaver that plays at resurrection. An elite is not the tradition: an elite is a vein, a precious vein, but a vein: it wants the boulder, they want other veins, and it is necessary that all the veins converge, although the central one alone, the most hidden, it goes regally and, hiding itself, submerging itself, dominates.

If there is no space, there is no echo, if there is no silence, there is no Voice, if there is no unanimity, there is no song. To create adaptations, and what is begin done in the West if not this, and for centuries? It is necessary that things sing, the boulders, the metals, the woods, the thoughts, the stars. Everything must sing, from the blade of grass to Brahman.

But in the West one plays masquerades: a mask appears and disappears: a thrill of passion — "he is a genie" — seen, known, buried: and he draws away: and by degrees the West submerges itself. Do you think of the price of the thing, of the object: what is one thing worth now? Nothing. A bucket, a book, a statue, a house, a city, the world: what is it worth? Nothing. What is it to give birth? Nothing. What is it to die? Nothing. What is it to think? Nothing.

Man now steals life: if the hunt is in his pocket, he touches it fearfully: he escapes from it. Here you are. He lives for nothing, dies for nothing. There is no sense. He plays with ghosts: the Lemurian age: individual, humanity, society, family, science. Those do not exist. That is

outside Tradition: Tradition does not know ghosts: that is why it is not only about showing and suggesting a unique higher type, but of establishing the conditions for which a tradition, which includes all the variously ordered activities but along a single axis, can exist. To hurl thrills of absolute liberation to men who do not even know how basic human existence should be established in the field of action, but always related to a center that is not its essence, is dangerous and absurd. *Either life is a rite* or it is nothing: either everything reacquires a symbolic character, under the general type of the offering, or else nothing remains.

The *tragic sense of life*, for which modern men have so much sympathy, is also the element of dissolution and above all irresolution. Life is not tragic: tragedy has created the desperate man. Life is that which is and is that which must be. Pessimism harms more than optimism. The modern idea of "value" is already a construction like that of *will* and *power* in another field. Neither optimism nor pessimism, but *to give meaning to action*, to direct it on the basis of a boundary of resolution, to bend it to give everything down to the foundation; in everyone, not in the few. The few will be here: but there will always be those-who-go, not the grim despisers, but those who watch very calmly the turmoil of the waters from above.

Today one "builds" on the whole line: such tragic sense sweeps things away, it is the Rembrandtian sense of the shadow that sweeps away the truth: the white, the neutral, it is a key, the psychological key that slaughters the very placid grass of the meadow.

Ascesis is not asceticism. Asceticism is a deviation of ascesis. To transcend means to surpass that which is called reality and to see this reality under a different aspect: one cannot achieve the one without automatically getting the other. Therefore, whoever transcends, changes his eyes and by changing his eyes, everything is changed. The relationship Ascesis-Reality is the true one: supposing that one realizes Fulfillment, i.e., that individuality is re-solved, reality is play, i.e., tentacles that now open up,

now disappear according to whether the eye opens or closes. The concept of Ascesis is precisely this: the elimination of everything that makes of the I that which it is: one denies, one burns, one dissolves up to that, at the boundary of the end, the resolution is completed. Then this is absolutely exact: "*Quicumque Deum intelligit Deus fit*" "whoever knows God becomes God", from the *Mundaka Upanishad* , but that *quicumque* is no longer *quicumque* when the transition from *intelligere* to *fieri* is complete. but that "who" is no longer the same "who" when the transition from "knowing" to "becoming" is complete. And I would like to say: *Secretum tegendum, secretum tegendum* literally "secret to be kept", the Latin translation of *Upanishad*, now more than ever. I know of someone who went to a Sufi and demanded from him like a European: in French, in the original "Initiate me into Sufism." The Sufi looked at me, I smiled, and he responded: "But my dear sir, if you are not yourself a Sufi, how do you count on becoming one?" The European said: "But, in the end, through initiation?" "Initiation!" said the Sufi watching the sea with eyes grinning. And I answered for him roughly: "There is no initiation: either beyond you, or nothing."

This man, who is still looking, never finds, in spite of the lyricism of his conversation. And, curiously, having found himself with a Master, he did not believe he had to do what, with that method, is imposed on those initiated: to close his eyes and let them fall. Do you know the game of the cadaver? But they want closed hands and a rigid body: and then, perhaps, *it is foolishness*. "Parietes non faciunt Christianum" walls do not make a Christian said Victorinus as a pagan. Then he realized his error and became a Christian.

Another point: I don't like the term "will". If by "will" one means that which it is meant in the West, let us no longer speak of it: the Orientals do not know it. Will is for Westerners a hard weapon, a stumbling block, a "construction": and if one does not mean that, then it is useless to call it "will": useless and dangerous, because who wills, in reality,

does not will anything: willing is a establishing ties (an example close at hand is in the races of the North of today: the will-obsessed). As to the will-consciousness, it is no longer "will".

"Resolution" is the true term that expresses the super-rational and ascetic reality.

Years ago, down in Africa on an unbearable, infernal, hot, afternoon. I had fallen, naked and immobile, onto the bed. All of a sudden, in the hurricane blast of the sirocco, I felt a dull dark visceral rhythm in the sun. I jumped up from the bed, put on some clothes, and was on the terrace: dazzling sun, sea, clouds of sand, the wind burned the eyes; three black men in front of me, their eyes rolling, the slow powerful rhythm, the bowels twisted inside out, the evasion of the base and the sea, oh! The dark gloomy disheveled sea.

Again, one evening. Jasmine. An Arab courtyard, Arabs lying down, reptilian eyes and a dancing girl, a belly dance and a dance song. The rhythm dug the abyss and the voice filled it up; the rhythm cut through the darkness and the voice called the abyss. And the eyes, oh! The eyes of that woman, the smile of the Virgin, the cosmic dance, the creation-game, the game-rhythm, salient in the voice, the voice bending itself on the rhythm like an abyss on fire.

It is dangerous to approach the **true** Sufis, those, empty or full, *who have a hidden origin*. The activity will come, if something can still be saved, simply, like passing the self-resolution of chaos in a very clear sky. Like resolving the ties of the seasons. But that will entail anything but certain unclean pseudo-actions of "willing", with poor human and also "super-human" finalism. The structure asks for, requires absolute disinterest, *the absence of that which makes that which changes, change*.

Atheism consists in *not having a human god* who is concerned with the colds and ailments, a pharmacist god.

To surpass (there are the Chinese), not to bring closer: to act such that heaven overlooks the solid speck: high, very high. Alone then one

will see what true immensity is. With the little god close at hand, i.e., close to the soul, because the soul no longer goes far from the hand. Not to open oneself to everyone and so to give a single thing to everyone, but to put oneself very high, in the absolute place, on the lines of a peak like those secure panoramic seats where one glimpses the end of the world, that stays in order to come, of this world and of the other.

Otherwise, let it be said *to men*: "It is necessary to adore God face down on the ground."

Posted on 2013-05-12 by Cologero

* * *

Logres on 2013-05-13 at 09:59 said:

"He plays with ghosts: the Lemurian age: individual, humanity, society, family, science. That does not exist. That is outside Tradition: Tradition does not know ghosts: that is why it is not only about showing and suggesting a unique higher type, but of establishing the conditions for which a tradition, which includes all the variously ordered activities but along a single axis, can exist. To hurl thrills of absolute liberation to men who do not even know how basic human existence should be established in the field of action, but always related to a center that is not its essence, is dangerous and absurd. Either life is a rite or it is nothing: either everything reacquires a symbolic character, under the general type of the offering, or else nothing remains."

He sees straight through "life" today. Was it on this site, or somewhere else, that I read that modern individualism will one day be regarded as a species of black magic? Also useful, the endorsement of a species of "atheism" & the definition of "will" as resolution. Is it fair to say that the line between Tradition and anti-Tradition is the line between Being and Non-Being? He seems to be saying that taking "Illusion" (which I have until understood as "non-being") in a certain way can be done along an axis of Being as "intimation". On a mere common-sense or basic and vulgar level, could one rephrase this by saying that one's direction is more important than one's current state, unless one is "awake"?

Saydan_Shah on 2015-12-07 at 15:23 said:

Introduction to Magic

This is the book authored/edited by Evola? And any idea of where I can get more of Guido de Georgio?

5.11 The Second Precept of Love

This passage is taken from *Dio e il Poeta* by **Guido de Giorgio**. **Julius Evola** asserted that De Giorgio followed a Vedantized Christianity; this is immediately apparent in his description of the world as the "play of God", which has its exact analogue in the idea of *lila*[23] *in Hinduism*. Readers will also recognize the influence of **Rene Guenon**'s *Multiple States of Being*, as shown in the topics of the Infinite, Possibility, or multiple worlds. Then again, Guenon claimed only to be explicating the metaphysics of the **Vedanta**. Yet, De Giorgio does not approach that text as a logical exercise, but rather as "one who knows".

Finally, there is the profound influence of **Saint Thomas Aquinas** and, of course, **Dante**. Much of the vocabulary, which cannot come across in a translation, is archaic, originating from Dante's time. There are several references to *The Divine Comedy*, which I have provided whenever I could recognize them. The Comedy is more than a poem, it is a detailed text for initiates. It seems to us that De Giorgio followed the path outlined, climbing the seven story mountain of Purgatory, and saw the world from that height.

It is tied to the first, and subordinated to the first, *ancillarily*, but in the purely religious meaning in which this term must be used, as profound comprehension of the divine drama, of creation, that, divine and nonhuman, refers to that which, coming from God, returns to God, as a "restitution" which becomes a "gift", a gift of love. The world is the fruit and the work of divine love which multiplies itself, remaining one, gives itself because given to Him, offers itself because offered to Him, breaks itself, shatters itself, apparently because every part, every fraction, purely apparent, comes back in the All, from which it separated itself as pure

[23] https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lila_(Hinduism)

"play". The world is God's "play", removing from this word any frivolous, human limitation whatsoever, in the special, precise sense that, e.g., Saint Thomas gives it, when he speaks of contemplation, in the Latin word "ludus". The world is the "mirror" of God, the crystal in which the Unity contemplates Himself and, contemplating Himself , pluralizes Himself , multiplies Himself , still remaining One, because He cannot not be One while being One, like a fire of a thousand sparks each one of which is fire but not *the fire*, since every relation with God is *uni*lateral, not double, not reciprocal, God alone being God and what has life from God, has being, not being able to be God, if God is God, "for the contradiction does not allow it"[24]. The world is "imprinted" by God in the sense that God, while passing, creates, and the created reflects Him, it is His footprint, nor can it be considered otherwise than in relation to Him, without which nothing would be, it is obvious, because the trace is a sign, a sign that indicates the Giver, the Donor, the One who imprinted it, stamped it, engraved it. One could not speak of God without the world, although God is without the world, beyond all possible worlds, for the simple reason that He cannot exhaust Himself in creation which is His work, nor limit Himself to it, why His power is always "in infinite excess"[25] in the ambit of created things and since this "excess" is infinite, it is understood without difficulty, that which we call "everything" created, is, ontologically, nothing in the face of He who created it.

If we call the "world" the visible, it is clear that is cannot reflect God who, by definition, by necessity, by absoluteness, is invisible, that not removing, however, what is visible, insofar as it is visible, it is also the sign, imprint, mirror, reflection of the invisible, and that the visible breaks itself, shatters itself indefinitely (a multitude of beings) *because it cannot contain the invisible*. The creaturely multiplicity is the indication of this impotency, as numerical indefiniteness is the indication of the infinity

[24] *Inferno*, XXVII
[25] *Paradise*, XIX

of unity, without which it could not offer itself, although no number of the series entirely reflects the unity that is in everything and in none of them.

God as God must create the world, without which He would not be God, or, at least, He would not be known and therefore loved as God, but if God is the Invisible, it is also necessary that he is God outside and beyond the world, outside and beyond creation, which is one of his possibilities but not all of his Possibility that must be infinite as He himself is infinite. His "infinite excess"... Manifestly, therefore, everything originating from Him, each thing should return to Him, and in fact, does return to him, must return to Him, but each thing, as every creature, through its way and manner, or *diversimode* diverse modes, Latin as Saint Thomas would say, by levels of integration. Among all creatures, there is man, who has his mystery which corresponds to the Mystery of the Incarnation, the descent for the ascent, and this mystery can determined in a certain manner saying that man can "take up again" all the work of God, in a *syn-thesis*, i.e., in a *com-position*, in the universality of understanding, of prehension as the eye which embraces an entire horizon in a unitary vision, uniting the multiplicity, joining the separated, but it is necessary, however, that he has a *third eye* in the middle of the forehead in which the two eyes are "centered", to resolve the duality in unity, since the two is limitation, it is a throwback, and must result in the three.

The privilege of man, therefore, is this, to be able to return to God, *freely and totally* because he alone, among all creatures, has the option, the choice, to remain in creation, or return to the Creator, taking up all creation, *capitulatim* summarily, Latin in the unity. This is the true, the great dignity of man that he owes to the faculty that, only in him, embraces not only what appears (the visible, the world), but that which is, God. This faculty is the intellect, not reason which, visibly, cannot pass beyond the visible domain of quantity, the world, creation.

Posted on 2023-03-21 by Cologero

* * *

William Zeitler on 2023-03-22 at 09:32 said:

What's the first precept of love? I haven't been able to find a blog by that title or a link thereto. Thanks!

6

Mes idées politiques, by Charles Maurras

6.1 His Political Ideas

> Ideas belong to no one; they are what they are.
>
> Charles Maurras, *My Political Ideas*

Tonight, I'm outlining the plan for translating a series of essays by Charles Maurras. This fulfills a promise and responds to a challenge. The promise was made in the comments section of Taki's Magazine[1] a few years ago when it used to be a conservative resource instead of the journal of choice for hip urban racists that it is today. The challenge is from **Alain de Benoist** to compare and contrast the ideas of Evola and Maurras. It appears no one has the will or the talent to accomplish that.

That still does not fully answer the question of "Why bother?" In his prime, Mauras was highly influential, not just in France, but also on the Iberian peninsula and across Latin America. Echoes of his thought still

[1] http://takimag.com/#axzz27L592q87

reverberate in Traditional Catholic circles through the SSPX[2] and TFP[3], although they are far from the mainstream. Yet for the modern world, his ideas are not only irrelevant today, they are positively distasteful. Nevertheless, there may still be salvageable concepts if we leave aside the more contentious parts of his writings.

The French Republic prides itself on its secularism, but Maurras himself was a secularist. The difference is that Mauras includes the entire history of France in his vision, while the Republic looks is concerned with the moment. Like the liberals, he also claims to base his worldview on science. However, for the liberal, the individual is the atom, and family, culture, and nation are the results of his will which he may freely choose or reject. For Maurras, family, culture, and nation come first, they are the source of the individual's identity and hence demand his allegiance. For the liberal, there is no fixed human nature since he creates his own identity. Maurras, on the other hand, based his understanding of a fixed human nature on the philosophy of Thomas Aquinas.

There is no compromise possible here. To the modern mind, Maurras' ideas are necessarily restrictive, as they limit his freedom in the present, and they are reactionary since they tie him to the actual past whereas he wants to be liberated for the possible future. For them, this exercise can serve as a museum for discarded ideas, useful for pedagogy, but not much else. The real challenge, then, is for the so-called New Right. This will serve as a touchstone to evaluate its doctrines which hardly differ from liberalism considering its commitment to a functional polytheism and its tolerance for the aesthetically ugly and the unnatural. We hope there may still be those looking for ideas on the Right that derive from traditional sources rather than from foraging in the weeds of postmodern thought for imaginary gems as does the New Right.

Maurras was a poet and a member of the prestigious **Académie française**

[2] `http://www.sspx.org/`

[3] `http://www.tfp.org/`

until his postwar conviction of collaborating with the enemy. Hence, his prose is written in beautifully expressive French so it is a shame to have to translate him as I will be unable to capture that.

Maurras was not often a systematic writer, so it is difficult to find a representative sample of his work despite his voluminous output. We considered two works. One was written late in his life, Order and Disorder, which fits into a theme we have been exploring recently. However, it is not broken up into sections so it is not so suitable for a blog. The other is My Political Ideas which does attempt to lay out his ideas somewhat systematically. Next Sunday, we will start with the chapter titled "Principles" and then decide if it is worthwhile to continue. These can and should be compared to some of the metaphysical principles we have been writing about. Like Abraham, I am hoping for ten good men to be able to provide insightful and relevant commentary on these essays, although in reality I would be satisfied with one. The forthcoming principles are:

1. Truth
2. Strength
3. Order
4. Authority
5. Liberty
6. Right and Law
7. Property
8. Heritage
9. Duty of Heritage
10. Tradition

Posted on 2012-09-23 by Cologero

* * *

Matt on 2012-09-23 at 23:37 said:

Excellent. The translation of Maurass' writing on Comte you provided a couple of years earlier was great so I'll be looking forward to this.

Both Maurras and Comte remain quite unique in their defense of traditional social-political structures while respectfully remaining non-committed to affirming the spiritual reality that the structures are intended to reflect. Though even then, Maurras became a committed Catholic near the end of his life, and Comte appeared to take a quasi-mystical outlook in his outlook with venerating the great predecessors that came before us.

Hope your health has improved.

Avery Morrow on 2012-09-24 at 00:52 said:

"Tradition means giving votes to the most obscure of all classes, our ancestors. It is the democracy of the dead. " –Chesterton

Drieu on 2012-09-24 at 17:17 said:

"However, for the liberal, the individual is the atom, and family, culture, and nation are the results of his will which he may freely choose or reject."

This is inaccurate and flat out stupid to anyone who has actually bothered to research the history of ideas. Not all liberals and leftists hold the same views, just like not all rightists hold the same views.

Immanuel Kant and Denis Diderot, both radicals in their time, did not see individuals as atoms but as *cultural agents*, i.e. that man was unavoidably shaped by his culture. The same apples to Johann Gottfried Herder, the philosophical founder of nationalism, who supported the French Revolution.

The anarchist Mikhail Bakhunin wrote that "Nationality is not a principle; it is a legitimate fact, just as individuality is. Every nationality, great or small, has the incontestable right to be itself, to live according to its own nature. This right is simply the corollary of the general principle of freedom."

Even among economic liberals, Milton Friedman explicitly states in Capitalism and Freedom that the basic component of society is not the individual, but the family.

Hell, Maurras's own ideas on nationalism (as well as Maurice Barrès's) were primarily shaped by Hippolyte Taine and Ernest Renan, both agnostic liberals (though of a conservative bent more akin to British Toryism).

There are many more examples, but those are just some prominent ones off the top of my head. You need to drop the inane traditionalist platitudes and straw men about some monolithic "Enlightenment" or "liberalism" and actually figure out what the other side thinks. Especially since most of the ideas attributed to the "Enlightenment" (secularism, republicanism, written constitutions, equality before the law, civil liberties) were organically developed well before then in the religious sphere by devout Christians, not by deists or skeptics.

"We hope there may still be those looking for ideas on the Right that derive from traditional sources rather than from foraging in the weeds of postmodern thought for imaginary gems as does the New Right."

Except that the right, including La Vera Destra to which your dear Evola refers, has always incorporated the latest philosophical trends into its thought. By absorbing some postmodern currents, the Nouvelle Droite has not at all betrayed the legacy of people like Joseph de Maistre or Juan Donoso Cortés. And considering that postmodernism thought aligns with certain motifs of the right, such as a suspicion of the Enlightenment narrative, disdain for rationalism, and rejection of an historical telos, I don't even see it as a necessarily corrupting element.

For the record, I'm not a leftist or liberal, but someone who is tired of seeing people who are nominally on my side repeat the same nonsense again and again and make themselves look like idiots in the process.

As for Maurras, I'd go for one of the early works like Enquete sur la monarchie. You forgot to mention that his views changed a bit after WWI. In the early period, he advocated decentralization, regionalism, and flirted with unorthodox economic doctrines such a syndicalism. After the war, he shifted towards support for centralization while still retaining some affection for the provinces, and became more reconciled with capitalism and less interested in activism. The latter two changes ended up driving away many of his most talented disciples who were much more dedicated to the earlier radicalism, such as Georges Bernanos, Lucien Rebatet, Robert Brasillach, and Thierry Maulnier.

Andrew on 2012-09-24 at 18:10 said:

And that is not the tradition we are talking about.

Cologero on 2012-09-24 at 19:03 said:

Drieu, I'm afraid we differ in method. In order to understand "liberalism" or any "ism", it requires an understanding of the principles that govern it. Hence, we here reject out of hand the empirical approach of asking those who call themselves "liberal" what their positions are on various issues. This fails for two reasons. The first is that focus turns to secondary issues. The second, and more important, is that few men are really aware of the principles and motives that drive their thought. In out language, we are interested in the "thesis" rather than the "hypothesis". Although I have hinted at that distinction previously, I will have to expand on it at a later time.

The sign of a great thinker is that he knows and can express his first principle. These are the men we need to focus on, not a hodge podge of random quotes. For example, Francis Bacon explicitly rejected "formal causes", which is antithetical to any Traditional understanding of the world. This has consequences in what you call the "history of ideas" even if later developments were not apparent to Bacon himself. Yet, this rejection is considered normal today even to the extent that very few men even realize that it underlies their entire worldview. We will deal with this again soon, probably on Wednesday.

Kant took this further by denying knowledge itself. Given Bacon's premise, Kant's conclusion absolutely follows. Yet this is opposed to any Traditional world view. So for Kant "culture" is an empirical reality that "shapes" an individual; unfortunately, that is not a very profound observation. The Traditional worldview is that a culture is a transcendental reality, something Kant denies necessarily as unknowable. It more than "shapes" the individual; rather the individual is unthinkable without it.

So, yes, Drieu, we try to "figure out" not just "what" they think, but rather "how" they think. And that is very often not exactly how they see themselves. In other words, what are the presuppositions of their thought? And, of course, we mean consistent thought since very few men are able to think consistently.

If this project has no appeal to you, you are welcome to leave and hang out wherever there are no stupid people or idiots. Traditional thought is always considered stupid, superstitious, and ignorant by the modern mind. Since you appear to have a modern mind, I don't see how we are on the "same" side, not even nominally.

I am always amused by readers who want to tell me what to write on this blog, or what to translate, or what I omitted. Obviously, I omit quite a bit, since my contention is that a single blog post needs to be narrowly focused. If you prefer that I translate Enquete sur la monarchie for you, cut me a check for all the time required and I will move it to the very top of my priorities. Otherwise, I will select texts based on my own purposes and interests.

Jason-Adam on 2012-09-24 at 19:31 said:

As someone whose life has been influenced by Maurras' ideas himself, I will gladly do what I can to assist in this project.

Let me ask Cologero, we know already the distinction between the traditional and modern minds. The new right seems to think the postmodern mind is something else and an improvement upon the modern that can lead back to traditional thinking. Do you agree and if not why ?

Izak on 2012-09-24 at 23:02 said:

I'm not really seeing the willingness to discourse with postmodern theorists as any indication that the New Right is eo ipso postmodern, or informed by liberal values, or even definable

in any meaningful way as of now.

The medieval Catholic justification for glossing heretics like Origen was that "even in a heap of dung one can find a nugget of gold."

Like most intellectual movements, the New Right will be defined by whatever influence it manages to concretely produce. Because that's what politics is all about.

Cologero on 2012-09-25 at 00:17 said:

Jason-Adam, what I will be looking for are comments on the texts, either explicating the text, relating it to other ideas, or putting it into a broader context. I don't plan to "debate" the New Right. I really do understand the allure of postmodernism; I have experienced it firsthand. The fundamental point is that if the knowledge of ultimate reality is already known, has been known since ancient times, and is handed down as tradition, then why the quest for novelty?

I suggest to the advocates here of the new right that they explain why Benoist ultimately rejected Maurras … that would be useful and would add to the store of knowledge.

The other part of the project is to compare and contrast Maurras and Evola; comments in that regard are welcome. Moreover, I am curious why Benoist thinks it a worthwhile project as well as the reason neither he nor anyone else has followed through with it.

Avery on 2012-09-25 at 01:33 said:

I employ vulgar sources wherever they may help people understand, and resort to fleshing out the Guenonian depths only when there has been a clear disruption of our common sense.

In this case, I see a clear connection between Chesterton's romantic definition and Cologero's statement, "Maurras himself was a secularist. The difference is that Maurass includes the entire history of France in his vision, while the Republic looks is concerned with the moment."

Jason-Adam on 2012-09-25 at 20:25 said:

I could write an essay explaining clearly the exact differences between Evola and Maurras so I will gladly comment when the texts appear. Let me just say one thing for now – that ultimately Maurras and de Benoist are looking to different pasts, one to the Middle Ages, the other to ancient Greece. I conjecture de Benoist has not gone through with the project because he would have to explicitly state then that he does admire mediaeval civilisation.

Jason-Adam on 2012-09-25 at 20:26 said:

forgive me, it should say de Benoist does NOT admire mediaeval civilisation.

Dominion on 2012-09-26 at 00:50 said:

The issue is one of form rather than essence, in my understanding. While it is true that the ultimate principles already exist, the way in which they manifest are not. This differs between

Traditional civilizations; Christendom did not look identical to the Caliphate, which did not look identical to old Rome, and so on. Traditionalists in the New Right, particularly Dugin, use postmodern thought to critique the basic principles of Liberal civilization and thought, which is similar to what Maurras sought to do with positivist philosophy ("What our fathers did through custom and feeling, we ourselves pursue it through reason and will, with the assurance and clarity of science.") When Faye (who is admittedly not a Traditionalist) talks about reconciling Evola and Marinetti, I interpret this as taking the ultimate principles which we already know and seeing how we can live by them in our current, temporal and changing world. Tradition of principle must not be made equivilant to traditionalism of form. As Guido de Giorgio once said:

"Tradition is absolutely different from traditionalism: one is an eternally fecund living patrimony, rich with infinite potentialities in all times and circumstances . . . . the other is but sterile residue, an inefficient, self-enclosing concreteness impossible to adapt and lacking all energetic and creative force. Tradition is clearly opposed to traditionalism, just as truth is opposed to commonplaces."

`Cologero on 2012-09-26 at 07:29 said:`

Well put, Dominion. The phrase you quoted also explains my own interest in the thought of Maurras and Comte. So are you saying that the Maurrasian critique of liberalism is no longer effective and that the postmodern critique may be more fruitful?

`Dominion on 2012-09-26 at 14:46 said:`

Considering the influential role that positivism plays in the current order, particularly in the scientific sphere and even to a great extent in the social sciences, I think that both the Maurrasian and postmodern critiques of liberalism would prove useful. Personally, although I find the postmodern critiques interesting and useful, I am more inclined towards rational and scientific perspectives and might thus find Maurras more rewarding. I don't have much background in his thought, however, and thus await your translation.

6.2 Principle I: Truth

> From Chapter II, "Principles", of Mes Idées Politiques, by **Charles Maurras**.

Yes sir, yes ma'am, because "speech is hard", its efficacy will be sweet; because the book is "bitter to the tongue", it will be invigorating and healing.

The signposts raised up on the road don't show their direction in a sweet and florid style: they flaunt the style of their utility. Clear, direct, insistent, and authoritarian, they don't say: "if I am mistaken", they don't doubt themselves, they do not excuse themselves from roughly throwing the direction arrows and the mile markers into the eyes of the people who pass. But does the traveler complain about it? As long as he has the heart of a philosopher, he gives thank to the author of profitable brutalities which he does not even feel tyrannized by.

It is his choice to slow down or step on the gas, to follow to change his direction. The milestone says what it is in clear terms, and what is necessary to take into account. The more that precise facts limit thought and, because of that narrow limit, the more that fantasies of the heart, wishes of the imagination, the needs, the amenities and personal interests will obtain safety and will be able to give themselves a career. An uncertain direction, a fact, whether vague or false, while appearing to flatter the arbitrariness of the walker, will restrict the freedom of his movements, of his rest, they will diminish his real powers, for the risks attached to the consequences of an indifferent or capricious itinerary will be increased by the insufficiency of his knowledge.

It is a great error to think that *contingencies*, as they say, accommodate themselves more easily to a lax and vacillating principle: to the contrary, all indecision of principles complicates the study of the facts, as well as their treatment; uncertainty thus is inserted at the sole point from where a little light could come to them, to the complexities of the earth shadows in the sky will be added.

Truth, a harsh but clear sun, is content to establish from above what is necessary to know and think before acting. It shows the good, it marks out the bad; it distinguishes the proportions following which the one and the other confront each other and mix in the infinite variety of our human events. Once so enlightened, man is far from having resolved the problems of practical life, but he has something to resolve them and if, as

happens to him too frequently, he can choose only between evils, he will better discern which will be the least, his effort can be applied to avoiding the worst; that makes perhaps the greatest point of the government of oneself and others.

Not only is truth defended by what it has that is naturally general, elevated, abstract, and foreign to man, but in order to decide to ascend to it, a general impulse [*élan*] of thought beyond the present, a full calculation of the future, is necessary. In order to adhere to this truth that veils everything, in addition an effort of will imposing silence on many instincts is necessary.

Truth (I do not say sincerity, I say the whole truth, the agreement of language and thought with external realities), can still be something besides the highest delight of intelligence: it is the empowered sovereign, it is all powerful force.

Sincerity is not the truth. The most correct intention and the firmest will cannot create what it is not.

Let us not underestimate any virtue, but let us give justice to the obvious virtues. There is no smile, grimace, or chattering of beautiful spirits that can stand against them. The decisions that they lead to are serious, sometimes painful, in the life of the spirit; exterior life doesn't always accommodate them, but the service that they render is such that they prevail over everything.

Truth is of value in itself. But there are bitter truths and sweet truths. There are useful and dangerous truths. There are those that are necessary to reserve only for the wise, and others which are suitable for the nourishment of all.

Some purely oratorical and mystical revolutionaries can believe that, fable or truth, it is always good enough for the people! We believe that the people have no needs less demanding than the elite. Truth is as necessary as bread. The historico-political lie poisons a people as absolutely as potassium cyanide.

A disdain which is not expressed does not take effect. To the contrary, an error and a lie that one does not take the trouble to unmask acquire little by little the authority of the true.

Complete text: `http://www.royaliste.org/spip.php?article520`

Posted on 2012-09-30 by Cologero

* * *

`Dominion on 2012-09-30 at 14:45 said:`

"Sincerity is not the truth. The most correct intention and the firmest will cannot create what it is not."

"To the contrary, an error and a lie that one does not take the trouble to unmask acquire little by little the authority of the true."

With those two statements Maurras has unveiled the secret to every victorious lie and legend's success and the key to its power. If a single man or an entire people cannot bring itself to tear the pretty mask off the lies which keep them entranced and captive, they cannot progress. Indeed, they may well fall deeper into the mire.

`Jason-Adam on 2012-10-01 at 17:52 said:`

This text, written in the flowery French style of which Maurras was a master of, is not something easily grasped by those used to modern Joe Friday "just the facts ma'am" styles of writing. What Maurras is saying here though is just exactly that – before we can figure the world out we need to begin with facts, things we are certain of through proveable means, to avoid being trapped by the lies of the power hungry.

`Attila on 2012-10-21 at 02:24 said:`

I disagree with the characterization of "flowery French style"– Maurras' writing is highly nuanced, and not reductionist- unlike so much coming from Anglo-Saxon circles.

6.3 Principle II: Force

To the principle of Truth, Mr. Maurras adds the principle of Force, without which the former is impotent. Yet, Force must be guided by sound judgment.

There are despotic weaknesses, malicious stupidities, and losers worthy of being so, as there are beneficent winners, heroes of energy and power to whom humanity owes immense progress, giants of health and strength who have merited the blessing of the past and the future. Force in itself, bared of its adventitious and incidental characteristics, force which is still in the service of neither good nor evil, naked force and by itself a good, and very precious and very great since it is the expression of the activity of being. It is idiotic to want to ignore its benefits.

In order to deter harmful sophism, one cannot grow tired of repeating it: force by itself, reduced to itself, is a good. That does not mean that it always does good or there is not a greater good.

Good in itself, it is also capable of the greatest benefits like defending the country, punishing crime, avenging honor, or protecting innocence.

But as it is capable of everything, it needs a rule as the primary guaranty and, put into the service of the best cause, an order. Order contributes to render it entirely and completely effective. But order also restrains it in the service of what it claims to serve; order prevents it from turning against what is dear to it in spite of itself. All disordered force is exposed to this peril.

It is up to Reason to moderate force, that is to say, the sense of measure and intellectual proportions, there is this civic sense which adds to the higher orders of the spirit I don't know what principle of cordiality, bonhomie, I would dare to say, of charity which does not desire the death of the guilty, but which desires, and very much desires, his rectification.

There remains also that clarity, that sincerity, the natural continuation of the rectitude of the spirit which permits neither hypocrisy nor disguise, but which marches straight ahead of ifself, head high and chest bare, this tranquil serenity which belongs to those who have freely assumed noble missions.

The theories of force are not at all in contradiction with the doctrine of solidarity and, anyway, human mutual aid needs to be strong to protect

itself or to be protected against violence.

If there may be in the world force which is of value, it appears indispensable for it to be strong; if there is something else, if, as we think, there is something better, and much better, it is still more necessary to be strong and powerful to save or to develop these true goods.

Posted on 2012-10-07 by Cologero

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Audrey on 2012-10-07 at 23:02 said:

I do find your posts to be a good mirror of self-reflection, contributing to the 'educatedness' of my self-observations and regulations of behavior. I would say, that real education should approach, at least in pary, a similar mode, as opposed to stuffing slots in people's heads with ideas and fighting fr intellectual real estate. Namely, paragraph #4 from the bottom, I have always wondered why every time I am asked about punishment under UCMJ, such as rank degradation, or jail, I always request instead rectificator measures. However, in the Army, this is considered a weakness. I guess their idea of teamwork, is more about pulling like a donkey, and not about actual collaboration.

Logres on 2012-10-08 at 05:22 said:

Bishop Joubert (as quoted by M. Arnold): "Force & Right rule the world – Force till Right is ready". Maurras' style and manner of thought comes across very strongly, even in translation. Thank you.

Sati Shankar on 2012-10-11 at 22:48 said:

Force,is in fact a double edge sword,neutral it itself as such, in the hands of some one capable in using it.Now it depends on the its user that it is used to protect or induce Good. History has enough to cite its misuses. The question is, whether to engineer (by force) a society where corrections will not be needed which depends, dangerously upon the user of force, Or to let the Tradition work so that no engineering is needed at all. Force kills spontaneity and freedom, most often.

The second point relates to the Force as inner energy, that is indispensable for an individual to attain his goal.

Graham on 2012-10-14 at 01:21 said:

"… neutral in itself …"

Maurras says that force is good in itself. That makes sense, since "it is the expression of the activity of being". This closely parallels Evola's remarks about virtue and power which are discussed elsewhere on Gornahoor.

6.4 Principle III: Order

> Although he described himself as a pagan, the influence of Thomism on **Charles Maurras** is quite clear. Being and Order, for him, are coterminous. I don't know the extent of Donoso Cortes' influence on Maurras, but Maurras also rejects endless discussion, claiming that to debate order, which has a mathematical-like certainty, is a waste of time. To choose disorder (or chaos) is to choose death and annihilation. Man, such as he is, needs to hold firm to his fixed reference points (or road signs?); modernity, on the other hand, wants to knock over every one of them. Who is left to still remember them and celebrate them on the calendar?

As no face could exist without the features that surround it and the line which contains it, as soon as the Being begins to move away from its opposite, as soon as the Being is, it has its form, it has its order, and it is that same thing from which it is limited that forms it. What existence is without essence? What is Being without law? In all the degrees of the scale, the Being weakens when order diminishes; it dissolves as soon as order no longer holds.

Order is only a means. It is a point of departure. To reestablish order restores an atmosphere favorable to the action of the spirit as well as that of the body. That order makes work possible or better. It guarantees it duration, supplies it with assistants or protectors.

Humane rule does not consist in killing, destroying, nor annihilating the subject whom it must, on the contrary, develop while maintaining him on his path.

The necessity to *subordinate* in order to coordinate and order, there is no rhetorical nonsense that can go against that mathematics!

To be conformed to order shortens and facilitates work. To contradict or debate order is to waste time.

Order, they say, is a higher justice.

For historical and political order, *to have* it is nothing, *to hold* it is nothing, if one is not also in a position *to keep* it.

In war as in peace, order is precious among all the goods. With its fake hardness, with its apparent strictness, it saves lives, as it measures and makes use of efforts.

The soldier who complains about the order is the enemy of himself. The blind kindness that joins in with this soldier is an enemy of the soldier. An unconscious and involuntary enemy; what does the intention matter if it sends him to his death?

Precisely because he is ungrateful and weak, because forgetfulness and fickleness are normal for him, man notices early on that it is necessary for him to look again, in Time that is constantly changing, for some points of fixed reference, for invariable points of support, whenever he wants to realize a plan of any importance, or he wants to be faithful to his goal and his love.

I deliberately write this last word, which only expresses the sentiment of persons; for if strong passions have their anniversary rites, if a return of certain dates leads to a natural return of thought to the joyful or sorrowful mysteries of the life of the heart, or even more so, when it is no longer a question of a sole being, but of a society, a religion, a cause, then will it be necessary to immortalize happy or gloomy memories on their dates.

Do not forget: this is the starting point of all order and all law.

Posted on 2012-10-14 by Cologero

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Jason-Adam on 2012-10-16 at 00:10 said:

Indeed, order is the basis of all life. Without a basis there is no society, as we see in our days as all forms of collective identity are in decline.

Cologero on 2012-10-16 at 17:08 said:

It is important to not that, for Maurras, order not only determines what a being is, but also what it is not. This is important for his subsequent analysis.

Lucius Cornelius Sulla on 2017-05-22 at 18:47 said:

How is Charles Maurras pagan? He was pagan after he lost faith, but he was then involeved in politics it is only after Dreyfus affair, that he become engaged in political affairs, but I never i read anywere that he considers himself pagan when he was defending church and become monarchist, or can some point me to were I can find that sentence?

Cologero on 2017-05-22 at 19:09 said:

Obviously, dude, you read it here. Unless you consider here to be Nowhere[4].

Lucius Cornelius Sulla on 2017-05-25 at 19:17 said:

you misinterpreted my question: how charles maurras is pagan?.It is last thing I could call him, he clear would describe himself as positivist and classicist.

Cologero on 2017-05-25 at 21:12 said:

OK, Sulla, from the OED definition of pagan[5], the most reliable source:

A person holding religious beliefs other than those of the main world religions.

So that is the sense I used the word. You are correct; he would have described himself as a positivist, at least after his youth. His first book, Anthinéa, about his visit to Athens, was originally titled "Pagan promenades". Eventually, however, he embraced Positivism and achieved a rapprochement with Catholicism.

At that time, he became coy about the designation "pagan" or even "atheist", but that need not concern us. Yet if he was a classicist, then he was a pagan in the same sense that Plato was a pagan.

Since the book under discussion was written much later in his life, I will change to text to read: "he was often described as a pagan", or something like that.

But I hope that excessive pedantry does not obscure the main point. To wit, the recognition of a cosmic order, i.e., "natural law", is possible for pagans, so it is not solely a Christian dogma.

[4] https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pesIGuV9DDk

[5] https://en.oxforddictionaries.com/definition/pagan

6.5 Principle IV: Authority

From Chapter II, "Principles", L'Autorité, of *Mes Idées Politiques*, by Charles Maurras.

Nature of Authority The idea that authority can be constructed from below would not have come into the head of our grandparents who were wise.

It is not made, in truth, from below nor from above.

Authority is *born*. In individuals, families, peoples, it is a gift which the will of men has very little to see.

The most vulgar observation is totally in accord here with the Catholic text *omnis potestas a Deo*[6]. In one of the oldest "Letters to Françoise", Mr. Marcel Prevost reminds his niece how, after having passed her baccalaureate, she knew she was obliged to show the secretary of the Faculty her notes, regardless of the rules of the University and the laws of the State. "You have a great gift, Françoise, it is authority," observed Uncle Marcel sententiously. Did he believe so well what he observed. Did he follow through what he observed?

Authority, seized thus at its birth, is something simple and pure. Certain human types possess it, the others are devoid of it.

In leaving aside those who know only how to submit, the man of liberty, recognizable in the pride of a heart that nothing crushes, differs from the one who is characterized by dignity and inspires above all respect: the man of authority differs from the other two. His liberty imposes itself naturally on the liberty of others, his dignity is radiant, it leads and carries. It is neither respect nor admiration—inert feelings—it is an enthusiastic submissiveness which responds to him.

Far from being irrational, instinctive wishes move more quickly than conscious reason, and perceptive logic is not more lacking than the pas-

[6] All power comes from God.

sions of a great love. The author of La Vita Nuova tells us that at his first sight of Beatrice his heart begins to beat in him impetuously, which **Dante** develops and explains in these terms:

> The spirit of life that reside in the most secret vault of the heart begins to tremble with so much force that the movement is made to be felt again in my smallest veins and, trembling, it says these words: '*Ecce deus fortiori me, qui veniens dominabitur me*.' Here is that God stronger than I, he is going to dominate me. Then, the animal spirit, which is hidden in its high vault where all sensitive spirits go to carry their perception, began to be greatly surprised and, addressing itself particularly to the spirits of the sight, says these words: '*Apparuit jam beatitude nostra*.' Our bliss has appeared.

It is necessary to reread all that penetrating and poetic analysis which is of an age where the laziest sophisms from Germany and the Jews [Freud] had not imposed on the European West a ridiculous philosophy of the unconscious. What was unconscious, one brought it to consciousness. What eludes the first grasp of reason, a more subtle reason pulls out in the night.

This explanation of the strong premonitions of a loving heart, such as Dante gives us, can be applied to the instinctive transports of an obedient soul before the authority that he judges to suit him: a quick judgment grants him to conceive that it will be good for him to serve that force conceived as useful and beneficial, whose order presages protection, justice, or victory. There is a taste in it of the beginning of a mysterious good. By what sign is it known? That is the great difficulty. Certain military leaders make themselves obeyed by genius, others by bravery, others by a type of mystical faith. The exterior and brilliant gifts of a Condé can add the magic of the example to it, but some generals carried on litters have radiated the same prestige.

Henry Fouqier, who was part of the *Thousand* [who conquered Sicily as part of the unification of Italy], loved to tell that the aging Garibaldi inflamed his band by saying to them in a whisper, from the base of his carriage where rheumatism confined him, a simple: "Gentlemen, move ahead!" So many passions of hope and confidence sleep in the human soul! Little suffices a little in order to make them rise from it, but this nothing is indispensable and no convention, no arrangement, no artifice of will can take the place of the first natural gift.

Authority is of the same order as virtue or genius or beauty.

The most learned cogs have never replaced authority *born* …

The French of the tenth century had settled down around the race which, for a hundred years or more, had always defended them effectively. Where did that race come from, from what heaven had it fallen on the country? Immigrant Saxons or native rural lords or even descendants of bourgeois Parisians, scholarship does not stop discussing it. They do not discuss the authority acquired little by little by their fortuitous power nor the benefit of their dynasty nor its constant happiness.

It expresses for centuries a power or protection and increase, it represents everything that the heart and spirit of men, isolated or reunited, wait for, hope for, and believe about a true authority.

True authority is naturally wise; an insane authority is not conceivable. The idea of authority does not mean, indeed, only the power and the great power exercised by a man or a group of men, but all the more, it confines the knowledge of the object on which this power is exercised and applied. The more the authority believes, the more this knowledge itself is developed. The more authority is perfect, the more it assumes the clarity and the exactitude of that knowledge, and the more it proportions itself in it.

Authority would not be an eternal political necessity if, at the same time as that guiding instinct which constitutes the bottom of the soul of the leaders, there did not exist in the soul of the subjects and the citizens

an instinct of obedience, "spirit of following," said Richelieu, who is the living expression of the greatest interest of the crowds: to be governed and well governed, in a good sense, with firmness.

The Conditions of True Authority: the Education of the Leaders

The development of what is called modern civilization tends increasingly favour material forces over moral forces.

If we rely on it in order to achieve social justice or the improvement of morals, we set ourselves up for considerable deceptions! That civilization equalizes neither wealth nor conditions: on the contrary, its complexity never ceases increasing the differences between men. It does not liberate: the authority of science and industry will tend instead to establish new races of slaves. Finally, far from pacifying and reconciling, its needs are so demanding that they seem to intersect at a right angle, to destroy or deny everything that is human.

Neither the game of supply and demand which continues capitalism, nor the principle of nationalities which created our armed peace, nor class warfare, by which the insurgent masses respond to the starvation brought by capitalism, would know how to spread in the modern world an ambiance of a sheepfold. We would be rather be pushed back among the antisocial wolves and pressured to live, by categories of class or race, according to the custom of the wolves. The inherited veneer of customs peels off little by little, the vestiges of general traditions disappear, and the statistics of criminality show what inevitably results from it.

Consider the progress of athletics (which could make, in a well ruled society, an admirable school of discipline and elegance), the passion (otherwise excellent in itself) of winning and prevailing in violent games, the new instruments created by science and those who apply them: this proliferation of ancient forces and these new means put in the service of powers without restraint only have to give their lessons: the moralist, with a thousand signs, sees brutality reborn.

As to the language of our contemporaries, I speak of the best, of those who are elevated, if not highly elevated, men and women, that it comes back to primitive onomatopoeia, if we "let come to grips with life", forces, destinies.

In the regime of brutality, there are neither leaders nor orders, nor even order, without its necessary hierarchy which is lacking. The massacres of September had leaders. It is not orders that the executioner lacked from the Duke of Enghien or Bishop Darboy. It is not necessary to complain about our times in this regard.

Class differences are more marked than they have been for a half century, the arrogance and despotism of the authorities would rather be on the way to grandeur. What is lacking in the directing spirits is that light which is the sign of the right to lead. The leaders remain and their power increases, but those are barbaric leaders left to the impulses of passion or interest. They command, they lead, because their troops will it, but they command poorly and lead wrongly, the mistake being learned.

They themselves also are, still more than these proletarian masses for which they feign a very vivid interest, the really underprivileged.

The intellectual and moral treasure, whose task of collecting that inheritance belongs to them, was disdained and finally lost. Thus the spirit of liberal democracy used it, which disorganized the country from above; borrowing the language of progress, pretending to possess the promises of the future, it abandoned the sole instrument of progress, which is tradition, and the only seed of the future, which is the past.

The history of the Third Republic can suffice to show the harm that there can be to surrender legislation, armies, the economy, diplomacy, and all the forms of authority and influence to those spirits without direction and without culture, to those hearts without self-mastery and without dignity.

The symmetric history of conservative England, where everyone who governed and served in the top jobs had undergone the hard and long

intellectual and moral preparation in the old universities, with a lot of Greek verses and Latin discourses, confirms how certain it is that the real happiness of the people depends on the good training of their leaders. The sword of the conqueror, the baton of the founder, even the pencil of the stockbroker, all these modalities of strength and cunning can and must bring about great benefits to the condition of having passed the necessary time under the strict rule of the educator. Everything that they take away from the rule, is not taken away from the rule nor from the authority which holds it: that is entrenched in the entire mass of the people; it is the nation and the human race who are the first dispossessed.

The lessening of the common intellectual and moral assets is a loss for everyone: the least will lose as much as the great.

They will even lose much more than the great, because that which perfects, refines, elevates the great, constitutes, to the profit of the others, the most precious, and often the only, guarantee against the abuses of power which greatness is precisely exposed to. Certain nuances of virtue and honor, certain beautiful persuasive accents of the voice which commands are the direct fruits of the sole education.

It is like that of religion.

Whoever said that a religion was necessary for the people spoke complete nonsense. Religion is necessary, education is necessary, a set of powerful brakes is necessary for the leaders of the people, for is advisors, its chiefs, due to the very function of direction and restraint that they are called to keep from it: if the passions of the human beast are to be feared for all, it will be to dread in the proportion that the beast will play with stronger powers and will be able to devastate a more extended field of action.

All liberty is not suitable in every State; each State depends on its historic antecedents and it geographic position like each man on his ancestors and his country. Salutary and tutelary dependencies, since they gave life, sustain it, and conserve it, and whoever rejects it, dies. Liberty

varies with time and place, but this is no State which can last without a sovereign authority.

Therefore, if we want to speak with exactitude, it is not liberty which is general and necessary, an ecumenical, basic, and human right; it is authority.

The Exercise of Authority The property of power resembles other properties; it results from work, from work done and "done well". Totally naked force can be applied for good and for evil, for construction, for destruction. When it did the good, when it constructed, it has merit from it, it has prestige and glory from it, it also sees the birth from it of this product which is called authority.

A power vacuum resembles the vacancy of a field. Whoever wants it, takes it; whoever is able to, holds onto it.

When there is a power vacuum it is, as Joan of Arc said, a great pity for the kingdom. And it is a great misfortune. To seize power in that case, if one has the strength, is simply an act of charity and humanity. A people needs a leader like a man needs bread. Not only, in such a hypothetical situation, is the right of first occupancy established, but there is a rigorous duty, a strict obligation for those who *can* occupy. When citizens are threatened by the enemy, it is necessary to command them if one can do it. When disorder is in the street, it is necessary to restore it back to order if one has the means.

Power is not an idea, it is a fact, and one believes in this fact when it makes itself felt; all criticism by the world can do nothing against the strength of a conqueror.

Most moralizers, who have confused minds, judged that power corrupted the heart of man. When power is elevated and lasts, when it lasts a little, the effect is totally the opposite; the learning of responsibilities matures and their experience perfects, rather than ruins, them.

Posted on 2012-10-21 by Cologero

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Jason-Adam on 2012-11-02 at 15:02 said:

Here is an interview deBenoist gave where he discusses Maurras in depth.

A case could be made from an Evolian perspective that Maurras did not go back far enough i.e. he defended l'ancien regime while forgetting that the actions of the French monarchy against the empire and papacy are what began the slide to destruction. Evola did say that the French monarchy brought on their own doom by their absolutist, anti-feudal and anti-Empire policies.

Dante was also opposed to the entire Capetian house and saw them as nearly usurpers. (see Purgatorio)

Does anyone know if Evola actually wrote about Maurras ?

Cologero on 2012-11-02 at 22:22 said:

I don't have time myself to find that passage. Where did Evola write that "the actions of the French monarchy against the empire and papacy are what began the slide to destruction"? Then we will be in a position to discuss it.

When specifically did those actions occur? I will be making a case soon that the "ancien regime" defined Feudal society through its understanding of the tri-functional division of society as pointed out by Dumezil. If the monarchy rebelled against the spiritual authority at some point then, yes, that would be indicative of the "degeneration of castes". However, I just translated a text where Maurras explicitly said that the temporal leaders were to undergo a religious education (i.e., the spiritual authority).

Evola did say that he believed what well-bred men believed to be healthy and normal prior to the French Revolution, i.e., the "ancien regime". That is the motivation behind the Maurras translations, viz., to highlight those healthy and normal beliefs.

Given this, I think Benoist's case falls apart.

I have just one complete article by Evola on Maurras from La Vita Italiana: "The defeat and future of France according to Action Francaise". I'll try to get it translated before the end of the year.

In other books, there are some references in passing . I'll gather them together at some point in the near future.

Jason-Adam on 2012-11-03 at 01:47 said:

1. I foolishly forgot to post the link to the interview, here it is

http://www.alaindebenoist.com/pdf/entretien_charles_maurras.pdf

2. Evola's anti French remarks are all throughout part II of Revolt against the Modern World. He specifically attacks Phillipe IV's attack of Pope Boniface VIII, also Francois I warring with Emperor Charles to the point of even allying with the anti-Christian Turks, Cardinal Richelieu's

centralising policy which destroyed the independence of the local aristocracy, and then Louis XIV's continuing wars against Austria and the empire.

Also in Men among the Ruins Evola said Italy should move away from France and closer to Germany.

These are not my opinions, I am merely trying to provide Evola's thoughts as I understand them.

Cologero on 2012-11-04 at 11:23 said:

Yes, Jason-Adam, that is the interview that "inspired" the series on Maurras. Unfortunately, there are too many elements for a comment box: the diverse views of Maurras, Evola, and Benoist himself, not to mention the view from Tradition.

As you point out, discrete historical events over the course of centuries can be pointed out, as Evola did. Or else, we can look at these events from the point of view of Tradition: which were informed by a sense of order, and which by an opposition to order. To make things manageable, we therefore reject out of hand the notion of an "Evolian" critique; we are only concerned about the critique of Tradition.

Specifically, then, a fundamental point is the degeneration of castes: how do Evola and Maurras see that. Of course, Evola was explicit about that, and he did not see the "ancien regime" as disordered; quite to the contrary, as we have pointed out numerous times, Evola himself claimed his views were in harmony with those of well-bred men of that ancien regime. I would say the same for Maurras.

Benoist, on the other hand, rejects outright that regime, placing himself in opposition both to Evola and Maurras.

You do point out an important difference between Evola and Maurras, viz., their relationship to German thought. The latter was appalled by it. Maurras actually proposed a sort of greater Romanity, among all the nations speaking Romance languages. Hence, he hoped for a closer cooperation between France and Italy, leaving Germany out of it. Maurras saw a direct line from Athens to Rome to Paris. Evola, on the other hand, was obsessed with Germany and its philosophers.

So what next?

P.S. To those who don't read French: that interview is by a living writer under copyright protection; otherwise I would make it available in English for you.

Jason-Adam on 2012-11-04 at 22:13 said:

Our discussion has reached an important highmark – Evola and Maurras are agreed upon which system of rule is best. We can also agree that restoring l'ancien regime, if it could be done, would result in restoring the Traditional form of western society. The major difference between Evola and Maurass is indeed the nature of Germany.

The question I have now is : on the matter of Germany and German philosophy, who is correct – Evola or Maurras ?

Cologero on 2012-11-04 at 23:52 said:

Coincidentally, I have a post planned on German philosophy for mid-week. Ironically, Maurras ended up liking the Germans a bit too much, and that cost him his reputation and his freedom after WW II.

There is an important difference, also, in fundamental orientation. Evola and Maurras were both pagans enamoured of ancient Greece and Rome–although Maurras was more influenced by its classical aspects–and both had high regard for the Medieval period. Evola accepted Tradition as a metaphysical, supra-historical, given. Maurras was a Positivist and historian; his view of tradition was simply as an historical reality and his understanding of it came indirectly from his knowledge of Catholic France.

Logres on 2012-11-04 at 15:39 said:

http://distributistreview.com/mag/2012/08/lord-acton-tends-to-corrupt/

Lord Acton's dictum has lead to a great deal of mischief in the Anglo ghetto.

Cologero on 2012-11-05 at 13:19 said:

Judging from personal correspondence, there seems to be some confusion about this section. They seem to think that this is a justification for "fascism". I responded that to me, it seems descriptive, not prescriptive. Actually, it can be read as the program for revolution as we wrote about recently. Revolutionary forces deliberately provoke public disorder precisely in order to create a power vacuum which they will attempt to fill. Since the public prefers order to chaos, they are usually welcomed … at first.

In the light of the previous section, remember that Maurras insisted that the temporal powers needed to be under the influence of religion. This is not true of modernity, following the American, French, and Russian revolutions which were overtly anti-religion to various degrees. That people who consider themselves pious or spiritual would favor modernity over the traditional thinkers who acknowledge the priority of the spiritual over the temporal, absolutely baffles me. They believe that modernity is the only "loving" and sane system.

This should also be read in the context of the "Social Contract" theories. Obviously, Maurras cannot accept that. The social contract theorists postulate that free individuals gather together to work out the mechanisms of power in their social group. Clearly that is not consistent with Maurras' understanding, since he claims that some group will assert power rather than wait for a social contract. The contract theorists presume the individual is supreme, whereas the traditional view is that society is prior to the individual.

Dominion on 2012-11-05 at 13:56 said:

It should be noted, though, that not all religions are equal in this regard. Many people who subscribe to some religious principle or order have felt themselves justified to do great damage to their societies and others, to destroy a Traditional order and heritage (Ansar Dine in the great city of Timbuktu), and so on. If the religion is not grounded in Truth, then it can be as destructive as any "atheist Stalinist."

The social contract can also be read in terms of different groups in society coming together, which is far closer to the way things really work (force isn't discounted). Preferably, the 'contract' would then allow each member of each group the best way to self-development in their respective contexts and according to their abilities.

6.6 Principle V: Freedom

Freedom is not at the beginning, but at the end. It is not at the root, but in the flowers and the fruits of human nature or, better said, human virtue. A man is freer in the proportion that he is better. This evolution is necessary. Our men believed they credited themselves with the prize of the effort by a Declaration of their famous rights, by displaying in their city halls and their schools, in their ministries and churches that that prize is acquired without effort. But to display everywhere that that everyone is born a millionaire, would everyone earn a shadow of a million?

Will you say that it is a right to freedom? The right to the million would not be more futile.

Freedom, a metaphysical principle, is one thing: freedoms are something else. The will of the people, the sum of individual wills, is one thing; the general will, the expression of the general interest of a nation, a race, a country is another thing, totally different.

The freedom of the crowd is called folly, that of a stupid person, stupidity, that of the crook, crime, that of the traitor, treason, and so forth. To say that freedoms limit each other is totally correct in the savage state or the state of anarchy: that simply means that the strong oppress or ex-

ploit the weak as long as the weak do not revolt against the strong and that potential victims did not find a sure process to snipe at and strafe their tormenters at will. Freedom conceived as regime or as principle, is a generally painful chaos.

Citizens who have reflected a little therefore do not let themselves be intimidated by the effects of words. They define freedom as a power or a force, a force or power that is worth what its subjects and its object are worth. The eternal ridicule of the 18th and 19th century consists in taking freedom for a rule or for a goal when it is only a means or the material.

Freedom lives in few men.

Whoever says real freedom says authority. Testamentary freedom creates the authority of the head of the family. Communal or provincial freedom creates the real power of the social authorities who live and reside in the place. Religious freedom recognizes the authority of spiritual laws and the internal hierarchy of a religion. Trade union and professional freedom devotes the authority of the disciplines and rules to the interior of corporations and professional organizations.

These are the observable facts.

If, however, in place of observing, one withdraws into himself to reflect, he realizes that the very nature of positive freedom—that which is not conceived by the relationship to an obstacle to surmount—freedom is the power.

Social issues are exercised in society and have as their point of application not marble, as the power of a sculptor, nor the machine, as the power of a mechanic, but by men engaged with us in social life.

What then is a freedom? A power.

Whoever can do nothing at all is not free at all. Whoever can do rather poorly is poorly free. Whoever can do infinitely is also infinitely free. One of the forms of power is wealth. Another of its forms is influence, it is physical force, it is intellectual and moral force. On what are these various powers exercised in various ways? On men. And that power, to whom

does it belong? To men. When human freedom is found at its highest point and it met human objects to which to apply and impose itself, what name does it take? Authority. An authority is therefore only a freedom reaching its perfection.

Far from the idea that authority contradicts the idea of freedom, it is, on the contrary, its completion and complement. The freedom of a father of a family is an authority. The freedom of a religious confession is an authority. There are still the authorities as freedom of an association, the freedom of a commune, of a given province.

When one wishes that the State respects private initiative in the economic order, one fundamentally demands that it respects what Le Play named with a beautiful expression: the social authorities. All real freedoms, defined and practical, are of authorities. Freedom opposed to authority; freedom which consists in not being *affected* by others, but also to not *affect* them, that neutral freedom is not compatible with nature nor with the order of life.

Posted on 2012-11-11 by Cologero

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`Cologero on 2012-11-11 at 19:05 said:`

Once again, the intent of this piece is a counter-argument to Rousseau's claim that "men are born free". On the contrary, Maurras asserts that freedom is an achievement, that it comes with maturity. Ironically, Maurras is close to Fichte's claim that a man is free to the extent that he can submit to the laws of Reason. The relationship between freedom and authority brings to mind Evola's claim that only the king can be said to be totally free.

`Avery on 2012-11-11 at 23:39 said:`

It appears that by restating freedom as a product of power, rather than something necessarily tied up with the kshatriya revolt, Maurras corrects Rousseau better than the Perennialists do, and is rewarded with a definition more meaningful both for historical societies and modern political purposes.

The Roman Senators were always "free" to believe and do what they wanted, and "freemen" or franklins had their power recognized even in the most Traditional society.

6.7 Principle VI: Rights and Laws

I always believed that the privilege of rights also represents the privilege of duties.

The experience of the nature of things established that the domain of common law is very limited and that there is, on the contrary, a multitude of private rights. Each group of men, which has its distinctive life, deserves a distinctive treatment. Whoever "favors" himself wants to be treated for his own benefit, and when this wish is not granted, the subject suffers, first of all, in the body which he is a part of, and secondarily in himself, due to the disrepute and the slackening which, by all necessity, affects that body.

Right, in order to be imposed and even to subsist, requires that it be exercised, that it be sustained, that it be published. It presupposes activity or it fades, little by little, in the blood and ashes of massacred men and burnt buildings, then in the sublime cold of these empty spaces where the raised voice of the most passionate of the rhetors is going to die out.

That is what the rhetors will never understand. They spend their life personifying "the right". But men of action and men of analysis ask themselves what this person without subject, this right without a living substrate, can be,: in their turn, by not understanding the antithesis that lingers everywhere, this right that they oppose to force, this force that they want to make the opposite of the right! It makes as much sense to put the triangle and a color in opposition. There are colored triangles, there can be colors spread on triangular surfaces. I do not conceive a right that would be abstract, which would be separated from a moral or material person in whom it exists, and that is to say, from a force.

There is force, more or less strong, which is right; there is force, more or less strong, which is wrong. But a rational being who, without any force, would be the right or would have the right: that is what I cannot conceive.

The right, which needs force in order to be recognized, needs it even more in order to be.

Legal reasoning starts from the principles of the Just and the Unjust, its first notions already represent the second or the third power of a high abstraction, and its definitions, if extensive, are necessarily fluctuating when it is about adapting their generality to practical life: among the multitude of particular facts, often very different, and which sometimes contradict each other, the spirit is more or less inevitably induced to lose sight of the impersonal reasons to stop its choice or even to lead its attention. It is then that, for lack of impersonal reasons, others appear: the personal motive suddenly appears, active and vigilant, and the idea of the right no longer remains clarified and guided except by the idea of the "*me*", by this "*me*" which is not without rights, but which claims to have them all and which instinctively steers the processes of thought towards its sole interest, sometimes understood in a tyrannical sense but always, to some degree, unconcerned with a good order, unconsciously favorable to some anarchy.

May the heavens protect me from saying that the Right leads to anarchy, he who wants, on the contrary, to rule it and pacify it! But he is a born warrior. In my opinion, the preference given to the legal method over the empirical method must belong to flourishing societies, strongly based on the principles which erupt from all sides and are obeyed by everyone.

Separate man from his family, his nation, his trade, tell him that he is king, tell him that he is God, and intoxicate him with the idea of Justice, you will see from what heart he will count the wrongs which will be done to him and what will be able to be his leniencies for the wrongs that he will come to do to others! This judge is too partial, a party too interested and too impassioned for it to be reasonable of him to remand theoretically all litigation. The one who recognizes all rights begins by imposing on the entire world all duties, without forgetting the penalties which correspond to all negligence.

That is the true folly of revolutionary individualism, whether it is political, social, or moral. It is impossible that an animal as sensible, as sad, as vulnerable as man, once placed on the interior altar that the dogmatic liberal erects on him, does not believe, nine times out of ten, himself to be the creditor of his fellow men and of the universe, in the place that the most miserable is on the contrary their debtor to the infinite!

This illusion of the creditor on society can only be only encouraged by the absurd metaphysics of Rights.

Clarifications on the Nature of Law According to a venerable [the Middle Ages] maxim[7], the law is made by the action of the sovereign (*constitutione regis*) and by the acceptance of the subject (*consensus populi*). Without doubt our jurists poorly translate these words. They figure that consensus, this must be understood as the agreement of fact, as noisy as the acclamation which follows the coronation of kings, as the simple approving whisper which Homer had follow the word of the leaders, *Epeythymesan axaioi*. But, in the great majority of cases, in the case on which we do not make little stories about, the agreement consists in the fact of raising no important contradiction, of understanding, of carrying out.

To go on to say: "Mister Subject, here is a law that will legally bind you. Do you really want it? Are you sure you want it? We need your signature," that is exactly to want to inspire him to say "no", to argue endlessly in order not to agree. The hatred of the new and the spirit of contradiction are so strong in men that we do not put the public good at their mercy.

Yet it remains true that the law must be made to be easily obeyed. A law must be acceptable. The law is not the law when its pronouncement suffices to provoke the people to fear it. It needs a natural and prompt consent.

[7] From the Middle Ages: *lex consensus populi et constitutione regis fit*.

The party which attacks a law which no one defends can be wrong or right, that is not the question: the author of such a law will not have less committed that political fault of not waiting for the best conditions and most favorable arrangements of the public spirit. Its law is only a decree of a state of siege that it will have to support, arms in hand, without having the right to complain or be surprised.

The spirit of modern laws is far from the spirit of the laws which govern the deeds of real life, and these real deeds, unable to worry about the scraps of paper which distort them or the spider which weaves its web in the legislative mind, continued to develop following the weights, measures, and numbers which compose them.

It is said: "But the deed can be the crime! The deed can be the atrocity! The deed can be the error!"

Definitely: realistic politics and morals do not provide bare facts and beliefs as the types and models of life. But they recommend two points:

First of all, to consider laws depending on which real deeds are chained, for if deeds can be vicious or criminal, the laws of vice and crime are not; the order of causes and effects which preside over realities themselves flawed are not the least flawed in the world, it is even excellent to know and to calculate, knowledge and calculation which alone permit action.

Secondly, action has the chance to be serious and useful only on the condition of aiming for a definite and just goal. It is neither sufficient to have an "ideal" in mind, nor to make a second-rate idea of "right" and "duty": this moralism, this legalism, this idealism must conform to the ideal, moral, and legal truth. In other words, it is first necessary to be right.

A false idea is a false idea. The will to impose on the world under the pretext that the world must be governed by ideas is an absurd pretence whose application will be forcibly criminal or fatal. Ideas are not equal to each other. All the claimed rights are not valuable. And not all ways of arranging mores are worthy of respect. The modern error comes from that sudden assimilation of contrary systems dreamed by the human mind. It

is definitely an easy error for orators and litigants. It allows the latter to support all causes. It lets the former please all audiences. But the people who trust in them pay the price.

Posted on 2012-11-18 by Cologero

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Avery Morrow on 2012-11-20 at 05:17 said:

Although it's written as a general principle, I've found that this is an extremely pertinent post in the light of the current Israel-Hamas war (where a lot of claims of one side being "in the right" are being thrown around), and every time I quote it people get very confused.

6.8 Principle VII: Property

Property is the natural safeguard of man, an industrious animal still more than reasonable, for whom his needs, his weakness, the dissatisfaction that he brings from the cradle make a narrow duty of transforming what surrounds him. Pascal is wrong to scoff at those poor children who say: this coin is mine.

One would not say "me", without saying "mine". Without property, man is condemned to death.

To possess is to command, it is to dispose of oneself, it is to be able to resist others, it is to exercise an influence, were it only by reaction.

Property emancipates existence and confers an authority at least on the goods of the earth and the fruits of labor.

Posted on 2012-12-02 by Cologero

* * *

Jason-Adam on 2012-12-03 at 17:57 said:

Very direct and to the point.

It does create a dilemma for those "Traditionalists" so-called who see hope in communism.

Saladin on 2012-12-03 at 19:14 said:

lol! "Traditionalists who see hope in communism"!!! You must be joking, right?

Jason-Adam on 2012-12-03 at 19:34 said:

I wish I were but I am not.…

There are men who claim to be both followers of Rene Guenon and Karl Marx. Alexandr Dugin's writings are a prime example of this tendency.…..

The person who first introduced me to Baron Evola's books was a National Communist.…..

Jason-Adam on 2012-12-03 at 19:37 said:

Read this to see how Dugin tries to mix Evolian-ism with Marxism.

http://against-postmodern.org/section-iv-mission-julius-evola

I can only imagine what the Baron would say if he could read this.…..

More and more, I am starting to see Dugin as the prophecied counter-intiation that Guenon mentioned in Reign of Quantity.…

Cologero on 2012-12-03 at 21:02 said:

It seems that a lingering affection for communism is the equivalent to the Stockholm syndrome[8] for some Russian intellectuals. Another we can mention is Israel Shamir.

Without property, man is a slave to the state. Even Medieval peasants had their land and couldn't be evicted by bankers or tax collectors. A Romanian friend has told me tales about life under communism. For example, the authorities deemed that his grandmother had more house than she needed. So they took over some of its rooms and moved in another family and a retired military man. She had no say in the matter.

Dominion on 2012-12-04 at 00:43 said:

The right to property is fundamental in order to preserve the ability to attain freedom (the Traditionalist notes, of course, that it is not freedom in and of itself, as the American right would have us believe). However, the right is not absolute. The banker or corporate shark who exploits the worker and nation cannot hide behind his right to property when the State exercises its own rightful duty to uphold Justice.

[8] http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Stockholm_syndrome

On the topic of communism, two important points must be made: first, that "communism" is many times used as an umbrella term to describe varying and contradictory elements, making it very much the equivalent of the "fascist" epithet. Second, that the way in which certain Traditionalists view "socialism" (that is to say, a society in which the worker has some sort of democratic control over capital and where the State advances these reforms) as being far from antithetical to the aims of Tradition is far more nuanced than some seem to think. The best criticism I have heard from these branches is that the exploited worker is viewed as a mere unit of production; socialism's aim is to view the worker as a human being whose work cannot be separated from his inner development. Thus, a socialism which allows workers democratic control over capital is necessary in order to allow the worker to develop his various mental and spiritual capacities.

With regards to the exoteric institutions of Tradition, many movements today which can be called "socialist" have moved in this direction, or at least have the potential to be educated towards this framework. One example is the Russian Communist Party today, which supports the Orthodox Church being a foundation stone of Russia, and aims to maintain social systems which view the family as a social good and unit, such as the public kindergarten system. It also wants to maintain small and medium sized businesses, which is not so distant from the distributist view of property's role. Dugin's fourth political theory is useful in that, using Being as its basis, it takes what is useful from the previous theories, including socialism. But what is base must be made subtle; what is made from the dust of the so-called enlightenment must be baptized in the water which brings true enlightenment. Be it property and the market, socialism and the worker, or the fasces and the authority of the State, this will need to be done in order to build an order in which the values of Tradition are embodied.

`Jason-Adam on 2012-12-04 at 02:54 said:`

Cologero is correct on the need for all persons to be property owners. Property is the basis of an individual life as Maurras articulately said above…..

I often wondered myself why Russians like Dugin who were victims of Communist repression suddenly turned nostalgic for the USSR….

Do you think though there's any merit in the arguement that since the USSR fell before the USA it was therefore not as degenerated ?

`Saladin on 2012-12-04 at 19:59 said:`

I am only vaguely familiar with Dugin. His Geopolitics is certainly interesting. Tradition has no use for Communism, and communism is totally opposed to Tradition. As Cologero said "without property, man is a slave to the state." There has never been a Tradition that has not protected the concept of Private Property.

Saladin on 2012-12-04 at 20:06 said:

Thanks for the link Jason! Dugin suggests that we read Evola "from the Left"! That explains a lot! He clearly has his own reading of Tradition but I completely agree with Cologero that this may be a bit of Stockholm Syndrome and definitely not "the prophecied counter-intiation" figure.

6.9 Principle VIII: Heredity

> Where there is no vision, the people perish: but he that keeps the law, happy is he.
>
> Proverbs 29:18

> In this insightful section, Maurras shows the importance of heredity, both in regard to progeny, but also with respect to the transmission of the "fruits" of a society through its bloodline. He points out that it is the society of those with faith who are most likely to understand this, and that it is due to God's very law: Be fruitful and multiply. Those angst-filled existentialists can fulfill this task only paradoxically by making it a sacred task. As faith declines, men see no need to preserve and pass on their heritage.

Nature proceeds most commonly by imitation and repetition: but it also has innovations, caprices, initiatives. In that case it acts with an extreme vigor.

When it lets a soldier be born in the house of peaceable magistrates, or a marine in the descent of wine growers, the new vocation is marked rather strongly, it is served by a rather firm will so that all resistances are broken. But these resistances, these difficulties have some good. These hardships are natural tests, letting the predestined strong pass, but rejecting the others in the hereditary condition most suitable to them, because nature assures them defense and protection.

As the means of action towards a future, heredity is the most direct and the simplest of all.

Its general utility results from the destiny of the generator gifted with reason, who reproduces himself before dying.

Human life would be shamefully short if nature had not furnished societies with a procedure that transmits the fruits of its works through the blood.

The impersonal passion, whose deposit man holds, acts only through him in order to get to others, but delegates to the children which he procreates a power over the goods that he likewise procreated, very often for them. The inert posterity which comes from his hand will be vivified by his living posterity. When his great sons begin to enrich his heritage, all workers a little amorous of his work feel with some truth that he is going to conquer death twice. The power of bequeathing his remains gives to the activity of a well-filled life the highest natural laurels.

Let us note that the Christian societies of the Middle Age, penetrated by the supernatural sentiment of a future life, always proved themselves extremely sensitive to the terrestrial reward of the father in his sons. They sang, with all their soul, "Abraham et semini ejus in secula" ["to Abraham and to his sons forever"].

Our different royal or imperial races arise out of nations fervently convinced of the reality of the kingdom of heaven: how would less believing peoples pay less attention to the carnal wish of hereditary duration? It is their only defense against time; they have only that anchor to throw on the abyss of the future. In a pinch, hereditary ambitions should have weakened through a sudden flight of celestial hopes; would the opposite be understood?

We can reason this way:

If some God hidden in the secret of hearts or soaring on the interplanetary abyss assists, immobile and mute, ardent and all powerful, the development of the efforts of humanity, it is His own law that He con-

firms in things and men; He can only bless its increased effects.

But if the spaces are empty and if the human heart is itself not assisted by any "internal consolation", all the happiness of the being and all the benefits of life appear more exposed to the erosion of time and the blow of death, their tradition, their transmission then seems more precious in its solitary immensity to perpetual destitution. All means of saving or prolonging the shaky personal effort becomes more sacred perhaps! The thought threatened is attached more closely to the philosophy of order and the knowledge of the laws of its preservation. Should this order succumb, the believers keep refuge in the divine City: he who no longer believes undergoes the catastrophe of everything that his dream vied with death.

Posted on 2012-12-09 by Cologero

6.10 Principle IX: The Duty of Heritage

> In this particularly beautiful passage, Maurras explains the duty of one generation to pass on its culture, customs, and traditions to the next, which in turn, has the duty to accept and develop that heritage. The loss of one's traditions needs to be taken at least as seriously as the attention we pay today to the possible extinction of various fishes and insects. Unfortunately, the youth of today are the new disinherited, since their fathers have passed on little except a hatred for their own past. How that plays out is uncertain, unless and until they rise up to reclaim what is rightfully theirs.

In order to justify what common sense and custom maintain by force, let us not talk about rights, but instead duty.

The duty to bequeath and make a will.

The duty to inherit.

Those who are called disinherited or proletarian are sometimes understood to be preaching that that is not just in their point of view. That is just and beneficial for everyone.

The good that is established in a natural or legal family can have doubtful sources: it is redeemed and moralized by its fixity, by the firm benefit that it establishes around itself in stabilizing the conditions of life, in distributing work, in securing it, in preparing a point of solid support to the generations to come.

There is no difference between the damages caused to nature by the death of a beautiful animal, followed by the return of its elements to the universal dust, and the destruction of an ordinary fortune to the death of its creator.

There is a dead loss for society as for nature, the obligation to take up again a long and painful task.

Prosperous social organisations are those that prevent these realities from dissolving into the void and which help to keep them from a total death: these purveyors of life, being the born-enemies of destruction, made a respected institution from its heritage, and, one could say, a type of sacrament from its legacy.

Posted on 2012-12-16 by Cologero

* * *

Jason-Adam on 2012-12-16 at 21:27 said:

Truly beautiful indeed. The West is in dire straits as even the descendents of the former elite are losing their ancestral heritage…….and instead of rising up to reclaim what is ours, too many faux traditionalists look to another culture….

6.11 Principle X: Tradition

Maurras concludes his list of fundamental principles with Tradition. This will be a disappointment to those who want to reduce

> everything to the rational, since traditional is beyond that. It is tied, as he says, to "blood and soil", that is, one's ancestors and the heritage they bequeathed. The deracinated modern mind is limited by the idea, the simulacra of the "proposition" nation.
>
> Yet, tradition is not blind. It successes serve as the paradigm for the future, it failures as lessons to be learned; there is no point to perpetuate errors. This is a living tradition, not stuck in the past through inertia. A true Tradition is never lost, it is only hidden. If it had one starting point, it can have a second. It will being anew only by men who know who they are.

Tradition means handing down.

Tradition gathers the forces of blood and soil. It is retained even when leaving one's country, as an eternal temptation to return to it.

True tradition is critical, and for lack of its distinctions, the past is no longer of use for anything, its successes stop being models, its setbacks stop being lessons.

In all tradition, as in all heritage, a reasonable being deducts and must deduct the liabilities.

Tradition is not inertia, its opposite; heritage is not nepotism, its counterfeit.

All traditions had a beginning and the sentiments of monarchistic fidelity, if they rise up very high, do not do so indefinitely: what began can begin again; what had one point of departure can find a second.

The opposition between reason and tradition, which is the same as the antithesis of reality and the idea, or art and nature, and that can be assimilated to the opposition of vinegar and oil, the sweet and the bitter, the fluid and the solid, in a cosmogony of infant peoples.

Posted on 2012-12-23 by Cologero

* * *

White Stag Knight on 2012-12-23 at 11:31 said:

Maurras, must be handled delicately and with dialectic quasi-Rabbinic intellectualism of finesse. He was not condemned by Catholicism without reason. He cannot be the center of our Right Hand Path counter-revolution. He can be but a source of truths to be mined, but no Doctor.

The nationalism of Maurras, in fact, signified in one sense the miasma of international European aristocracy and the fragmentation of Christendom.

We aim to resurrect the Holy Roman Imperium of Christ Rex.

No single nation can exist in self-deifying separatism and claim special privileges.

The Empire is Universal.

Cologero on 2012-12-23 at 12:32 said:

Obviously, White Knight, we can't disagree with you. However, using his own standard, if we add Maurras' assets and deduct his liabilities, we are still in the black. My prime motivation has been this: to show that a pagan non-theist relying on positive science can still discern Tradition. That is because the Logos is made visible in creation. There are many men today in that position who would still nevertheless want to align with Tradition. Maurras shows that honest science does not necessarily have that corrosive effect assumed by the anti-Tradition.

His hyper-nationalism is not the ultimate reality, but remember that the Empire does not deny nor annihilate nationhood. At one point, there was a group around Maurras that floated the idea of an alliance of the Latin-speaking nations. That would have been a start toward reunifying the ecumene. Had that materialized, the role of Romania would have been important in uniting the East and the West.

Dominion on 2012-12-23 at 14:46 said:

Thank you so much for translating this work. I'm beginning to think it would be worth it to learn French simply to read the originals. Seeing as the Action Francaise was of a royalist nature, perhaps there is room here for an article comparing Maurras' view of the royal vs the religious spheres in the social order with those of Evola and Guenon? I would guess that he would approximate Evola to a greater degree, having the Church being more subject to the King, but if there is one thing I have learned from these principles it is that he is not to be underestimated in his depth.

With regards to what you say about the role of nationhood in Tradition, I see the proper view more and more espoused in the "Identitaire" movement that is currently exploding over Europe. They hold the local (city and region), national, and European levels of identity as valid and complementary. I have found (observing it from a distance from across the pond) that there are many in that movement who are familiar with some Traditional works, Evola figuring large (with his shortcomings compared to Guenon or some others causing some problems, admittedly).

Do you think a possibility exists of leading those who are open from a "mere" nationalism to one informed by Tradition?

Jason-Adam on 2012-12-27 at 00:38 said:

Cologero – can you provide some links in English or French explaining in more detail Maurras' plan of reuniting the Latin nations ? I was unaware that he went beyond French nationalism and would like to read more on this.

Cologero on 2012-12-27 at 06:08 said:

Here is an overview: L'union des latins[9].

In Maurras' own words: Les Forces latines[10].

Jason-Adam on 2012-12-27 at 17:41 said:

Thank you, Sir. I've just read both and find myself in agreement with Maurras – one point he made that I never considered before is that the southern Catholic Germans are actually descended from Roman colonists, and the failed Holy Roman Empire was an attempt to Latinise the Germans. I'm finding myself in accord with his notion of Catholicism being part of the Latin race's blood, his version of the continuation of Romanity rings truer than Evola's idea of Germany being the successor to Roma.

[9] http://maurras.net/2011/10/06/union-des-latins/

[10] http://maurras.net/textes/196.html

7

Maurras' Short Articles

7.1 All Soul's Day

Around the second of November, I would like to avoid naming here the living, or rather to be concerned with them only insofar as they themselves are concerned with men who had already departed from life. A melancholy memory is not a simple dream, and nothing deep down is more useful to those who remain than the strong tenor of those who have left.

But perhaps it would be suitable, while on this subject, to make a distinction. There is the universal cult of the dead, of all the dead, of those who had existed, provided that they had belonged to the human race; and there is, closely related, the particular cult, more reserved, prouder, and, in my sense, more beneficial. That renders to the elite among the dead, those whom the positivists call, a little verbosely, "the great types of humanity", and the Catholics, more briefly, the "saints". The first of these cults presents a great drawback; in teaching us to venerate all of defunct humanity, it trains us logically to venerate, en bloc, all of living humanity, that is to say, to make us accept and even venerate the worse

faults that it commits even though we recognize them as much in ourselves as in our neighbours. The second cult shows the opposite benefit; by obliging us to hold the dead as our models, it forces us to select from among these scattered people, hence, indirectly, to make a critique of our own characters: by applying our minds to consider those great dead men, it opens us up to the way of personal exaltation and perfection.

The consequence is that human solidarity, to use that term, must belong much less to the crowd of our predecessors, than to the persons of the past who have realized, in a great way, the fine natural traits of man. Those who pass up the opportunity to serve their great memory, pass up an undoubted opportunity to help themselves, to correct themselves, and to improve themselves.

That said, what to think of the cold and sad silence that has greeted these last few weeks—in the newspapers, in the reviews, everywhere finally where they pride themselves on their thought and style—the great news of the discovery of a newly published book of Bossuet? Regarding the second tract on the États d'oraison ("States of Prayer"), if it had taught nothing new of the opinions and sentiments of the illustrious bishop, if it had been only a sketch, a pale appendix to some known works, it still would have been necessary to honour in it, after two hundred years, some unheard contemplative words of a voice which fills the world. This indifference of the critics and the public, had, moreover, no excuse, and the six chapters published the other day in la Quinzaine by the fortunate author of the discovery, Abbot Levesque of Saint-Sulpice, was worthy of attention and of commentary for the same reason that *Relation sur le quiétisme* ("Relation to quietism"), so fine, so piquant and solid, especially because of the first tract of États d'oraison whose eloquence equals the power of the ideas.

The honour of our times will have been to render to Bossuet his rightful place. We have displaced him from it. First, by literary rancour: reread Paul Albert and the other critics of romanticism, and you will see how

much this great man baffles them. It is that, if it is not right, at least it is possible to contend that a Jean Racine or a Jean de La Fontaine have united a marvellous vigour to their supreme perfection: to deceive the inane, or perhaps by innate taste in reserve, these two poets have disguised their strength under elegance and grace. But this force bursts out divinely in Bossuet. I do not know which imagination was more powerful than his or more allied, for example, to that of Homer; he joins to it a sentiment, an almost dramatic passion: nevertheless, order is never weakened in him. It is not necessary to be astonished if true strength is naturally harmonious and there is always something weak or morbid, even vertiginous, in disorder. The most fanciful of men—Plato, Aristophanes—were the most reasonable, the most sensible, and the finest.

After the romantics, Bossuet bored Renan. Pardon the word, let us rather not apply it to the person of Renan, but to the adjuncts, the dependants, if you like, to the low offices of this illustrious writer: there were in him some parts corrupted by Hegelianism. Bossuet's unswerving logic resisted it. I imagine that it would still resist it if, by some miracle, Bossuet returned among us. Everything that the Germans said against the principles of reason is something confused. They always mixed the orders. All the same, in a superior order, our reason would be defective, there remains an order, the human order, where, in spite of all, it exercises itself supremely. That is what the author of La Synthèse subjective discerned with true genius. The influence of Comte has led the wise public back to Bossuet; as for those who don't have time for reflection, the fortunate intervention of Mr. Brunetière produced around the same time the same happy effect.

So that the most harmonious of men is admired with unanimity.

The silence maintained on the new treasure added to the old treasure by M. Levesque is therefore doubly inexplicable. From where I am writing, I can, by turning a little, see the complete set of Bossuet's books stacked up on the shelves familiar to me, and I have on this table, the His-

toire des Variations, that I can open at my liking, assured of meeting in it the perfection of life from its first pages. Nevertheless, I would not know how to compare for its vivacity, the beautiful freshness of pleasure, that emotion already old to the emotion that the newly discovered chapters have given me.

A statue recently pulled out of the ground, even from an inferior age, touches and moves for an instant with more force than the most beautiful things known. Judge if chance brings to daylight a masterpiece from Phidias' school! We have here a masterpiece from Phidias himself. Space is lacking to justify my sentiment in regard to the profound and subtle ideas exposed in the second tract of the États d'oraison. But I am sure that we will tremble at the simple sound of the eloquence, its rhythm, and its performance.

In the chapter *Que la foi se perd dans l'incompréhensibilité de Dieu* ("Faith is lost in the incomprehensibility of God"):

> It is a doctrine common among the holy Fathers and among theologians, mystical as well as scholastic, that we know God by negation rather than by affirmation; that is to say, that we know well what he is not, but we do not know what he is: so, in order to reach the lofty knowledge of the Divine Being, it is necessary to reject all our ideas and form our consciousness a little closer to the way we form a statue, by removing, from the marble from which it is formed, first one piece and then another, because it is the analogy which they use following the author of the Divine Names. So, they say, in order to know God, it is necessary to deny, in a certain sense, everything that we think of Him and everything that we say about Him, not as false, for it would be an impiety and an atheism to deny that God is holy, eternal, almighty, the "I Am", Father, Son, and Holy Spirit, and, in these three persons, one God: we don't deny, therefore, these things as false, not pleasing to God! But we reject them in some fashion as still poorly proportionate and suitable to the immense perfection of the Di-

> vine Being: so that whatever effort that we make to know Him well, however sublime are the ideas that are presented to our spirits or the thoughts that we try to form from then, we deny that they are equal to his high and impenetrable majesty.

In the chapter *Theology and contemplation of saint Augustine*:

> But among the Fathers where this divine theology seems to me the most highly expressed, it is St. Augustine where he says to God: "I sought you outside, and you were within, I found you there without your entering by any of my senses. You didn't come there with colours or exquisite tastes; you didn't run there with odours or with pleasant sounds and chants. If you are a light, you are a light without a cloud, without sunset, and without body: you are nothing that I see, that I touch, that I sense, that I imagine in my mind, of that which I am: for my spirit, my mind, which is what I find most excellent in myself, learns, unlearns, forgets, loves certain things and then is disgusted by them; and God is not all that because He never changes. In rejecting, then, all those things and all those sense images, and opening only the eyes of the soul, it sees in itself, without any form, a justice which judges it and which it judges not, but by which it judges everything; a truth that slips away, for as little can one come near the sense of it as to touch it.

That is only a translation, a summary, a paraphrase; and genius breaks out in each word. Bossuet, moreover, excels in summaries. And he is perhaps the only classical Christian among whom the crudest citations of the Bible and of the Fathers, even though extremely numerous, do not subsequently result in a blemish in style. He establishes and transforms everything. His example can let us judge the value of modern theories of invention and originality.

But let us cite once more, a single sentence that ends on a charming inflexion: Faith makes it known to the soul that it is made in the image

and likeness of God; this links two things: one, that it is pleased to gather its thoughts to contemplate in them the image of God; the other, that is can not stop in itself, but it is gently attracted and elevated to God, of whom it is the beautiful and living image. Yet, it is a mistake to blame oneself for admiring similar things in Bossuet. His spirit is too far above the sentences thus sketched out! But strength consists in finding the whole in its least objects and, thereby, according to a view loved by Hugo, even the small appears great.

From "Barbarie et Poésie", originally published in *Revue Encyclopédique*, October 31, 1896.

7.2 Remembering the Dead

> This translation of Charles Maurras' *All Soul's Day*[1] originally appeared in Taki's Magazine[2].

On **All Soul's Day**, we honor the memory of the dead, especially those closest to us in our hearts and mind. **Charles Maurras** refers to this as "the universal cult of the dead, of all the dead, of those who had existed, provided that they had belonged to the human race"; this is a subjective memory. Although it is praiseworthy to remember our ancestors, Maurras points out this drawback:

> in teaching us to venerate all of defunct humanity, it trains us logically to venerate, en bloc, all of living humanity, that is to say, to make us accept and even venerate the worse faults that it commits even though we recognize them as much in ourselves as in our neighbours.

[1] `http://www.gornahoor.net/library/AllSoulsDay.pdf`
[2] `http://takimag.com/article/all_souls_day/`

Alongside this, there is an objective memory in the sense that it is part of our experience and, therefore, quite real in the Positivist sense. Maurras describes this cult as:

> more reserved, prouder, and, in my sense, more beneficial. That renders to the elite among the dead, those whom the positivists call, a little verbosely, "the great types of humanity", and the Catholics, more tersely, the "saints".

This form of remembrance has a certain benefit:

> by obliging us to hold the dead as our models, it forces us to select from among these scattered people, hence, indirectly, to make a critique of our own characters: by applying our minds to consider those great dead men, it opens us up to the way of personal exaltation and perfection.

Maurras summarizes:

> The consequence is that human solidarity, to use that term, must belong much less to the crowd of our predecessors, than to the persons of the past who have realized, in a great way, the fine natural traits of man. Those who pass up the opportunity to serve their great memory, pass up an undoubted opportunity to help themselves, to correct themselves, and to improve themselves.

Comte's follower, **Antoine Baumann**, expands on this idea:

> *Humanity* does not mean in any way the whole of men scattered among the living on this planet, nor the simple total of the living and the dead. It is only the group of men who have cooperated in the great human work, those who persist in us, whom we continue, those of whom we are the true debtors, the others being at

times only "parasites" or "producers of manure". This large human elite is not a futile image. It forms what there is of the most real in us. We feel it as soon as we reach down to the secret of our nature. Subjects of mathematical and astronomical facts, subjects of physical facts, chemical facts and the facts of life, we are moreover subjects of special facts in the human family. We depend on our contemporaries. We depend even more on our predecessors. What thinks in us, before us, is the human language, which is not our personal work, but the work of humanity, it is also human reason which preceded us, which surrounds us and anticipates us; it is human civilisation in which a personal contribution, as powerful that it may be, is never but a molecule of a tiny energy in the drop of water added by our contemporaries in the current of this vast river. Actions, thoughts, or feelings, are products of the human soul: our personal soul is there almost for nothing. The true positivist repeats rather like Saint Paul: in ea vivimus, movemur et sumus "in him we live, move and have our being" , and if he put his heart in harmony with his science and his faith, he can only add, in an act of adoration, the slightly modified words from the Psalmist: Non nobis, Domine, non nobis, sed nomini tuo da gloriam! "Not To Us O Lord Not To Us But To Your Name Give Glory"

Auguste Comte explains the objective reality of the **Great Being**:

The most important applications constantly derive from the theories formed in a simple scientific purpose and which often were cultivated during several centuries without producing any practical result. One can cite a very remarkable example of it in the beautiful speculations of Greek geometers on conic sections which, after a long series of generations, served, in determining the renovation of astronomy, to finally lead to the art of navigation to the degree that it attained in these days and to which it would never have appeared without the purely theoretical works of Archimedes and

> Apollonius; so that Condorcet was able to say with reason in this matter: "The sailor whom an exact observation of longitude preserves from the shipwreck owes his life to a theory conceived two thousand years before, by men of genius who had in view simple geometric speculations."

This is the time to bring to mind those "persons of the past" who have, over the course of time, built up the edifice of civilisation, not because they need it, but rather because we do. These persons are not always those who receive the most public adulation, which is often a mask for contemporary ideology. Instead, seek out the neglected and unknown, those whose ideas still live in the Great Being, though they may be suppressed in our time. The religious have their saints and mystics; the knights had the cult of the Nine Worthies[3]; Hermetists recall their own predecessors. There are forgotten men of genius who still affect our lives; do not neglect them.

Posted on 2010-11-01 by Cologero

[3] `http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=331`

8

Other Translations

8.1 Eastern Wisdom and Western Knowledge

by Ananda Coomaraswamy

East and West, *The Crisis of the Modern World*, *Introduction to the Study of Hindu Doctrine*, and *Man and His Becoming*, Luzac, London, (1941-1946) are the first in a series in which the majority of **Rene Guenon**'s works already published in French will appear in English. Another versions of *Man and His Becoming* had appeared earlier. M. Rene Guenon is not an "Orientalist" but what the Hindus would call a "master," formerly resident in Paris, and now for many years in Egypt, where his affiliations are Islamic. His *Introduction general à l'étude des doctrines hindoues* appeared in 1921. As a preliminary to his further expositions of the traditional philosophy, sometimes called the *Philosophia Perennis (et Universalis)* must be understood, for this "philosophy" has been the common inheritance of all mankind without exception), Guenon cleared the ground of all possible misconceptions in two large and rather tedious, but by no means unnecessary, volumes, *The Spiritist Fallacy* (a work for which **Bhagavad Gita**, XVII, 4, "Men of darkness are they who make a

cult of the departed and of spirits," might have served as a motto), and *Theosophy, History of a Pseudo-Religion*.

These are followed by *Man and his Becoming according to the Vedanta* and *The Esoterism of Dante*, *The King of the World*, *St. Bernard*, *East and West* and *Spiritual Authority and Temporal Power*, *The Symbolism of the Cross*, *The Multiple States of Being*, and *Oriental Metaphysics*.

More recently Guenon has published in mimeographed, and subsequently printed, editions *The Reign of Quantity and the Sign of the Times*, and *The Principles of Infinitesimal Calculus*.

In the meantime important articles from Guenon's pen appeared monthly in *La Voile d'Isis*, later *Études Traditionnelles*, a journal of which the appearance was interrupted by the war, but which has been continued as from September-October, 1945. *Études Traditionnelles* is devoted to "La Tradition Perpétuelle et Unanime, révélée tant par les dogmes et les rites des religions orthodoxies que par la langue universelle des symboles initiatiques". The Perpetual and Unanimous Tradition, revealed as much by the dogmas and the rites of the orthodox religions as by the universal language of initiatory symbols. Of articles that have appeared elsewhere attention may be called to "Islamic Esoterism" in "Cahiers du Sud". Excerpts from Guenon's writings, with some comment, have appeared in 'Triveni' (1935) and in the *Visvabharati Quarterly* (1935,1938).

A work by L. De Gaigneron entitled *Vers la connaissance interdite* is closely connected with Guenon's; it is presented in the form of a discussion in which the Atman (Spiritus), Mentalité ("Reason", in the current, not the Platonic, sense), and a Roman abbé take part; the "forbidden knowledge" is that of the gnosis which the modern Church and the rationalist alike reject, though for different reasons — the former because it cannot tolerate a point of view which considers Christianity only as one amongst other orthodox religions and the latter because, as a great Orientalist (Professor A. B. Keith) has remarked, "such knowledge, as is not empirical, is meaningless to us and should not be described as knowledge"

— an almost classical confession of the limitations of the "scientific" position. Guenon's French is at once precise and limpid, and inevitably loses in translation; his subject matter is of absorbing interest, at least to anyone who cares for what Plato calls the really serious things. Nevertheless it has often been found unpalatable; partly for reason already given, but also for reasons that have already been stated, paradoxically enough, by a reviewer of Blakney's Meister Eckhart in the 'Harvard Divinity School Bulletin', who says that, "To an age which believes in personality and personalism, the impersonality of mysticism is baffling; and to an age which is trying to quicken its insight into history the indifference of the mystics to events in time is disconcerting." As for history, Guenon's "he who cannot escape from the standpoint of temporal succession so as to see all things in their simultaneity is incapable of the least conception of the metaphysical order" adequately complements Jacob Boehme's designation of the "history that was once brought to pass" as "merely the (outward) form of Christianity." For the Hindu, the events of the Rgveda are nowever and dateless, and the Krishna Lila "not an historical event"; and the reliance of Christianity upon supposedly historical "facts" seems to be its greatest weakness.

The value of literary history for doxography is very little, and it is for this reason that so many orthodox Hindus have thought of Western scholarship as a "crime": their interest is not in "what men have believed," but in the truth. A further difficulty is presented by Guenon's uncompromising language: "Western civilization is an anomaly, not to say a monstrosity." Of this a reviewer has remarked that "such sweeping remarks cannot be shared even by critics of Western achievements.."

I should have thought that now that its denouement is before our eyes, the truth of such a statement might have been recognized by every unprejudiced European; at any rate Sir George Birdwood in 1915 described modern Western civilization as "Secular, joyless, inane, and self-destructive" and Professor La Piana has said that "What we call our civ-

ilization is but a murderous machine with no conscience and no ideals" and might well have said suicidal as well as murderous. It would be very easy to cite innumerable criticisms of the same kind; Sir S. Radhakrishnan holds for example, that "civilization is not worth saving if it continues on its present foundations," and this it would be hard to deny; Professor A. N. Whitehead has spoke quite as forcibly — "There remains the show of civilization, without any of it realities."

In any case, if we are to read Guenon at all, we must have outgrown the temporally provincial view that has for so long and so complacently envisaged a continuous progress of humanity culminating in the twentieth century and be willing at least to ask ourselves whether there has not been rather a continued decline, "from the stone until now," as one of the most learned men in the U.S.A. once put it to me. It is not by "science" that we can be saved:

> the possession of the sciences as a whole, if it does not include the best, will in some few cases aid but more often harm the owner.
>
> We are obliged to admit that our European culture is a culture of the mind and senses only.
>
> The prostitution of science may lead to world catastrophe.
>
> Our dignity and our interests require that we shall be the directors and not the victims of technical and scientific advance.
>
> Few will deny that the twentieth century thus far has brought us bitter disappointment.
>
> We are now faced with the prospect of complete bankruptcy in every department of life.

Eric Gill speaks of the "monstrous inhumanity" of industrialism, and of the modern way of life, as "neither human nor normal nor Christian... . It is our way of thinking that is odd and unnatural." This sense of frustration is perhaps the most encouraging sign of the times. We have laid

stress on these things because it is only to those who feel this frustration, and not to those who still believe in progress, that Guenon addresses himself; to those who are complacent everything that he has to say will seem to be preposterous.

The reactions of Roman Catholics to Guenon are illuminating. One has pointed out that he is a "serious metaphysician," i.e. one convinced of the truth he expounds and eager to show the unanimity of the Eastern and scholastic traditions, and observes that "in such matters belief and understanding must go together." *Crede ut intelligam* believe in order to understand is a piece of advice that modern scholars would, indeed, do well to consider; it is, perhaps, just because we have not believed that we have not yet understood the East. The same author writes of East and West,

> Rene Guenon is one of the few writers of our time whose work is really of importance ... he stands for the primacy of pure metaphysics over all other forms of knowledge, and presents himself as the exponent of a major tradition of thought, predominantly Eastern, but shared in the Middle Ages by the scholastics of the West ... clearly Guénon's position is not that of Christian orthodoxy, but many, perhaps most, of his theses are, in face, better in accord with authentic Thomist doctrine than are many opinions of devout but ill-instructed Christians.

We should do well to remember that even St. Tomas Aquinas did not disdain to make use of "intrinsic and probable proofs" derived form the "pagan" philosophers.

Gerald Vann, on the other hand, makes the mistake which the title of his review, "Rene Guenon's Orientalism" announces; for this is not another "ism," nor a geographical antitheses but one of modern empiricism and traditional theory. Vann springs to the defense of the very Christianity in which Guenon himself sees almost the only possibility

of salvation for the West; only possibility, not because there is no other body of truth, but because the mentality of the West is adapted to and needs a religion of just this sort. But if Christianity should fail, it is just because its intellectual aspects have been submerged, and it has become a code of ethics rather than a doctrine form which all other applications can and should be derived; hardly two consecutive sentences of some of Meister Eckhart's sermons would be intelligible to an average modern congregation, which does not expect doctrine, and only expects to be told how to behave.

If Guenon wants the West to turn to Eastern metaphysics, it is not because they are Eastern but because this is metaphysics. If "Eastern" metaphysics differed form a "Western" metaphysics — as true philosophy differs from what is often so called in our modern universities — one or the other would not be metaphysics. It is from metaphysics that the West has turned away in its desperate endeavor to live by bread alone, an endeavor of which the Dead Sea fruits are before our eyes. It is only because this metaphysics still survives as a living power in Eastern societies, in so far as they have not been corrupted by the withering touch of Western, or rather, modern civilization (for the contrast is not of East or West as such, but of "those paths that the rest of mankind follows as a matter of course" with those post-Renaissance paths that have brought us to our present impasse), and not to Orientalize the West, but to bring back the West to a consciousness of the roots of her own life and of values that have been transvalued in the most sinister sense, that Guenon asks us to turn to the East.

He does not mean, and makes it very clear that he does not mean, that Europeans ought to become Hindus or Buddhists, but much rather that they, who are getting nowhere by the study of "the Bible as literature," or that of Dante "as a poet," should rediscover Christianity, or what amounts to the same think, Plato ("that great priest," as Meister Eckhart calls him). I often marvel at men's immunity to the *Apology*, *Phaedo* or

the seventh chapter of the *Republic*; I suppose it is because they should not hear, "thought one rose from the dead."

The issue of "East and West" is not merely a theoretical (we must remind the modern reader that from the standpoint of the traditional philosophy, "theoretical" is anything but a term of disparagement) but also an urgent practical problem. Pearl Buck asks,

> Why should prejudices be so strong at this moment? The answer it seems to me is simple. Physical conveyance and other circumstances have forced parts of the world once remote from each other into actual intimacy for which peoples are not mentally or spiritually prepared. ... It is not necessary to believe that this initial stage must continue. If those prepared to act as interpreters will do their proper work, we may find that within another generation or two, or even sooner, dislike and prejudice may be gone. This is only possible if prompt and strong measures are taken by peoples to keep step mentally with the increasing closeness to which the war is compelling us.

But is this is to happen, the West will have to abandon what Guenon calls its "proselytizing fury," an expression that must not be taken to refer only to the activities of Christian missionaries, regrettable as those often are, but of those of all the distributors of modern "civilization" and those of practically all those "educators" who feel that they have more to give than to learn form what are often called the "backward" or "unprogressive" peoples; to whom it does not occur that one may not wish or need to "progress" if one has reached a state of equilibrium that already provides for the realization of what one regards as the greatest purposed of life.

It is as an expression of good will and of the best intentions that this proselytizing fury takes on its most dangerous aspects. To many this "fury" can only suggest the fable of the fox that lost its tail, and persuaded the other foxes to cut off theirs. An industrialization of the East may be

inevitable, but do not let us call it a blessing that a folk should be reduced to the level of a proletariat, or assume that materially higher standards of living necessarily make for greater happiness. The West is only just discovering, to its great astonishment, that "material inducements, that is, money or the things that money can buy" are by no means so cogent a force as has been supposed; "Beyond the subsistence level, the theory that this incentive is decisive is largely an illusion."

As for the East, as Guenon says, "The only impression that, for example, mechanical invention make on most Orientals is one of deep repulsion; certainly it all seems to them far more harmful than beneficial, and if they find themselves obliged to accept certain things which the present epoch has made necessary, they do so in the hope of future riddance ... what the people of the West call 'rising' would be called some 'sinking'; that is what all true Orientals think." It must not be supposed that because so many Eastern peoples have imitated us in self-defense that they have therefore accepted our values; on the contrary, it is just because the conservative East still challenges all the presuppositions on which our illusion of progress rests, that is deserves our most serious consideration.

There is nothing in economic intimacies that is likely to reduce prejudice or promote mutual understanding automatically. Even when Europeans live amongst Orientals, "economic contact between the Eastern and Western groups is practically the only contact there is. There is very little social or religious give and take between the two. Each lives in a world almost entirely closed to the other — and by 'closed' we man not only 'unknown' but more: incomprehensible and unattainable." That is an inhuman relationship, by which both parties are degraded.

Neither must it be assumed that the Orient thinks it important that the masses should learn to read and write. Literacy is a practical necessity in an industrial society, where the keeping of account is all important. But in India, in so far as Western methods of education have not been imposed from without, all higher education is imparted orally, and to have heard

is for more important than to have read. At the same time the peasant, prevented by his illiteracy and poverty from devouring the newspapers and magazines that form the daily and almost the only reading of the vast majority of Western "literates," is, like Hesiod's Boeotian farmers, and still more like the Gaelic-speaking Highlanders before the era of the board schools, thoroughly familiar with an epic literature of profound spiritual significance and a body of poetry and music of incalculable value; and one can only regret the spread of an "education" that involves the destruction of all these things, or only preserves them as curiosities within the covers of books.

For cultural purposed it is not important that the masses should be literate; it is not necessary that anyone should be literate; it is only necessary that there should be amongst the people philosophers (in the traditional, not the modern sense of the word), and that there should be preserved deep respect on the part of laymen for true learning that is the antithesis of the American attitude to a "professor". In these respects the whole East is still far in advance of the West, and hence the learning of the elite exerts a far profounder influence upon society as a whole than the Western specialist "thinker" can ever hope to wield.

It is not, however, primarily with a protection of the East against the subversive inroads of Western "culture" that Guenon is concerned, but rather with the question, What possibility of regeneration, if any, can be envisaged for the West? The possibility exists only in the event of a return to first principles and to the normal ways of living that proceed from the application of first principles to contingent circumstances; and as it is only in the East that these things are still alive, it is to the East that the West must turn. "It is the West that must take the initiative, but she must be prepared really to go towards the East, not merely seeking to draw the East towards herself, as she has tried to do so far. There is no reason why the East should take this initiative, and there would still be none, even if the Western world were not in such a state as to make any effort in this

direction useless. ... It now remains for us to show how the West might attempt to approach the East."

He proceeds to show that the work is to be done in the two fields of metaphysics and religion, and that it can only be carried out on the highest intellectual levels, where agreement on first principles can be reached apart from any propaganda on behalf of or even apology for "Western civilization."

The work must be undertaken, therefore, by an "elite." And as it is here more than anywhere that Guenon's meaning is likely to be willfully misinterpreted, we must understand clearly what he manes by such an elite. The divergence of the West and East being only "accidental," "the bringing of these two portions of mankind together and the return of the West to a normal civilization are really just one and the same thing." An elite will necessarily work in the first place "for itself, since its members will naturally reap from their own development an immediate and altogether unfailing benefit." An indirect result — "indirect," because on this intellectual level one does not think of "doing good" to others, or in terms of "service," but seeks truth because one needs it oneself — would, or might under favorable conditions, bring about "a return of the West to a traditional civilization," i.e. one in which "everything is seen as the application and extension of a doctrine whose essence is purely intellectual and metaphysical."

It is emphasized again and again that such an elite does not mean a body of specialists or scholars who would absorb and put over on the West the forms of an alien culture, nor even persuade the West to return to such a traditional civilization as existed in the Middle Ages. Traditional cultures develop by the application of principles to conditions; the principles, indeed, are unchangeable and universal, but just as **nothing can be known except in the mode of the knower**, so nothing valid can be accomplished socially without taking into account the character of those concerned and the particular circumstances of the period in which they

live.

There is no "fusion" of cultures to be hoped for; it would be noting like an "eclecticism" or "syncretism" that an elite would have in view. Neither would such an elite be organized in any way so as to exercise such a direct influence as that which, for example, the Technocrats would like to exercise for the good of mankind. If such an elite ever came into being, the vast majority of Western men would never know of it; it would operate only as a sort of leaven, and certainly on behalf of rather than against whatever survives of traditional essence in, for example the Greek Orthodox and Roman Catholic domains. It is, indeed, a curious fact that some of the most powerful defenders of Christian dogma are to be found amongst Orientals who are not themselves Christians, or ever likely to become Christians, but recognize in the Christian tradition an embodiment of the universal truth to which God has never nor anywhere left himself without a witness.

In the meantime, Guenon asks, "Is this really 'the beginning of an end' for the modern civilization? ... At least there are many signs which should give food for reflection to those who are still capable of it; will the West be able to regain control of herself in time?" Few would deny that we are faced with the possibility of a total disintegration of culture. We are at war with ourselves, and therefore at war with one another. Western man is unbalanced, and the question, Can he recover himself? is a very real one. No one to whom the question presents itself can afford to ignore the writing of the leading living exponent of a traditional wisdom that is no more essentially Oriental than it is Occidental, though it may be only in the uttermost parts of the earth that it is still remembered and must be sought.

Posted on 2012-10-27 by Cologero

8.2 German Influence on Indology

This is the final chapter of **Rene Guenon**'s *Introduction to the Study of Hindu Doctrines*, which was first published in 1921, right after the end of World War I. It was removed, at the author's request, from subsequent editions, including the version translated into English. It is quite harsh on German scholarship and even on Germans themselves. Moreover, his criticism extends to Europeans in general whose "imagined superiority leads to misbehavior in the world."

I don't believe this chapter is available in English. Even if it is, it is worth repeating.

German Influence It is rather curious to notice that the first Indologists, who were mostly English, without showing any very deep understanding, often said more correct things than those who came after them; no doubt they made many mistakes as well, but which at least were not of a systematic character, and which did not result from a bias, not even unconscious. The English mentality, of course, has no aptitude for metaphysical conceptions, but it does not make any pretension in this respect either, while the German mentality, which is not really better endowed, has the greatest illusions. To realize this, we need only compare what the two peoples have produced in terms of philosophy.

The English mind hardly left the practical order, represented by morality, sociology, and experimental science, represented by the science of psychology which it invented. When the English mind is concerned with logic, it is above all induction that he has in view and to which he gives preponderance over deduction. On the other hand, if we consider German philosophy, we only find in it hypotheses and systems with metaphysical pretensions, deductions from a fanciful starting point, ideas which might seem to be profound when they are simply nebulous; and this pseudo-metaphysics, which is everything that is farthest from true meta-

physics, the Germans claim to find in others, whose conceptions they always interpret according to their own.

Nowhere is this latter fault more invincible than with them, because no other people has such a narrowly systematic mindset. Moreover, the Germans, in this regard, just push defects which are common to the whole European race to the extreme. Their national pride leads them to behave in Europe as Europeans in general, infatuated with their imaginary superiority, behave throughout the world. The extravagance is the same in both cases, with a simple difference in degree. It is therefore natural that the Germans imagine that their philosophers have thought all that it is possible for men to conceive, and no doubt they believe they are doing a great honor to other peoples by assimilating the conceptions of these to this philosophy of which they are so proud.

This does not prevent Schopenhauer from making a ridiculous disguise of Buddhism by making it a kind of "pessimistic" moralism, and from giving the precise measure of his intellectual level by seeking "consolations" in the "Vedanta"; and we see, on the other hand, contemporary orientalists like Deussen claiming to teach the Hindus the true doctrine of Shankaracharya, to whom they quite simply lend the ideas of Schopenhauer! It is because the German mentality, by the very fact that it is an excessive form of the Western mentality, is the opposite of the East and cannot understand anything about it. As it nevertheless claims to understand, it necessarily distorts it. Hence these false assimilations against which we protest on all occasions, and in particular this application of the labels of modern Western philosophy to Eastern doctrines.

When one is incapable of doing metaphysics, it is certainly better not to be concerned with it, and positivism, in spite of its narrowness and incompleteness, seems to us still much preferable to the rantings of pseudo-metaphysics. The greatest mistake of the German orientalists is therefore to be unaware of their incomprehension, and to carry out works of interpretation which have no value, but which are imposed on all of

Europe and very easily succeed in doing making themselves authoritative, because other peoples have nothing to oppose or to compare to it, and also because these works surround themselves with an apparatus of erudition which strongly impresses people who have a strong superstitious respect to for certain methods.

These methods, moreover, are also of Germanic origin, and it would be quite unfair not to recognize in the Germans the very real qualities which they possess in the matter of erudition: the truth is that they excel in the composition of dictionaries, grammars, and those voluminous works of compilation and bibliography which require nothing more than memory and patience. It is extremely unfortunate that they did not fully specialize in this kind of work which is very useful to consult on occasion, and which, appreciably, saves time for those who are capable of doing other things. What is hardly less regrettable is that these same methods, instead of remaining the prerogative of the Germans, to whose temperament they were particularly suited, have spread to all European universities, and especially in France, where they are considered to be only "scientific", as if science and erudition were one and the same thing. In fact, as a consequence of this deplorable state of mind, scholarship comes to usurp the place of true science.

The abuse of cultivated scholarship for itself, the false belief that it can suffice to impart understanding of ideas, all of this, among Germans, can still be understood and excused to some extent; but, among peoples who do not have the same special aptitudes, we can only see in them the effect of a servile tendency to imitation, a sign of an intellectual decadence which it is high time to remedy, if we do not want to let it turn into a definitive decline.

The Germans very skillfully prepared the intellectual supremacy they dreamed of, by imposing both their philosophy and their methods of scholarship. Their Orientalism is, as we have just said, a product of the combination of these two elements. What is remarkable is how these

things have become instruments in the service of national ambition; it would be quite instructive, in this regard, to study how the Germans were able to take advantage of the fanciful hypothesis of "Aryanism", which they had moreover not even invented.

We do not believe, for our part, in the existence of an "Indo-European" race, even if we do not wish to persist in calling it "Aryan", which makes no sense. But what is significant is that German scholars have given this supposed race the denomination of "Indo-Germanic", and that they have taken all their care to make this hypothesis plausible by supporting it with multiple ethnological and above all philological arguments. We do not wish to enter into this discussion at this point. We will only point out that the real resemblance which exists between the languages of India and Persia and those of Europe is by no means the proof of a community of race.

To explain it, it suffices that the ancient civilizations that we know of were originally brought to Europe by some elements relating to the source from which the Hindu and Persian civilizations directly proceeded. We know, in fact, how easy it is for a tiny minority, under certain conditions, to impose its language, with its institutions, on the mass of a foreign people, even though it is ethnically absorbed in it in a short time. A striking example is that of the establishment of the Latin language in Gaul, where the Roman presence, except in a few southern regions, was never more than negligible. The French language is undoubtedly of more or less pure Latin origin, and yet the Latin elements entered only a very small part in the ethnic formation of the French nation; the same is also true for Spain. On the other hand, the "Indo-Germanic" hypothesis is all the less valid since the Germanic languages have no more affinity with Sanskrit than other European languages. It can only serve to justify the assimilation of Hindu doctrines to German philosophy; but, unfortunately, this supposition of an imaginary kinship does not stand the test of the facts, and nothing is in reality more dissimilar than a German and

a Hindu, intellectually as well as physically, if not even in more ways.

The conclusion that emerges from all of this is that, in order to obtain interesting results, it is necessary to first get rid of this influence which for too long has weighed so heavily on Orientalism; and, although it is hardly possible for some individuals to break free from methods which constitute for them inveterate mental habits, we hope that, in general, recent events will be a favorable occasion for this liberation. However, let us understand our thought: if we want the disappearance of German influence in the intellectual field, it is because we consider it harmful in itself, and independent of certain historical contingencies which do not exist and change nothing. So it is not these contingencies that make us wish that the influence in question disappear, but we must take advantage of the state of mind that they have determined.

In the intellectual order, the only one we are dealing with here, sentimental concerns do not have to be taken into consideration. German conceptions today are worth exactly what they were worth a few years ago, and it is ridiculous to see men who had always professed a boundless admiration for German philosophy to suddenly start to denigrate it under the pretext of a patriotism which has nothing to do with these things. Fundamentally, this is little better than more or less consciously altering scientific or historical truth for reasons of national interest, precisely as the Germans are accused of doing.

For us, who owe nothing to Germanic intellectuality, who have never had the slightest esteem for pseudo-metaphysics in which it delights, and who have never accorded to erudition and its special procedures more than the most relative value and importance, we are very much at our ease to say what we think about it. And we would have said absolutely the same thing even if the circumstances had been quite different, but perhaps with less chance of agreeing in this with a generally prevalent trend. We will only add that, especially as regards France, what is at present most to be feared is that one escapes German influence only to fall under other

influences which would be hardly less fatal. Reacting against the spirit of imitation therefore appears to us to be one of the first conditions for a true intellectual recovery: it is not a sufficient condition, no doubt, but it is at least a necessary, and even indispensable, condition.

Posted on 2021-07-04 by Cologero

* * *

Arthur Konrad on 2021-07-05 at 05:44 said:

First things first:

Whosoever aspires to be dabbling in the black arts must at the very least be able to read a language in which it is possible to communicate the music of things. Which is to say, Germans, as well as the Slavic peoples (with whom they share many mental attributes) are at a disadvantage from the onset. Among the latter, only the Russian language is an exception, and how perceptive of otherworldly things have the Russians always been! The rest of them have been derived from the speech of the folk, apparently, to satisfy the needs of both practicality and national-romantic fervour.

But alas, the 'language of the people' is for issuing curt agricultural commands and managing domestic affairs, not for communicating the highest mystical teaching. That is why among the Eastern Slavs, the clergy thought it prudent to preserve the Church Slavonic, a true liturgical language. People like to say 'Oh, but the German poetry!'. But German poetry is valued for its intellectual content, which is only one part of poetry. That being said, German is the most bastardized of all Germanic tongues, which really goes against all common wisdom, and conversely, the Russian is the most pristine of the Slavic ones.

As for me, if I haven't learned English my mental development would have been altogether stunted, what with my ears condemned to hearing only that which can be communicated in this clumsy, unwieldy linguistic apparatus which is called my mother tongue. For that I can thank globalism and capitalism.

Max on 2021-07-05 at 18:05 said:

Perhaps it could be profitable to narrowly systematize Guénon's pure Latin thoughts, if not even fitting them into some form of compilation. Takeaways:

The German mentality has the greatest illusions.

The Germans always interpret other's conceptions according to their own.

No other people has such a narrowly systematic mindset.

The Germans imagine that they have thought everything that it is possible for men to conceive.

The Germans believe that they are doing a great honour by assimilating other people's conceptions.

The other more superstitious peoples of Europe are easily fooled by German methods of erudition.

It is unfortunate that the Germans did not specialize in being Guénon's personal secretary – they could have been useful on occasion.

Germans excel in things that require nothing more than memory and patience.

Scholarship has come to usurp true science.

The Germans very skillfully prepared the intellectual supremacy of their dreams.

Guénon knows how easy it is for a tiny minority to impose its language and institutions on a mass of a foreign people.

Germanic has no more affinity with Sanskrit than other European languages.

The kinship is an imaginary supposition anyway.

Intellectually, nothing is more dissimilar than a German and a Hindu.

Physically, nothing is more dissimilar than a German and a Hindu.

If not even in more ways, nothing is more dissimilar than a German and a Hindu.

It is hardly possible for some individuals to break free from Germanic methods, which for them constitute inveterate mental habits.

Guénon hopes that certain events will nevertheless present a favorable occasion for the liberation from the German mentality.

German influence is harmful independently of certain historical contingencies, which do not exist, and would change nothing even if they did.

Guénon owes nothing to Germanic intellectuality.

In the intellectual order, sentimental concerns do not have to be taken into consideration.

8.3 Lohengrin

This is a chapter from *The Middle Ages* by **Karl Heyer**.

In the knowledge of the Mysteries it is known that the great leaders of mankind, the initiates, are those who help humanity take a new step in development. Lohengrin is the messenger of the Holy Grail. He appears before medieval consciousness as the great leader and initiate who takes

mankind a step further during the middle part of the Middle Ages. He brought the culture of the towns, he inspired the citizenry as they came into being. This is the Lohengrin individuality: and Elsa of Brabant is nothing but a symbol of the medieval folk soul who is to take a further step of development under the influence of Lohengrin. The legend of this progress in human history is beautifully and movingly portrayed.

By the question she asks from curiosity, Elsa brings about the disappearance of the initiate. This expresses the increasing earthly darkening of consciousness of the people who find their path of development in the towns. Materialism sets in, and only centuries later will this darkened consciousness, that has, however, set human beings free, once more receive a call from the spiritual world, a call for further great changes of consciousness coming from the continuing, though transformed stream of the Holy Grail.

The fertile seeds of the modern economic realm, as it later grew on capitalist, bourgeois foundations during the centuries of the fifth post-Atlantean era, were certainly sown in the Middle Ages. The same cannot be said, however, of the modern state. Its roots lie the territories of the princes who gradually began to organise their states with the help of legally trained civil servants. This tendency was based on the countryside, not on the towns which were often engaged in direct dispute with the princes. With regard to the time beginning around the fifteenth century, Rudolf Steiner pointed to the following:

> People in the towns were proud of their individuality and freedom, as may be seen in the portraits that have come down to us from those days... But the village communities remained outside. The power of the territorial princes made itself felt. People in the villages who gradually found themselves in opposition to the towns found their leaders among the ones who took their part, or said they would take their part, against the towns.

Under the influence of pressure from the surrounding countryside

the towns became a part of wider administrative structures that embodied the principles of Roman law. The modern state came into being. It was formed working inwards towards the towns from the surrounding countryside. What conquered the towns from the surrounding countryside was a juridical Latin or Roman element that was beginning to emerge and had indeed grown so powerful that there was no longer any chance for another stream that was struggling to come to the surface among the rural populations. In England and Bohemia, for example this was the stream of Wycliffe and Huss, and the Bohemian Brethren. None of this managed to take hold. The only thing that really succeeded in gaining the upper hand was the Roman administrative element.

Posted on 2022-09-07 by Cologero

9

Some Evola's Translations

9.1 Evola's Advice to the Pope

> On the occasion of the visit of Pope Benedict XVI to the USA, it may be appropriate to quote Evola on the situation of the Church just after Vatican II and on its prospects to become an authentic force of Tradition.
>
> This is from the conclusion of the chapter "Esoteric Catholicism" in his work *Mask and Face of Contemporary Spirituality*.

Nominally, the pontificate, an institution that was already existent in ancient Rome, is part of Catholicism, and stands at the center of the Church and at the top of her hierarchy. But we must ask what subsists in it of its primal function and of Tradition on the whole. The prophetic hope of a Jaochim of Fiore[1] in the coming of a "angelic pope" having almost the marks of an initiate and inaugurating a new "Reign", that of the acting, vivifying, and living Holy Spirit, has remained a utopian illusion. And if we want to adapt ourselves to the contingencies of recent times,

[1] https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Joachim_of_Fiore

in particular the figures of the two most recent pontiffs, John XXIII and Paul VI — with the climate of "aggiornamento" and modernization, with the increasing aversion toward Catholic Integralism[2] and toward so-called "residual medievalism" — seem to definitively seal a disastrous balance sheet.

So the conditions for which we can give a somewhat positive response to the issue we formulated, viz., the possibility of Catholicism to furnish what many sought elsewhere, appears to be nonexistent, at least if we consider the large picture. Yet so often this search has pushed them into the confusions and errors of neo-spiritualism. Given what we have said, it is problematic that, in spite of everything, the Church, the "mystical body of Christ", is the carrier and administrator of a true supernatural power objectively acting through rites and sacraments, of which it can benefit those who become its members, hoping thereby to experience beyond the confessional religion and not seeing the paramount goal in so-called "holiness".

One can nevertheless recognize that Catholicism contains, in spite of everything, traces of a wisdom that can serve as the basis for an "esoteric" dimension of various elements. One exponent of "integral traditionalism" had this to say:

> The fact that the representatives of the Catholic Church understand so little of their own doctrines here he is referring to their inner dimension must not make it such that we ourselves demonstrate the same incomprehension.

Otherwise, all the impediments and all the limitations appear difficult to remove. Leaving priestly Catholicism out of consideration, we could refer to the ascetic Catholic in regard, above all, to the ancient monastic traditions, to that which concerns, if not an initiation, at least an inte-

[2] https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Integralism

rior discipline that looks toward an opening to transcendence and an approach to the supernatural. But even in this case, the difficult work of purification and essentialization would be imposed, given the co-presence of devotional elements and specifically Christian complexes through which it is perhaps difficult to gather up valid tools for interior action without including the knowledge of what other traditions offer.

A Catholicism that is raised up to the level of a truly universal, unanimous, and perennial tradition where faith can be integrated into a metaphysical realization, the symbol integrated into the path to awakening, the rites and sacraments into acts of power, dogmas into expressions of an absolute and infallible consciousness because it is beyond human and, as such, alive in beings unbound from terrestrial chains through an ascesis, and where the pontificate recovers its primal mediating function — such a Catholicism could supplant every "spiritualism", both present and future.

But observing the reality is this anything more than a dream?

Posted on 2008-04-18 by Cologero

9.2 Julius Evola on Esoteric Catholicism

> Today with difficulty, if not exceptionally in some close to dangerous existential crises, the potentiality of Christianity at its beginnings as that "tragic doctrine of salvation" can be re-actualized. The problem is not set and we even say without reticence that if anyone who has known, for some time, nothing other than the vainest constructions of philosophy and the secular plebeian university culture of today or the contaminations of the various contemporary individualisms, aestheticisms, and romanticisms, would "convert" to Catholicism and would experience truly the faith at least, with a total commitment and possibly in a "sacri-

ficial" sense, that would signify not an abdication but rather, in spite of everything, a progress.

From *Maschera e Volto dello Spiritualismo Contemporaneo*

Posted on 2011-03-31 by Aeneas

* * *

`Cologero on 2012-12-21 at 09:20 said:`

Alex, we here at Gornahoor have gone through a lot of trouble to make Evola's work available, including much of his correspondence. At this point, there are several hundred thousand words of text, but there is a search feature available plus google indexes everything here.

Since you seem to be a recent visitor, I'll make you aware of this text by Julius Evola: *Esoteric Catholicism and Integral Traditionalism*[3]. So obviously your grasp of his work has limitations. This is not a criticism, since we all have limiatations; keep that in mind whenever and wherever you read anything.

We have elucidated several hermeneutic principles. First is that, regarding Guenon and Evola, Guenon is the Master and Evola the pupil. This is not just our position, Evola himself admits it. In their correspondence over decades, Evola went to Guenon for advice, but never the reverse. A careful reading of our texts will reveal inconsistencies in Evola over the years. Evola seemed to have, as Guenon points out, certain prejudices that colored his opinions, as well as ambitions to be academically acceptable, something Guenon did not care about. Also, Evola was never initiated into anything, so we must take his ipse dixit pronouncements with a grain of salt.

So let's start with Guenon. He addresses the Christian tradition in several of his works and understands its esoteric origins. Moreover, he points out that such works as Dante's Divine Comedy and the Romance of the Rose are esoteric texts. So anyone with the proper understanding can certainly see that there definitely is an "esoteric dimension" in Catholicism, at least as it was understood in the Middle Ages, which is really all we are interested in here.

Another hermeneutic principle is to look at whether a teaching is consistent with the metaphysics of Tradition. We see that in the Middle Ages, there was an understanding of the different levels of the soul, that there is an intellect that is superior to the rational mind, that there is a cosmic order, that the persons in society fall generally into a caste-like division of

[3] `http://www.gornahoor.net/library/EsotericCatholicism.pdf`

functions, and so on. We see this all in the spiritual tradition of the Middle Ages. Not even Evola denies that the European Middle Ages was a Traditional society. Obviously, this was not the result of an accident, but indicates the existence of an esoteric tradition that manifested in what we see as its outward forms.

Ultimately, how does it help you if someone tells you there was an esoteric society in Prague in 1647 or some such thing? This is all mechanical thinking and can only result in the simulacra of authentic esoteric understanding. Your starting point must always be self-knowledge and self-understanding, to see how your mind works, where your thoughts come from, how desires arise, and so on. As your own consciousness becomes more ordered, it will be easier to understand esoteric texts.

Jason-Adam on 2012-12-22 at 01:47 said:

I apologise if I intrude but several of Alex's points are in error :

1. The Holy Grail is not of pagan origin but is an esoteric representation of the eucharist. I recommend strongly reading AE Waite's work of the Grail to understand its role as a symbol of inner Christianity.

2. Guenon did admit the existence of initiation in Christianity but that it was no longer open to all as the organisations in question were withdrawn from the world. With time that could change.

3. Evola was indeed quite inconsistent because at the end of his life, in Orientations, he admitted that the Church held to the positions of the Syllabus of Errors, then he would support the Church. In other words Evola was of the same opinion as the late Archbishop Lefebrve.

4. Alex, I believe your development would be aided by reading the works of Jean Borella...

Mihai on 2012-12-22 at 09:56 said:

The Grail has its antecedents in ancient Celtic legends and traditions and it was considered a pre-figuration of the Eucharist, thus transposed in Christian terminology.

Also, Waite is an author that can hardly be taken seriously, given his connections with "organisations" such as The Golden Dawn.

Guenon actually reviewed that very book in an article which is part of *Symbols of the sacred science*.

Cologero on 2012-12-22 at 17:47 said:

Alex: Guenon has written extensively about initiatic organizations in the West, which he claimed existed up until a few centuries ago. He also made a rather surprising revelation in one of his letters to Evola. Guenon also explained his conversion to Islam, which is probably not what you think. All that is documented here, and in his books, so perhaps you can comment on specifics.

You have a misunderstanding of initiation or tradition, by confusing the Tradition with the various outward forms it may take. What is your purpose in that if not polemical? If you want to strut your stuff, then explain why the Divine Comedy is not indicative of initiatory knowledge? Guenon certainly thought it was, and if he was wrong about that, how can we trust him on anything else?

Evola, unfortunately, mixes up non-traditional ideas with his own philosophical "system". That is what makes him appealing, and we add, comprehensible, to certain kinds of minds. He is good on the criticism of the modern world, but unreliable on anything of a positive nature.

Logres on 2012-12-22 at 23:07 said:

Alex said "That doesn't mean they were contained inside the main Christian religion... "

I don't understand this point of view – it sounds as if you are saying "unless so-and-so exoteric religion has organized within itself, as an institution (albeit a secret one, or a "hidden one"), which is sort of an acknowledged 'state secret', then that religion cannot be said to 'contain' an esoteric tradition".

Those seem like very loaded terms – granted, no one is arguing that the exoteric Christian religion did everything it could to foster esotericism in the West – if it had done this, it would either

a) be esoteric itself

b) the exclusive product of said esoteric society

I am not sure if any religion would fit category b, and choice a seems to undercut the idea of "religion" to begin with.

Instead, Christianity seems to have been a hybrid or amalgamation of sorts, a "Platonism for the masses" or (as Borella put it) a sort of esotericism made into exoteric religion. Perhaps one can disagree with the "gambit" of doing this, but I am not sure what the point would be – every possibility will have to manifest, and this possibility was certainly latent in any attempt to inter-relate esoteric mystery with exoteric dogma.

Jason-Adam on 2012-12-22 at 23:27 said:

As a way of relation, it must be said that the esoteric-exoteric conflict which exists in Christianity also exists in other traditional belief systems – in Islam many exoteric Sunnis and Shia believe Sufism to be heretical and Sufis have been persecuted from time to time. In China and Korea exoteric Confucians at time persecuted esoteric Taoists and Buddhists. Evolians are holding Christianity to an imaginary high standard no religion in the world is up to par on. Ultimately we are dealing with the prejudice of a Dadaist and his heavy metal fan followers who despise their ancestries and cover up their nihilism in pseudo-academic effete jargon.

Now to return to the nature of Christianity, it is indeed Platonism for the masses as a philosophy professor of mine also put it, Schuon also agreed on the notion of esoteric made

exoteric. More to the point, Boris Mouravieff shows that Christianity is not simply another form of the tradition but it is the completion and fulfillment of all traditions. Christianity is the universal religion to unite all men under God's kingdom.

One word of advice to students I should add – instead of focusing solely on politics as Evolians tend to do, one should study the art of a particular time and place to know the inner feeling and dynamic of said society. The Christian Mediaeval West had art based on the theme of transcendence, whereas the Classical art preceeding and the Renaissance art following it were human-based art styles. Art history matches prefectly with Guenon's interpretation of Christianity as restorer of Western tradition from Greco-Roman degeneracy and the decline of the Church is the decline of the west... .

Mihai on 2012-12-23 at 06:09 said:

@Alex:

Try to look a little into what the Christian East contains.

Try Dionysius the Areopagite, Maxim the Confessor, Gregory Palamas, John of the Ladder as well as many other saints whose teachings have been collected in the Philokalia. The Hesychastic Way, the way of the Heart, is the very core of Christianity and represents an integral Christian esoterism, without it being mixed with non/pre-Christian elements, as was the case with Christian Hermeticism and the Grail.

I agree that Catholicism has tended, with each passing century, to cultivate a more and more rationalist approach to religion, which lead to the numerous problems that have sprung in the West, beginning with the very idea behind modernity itself.

Also, you have to understand that Evola is no authority when discussing the Christian tradition. Some of the arguments he brings in that chapter posted by Cologero are of the kind that only a rationalist academic critic would make.

Evola's approach to spirituality, also has some flaws, some only in particulars, but a few in essential matters, which cannot be passed over.

One such example is his view of spiritual as something "impersonal".

Logres on 2012-12-23 at 15:01 said:

Alec, those are good recommendations by Mihai – everyone's been argued with on this Forum – it's part of who we are – iron sharpening iron. You might be interested in the Hesychasm controversy that erupted around Barlaam, who denied "navel-gazing" : the Eastern Church strongly defended not only the ideal, but the specific practices. http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Barlaam_of_Seminara

Cologero has done a lot of work digging up obscure Christian teachings and examining them in light of Tradition – the consensus on this Forum is against you, so it's a rough, uphill

row to how, because it's not a religious, but an intellectual consensus, between those of widely varied practice and background.

Cologero is right to emphasize a certain purity of will and intuition here – you find what you seek. What needs to happen, as soon as possible, is that Traditionalists begin reweaving the garment of God, which has been ripped asunder. It exposes (to the casual eye) the project to the accusation that we are cherry-picking for a special thesis, but this is something deeper than a will-based and relativistic reshaping of history "as we would like it to be" – it is the Hermetic method of seeing below the surface, and discerning the Logos at work. The Church has a lot to answer for, and judgement starts at the household of God; but we have the critical evidence and the criticism, which only sets the task before us: to see deeper into the mysteries. As you do so, you will no doubt come upon "things" others are not aware of – test the spirits, and keep going. But don't take a starting point as an ending point, and shut the Book. Keep going.

Logres on 2012-12-23 at 15:03 said:

Also, as regards Evola, one learns (or should learn) more from the errors of genius, than the "correct thinking" of the mediocre. That is the approach one should have with Evola.

Senko on 2012-12-23 at 21:38 said:

Alex, Charbonneau-Lassay, who was a really orthodox Catholic was the depositary of the Order of the Paraclite, that was a "mainstream" Catholic initiatic order. By the way, in this issue I have to agree with Reyor and Borella, the very Sacraments are meant to be initiatic, so, for those qualified and aware of their nature they are initiatic, for the rest, they appear as exoteric, though the initiatic influences are still there, even if wasted or not "used".

Senko on 2012-12-23 at 21:41 said:

Mihai,

You are right pointing to the Orthodox East, but if you let me, I'll add that all this can be used in the West too. My parrish priest (I'm Catholic) taught me Prayer of the Heart, and I used to discuss with him so Orthodox and Hermetic authors (even Guenón a few times)

Logres on 2012-12-23 at 22:16 said:

Alex: I am not so sure you just asked a question, you also actually made the assertion:

"I certainly agree the European Middle Ages was a traditional society, but Christianity in itself never had an initiatic system... "

Mihai on 2012-12-24 at 02:12 said:

You are certainly lucky to have found a parish priest who is open towards things like Hermetism and esoteric matters in general.

Nowadays, Christian priests (both in the East and in the West) who have an integral knowledge of the very heart of Christian teachings are hard to find, but not impossible.

Jason-Adam on 2012-12-27 at 00:33 said:

1. When dealing with matters of truth or falsehood emotions play no role in the decision, Julius Evola was a seeker after truth and a lover of order, as such we are all united in the same endeavour, thus I respect Baron Evola as a man who offered sometime profound insights. However he sadly was infected with the spirit of rebellion which created the modern world he despised and he never quite shook off his Dadaist past, his hatred of Christianity being part of said rebellion. However, at various times in his life, he seems quite close to the truth. I've learned over the years to sense a writer's inner feelings that he tries to disguise in his words and I can tell that for all his Stoic front he put on, Evola was hollow and looking for what he could not find. If only he had lost a little pride, as God Himself suggested with the wound in 195, he could have found liberation in Catholicism.

The respect I have for a tragic hero such as Evola does not extend to those degenerate pariahs who use his name to justify their antisocial and destructive behaviour. It must be pointed out, as I am surprised Cologero hasn't yet, that Guenon clearly said in La crise du monde moderne that a dead tradition can not be revived once an organisation has no successors to its spiritual power – we can all agree that paganism has no valid chain of initiation that go back to pre-Christian times – and as such Evola did not advocate restoring something he knew could not be done but instead he believed in abstract principles with the hope that revelation would come at a future date.

And one more note – in the piece Cologero translated above Evola actually said that on the vulgar level it is correct to defend Catholicism from other spiritualities in the West for foreign beliefes divorced from their places of origin are prey to becoming agents of the countertradition, as we can see today in various perversions of Brahmanism, Buddhism etc etc... .

Cologero on 2012-12-27 at 06:38 said:

Very well put, Jason-Adam. It is not up to me to say everything, but anyone with an objective mind can put things together as you have. On the positive side, Evola has been instrumental in leading many to see the shortcomings of the modern world. That, of course, includes the existing spiritual traditions which seem far from what they used to be. I believe that I have documented sufficiently how the spiritual worldview of 1000 years ago differs significantly from what is commonly held today. Perhaps you can understand why Evola was so reluctant to associate himself with its contemporary forms.

Unfortunately, that left him in a precarious position, a "traditionalist" with no Tradition. He knew paganism could not be restored; that is why he was so harsh in his criticism of neo-paganism. From his correspondence with Guenon, we can see that even into his 50s, he was

still searching for an initiation or tradition, even through marginal figures. That is sad.

His attitude toward Dadaism is quite strange. Clearly, it was a revolutionary movement; we can understand why a young man would have been attracted to it, but would have dropped it after finding Tradition. He seems to have done so, since he associated Dada, and its Romanian founder, with "cultural Marxism", as we showed in an essay written in the 1930s that we translated. Yet in his spiritual autobiography, he retracts himself and goes on to praise Tristan Tzara. Then there is that rather sad interview with him floating around on youtube where he shows great joy in his association with Dada. To shock the bourgeoisie is a left wing sport.

Evola often wrote about the inner spiritual combat. It should not be necessary to point out that there is an abyss between writing about it and actually engaging in it. At this point, it is no longer sufficient to simply quote Evola as an "inspiration"; our inspiration needs to come from a higher source.

`Jason-Adam on 2012-12-27 at 17:49 said:`

One blessing in disguise I think Vatican II has brought is that in the fight against it, traditionalist Catholics have been inspired to rebirth the Mediaeval spirit in themselves and not remain passive as too many Catholics had become by the 1930s-1940s. While the circle of traditional Catholicism is quite tiny, we do not know yet if they may amount to something more in the future... ... ...

Evola I think had 3 phases in his life – the initial revolutionary period in the 20s, his shift to conservatism in the 30s and 40s, and then his "anarchist/active nihilist" post-war return to his youth in the 50s and 60s. Even yet though, as late as 1974 he was writing that he hoped the Church could hold Spain together after Franco's death... ...

9.3 Giuliano Imperatore

In the November 1940 issue of *La Vita Italiana*, Julius Evola, writing under the pseudonym "Arthos", addressed the ancient concept of race in the article "Sulle origini e sul doppio volto del razzismo". We here are interested in the Emperor Julian, known as the Apostate. In this article, Evola aligns himself with Julian and states his opposition to the scientistic, genetic view of the origins of races, nations, and castes.

Flavio Claudio Giuliano[4] was the last of the pagan Roman emperors, the nephew of Constantine, who had established Christianity as the religion of the Empire. After several successful military campaigns against the Germans and Gauls, Julian became Emperor following the death of his cousin Constantius and resided in Constantinople, the seat of the Eastern part of the Empire. In the tradition of Marcus Aurelius, Julian was a philosopher-king. Although raised as a Christian, he abdicated under the influence of neo-platonic philosophy[5], which he studied in Athens (and was the classmate of two future saints: St. Basil the Great and St. Gregory). Apparently, he was initiated into the Eleusinian Mysteries and Mithras. As Emperor, he tried to govern on these three planks:

- Roman Tradition
- Hellenic Culture
- Neoplatonic philosophy

In short, we have a unique man: warrior, philosopher, emperor, initiate who supported the fundamental supporting principles of Western civilization. So what went wrong? Julian was not content to be non-Christian; he became anti-Christian. This led him to rule by force and violence, something Evola has warned against. He forced Christians out of state administrative duties and created martyrs, so any positive contributions he made were forever forgotten under the rubric of Julian the Apostate. A more cautious man may have noticed that his program was already in effect.

- **Roman Tradition**. He was concerned about the parallel hierarchy in the Church that mirrored the leadership hierarchy. Well,

[4] http://it.wikipedia.org/wiki/Flavio_Claudio_Giuliano

[5] http://www.traditioninaction.org/Cultural/A014cpManualCivility_Bearing.htm

because of the hierarchy, the Catholic church was able to sustain Roman tradition and law well into the Middle Ages.

- **Hellenic Culture**. He forbade the Christian schools from teaching Greek literature. This just isolated the Christians from Hellenic culture. Prior to that, Homer's epic poems were considered divinely inspired, Alexander was considered a saint, and Plato a revealer of divine Truth.

- **Neoplatonic philosophy**. Christian theology was founded on Neoplatonism and should have been encouraged.

Although he himself did not believe in the existence of the Roman gods (he was a monotheist), he nevertheless tried to re-establish their cult. The problem is that once the noble lie is no longer believed, you cannot just will it back into existence. All that is now moot, in any case, since the so-called Reformation of the Northern peoples did much to destroy the triple foundation of Western civilization. So let's move on to Evola's points. Evola summarizes Julian's position:

> Against the Christian conception of the generation of men from a single couple, this emperor held to the doctrine of multiple creations, that is, of the diverse origins of men, unequal in race and disposition in the primordial times of the immortal gods. This idea reflects traditions very familiar to the ancient aryan peoples, which accounts for the differences not only of race, but also of castes and lineages or nations, *stirpe* , by fundamentally distinct divine or demonic symbolic figures.

Thus, in his monotheism and polygenism, Julian is aligned with the theories of Herman Wirth[6]. It is important to note here that Julian claims

[6] `https://gornahoor.net/library/UltimaThule.pdf`

that races, nations, and even castes have their origin in spiritual differences, *not* because of genetic factors. This is why Evola quotes him approvingly as one of the advocates of the Traditional doctrine of spiritual races. The modern mind can see origins only in term of time, in the past. So to them, the origins of man appear to be singular from the genetic perspective; even more absurdly, the genetic view would trace man's origin to the orangutan[7].

Evola next addresses Thomas Campanella's City of the Sun[8]. Although the City is based on traditional principles, such as rule by the philosopher-king and solarity, Evola notices the beginning of a more modern idea of race. For the Solarians, breeding is planned in the same way that horses or dogs are bred. This Evola criticizes as a rationalistic and mechanical approach. Evola then relates Campanella's "solar race" to the the Aryan-Hyperborean "super-race", and to the conception in the Middle Ages:

> the idea of race, united from the beginning to the idea of a public service, constituted one of the fundamental conditions of the nobility of the Middle Ages; a condition considered so natural, that no one thought of having to express it in words, much less in an "myth" or a theory. Let's keep in mind that, in later periods, "science", in the modern sense, appears always as the enemy of this true aristocracy, faithful to the idea of race up until the period of the Enlightenment, the precise point where the scientistic myth, in strict connexion Masonic agitations, helped it to dig its grave.

Posted on 2011-03-15 by Cologero

* * *

[7] https://gornahoor.net/?p=1604

[8] https://gornahoor.net/?p=518

EXIT on 2011-03-16 at 09:50 said:

Actually, Julian emphasized the differences in races and nations due to the national gods who were subordinate to the supreme god (thus, contrary to what you have stated, he did believe in the gods), but the actual existence of these differences are what really matters, and because of these differences he rejected Christian universalism which he considered racial treason and supported the ancestral traditions. Christianity, he said, was a wicked fiction. It mixes Jewish mentalities with misunderstood Aryan teachings, steals quotes from the mouths of gentiles, rewords them, then places it all into the mouth of a fictional messiah which is presented as historical fact. If you ask me Julian was not forceful enough in dealing with this false religion. This modern anti-power mentality is wholly foreign to true European character. It was Heraclitus who said that "Strife is the father and king of all... it is necessary to understand that war is universal, and order is fighting, and everything comes about through fighting and necessity" for "the lightning bold steers all things."

Cologero on 2011-03-16 at 12:49 said:

"Belief" is the word in question. He didn't accept a literal belief in the stories. To repeat Evola, which would be unnecessary to careful readers, races are the accounted for by "fundamentally distinct divine or demonic symbolic figures"

So we see conjoined "divine" with "symbolic figures" ... the gods are "symbolic figures" which is all we implied. That, plus monotheism, makes Julian's "religion" something other than the traditional cult. Again, exactly what we claimed.

So all you show that Julian had his opinions, but was ineffective in his project ... again what we said. There are alternate ways to win the battle and Julian allowed his passion to get in the way of his intellect.

Albion on 2011-03-16 at 14:43 said:

Evola's objection to materialistic orgins repeats almost verbatim Oswald Spengler's objection to Darwin, which he characterized as essentially "English" (by which I believe he meant materialistic). Likewise, Aristotle compares unfavorably in his book to Plato. The fundamental point seems to be that the origin of freedom lies in the invisible realm, and not the other way around. The material world can never superimpose itself in a one-to-one relationship, or else it would destroy that more real kingdom. This is a very helpful post, Cologero; it sheds a lot of light on why Rome collapsed.

Albion on 2011-03-16 at 16:09 said:

Evola was working backwards, and so (in a sense) was Julian. Certainly, the gods do not look to us as they did to our ancestors. Nevertheless, they can remain real, more real perhaps, and differently real than before. Whatever Julian thought, Evola was most likely right to eschew

some kind of fundamentalist re-paganizing worldview. St. Ambrose of Milan wrote, concerning Rome, "it is no shame to pass on to better things". Yet this could also be applied to "Christianity". It is always from the higher perspective that such superimposition is possible. I think this is what Evola was driving at.

Graham on 2011-03-16 at 16:27 said:

The criticism of Julian is only over the policy of setting pagans and Christians against eachother, when under Constantine they had been synthesizing. Perhaps history affords a symbolic judgement of his efforts, in the division of the two 'halves' (geographical and spiritual) of the Empire, and their subsequent fates.

Graham on 2011-03-16 at 16:50 said:

Albion,

The unconditioned influence of 'genius' or 'daimon' would seem to be somewhat beyond Spengler's purview. For Evola, the origin is always potentially present; not so for Spengler, which explains his fatalism. This is a key difference between him and Tradition, which should be emphasized for the sake of understanding the latter.

John Bardis on 2011-03-18 at 05:52 said:

As to "believing" in the gods, an interesting book might be Jean Richer's _Sacred Geography of the Ancient Greeks_ (1967, ET 1994). From the back cover:

"Richer found Plato's ideal city repeated around the most important oracular centers on ancient Greece. He shows how Plato's description was a later codification of a much earlier practice of dividing geography into twelve regions under the patronage of the gods of the zodiac. Several such twelve-part divisions of the Greek Territories are presented here."

The center, of course, was the place of philosophy and monotheism.

As to the idea that each nation has its own angel–that comes from the Old Testament. Also note the matter of twelve tribes.

Another book that might be relevant is Anthony Damiani's _Astronoesis_ (2000). This brings astrology into Plotinus' system. In other words, the twelve signs, but especially the "odd" movements of the planets, explain the transition from the One to the many.

John Bardis on 2011-03-18 at 12:26 said:

That reminds me of Hegel's view of the Monarch, here described by Zizek:

"Let us recall how the King–this exemplar of point de capiton, this individual who 'quilts' the social edifice–was conceptualized by Hegel: the King is undoubtedly the point of the 'suture' of social totality, the point whose intervention transforms a contingent collection of individuals into a rational totality–yet precisely as such, as the point which 'sutures' Nature and Culture, as

the point at which a cultural-symbolic function (that of being a king) immediately coincides with a natural determination (who will be king is determined by nature, by biological lineage), the King radically 'desutures' all other subjects; makes them lose their roots in some preordained organic social body that would fix their place in society in advance and forces them to acquire their social status by means of hard labour. It is therefore not sufficient to define the King as the only immediate junction of Nature and Culture–the point is rather that this very gesture by means of which the King is posited as their 'suture' de-sutures all other subjects, makes them lose their footing; throws them into a void where they must, so to speak, create themselves."

Cologero on 2011-03-19 at 00:50 said:

Interesting, since Evola was quite familiar with Hegel, though he never accepted Hegel's conception of a determinate unfolding of consciousness in history. However, I think I'm missing Zizek's point: this first part makes sense, but who are "all other subjects"? Are they outsiders who don't fit into the rational totality? Is the point that with Julian, suddenly the Christians were "desutured" from the Empire?

John Bardis on 2011-03-19 at 09:21 said:

Actually a King and an Emperor are two different things.

In Hegel's political philosophy he describes a very modern conception of the state. The one odd thing about it, though, for an American at least, is that he reserves a place in the modern state for a king. So the position of king would be the only hereditary office that he knew about. So the king is what he is by nature. Everyone else in the state has to become whatever it is he or she will become.

Like most Germans of that time, for Hegel ancient Greece was the ideal. It was an _immediate_ concrete universal. The Roman empire was an abstract universal. The modern state is a _mediated_ concrete universal.

So a king gives the people of a given state its identity. But an emperor destroys the identity of all the various people in the empire.

So, then, Hegel's view is _very_ different from that of the Traditionalists. He was very much opposed to the Romantic thinkers of his time who glorified India and the Catholic Church.

So, really, it isn't particularly appropriate to bring Hegel into things here. But on this one point, he seems to have been the last of the modern Western thinkers who had any appreciation at all, even if only very slightly, for a hereditary office.

9.4 Universality and the Heroic Life

Between 1931 and 1943 Julius Evola published 135 articles in the journal La Vita Italiana. What follows is the conclusion to "Universalità imperiale e particolarismo nazionalistico" from the April 1931 issue, in which Evola contrasts the Universality of the Empire to the particularity of the nation. In a few short paragraphs, he brings in the expected themes of caste, spirit, the ascetic life, the heroic life, fate, and so on.

Universality as knowledge and universality as action: the two bases of every imperial age. Knowledge is universal when it reaches the point of giving us the meaning of things, in the face of that greatness and eternity, everything that is *pathos* and the fads of men vanishes: when it leads us into the primordial, the cosmic, into that which in the field of the spirit has the same characteristics of the purity and power of the oceans, the deserts, the ice fields. Every true universal tradition carried in itself this breath of vastness, animating disinterested forms of activity by it, arousing the sensibility for values that do not let themselves be measured by any criterion of utility and passion, whether individual or collective; introducing to the "living" a "more than living". This is the type of an invisible empire that history shows us in the examples of Brahmanic India, the Catholic Middle Ages, even of Hellenism: a homogeneous culture that rules every politically and economically conditioned reality, from the inside in a range independent of the people or city.

But we can think of a concept of empire, visible as well as invisible, having a both a material and a spiritual unity. We understand a similar empire when along with universality as knowledge, we also have *universality as action*. Here as historical references, we can mention ancient China, Rome (in part), and once again the Middle Ages in the movements of the Crusades on the one hand and Islam on the other.

Universalizing action is pure action: it is **heroism**. So in the two con-

ditions of imperiality we again find exactly the qualities that defined the two higher castes of antiquity, the sapiential caste (which is not necessarily the sacerdotal) and the warrior caste. We immediately point out that the concept of "heroism" here described is not that of the moderns. In the traditional concept, heroism is an ascesis in the strictest meaning of the word, and the hero is a nature so purified from the "human" elements, as far as he is the ascetic: he participates in the same character of purity as the great forces of circumstances, and has little to do with the passionality, sentimentality, and various movements of men, whether ideal or material, individual or collective.

The specific functions of each one of the ancient castes expressed its proper nature, the way of being of those who belonged to it: so war to the warrior was valued as his purpose, as the life for his own spiritual realization. He fought therefore in a "pure" way, war in itself was a good, and heroism was a "pure", hence universal, form, of activity. The rhetoric of the "battle for rights", "territorial claims", sentimental or humanitarian pretexts, and so on, are modern things in everything and for everyone, totally alien to the traditional concept of heroism. In the *Bhagavad Gita*, in the *Koran*, in the Latin concept of the *mors triumphalis*, in the Hellenic assimilation of the hero at the beginning of the city, in the Nordic symbol of Valhalla, opened up only for the heroes, in certain aspects of the "holy war" known even by Catholic feudalism: we find, formulated in various ways, the transcendent idea, both supernatural and super-human, of heroism. Heroism here is a method of virile ascesis, of the conquering of one's lower nature, a life of immortality and in relationship with the eternal. Transfigured in a similar atmosphere, action gains a universal nature: it becomes almost a force from above, also capable of transposing the universality of a tradition of the spirit into a earthly body: it is the condition of the empire, in its highest meaning.

Are these exhumations of ancient ideals anachronistic and vain? They can also be so. But then this means only that current conditions are such

to reduce the evocation of ideals and symbols, that today have lost their original meaning, to an empty rhetoric in which many indulge.

This does not block anything in the doctrinal sense. One can and must always trace a line of demarcation between concept and concept and to take care not to allow in a contradiction. When the points of reference are "national pride", the "irredentistic demand", the "necessity for expansion", etc., one is in the legitimate principles of a strongly modern nation, but one is certainly not in that of the empire. One wonders if a Roman had ever fought for any similar reason, and if he had ever needed to get motivated by such passional rhetoric to accomplish the miracle of that worldwide conquest, through which the universality of the luminous Greco-Roman civilization was spread to distant parts of the earth.

It is necessary to go back to the state of pure force, of force that comes with the same fatality and the same purity and the same inhumanity of the great forces of circumstances. The great conquerors always felt almost like **sons of fate**, carriers of a force that had to be realized and to which, starting from their own person, their own pleasure, their own tranquility, all of which had to be subdued and sacrificed. In its integral meaning, the empire is something higher, transcendent: the *Sacrum Imperium* Holy Empire . How can we then associate the myth of the empire to this or that idealism or traditionalism (in a narrow sense) or sentimentalism or utilitarianism? How to connect it to the needs of a faction or nation, not to also mention a district, village, or country? Nevertheless, among the moderns it is all too frequently the case that it ends up in similar absurdities.

Whoever recalls the imperial symbols, which is the land that gave life to his body, must be capable of seeing all that. It is necessary that he knows what the "nation" is and what the "empire" is: which is the limit of one thing and that of the other. It is necessary that the mind be opened up to that which in man neither begins nor ends in man: that he understands, as the culmination of the most intense individuality, universality, both

as knowledge and as action. And above all it is necessary that having the sense of the measure to which today everything is unnaturally reduced, he knows that there is all one world to which to say "no" before the auroral brightness of a possible European imperial era beyond the world of slaves and merchants.

Posted on 2011-08-10 by Aeneas

* * *

logres on 2011-08-12 at 21:45 said:

"... which does not begin nor end with man... "

Christianity has forgotten that the Father is archetypal and hence beyond our current form, and that our destiny is not to be merely man, but to pass to another state. How shameful it is to have to be reminded of this from a "pagan" – but how instructive!

9.5 We Antimoderns

In 1930, **Julius Evola** launched the periodical *La Torre* which was subsequently shut down by the Fascist government of Italy. This was just after the publication of the Italian edition of *Pagan Imperialism*, but before Revolt against the modern World. This essay, *Noi Antimoderni*[9] is from the inaugural issue. While there is nothing unexpected here, it sets the scene for his subsequent works. The translation will appear in two parts.

Commentaries are featured with small letter.

In many ways today, a dark threat, understood in an always more precise sense, looms over the entire civilization of the West. In the crisis, without insisting on this or that special form, but rather on the structure

[9] http://www.juliusevola.it/documenti/template.asp?cod=527

of the entire modern world, it seems to foretell the symptoms of the end of a world, the decline of a culture.

While **Rene Guenon**, analyzes the imbalance and discomfort characteristic of this era, he, in fact, shows how its characteristics are precisely those of the Dark or Iron Age, foretold by ancient traditions.

> There are two important points to keep in mind:
>
> 1. The so-called crisis is entwined in the very structure of the modern world. It is not a question of fixing a limited problem, winning an election, or purging the West of some group or form of thought.
>
> 2. Its characteristics can be known in advance by those who understand cosmic cycles. Everything that happens does so for a reason, by following certain principles, or rather, by the denial and neglect of real principles.

Spengler indicates how today there is in existence a fatally inflexible law, for which, like any organism, each civilization, after its rise and prospering, its fall and its petrification into a lifeless barbaric grandeur follow.

After **Netzsche**, **Keyserling**, **Kalergi** indict the immoralism and the irrealism of the European soul, while **Benda** notes the treason of the intellectuals, the enslavement of the classes that were the legacy of a spiritual tradition, due to passion and political hatred.

In fact, ancient certitudes totter everywhere, principles are uncertain everywhere, traditions are lost, spirits are divided, and dark, uncontrollable, and irrational forces impel and overwhelm men and society, playing with them through ideas, interests and passions that they delude themselves into pursuing.

> Haven't we had enough kvetching and jeremiads? We know things are awry, so what is the point of indulging in criticisms of this injustice or that stupid policy? There is a time for righteous anger

and a time for sober reflection. Pace this critique, there must be men who stand above them.

- They know the ancient certitudes.
- They are certain about their principles.
- They seek to recover their traditions.
- Their spirits are unified in solidarity each other and continuity with their ancestors.
- They are aware of the dark and chaotic forces within themselves and learn to master them.

Those who insist on simple or one-dimensional answers will get lost here.

That civilization, of which the Modern man was so proud, and in the name of which he believed the *myth of progress* and had marched to the conquest of the world, that civilization is now faced with a *reductio ad absurdum*, and with a reversal of the values which it had claimed for itself.

Having thrown itself into the conquest of matter, it served its purpose only at the cost of materializing the spirit, of excluding any higher form of life, of amalgamating individuals in the tyranny of collective bodies, we would almost say *subhumans* in their lack of face, rationality, and light, in their subjection to energies that from time to time, as though galvanizing with a temporary life fearful of dead or automated bodies. It hurls them against each other.

The Christian attempt to give the West a religious tradition can only be considered a failure. Nostalgia, as shown in spirits like **Maritain**, **Guenon**, or **Berdyaev**, turn to the feudal and Catholic Middle Ages, putting aside perhaps the insurmountable distance between then and now, when Europe really had begun to organize itself under the two great symbols of Action and Contemplation. What does it matter that Christianity (without realizing it) served as a vehicle for the transmission of a Transcendent

Wisdom, *prior to every age*, and that the Church in its Rites, Symbols and Dogma conserved its deposit, if for some time now, there has been no consciousness corresponding to it?

> Evola's criticism is misguided here. There is no question of returning to the material conditions of a bygone age, but rather of recovering its essence. Maritain became infected with modernist ideas. Berdyaev, although not a Traditionalist per se, was nevertheless a man of Tradition. He called for a new Middle Ages. Guenon had a deeper understanding of Tradition and was beyond certain prejudices, as he adhered to a strict intellectuality.
>
> It matters quite a bit if Christendom was the bearer of a Transcendent Wisdom. At the very least, it provides us with an understanding of Tradition that is "close to home" in space and time. The exercise of extracting the Traditional elements from the thought, rites, symbols, and dogmas is very valuable and less prone to misunderstanding than the abstract study of Asian traditions. Conversely, we are dubious about the claim of any man to be a Traditionalist if he cannot recognize Tradition in those elements.
>
> We agree that for quite some time, there has been no consciousness of such a Tradition in the visible representatives of Christianity today. *A fortiori*, the Middle Ages are an embarrassment to them, and the pagan and Traditional elements in it were explicitly rejected by the Reformation. Hence, those of a nostalgic bent are disappointed and are forced to hold many mental reservations.
>
> However, Evola's assertion that the Middle Ages were *never* conscious of the Traditional element is simply absurd. A Tradition, by its very nature, requires a conscious elite to maintain it, and when that is lost, the Tradition is lost. It cannot run mechanically or automatically. Thus, Guenon's explanation that Christianity was originally an esoteric movement makes more sense. He

> points to The Divine Comedy as an initiatory poem, as well as other writings from the period. This is not to defend Christianity, but rather the notion of Tradition itself, as well as the intelligence and integrity of our European ancestors.

Christianity today is no longer of value to people than as a small faith and morality that everyone professes and everyone betrays; it is mediocre and bourgeois in Catholicism, weakened and stimulating practical achievements in the social rigour in Protestantism? It is only this regard that those who speak of *Tradition* and of the *Return to Tradition*, in fact, know even less of those who deny what Tradition is.

> Here Evola goes for the low lying fruit, repeating what has been said by others ad nauseum. At least he only takes a paragraph to do so. What is the value of criticizing the worst elements rather than the appreciating the best? In Ancient Greece and Rome, the bulk of the population consisted of serfs, slaves, and outcastes. Does he judge paganism by their superstitions or by the few priest-kings and warriors? Always remember there are different castes and types of men, who embody a Tradition to a greater or lesser degree. We should always look to the greatest exponents.

Henri Massis, who brought up the symbol of the Defence of the West and raised the alarm against the asianization of the Latin world, in reality, does not know what the East is nor what could be of value in the West as a principle of reintegration. He does not know how much of what he denies is in what he affirms, nor how much of what he affirms is in what he denies. We then are silent about everything that for some time we proclaimed concerning traditions and traditionalism, whether on this or that basis, those who exalting a Vatican Rome, others a Masonic Rome, or a Mazzinian and Giobertian Rome, who, raising strange taboos to the right and the left, launching attacks in the void, preparing with wordiness and the most implausible mess. Here, as elsewhere, the confusion of

tongues is complete; the power of diagrams, formulas, and words, that, as entities created by Magic, no longer depending on those who created them, is almost without limit.

Neither is sufficient. An amorphous need to escape to the Ahrimanic embrace of materialism, no longer meeting those supports that were given by the surviving traditions only on the assumption of interior and living relationships, has created an even more dangerous perversion in the unbalanced Western soul: *neo-spiritualism*.

From the various revivals of a suspect mysticism to the introduction of always more counterfeit exotic doctrines; from the newest spiritualistic superstition to the morbid interest in the problems and complications of the unconscious and psychoanalysis; from Intuitionism and Surrealism to the various messianic forms and to pseudo-religious and pseudo-occultists of the 1700s that swarmed at the margins of Protestantism; from humanitarian and universalistic ideologies to those of a **Religion of Life** and a **Superman** who, strange to say, almost always ends in associations of women and sub-men: from all of these forms a common meaning is revealed.

It is the unraveling of the European soul, it is its self-release, its escape.

Diverted by an insane drive for liberation, it evades the real, not for a super-real, but rather for a sub-real and a pre-real in which the sense of individuality is dissolved, and a cloudy, ecstatic coalescence with subhuman forces abolishes the law of pure action and clear vision.

> With the void left by the loss of the Tradition in the Middle Ages, many false and counterfeit traditions rush in. No point to belabour them … you see them them as counterfeits or not. The reference to Ahriman is interesting, the result of his time with the Anthroposophists in the Ur and Krur groups.
>
> As we would expect he opposes the path of ecstasy in favour of **pure action** and **clear vision**. The former follows the latter, lest we forget.

As little as that against which it reacts, such a spiritualism therefore constitutes a principle: it is not a sign of rebirth, but is instead — like that which already Asianized the Greco-Roman world in the Alexandrian period, and to which it so strangely resembles — a symptom of decline, an expression of rejection and resistance in the universal turmoil.

> Evola later dedicated a book to this topic, Mask and Face of Contemporary Spiritualism, which included critiques of Theosophy, Anthroposophy, Psychoanalysis, and several other neo-spiritual movements. Here, he compares them to the various spiritual imports from Persia and India, following Alexander's conquests. Nevertheless, Evola seems to have later excluded other Asian influences such as Mithraism, early Buddhism, Taoism, Tantra, *et al*. However, while he never advocated incorporating their cultural artifacts along with their metaphysical teachings. Contrast that with some contemporary neo-Traditionalists.

Hence, sad omens loom over the Western world: since it is not a question of a circumstance of recent times, but rather the logical conclusion of the very principles on which this civilization has developed. In America — which is the most formidable of the newest barbarisms — is there perhaps not found the endpoint of the industrial course initiated by European Civilization?

And in Bolshevism, which in a certain way constitutes a different form of the identical danger — does it not reveal perhaps the law in the materialistic social mask of that mysticism of community that, through the Christian subversion, swept away the individual, hierarchical, and imperial values of the Greco-Roman world?

> This is old news by now, especially as Bolshevism as such is no longer a threat to Europe. Perhaps in his day, there seemed a viable Third Way, but is of little significance now. Even the opposition between capitalism and liberalism is a mirage, since they not just

co-exist, but are actually in a symbiotic relationship, despite some rumblings from the left fringe and even less consequential clamoring on the various claimants to the real Right. The reference to the Christian subversion is unfortunate here, for several reasons.

1. First of all, he claims to be relying on principles rather than contingent events, a promise he breaks here.
2. Secondly, it is misleading. Many assume that casting off Christianity will suffice to solve the problem. Yet, as Europe becomes more and more de-Christianized, the problem worsens. Rather than unveiling the "inner pagan" in the European soul, is has brought about a spiritual vacuum filled by materialism, hedonism, or neo-spiritualism.
3. It is historically untrue. The Greco part of the world continued its hierarchical and imperial values for another millennium. The Roman part managed to recover it and maintained it in one form or another for a thousand years. Rome was already in decline; a spiritually strong people don't go looking for novelty. The degeneration of castes had already occurred in the city-states. Rome was forced to make concessions to the mass of Plebes around the city. This suffices for now.

All this tells us how little there is to hope about the efficacy of a reaction.

Still one generation — two at most — and every surviving possibility can be choked off, and nothing will stop this great dark mass that already runs down the slope: unless a sudden upheaval, a crisis that radically jolts the foundations of modern civilization comes to reestablish the equilibrium, whether through something, that through the eyes of most men for most of them will be the same as a catastrophe.

Possessing this conviction, what task remains to the few that still resist?

Not a direct action, but that more disconcerting action which can wield the mute and impassive presence of a stone guest. We must break the bridges, and with absolute adherence to primordial meanings and visions, those who will still act before the causes of the current civilization are established, constitute a pole, which, if it will not prevent this world of deviants from being what it is, will impede them, however, from asserting the nonexistence of every other horizon, to glorify itself, to establish by law itself to religion, to think that which is, should be what it is and that is good that it is.

Hence, a fixed point, and from such a point, new relationships, new distances, new consciousnesses; from such consciousnesses, perhaps — in someone — the beginnings of liberating crises.

> Well, we are two generations from the publication of Evola's essay. Are all possibilities choked off? Yet, don't we see more interest in Tradition, especially among young men? More translations are available, more commentaries on Eastern metaphysics, and so on. The World Cycle has its own program and is not as impatient as we are.
>
> A catastrophe may occur but is not the only possibility as Guenon pointed out. The task is simple: *absolute adherence to primordial meanings and visions*. Then act as a **stone guest**, a sojourner in the land of the lost, act as the unmoved mover, without attachment to results.

It is natural that many points in this regard be made precise and clarified: we will return to that task in our subsequent articles. Up till now we say that it is not a question of returning, because the reference is primarily to certain principles and certain interests, which, being above time, they have (in the words of Guenon) a permanent relevance.

> To be a man **above time**, adhere to principles whose relevancy and applicability are never in doubt.

Having lost the sense of this relevance, having been dissolved in the myth of a pure flowing, of a pure stretching that pushes further and further its very goal of a process increasingly powerless to reach mastery, this is one of the characteristics of the world against which we anti-moderns set ourselves.

Hence, a clean boundary that separates two epochs, not in an historical sense, but rather in an ideal sense: and we might call one the **Traditional**, the other **anti-traditional**.

The first point is that relating to the spirit of the beginning, cancels every difference of the common opposition to the other. Then, we would like especially to mention the symbol closest to us Westerners: the symbol of **action**, restored to its full and traditional significance, of which the equivocal defense of the West of today could have a shapeless premonition.

To be a man **against time**, act on Traditional principles.

But not before the fixed point is established; that the sense of the distance is precise, so that the modality and nature of the processes appears, which sustain and foment the perversion of the European soul.

Posted on 2012-01-30 by Aeneas

* * *

Avery on 2012-01-31 at 01:58 said:

"The so-called crisis is entwined in the very structure of the modern world. It is not a question of fixing a limited problem, winning an election, or purging the West of some group or form of thought… We know things are awry, so what is the point of indulging in criticisms of this injustice or that stupid policy?"

A spot-on point that people know intuitively, and are being taught to forget by the media. Politics is one of the blasts that a culture unleashes into the world, like the corona of the Sun. It is an epiphenomenon and attacking who sits on the throne at the moment, on the basis of

your cultural reaction to him, is the farthest thing from orienting yourself as an actor within your culture at large.

Avery on 2012-01-31 at 02:04 said:

As for Evola's approach to Christendom, he strikes me as the epitome of European alienation. With alienation comes spiritual destruction, so Evola looks for a more ancient and mysterious spirit. His firm resolution to embrace both tradition and Europe without also embracing Christianity is the struggle behind much of his work.

Boreas on 2012-01-31 at 04:43 said:

Well said, Avery. Evola was right and had superior knowledge on many things, but he forgot or did not fully understand – maybe because of his "personal equation" which led to his errors also (manipura again) – the three things Christ brought to the world with the fulfillment of his own Great Work: Unity, Love (ultimate compassion and loving-wisdom) and the embodiment of the Spirit from the highest realms into the deepest recesses of matter.

Recommended reading: Matt. 12, the whole chapter

Cologero on 2012-02-01 at 22:42 said:

"And why should it be that among the greatest mystics only the women, Saint Ignatius Loyola excepted, have been visionaries? Think about Catherine of Siena, Marie of the Incarnation, Mechtilde of Hackborn, Elizabeth of Schoenau, Julian of Norwich and others. For the most part, like oceans or tidal pools, women keep their vital secrets.

Evan S Connell, Points for a Compass Rose

Charlotte Cowell on 2012-02-02 at 16:26 said:

yes, it is tricky, especially when you don't know someone, hence my checking in about possible upsets (I can be quite blunt, mainly I make myself laugh and not necessarily anyone else!). But regarding that comment I was not actually 'worried' but it would be very complicated to convey why I was feeling beyond confirming I was very amused! However I can be a nervous type of person at times – highly strung you might say – so it is not surprising if you wondered if I really WAS worried!!

@Boreas, I went through a heavy metal phase when I was about 13 and shall never, ever return. However, I do think Led Zeppelin are an amazing band, one of the best ever, even though they're a bunch of lefthanders, well Jimmy Page at least. There's an extremely readable biography by Peter Levanda called Stairrway to Heaven, covering the whole band, which I really enjoyed. Levanda has also written equally gripping books on Hitler's Occult War – Unholy Alliance. Other

than Led Zep a bit of Deep Purple is fine, same for ACDC, I'm not entirely writing off the genre, but I really prefer……D I S C O (the Studio 54 and Paradise Garage kind [D83D?][DE42?]), world music, reggae, house, chillout stuff and things of that ilk. Some people call it 'girly music', although the best DJs are usually men

Point 2 you make I agree is valid in terms of catharsis, but there is also a danger of dark music or whatever invoking dark forces, as is the intention of the artist in many cases. In the same way you hear atonal rap music now, which is truly repulsive in most cases – I can't see this having any kind of good effect on listeners and the same goes for the worst kind of death metal, which can really be very sinister.

`Charlotte Cowell on 2012-02-02 at 17:57 said:`

Boreas, with respect to something we were talking about on another thread, I read someone post this on facebook that is relevant to the points you were making:

The gospel teaches that Yohanan the Baptist lived in the wilderness and that he ate "locusts and wild honey." According to the Kabbalah, the "locusts" represent admixed and dark forces, and the ability of the prophet to devour and transmute them, and the "wild honey" represents divine forces, and the ability of the prophet to receive and integrate them, and embody them. In the Yeshua Messiah we are also called to this "diet," empowered in the very same spiritual work so long as we live in this wilderness. Peace be with you!

`uberman on 2012-02-01 at 19:01 said:`

This series is a very welcome, perhaps belated diction and commentary on our historical predicament, penned form the heights. Like a breath of cool air in the encroaching desert, bringing with it a message of steadfastness and hope to an otherwise panic stricken cause.

"If you can force your heart and nerve and sinew
To serve your turn long after they are gone,
And so hold on when there is nothing in you
Except the Will which says to them: 'Hold on!'" – R.K

9.6 Orientations: The Religious Question

> The *nature* of man is to be a cognitive, religious and sociable animal. All experience teaches us this; and, to my knowledge, nothing has contradicted this experience.

Joseph de Maistre, *Study of Sovereignty*

Evola regarded Joseph de Maistre as standing on the same side of the barricade as himself. And, like Maistre, he does not deny the obvious — man is a cognitive, religious and sociable animal. It is only the characteristics of knowledge, religion, and society that is in question.

In 1950, Evola wrote a short pamphlet, *Orientations*, consisting of eleven fundamental points to guide his young followers who were out to form a new right movement after the collapse of World War II. The eleventh and final point deals with the religious question.

> A religious factor is necessary as the background for a true heroic conception of life which must be essential for our battle deployment. It is necessary to feel in oneself the evidence that there is a higher life beyond this terrestrial life because only those who feel that way possess an intangible and inner directed strength, only they will be capable of an absolute impulse — while, when this is lacking, defying death and taking no account of one's own life is possible only in sporadic moments of exaltation or in an outburst of irrational forces: nor is there discipline that can be justified, in the individual, with a higher and self-sufficient significance.

Posted on 2008-08-25 by Cologero

* * *

GF on 2010-05-25 at 19:48 said:

In the Hindu Doctrines, chapter four, Guenon's definition of religion pointedly includes sociability and cognitivity. It is also worth noting that etymologically the word religion has two meanings: that which binds men to men and that which binds men to a higher principle. Clearly the social bond, in its deepest sense, is only possible by means of a shared principle. What's more Guenon says that metaphysical incapacity "brings a strange confusion of thought as its fatal and unquestionable consequence." (58) So it seems that mans cognitive and sociable natures are wrapped up in his religion (in the principled sense).

While on ch. 4, I have to ask: who's evaluation of Rome is more correct, Evola's or Guenon's?

Cologero on 2010-05-26 at 23:27 said:
Do you have something specific about Rome?
Evola would regard Rome from the perspective of Action. Also, the Emperor being both spiritual as well as political leader. He considered the Roman mystery cults to be authentic sources of initiation.
Guenon's perspective is contemplation, and the Roman religion was not as anvanced as the Vedanta. Guenon thought the political authority should be under the spiritual authority.

GFJF on 2010-05-29 at 02:20 said:
That answers my question, actually. Should have seen it for myself.

9.7 Orientations

Point 1

> Tonight, we are posting the first point of **Julius Evola**'s Orientations and will continue for the next ten Sundays.

It is useless to create illusions with the pipe dream of any optimism whatsoever: we find ourselves today at the end of a cycle. Already for centuries, at first unfelt, then with the surge of a mass that caves in, numerous processes in the West have destroyed every normal and legitimate ordering of men, and distorted every higher conception of living, acting, knowing, and struggling. And the impulse of this downfall, its speed and its dizziness, is called "progress." And hymns were sung to "progress" and we were deluded that this civilization is — a civilization of matter and machines — civilization par excellence. The entire history of the world was preordained to it: until the ultimate consequences of this whole process was such as to bring a few to an awakening.

Where, and under what symbols, of those who sought to organize the forces for a possible resistance, is well-known. On the one hand, there

is a nation [Italy] which, from when it became unified, had known only the mediocre climate of liberalism, democracy, and constitutional monarchy — dared take up again the symbol of Rome [the eagle] as the basis for a new political conception and for a new ideal of virility and dignity. Analogous forces were awakened in the nation [Germany] that had made in the Middle Ages the Roman symbol of the Imperium as its own, to reassert the principle of authority and the supremacy of those values that have their root in blood, in race, and in the deepest strength of a people. And while in other European nations some groups were already oriented in the same direction, a third force in the Asian continent [Japan] added itself to the alliance, the nation of samurai, in which the adoption of exterior forms of modern civilization did not compromise the fidelity to a warrior tradition centered on the symbol of the solar Empire of divine right.

We do not pretend that in these currents the distinction between the essential and the incidental is clear cut, that in them it made to the ideas of the opposing party an adequate persuasion and qualification of persons, that there were various outdated influences affected by the same forces that had to be combated. The process of ideological purification would have been able to take place a second time, so that some immediate and non-deferrable political problems were solved. But it was also clear that an alliance of forces was taking form, representing an open challenge to "modern" civilization: both to that of the democracies inherited from the French Revolution and to the other, representing the extreme limit of the degradation of Western man: the collectivistic civilization of the Fourth Estate, the communist civilization of the mass-man without a face.

The rhythms accelerated and the tensions increased ending up in an armed conflict of these forces. What prevailed was the massive power of a coalition that did not back down in the face of the most hybrid of their agreements, and of the most hypocritical of this ideological mobilization

in order to crush the world that was rising up and that intended to assert its right. Whether or not our men were equal to the task, if errors were committed in regard to timeliness, complete preparation, or measure of risk, that is beside the point, that is not something that compromised the inner meaning of the battle that was fought. Likewise, it does not interest us that today history is avenged on the victors, that the democratic powers which, having formed a coalition with the forces of red subversion just to conduct the war up to the senseless extremism of an unconditional surrender and total destruction, today sees come back to roost against the allies of yesterday, a danger more terrible than the one they wished to avoid.

The only thing that counts is this: we find ourselves today in the middle of a world of ruins. And the problem to be posed is: do men still exist on their feet within the middle of these ruins? And what should they do, what else can they still do?

Point 2

> The way out of the current situation, according to Evola, will not come from a new political party or platform. Rather, it will require men of a certain character, vision of life, and principles. These are not yet made. Probably, they are still not clear, because after 60 years, there is still no single vision of life among those who oppose the modern world.
>
> Political systems alone are not determinate: the best systems will fail if the population cannot maintain it, while a superior people will succeed despite the system. After 60 years, there should be evidence for this claim. In making this moral argument, Evola goes against the entire modern world which sees the Axis powers he supported as the very embodiment of evil.

Such a problem indeed goes beyond yesterday's alliances, since it is clear that the winners and losers [*vincitori e vinti*] now find each other on

the same level and that the only result of the second world war was the reduction of Europe to the object of extra-European powers and interests. It must be recognized then that the devastation that we have around us is of an especially moral character. We are in a climate of general moral anesthesia, of profound disorientation, in spite of all the words of order in use in a society of consumption and democracy: the breakdown of character and every true dignity, the ideological confusion, the prevalence of the lowest interests, living hand to mouth, are what characterizes, in general, the post-war man. To recognize this, also means to recognize that the first problem, the base of every other, is of an inner nature: To pick oneself up, to rise up interiorly, to give oneself a form, to create in oneself order and rectitude.

No one has learned from the lessons of the recent past if he still fools himself about the possibilities of a purely political battle and about the power of one or the other formula or system, whose new human quality is not made by a specific opposing party. Here is a principle that today more than ever should have absolute evidence: if a State possesses a political or social system that, in theory, is of value as the most perfect, but the human element was deficient, that state would descend sooner or later to the level of the basest societies. However, a people, a race capable of producing true men, men of right feeling and reliable instinct, would reach a high level of civilization and would stand on their feet in the face of the most calamitous tests even if its political system was defective and imperfect. One takes therefore a precise position against that false "political realism" that thinks only in terms of programs, party organizational problems, or social and economic prescriptions. All this belongs to the contingent, not to the essential. The measure of what can still be saved depends upon the existence — or not — of men who are in front not to preach formulas, but to be examples, not going towards demagogy and the materialism of the masses, but to awaken different forms of sensibility and interests. Starting from what can still remain among the ruins, to reconstruct slowly a new

man to animate through a determinate spirit and a suitable vision of life, to fortify through the tenacious adherence to given principles — this is the true problem.

Point 3

> First of all, what is that "legionary spirit" and where is the evidence for it today? That spirit has nothing to do with hot-headedness, emotional outbursts, or partisanship. Rather, it is characterized by an iron will, a sense of order, rationality, mental sobriety, the ability to plan or strategize, loyalty, the adherence to principles.
>
> How does that fit in today, among those who can see in such a spirit only a disease, a mistake, the "authoritarian personality". Today hedonism is preferred to sobriety, living for the moment instead of strategizing, the lack of discrimination instead of the quest for order, the irrational, the unusual, the absurd instead of rationality. But what idea or principle is there to be loyal to? Even among certain groups that claim to be "radical traditionalists" there is no underlying unity. Rather, they are motivated by the party spirit, i.e., alliances are made based on similarity of immediate goals, but not on the possession of a common mind.
>
> Evola's vision is far from being realized, even further than when Orientations was published. Where do we see the *legionary spirit* "in the factories, in the laboratories, in the universities, in the street"? The "agitators" today wonder why no one will follow them. Isn't it time to look elsewhere?

Something already exists as spirit that can serve as evidence of the forces of resistance and resurgence: it is the *legionary spirit*. It is the attitude of those who were able to choose the hardest way, who were able to fight even knowing that the battle was materially lost, who were able to confirm the words from the ancient saga: "Loyalty is stronger than fire" and through which the traditional idea was affirmed; that is the meaning of

honor and shame, — not small measures drawn from petty morality — that creates a substantial, existential difference between beings, almost like that between one race and another.

On the other hand, there is the realization typical of those in whom what was the end now appeared as the means, in them the recognition of the illusory character of multiple myths while leaving untouched those who were able to achieve *for themselves*, on the borderline between life and death, beyond the world of contingency.

These forms of the spirit can be the base of a new unity. The essential thing is to adopt them, to apply them, and to extend them from the time of war to the time of peace, of this peace especially, that is only a setback and a poorly kept down disorder—to those who bring about distinctions and a new alignment. That must happen in rather more essential terms than what is a "party", which can only be a contingent instrument in sight of given political battles; in terms more essential than even as a simple "movement", if by "movement" is meant only a phenomenon of the masses and aggregation, a quantitative phenomenon more than qualitative, based more on emotive factors than on strict, clear adherence to an idea.

It is instead a silent revolution proceeding in the depths, that must be propitiated, to those who are, it first creates on the inside and in the individual the premises of that order that then will have to also be asserted on the outside, supplanting as quick as lightning at the right moment the forms and forces of a world of subversion. The "style" that must gain emphasis is that of whoever holds onto positions in faithfulness to himself and to an idea, in a collected intensity, in a repulsion for every compromise, in a total engagement that must be manifested not only in the political battle, but also in every expression of existence: in the factories, in the laboratories, in the universities, in the street, in the very personal life of the affected. One must reach the point that the type of which we speak, and who must be the cellular substance of our alliance,

is well recognizable, unmistakable, differentiated, and one can say: "He is one who acts like a man of the movement."

This must today be recovered, which was already the guarantee of the forces that yearned for a new order for Europe but which in its realization often was impeded and diverted by multiple factors. And today, fundamentally, the conditions are better, because misunderstandings do not exist and it suffices to look around, from the streets to the Parliament, because the callings are put to the test and one has, clearly, the measure of what we must *not* be. Facing a world of mush whose principle is: "Who makes you do it", or: "First comes the stomach, the skin (the *Malapartian Skin*![10]), and then morality", or again: "These are not times in which we can be permitted the luxury of having a character", or finally: "I have a family". One is able to oppose clarity and service to them: "We cannot do otherwise, this is our life, this is our being". Whatever is positive will be able to be reached today or tomorrow. It will not be through the abilities of agitators and politicians, but rather through the natural prestige and the recognition of men whether of yesterday, or, and even more, of the new generation, that so many are capable and in that give the guarantee for their idea.

Point 4

> Here a new vision is put before our eyes. The regression of castes must be walked back up, but in today's undifferentiated world, one's caste is unclear. New spirits will awaken, but not from the expected places. This has nothing to do with economic classes. It is a revolt against the conformity of the bourgeois world, but from superior values, not the lower values of the mass man.
>
> This awakening spirit comes from the inside and cannot be identified with an external movements. Thus all attempts to identify

[10] http://www.britannica.com/EBchecked/topic/359524/Curzio-Malaparte

> such spirits based on adherence to some political ideology or religious form will be far off the mark. Yet, these spirits will recognize each other and form natural hierarchic structures. It is not a "big tent" or equals, or debaters in endless conversation. Hence, counter-traditional movements that try to include anarchists or the abnormal cannot be part of this.
>
> Sentimentality has no part of this, despite those who tell me I should "like" this person or web site, etc. But "liking" is not the issue. This sentimentality is opposed to "impersonality", the idea that it is "strictly business, nothing personal"; this attitude comes apparently from a deep part of Evola and its source is not the Nordic soul.
>
> The text follows.

Therefore, a new substance must clear the way in slow advance beyond the squares, the classes, and social positions of the past. It is necessary to keep a new pattern right in front of your eyes, in order to measure your own strength and calling. It is important and fundamental to recognize exactly that this pattern has nothing to do with classes as economic categories, and the antagonisms related to them. It could manifest itself in the clothing of the rich as well as the poor, of the worker as well as the aristocrat, of the businessman as well as the explorer, of the technician, theologian, farmer, or the politician in the strict sense. But this new substance will know an internal differentiation, which will be perfect when, again, there will be no doubt about the vocations and functions of followers and commanders, when a restored symbol of unshaken authority will tower over the center of new hierarchic structures.

That defines a direction that is as anti-bourgeois as anti-proletarian, a direction totally devoid of democratic contaminations and "social" foibles, because leading toward a clear, virile, articulated world, made by men and leaders of men. Disdain for the bourgeois myth of "security", for the petty standardized, conformist, domesticated, and "moralized" life.

Disdain for the anodyne bond characteristic of every collectivistic and mechanistic system and of all ideologies that grant to confused "social" values primacy over those heroic and spiritual values by which we have to define, in every domain, the type of true man, of the absolute person.

And something essential will be attained when the love for a style of active impersonality is revived, for which that which counts is the work and not the individual, for which a man is not capable of considering himself as something of importance, importance being instead his function, his responsibility, the task he adopts, the goal he pursues. Where this spirit asserts itself, many problems of the economic and social order will be simplified, which would otherwise remain insoluble if confronted from the outside, without the counter party of a change of spiritual factors and without the elimination of infectious ideologies that already in part prejudice every return to normality, as well as the perception itself of what normality means.

Point 5

> Although the Cold War between the USSR and USA is over, this makes Evola's insights in this point all the more prescient. As long as communism and the Soviet Union were perceived as external enemies, the USA could sustain internally a certain amount of reaction and conservatism to define itself as the opposite of the USSR. However, once the wall came down, the right in the USA became irrelevant, so that progressive forces could continue unchecked, no longer subject to the charge of being pro-marxist and treasonous.
>
> Evola was not deceived and recognized that the various movements, ostensibly in opposition, were in fact different degrees of the same frame of mind. The imagery he uses of the dusk and poison are beautifully written. Little else has changed in 60 years, since the trends he abhors are still considered to be "progress", and

> the West is in a constant state of "waiting" … waiting for the culmination of this "progress" in the indefinite future in who knows what form. Since the "real" world only exists in the future, the past, and Tradition, are thereby disvalued. Evola may be placing too much blame on the USA, for Europe herself has been equally complicit, if not even leading the way. He is correct, though, in a significant point: the battle has been lost without even a shot being fired.

Not only as a doctrinal orientation, but also in regard to the world of action, it is then important for men of the new arrangement to recognize correctly the concatenation of causes and effects and the essential continuity of the trend that has given life to the various political forms in play today in the chaos of parties. Liberalism, then democracy, then socialism, than radicalism, finally communism and Bolshevism have historically appeared only as degrees of the same evil, as stages that prepare each one that follows in the complex of a process of decline. And the beginning of this process stands at the point at which Western man broke his ties to tradition, denying every higher symbol of authority and sovereignty; he claimed for himself as an individual a vain and illusory freedom; he becomes an atom rather than a conscious part of the organic unity and hierarchy of a whole. And the atom, in the end, had to find, opposed to himself, the mass of other atoms, other individuals, and to be involved in the emergence of the reign of quantity, of the pure number, of the materialized masses and not having another God outside of the sovereign economy.

This process does not stop here halfway. Without the French Revolution and liberalism, there would not have been constitutionalism and democracy, without democracy, there would not have been socialism and demagogic nationalism, without the preparation of socialism there would not have been radicalism and finally communism. The fact that these various forms today often represent, one alongside the other or in

opposition, must not prevent the recognition, to an eye that truly sees, that they hold themselves together, they link to each other, mutually condition each other and express only the different degrees of the same trend, the same subversion of every normal and legitimate social order.

So the great illusion of our time is that democracy and liberalism are the antitheses of communism and have the power to stem the tide of the forces from below, of what in the jargon of the syndicates are called the "progressive" movement. Illusions: like those who say that the dusk is the opposite of the night, that the incipient degree of an evil is the antithesis of the acute and endemic form of it, that a diluted poison is the antidote of the same poison in its pure and concentrated state. The men in the government of this "liberated" Italy have learned nothing from recent history whose lessons were repeated everywhere to the point of monotony, and continue their pitiful game with out-of-date political conceptions and hands in the parliamentary carnival, almost a dance macabre on a simmering volcano.

But for *us* there must instead be the courage of radicalism, the "no" said to political decadence in all its forms, both of the left and of a presumed right. And, above all, we must be aware of that which he does not share with subversion, and that making concessions today means condemning oneself to be totally overwhelmed tomorrow. The rigour of the idea, therefore, and readiness to push ahead by pure force when the right moment is reached.

That naturally also implies the disengagement from ideological distortions, unfortunately popular even in a part of the youth, because of which they indulge in excuses for the destruction that has already happened, deluding themselves by thinking that they, after all, were necessary and served "progress"; they think that it must be combated for anything "new", put off into a determined future, rather than for the truth that we already possess because they, although in various forms of application, always and everywhere made from the base of every right type of social

and political organization.

These foibles must be rejected. And we come back to those who are accused of being "anti-historical" and "reactionary". History does not exist, a mysterious entity spelled with a capital H. They are the men, if even they are *really* men, who make and unmake history; so called "historicism" is more or less the same thing as what is called "progressivism" in leftist circles and it wants a single thing today: to foment passivity in respect to the trend that swells and always leads lower. And, as to "reactionism", you ask: You would therefore prefer that while you act, destroying and profaning, we do not "react", but stay to look so that they say to you: bravo!, continue? We are not "reactionary" only because the word is not strong enough especially because we start from the positive, we represent the positive, real and original values, the light of some "sun of the future" is not necessary.

In the face of our radicalism, in particular, the antithesis between the red "East" and the democratic "West" appears irrelevant, yet a possible armed conflict between these two blocks appears to us also tragically irrelevant it. To look only at the immediate, the choice of the lesser evil certainly remains because the military victory of the "East" would imply the immediate physical destruction of the last exponents of resistance. But at the base of the idea, Russia and North America are to be considered as two prongs of the same pincer because they squeeze themselves permanently around Europe. In two different but converging forms, the same foreign and hostile force acts in them. The forms of standardization, conformism, democratic leveling, frenetic productivity, a more or less domineering and explicit "brain trust", and piecemeal materialism in Americanism can only serve to pave the road for the last phase that is represented, along the same direction, by the communist ideal of the mass-man.

The distinctive character of Americanism is that the attack against quality and personality is not put into effect by the brute force of a Marx-

ist dictator and the mind of the State, but it happens almost spontaneously, by the ways of a civilization ignorant of ideals higher than wealth, consumption, productivity, production without brakes. Therefore, through a worsening and a reduction to the absurd of what Europe herself chose, the same patterns have taken, or are taking, form there. But primitivism, mechanism, and brutality remain so much more on one side than the other. In a certain sense, Americanism is more dangerous for us than communism, because it is a type of Trojan horse. When the attack against the residual values of European tradition is effectuated in the direct and naked forms characteristic of Bolshevik ideology or Stalinism, some reactions still reawaken, certain lines of resistance, even if ephemeral, can be maintained. Things are different when the same evil acts in a more subtle way and the transformations take place on the plane of the general customs and visions of life, as is the case for Americanism. Enduring this influence with a light heart in the name of democracy, Europe is already predisposed for the final abdication, so that it could even happen without even the need for a military disaster, but it will arrive, through "progressive" path, after a final social crisis, at more or less at the same point. Again, it doesn't stop here halfway. Americanism, willing it or not, works for its apparent enemy, for collectivism.

Point 6

> There are several important issues brought in Point 6. That these are in dispute today is incredible, if, in fact, they are even noticed. Perhaps the professional politicians do know it, but are coy enough not to mention them publicly.

- The first is the reduction of the political to the economical. This is even more pronounced in the USA elections, where the economy is supposed to outweigh every other issue. The net effect of this is that, because they are left out

of the political discussion, lower political and social forces can continue unchecked.

- The second is that there is no such thing as a "spontaneous" grassroots movement from below. We are led to believe that there are certain important issues and movements then arise to deal with them. The opposite is actually the case; movements fabricate issues to gain power and achieve their own ends.
- The false ideal of "social justice" is still used to this day for political gain. It is quite effective, except for those who expect "justice".
- On a positive note, Evola proposes, as always, a hierarchical arrangement based on high and heroic ideals. To replace the parliamentary system of professional politicians, he proposes a form of corporativism. This is not, as often believe, the rule by corporations as understood in the West, particularly the USA. Rather, it refers to the representation of the various business sectors, e.g., health, energy, etc., by workers as well as owners. They would bring expertise in their fields to the political and spiritual hierarchy, unlike democratic politicians who typically have no expertise. Contra this, one could complain that these are "special interests" who already have too much influence. However, now it is done in secret, behind closed doors. That would not be the case in a corporative system which actually has a more balanced and diverse representation than current Western deliberative bodies. Furthermore, in such a system, economic factors alone would not have dominance.

Not without relation to that, our radicalism of the reconstruction requires that we do not compromise not only with every variety of Marxist or socialist ideology, but also with what in general can be called the *hallucination* or the *demon of the economy*. Here it is a question of the idea

that in both individual and collective life, the economic factor is the important, real, and decisive one; that the concentration of every value and interest on the economic and productive plane is not the unprecedented aberration of modern Western man, but rather something normal, not a possible brute necessity, but something that must be desired and exalted. Both capitalism and marxism remain enclosed in this dark circle. We must break through this circle. As long as we know how to speak only of economic classes, work, salary, production, as long as we delude ourselves that true human progress and the true elevation of the individual are conditioned by a particular system of distribution of wealth and goods and have therefore something to do with indigence or affluence, with the state of USA *prosperity,* or with that of utopian socialism, we always remain on the same level of what must be combated. This we must affirm: everything that is economy and economic interest as mere satisfaction of physical needs had, has, and always will have a subordinated function in normal humanity; that beyond this sphere an order of higher, political, spiritual and heroic values must be differentiated, an order that–as we already said—does not know and not even admits, proletarian or capitalists, and only depends on what things must be defined as worth living and dying for. A true hierarchy must be established, new dignities must be differentiated and, at the top, a higher function of command, of the *imperium* must dominate.

Thus, in such regards, many evil herbs that have taken root here and there are eradicated, sometimes even in our camp. What is, in fact, this talk of "State of work", of "national socialism", of "humanism of work" and similar ideas? What are these more or less stated requests for a regression of politics into the economy, almost as a resumption of those problematic tendencies toward an integral and, fundamentally, headless, corporatism that fortunately already found the way blocked in fascism? What is this consideration of the formula of "socialization" as a type of universal drug and this elevation of the "social idea" to the symbol of a new civilization

that, who knows how, should be beyond both "East" and "West"?

These—it is necessary to recognize this—are the sides of a shadow present in not a few spirits, who only, for other reasons, find themselves on the same side as us. With that they think they are faithful to a revolutionary order, while they obey only stronger suggestions of them with which a degraded political environment is saturated. And among such suggestions the same "social question" returns. When will they finally take into account the truth, i.e., that Marxism did not arise because a real social question existed, but the social question rises—in endless cases—only because Marxism exists, that is to say, artificially, and yet in almost always insoluble terms, to the work of agitators, to the famous "awakeners of class consciousness", on which Lenin expressed himself very clearly, when he refuted the spontaneous character of proletarian revolutionary movements?

It is starting from this premise that it would be necessary to act, in the first and foremost meaning of ideological anti-proletarianization, as the disinfection of the still healthy parts of the people from the socialist virus. Only then will the one or the other reform be able to be studied and actuated without danger, in compliance with true justice.

So, as the particular case, we will see, according to that spirit, the corporative idea can be again one of the bases of the reconstruction: corporativism not so much as a general system of state and almost bureaucratic composition that maintain the deleterious idea of opposed political arrangements of class systems, but rather as the need that in the very interior of the business that unity, that solidarity of differentiated forces be reconstructed, that the capitalist lie (with the subversive parasitic type of the speculator and the finance-capitalist) on one side, the Marxist agitation on the other, have jeopardized and shattered. It is necessary to bring the business to the form of an almost military unity, in which they compare the solidarity and the fidelity of associated working forces around it in the common enterprise to the spirit of responsibility, to the energy and

the competence of the directors. The only true task is, however, the *organic reconstruction of the business*, and to realize it is not necessary to use formulas intended to adulate, for base propagandistic and electoral ends, the spirit of sedition of the strata inferior to the masses disguised as "social justice". In general, the same style of active impersonality, dignity, solidarity in the production that is typical to the ancient professional and artisan corporations should be recovered. Syndicalism, with its "battle" and those genuine threats which it now offers us too many examples, is to be banished. But, let us repeat, much one must reach that point starting from the interior. The important thing is that against every from of resentment and social antagonism everyone knows how to recognize and love his own place, that conforms to his own nature, recognizing thus even the limits between which he can develop his possibilities and follow his own perfection: because an artisan who perfectly discharges his function is undoubtedly superior to a king who is unfit and not at the height of his dignity.

In particular, we can permit a system of expertise and corporative representation, to supplant the parliamentarianism of the parties; but we should keep in mind that the technical hierarchy, in their entirety, can signify nothing more than a level in the integral hierarchy: they concern the order of means, to be subordinated to the order of ends, to which only the properly political and spiritual part of the State corresponds. To speak instead of a "State of workers" or of production is to make the part equivalent to the whole, the same as reducing the human organism to its simply physical and vital functions. Nor can a similar obtuse and dark thing be our emblem, nor the "social" idea itself. The true antithesis facing both the "East" and the "West" is not the "social ideal". It is instead the *integral hierarchal idea*. In respect to that, nothing uncertain is acceptable.

Point 7

Highlights of point 7:

- The ideal is a virile and organic political unity
- This unity is fundamentally a spiritual unity
- The dignity and freedom of the human person is found in an organic society, not in individualized liberalism
- Evola rejected the Salo Republic because it excluded the Italian monarchy
- The spiritual environment must be created prior to the political and a suitable symbol created

The Carlyle quote is from *Heroes and Hero Worship* and is misquoted in *Men Among the Ruins*. This is the full quote:

The Valet-World has to be governed by the Sham-Hero, by the King merely *dressed* in King-gear.

If the ideal of a virile and organic political unity was an essential part in the world that had to be swept away—and through it, we also brought back the Roman symbol—we must then recognize the cases in which such a need deviated and was almost miscarried in the mistaken direction of *totalitarianism*. This, again, is a point that must be seen with clarity, so that the differentiation of the political fronts is precise and, also, arms are not furnished to those who want to confuse things after due consideration. Hierarchy is not hierarchism (an evil that, unfortunately, today at times tries to come back in minor tones), and the organic conception has nothing to do with a statolatrous sclerosis and a leveling centralization. As for the individual, a true surpassing both of individualism and collectivism happens only when men are face to face with men, in the natural diversity of their being and their dignities. And as for the unity that must prevent, in general, every form of dissociation and absolutization of the particular, it must be essentially spiritual, it must be a central, orienting

influence, an impulse that, depending on the leaders, assumes very differentiated forms of expression. This is the true essence of the "organic" conception, opposed to the rigid and extrinsic relations typical of "totalitarianism". In these fields the requirement of dignity and liberty of the human person that liberalism can conceive only in individualistic, egalitarian, and privatistic terms can be realized integrally. It is in this spirit that the structure of a new political-social ordering must be studied, in solid and clear articulation.

But such structures need a center, a supreme point of reference. A new symbol of sovereignty and authority is necessary. The delivery, in this regard, must be precise and ideological prevarication cannot be admitted. It is good to say clearly that here we are only talking about the subject of the so-called institutional problem; it is first of all about what is necessary for a specific *climate*, for the fluid that must animate every relationship of fidelity, dedication, service, disindividualized action, so that the gray, the mechanistic, and the oblique of the current political-social world is truly surpassed. Here today it will therefore end up with no way out when at the top it is not capable of a type of ascesis of the pure idea.

Both the less felicitous antecedents of our national traditions, and even more, the tragic contingencies of yesterday's prejudice are, for many, the clear perception of the right direction. We can still recognize the inconclusiveness of the monarchical solution, when those who today can only defend a residue of the idea are kept in view, a symbol emptied and devitalized, which is that of the parliamentary constitutional monarchy. But in an altogether decisive way the incompatibility in relation to the republican idea must be pointed out. To be anti-democratic on the one hand, and on the other to defend "ferociously" (this is unfortunately the terminology of some exponents of a false intransigence) the republican idea is an absurdity that is the proof of it: the republic (we mean modern republics: the ancient republics were of the aristocracy, as in Rome, the latter of the oligarchy, often with the character of tyranny) belong

essentially to the world that rose to life through Jacobinism and the anti-traditional and anti-hierarchical subversion of the XIX century. And to such a world, which is not ours, let it go. In terms of principle, a currently monarchical nation that becomes a republic can only be considered as a "degraded" nation. For Italy one does not play in the ambiguity in the name of a fidelity to Fascism of Salo, because if, for this reason, one should follow the false republican way, at the same time it would be unfaithful to something more and better, it would throw into the sea the central nucleus of the ideology of the 20s, i.e., its doctrine of the State in regards to authority, power, *imperium*.

It is necessary to conserve this doctrine, only without agreeing to level down and without making it the game of any group. The concretization of the symbol can be left indeterminate for now; the essential task is to prepare silently the spiritual environment adapted to what the symbol of an intangible elevated authority has felt and reacquired the fullness of its meaning: it cannot correspond to the stature of any revocable "president" of the republic, and not even that of a tribune or populist leader, the possessor of mere individual formless power, lacking every higher blessing, supporting himself instead on the precarious prestige he exercised on the irrational forces of the masses. It is that to which some have given the name of "Bonapartism" and that was justly recognized in its meaning not as the antithesis to demagogic or "popular" democracy, but also as its logical conclusion: one of the dark apparitions in the Spenglerian "decline of the West". There is a new touchstone for us: the *sensibility* in respect to all that. Carlyle had already written: "the Valet-World has to be governed by the Sham-Hero" and not by a real Ruler.

Point 8

> In this point, **Julius Evola** brings up the topic of nationalism, which he rejects. In particular, there is no support for anything calling itself "White Nationalism", despite those movements that

> claim to be "radical traditionalist" or "influenced" by Evola. That would be to be based on "naturalistic" principles, a notion totally opposed to any Traditional state.
>
> Rather, it must be based on the "Idea", and of course, this Idea is the Traditional idea. This is not at all comparable to the American claim to be a "proposition nation", that is, it is based on an "idea", not on an ethnicity, religion, or culture. The American proposition is that "all men are created equal", the polar opposite of the hierarchical state. In theory, that means that each man decides what is true and good, and determines his own meaning of life. However, what that means in practice is the idolization of the least common denominator. In theory, each man would be free to actualize his highest possibilities; in practice, the harsh reality is that the possibilities of the mass of men are quite limited. In the Traditional State, dominated by the highest spiritual ideal, common men are raised beyond their natural capacities and find their true meaning in higher values.
>
> We see Evola proposing an Order, presumably along the lines of the Templars, that is, an order that is both spiritual and chivalric. That would only be possible when there are a sufficient number of men who both know and are faithful to higher principles, and can testify as witnesses to a higher authority.

Another point must be made in an analogous order of ideas. It concerns the position to take in regards to nationalism and the general idea of homeland. That is so much more timely, inasmuch as today, in order to try to save whatever possible, many people would like to adopt a sentimental and, at the same time, naturalistic conception of the nation, notions foreign to the highest European political traditions and irreconcilable with the same idea of the State which we spoke about. Even prescinding from the fact that we see the idea of homeland being invoked rhetorically and hypocritically by the most opposed parties, even by exponents of red

subversion, that conception is not now factually at the height of the times because from one side it assists the self-formation of great supranational blocks, and from the other it always appears more necessary to find a European point of reference, unifying beyond the inevitable particularism that inheres in the naturalistic idea of the nation and still more in "nationalism".

Nevertheless, the question of principle is more essential. The political plane in such regards is that of an elevated unity in respect to the unities defined in naturalistic terms as are also those to which the generic notions of nation, homeland, and people correspond. In this higher plane, the idea unifies and divides, an idea carried by a resolute elite and tending to be concretized in the State. For this reason the Fascist doctrine—that part of it which remains faithful to the best European political tradition—gave primacy to the Idea and State in respect to nation and people and it understood that nations and people acquire a meaning and form and participate in the higher degree of existence only within the State. Even in periods of crisis, as there is currently, it is necessary to hold firm to this doctrine. Our true homeland must be recognized in the Idea. Not being from the same land or the same language, but being of the same idea is what counts today. This is the base, the point of departure. As for the collectivistic unity of nation, of the children of the homeland[11]—which has predominated more and more from the Jacobin revolution until now, we in any case oppose it with something like an *Order*, men faithful to principles, witnesses to a higher authority, and legitimacy proceeding precisely from the Idea.

In the matter of practical ends today it is desirable to arrive at a new national solidarity, only we do not descend to compromises in order to reach it; the presupposition, without which every result would be illusory, is separation from that and taking the form of a definite political arrangement from the Idea—such as political ideas and visions of life.

[11] In French, *des enfants de la patrie* from *La Marseillaise*.

Even today there is not another way: it is necessary that among the ruins the process of the origins be renewed, that which, depending on elites and a symbol of sovereignty or authority, unites the people in the great traditional States, as forms arising out of the unformed. This realism of the idea is not to be understood as meaning to remain on a fundamentally sub-political plane: that of naturalism and sentimentalism, if not completely of the patriotic rhetoric.

And in case we want to support our idea also on national traditions, one remains very careful: because there is an entire "homeland history" of Masonic and anti-traditional inspiration specializing in attributing national Italian character to the most problematic aspects of our history: starting from the revolt of the Communes supported by Guelphism. With it, a tendentious "Italianity" takes prominence in which we cannot and do not want to recognize ourselves. We leave it voluntarily to those Italians who celebrated the "second Risorgimento" with "liberation" and partisanship.

Idea, order, elite, State, men of Order—in such terms the lines are maintained, as long as it be possible.

Point 9

> In Point 9, **Julius Evola** rejects the "solutions" offered by the modern world. First of all, it is not simply a matter of preserving a certain "culture", which is the superficial, but rather of developing an entire "worldview", in the heart of man's being, from which culture will arise as an effect.
>
> This worldview does not come from reading books and, we should add in our age of mass media, it definitely cannot arise from passively absorbing the ideals, values, and opinions of main sources of public discourse today. The "right" worldview cannot only arise within, from living a noble life, perhaps following, as Evola said in different circumstances, the *Path of the Gods*. Personally, I

> find that the Noble Eightfold Path of the Buddha expresses this idea: right view, right aspiration, right speech, right action, right livelihood, right effort, right mindfulness, right concentration.
>
> Evola then singles out three modern worldviews for a withering critique: darwinism, pschoanalysis, and existentialism. All three—and even today they form the foundation for the modern and postmodern wordlview albeit in somewhat mutated forms—reduce man to the lowest level. He is an "evolved" animal, he is the plaything of unconscious forces, he is dominated by feelings of angst and meaninglessness. Anyone who opposes these worldviews is then branded as ignorant or even evil. As he points out, the worst invective is directed to those who refuse to accept darwinism as a valid understanding of the origin of man; the darwinian dogma is enforced more strictly than any previous Inquisition.

Something needs to be said about the problem of culture. Not beyond measure. We in fact do not overvalue culture. What we call a "worldview" is not based on books; it is an inner form that can be more precise in one person without a particular culture than in an "intellectual" or a writer. We must ascribe the fact that the individual is left open to influences of every type to the weight of everything among the bad omens of "free culture", even when he is not able to be active in relation to them, to know how to discriminate, and to judge according the right judgment.

Thus discourse cannot just point out that, as things currently stand, there are specific currents from which the youth of today must defend themselves interiorly. We spoke initially of a style of rectitude, of inner resistance. This style implies a right knowing and young men especially must take account of the intoxication working on the totality of a generation from concordant varieties of a distorted and false vision of life, that have affected men's internal strength. In one form or another, these toxic elements continue to act in the culture, in science, in sociology, in literature, as so many points of infection that must be identified and

beaten. Aside from historical materialism, which we already mentioned, Darwinism, psychoanalysis, and existentialism are among the major ones.

The fundamental dignity of the human person must be asserted against Darwinism, recognizing his true place, which is not that of a particular, more or less evolved, type of animal among so many others, differentiated through "natural selection" and always tied to bestial and primitivistic origins, but he is to elevate himself virtually beyond the biological plane. If today no one speaks much anymore about Darwinism, its substance nevertheless remains. The biological Darwinian myth, in one or another of its variants, has the precise value of a dogma, defended by the anathemas of "science", in materialism, whether of the Marxist or American civilization. Modern man is addicted to this debased idea, he recognizes himself in it comfortably and finds it natural.

Against psychoanalysis the ideal of a Self (or "I") must be validated, a Self who does not abdicate, who intends to remain conscious, autonomous, and sovereign in the confrontation with the dark and subterranean part of his soul and the demon of sensuality; that does not mean either "repression" or a psychotic scission, but he brings about an equilibrium of all his faculties ordered to a higher meaning of living and acting. An obvious convergence can be pointed out: the disempowerment of the conscious principle of the person, the prominence given to the subconscious, the irrational, the "collective unconscious" and similar ideas from psychoanalysis and analogous schools, corresponds in the individual precisely to what the urgency, the impulse from below, the subversion, the revolutionary substitution of the inferior to the superior, and the disdain for every principle of authority, represent in the modern social and historical world. The same tendency acts on two different planes, and the two effects cannot avoid being mutually integrated.

As for existentialism, even to distinguish in it what is properly a philosophy—a confused philosophy—it remained, until our time, of pertinence to restricted circles of specialists. It is necessary to recognize the

state of soul in crisis that became a system and was adulated, the truth of a broken and contradictory human type who experiences, with anxiety, tragedy, and the absurd, a freedom from which he does not feel elevated, and to which he instead feels without escape and responsibility, condemned in the midst of a world deprived of value and meaning. All this, when the best Nietzsche had already indicated a way to recover a meaning for existence and to give to oneself a law and an intangible value even in the face of a radical nihilism, in the sign of a positive existentialism, according to his expression: from a "noble nature".

Such are the lines of surpassing that must not be merely intellectualized but lived, realized in their direct meaning for the interior life and one's own conduct. To lift oneself up is not possible as long as one remains as though he is under the influence of similar forms of false and deviant thinking. Detoxified, a man can pursue clarity, rectitude, strength.

Point 10

> Julius Evola points out the three possible reactions to the modern world, which he regards as fundamentally "bourgeois". We may dispute that today in that proletarian values seem to predominate in our time.
>
> 1. Oppose the bourgeoisie with a "collectivized and materialized humanity," to which we may add an "undifferentiated" humanity.
> 2. Maintain the bourgeois status quo through focusing on the economic life, solely.
> 3. Oppose the bourgeoisie with a "higher heroic and aristocratic conception of existence", which is both "anterior and superior" to the current state of affairs.

The position that lies in the zone between culture and custom will finally be made clear. From communism came the rallying cry of the anti-

bourgeois that was also picked up in the cultural groups of certain "committed" intellectual circles. As bourgeois society is something intermediate, so there exists a double possibility of surpassing the bourgeois, of saying "no" to the bourgeois type, to bourgeois civilization, to the bourgeois spirit and bourgeois values. One corresponds to the direction that leads even lower than all that, toward a collectivized and materialized humanity with its Marxist "realism": social and proletarian values against bourgeois and capitalist decadence. But the other is the direction of those who oppose the bourgeoisie in order to actually rise up beyond it. The men of the new arrangement will still be anti-bourgeois, but by way of the aforesaid higher heroic and aristocratic conception of existence; they will be anti-bourgeois because they disdain the comfortable life; anti-bourgeois because they will follow not those who promise material advantages, but those who demand everything from themselves; anti-bourgeois, finally, because they are not preoccupied with security but love the essential union between life and risk, on all planes, making the inexorability of the bare idea and precise action his own. Yet another aspect, through which the new man, cellular substance for the motion of awakening, will be anti-bourgeois and will differentiate himself from the preceding generation, is through his intolerance of every form of rhetoric and false idealism, of all those great words that are written in capital letters, of everyone who is merely a gesture, words intended for effect, scenography. Essentiality, instead, a new realism in pitting itself exactly against the problems that will be imposed, in doing so the value is not appearing, but rather being, not prattling, but rather realizing, in a silent and exact way, in sync with similar forces and in adherence to the command that comes from above.

Those who are able to react against the forces of the left only in the name of idols, of lifestyle and the mediocre conformist morality of the bourgeois world, have already lost the battle beforehand. This is not the case for the man who stands on his feet, having already passed through the purifying fire of internal and external destruction. This man, in the

same way that politically he is not the instrument of a false bourgeois reaction, so, in general, he regains forces and ideals anterior and superior to the bourgeois world and the economic era, and it is with them that he creates the lines of defense and consolidates positions when, at the opportune moment, he will strike out with the action of reconstruction.

Even in such regard, we intend to reclaim a delivery not followed: because we know how in the Fascist era there was an anti-bourgeois tendency that had tried to explicate itself in a not dissimilar sense. Unfortunately even there the human element was not up to the task. And they knew how to make rhetoric even out of anti-rhetoric.

Point 11

> In the final point, **Julius Evola** addresses the question of spirituality. He first considers Catholicism, the last Tradition in the West, but rejects it as inadequate in our time because the Church no longer represents that Tradition. If, instead, had it maintained that Tradition, had it still represented the only force against the modern world, and had it held firm to the principles of *The Syllabus Of Errors*[12] (which everyone should read), Evola would support it.
>
> Evola does not propose some other tradition, alien to Europe, but rather counts on new men, aware of the transcendent, aware of life beyond death, to forge a new spirituality, in expectation of a blessing from above. Given his anti-clerical attitude, this is a somewhat inconsistent position. What is there to prevent such men from recovering that tradition on their own? Why must they wait passively for the "church" to give it to them? The Kingdom is taken by force.

Let us briefly consider a final point, that of the relationship with the dominant religion. For us, the secular State, in whatever form, belongs to the

[12] `https://www.papalencyclicals.net/Pius09/p9syll.htm`

past. And, in particular, we oppose its parody that asserted itself, in certain circles, as the "ethical State", the product of a weak, spurious, empty "idealistic" philosophy associated with Fascism [that of Giovanni Gentile], but through its nature such to give equal approval, like a dialectical game of dice, to the anti-Fascism of a [Benedetto] Croce.

Yet though we oppose similar ideologies and the secular State, a clerical or clericalistic State is likewise unacceptable for us. A religious factor is necessary as the background for a true heroic conception of life that must be essential for our political alignment. It is necessary to feel in oneself the evidence that there is a higher life beyond this terrestrial life, because only those who feel this way possess an unbreakable and unconquerable strength, only they will be capable of an absolute enthusiasm. But where this is lacking, to defy death and to take no account of one's own life is possible only in sporadic moments of elation or in the unleashing of irrational forces: nor is there a discipline that can be justified, in the individual, with a higher and independent meaning.

But this spirituality, which must be alive among us, does not require obligatory dogmatic formulations of a given religious confession; however, the style of life that must be drawn from it is not that of Catholic moralism, which aims for little more than a virtuistic domestication of a human animal; politically, this spirituality cannot but foster mistrust in respect to everything that as humanitarianism, equality, principle of love and of the forgiveness instead of honor and justice; it is an integral part of the Christian conception. Certainly, if Catholicism were capable of making a program of high ascesis its own and exactly on this base, almost like a recovery of the spirit of the best Medieval crusader, makes of faith the soul of an armed bloc of forces, almost a new close-knit Templar Order, relentless against the currents of chaos, breakdowns, subversion, and the practical materialism of the modern world—certainly, in such a case, and also in the case that, at the minimum, it held firm to the positions of the Syllabus, there could not be a single instance of doubt about our

choice.

However, as things currently stand, given the mediocre and, fundamentally, bourgeois and parochial level, to which today practically everything that is confessional religion has descended and given the modernist destruction and the rising opening to the left of the post-conciliar Church of the "aggiornamento", for our men, pure reference to the spirit will suffice, precisely as the evidence of a transcendent reality, to appeal to another force in order to graft onto our force, to have a foreboding that our battle is not only a political battle, to attract an invisible consecration on a new world of men and leaders of men.

Conclusion

> With this paragraph, **Julius Evola** concludes his Orientations. Note that he asks the next generation to take up the torch, but not necessarily to repeat exactly the past. Lessons must be learned and Tradition expressed perhaps in new terms. Fighting old battles may not be helpful in the present battles.
>
> Note that Evola, the "man of action", insists on intellectual rigour and intransigence with respect to the ideas of Tradition. Those who hold firm to those ideas will be united. This unity cannot be achieved on the basis of some contingent political position; certainly not with those who deviate from such ideals while claiming to be "traditionalists". Those who keep their minds focused on the ideals of Tradition will never be overcome by the enemy. They remain firm in the conviction that "what can be done, will be done."
>
> As a side note, please note the reference to "illusory order". This distinction will be important in the discussion of the Logos.

These are some essential orientations for the battle to be fought, especially in respect to the youth, who take up the torch and the baton from those

who have not fallen, learning from the errors of the past, knowing how to discriminate and review everything that was affected, and still today is affected, by contingent situations. It is essential not to descend to the level of the adversaries, not to be reduced to repeating the same mantras, not to insist unduly on those of yesterday which, even if worthy of being remembered, do not have the impersonal and current value of an idea-force, not to yield to the suggestions of false politicizing realism, the mark of every "party". It is necessary for our forces to act also in political hand-to-hand combat in order to create all the possible space in the current situation, and to contain the assault, otherwise almost uncontested, of the forces of the left. But beyond that it is important, it is essential that an elite constitute itself which, in a gathering intensity, identified by an intellectual rigour and an absolute intransigence, depending on the idea that must be united and affirmed above all in the form of the new man, of the man of the resistance, of the man standing up among the ruins. If the task will be to go beyond this period of crisis and vacillating and illusory order, the future will be up to this man. But when also the destiny — that the modern world created for itself and is now sweeping away — should not be restrained, beside such remarks the interior positions will be preserved: in whatever eventuality, what can be done will be done and we will belong to that country which will never be occupied or destroyed by any enemy.

Posted on 2012-07-01 by Aeneas

* * *

`apeiron on 2012-07-10 at 19:06 said:`

"Starting from what can still remain among the ruins, to reconstruct slowly a new man to animate through a determinate spirit and a suitable vision of life, to fortify through the tenacious adherence to given principles – this is the true problem."

This problem is a very true one that still begs for a solution and surely it will be ongoing for the foreseeable future. For it appears that each rectitude since the end of WW2 has been one of a personal nature rather than one holistically aligned. I praise Gornahoor for trying at least to bridge this divide in an original way by continuing Dantes' task, the hermeticism and templar Rosicrucianism of transcendent European sovereignty that links a Tradition from our deepest hyperborean antiquity to our break with the present circumstances. Guenons example to abandon his own Tradition and seek that of an Islamic one, is not ours and neither can Evolas' personal equation amount to a solid example for emulation despite the greatness of the man's works. Yes I'm generalizing in this post without getting into academic specifics, but its holds true all the same.

To quote Mouravieff, from Gnosis (book III):

"Since then, the revolutions that have successively brought us steam, electricity, mechanimtion and atomic energy have transformed the face of the world, and habit as a substitute for buppiness has disappeared during these upheavals. This means that, although we hear people claim happiness with growing fewour in the feverish atmosphere of our times, we find ourselves in a void. If a few 'last of the Mohicans,kith their outdated mentality, raise their voices to call for a return to the 'normal' state of things, in their ndive sincerity they appear like mediaeva1 knights leading a cavalry charge against armoured cars"

It is slightly puzzling to understand why such an important work as "Orientamenti" had not been translated into English before so for that reason I extend my thanks to Gornahoor for taking the initiative. If all systems have fallen and all ideologies have failed then surely a guide of this sort that works on interior strengthening of the spirit is needed more than ever. At the same time I'm not suggesting anything conclusive will be drawn from this, but I look forward to the subsequent points in this series. We know what the problem is but the answers are lacking as usual, and even the best minds spend years in the wilderness piecing together the pieces of a fragmented interior.

Dominion on 2012-07-15 at 12:29 said:

Seeing at last one of the few Traditionalist writings in which we get a view of how the revolt takes place is definitely inspiring. Evola's idea that the Traditional man must simply live as a Traditional man, and make himself known by virtue of his existence is simple and yet highly practical. Assuming that a personal inner order has been achieved, or is being achieved, it lets this fact be transmitted into the real world. It can be done in daily life, at any level of society. In a sense, the man of Tradition then displaces the current order by refusing to be a part of it through his personal actions. It reminds one of Michael Collins' dictum that the Irish would "defeat the British Empire by ignoring it." Thanks for publishing.

Logres on 2012-08-05 at 20:59 said:

Baron Ledhin proposed something along the lines of corporativism:
http://www.phillysoc.org/Portland.htm

Cologero on 2012-08-06 at 07:18 said:

Logres, that is one ugly hard-to-read web site.

To consider the question about "why" to deal with such political/economic topics, particularly since it can only be done in a Platonic way with no chance of implementation. First is as an antidote to the many web sites that claim to be "radical traditionalists", "influenced" by Evola, when they clearly have no such program as that envisioned by Evola, often run by people who "no longer know what normal is".

The hierarchy of spiritual values, then military/political, and lastly economic is the traditional social arrangement, described even by Hermetic authors. Can such an arrangement even be considered "in thought" at this time? Clearly, this arrangement has been the target of overthrow by all revolutionary movements. To this day, the ideal of religious authority, martial spirit, and cooperative economic activity is falsely considered "fascist", and every vestige of it is attacked. For example, an attack on the remnants of spiritual authority is disguised as a women's health issue. The warrior spirit is mitigated by egalitarian pressures in the armed services. And so on … why would there not be any value in considering such events from the standpoint of Tradition?

Logres on 2012-08-06 at 09:51 said:

"The important thing is that against every from of resentment and social antagonism everyone knows how to recognize and love his own place, that conforms to his own nature, recognizing thus even the limits between which he can develop his possibilities and follow his own perfection: because an artisan who perfectly discharges his function is undoubtedly superior to a king who is unfit and not at the height of his dignity."

Great quote. Ledhin used to say "loving command, and proud obedience" were the watchwords of the organic Catholic order.

logres on 2012-08-12 at 14:57 said:

I must say that Evola always surprises me with what a precise mind he possessed – once he says it, very often, it clears away a century of thought, and years of personal confusion:

"In these fields the requirement of dignity and liberty of the human person that liberalism can conceive only in individualistic, egalitarian, and privatistic terms can be realized integrally.."

This was exactly the same goal aimed at by Baron Ledhin, who (unfortunately) did not understand the abiding ideal of imperium – once the monarchs were all equal, the World Wars commenced, and they seemed powerless to stop it (though they personally wished to, at some level). I wonder if Ledhin knew of Evola? I'll have to check…

logres on 2012-08-12 at 15:08 said:

" Indeed, Kuehnelt-Leddihn observed that one of the weaknesses of the Right was its failure to failure to offer a utopia of its own as a counter to the utopias of the Left.9[2033?] (Leftism Revisited)

Indeed, "Erik von Kuehnelt-Leddihn was fond of pointing to the traditional Chinese civil service examination system as one reflecting the ideals of meritocracy. The scholars who comprised the Mandarin class were drawn from the ranks of those demonstrating superior skill and ability. This was not a hereditary class but one where even the lowliest peasants with remarkable talents could achieve self-advancement."

Interesting that Ledhin (like CS Lewis) seems to have appreciated the possible directions "things might have gone", but appeared powerless to actually articulate it. One wonders what might have happened had a more coordinated, concerted, and spirited effort been made to reconstitute the opposite of a Revolution, without falling into the Benoist (or similar) side-tracks.

Cologero on 2012-08-12 at 20:08 said:

Good points, Logres. I was speaking to someone a couple of weeks ago, who claims to follow the New Right. I asked about his (or their) vision. He envisions communities of pagans, practicing their own way, apparently like the city states of Ancient Greece. I asked him the a question, equivalent to what you mentioned about kings. How do you guarantee the "kings" won't begin to battle each other and consolidate; especially since they want to be a "virile" (at least some do) and warrior society. I also pointed out that they would have no way to protect themselves against the dreaded "monotheists", who would probably have the imperium in mind. Curiously, he tried to shame the monotheists for being intolerant; sounded just like a liberal.

As Evola points out, the spiritual vision comes first, the symbol to gather around. It will be a hard sell, since liberal individualism is so ingrained and anything else seems a threat to that willfulness that is called "freedom". One of the dominant spiritual visions involves being raised up into the clouds; doesn't make sense and is untraditional, yet it holds a lot of hearts and minds.

A meritocracy like the Mandarins is hardly possible now, as we know who will administer the tests, what answers will be deemed acceptable, and who will get "bonus" points. I suppose we are already, in a way, ruled by Mandarins, just not what Kuehnelt-Leddihn would have hoped for.

apeiron on 2012-08-12 at 20:35 said:

I always resonated with the simplicity inherent in the spiritual unity of the true golden Imperium, everything else just falls into place almost with a non-rational(supra-rational) gnosical understanding.

"One of the dominant spiritual visions involves being raised up into the clouds; doesn't make sense and is untraditional, yet it holds a lot of hearts and minds."

Which dominant spiritual vision do you speak of here? Christianity, Judaism or Islam? Are these untraditional visions in your eyes?

`Cologero on 2012-08-12 at 21:57 said:`

Apeiron, apparently you are not familiar with religious trends in the USA. I was referring to the neo-Christians in North America who believe they will be lifted up into the clouds before the end of the world as described here, for example[13]. There are many such believers in the USA. Not every Christian sect is "traditional" in its outlook.

The point is that there is no spiritual vision that can unify the West at the present time. Part of task pointed out in Point 7 is to see clearly the various movements competing for that vision.

`Dominion on 2012-08-12 at 21:59 said:`

A similar system still exists in China with the CPC's cadre apparatus. Prussia's Junker aristocracy is another good example of a sort of "aristocracy of merit".

This statement by Evola is, I think, very handy both as a repudiation of totalitarianism and aspects of historical fascism, and a guide to what exactly was wrong with it. When we look at fascist movements, there is a very big pattern of trying to preserve traditional forms without adhering to the truths that the forms are meant to embody. For example, Italian fascism's focus on the Roman Empire in its expansionist policy and "Caesarism", rather than in its spiritual Tradition. Spanish fascism's focus on the Catholic Church and the archetypal peasant, which resulted in the stagnation of many aspects of Catholic life in that country as the State used the Church as a justification for its totalitarian rule (writer Richard Wright reports that fornication among the Spanish agricultural classes was higher than in most other "liberal" European countries, a pattern that continues today in the American South with things like teenage pregnancy and use of pornography). National Socialism's focus on the racial Aryan, and not the spiritual one.

It is of utmost importance to realize the steps in which a transition and reformation in ideas must go. The ideas by some groups to implement an "Imperium" in Europe or the West at this stage is nonsensical. The first great task is to enable individuals to grasp the truths of Tradition themselves and begin their 'personal' transformation. As these numbers grow, it may become possible to create bigger and bigger networks. Then, and only then, can one even begin the think about restoring Tradition at the level of society and State. It may be well for us to purge the idea of ever seeing these later stages in our lifetimes, for it would be better to die knowing

[13] `http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Dispensationalism`

that a rebirth is being carried out step by small step than to see a false Imperium created by those who cannot see that it is a form containing nothing.

Ferdinand Gombault on 2012-08-13 at 09:59 said:

logres, Erik von Kuehnelt-Leddihn knew of Evola; in one of his works he mentions his name in a somewhat condescending manner pointing to his "paganism". If you wish, I could try to find the exact quotation. However, I doubt that Kuehnelt-Leddihn was really familiar with Evolas writings.

The two had a decisive dissent: Kuehnelt-Leddihn was a fervent catholic and I do not have to explain Evolas conviction in this regard. On top of that, Kuehnelt-Leddihn regarded himself as a "liberal" (though in a Central-European sense, which does not have the meaning "left", for Kuehnelt-Leddihn rather to the contrary), which I strongly doubt Evola would have done. Kuehnelt-Leddihn also was decidedly anti-rascist and anti-fascist, although anti-egalitarian and "right-wing". I personally would recommend reading his books as a stimulating contrast to Evola.

Logres on 2012-08-19 at 16:31 said:

Wouldn't there be a difference between arguing for a "white" Imperium & prudentially believing that certain ethno-states be maintained in relative genetic stability, provided that the entity was not allowed to exalt itself to a transcendental level, or expand at the expense of other, similar entities? Or is that an inevitable betrayal of principle, as well? Is the distinction moot at this point?

apeiron on 2012-08-19 at 19:15 said:

It is fair to say that Evola rejected the Jacobinic manifestation of the nationalist idea as lesser to that of a spiritual Imperium of Aryan races, hierarchically aligned. Why National Socialism and Fascism were not explicitly called "white" or "Aryan" nationalism is simply because there was no demographic crisis of white peoples in their indigenous homelands or of their genetic stock worldwide: the first tier of race. At least back in the thirties one had, more or less, only the spiritual problem to worry about.

In Evolas words, from "Doctrine of Awakening":

"We have to remember that behind the various caprices of modern historical theories, and as a more profound and primordial reality,

there stands the unity of blood and spirit of the white races who created the greatest civilizations both of the East and West, the Iranian and Hindu as well as the ancient Greek and Roman and the Germanic."

To say that there was no support for "anything calling itself "White Nationalism"" may be true but slightly misleading. Equally one could make the same argument for National socialism and Fascism, both modern themes influenced by masonic ideas yet stood as the last bridge-stone

since the middle ages to surpass modernism with the right direction. Both of these regimes Evola worked with, had they not been crushed by two daemonic hyper-material superpowers, it is only our speculation what may have come of them.

Cologero on 2012-08-19 at 20:39 said:

Logres, Evola's context was post-WWII Europe; he was pointing a way out of the ruins. Hence, a "white" imperium was implicit, given the ethnic constitution of Europe in 1951; he was not speaking of any other situation or other civilizations. The point, nevertheless, is that race, or even ethnicity, is insufficient as a unifying principle, and the facts bear that out. By definition, an Empire consists of ethno-states. So what Idea would unite them? Certainly, ethno-nationalism in itself would not.

As for Apeiron's thoughtful point, we wonder if the race that created the "Iranian and Hindu as well as the ancient Greek and Roman" civilizations even still exists; certainly that spirit no longer exists. Ironically, this is implied in his comment about the "two daemonic hyper-material superpowers", the modern equivalent of the "civilizations both of the East and West".

Sparrow on 2015-03-02 at 03:01 said:

I once made the point that White Nationalists with their petty agendas, orgiastic violence, and inability to contemplate the transcendent, had more in common both psychologically and in spirit with a drunken Red Army officer than the calm, disciplined SS foot soldier they desire to emulate. The remark was not well received, but I feel it had a certain truth to it.

Michael on 2012-09-02 at 20:46 said:

Will the action of reconstruction happen spontaneously, or will it be the result of an organization? In other words, is it just a matter of living in a certain way (riding the tiger) or the result of a movement?

Cologero on 2012-09-04 at 12:09 said:

Michael, nothing happens "spontaneously".

First, the conscious and unconscious agents of revolution need to be identified

Then, of the former, the covert and open agents of revolution

Then there must be an understanding of what revolution is

Then there will be the understanding of the opposite of the revolution

The possible is the real, hence the conditions to make the foregoing possible must be identified.

Cologero on 2012-09-04 at 20:23 said:

There is a rather odd debate[14] between Olavo de Carvalho and Alexander Dugin. In Section 9 Carvalho describes the possible historical agents. Although both men are Traditional men of the Right, influenced by Guenon, they are far apart from each other. I don't believe either one identified fully the revolution; whether their solutions are fully convincing is a matter for debate.

Logres on 2012-09-05 at 05:53 said:

That was an odd debate – I found myself in sympathy with the Westerner, but nodding at points Dugin was making, such as the necessity to love both a country/culture's flaws as well as excellencies (in a sense). Any comments you care to make further on this debate would be much appreciated, Cologero. Dugin has a Gnostic streak, at least in rhetoric, that is difficult to contextualize, for me.

Jason-Adam on 2012-09-05 at 06:17 said:

Not to go tangental, but I think that in order to fully understand what Olavo and Dugin were debating, we first need to consider the ideas of Franco Freda, the follower of Baron Evola, and his book THE DISINTEGRATION OF THE SYSTEM. I am sure Cologero has read the book, but to summarise it, Freda's argument was that men of Tradition are loyal to timeless principles irrespective of race or culture and thus if the West has become anti-Traditional beyond all hope of recovery, as Evola argued in Ride the Tiger, to restore a Traditional world it is first necessary to destroy the West; hence Freda's call for the "Right" to ally with the extreme and violent left. This is a huge influence on Dugin's worldview.

Michael on 2012-09-05 at 20:10 said:

When you said agents of revolution, I thought of the individuals and organizations that initiated and spread Enlightenment ideas, but Carvalho appears to have a broader understanding of what an agent is.

If Carvalho is correct, then the only hope of a return to Tradition in the West is the Catholic Church since it is doubtful that the other entities named (royalty & nobility, initiatory & esoteric organizations) are willing or able to do anything. This is especially true if Guenon was right in saying that initiatory organizations no longer exist in the West.

Cologero on 2012-09-05 at 23:52 said:

On one point, the two men agree: there is a globalist financial elite. Carvalho supports a conspiracy theory, identifying that group as the "Syndicate", transnationalist, not confined to any

[14] http://theinteramerican.org/blogs/olavo-de-carvalho/257-olavo-de-carvalho-debates-alexandr-dugin-ii.html

particular country. Dugin, OTOH, conflates that group with American power *in toto*. Whence, their widely divergent views. Carvalho[15] identifies three movements that can oppose the Syndicate: (Section 5)

1. An international union of Catholic and Protestants
2. Zionism
3. American neo-conservatism

There is no evidence of them acting in concert, nor even verbally opposing the plans of the "Syndicate", not even in muted tones. Nevertheless, Carvalho wishes to defend the existence of Catholic-Protestant Christianity, Israel, and the USA as a nation; he sees Dugin as calling for their extinction.

> Cologero on 2012-09-06 at 00:02 said:

No, Jason-Adam, I hadn't read it, despite its interesting premise. At the time of its publication, I would have been supporting the Left and would have seen no purpose in such an alliance. As far as its being "first necessary to destroy the West", every death is a birth; what interregnum of the left born from that destruction would then cede power voluntarily to Tradition?

As Evola makes clear in Point 10, the bourgeoisie can be opposed in two directions: from below and from above. What purpose would be served by adopting the goals of the proletariat? Would "aristocrats of the soul" take to the streets? We agree with Joseph de Maistre that what is necessary is not a revolution in the opposite direction, but rather the opposite of a revolution.

I'll reconsider it in the forthcoming review of Dugin's Fourth Political Theory.

> Cologero on 2012-09-06 at 00:10 said:

Michael, Carvalho himself anticipates a "worldwide united front of Christians [Carvalho does not include Orthodox], Jews, and American nationalists", whose existence, he believes, is threatened internally by the globalist elite (Syndicate) and externally by the powers Dugin supports: BRIC and international Islam. It is certainly not obvious what would unite those three groups, other than the desire for mere survival. The Catholic Church, such as it is, seems unable, and even unwilling, to do anything to oppose the modern project. However, this is not to say that the Traditional spiritual forces of the West cannot arise again in some other way.

> Jason-Adam on 2012-09-08 at 22:33 said:

[15] http://theinteramerican.org/blogs/olavo-de-carvalho/257-olavo-de-carvalho-debates-alexandr-dugin-i.html

The end goal is to restore Tradition. The perspective Evola took later on in his life was that it was no longer possible to go BACK to the Tradition of our ancestors but that we need to move forward to the start of the new cycle, hence we support the proletariat to speed up the process of destruction.

Over a period of several generations, it is possible that a new aristocracy would emerge from communism, and the system would transform itself from a material system to a metaphysical based one….the example of north Korea must be mentioned. north Korea has become a quite traditional monarchy based on Confucianism and (according to even its own officials) metaphysics.

Jason-Adam on 2012-09-08 at 22:39 said:

The other point to mention is that, in his recent essay THE MISSION of JULIUS EVOLA, Dugin said that Guenon and Evola were wrong to declare capitalism the thought of the third estate, and communism that of the fourth. He makes an intruging thought that since the Kali Yuga concludes with the rise of the Counter Tradition, atheistic communism cannot be the Antichrist. The fact the USSR fell while the USA remains shows that in the world of decline the Soviet Union was not as fallen as America is.

I forget to add that these are not my views but I am arguing Dugin's case, as part of a Socratic exercise to stimulate Cologero and Logres.

Logres on 2012-09-08 at 22:56 said:

Dugin wants to argue that the West is "water" and hence Chaos (the Thalassocracy of the Sea). But isn't Water just one of the Four Elements? Why would (inherently) Water be worse than Earth (Asia)? And does Water have something to do with the spiritual flood God is pouring out over the Earth? And does this make the North "Fire" and the South "Air"? Dugin has some fascinating insights and criticisms of the Anglo imperium, most of which I agree with in point, but I'm waiting for C to review the book before saying more. The destructive Gnostic side of Dugin is evident here:

http://arctogaia.com/public/eng/gnostic.htm

Russia will always be "Red" (Mouravieff emphasizes this) but I see no reason why Dugin would want to characterize the spiritual heritage of Orthodoxy as inherently "Gnostic" in the sense he describes. Part of the problem is with terms, but another part of the problem is that different sections of the globe are going to be "different" while remaining Traditional. Dugin may be deceived by some of his own rhetoric, it's possible – it wouldn't be the first time someone extremely bright (eg., Zizek) has gotten carried away by the sound of his own voice and ended up spinning webs of illusion for himself.

Cologero on 2012-09-09 at 18:45 said:

I am going to ask you, Jason-Adam, to hold that thought until we begin a review of Dugin's book The Fourth Political Theory. Despite his vast and deep knowledge of Guenon and Evola, he makes some serious errors. The first and most obvious is confusing the empirical and contingent with principles. Guenon and Evola point to the degeneration of castes, not necessarily to specific ideologies. For example, the problem is not capitalism in itself; rather it is making the values of the bourgeois the dominant values, and so on.

Keep in mind, too, that the USSR was leninist; according to Marx, communism would arise only after capitalism, so the USSR was premature and does not reflect perfectly what Dugin tries to pull from it. Also, there is little doubt that proletarian values are predominating in the USA; this is what we need to ponder, not how we label its economic system. Beyond that, there is the "fifth caste", the former outcastes, whose values (or lack thereof) predominate. How this manifests is up for discussion.

The worse fault is the metaphysics of Chaos over Logos, a very unfortunate mental error. The reasons should be obvious, but this will be a topic of discussion perhaps later this week.

Mihai on 2012-09-10 at 09:59 said:

"it is an integral part of the Christian conception"

The problem with Evola, in respect to his view of Christianity, is that when he speaks unconditionally about "Christianity" he actually has in mind Catholicism, which is certainly not the whole of Christianity. He is usually right when he criticizes certain failings of Catholicism, but- it is clear from his writings- that he completely ignores and has no knowledge of Orthodox (Eastern) Christianity.

It is true that here he only speaks for western Europe, but in general, he writes about Christianity as if there is nothing there except Catholicism.

Also, I agree that when talking about a positive solution to bring Europe back to Tradition, he only gives equivocal solutions.

"[….]for our men, pure reference to the spirit will suffice, precisely as the evidence of a transcendent reality, to appeal to another force in order to graft onto our force, to have a foreboding that our battle is not only a political battle, to attract an invisible consecration on a new world of men and leaders of men."

At best, this may only work for a few, very gifted, persons; but even they need a certain form in which to practice their spiritual aspirations. All in all, this really doesn't answer to the question of a "practical" spiritual life.

Michael on 2012-09-10 at 10:49 said:

Evola indicts Christianity as a whole: "These forces worked spiritually, through primitive Christianity, to destroy the European spirit. At first, they concealed themselves within the lunar spirituality which took shape in the Catholic church, that is to say, a spirituality whose type

is no longer the sacred king, the solar initiate, or the "hero", but the saint or the priest who bows before God, whose ideal is no longer the warlike, sacral hierarchy and "glory" but fraternal community and caritas."

I doubt that Orthodoxy is that different on these points given that the teachings of Catholicism and Orthodoxy both spring from the same Founder, the same scriptures. That is not to say that there are not differences, only that these differences are insubstantial in comparison to what is held in common.

I disagree with Evola on his rejection of Catholicism as the religious form for the West. The old imperial paganism and the cult of Mithra may be more ideal (from Evola's perspective), but they are both long dead because there is no succession in these religions.

I also don't follow on what has changed in the Catholic Church that has rendered it completely illegitimate. It was arguably valid in the Middle Ages. True, Western Civilization has changed, but the change has been in spite of the Church, not because of it.

Cologero on 2012-09-10 at 12:44 said:

Evola has been remarkably inconsistent over the years on this question. This is probably one of the reasons for Guenon's accusation that Evola was full of prejudices. Orientations was updated toward the end of his life, as the references to Vatican II make clear. Nevertheless, if the church still supported the Syllabus (which I don't see how Evola could agree with in toto) and there were warrior orders, he would support Catholicism. Keep in mind that the purpose of those orders was to (1) destroy paganism and (2) recapture Jerusalem. Which of those programs does Evola support? Or who else should they fight? Perhaps liberals? Is open warfare really the best option today? These and other obvious questions are never addressed.

Guenon and Evola disagree fundamentally on this issue. Guenon asserts that Christianity was esoteric at its source, hence Western Medievalism was also. For him, there would be no problem with Orthodoxy, particularly since it preserved much of the neo-platonic tradition. For Evola, on the other hand, early christianity was an aberration that was corrected in the West only by its fortuitous encounter with Nordic influence. The East did not have that encounter, but I doubt Evola even gave it a moment's thought.

As for the church today, which is embarrassed by the Middle Ages and treats the Syllabus with neglect, how can it be the same? Vatican II opened the door to the modern world, ignoring completely both the crisis and the revolt. All that is necessary is to read, for example, De Monarchia or Consolations of Philosophy to realize there was quite a different thought process. Since the Middle Ages was the last Tradition in the West, it is the place to start. To mindlessly repeat Evola's prejudices, which we run into quite often, is to really miss the point.

Michael on 2012-09-10 at 14:34 said:

Thanks for the clarification Cologero, but now my reading list has expanded yet again to include Boethius and the documents of the Council (read in light of the Syllabus).

What are your thoughts on the chivalric orders that have survived into the present? As you point out, they are no longer warrior organizations in our current age.

Mihai on 2012-09-10 at 15:48 said:

The Eastern Roman Empire (known today as the Byzantine Empire), preserved the old Greco-Roman traditions and laws and incorporated them in a Christian synthesis.

Not to mention the fact that Orthodoxy preserved throughout the centuries an initiatic path- Hesychia. Of course, this is a jnanic, contemplative path, which I doubt would attract much of Evola's interest. Still, I am pretty sure that he had no idea of it, because in one of his articles he said something like "The notion of a Christian initiation is, today, a pure fantasy", while it is clear that Hesychia is not a fantasy, even though it is quite difficult to obtain such an initiation.

I think Evola's view of Christianity was much too influenced by his early Nietzsche period, and this carried on, even if only residually, throughout the rest of his life.

Jason-Adam on 2012-09-11 at 01:47 said:

Evola is very contradictory. Here it seems that if the beliefs of the Vatican hierarchy were the same as those of the SSPX, Evola would be pro-Catholic. Yet when the Church was under B. Pius XII (who is denigrated by the enemy az a nazi) and fighting communism with success in Spain and Portugal, not to forget Croatia, and working with fascism from above through the Society of Jesus to make it into a positive state-building force while eliminating the negative destructive elements much as Evola was trying to do himself, Evola was totally anti-Catholic that whole time !

For myself, I am trying to decide on whether to adopt a western Orthodox or traditional Catholic practice. I lean towards orthodoxy because it preserves the doctrine of imperium as well as initiation through hesychasm and deification/theosis; but the one flaw I find in orthodoxy is that it does not have a theology of holy war the way catholicism does. I actually think traditional Catholicism as being somewhat more masculine and warlike than orthodoxy

Now, I think Evola's dismissal of orthodoxy comes from his reading DeMaistre's book on the Pope where he considers orthodoxy to be another form of protestantism.

Dominion on 2012-09-11 at 02:04 said:

In place of the western Crusade doctrine, Orthodoxy appears to have its battle theology encapsulated in the histories of the Orthodox nations. Tsar Lazar of Serbia, who chose the Kingdom of Heaven over that of Earth and died in a holy battle, is an example.

Mihai on 2012-09-11 at 02:15 said:

Catholicism seems to have created a confusion between temporal power and spiritual authority. The Pope's pretence to temporal power and the attempt at usurpation and annexation of the duties that rightfully belong to the Emperor have created many problems in the West.

In the East, there was no such confusion. Orthodoxy certainly is a path that is dedicated towards contemplation and purely metaphysical knowledge. However, this does not exclude the participation of more active types in the tradition.

The advantage that Orthodoxy has over Catholicism is that the latter has as its supreme point of reference the Supreme Being. The former goes beyond this point and considers the Supreme Identity and synthesis between Being and Non-Being.

DeMaistre, while I greatly respect him, does have some limitations because of his exclusivist Catholic upbringing. Even his easy dismissal of Luther and early Protestantism doesn't stand, as the problem is more complex than he seemed to consider. I have seen this sectarian type of exclusivism in many Catholics, which is a really assumptive attitude on their part. After all, it was in Catholic Europe that the modern deviation began, and it was from there that it spread all over the world. Catholicism has not only been unable to do anything to stop it, but, with Vatican II, it even gave in to it and began accepting whatever terms modernism imposed on it.

As always, realization is indirectly proportional to the level of boasting.

Graham on 2012-09-11 at 11:58 said:

Regarding Hesychastic initiation:

As we indicated above, genuine Hesychasm is so exclusive that any attempt at popularization and vulgarization is impossible.What is scattered in the modern world is a pseudo-Hesychasm which gives many the illusion that they obtain an initiation by repeating the Prayer of the Heart or practicing other techniques made public.

http://www.scribd.com/doc/81326126/Hesychasm-II

Graham on 2012-09-11 at 12:30 said:

"Now, I think Evola's dismissal of orthodoxy comes from his reading DeMaistre's book on the Pope where he considers orthodoxy to be another form of protestantism."

Christ himself established the Petrine Primacy: 'Thou art Peter and upon this rock I build my church…' . This was accepted with docility by the Eastern Fathers for hundreds of years, until the wanton rebellion that led to the Great Schism. Under such conditions I'm not sure how one can believe that the East "preserves the doctrine of Imperium."

Jason-Adam on 2012-09-11 at 19:30 said:

I am willing to accept that, Graham, but do Christ's words extend to the temporal sphere of things ? Is Peter Caesar ?

Audrey on 2012-09-16 at 21:29 said:

You know, I would agree 99%. The missing percent being a caveat on the female gender.. Every female in the beginning of her sexual life is at the mercy of a good partner who will assist her to grow up. It rarely happens and predatorial female cougars abound.. not to mention gurus. Society would be less to the left if sexual perversity did not abound.. Yet males need to be held accountable and they never are. More often than not they like to play Lambs of God as if it is all the women's fault. I believe that Evola addressed that as well.

Andrew on 2012-09-17 at 23:01 said:

Audrey is correct and that point deserves more discussion.

I have always thought a return to Sol Invictus is the only real option in a world that depends so much on the empirical. Manifestation is the living symbol of the principles from which phenomena precipitate. Emulation of the natural world's relation to the sun would produce a religion and society perfect on every level of realization.

Andrew on 2012-09-17 at 23:03 said:

Yes, Evola did address that point to the tune of, "the problem with women is that men have let them deviate in line with their natural tendencies".

Andrew on 2012-09-17 at 23:07 said:

There is an entire class of mythology, of which the trials of Heracles are a part, that tell the story of the "herculean" efforts it took to subjugate feminine nature to the order of Heaven. It was a sustained effort. What we have today is several generations that have given up on that civilizing project.

9.8 Spiritual Knighthood

> This is from a brief article by **Mircea Eliade** on the importance of **Ananda Coomaraswamy** and **Henry Corbin**. I don't know if this article is available elsewhere[16], but in case not, I have translated the French portions of it.

Ananda Coomaraswamy did not try to prove any doctrine, but rather

[16] https://www.amiscorbin.com/images/documents/pdfs/Eliade_1979.pdf

to show its consistency and intelligibility. Those properties provide the ground for faith, in the sense of "confidence" rather than belief. AKC writes:

> [Philosophia Perennis] is neither a system nor a philosophy, it cannot be argued for or against.

However, the story does not end there. Tradition cannot be proved because it is a fact, and there is no disputing facts. But to become a "fact", it must be realized, i.e., made real. When this happens, it is no longer faith, but rather gnosis.

What Ananda Coomaraswamy did for the comparative study of the religions of India with those of the West, including ancient paganism and the spiritual system of the Medieval period, Henry Corbin did for what are referred to as the three "Abrahamic faiths". He probes them in their depths, thereby rescuing them from the superficial critiques of both contemporary neo-atheism and neopaganism. Besides his lifelong devotion to the study of Persian and Sufi esoterism, Corbin was also interested in Heidegger's philosophy and, curiously, the immense works of Emmanuel Swedenborg.

Recognizing that the crisis of the West is in its foundations a spiritual crisis, Corbin founded the **International Center of Comparative Spiritual Research** in 1974. His goal was to encourage a new kind of university, where Traditional sciences could be studied free from the rationalistic prejudices of academia. He describes it:

> The specific character of this Association is marked in its very name: it makes the concept of "spiritual knighthood" the norm of its researches and activities, and it makes Jerusalem the mystical "symbol" of the encounters and gatherings whose place it hopes to be. The self-criticism of the West, as well as the accusations brought against it, never, in general, take into account

> the spiritual traditions of our western world, because they don't know them. The first cause of it is that unlike the great theological systems maintained by the religious Orders, or unlike the philosophical systems professed in the Universities, the treasure of the spiritual sciences, that can be grouped under the more or less suitable and adequate term of "esoterism" is found abandoned in a state of neglect. One could just as well speak of suffocation by the canonical and legal spirit. The result is that this treasure remained buried in libraries, an object sometimes of the curiosity of well-intentioned scholars, but most often the prey of improvisers lacking discernment. Whence the proliferation of pseudo-esoterisms. It is therefore important to finally form a home for these high sciences whose neglect and oblivion are at once the cause and the symptom of the crisis of our civilization. To this purpose we cannot separate the history of philosophy, the history of the sciences, the history of spirituality. But it is possible to not separate them only by a "rebirth" presupposing a plan of transhistoric permanency. Such is the meaning that we give to a restoration of traditional sciences and studies in the West. This restoration presupposed the necessary conjunction of the needs of the spiritual life and the rigors of scientific investigation, such that academics are accustomed to conduct.

There are three stipulations: first, it is limited to the three "religions of the book". Second, the spiritual meaning, i.e., the esoteric meaning of the Sacred Word is common to those religions. In his own words, this is the third:

> The Man, Adam, the *Anthropos*, was created in some other parts, let us say in the Pleroma, and "descended" down to this world. With him, the Word [Logos] descended to this world. With that descent, History begins. Man and the Word were made captive in or under a terrestrial envelope. Otherwise, they would not have

> been manifested in this world and History would never have begun. They would have remained in the state of flashing of non-perceptible light. However, under the terrestrial envelope, thanks to which we can see and hear, thanks to which we can give form to something like History, lives that flash of light which belongs to another world. At that point history is truly understood only if man perceives the trace of that flash and recognizes it … When he recognizes it, when that flash is remembered (*anamnesis*), man experiences the state of "those who know", the *gnosis* of the gnostic, in the strict meaning of the word "*gnosis*"… we therefore say that the flash of light, *exiled* under the terrestrial envelope, is at this point, *saved*. And such is the deep meaning of the word *gnosis*: a salvific knowledge because it is not a theoretical knowledge, but because it effects a transmutation of the inner man. It is the birth of the true man, the *verus homo*.

Corbin identified three sources of knowledge for "traditional science":

1. **Philosophy**. Intellectual activity, in the metaphysical sense of *nous* or *intelectus*.
2. **Theology**. The body of traditional teachings.
3. **Theosophy**. Inner revelation, or active imagination.

For Ananda Coomaraswamy, the *philosophia perennis* consists of the first principles behind the appearances of the several traditions. For Corbin, it is the visionary perception of the intermediary world that "is designated in Arabic as "*alam al-mithal*", that I need to translate by *mundus imaginalis*, the *imaginal* world, to differentiate it from the *imagination*.

Corbin concluded his presentation:

> Henceforth, the relationship between man and his God is that of knightly service. At its limit, this relationship produces the metamorphosis of the warrior knight to the spiritual knight.

> I just tried to find the type of scholar who, in the measure where he corresponds to the idea of the legitimate heritage [the esoteric Abrahamic tradition], can assume the vocation of spiritual knight. Because he is at the same time the man of knowledge and the man of desire [yearning for the Absolute; see e.g., *Man of Desire* by Louis Claude de St-Martin], because for him the intellectual life and research could never be isolated from the spiritual life and research, he provides a powerful contrast with the type of man in whom intellectuality is developed in ignorance of all spirituality.
>
> *Posted on 2012-10-18 by Cologero*

* * *

Audrey on 2012-10-19 at 21:22 said:

Indeed.. I had a brief moment of wondering 'why' I do what I do.. and then it occurred to me that it largely is about boundaries. Without constant work, mechanicalness will win. Hence, I understood the notion of working with others.

Audrey on 2012-10-19 at 21:24 said:

The mechanicalness of the Earth cannot be combatted with self-actulization only. Others must be brought along as well.

9.9 The Secret Meaning of Marriage

Recently several of Gustav Meyrink's books were republished: *The White Dominican*, *Walpurgis Night*, *The Angel of the West Window*, after the publisher Bompiani had already published a new translation of the *Golem*, a book that had in its time a great success in Germany and from which a film was also made.

Gustav Meyrink (1868-1932) is a truly unique author in his genre. The designation "novel" is only approximately applied to his books. If the supernatural has a prominent part in them, the whole is not reduced,

however, to the fantastic, as, for example, in Poe or Hofmann or even Lovecraft.

In them, the supernatural has, in its way, a realistic character through the frequent references to initiatic teachings, which sometimes are directly given, other times they come from symbolic contexts. For Meyrink this element is actually his primary purpose. So in an interview he declared that his novels were only "coverings", that they had a symbolic content which reflected his experiences. He asserted, moreover, that he more than invented his characters and their events, he "lived" them.

It is possible that Meyrink had an initiation in the proper sense. First of all, in his youth an impulse toward the supernatural had brought him to be interested in some spurious forms of "occultism" and to the same spiritism from which, however, he turned away from them decisively, pronouncing severe judgments on them. Especially thanks to successive contacts with some Hindus and Cabalistic circles, he found the "way" and was able to formulate a complex conception of life with a magical and initiatic orientation that, although expounded in novels—novels of a high artistic value — through his clarity and authenticity, it is difficult to find in works specifically dedicated to this material.

We can note here some of the principle aspects of this conception. As the center, we can value the doctrine of Awakening with the contrast between the habitual state of human existence and that of those who have passed onto a higher form of existence and who are also called the "Living", in its eminent sense. If Buddhism at its origins itself had the doctrine of "anatman", or the denial of a true I in common man, this is also Meyrink's view.

A character in Walpurgis Nights says:

> You truly believe that all those who often mill around in the streets possess an I. They do not even possess anything. They are rather possessed at every moment by a phantasm that plays the part of an I in them.

Elsewhere Meyrink speaks of "extinguished suns", of existence fundamentally spectral.

> Man is so firmly convinced of how much he is awake. In truth, however, he is imprisoned by a network of sleep and dreams that he himself has created. Those who are entangled pass through life like a herd led to the slaughterhouse.

The man who breaks away from the herd, has found again that

> key of power over his lower nature, rusted since the flood, who is called to be awake. To be awake is everything.
>
> Only the awakened man is, in reality, immortal. Stars and gods fade, he only remains and can accomplish everything that he wants. But there is a god above him.

Concerning the way that leads to awakening, Meyrink speaks of the "magical kingdom of thought", something different from the usual peculiar exercises of mental concentration pointed out by theosophy and "spiritualists". In a text inserted in the Green Face, some techniques to lead to awakening are pointed out, techniques that in part recall those of Yoga and that start from the immobilization of the body in order thereby to detach from it and transcend a world of appearances and illusions. Elsewhere, he also mentions the test of remaining conscious in a change of state provoked by toxic fumes.

It seems, therefore, that Meryink also considers a type of predestination or vocation (in the sense of being called) necessary to reach toward Awakening. For example, he recalled the legends about the apparitions of beings who "never died" — Elijah, John the Evangelist of the gnostics, the cabbalistic Chidher Green, to whom we could add the mysterious Islamic El Khidr — who would manifest themselves to those who "were bitten by snakes". Or to lead to such is a "destined" configuration of his

own existence, a sudden interior reversal (that in a certain world brings to mind the "satori" of Zen) or the sudden acceleration of existential rhythms: "like a horse who up until now had gone by walking and in one stroke launches into a gallop".

The event, then, can also have tragic aspects, it can be that of a type of Walpurgis Night: forces that are liberated, that take possession of the being and transport him. The awakening happens after something like a nightmare, and on that very subtle line that separates the "Way of Life" from the "Way of Death".

In Meyrink's world, woman and the symbol of the androgyne have an important role. The words put into the mouth, in the Green Face, of the cabbalist Sephardi in speaking of the bridge that leads to Life are:

> No man can reach that goal alone; he needs a female companion. It is only possible, if at all, by a combination of male and female forces. Therein lies the secret meaning of marriage which had been lost to mankind for thousands of years.

The reference is, however, especially to a particular "magical" type of conjunction, and it is only to this that the symbol of the realization of the androgyne (of the complete being, more or less in the Platonic sense) is tied. The basic idea here is that the sexual instinct "is the root of death", but that the task is not to eradicate it and to flee from woman as Christian asceticism proposes, but rather to absorb in man the feminine principle, separated on earth from the masculine principle, and a secret union that is not deprived of dangers.

The masculine and the feminine would not constitute just a polarity (which in common existence can also lead to a simple, banal complementarity). Between the two principles a tension and a latent but real antagonism exists. A character in the *Angel of the West Window* contrasts the "eros procreating like an animal" and common love, called "plebeian", sexual relations in which the latent sexual polarity becomes manifest and extreme, as much to confer on experience a destructive character.

If in China woman was called "the enemy" because she tends to capture the yang principle of man, Meyrink speaks of the "draining death that comes from woman" in relation to the action that she would exert — insensibly and invisibly — already in a general way; with clear reference to tantric practices, he however considers — always in the clothing of fictional events — some procedures intended to make the "magical element" carried by the masculine sexual energy not spill out and be lost in the feminine substance.

Among the various themes taken up by Meyrink from the initiatic Traditions, there is that of an "Order", that may also correspond to the "chain of the Living", i.e., of the "Awakened Ones", and the theme of a supreme occult center of the world, the seat of beings who invisibly control the destinies of men. For the second theme, recurrent in one form or another in secret teachings and in the traditions of various cultures, we can return to the vast material collected and interpreted by **Rene Guenon** in his book *The King of the World*.

The reader can also limit himself to the simple literary aspect of the "novel" in Meyrink's works which, as we said, are unique in their genre.

Some readers will be able, however, to also value adequately the actual teachings, like those which we have brought attention to, woven into the narrative events and symbolized by them.

This essay by **Julius Evola** was originally published in the journal "Roma" on 7 July 1972 under the title *Senso occulto del matrimonio*.

Posted on 2012-10-20 by Aeneas

* * *

Audrey on 2012-10-20 at 20:07 said:

Similar to Franz Bardon. Seems to be a beer putsh trend around the 19c. Meant not derogatorily, by the way.

Audrey on 2012-10-20 at 21:08 said:

And he seem to touch on the same things as Franz Bardon, esp. in his the Key to the True Qabbalah. The Hindu influence remains a mystery to me at its roots, despite my acquaintance with it both in terms of

teaching as well as persons.

Audrey on 2012-10-21 at 01:18 said:

Indeed! Hence for example, whereas I find rape absolutely unacceptable, as it robs the female of chances of growing conscious, it is true that in fact sexual instinct is te root of death. Evola wrote that even in death the man acts as a gateway for the female. Humorously, the power rape in the Army becomes subjugation to men's fear, cowardice, etc. Hence a perversity of survival and the entire food nonsense. Humorously, I carry an M16 which I shoot left-arm, even though I am right-handed. Nothing, and I mean nothing makes military males angrier, feeling weaker, etc. The whole notion that they cannot dominate a female's ass and fertilize it like it's mother earth drives them crazy. Sorry about the graphic quality of what is written. It is also why so many regard sex as initiatory and so forth. A female who has powers of life and death over men, and is not your mother/wife is extremely, how shall we say, unpalatable.

Tiffany Dawn Smith on 2021-10-20 at 17:14 said:

What a great blog to have found today! I just ordered Guenon's King of the World on your recommendation. Thank you.

9.10 Nietzsche for Today

> This essay by **Julius Evola** was originally published in the journal *Roma* on 28 July 1971 under the title *Nietzsche ancora oggi*. This is Evola's mature statement on Nietzsche, although it is not always clear if he is describing Nietzsche or himself. Tomorrow we will post our own opinions on "Nietzsche, 40 years later".

In Italy it seems that an interest in **Friedrich Nietzsche** has been revived. One obvious sign of it is that Adelphi of Milan is publishing critical translations of all his works; secondly, there is the almost simultaneous appearance of two books, *Nietzsche* by Adriano Romualdi, which contains a full essay on this thinker followed by a selection of passages from

his writings, and then the translation from the German of an excellent systematic work, *Nietzsche and the Meaning of Life* by Robert Reininger. The specific approach of the second of these books leads us to pose this question: apart from the importance that Nietzsche has as a philosopher in general, what can his ideas mean today and, more precisely, which of his ideas maintain any validity?

The relevance of this problem was brought to light by Reininger, by noting that the figure of Nietzsche also has the quality of a symbol, and that his persona embodies at the same time a cause: "it is the cause of modern man for which one fights, of this man no longer with roots in the sacred soil of tradition, oscillating between the peaks of civilization and the abysses of barbarity, seeking himself, i.e., led to create for himself a satisfying meaning for an existence of everything pushed back to himself."

One can further specify this view concerning the problem of the man of the period of nihilism, from the "point zero of all values", of the period in which "God is dead", on the basis of what Nietzsche had his Zarathustra announce, and that today is notoriously translated in a common and almost banal form; of the man in the period in which all external supports fail and in which — as our philosopher already said — "the desert grows".

In the same way, one can say that however much Nietzsche can possibly provide concerns the pure individual problem. All the formulations having a possible relation with collective and political problems are put aside, those for which many wished to see a collusion between Nietzschean doctrines and some past political movements, especially Hitlerian National Socialism and which were also accused of having fueled the pride of a presumed "Herrenvolk" (i.e., a master race) and the fixation with a poorly understood biological racism.

If a "superman" undoubtedly constitutes a central idea of the whole of Nietzschean thought, it is in terms of a "positive superman", it is not that grotesqueness in the style of d'Annunzio, nor the "blond beast of

prey" (this is one of Nietzsche's poorest expressions) and not even the exceptional individual who incarnates a maximum of the "will to power", "beyond good and evil", however without any light and without a higher sanction.

The positive superman, which suits the "better Nietzsche", is instead to be identified with the human type who even in a nihilistic, devastated, absurd, godless world knows how to stand on his feet, because he is capable of giving himself a law from himself, in accordance with a new higher freedom.

Here we must note the clean line of demarcation that exists between Nietzsche as "destroyer", the smasher of idols, and "immoralist" (this latter designation which he often claimed, but only to cause a sensation: because his disdain only concerned "petty morality" and "herd morality"), and that "revolution of nothing" [i.e., 1968], that anarchism from below which the profound crisis of the modern world is bringing about. It is as significant, as it is natural, that Nietzsche is absolutely unknown by the so-called "protest" movements of today, while he was the first and the greatest of rebels. There is no correspondence in the human subject, the true elective affinities — i.e., the plebeian — of such current movements is revealed in their frequent collusion with Marxism and its offshoots, and with every social and racial slum near to the violent and destructive surface of the purely subpersonal and naturalistic strata of being.

The words of Nietzsche's Zarathustra are current and pertinent, in this regard, when he asks who strives to loosen himself from every chain: "You call yourself free, but that does not matter to me — I ask you: free for what?", remembering that there are cases in which the only value that he possessed was thrown away together with the chain. This is a clear warning for those who today only know how to speak of "repressions" and who feed a hysterical intolerance for every type of authority — and they feed such an intolerance — just for this reason: because they do not have in themselves a higher principle that commands.

Now the Nietzschean type, who has put "nihilism behind him", who, in fact, "knows how to obtain a healthy remedy from such poison", is the one who instead possesses that principle, and who therefore also knows how to give himself a law. Reininger, in this regard, is correct in seeing in Nietzsche the affirmer of an "absolute" morality like Kant's, and certain connections could even be established with ancient Stoic ethics, which likewise advocated an interior sovereignty.

Certainly, the multiplicity of dramatically changing positions, sometimes even contradictory, among which Nietzsche sought to find his own way, can lead toward a quite different direction: for example, when Nietzsche promotes the exaltation of "life" or when he invokes the "fidelity to the Earth". Fidelity also to oneself: to be and to will to be what one is, sometimes this is proposed as the only possible and valid standard in the "desert that grows". The adequate, but dangerous, standard, known even in classical antiquity before any "existentialism".

The fundamental problem, of the greatest importance for what the best of Nietzsche can offer today, entails this danger. After what has been said at this point, one must be one's own law to oneself, it is a question of seeing what the individual finds in himself and accepting the limit reached by the multiple processes of spiritual dissolution that have acted in recent times: to see whether one finds in oneself that natural disgust for vulgarity and for every base interest, that will for a voluntary, clear discipline, that ability to freely establish "values" and to achieve them without giving up whatever the cost, those values that in Nietzsche define the "Overcomer" (Überwinder), the man not broken among so many things that are broken today.

Posted on 2012-12-30 by Cologero

* * *

Mihai on 2012-12-30 at 11:13 said:

I agree with your introduction, that Evola seems to combine a description of Nietzsche with a description of his own ideas.

In Nietzsche, there is nothing of the "positive superman" to be found- that is the person who can give himself a higher law according to a higher function, because for Nietzsche, there is no higher law or function to begin with. For him everything begins and ends in the individual- just like in every modern philosophical movement one might add.

If Nietzsche's writings are to be exploited, then one must keep his best ideas as regarding the means (such as his view of freedom), but totally discard the ends, because they are truly dead (ends).

It is also to be remarked that Evola only gives ambiguous explanations and descriptions whenever speaking of "higher values" or of "Transcendence".

X on 2012-12-30 at 12:12 said:

When Evola could address such person as Nietzsche having "an 'absolute' morality" in the last years of his life, it just can represent the actual level of his own morality. It was from such level of morality he could write those words about Christianity.

Avery on 2012-12-30 at 18:04 said:

Evola does have a few descriptions of higher values. He makes a few vague lists in Ruins which I will not go hunting for, and elaborates on some of them, like this one: "Against all forms of resentment and social competition, every person should acknowledge and love his station in life, thus acknowledging the limits within which he can develop his potential; and should give an organic sense to his life and achieve its perfection, since an artisan who perfectly fulfills his function is certainly superior to a king who does not live up to his dignity." (Ruins, IT edition, 171)

However, citing the Tao Te Ching, he insists that the laws of the traditional era "could not be reduced in any way to the domain of morality in the current sense of the word." (Revolt, 56) This reflects some statements in Guenon as well.

The main difference between Evola and Guenon, as articulated here before, is that Evola sees the articulation of Tradition as a will to solar power, while Guenon sees it as the discovery and maintenance of alchemical marriage. Of course the historical eras they most preferred were different as well.

Jason-Adam on 2012-12-30 at 18:40 said:

It will be interesting to read Cologero's thoughts on this article – he is correct to see that in discussing Nietzsche, Evola is really discussing himself, and in this way we can see the total and absolute affinity Evola felt with Nietzsche, something that began at a very young age for him, Nietzsche filled for the void for him left after he abandoned Catholicism following his reading

of Merejkowski's books. Nietzsche was arguable Evolas greatest influence considering how he modified the thought he took from others, even Guenon, to fit the Nietzschean pattern. As one website puts it, Evola's philosophy is an attempt to given Nietzsche a universal and metaphsyical basis.

Cologero on 2012-12-30 at 20:18 said:

Regarding the artisan, Aquinas makes a similar point. That passage from Ruins, moreover, seems to contain a lot of "moralizing". Even the Tao Te Ching can be translated as the Way of Virtue. I guess the key is to know what the current meaning of morality is.

There cannot be incompatible ways to "see" tradition. Those approaches must be harmonized or else one must be rejected.

Which historical eras did each prefer, assuming that makes sense? Evola was on record in saying that the way he thinks was the same as that of the well bred man before the French Revolution. Guenon is on record in saying that the restoration of Tradition in the West should use the Middle Ages as the model and that form it would take should be based on the spiritual tradition at that time. We seem to be isolated in taking that project seriously.

Cologero on 2012-12-30 at 20:38 said:

Dealing with the Nietzsche piece, Jason-Adam, will not bring any pleasure. I don't think it correct to say that there is a total and absolute affinity between Evola and Nietzsche. Evola often used the phrases "the best Nietzsche" or "the worst Nietzsche", so he clearly became aware at some point of the incompatibility of Nietzsche with Tradition. There is really no explicit doctrine of N. that E. adopts. E.g. in Revolt, we read "the superman notion which is Nietzsche at his worst." In this piece, E. rejects "the blonde beast of prey". E. never mentions, AFAIK, the eternal return, E. rejects N.'s naturalism, and so on. It was more a question of style. E. adopts a pattern, as you put it, a way of looking at things, and the bombastic style with its ideals of pagan greatness and anti-Christianism. This leads to some absurdities such as his wanting to praise the Middle Ages while rejecting its underlying spirituality.

Also in Revolt, E claims N had an absolute morality without knowing it. I'm sure N would deny it, had he heard that. The problem, as you accidentally point out, is that Evola had a personal philosophy instead of an impersonal metaphysic as explained by Guenon. By letting the camel's nose of Nietzscheanism under the tent of Tradition, Evola has led many astray. Yet on balance, I still think Guenon was Evola's greatest influence; E. referred to him as the "Master of the 20th century". On balance, then, I think the best practice is to read Evola through Guenon to get the most out of his writings.

Jason-Adam on 2012-12-31 at 00:04 said:

I agree with your observations, Cologero, and stand corrected.

Another point regarding Evola should be meditated on – his statement to Abd-el-Wahid Pallavicini that he was interested in temporal power moreso than spiritual. So it is fair to say that Evola places a greater emphasis on politics whereas Guenon sticks more with principles. I wonder what Evola (or Guenon) would think of Dugin's statement that one can not be a Traditionalist without personally being involved political anti-liberal activism.

I agree with the principle of Gornahoor on taking the Moyen Age as our base to which we should return to, as opposed

to following a foreign form or waiting for a new form to arise. The road is narrow and the way is rough however…..

Not to sound tangental, but how would you respond to Dugin's words in aninterview early this year where he said that he believes Orthodoxy is a fully valid form for the east, but as for the west it is up for westerners to decide which form is best suited for them; he personally prefering neopaganism because he fears a revitalised Catholicism would attempt to impose union with the eastern churches. We went over a lot of this before in discussing Romanides who is an important if uncredited source for alot of Dugin's beliefs – but I do see myself that the east-west schism is something that can not be undone so easily as there are cultural and geopolitical impasses in addition to the doctrinal…….I hope you can suggest something I am not aware of….

Mihai on 2012-12-31 at 03:29 said:

Dugin is hardly a worthy source for anything…

Avery on 2012-12-31 at 11:52 said:

Yes, both were trying to work with all pre-modern ages, but where Guenon saw Tradition as something that flowered with the intellectual glory of the Middle Ages, Evola was big on Roman pre-intellectual intuition, and disapproved of Catholic Christian developments as a step downhill that opened the path to failure. He was a well-bred and orthodox pagan, and he would have made a fine Japanese, but he never made any pretense at embracing developed, medieval traditions as Guenon clearly did.

I agree that at least one of these views is wrong, or at least needs repair. Evola's use of Nietzsche and Otto Weininger can clearly be improved on. But both writers presented internally complete systems and there are good arguments to be made for both "Tradition as the primeval pagan imperialism" and "Tradition as fulfilled by the medieval nations". I made a study of both views in my recent book but failed to reach a conclusion; we'll see how the editor likes it.

Janus on 2012-12-31 at 17:08 said:

It's important to not fall into a "will the real Tradition please stand up" trap. Both ancient Rome and medieval Europe incarnated the Tradition in it various aspects. The difference, as

Lings pointed out, what that the Christian embodiment of Tradition pointed to Love as a path to salvation, whereas this was not emphasized as much in Rome. Given that we are working in the western context, It's useful to look at both Christendom and Rome as predecessors in Tradition. But its re-manifestation won't look exactly like Christendom, nor Rome. Once an age of Tradition is lost, it can only be reborn, not resurrected into a zombie.

Cologero on 2012-12-31 at 18:55 said:

Excellent points, Janus. I think we are just interested in what features are Traditional so they can be recognized. The next cycle will begin first in consciousness, so there will first appear a vanguard with that clear inner vision.

Fourth Magi on 2021-12-30 at 10:23 said:

Nietzsche is great, but logic is not his forte. Otherwise, he would have noticed that humanity rejected God when it realized that the concept of God contradicts the concepts of human good and evil. There is no need to overthrow God, since God has become superhuman and needs protection from everything that is too human.

9.11 Initiatic Centers and History (I)

> This essay is chapter 17 of *L'Arco and la Clava* by **Julius Evola**. It will be published in two parts; the first part deals with general considerations and the second with Tibet.
>
> There are several things to ponder. For example, what is the "symbolic dimension" to consider, and how is it related to the historical? Is there really any historical evidence, in the current academic sense, for these centers? How can such centers be recognized? What are the higher states of consciousness? Why were the centers unable to prevent the current decline, a topic Evola brings up, blaming the fall on man's freedom? Are the current pan-Islamic movements really an attempt to restore Tradition to those lands? If so, have the Sufi centers played any role in those movements?

Given the confusions that abound in this area, it is opportune to clarify

first what we mean, in general, by "initiatic centers" and "initiatic organizations".

We treated initiation in an earlier chapter[17], so here we will limit ourselves to recall that, in its authentic and integral meaning, initiation consists in an opening of consciousness beyond human and individual conditionalities, entailing a modification of the subject (of his "ontological status"), who then participates in a higher freedom and a higher consciousness. That is tied in the grafting in the individual of an influence in a certain transcendental, or not simply human, way. In general such an influence is transmitted, and the transmission is an essential function of an initiatic center. What arises from it is the idea of an uninterrupted "chain" (the term used in Islam is exactly silsila) whose origins are remote and mysterious, in parallel with a "tradition". According to the Guenonian school, the various initiatic centers, if they are authentic and regular, would be connected to a unique center and would even draw its origins from it. A similar assumption confronts us however with difficult problems, if it must be validated in some way.

For the topic that we intend to discuss here, the question arises about that aspect of spiritual influences that do not solely concern "knowledge", a spiritual illumination, the attainment of gnosis, but also a power. This power could even be considered by some—and not incorrectly—as a positive sign because, as long as it is only about a knowledge regarding higher spheres, but if it remains in a purely interior domain, it could also create illusions. The coexistence of a power, that as such is verifiable, is an indirect, but sufficiently positive, proof, for the solidity and the reality of the same knowledge which is considered to having been attained by means of an initiation.

Titus Burckhardt, moreover, was able to speak, in terms of initiation centers, of spiritual influences "whose action, if not always apparent, passes incommensurably beyond everything that is in the power of men".

[17] `http://thompkins_cariou.tripod.com/id49.html`

Let's move now into the area of reality and history. We had a friendly debate with Burckhardt about the existence and the state of initiatic organization in the world of today. It is not that we assert that they no longer exist, but rather that they have become ever more rare and difficult to access (the assumption is always that it is about authentic initiatic organizations, and not of spurious groups that claim to have such a character). It seems that a progressive withdrawal of such organizations, and therefore of the forces that are manifested in them and of which they were the bearers, has been verified. Moreover, to refer to some traditions worthy of note, this phenomenon would not even be recent. We will limit ourselves to mention those texts in which it is said that the search for the Graal was brought to an end, but through a divine order, the Templars of the Graal abandoned the West and moved, together with the mystical and magical object that no longer remained "among the sinful peoples", to a mysterious region, sometimes identified as where "Prester John" reigned. And there, magically, the castle of the Graal, Montsalvat would also have been relocated. Naturally, the symbolic dimension must be considered in all this.

A second, more recent tradition concerns the Rosicrucians. After causing a commotion, especially with their Manifestos in which they made known their "invisible and visible presence" and with their project of the restoration of a general higher order, the Rosicrucians also withdrew, going back to the beginning of the 18th century; for this reason, we consider that certain groups who subsequently self-qualified themselves as "Rosicrucian" were without authorization and lacking every regular traditional filiation or continuity.

We could add an Islamic testimony of the Ismailist initiatic stream and in particular by that of the so-called Twelvers. The corresponding view is that the Imam, the supreme head of the Order, the manifestation of a power from above the also the beginning of initiations, has likewise withdrawn. They instead await those who will manifest again, but the

current epoch would be that of an "absence".

Nevertheless, that, in our opinion, does not imply that initiatic centers in the strict sense do not currently exist. Without doubt, they still exist, even if in that respect the West barely comes in question and needs to advert to other areas, both in the Islamic world and in the Orient. That established, the problem is the following: if, as Burckhardt asserts, such centers were deposits of the spiritual influences by definition, were deposited, apart from the initiatory use, we have to attribute the beginning of a possible action to something external that "if not always apparent, passes incommensurably beyond everything that is in the power of men", how must we conceive the relationship between such still existent centers (if existing not as mere survivals) and the course of recent history?

From the traditional point of view, this course has, in general, an absolutely involutive and dissolutive character. Now, in the face of forces that are at work in these developments, what is the position of initiatic centers? If they always have had those influences as is claimed, must one think of a type of order received from them, but not using them, and not preventing the process of involution, or must one hold that the general process of "solidification" and impermeability of the environment to the supersensible, provoking a type of rift now renders relative every action that goes beyond the initiatic field in the purely spiritual and interior direction?

It is good to clarify and to put aside the cases in which historically are only the harvested fruits which had been sown earlier. Men have a fundamental freedom. If they have used it for their ruin, the responsibility falls on them and there is no reason to intervene. Now, we can say that for the West, which has been taking the path of the anti-tradition for some time and that through a chain of cause and effect, sometimes quite visible, sometimes hidden to a superficial glance, fatally proceeded to find itself in its current state, that resembles the kali yuga, the "dark age" prophesied by ancient traditions.

But in other cases, things do not remain in the same way. There are civilizations that by not having followed the same path, by not having chosen mistaken vocations, but finding themselves subjected to external influences, would have to be defended. But that seems to not be observed. For example, in the case of Islam there are certainly existing initiatic Sufi centers, but their presence has not actually prevented the evolution of Arabic countries in an anti-traditional, progressive, and modernist direction, with all the inevitable consequences.

> This is the conclusion of the essay, dealing with initiatic centers in Tibet. In it, **Julius Evola** proposed a sort of occult drone warfare, assuming initiatic centers truly possess superhuman powers. He offers reasons why the Tibetans allowed the communist invasion had they been able to prevent it by paranormal means. I am curious about reactions to this piece as well as how it relates to the current obsession with various "superheros".

But a decisive case is that of Tibet. Tibet did not consider at all taking the same path as Western countries. It had maintained its traditional structures intact and was also considered as a country in which, more than any other, individuals and groups existed who were in contact with superextensible and divine powers. That did not prevent it from being invaded, profaned and devastated by the Chinese communist hordes, which also put an end to the "myth" of Tibet whose fascination had such a hold on the Western spiritual milieu. Yet, in principle, there should have been manifested and presumed for possible use, some concrete opportunities of what was attributed to influences of a not simply human and material order.

To be precise, we are not thinking of invisible and magical barriers of protection that would have blocked the invaders of Tibet. It is sufficient to advert to something somewhat less spectacular. For example, with reference to so-called modern parapsychological research, performed under

strict controls, the reality of "paranormal phenomena" has been verified, that is, the possibility that objects can be displaced, moved or levitated at a distance without a normal explanation. Only that, given the matter with which almost exclusively has to do paranormal research, it is a question of spontaneous sporadic processes, often extrasensory, but not producible at will. Nevertheless the fact has been verified that a psychic agent can cause phenomena like the levitation of a heavy object, that implies an undoubtedly superior force to the force necessity to cause, for example, brain damage with a deadly outcome. Even the phenomena of bilocation, or of the projection of one's own image in a distant place, has been verified (moreover, it seems that it has happened even with Padre Pio of Pietralcina).

So, from everything that has been reported by travelers and observers worthy of credence, beginning with Alexandra David-Neel, similar phenomena was verified in Tibet, however not as phenomena of an extrasensory and unconscious character, but rather as consciously controlled and willed phenomena, made possible by discipline and initiations.

Now, it would have sufficed to use powers of that type to cause, for example, a cerebral lesion and thereby to strike down Mao Tse-Tung at the moment the first communist division crossed through the Tibetan border. Or rather to use that power of projection of one's own image to cause a warning apparition in the face of the Chinese communist leader.

All this should not appear as a merely digressive fantasy to those who have a conception of initiatic centers like that indicated by Burckhardt's words cited above and who believe that similar initiation centers still exist. And haven't the Tibetan traditions even spoken of the famous Milarepa who in the first period of his life, before reaching the Great Liberation, was an outlaw who dedicated himself to black magic, and, in fact, caused a massacre of his adversaries by magical means? Instead we are present at the end of Tibet, without being able to bring in the idea of a type of

Nemesis (as for the West). A recently translated book in Italian[18] speaks of the Odyssey of those lamas who were able to do nothing but escape in order to save their lives, while in the country others were massacred, by those who sought to eradicate everything that had a holy character, and began the communist atheist indoctrination of the people. The only resistance was the guerrillas of Tibetan partisans who pulled back in an inaccessible area. It is useless to say what, an occult defense like that mentioned would have signified instead. Its significance would have made all the marvels of voyages and amazing explorations boasted about by the modern Western world appear very banal and insipid.

So the problem we just posed holds good, without, it would seem, an adequate clarification of it being possible. The only idea that perhaps I could put forward is that of a type of fracture of what exists and the autonomization of a certain part of reality, therefore also of history, with a consequent impermeability in regard to extrasensory influences. It could also relate to the doctrine of cycles, to that which is characteristic of the closing of a cycle. Only that in the case in question, little space would remain for values of a moral character. We should think of a general process in which even those who have not fomented it find themselves implicated. And it should also relate to a type of password transmitted to initiatic centers, with the goal of letting destinies be fulfilled.

This is an order of ideas that would lead rather far, to the same conception of an inscrutable direction of the world and, in another direction, to the existing relation between freedom and necessity. When another perspective should not be of value, necessity could be related only to the factual domain of existence and freedom for various attitudes that could be assumed in the face of facts (or to the reaction to them), which, in terms of principle, is not determined. In this context one could give, among others, a particular weight even to negative and dramatic experiences, that they can give if one assumes a given attitude, even to take on

[18] *Born in Tibet*, by **Chogyam Trungpa**.

the character of a test. As we see, this is a field of rather vast and complex problems, with which is also grappled with in the theology of history. We have mentioned this only as a general background to which the deepening of the specific subject of this essay refers.

Note Evola added the following note regarding the theology of history.

> At the traditional Catholic base, things are not so easy in cases like Spain's so-called "Invincible Armada"; organized against the heretics and set sail after having every very solemn consecration, it was destroyed, even prior to actual combat, by a storm, the "forces of nature".

Posted on 2013-01-20 by Aeneas

* * *

Jason-Adam on 2013-01-21 at 08:24 said:

Some modern writers that that Evola was maybe a bit pessimistic regarding the influence of iniatory centres in the Islamic world and that the modern Islamic movements such as the apocalyptic Khomeini movement in Iran, based around the coming return of the 12th Imam, is such a result of a traditional force acting.

Cologero on 2013-01-27 at 20:45 said:

It seems Evola is moving the problem of theodicy from God to the initiatic centers. If the latter centers had been able to prevent a great evil, should they not have done so? he asks. He makes some conjectures about why that may not have been possible.

You can imagine how absurd history would be if every "bad guy" was occultly punished by initiatic centers prior to their nefarious deeds. Given such powers on the material plane, it is difficult to conceive how they could have disappeared. Isn't it more likely that the superhuman powers spoken of involve states that transcend human, all-to-human, concerns?

His theology of history is also skewed. If God always "intervened" to punish the bad and reward the good in this life, then men would become religious merely to be on the right side of things, in order for personal gain. There would certainly be no need for faith, since God's will would be visible to everyone, clearly and not as a reflection in a dirty mirror.

Logres on 2013-01-27 at 23:22 said:

If the natural state of affairs is the "Golden Age", then to induce a degeneration, the falling asleep of higher centers (collectively and personally) would be required: it would grow colder and colder, and conscious centers would drop off to sleep. Those that were still awake would perhaps withdraw in order to maintain their own equilibrium? Basically, a period of dormancy? This is in Nature. Maybe, as you say, the whole point is to reassert the absoluteness of God at the end of the cycle, in such a way that no one who remains awake can be in any doubt that God's sovereignty is supreme. He seems to be referring at the end of the essay to "transvaluation of morals"; and I have no idea what he means by a "password". But the Spanish Armada reference is intriguing, especially when one thinks that Lepanto had an entirely different outcome in the opposite direction (and not that far removed in time).

Cologero on 2013-01-27 at 23:59 said:

Password or watchword … the translation of "parola d'ordine'.

Yet Constantinople fell not long before the Armada and a millennium after Constantine's victory. Notre Dame lost to Alabama.

The rain falls on the just and the unjust … I don't think we can draw any conclusions from who gets wet.

But he was writing specifically about Tibet which in recent times (Evola's recent) was presumed to still have secret initiatic centers, or perhaps not so secret. They had the powers of telekinesis and bilocation. If true, why did they not use them against the communists? Of course, these superhuman powers existed in a vertical direction, not on the horizontal plane. In line with the principle "don't feed the animals in the wild", and "let wildfires run their course", these higher powers don't interfere directly on lower planes.

Mihai on 2013-01-28 at 05:15 said:

This article surprises me. As an author of so many good esoteric books (and a person who studied such things all his life) Evola seems to speak with no reservations about reckless usage of magical powers, with an ease that only the lesser of occultists would be capable of.

It surprises me even more greatly since, even as early as 1931, in his "Hermetic tradition", he wrote about magical powers for material ends that "a true adept would only make use of such a thing when it is justified by a higher, spiritual goal". (the quote is approximate, from my memory- see the closing chapters of the above mentioned book).

If we are to approach historical things from such an angle, we could ask indefinetly all sorts of non-sense questions such as : why did the early Christian martyrs, who produced such great miracles, not use their powers to (at least) avoid detection from the Roman authorities when they came looking for them. Or why did Christ, as the Second Person of the Trinity and

Principle of the whole of manifestation, did not use His powers to come down from the Cross (as His adversaries "suggested"), or, better yet, to tear them to shreds, or to destroy the whole universe at that moment, as unworthy to receive His blessings.

It is very unclear to me why would Evola, who his whole life emphasized the overcoming of a merely human understanding of history, would make such inquires in this essay.

As for the theodicy that Cologero brought forth in the above comment, I think that Boethius did a fine work.

Cologero on 2013-01-28 at 07:58 said:

Not to forget the first half of the essay where Evola is addressing Burckhardt's claim about initiatic centers "whose action, if not always apparent, passes incommensurably beyond everything that is in the power of men". Evola seems to be saying that if that is true, then their action in history is not visible. Recall this passage:

> From the traditional point of view, this course has, in general, an absolutely involutive and dissolutive character. Now, in the face of forces that are at work in these developments, what is the position of initiatic centers? If they always have had those influences as is claimed, must one think of a type of order received from them, but not using them, and not preventing the process of involution, or must one hold that the general process of "solidification" and impermeability of the environment to the supersensible, provoking a type of rift now renders relative every action that goes beyond the initiatic field in the purely spiritual and interior direction?

Mihai on 2013-01-28 at 08:54 said:

Yes, it seems I have taken this text out of context.

However, it remains true that Evola does treat this question rather simplistically, although he does seem, in the end, to at least lean towards a right conclusion. The problem is to understand, first of all: what do we mean by an invisible "action". Surely, no such center would ever act against the course of Divine order.

It is just a question of HOW do these 'centers' manifest beneficent effects, according to the natural flow of each age. For example, in the current state of the Iron Age, to act upon the world may mean to lead a few of the individuals who still are capable of upholding superior principles back to tradition.

I believe that Evola's perspective does tend, at times, to be limited because of his somewhat "magical" understanding of certain esoteric phenomena (if I can call them such), a perspective he never really quite shook of.

Scardanelli on 2013-01-28 at 09:22 said:

So the modern superhero phenomena could be seen as a sort of counter-initiate… He who uses his superhuman powers strictly on the horizontal plane for material gains and ends, and always to the benefit of the masses. For a traditional initiate to use his powers in this way would be a debasement of himself.

Scardanelli on 2013-01-28 at 12:16 said:

Further, would this not also imply that physical superhuman powers are but the lower analogue of a higher understanding? For instance, telekenesis is simply the physical manifestation of a power which is manifested differently at a higher level? I'm not sure what the higher analogues might be that correspond to their lower physical powers, but perhaps this is why I can't fly through the air or read the thoughts of others.

Scardanelli on 2013-01-28 at 13:10 said:

Thus, it would seem that it isn't a question of why these initiatic centers failed to act, as it would seem that in the "solid" nature of the Kali Yuga especially, these purely physical powers might be easier or encouraged in some way. Perhaps any attempt to physically act against the forces of degeneracy would only encourage the process…you hint at this somewhat in your comment Cologero, and forgive me if I'm repeating the obvious here. I'm just following a line of thought…

Jason-Adam on 2013-01-28 at 23:59 said:

Very well written and thoughtful piece by Evola here.

The only thing I can add to his writing is by asking if there is any merit at all to the hypothesis of a few so-called traditionalists that there were somehow connections between initiatory centres and communist parties and that the triumph of communism in the east was not in spite of but because of said centres ?

Avery on 2013-01-29 at 02:02 said:

Evola had a bit of blurring between fantasy and reality in his most abstruse studies of distant places and ancient lands, even while his practical understanding of the world around him was solid. If you read The King of the World carefully, you will notice that even when Guénon felt personally convinced of a fact about magic, initiation, deep history, etc., he found its symbolism to be more important and make the pursuit of "authenticity" less relevant. Evola,

on the other hand, really was interested in Atlanteans and superpowered Tibetan monks, even though he saw through the myths of contemporary Italy. It's sort of a modern version of the traditional Eastern story of getting distracted by promises of unlimited power while following the initiatory path.

Pickman on 2013-01-29 at 14:05 said:

[Cologero :Of course, these superhuman powers existed in a vertical direction, not on the horizontal plane. In line with the principle "don't feed the animals in the wild", and "let wildfires run their course", these higher powers don't interfere directly on lower planes.]

What are you suggesting that these so called superhuman powers were metaphors of in a vertical direction?

Cologero on 2013-01-29 at 16:51 said:

Yes, Pickman, primarily metaphors or better, symbols. This is not to suggest that they are not "real" powers at their own level.

Otherwise, we are stuck with the problem Evola brings up: why did the centers not use their powers over material manifestation to prevent the communist takeover? Instead, the lamas took off when they could, leaving the population to their own devices.

We see this, too, in our time with the "Law of Attraction" fad. For its adherents, the purpose of higher spiritual powers is to manifest better things in life such as automobiles, money, love, etc. This would eliminate the whole notion of a "quest", or seeking, since who were of superior spiritual development would be visibly obvious. But mythically, the quest is into the unknown, not the known.

9.12 The Fire of Creation

This review by **Julius Evola** of J J van de Leeuw's book **The Fire of Creation**, in its Italian translation, originally appeared in *Bilychnis*, volume XXXII, August-September, 1928.

J J van de Leeuw was a Theosophist and a priest in the Liberal Catholic Church[19]. In van de Leeuw's understanding of the Trinity, the Father is the Will, the Son the Logos, and the Holy Spirit

[19] http://www.thelccusa.org/

> is Thought. Evola sees in this book an echo of Joachim of Fiore[20], a saintly Abbott and highly regarded by **Dante**. In this review, Evola picks out one of the more interesting themes of the book, summarizing it rather well. Since the Liberal Catholic Church, just like the Roman, claims apostolic succession, we could read this as what Evola wished the Catholic Church would teach. Consider it his contribution to Vatican II, had he been allowed.

Though belonging to the stream of Blavatsky's anglo-indian theosophy, about which we have written not very favorably in the past, this work, whose Italian translation we draw attention to, represents something deep, clear, and well sketched out. The usual mythological cosmologies are not found in it, nor does he stray into clairvoyance, reincarnation, or similar topics. Van de Leeuw instead proposes a *practical* point of view, of direct spiritual experience.

The mystical prophecies of **Joachim of Fiore** had earlier announced: "The Kingdom of the Father has passed, that of the Son is passing, the Kingdom of the Holy Spirit is on the point of arising." And Van de Leeuw declares precisely that today we are truly at the dawn of the coming of the third person in the dialectic of the divine; the direction of creative activity in motion, of the universe in which *dynamis* or power is the fundamental note, and the immanent presence of the "cosmic Fire" is characteristic of this. The evolutionist and becomingistic direction, the meaning of liberty, of independence from every creed, of individual initiative; the more and more prevalent tendency to move from action to knowledge rather than from knowledge to action until now, are, in modern times, so many signs of it. Those who have been touched by the "Fire of Creation" throw themselves into action, confident of drawing their certainty and their religion from it: they no longer say "we pray", but they say instead "we work". The author insists greatly on this aspect of *experience*, and not

[20] https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Joachim_of_Fiore

of philosophy or belief. One is put in relationship as with a conductor charged with a current of spiritual life, from which proceeds a discharge that dynamizes all our being. In the experience of the "Fire of Creation" one has the sense of a superior energy of something previously felt, and we are electrified through action. In such a moment we feel not only that we desire to do some things, but that we *can* do them: it seems to us that no obstacle can ever resist this enormous energy that we now feel inside of us.

The author seeks moreover to justify in terms of inner experience the same concept of the "Divine Mother": it would be an aspect complementary to the Fire or to the Holy Spirit, to which it stands in the same relationship of the feminine to the masculine. The sense of hot activity producing its happening in something, the perception of being the same nature and of transforming within ourselves the radiant powers, the creative activity of the creative Fire in the fruitfulness of advancement and in abundance of beauty and form. Close to the impulse to act, the direction that we can make of the exultant joy that is awakened when we know the "Holy Spirit" principle, the complementary aspect "Mother" is instead a process of intimate transformation that renders productive what used to be dead.

The author also gives examples of techniques to produce these experiences. The presupposition is that the ordinary world is only a projected image of our consciousness through the mind and senses. We confuse this image with reality. It is then a question of controlling such an idiosyncrasy of our human manufacture, that makes us project the consciousness of what is inside us around ourselves into the world, and to reconverge at the center, instead of losing ourselves in the contemplation of our image of the world, just as the prisoners of Plato's cave stare at the shadows on the walls. It is possible to concentrate our Self into a very small point of consciousness and to pass through that point into the world of the Real, of the "things that are", and no longer our exteriorized images of it. We

have to push ourselves ahead, and having withdrawn our consciousness from its image of the world and stopped its transcendental imaginative faculty, reintegrating ourselves in that absolute immanence, from which they originate, at the same time, the sense of the Fire of Creation and the vision of the Real in the world.

Posted on 2013-04-10 by Cologero

* * *

Jason-Adam on 2013-04-11 at 13:27 said:

I have not read this book but desire to after reading Evola's positive review.

Let me add though that the Liberal Catholic Church is a heretical breakaway sect based on Free-Masonry and rebellion against Vatican I and is not an apostolic Church.

Cologero on 2013-04-11 at 16:08 said:

I suspect, Jason-Adam, that Evola's review is better and more inspiring than the book itself, which may disappoint. Unfortunately, I can't locate my copy of the book which I had read quite some time ago.

Jason-Adam on 2013-04-11 at 17:35 said:

This is tangental but I feel it necessary to include this on a page devoted to Evola and the Church – I hope Avery will see this and comment as well :

Avery made an interesting remark that all the political Traditionalists are anti-Christian whereas the Christian Traditionalists are not involved in political movements. I believe this is because we are seeing the difference between brahmans (the Christians) and kshatriyas (the pagans). I offer as an opinion the reason why modern day kshatriyas in the west are driven to despise the Church is because the Church has failed to maintain the path of action, the old time warrior Christianity of the Crusades. What Catholic of today would praise Godfrey de Bouillon the saviour of Jerusalem ? One of my favourite works of epic poetry is Gerusalemme Liberatta of Tasso's, would modern Catholics see themselves in that work ? Would any respectable theologian say with St Bernard that it is good and right to kill the enemies of the Catholic religion ? The general effeminancy and passivity of the modernist Church is turning away men of fighting spirit.

It is ironic that the main reason I am so drawn to catholicism, true catholicism, is that compared to the contemplative spirit of the eastern church, western catholicism is a religion of action as Soloviev eloquently explained in Russian and the Universal Church.

Michael on 2013-04-11 at 20:48 said:

Van de Leeuw's teaching sounds attractive. Who would not want to be filled with the power to overcome all obstacles? But chasing after this kind of experience is probably a waste of time. Better to just be men of action in fact rather than waiting for some move of the Spirit, and we will find that it has been the Spirit moving us all along after all.

Cologero on 2013-04-12 at 08:34 said:

Yes, Jason-Adam, you have identified the cause of the break up. I've noticed, however, that even the neo-pagans display images of Christian knights on their web sites, so they may not be as far from you as you may think. This split is bad for both sides. The "brahmans", as you call them even though they have not preserved the entire spiritual heritage, are attracting spirits of a certain type. Occasionally I check their writings and what is remarkable is the vitriol and antipathy they display toward their fellow religionists who doesn't accept that the church began — or recreated itself anew — in 1965. They are really modernists, perhaps with little quirks such as opposition to abortion; otherwise, spiritually they are quite similar.

The "kshatriyas", in their position, give up 1500 years of their history along with the deep metaphysical, spiritual, and moral teachings, etc. It seems to me that the battle needs to move to a different front and the spirituality appropriate for the kshatriya given its proper place.

Avery Morrow on 2013-04-12 at 12:57 said:

I agree that the split is bad for both sides. I will give Jason-Adam's question a shot. For me, Hannah Arendt's *The Human Condition* has been a key to this pagan-Christian puzzle. To summarize just some of her work: the ancients considered labor an animal necessity, and only who had absolutely no need for work could be considered freemen and citizens, who were suitably free of private hindrances to devote their lives to public work. So far, so Evola. Christianity cultivated this disgust for lowly animal needs into a complete rejection of the earthly city, which perhaps was becoming a burden for the late Romans. Thereafter you had Guenon's division of spiritual authority and temporal power, with only the spiritual being truly public. But even in the temporal world the proper distinction between public and private persisted and was widely understood.

Arendt identifies some modern inversals that even Evola did not seem to catch. She says that the modern devolution of power actually destroyed the idea of "public good" entirely in the West and replaced it with a confluence of private interests which slowly corrupts and devalues our sense of the public sphere. Furthermore, she identifies this counter-tradition with "society"! As opposed to the classical Senators and medieval peers, whose speech was truly free, modernity more and more requires people to agree with each other to achieve social graces. "The victory of equality in the modern world is only the political and legal recognition of the fact that society

has conquered the public realm, and that distinction and difference have become private matters of the individual." (41)

The neopagan-Christian distinction is therefore obvious. Modernity basically tells religion and all other former public interests to step aside and let the private interests rule. Christians earnestly believe that they can accomplish their goals while following the rules of society. The Nouvelle Droite, from a utilitarian perspective at least, sees the Christian ideal as a waste of time, and wants nothing to do with "society", because a true nation needs a national spirit. Yet I still do not believe that the neopagans are right from the deeper, spiritual perspective.

By the way, I recently read a Japanese spiritualist's idea of Christianity where he focused on the concept of "not peace, but a sword" and claimed that Christians should also be enemies to this world. It's certainly all there in the Bible, but it would be a very Protestant and un-traditional rereading.

Jason-adam on 2013-04-12 at 14:40 said:

I am glad to see my question brought out good points by both Cologero and Avery... ... I dont recall Evola discussing ever the concept of society but Avery's comments reminded me of Carl Schmitt discussing the differences, tension of, and basic opposition to state and society. The modern world is clearly the same thing as the liberal world and liberalism believes that the central place once occupied by spirituality should be replaced by private inquiry and skepticism. It is plain to see how this means the revolt against tradition. The catholic Church fought against this idea and tried to subjugate society to itself but after Vatican II it has accepted a role as punching bad of society and a refuge for old women nd closeted faggots... ... of course Schmitt was modern himself in believing that the state could be a substitute for spiritual authority which was the main flaw in fascism. i'm curious to see how Gentile describes the situation.

I am not a neopagan because, besides my feeling that catholicism explains the world in a better way than paganism can, my parents are catholics, my grandparents are catholics and my family has a heritage of being catholic knights. this may sound stupid but i dont feel a need to rebel against my family's history, even if the entire Church visible has become apostate, i dont see a need to abandon my belifs. if need be i can live my life by myself separate from the world in the truest christian sense of the word.

This actually raises another question ; before my abandoning national bolshevism, I was constantly attacked by my former 'comrades' as being sentimental and reactionary for my views – so would you say that attachment to family and ancestors is emotional and should be overcome ? or is devotion to family the essence of Tradition ?

Cologero on 2013-04-12 at 17:41 said:

I'm not grokking this Avery. For example, just from the first paragraph. Evola criticized Christianity for sacralizing labour; he himself avoided it on the principles you noted. Did Christian

really invent "disgust for lowly animal needs"? Are you making defecation a pagan virtue? Are you saying that Guenon somehow invented or fabricated the concepts of spiritual authority and temporal power? There is no "thereafter", it always was. Where does Guenon imply that only the spiritual authority is truly public?

Arendt adds nothing to this discussion and actually seems to be harming your intellectuality. A "confluence of private interests" is a professorial expression for unbridled individualism, or a "heap" rather than an organic society. Evola has definitely "caught" that, in ways that Arendt and her admirers cannot understand.

Christians "earnestly believe" they should be following the will of God, not the rules of society.

You are partly right about the new right. There is no "nation" without a national spirit; in that case, it is just a country. They reject Christianity as the expression of that spirit. It is an ideological position, not a utilitarian one.

Michael on 2013-04-12 at 19:58 said:

Just curious, where does identifying Christians with brahmins and neo-pagans with kshatriyas come from?

Avery Morrow on 2013-04-12 at 21:31 said:

Did Christian really invent "disgust for lowly animal needs"?

No, you've got it backwards. The pagans saw politics as part of the intellectual life. The Christians didn't. That's all I meant to say.

Arendt doesn't stick to Evola's line but I'm pretty sure she has got more figured out than you give her credit for: "The modern reversal followed and left unchallenged the most important reversal with which Christianity had broken into the ancient world ... The victory of the Christian faith in the ancient world was largely due to this reversal of the individual life for the body politic , which brought hope to those who knew that their world was doomed ... This reversal could not but be disastrous for the esteem and the dignity of politics." (314)

Cologero on 2013-04-13 at 16:45 said:

It was just being used metaphorically, Michael, to show how one-dimensional the Christians had become.

9.13 The Idea of the World in the East

This very early review by **Julius Evola** of "The Science of Peace" and "The Science of the Sacred Word" originally appeared in *Bilychnis*, volume XXVI, September, 1925. This is part one of two parts. The third part will deal with the idea of the world in the West.[21]

> As readers here know, Evola's first book, The Individual and the Becoming of the World, was presented to the Free Theosophical Society in Rome; hence, he was aware of theosophical literature. **Bhagavan Das** was one of the figures who stood out to Evola, although apparently ignored by the Theosophical Society today. Evola expresses the reasons below, but it should be clear that Bhagavan Das' knowledge of German idealism, particularly the thought of Fichte made an impression on Evola.
>
> Bhagavan Das was an Indian Theosophist writing in the first half of the twentieth century. In true theosophical fashion, he claimed to have uncovered the Pranava Vada by **Gargayana**, which was dictated to him by a blind man who had memorized the million lines. Nevertheless, Evola has extraordinary high praise for the man and his works, claiming it was written for the Western mind. That is no doubt a side effect of his theosophical training, but he also relates Vedic ideas to Western thought, especially the German idealists.
>
> In my research into Bhagavan Das, I found out that his works were also highly recommended by the Theosophist **Alice Bailey**. Curiously, there are some pagan circles in Russia[22] that hold both Evola and Bailey both in high esteem, for reasons that escape me.
>
> For those interested in the texts:

[21] This is not the American musician who goes by that name.

[22] `https://web.archive.org/web/20170711193147/http://sicsa.huji.ac.il:80/13shnir.html`

The Science of Peace: https://gornahoor.net/library/ScienceOfPeace.pdf

The Science of the Sacred Word: http://www.makara.us/05ref/01books/pranavavada/pv_toc.htm

Background information on the Pranava Vada: http://thecelestialnavigator.blogspot.com/2010/12/pranava-time.html

First part

There is a point that whoever approaches oriental wisdom should keep constantly in mind and that instead, as far as I know, is neglected also by our major philologists is this: the quality and role by which its expressions in the East and in the West is experienced are in fact different. While among us, to experience a content means, approximately, to think it and to know how to speak it, so that the expression in its rational form is something that expresses it adequately and with which it is interchangeable, in the Oriental, the content instead draws its evidence from an interior and individual experience and, in respect to which, its expression is always an allusive sign, a symbol, a contingent image. Hence, simply translated oriental texts imported into Europe can only yield little or nothing: to translate an oriental text should not mean to put our words in the place, e.g., of Sanskrit words, but rather to seek for an inner reconstruction to take into account the profound explanation of that content, which in the Orient is supported not on the expression, but rather on an internal apperception, and therefore to make oneself give this same content back to rational mediation according to its own form. Such is the true translation, in respect to which the linguistic translation is something in fact secondary and subordinate, and only in this conditions can oriental metaphysics fit into the western mentality and can be not a simple object of erudite curiosity, but can operate in a vital way.

Now the work of Bhagavan Das, which we highly recommend to the

reader, represents the most serious and successful effort along such lines. Bhagavan Das is an Indian who has sketched out an austere discipline of western speculative culture, and joining it with singular gifts of penetration and critical awareness, he has proposed to give the essence of one of the greatest Indian metaphysical systems—the Vedanta—in an explanation proper to our European mentality, and thus (and in that is the superiority of his work in respect to various purely intellectual presentations previously attempted) to the dialectical and critical awareness elaborated by German idealism, in which that mentality has culminated. The Science of Peace represents a general placement, a taking of a purely speculative, synthetic and fully detailed position; the redaction of Gargayana's Pranava Vada is its later development that is deployed and shares in the opulent material of the Vedas, thereby leading the reader into the heart of the Indian tradition. It treats a work so complex and rich that the attempt to give it here in few words not just a summary, but even only the meaning and the more general lines is certainly rather risky. This is therefore a warning to the reader.

In the introductory section, Bhagavan makes us present at the rising of the moral crisis in man: doubt, anguish, the problem of certainty, that of the I and the not-I, and finally the anxious searching for a firm point, of a concept that can take account of the chaotic and contradictory material of experience. Various solutions proposed by the East and the West are little by little undertaken and then criticized and made to pass into other until it reaches an understanding of an opposition as the final foundation: on the one hand, the experience of multiplicity, the changeable, and the illusory refers, as in its condition, to something simple, firm, self-evident: to the I; on the other hand, the I does not have at all a pure experience of itself as such, but is inseparably connected to this dispersed, changeable, and uncertain matter of sensible reality, to which it is opposed. Having reached such a result, it remains to understand its meaning. Here the author moves onto a deductive procedure, discussing the Pranava Vada,

i.e., the "Science of the Sacred Word".

The central point is that the truly absolute is not that which is simply itself in an emptiness of abstract identity, but rather that which is itself as negation of all that it is not, and that therefore it is at the same time the creative function of its "other"—of the particular, the contingent, and the changeable—if only as the simple antithesis, against which it strikes the awareness of the universal, if only as the simple matter generated only by giving life to the flame that, devouring it, reaffirms the point of infinity. One therefore has a dialectic concept of the Absolute, enclosed in the sacred word Aum, whose meaning is: aham etat na = "I-this-not" = "I am not this"; i.e., the idea of the Absolute as that supreme simplicity that draws itself from the synthesis of three movements: of an I, of a not-I or "this" opposed to it, and of a power that connects the three terms together according to a double function of creation (the I that poses the not-I) and of negation (the not-I dissolved and taken back into the I).

Brahman is exactly this syntheses in its aspect of actual, eternal, simultaneous unity of the three moments; a unity that is neither the one opposed nor the other, neither affirmation nor negation, neither universal nor particular, neither rest not motion, etc. but something that transcends and contains them all, all contradictions and higher reconciliations. It is the *dvandvatitam*, opposed to the *dvandam*, i.e., to the relative, the process of which one can say, like Aristotle, that it is the *act* and the eternal substrate.

As to the *dvandvam*, it therefore includes everything that is determined through relationships, and is expressed in the three moments just mentioned.

Second part

Pratyagatma Pratyagatma, would be the I or Brahman understood in his immanent aspect so that it is determined by its opposite or not-I. It is

that which stays fixed and one within every variation, the universal, the point without extension, and the eternal required through the possibility of the experience of everything that is spatially multiple and temporal. From its relation to the not-I, which is essential to it, it nevertheless takes in three determinations:

1. Jnana = knowledge, as the moment according to which it places for itself and against itself or represents the not-I, the "this"

2. Kriya = action, as the moment according to which it is affirmed in the not-I

3. Iccha = will or desire according to which the possibility required by the preceding moments, of self-identification of disidentification from the not-I

Mulaprakriti Mulaprakriti, matter or not-I. As opposed to the I, which is the universal, it would be pure, dispersed particularity. Nevertheless, in as much as it is also tied to the I, it reflects in itself its characters, i.e., infinity, immobility, and eternity, however as that false infinity, immobility, and eternity that is characteristic to the infinite number of particulars, to the eternal of the "always finite" and the "always changeable". The way that Bhagavan Das deduces the becoming of nature is interesting. If one could take the not-I in its totality, it would be possible to conceive its negation in a single simultaneous act; but the character of the not-I is instead particularity. Now the particular does not have a *contradictory* that negates it suddenly, but rather a *contrary* that negates it successively. More clearly: being can be negated suddenly by non-being; but heat has instead is negation in the cold that follows it. So the "I am not this" of the supreme synthesis, the reflection in mulaprakriti, has the meaning of "I am not this, but this other; not this other, but still this other" and so on, in a succession and an indefinite recurrence of opposites that negate

each other, the one after the other, in a current through eternal revulsion and eternal craving. Such is the truth of nature, the eternal wheel of beings and rebirths. The unlimitedness of the world as becoming is therefore only a self-reflection, onto the many things, of the unlimitedness of Brahman—the transcendent One without limitation.

Mayashakti Mayashakti, which is the demiurgic power from which creation and destruction proceeds and from which the various relationships between I and not-I are determined and governed. Under a first aspect is pravritti, i.e., the direction by which knowledge pushes itself in a certain way beyond itself and, identifying itself, associating itself with a particular material, becomes conscious of a such and such determined finite being. Under a second aspect is nivritti, that through which the I reconverges, detaches itself from particularity, negates it, and little by little elevates itself in every higher degrees of synthetic consciousness and of universality, reflected by the hierarchy of the beings of nature approaching man, to whom in his turn the way of the yogis and rishis is destined up to the limit of the brahmanjanis, or "those who know" Brahman.

Conclusion Here we cannot even sketch the ample and complex developments given by Bhagavan Das to this conception; on the basis of the ternary rhythm contained in AUM transposed on various "octaves", he has the means of giving deductively not only the general lines of a logic, of a music, of an anthropology, of a theory of knowledge, but also of the rituals, symbols, of traditional mythology, thus reaching a true system of Indian knowledge. We pause only on one point. The I in itself, contains and negates in a single act the totality contradicted by the infinite particulars of infinite oppositions. This synthesis therefore is obscured at the level of finite existence, which instead experiences a particular or group of particulars at the same time: these are for them the real and the actual, the rest are pushed back into the past and into the future, as

virtual, whose unity (i.e., that total synthesis described above) is nevertheless ideally presupposed by him, in the sense that it makes those universal concepts possible, which is needed in order to be orientated an organize his own finite experience. Now this problem arises: how can one conceive the coexistence of the finite I (jiva) in whom only a part of possible experience is actual, with that "I" in which all is actual (Brahman)?

Bhagavan Das' answer is that whatever is virtual for a single particular consciousness, is on the other hand actual for other consciousnesses, and is explained with a rather nice image. Let us suppose a gallery of paintings immersed in the darkness, and a person with a lamp capable of illuminating only one of them at a time; this person will pass from painting to painting, excluding thereby the rest of them, relegating them into a past or a future. Let us now assume as many persons as paintings: for each one of them the same could be said, however the opposition of an actual and a virtual; but in their wholeness they will succeed in entirely illuminating the gallery that they walk though freely substituting themselves ecah one with the other. Such is the relationship of pratyagatma or universal consciousness with the consciousness of the individuals; a pure brainwave pulling itself from the infinite process with which infinite individualities, by identifying and disidentifying themselves, experience, and transcend step by step, they pose and negate the infinite multiplicity characteristic of the non-I.

Even by this fleeting review, the interest that the works here mentioned should generate is obvious. These works should therefore not be missing from the library of all those who turn to the East not out of extrinsic curiosity or a craving for exoticism, but through a true interest; and that therefore they desire to have the spirit and the concept of traditional wisdom, not erudite and philological representations, discourses, and disquisitions about them, as unfortunately is the case of the great number of the publications of our orientalists which, to tell the truth, too often resemble eyeglasses without eyes.

The Idea of the World in the West

> This the the concluding part of review by **Julius Evola** that originally appeared in Bilychnis, volume XXVI, September, 1925. In this section, he discusses the book *L'idea e il mondo* by R. Pavese, while comparing it to the ideas previously discussed about Bhagavan Das. I know nothing of Pavese and he does not seem to have made any impact on subsequent philosophy. Nevertheless, the review brings up good points. In particular, there is the insistence that speculative thought is vague and useless without a spiritual practice to bring such thought into realization.

Regarding what we just said about the Pranavavada[23], the reader will have observed by himself—as Bhagavan Das did not fail to observe—the many analogous points that oriental views share with what has been developed in recent European speculative thought. One would almost be tempted to think of a sort of great cycle of culture, at whose end some themes proposed at the beginning would be reintroduced, although on another octave. It is, for example, surprising how close to the Pranavavada is the conception constructed by R. Pavese. In his own way, starting from gnoseological idealism, as opposed to which he reaffirms the legitimate requirement that it is not sufficient to return to the so-called "transcendental I" and to a priori logic, but rather it is necessary to determine a conception of these, which takes into account our concrete experience, reality, and physical discoveries in which it has developed. Otherwise, one might just as well exile philosophy into a world of vague and useless abstractions.

The meaning of the conception he proposed is, approximately, the following. God cannot be conceived as absolute transcendence unless in reference to a contrasting, absolute immanence, as eternity is in contrast to temporal becoming. Therefore by showing effectively the process

[23] https://www.makara.us/05ref/01books/pranavavada/pv_toc.htm

that generates this opposition in order to then reconcile it in a higher inspiration, we have approximately the same idea condensed in the sacred word AUM. Although for Pavese, one pole is the idea as "logical comprehensiveness", the other is matter as physical extension and energetic field. The two poles correspond to each other (that which ideally is concept logically comprehending the various known things, objectively is the "nucleus" that dominates a "certain energetic field", and vice versa) and they convert into each other. It is like a cyclic flux of "precipitation" and "sublimation". On the one hand there is the idea that realizes itself and, in that way, engenders physical extension, existence in space and time, from that logical comprehensiveness: such is the "practical" or natural phase that implies a beginning of relative unconsciousness, since the idea is immersed in it, it loses itself in its act, making itself brute power.

On the other hand, there is the nature that reconverges, the idea that reclaims itself from that multiplicity and that existence into which it had degraded itself, and it reincludes it in a new spiritual unity, that is proper to the concept and knowledge in general. Such is the conscious, "theoretical" phase opposed to the natural unconscious process. But the two moments, as was said, are simultaneous and recurrent: it is a flux that rises from one place and descends from the other without interruption, according to an unending vortex that makes spirit from matter and matter from spirit. The two directions, intersecting each other, give rise to nodes or "inflection points", in which the eternal cycle is reflected in miniature and which would correspond to individual beings. The identity, the absolute adequation of idea and reality, of comprehension and extension, nucleus and field, simple form and plural matter, is found only in God, the eternal "concept" of cosmic becoming, to become what is His "conception" or content, in which He circulates with alternating rhythms. In finite individuals, identity is instead a "having to be", something to which they tend, since the order of nature is precisely defined by an eternal imbalance of the two moments from which its becoming arises.

Pavese's originality lies in his bold placing in reciprocal conversions the logical comprehension of a concept with the extension of an energetic field understood as its objective correlative. That gives him a way to graft onto a dialectic scheme, that reminds us of Proclus and Spinoza, the views of recent physics and mechanics, and thereby extends the speculative penetration right into the very heart of the concreteness established in science. In the second place, in the effort of dynamizing, of making "fluid", of gathering in simultaneity the moments of the process, it results in a type of classificatory system of other conceptions. Opposed to that, there is the lack of an organic and systematic exposition and a certain obscurity and convolutedness of expression.

In similar oriental and occidental conceptions, one must nevertheless ask up to what point is it critically justifiable to place oneself at the Absolute, in order to deduce all the rest from that. A Cartesian argument attempted by Pavese is, to tell the truth, inadequate. Similarly for Bhagavan Das, it is true that he first proceeds inductively starting from the analysis of the nature of human experience; but when he then tries to explain the result of that analysis with a deduction, even he makes, and cannot help but make, a leap: the two methods cannot be joined together. Deduction can offer only probable explicative principles in order to interpret the data of fact and, as such, they are deprived of necessity and convertibility. It is therefore necessary to note that the criterion of certainty for the Oriental is not criticism and logic, but rather that of a "transcendental experience". It is, for example, said that the Vedas are the expositions of what the *rishis* have *seen*. For the *rishi*, meaning those who have realized themselves up to the level of Brahman, the deductive procedure of their knowledge could have in itself the character of intrinsic evidence and a justification, that cannot appear to those who look at it from the level of finite existence.

Posted on 2013-04-28 by Cologero

9.14 Outline/Summary for Evola's Revolt

Housekeeping note: *Logres* is the pen name of M. Smallwood, and I appreciate the fellowship and camaraderie of all those here, and at Gnosis group; I thank you all, and also our host. What follows is an outline of the foreword to *Revolt against the Modern World*, an executive summary, Evola's own review, and a few footnotes. There will be a discussion Thursday, starting with a few high points and remarks from the Foreword. Evola claims to establish a metaphysics of history, a possibility denied or inverted by all modern thought. His purpose is to aid those who either can, or will be able, to awake from modern history. We will look closely at the text in the foreword, focus on his insights, and discuss. Food for thought: Contrast Evola's work with the Durant's *History of the World*, O. Spengler's *The Decline of the West*, or A. Toynbee's *History of Civilizations*, or even Marxist anti-metaphysic purporting to give the meaning of history.

> Between the desire
> And the spasm,
> Between the potency
> And the existence,
> Between the essence
> And the descent,
> Falls the Shadow.
>
> T. S. Eliot

I. An Outline for the Foreword in Revolt Against the Modern World

A. Justification and Need for the volume Amateurish "intellectuals" have wrung their hands over the "West" while lacking true principles, retain (due to passions) false principles they ostensibly reject, and

get caught up generally in "contingent and terminal" forms which are the spasms of false principles to begin with. None of these "reactions" have positive value, only possessing value as a symptom merely, like the sleepwalker whose deep sleep prevents him from noticing he is ambling about on a dreadful height or precipice, subject to the ever-increasing likeliness of tumbling lifelessly down into ruin. This is a protective mechanism which creates an illusory "limit", allowing the disease to run a terminal course before detection, thereby creating a better climate for the inevitable death of the patient. This process has only lately been detected, and ineffectually, although ancient man was well aware of its possibility and outcome. This demonstrates that the process robbed man of even an awareness of "true normalcy and health". On the contrary, we must dig ever deeper to uncover the true root of the disease (as opposed to symptoms, since treating symptoms will not lead to a good outcome). A foundation, a center, a principle gives rise to true action, rather than reaction, and men today are incapable of anything but reflexive protest. Even experience teaches that nothing salutary happens in this way: we cannot toss and turn on a bed of agony – the point is awaken and arise. The real starting point is not to protest "technocracy" or "consumerism", but to find the root. The real still exists, invisible and mute – we have to acquire eyes and ears to see it. This would be an absolute reference point. This would be a point of understanding modern deviation and simultaneously, mounting an effective defense[24]. "The only thing that matters is the silent endurance of a few". This will induce liberating crisis in those around them.

[24]The energies that have been liberated, or are in the course of liberation, are not such as can be reconfined within the structure's of yesterday's world. The very fact that attempts at reaction have referred to those structures alone, which are void of any superior legitimacy, has made the subversive forces all the more vigorous and aggressive. *Evola*.

B. Purpose This is my task, within my limitations, to contribute to this work of establishing the total decadence of the modern world. It is upon the ruins of real civilization that the "Modern" has been constructed, and this realization will provide the true foundation for revolt, clarifying what is reacted against and in what name (legitimacy). The cadaverous wisdom of "Progress" glorifies defeated, decrepit man as the ultimate standard, outside of which is supposedly darkness and nothing. This intransigence and Lie proves the blindness of the Modern.[25] It is not merely that we gain a certain perspective from realizing the relativity of "the Modern" in studying what is past, but we also see that from the perspective of what is Past, the Modern simply "is not": the disappearance of the Modern will itself mean nothing, from the vantage point of Tradition. I call this the "dualism of civilizations" (as opposed to merely the "relativity of civilizations"). There is a moral dimension, not merely a historical one, at work here. One possesses Being, the other is built upon illusions. They are different types.[26]

C. Thesis In the 8th-6th centuries BC, the process of involution and degradation began, when "History" actually began. There have been several phases following, including the fall of Rome/advent of Christianity, the decay of the feudal order and Empire, and the advent of humanism and Reformation. All of these are Iron Age phenomenon, the "Wolf Age". Underground forces have become more and more manifest, and the process of decay swifter and swifter, more decisive, more universal. It will seal the collective fate of millions. This is the historical and relative side. The fact that we cannot trace it further shows how deep the process

[25]"Those whom the gods wish to destroy, they first make mad". Livy.

[26]They are "unequals". Any argument about which is "better" is pointless, or incomplete. One is an actual civilization, the other is the opposite of that.

had already gone, & how a reaction must step outside of history.[27] Any civilization that bases itself in the "temporal" will eventually fall prey to these same forces. It is "accidental" that true Tradition lies outside of Time, however, that accident demonstrates where we should begin.[28]

"These things did not just happen once, but they have always been" – a fog cannot obliterate the heavens. The best of "modern" scholarship is a display of ignorance at best. Although a relative value can be placed on the results of their research if they are used from another perspective, there is always a tendency of other influences to creep in, the presence of which are subtle. Myth, legend, and epic have a high validity in this line of inquiry[29]. Our perspective is super-individual and non-human.[30] These truths either Are or Are Not: they cannot be debated or even discussed (in the modern way). It is only possible to remember. They are constant and central and equivalent, regardless of how difficult to discern or how fragmentary in application. "Certainty and transcendence and universal objectivity is innerly established" by them. Nothing can destroy them, nor can they be reached by alternate means.

D. Method For the first part of the volume, I intend to identify by correspondences the traces of what is spiritual, true, certain, and objective (which must be made to speak and to appear) which are homologous across all times and places – this will result in one Truth which is invariant, transcendent, and the origin. Having achieved this, in part two,

[27]Thucydides, for instance, had a modern conception of history, and is the father of "history". Ancient man had no concept of "Time" as we do.

[28]I take his meaning here to be that, from a modern point of view, the descent into history represents a happy evolutionary accident, or at best, a kind of historical twist, which lead to the randomly meaningless but ultimately beneficial situation we find ourselves in today.

[29]Wagner's *Parzifal* is interesting from this point of view: a look at ancient myths and "new" ones (the Grail).

[30]He doesn't speak of a "superman" like Nietzsche, but of what is "non-human"

we will proceed (with this knowledge) using induction, "a discursive approximation of a spiritual intuition", which will clarify the pathways and etiology of decline, as well as inform us as to the greater and lesser degrees the truth was manifested. (So part one is "seeing" what is of value in the wreck, part two is understanding the trajectory of the wreck through its relation to what is real). This induction of part two is neither eclectic (as in the sense of picking a certain language best suited to subject or person) nor comparative (just as using parallaxes to find the location of star[31] is not mere comparison). The result will be "the same one meaning and same one principle". This will lay the foundations for an eventual positive and effective revolt, against what is passively and semi-consciously accepted today. Those who defend the "concrete" of the modern world ought to be told, not "Stop!" but "Go Ahead!": "the pit must be filled: there is a need for fertilizer for the new tree that will grow out of your collapse"[32].

E. Result This work will provide guiding principles and essential elements – certainly entire volumes more could be written. These forms and ideas are not "realities", but that which makes "realities" possible: their value is independent of that which they establish, which will never be "perfect". Of course there are imperfections – but this argument would eventually invalidate any reality[33]. Indeed, from this point of view, establishing what is normal and healthy may be no less possible today than yesterday, as even in the past Tradition was not lived up to. We are providing here a "metaphysics of history", allowing us to trace the genesis

[31]Using parallaxes allows someone in a seemingly relative position without hope of measurement to actually triangulate a relative position vis a vis other distant and also relative points. Erastothenes used the variant positions of shadows on obelisks at Alexandria and in Nubia to calculate the exact circumference of the earth.

[32]Guido de Giorgio quoted here.

[33]It is certainly true that even traditional civilizations did not utterly do away with sin, injustice, or imperfection (view it how you will).

of the modern world, and at the same time, embrace what is symbolical, super-historical, and normative. The result will be sufficiently enough (but not exhaustive) for those who are either already awake, or possess the possibility of awakening.

II. Executive Summary of Evola's Volume Evola delineates his purpose in the Foreword to *Revolt Against the Modern World*, in a manner to obviate, absolutely, any potential misunderstanding. He clearly explains that the work is a beginning, and a foundational contribution to the preservation of Tradition (rather than a complete edifice, which would require "volumes"). He is laying a foundation in the sense that he uncovers and defends in an absolute and definitive way that which is, strictly speaking, absolutely necessary to the recovery and manifestation of those principles. Astoundingly, it will be a "metaphysics" of history, a possibility denied or inverted by all modern thought forms (eg., Spengler, Marx, liberalism, degenerate Christian schools of thought, etc.) Because most Western thought involves and invokes a modicum of history & theory, it is helpful to explain Tradition both as a counterpoint to modern historicism (Part One: the unreducible remainder of the "Myths"), and also as a non-historical object that has maintained a decisive presence even in a period which has abandoned it in favor of the temporal continuum, as well as denying it clear and full expression (Part 2).

Therefore, Tradition manifests, in a positive sense in the myths and legends and even some historical periods of the Past (Part 1), & also as deprivation and endurance (a negative sense) during the period of its so-called eclipse (Part 2), the period in which modernity and anti-Tradition enjoy a titulary and technical dominance that saturates Being today and heavily hampers even the possibility of conceiving Life differently from its current distortions. Because of this, his book includes the "death" of tradition (in the 6th-8th centuries), & traces the presence in the periods following this immersion in the heightened historical sense (an immer-

sion which springs to life, for instance, in the histories of Thucydides). However, he also seeks knowledge "beyond" the historical period (Part One). In this way, he not only traces the rise of Tradition's opposite (Revolution in a pure sense), but forcefully proves the reality of Tradition in a period which did not perfectly or even greatly manifest it (in Evola's mind, there is a distinction between the essence of Tradition which manifests, and the vehicles it uses, as well as the degree or particular form to which it perfects itself: this is why he divides his work into two parts, Part 1 being concerned with the Essence, Part 2 with the particular "story" of how Tradition manifested).

That this is not a virtuoso parlor trick of the intellect is further shown by the perfect interchangeability and equivalent nature of Tradition throughout the historical continuum in various highly contrasting periods (eg., Greek and Aztec), as also by the fact that this very Tradition radiates an energy which something else has twisted and distorted, making possible the very decay which presumes to deny the primordial source of its remaining power and twisted legitimacy. Evola demonstrates all of this with crystal accuracy, sourcing primary texts, and restates the unwritten thesis in language and arguments suitable particularly for the Western seeker, even the one who is interested in comparing the Western tradition with other traditions. Not only does Evola's thesis possess far more explanatory power than its logical competition (it should be remembered that explanatory power alone is practically the sole criteria of certain higher forms of scientific argument)[34], it is internally coherent in a way which demonstrates its freedom from truncated and merely ideological solutions to the "problems" of Life. Another way to put this would be that it is not merely analogically compatible with what we find in history and pre-history, but homologous.

You may find it useful to compare the above with what follows below,

[34] It is certainly true that even traditional civilizations did not utterly do away with sin, injustice, or imperfection (view it how you will).

which is the

III. Editorial Presentation to the First Edition (Evola's Own Anonymous Review) "The seemingly polemical title of this work conceals a powerful historical and metaphysical reconstruction, as the basis for the in-depth understanding the greatest problems of the current age.

The author's fundamental idea is the opposition between two types of civilizations, called "traditional" and "modern" respectively: the former, based on the values of pure spirituality, aristocracy, and hierarchy; the latter, rooted in the purely human, secular, and contingent element. With a series of summaries, the fundamental meanings are given that used to dominate in the living, believing, knowing, acting, ruling, and self-transcending of "traditional man": meanings that an in-depth examination of the most varied texts and evidence are shown to be remarkably identical in all the greatest civilizations of the past. In a second part, the processes are made precise that, in a type of fall, led from the traditional world to the modern world. From the exploration of prehistory, in order to which it throws unsuspected light, the investigation proceeds in an historic outline that extends to the birth of the new Russian-American barbarism. The Aryan civilizations, then the Roman and Ghibelline, in the author's presentation appears as great luminous culminations in this sequence of events over millennia and as symbols of perennial current events.

In a conclusion, the author poses the problem of future times. That last world of the book is not so much a "decline of the West", but instead a profession of heroic faith, precisely a call for the spiritual revolt after having had the courage of looking into the depths and its most remote roots that world of decadence, against which today those who believe in the highest possibilities of our Revolution, fight.

The book, of which a German translation is in preparation, has a totally particular character, in order to join a series of truly revolutionary

historical views to a very serious, scientific documentation presented in an incisive, suggestive, and fully accessible style.

Revolt against the modern world is not a book of sterile polemics, but of serious culture, particularly illuminating for those who want to understand, through a series of quick summaries, the meaning of history and the spirit of the greatest civilizations and institutions of the past as the positive basis to achieve to a truly reconstructive action.

It therefore interests anyone who is not indifferent in the face of the great problems that in the present hour assail the people and from which solutions will depend the destinies of the future world and of Western man in particular."

Posted on 2015-08-22 by Logres

* * *

Alistair Fraser on 2015-08-24 at 18:27 said:

Logres , i am pleased to be reading yours and the hosts and others illuminating works , and good tidings from scotland , i am adding my own inputs in various areas

Mark Citadel on 2015-08-25 at 15:17 said:

I feel I am definitely going to have to read this one again. My highest recommendation to anyone is to read Guenon's Crisis first, its a gentler introduction to the concepts Evola dives into.

9.15 The Metaphysics of Sex and the One

Interim Note on Being One with Everything

> Pantheism does not admit the existence of individual beings.
>
> Pantheism offers only the perspective of letting oneself be lulled by the undulation of the ocean of deified nature.
>
> Valentin Tomberg

There is a photo of **Giulio Cogni** in **Julius Evola**'s *Sintesi di dottrina della razza* with the following caption:

> An Italian Nordic-Aryan type of the body with an Amazonian race of the spirit. Actually, it is a matter of a person, in whose theories an external energetic and almost Promethean aspect is mixed with a Demetrian-Lunar pantheistic vision of the world with a special recognition given to the feminine element.

Giulio Cogni was a philosopher, music critic (a specialist on Wagner), and an author of books on Eastern spirituality. After the German-Italian alliance in the 1930s, there was a scramble among Italian intellectuals to outline a Fascist understanding of race, in opposition to the German's. The consensus was a more spiritual understanding of race. Thus Julius Evola published several works on the topic. His young friend, Massimo Scaligero, published a book on race based on some ideas from Anthroposophy. Giulio Cogni, who was a follower of the philosopher Giovanni Gentile, tried to reconcile Alfred Rosenberg with the situation in Italy. From the snippets I've found, Cogni denied the notion of racial superiority and, not unlike Evola, claimed that "Aryan" referred to a spiritual quality rather than a biological quality.

After the defeat of WWII, Evola more or less abandoned the topic. Scaligero and Cogni, on the other hand, managed to rebrand themselves: Scaligero as an Anthroposophist and Cogni as a Vedantist. As an indication of their success, some of their articles have been republished in the American *Yoga Journal*, with no mention of their Fascist past.

After the war, Evola's and Cogni's life paths diverged. I did find a rather long review by Evola of Cogni's book *Io sono te: sesso e oblazione* ("I am you: sex and offering"), which highlights the differences between the two thinkers and would explain Evola's evaluation of Cogni.

In that book Cogni proposes a pantheistic worldview based, as he claims, on the Vedanta: "we are all one". That logically leads to an undifferentiated view of the human situation, which includes promiscuous

sex, self-sacrifice, and androgyny. Since Cogni articulates in an intelligent and sophisticated way many of the commonly held views in the modern world, the review is an apt essay for discussion.

Being Cogni bases his ideas on the notion of the Vedantic One, as he understands it to indicate the overcoming of all distinctions. Quoting Hegel, Evola describes this view as "the night in which all the cows are black". I noticed this years ago when I participated in a **Nisargadatta** discussion group. The consensus view in that group was that, as an enlightened being, he more or less disappeared into the "One". Nevertheless, as I pointed out, he spoke, responded to his name, etc., but that had little impact on the discussion.

In that view, there is only undifferentiated Being, so the beings we experience are illusions. "Whose" illusions they are, or why those "illusions" take such a specific form, or why do different people experience a similar world, was never made clear if only the One exists.

Jacques Maritain, in *The Degrees of Knowledge* provides a more satisfying answer. When I know Peter, I judge him to be a man, but even more fundamentally, I have an intuition of Peter as a being. This intuition is found everywhere, it "saturates all things". Maritain explains our experience of Being.

> Being is a primordial and general conceptual object which is at once and from the beginning essentially diverse in the diverse subjects in which the mind discovers it. What is primarily known, and in which every object of thought is resolved for the intellect, is being. But nothing can be added to it extrinsically to differentiate it, for all its differentiations issue from its own depths.

In other words, Being is known through beings. *Pace* Cogni, Being is already highly differentiated. In the Western tradition, this is expressed as the doctrine of the consubstantiality of the Logos with Being. Evola expresses the same notion in a slightly different way:

> The One dominates a well-articulated order of differences (a cosmos, in the Hellenic sense).

So, "Illusion" has a much different connotation. For Cogni, the illusion is the separateness and distinction of beings, which are ultimately part of Brahman. However, illusion is actually much more subtle, and hence, more difficult to eradicate. The illusion arises from our failure to grasp the meaning of the Whole and how the parts are interconnected. This is due to the weakness of the intellect and erratic emotional reactions.

Descending and Ascending Movements Evola claims that Cogni fails to distinguish between the subconscious and the superconscious, with the following consequence:

> Cogni has no sense of the fact that just as an "integrative ascending self-transcendence" exists, so a divisive descending self-transcendence also exists for the true personality. That is, there are possible openings of the I both toward the higher as well as toward the lower, which also means toward "nature", toward the unconscious, toward the vital formless bottom.

In an early essay, *The Holy Spirit & the Sophia*, Tomberg describes that downward movement in these steps.

First the Logos descends to the conscious I. If the I is oriented to the Logos above, it is ascendant. This supersensory "Temple of Wisdom" or "House of Sophia" is the knowledge of the Whole (but not of every individual fact).

However, that movement can continue downward in these stages, each with its own type of intelligence:

- **Hunger**. The stream of the Logos is brought down to the level of digestive activity. This leads to a logic in which the stomach and its interests determine logic and conclusions. This is the level of Marx.

- **Sex**. The stream is brought down to the instinctive life. This is the level of Freud and psychoanalysis.
- **Nature**. The stream descends to the subterranean spheres. This logic may seem quite convincing. At its lowest point, the individual no longer thinks independently, but thoughts arise through him.

Pantheism Tomberg distinguished between theism, pantheism, and naturalism, which are valid on different planes:

- **Naturalism**: only what is experienced through the senses is real
- **Pantheism**: thought alone can grasp the world. Existence is illusory, only the Absolute, One, Brahman, or God is real
- **Theism**: Transcends rational thought. Existence not strictly logical, i.e., cannot be derived from thought.

Evola offers something similar in this comment:

> So Cogni denies that that polarity is an essential requirement of eros, which he believes concerns only the naturalistic plane, like electrical and similar phenomena. That means that for him all the documentation that we have gathered, in an entire chapter, from the most varied cultural areas, regarding the "metaphysical dyad", might as well not exist because it contradicts his promiscuous pantheism.

Thus, on the naturalistic plane, any sexual experience is worthwhile in its own right if it is observed in natures. Neither electricity nor eros depends on a anything higher. For pantheism, the male-female polarity is just a form of thought with no ultimate reality. It is no more than one particular expression of sexuality.

Not to forget that the young Evola's first book was a translation and commentary of the *Tao Te Ching*, he understands that, on the metaphysical level, the Yin-Yang, male-female, dyad is fundamental. Hence, sexual expression on the physical plane needs to mirror that.

Postscript on Sexual Intelligence The flip side of Evola's critique is that Cogni has empirical experience and contemporary mores on his side. As we saw above, the sex instinct has its own logic and intelligence. Those who have "transcended" the self in the descending direction will be baffled by appeals to sexual restraint based on higher principles.

The occultist **Alice Bailey** seemed to have had an intuition of this, making predictions that have largely come to pass. In *Esoteric Healing*, she wrote:

> Inter-marriage between nations and races, the fusion of bloods for hundreds of years—due to migration, travel, education and mental unity—has led to there being no really pure racial types today. This is far more certainly the case than the most enlightened think, if the long, long history of mankind is considered.

The European wars of last century, not to mention more recent turmoil, have certainly exacerbated those four factors. Eros, or the sexual drive, is potent, even to the point of overcoming barriers:

> Sexual intercourse knows no impenetrable barriers … The urge to mate becomes peculiarly strong when men are removed from their familiar settings and experience the novelty of complete loneliness, when the normal inhibitions and customs imposed by family relationships and national standards are removed, when danger of death is constantly faced and the larger value submerges the lesser values and the usual conventional attitudes

Appendix on the 120 Days of Sodom Curiously, Evola accuses Cogni of tending towards the sexual excesses of the **Marquis de Sade**. This may not be so far-fetched, given the tendency of some on social media to associate the "right" with bondage, domination, and so on. They are not to be taken seriously.

Nevertheless, the Italian communist film director **Pier Paulo Pasolini** created a work based on de Sade's book, but situated it in the Salo Republic. Perhaps he derived that association from Cogni, but certainly not from Evola who rejected such practices. Paradoxically, it was Pasolini himself who advocated sexual experimentation. He was murdered by an underage hitchhiker who objected to Pasolini's proposition to sodomize him with a broomstick.

Translation

> Evola's review of Giulio Cogni's book *Io sono te: sesso e oblazione* (You and I: sex and offering).

In general, we do not believe that discussions have a meaning and a seriousness unless it essentially aspires to a clarification in the premises of a common base. If a writer is able to recognize the fundamental premises of his own thought (whether or not tied to a "personal equation") and sees his fundament difference in respect to those of another writer, the only serious thing is that he follows his own way without trying to insert himself in an intellectual world foreign to him. Unfortunately that happens rarely, due to the lack of such a preliminary self-analysis. That does not limit us to an inescapable criticism of other people's views (which is of course approvable and fruitful), but is put on a confused argument: precisely because of the heterogeneity of basic conceptions. That demonstrates fundamentally the activity of subrational explanations.

For this reason, we would not have considered that a book titled *Io*

sono te: sesso e oblazione[35] was by Giulio Cogni. The author has certainly believed he included in it an essay on our work, the *Metaphysics of Sex*. That would not be as important as the fact that in the circumstances grave confusions and distortions weighed on a domain that goes beyond the ideas that we've espoused in various places. Hence, the opportunity of a development that, apart every polemic need, intends to highlight some ensemble of ideas which may be of interest for the reader.

The views of *I am you* reproduce, in its essentials, that which Cogni had already expressed in another book, *Saggio sull'amore* [Essay on Love], published in 1922. At that time, someone wisely said that Cogni, at that time a Gentilian through the skin, had translated the Gentilian theory of the "spirit as pure act" into a more sapid "theory of the spirit as impure act", since he recognized in the sexual union a principle concrete form of the identification of the subject with the object postulated by Gentile's actualism. Moreover, Cogni formulated a phagic or anthropophagic theory: love, would mean eating oneself, devouring oneself. A similar thesis in his new book: where "the famous hunger — sex, hunger-love, equation" is established. Previously, Cogni presented the situation in rather masochistic terms: man eaten by the woman in whom he was absorbed and lost himself as individuality. In the more recent exposition erotic anthropophagy seems to be conceived as reciprocal, turning out however to be little imaginable because, ironically, he would want to think that at the end of the lovers, there remained only two mouths, each being ingested and consumed wholly by the other.

If it all ended here, with phagia, it would be said the Cogni was inspired only by the crudest aspect of sexuality: the "hunger" of bodies, simple lustful longing. But suddenly he proceeds to appositions that are in complete contrast with what, as analogy, might suggest "eating" and hunger. In fact, Cogni always returns again to self-denial, to sacrificial offering, the abandonment of oneself that there would be in eroticism

[35] *You and I: Sex and Offering.*

and in sexual union. Carnal pleasure would be "complete renunciation of oneself in order to make oneself the other."

He moves directly to a type of mysticism: "the sexual act is humility of annihilation and sacrifice of oneself to the universal life that is seen in the body of the beloved". "Love is phagic because only with the gift of the body and with devouring and making oneself devoured one realizes the more powerful symbol of Unity: every alleged individual separation is removed." The ultimate goal is "the immersion of the cosmic One without a second." All this seems to us pure digression, even with a slight paranoid tint.

First of all, about the incongruence between the points of view, it must be pointed out that in hunger and in phagia presented as the keys of sex, there is nothing of this sacrificial orientation, of the abandonment of oneself, and of "sweet" identification (sweet is a word that often recurs in Cogni even in connection to sadomasochistic situations; that would point, to malign him, at the strong preference, usually female, for products of the confectionary industry instead of the prevalent manly taste for spicy and peppered food). indeed, in hunger the need operates by suffering from a deprivation, while eating leads only its own conservation and satiety: exactly the opposite of the abandonment of the sacrificial gift of oneself. Nothing sweet, then, if hunger is absolute, devouring. And since Cogni even makes almost a dogma out of anthropophagy in its proper sense, he does not know that in it, at most, the situation is not different: it is multiply attested that if the savage feeds himself with the flesh of others, he does not do it for a "sweet" identification, but only and darkly because he believed he absorbs the other's strengths to this own advantage. As for eating the flesh of sacrificial victims, it is a fantasy to say that in it the tendency acts to submerge oneself in the cosmic One. In general, here everything comes down to totemic participation (the victim incarnates the totem), then a rather restricted order, shadowed by sorcery and demonism typical of totemism in general. Therefore, these are very

fragile and inconsistent bases for the advocated theses referring to sex. And the Eucharistic symbol, if one does not want to totally contaminate it by discovering in it rather suspect roots, is reduced to a mere allegory.

As far as we are concerned, the fundamental intention of the book *Metaphysics of Sex* was to highlight the existence of a possible transcendent dimension of sex. We tried to lead the transcendental meaning of eros (in the almost Kantian sense) back to a dark, unconscious impulse to restore an original wholeness, which we referred as the most noted mythical formulation in the West, to the Platonic theory of the androgyne. Besides, we found that phenomena of transcendence could intervene in the erotic-sexual experience of a momentary traumatic removal of the common conditionality of the individual consciousness, we showed that this was the presupposition of practices of some environments, especially the Oriental, in which it was done in a magical, initiatic, or evocatory use of sex. But all that is quite far from Cogni's mystical-phagic digressions, and every confusion in this regard is deplorable.

First of all, we should not generalize by attributing the strong value of transcendence to that which is typical of almost all sexual unions of human beings. What appears in the metaphysical or transcendental cannot be made of value in the phenomenological. In a phenomenological examination fall all the idealizing and mystical fixations, with the very sweet sacrifice and the sacrificial surpassing of oneself in the flesh of the other which Cogni always comes back to. Factually, in most sexual intercourse, one partner seeks only his *own* pleasure, making the other the means, so that the situation is not very dissimilar, *sit venia verbis,* from a "masturbation duet". Therefore nothing overcomes the individual bond. In the second place, existentially, often, and today more than ever, sex is of value to the individual only as a self-confirmation, only to assert a "need" (*Geltungstrieb* as Adler would say), or to look for an illusory, turbid substitute for a true sense of existence, of which he is deprived: then, again, no exit from the closed circle of the individual. Finally, as we said

and also highlighted in our book, if sporadic phenomena of "transcendence" in the profane experience of sex can sometimes be verified, they often are not *experienced* as such. They are realized in apical forms to the trauma of the organism which represent, for the most part, a solution of continuity of the consciousness from which one returns emptied, instead of having had the "shining experience of the One". That, in general, is rarely the case in profane, carnal, or romantic love. It is especially pertinent to the magical and initiatic use of sex, the use that, inter alia, involves a special conduct of sexual intercourse and about which one thing is certain: intensive states of a special destructive intoxication intervene (in an almost ontological, not a moral, meaning), which excludes phagia, the abandonment of the other, the sacrifice of oneself, and all the sweet and pantheistic affectations so dear to Cogni; and they never failed to emphasize the dangerous character of that practice, for anything idyllic, romantic, and idealizing.

Cogni has also noticed the relation, noticeable in multiple forms, between eros and death, between the divinity of sex and the destructive divinity and death, that we did, but without understanding it in its true sense. It is significant that, among other things, the secret Hindu orgiastic rites that aimed at the aforementioned experience of transcendence, was celebrated in the sign of goddesses like Durga and Kali, not in their maternal aspect but in the destructive aspect. Sekhmet, the Egyptian goddess of love, is also the goddess of destruction and war (her leonine head refers to a beast whose manners are not at all the sweetest). Something analogous applies to the ancient goddesses of the Mediterranean area, starting with Ishtar, also the goddess of the orgy.

The following point is related to that. We indicated the magnetic base of every eros and every intense sexual experience. It is the development of such a base that serves as the basis for those experiences. But it is due precisely to the polarity of the male and the female as ontological principles, something always acknowledged. So Cogni denies that that polarity is an

essential requirement of eros, which he believes concerns only the naturalistic plane, like electrical and similar phenomena. That means that for him all the documentation that we have gathered, in an entire chapter, from the most varied cultural areas, regarding the "metaphysical dyad", might as well not exist because it contradicts his promiscuous pantheism.

Without dwelling on such a, perhaps a little too specialized, topic, let's indicate in general the horizons between which the erotology proposed by Cogni moves. The theory of eros as pantheistic identification has found nourishment, in Cogni, in his references to India and to Hindu philosophy of the Vedanta. It appears in a clear way that Cogni has seen of India only what, given his temperament, he was capable of, the India that would be immersed in the "dream of the One", the "hot all comprehensive all justifying sweetness, royally tolerating, loving and accepting of the people and the land of India". *Mother India*, discovered by certain useless humanitarian American authoresses like women, with Gandhiism, non-violence, the alleged climate of "loving equality" for the meaning of the One above every illusory difference, would be the true India. But that is an image in part one-sided, in part absurd.

First of all, Cogni seems to overlook the small defect of the beauty present in the "sweet tolerance", exhibited by the recent massacres between the Hindu and Islamic inhabitants of India, which Gandhi made out as another pleasant event. He then ignores the fact that, if there was a social regime which ruled in the most rigid way the principle of difference for entire millennia, this was the Hindu caste system. To the alleged India all love, abandonment and pardon we contrast the India of the great epochs and of the Bhagavad Gita, a traditional text having the same popularity which the Bible enjoys among the Westerners. It attributed the characteristic of a passion, destructive in its transcendence, to the highest form of the appearance of the divine, while also drawing from it a spiritual and metaphysical justification of the duty of the warrior to fight and kill, sparing neither friends nor relatives who were found on the

enemy front. And everyone knows that the Hindu Trimurti, much closer to the Hindu population than the abstractions of Vedantic speculation, considers a divine function in Shiva to whom destruction is proper.

But now it is necessary to repeat myself that Cogni is visibly affected by spiritual scotomas which prevent him from seeing whatever does not support his inclinations. So Buddhism interests him only in its late and popular exoteric forms of a religion, with "love for all creatures", Amitabha the god of love, etc., in contrast to the serious individual ascetic techniques of the Buddhist doctrine of "awakening" of the authentic texts of the original Buddhist canon, that we showed with strict reference to the texts in a book that Cogni says he was familiar with. From that canon it becomes obvsious that, among other things, if love and compassion figure (however with an instrumental function) as preliminary stages in the sequence of the four phases of the highest Buddhist contemplation, of *dhyana*, they are left behind, since the summit is constituted by a state of sovereign, disincarnated impassibility and imperturbability that, pleasing or not to Cogni, has something of the Olympic quality and nothing of a week humanitarianism.

In fact, our author does not stand at the peaks but in the trash heaps of India. The current devotion has had a part in India, but in the lower popular strata, not unrelated to a pre-Indo-European substrate of the country. Only relatively recently has it corresponded with a philosophic system, that of Ramanuja. Earlier, it was considered a "path of devotion" and love, *bhakti-marga*, but it certainly did not stand at the first level, the dignity of a spiritual "regal path", *raja-marga*, which was instead attributed to the path of knowledge", *jnana-marga* and *jnana* yoga.

That character was mainly attributed to the Vedanta, which Cogni is enthusiastic about, seeing in it however only the theory of absolute Identity, of non-duality, of the One-All, of "thou art that", the theory that serves him as the basis for his ideas of eros that embraces and reunites everything.

Well, here we can first of all say that the Vedanta in the primitivistically pantheistic key does not at all exhaust the Hindu spiritual world. We can point out, especially, that a radical monism was not attested in its origins, in the Vedas, which present us with a clearly articulated *pantheon*. In the second place, India has known great speculative systems, like the Samkhya, which has instead emphasized a primordial duality, that of Purusha and Prakriti, and like metaphysical tantrism, which argued against the "illusionistic" Vedanta (the world is *maya*) and along with the school of Kashmir formulated a well differentiated cosmological doctrine.

We will not dwell on these factual data about India. The essential point is that Cogni exchanges the metaphysical One with the pantheistic One, with that One which, according to the expression Hegel used in regard to the philosophy of identity of the later Schelling, is "the night in which all the cows are black". It is not about the One that dominates a well-articulated order of differences (a cosmos, in the Hellenic sense) but rather of a promiscuous "naturalistic" unity to be related, rather, to "Life". This is Cogni's spiritual horizon.

From that confusion, much more serious confusions arise in the practical realm. Cogni has no sense of the fact that just as an "integrative ascending self-transcendence" exists, so a divisive descending self-transcendence also exists for the true personality. That is, there are possible openings of the I both toward the higher as well as toward the lower, which also means toward "nature", toward the unconscious, toward the vital formless bottom. Only the former correspond to the high ascesis, to initiation, to authentic yoga. The ancient wisdom already distinguished and counterpoised the higher waters from the lower waters, the first illuminating, the latter intoxicating and divisive, and this basic doctrine, taken up again by thinkers around the period of the Renaissance, was opportunely recalled by one of the few people today truly qualified in this field, by Rene Guenon, to alert us about the danger and deviations of a certain contemporary spirituality.

To return to the field of eros, Cogni recalled in passing the ambivalence that is present, from the spiritual point of view, in sexual experience. If the woman was seen as a danger, if one could say *foemina mors animae* in Latin so as to recommend continence, that is not attributable to a moralistic attitude, to the "theological hatred for sex" that Vilfredo Pareto spoke about or to the "sexophobia" on which L De Marchi insists. They also had in view the possibility that the experience of sex, when it was not about curbing mere mortals and moralizing, but for those who had supernatural aspirations, that it could even lead to the negative direction of a "descending self-transcendence". And if we examine the use of sex predominant in the most recent generations, we find a reflection of that even on a quite profane plane: other than a "sweet" sacrifice of oneself, a "carnal offering", that redeems and leads to the One, but couplings used on the same life of drugs (to be precise: of the current profane pandemic use of drugs) to draw from the extreme sensations of the orgasm the illusory confirmation of the sense of oneself (the exact opposite of the direction toward the higher).

When the One is "the night in which all the cows are black", every difference is challenged and discouraged, and promiscuity in the name of that One becomes a norm even in the forms more repugnant for every well born person. In that regard, Cogni is explicit and demonstrates, if nothing else, the courage of coherence. He asserts, for example that "every doctrine that starts from the absolute and not relative point of view, from inferiority or hierarchal superiority, is erroneous at its base, if it is true that the One is all and identical to Brahman". Note that these words are said in regard to the difference between the species, between men and animal species, for example. We are not talking about how it relates to the human environment. Cogni will certainly not object, to the greater glory of the Vedantic One, if a young Nordic girl beds a Zulu or an Australian aborigine whose morphological and mental level corresponds to the stone age. He is certainly an egalitarian to the bitter end, a fanatic

integrationist (he rushed to make an act of contrition, keeping to date in relation to a past error because in the fascist period he was a racialist, albeit of a dubious racial theory), an admirer of "unisex" and the "third sex" and so on. But the last straw is in the area of carnality. As a more audacious form of identification, phagist or not, in the name of the One, he actually admits not only homosexuality and pederasty, but even sex with animals, sodomy with women, and so on. His theory explains how "many people have so much attraction for such relationships commonly judged against nature". "Only by accepting in principle the ordinarily most repugnant areas of the other (for sexual use), is one certain of having reached absolute identity." At this rate, we believe that Cogni would, in the same way, value even coprophagia (the eating of feces as a form of eroticism) and would sanctify the disgusting events where even coprophagia figures abundantly as the decisive erotica along with the other horrors, described in the *120 Days of Sodom* by the **Marquis de Sade**.

Naturally, in denouncing similar aberrations of Cogni, we do not appeal to any conformist moralism but to what is called normal in a higher, not social, sense. For example, pederasty at the most can be tolerated when if arises from special constitutional situations of imperfect sexualization but must be stigmatized as a vice, deviation, and perversion in all other cases, denying also that in this, as in all other case of sexual psychopathy, the necessary objective requirements from a metaphysics of sex are present for the actual experiences of a deconditionalizing intensity. But there is no hope that Cogni has such an understanding for similar things.

Finally, we need to point out another deviation in Cogni, unifying promiscuous sexuality with pantheism. Since, as we have seen, his reference point is not metaphysical reality but rather the promiscuous bottom of "Life", skirting the unconscious and the subconscious; in his more recent writings, Cogni sympathizes openly with psychoanalysis and metapsychics. He goes so far as to say that parapsychology "remains still the great hope of the future". He poses himself in a duet of mutual ad-

miration with Emilieo Servadio who had "opened the way", "knowing India in depth and every type of initiatic thought and psychic depth". That makes us smile. If Servadio had ever really had some idea of intiatic matters and authentic wisdom that was when, before the war, he was vividly interested in the publications edited by the "Ur Group" which I directed. After the war, at a snail's pace, he more or less set all that aside and he immersed himself in psychoanalysis. Moreover, that brought on a lucrative professional program and seeking to put himself everywhere before the public, he associated psychoanalysis with parapsychology, in place of initiatic knowledge and wisdom traditions, giving himself however to probe not the psychical depths but rather the slums of the psyche. The connection with psychanalysis and metapsychics took place in Cogni without difficulty through the fact that his One is easily relatable to the "deep unconscious that is one in the entire universe", by which telepathic phenomena and metapsychics in general can be explained, while it is the field proper to psychoanalysis.

In fact, in these new disciplines the unconscious becomes a sack in which things of every type are placed. One does not think at all about such an elementary and basic distinction, like that between the subconscious (or unconscious) and the superconscious, in part for the simple reason that psychoanalysis and metapsychics have no idea of the latter, and then because in their experimental field, for obvious reasons, it is rather difficult to even imagine. Form this also come aberrant assimilations, like those of C G Jung, in which the homologous figures perceived by psychopaths or oneiric visions of symbols and mythical structures of the initiatic and religious field, reducing everything to the emergence of the archetypes of the collective unconscious. Now, it still holds that, apart from psychoanalysis with its murky world, all modern parapsychology embraces only the offal of the extranormal and is outside all that might have an authentically spiritual value. It is only a question of the slums that can impress only the naïve. But the reason for Cogni's interest in

such things appears evident given what is said: it is a question of true elective affinity. At this level is where he locates which he called the "great hope". Signs of the times.

In conclusion, from the present considerations it turns out that the mentality, the personal equation, the elective affinities, the theoretic referents of Cogni have no point of contact with a spiritual world that we presume is not personal. In cases of this type, as was said at the beginning, discussions have little meaning. However, these notes are less about "arguing" than taking the occasion to make clear certain questions of undoubtable relevance for those readers who might have an interest in the themes treated.

Posted on 2015-10-08 by Aeneas

* * *

Aleksandar Gueric on 2015-10-15 at 01:40 said:

Alice Bailey certainly knew all about the united world and homogeneous raceless population agenda due to the connection between Theosophy and various groups of shady origin, including Fabian society, who, in the spirit of Bavarian Illuminaty, contined the work of subtle social engineering towards the Age of Aquarius i.e. Lucifer. We are all witnessing a progress of this plan and it's acceleration. I wouldn't be surprised if they had connection with the Frankfurt school as well.

Speaking of ascending and descending in regard of transcendence of human experience I am reminded of Terrence McKenna's "Archaic Revival", a concept of complete cultural and individual dissolution of boundaries and return to, what he called, protohistoric paradisical existence of pastoral, orgiastic and classless mushroom worshipping potheads. McKenna was a feminist, profound one some may say, but still a feminist who never missed a chance to blame evil patriarchy and it's fascist spirit for all the wrongs in modern world. Well, his idea of the return into a sacred womb of matriarchy included different kinds of human descendance into the subconscious and nano existence within the cyber world. On the other hand, he considered ascending spiral "techocratic and fascist". When we research his origins we will find the same shady connections. Since I don't intend to turn this comment into a conspiracy rant I will stop here. But there is definitely a global agenda regarding descending transcendence and it's popularization.

Italian racialists had every right to criticize National Socialists race theory which ignored spiritual dimensions and focused strictly on blood alchemy. How many Aryan looking nordics

are out there, with the completely atrophied spirit and essence? Could we call them Aryans? Certainly not, for Arya is a spiritual nobility as well. Arya is a title not a race, although it's reserved only for certain races (indo-european stock).

Cologero on 2015-10-16 at 07:42 said:

Cogni's views are more in tune with the signs of the times. His views on sexuality, psychology as a spiritual path, pantheism, paranormal experience (e.g., the widespread interest in "channeling", astral travel, shamanism, the "law of attaction") have become mainstream since Cogni's book was published. On the other hand, Evola's insistence on the transcendent "metaphysical dyad" is losing steam (and is not aided by Evola's past association with race and fascism). Even one of the last holdouts for the dyad, the Roman Church, is wavering, if the discussions emanating from the Synod on the Family are any indication.

The Italians started destroying everything associated with Mussolini as the Allies advanced toward Rome. Thus, it is impossible for an independent scholar to find most of the books from that era. However, I did find this article, *The Italian Roots of Racialism*[36], which has a discussion on Cogni. The writers discussed may have well as been space aliens, since their viewpoints are so far from anything being expressed today.

Sparrow on 2015-10-18 at 06:39 said:

Since he was a Vedantist, one would think that Cogni read the Bhagavad Gita and realized that the "Oneness," is not a call to promiscuous dissolution rather than a virile call to action and obeying one's dharma.

Cologero on 2015-10-18 at 15:37 said:

Yes, Sparrow, that is precisely the point Evola made against him. Since I haven't been able to find Cogni's text anywhere, it is impossible to make a complete judgment. Nevertheless, he seems to be among the "neo-vedantists" who are prominent today in the West. (A google search will provide many examples.)

Since Cogni was heavily influenced by psychoanalysis, I suspect he had in mind Freud's notion of the "oceanic feeling" in which there is a return to the infantile consciousness of being "one with the world".

SB on 2015-10-18 at 15:55 said:

Is Cogni very well known among spiritual and philosophically inclined people today in Italy? And if so, is his reputation more "mainstream" than Evola 's ?

[36] http://escholarship.org/uc/item/85r1607t#page-1

SB on 2015-10-18 at 15:59 said:

Re. Pasolini, if I may offer a comment re. his association of Sadism with Fascism, I believe it may simply be a result of New Left association of authoritarianism with sexual dominance, as part of their general worldview basing everything on sexuality (derived ultimately from Freud but more to the point from Wilhelm Reich, Herbert Marcuse etc)

Cologero on 2015-10-18 at 16:46 said:

@SB, as I mentioned, Cogni's books are unavailable in print or electronic editions. Hence, I can't imagine that he has much of a reputation at all anymore. What I did say is that his worldview appears to be more congenial to people today. For example, he is much more open to, let's say, the "varieties of sexual experience" than Evola was. Evola was more attached to the boy-girl thing, not for any moral or religious reasons, but rather because he believe it reflects the polarity of the male-female, or yin-yang, princples, the overcoming of which results in the "androgyne".

As for your other point, Pasonlini, Marcuse, etc., seem passe now. Such an association was shattered by Michel Foucault's life and work. He combined gay S&M with libertarian economics, sort of the precursor of the "socially liberal but economically conservative" type, not uncommon today. But he went further, challenging power structures that would marginalize certain groups, perhaps those who could be considered the "fifth caste" that the Tantras refer to.

SB on 2015-10-18 at 18:23 said:

If I'm not taking the discussion off topic, what's the fifth caste as I'm ignorant of the subject? The pariah/untouchable?

In response to your mentioning the New Left as being passé, my observations would be that society has hit a key turning point with the transition to postmodernism; the rationalist mentality that has been dominant since the XVII-XVIIIth centuries, the search for a theory which explains everything, has been judged a failure and now rather than proposing new systems or axioms for all to follow as they did in the past, philosophers are questioning every existing remaining "given" rule of society with the aim of abolishing it, to the extent where language even no longer has a definite meaning (Derrida and Deconstructionism). It's an interesting thought process to see where it's leading to; one could well say the world is heading to the submersion into the undiferrentiated all . The rise of the environmentalism with their quite pantheistic beliefs (Gaia hypothesis) is another trend in this direction.

Aleksandar Gueric on 2015-10-18 at 19:22 said:

"If I'm not taking the discussion off topic, what's the fifth caste as I'm ignorant of the subject? The pariah/untouchable?"

You probably think of dalits. European gypsies descend from them, which is proven in genetic studies.

9.16 Scaligero Meets Evola

First part

In this essay, **Massimo Scaligero** describes his first impressions on meeting **Julius Evola**. Although they went in different directions (Scaligero became an Anthroposophist), they remained good friends and collaborated for several years. Like Evola, Scaligero was interested in the Roman spirit in the context of spiritual races. Scaligero incisively notes the essential differences in their worldviews. Scaligero uses thinking and imagination to penetrate into reality, and ultimately to the Logos. Evola, on the contrary, insists on the primacy of will.

I knew Evola at a time when almost everyone prudently distanced himself from him: he revealed himself, by means of the journal *La Torre*, to be the boldest protester of the culture of the Regime. Even though those around him created a type of vacuum, for that reason he carried on the attack unperturbed. That attracted my attention, even if I did not yet understand what he was really driving at. In those days, around the spring of 1930, I went to him despite being advised against it by well-meaning friends: I did not want others to decide for me. At that time telephones in the home were rare, so the appearance at someone's home would not have been considered an indiscretion: in case of the absence of the person you wanted to visit, we used to leave a calling card with the concierge.

I was curious to know the person who showed so much courage and about whom Adriano Tilgher had spoken to me with admiration,

albeit with reservations about the content of his doctrines. I remember he called him "the most powerful dialectician of Europe". But that was not what impressed me. I had yet to understand that Tilgher was referring mainly to the dialectical battles at the *Associazione per il Progresso Morale e Religioso* (Association for Moral and Religious Progress), then directed by professor Giuseppe Puglisi, and headquartered in Piazza Nicosia (later, it was transferred to Piazza Campicelli under the direction the poet Raniero Nicolai) where, at the end of the conference, a debate took place in which the usual participants included Professor John Imperato, Professor Ernesto Quadrelli, Professor Giuseppe Palanga, sometimes Tilgher, and, finally, Evola, who regularly beat them all with compelling arguments and humorous barbs.

I knocked on the door of the next to top floor of Corso Vittorio 197 and a youthful, tall, rangy character, undoubtedly older than I, opened the door: his expression was between Buddhist and Olympic, his bearing quite calm. Having at once intuited the meaning of my visit, or rather, lack of one, Evola promptly met me with genuine affection and this affection was the strength of the connection, beyond dialectics and doctrine, that linked me to him for years.

As I wrote in my book *From Yoga to the Rosicrucians*, I didn't know that Evola had followed an esoteric path for a time and directed a group of aspirants to initiation, although his name was familiar to me from the journal *Ignis*.

I was already following my own very personal path since adolescence, which was between Yoga and the most unrestrained thought of the West — Nietzsche, Stirner, Bauer — but I did not like to talk about it with anyone.

I recall that at first Evola was surprised by the meaning of my visit, neither political, nor esoteric: as I said, at that time he was subject to continuous attacks and intimidations. I remember that the theme of mountains and the inner impressions of the climb, the silence and soli-

tude of the peaks, united us right away. In a chapter devoted to Evola, in the book I mentioned, I outline the meaning of my relationship with him: the encounter with a world that gave me the perception of thought as a primordial force.

I loved Goethe and Nietzsche for that reason: not the Nietzsche of the exaltation phase, but rather that of *The Birth of Tragedy* and *Thus Spoke Zarathustra*.

At that time, I dramatically felt the state of death of the thinking of the whole culture, every expression of culture, whatever its subject, or its political complexion: I had the impression of moving in a vast cemetery: I came out of it every time thanks to energetic meditation, but it was important for me to encounter, through Evola, a kind of thinking that I secretly cultivated in myself: a thinking still capable of life and freedom. After several years, moreover, I had to believe that it was not so much the content of Evola's writings which delighted my inner self, but also feeling that content as a very personal construction: a work of art: a work of brilliant, organic art, even when I felt the affects — to be clear — of Tantrism of the "left Hand".

The harmony with Evola was essentially this: the contact with a world of forces. But this was possible because I myself carried in me this world of forces: the recognition of their origin, however, gradually brought about the orientation that was to carry me out of the path. But what is not in dispute: reality is one, truths are many.

The dialogue with Evola reinforced in me the need for a distinction of values and traditions: that was decisive for me with regard to issues such as karma and reincarnation, the essentially Christian character of Western alchemy, the mysteriously Christian character of the Grail, the fundamentality of the Logos as Christ-Principle. I understood Evola's paganism, but I considered it only as a positive impulse of the quest for what really was the Logos beyond all worldly expressions and beyond what He had become in theological and ethical-political formalism.

Actually Evola is a strong medicine, a shock treatment, the application of force without mediation: as such, he acts in those who already have the power of mediation and just has the task of making it operative. But if he truly realized that, he already has the principle of the Force. Thanks to Evola, I encountered a decisive moment of my inner experience: the feeling of liberation, which gives the image rather than knowledge of liberation: the heroic, mythic image, not cognitive. I then had to discover that the cognitive way was necessary for me: Evola's way had the cognitive appearance, but in essence it relied on the feeling of strength, not on its reality, penetrable and comprehensible by the power of the idea. To renounce this power of the idea, means to accept super-nature mystically, or by faith.

In other words, we do not enter into the magical by the feeling of magic or by the dialectic of magic, but only by virtue of its initial power in the soul, which is ideational or imaginative power. Evola, indeed, cannot hide a certain contempt for thinking, or for a "way of thinking", believing thinking as the expression of a specific sentient nature and not of supernature.

The ideal of the absolute individual was for him an expression of the will sufficient in oneself: thinking indeed has nothing to do with it, and he is right, but you cannot move away from it: nor can you willfully experiment with thinking, which ceases to be dialectical, but volitional. He pointed out that in yoga, essentially the strength of the will was awakened and recovered in its magical movement, and it becomes the flow of Kundalini.

The whole power of evolian "persuasion" is this immediacy of the possessed will. He refuses, as premise, thinking, the cognitive act, the mediation of the idea: Evola always speaks about an absolute act, a movement from which they come about, as it should be in itself magical.

It is in effect the raw material of the Work, which it is necessary to already have: Evola attributes it to a particular inner constitution, to be-

longing to a particular race of the Spirit. For me it was always clear that it is about the meeting of the free I with its own karma: This is the condition of the element with which a psychophysiological I covers itself.

Nevertheless, that persuasion, so decisively expressed by Evola, was a confirmation of my personal experience of the centrality and the invincibility of the I: which, brought to the depths, can encounter the Logos, His origin: Evola was not able to recognize that. I knew that the formulation of the centrality and asceticism of the I was correct: I appreciated Evola, because at that time I was convinced that he had never come to talk about it so explicitly and methodologically. Stirner's and Nietzsche's attempts were ultimately Hegelian-romantic: bold offshoots of the Hegelian left, but prisoners of dialectics.

Second part

> This is the conclusion of **Massimo Scaligero**'s essay describing his first impressions on meeting **Julius Evola**. In this part, Scaligero gets to the heart of Evola's thinking, describing what unites them and what separates them.
>
> Unlike other reviews that describe Evola as a political figure, a philosopher, etc., Scaligero understands Evola in the way that one esoterist can understand another.

The way which I personally followed at that time was my own synthesis, which, I believed, could not correspond to a doctrine. The term "Science of the I" resonated pleasantly familiar with me: in fact it corresponded to the ideal of asceticism to which I tended and to the correlative method. This was the true help that I got from Evola: to perceive the doctrinally justifiable asceticism of the I, independently of Tradition. The reality of this proved to be traditional, even as it did not correspond to any conceivable form in Tradition. In a similar way, however, it was possible to come to see the source of this asceticism. For a while I had the

feeling of having found in Evola the master that I was looking for, and he had indeed more than a claim.

I think I was affected more than Evola, by the disappointment of the fact that, at a certain time, even as I was following the "way of the I", I was no longer able to follow his path. I could recognize in him only a characteristically strong indicator, an individuality from autonomy so sufficient in himself, since it does not require *metanoia*, or conversion, of his own dialectic to arouse in others the feeling of his strength through dialectic: naturally, without possibility of the resolution of individual limits: in the end a resolute titan, whose strength however had its foundation in himself, but he could not become the weakness of the less autonomous disciple who is unable to find the foundation in himself, that is, his inner path.

Along the way, I could understand my relationship with Evola even better. Generally it happened — and it is happening — that one reads his works and then decides to follow him. In substance it had happened to me in a something different way: I had gone to him without reading a single line of his: for a long time our conversations had as its theme the mountains, nonconformity, the courage to oppose the pseudo-culture. I kept company with a group of aggressive transtiberine friends, that I mobilized when he was in danger of being attacked again on the occasion of the different causes that he had in court for lawsuits and the aftermath of lawsuits. I remember that, at our second meeting, he lent me Meyrink's *Golem*, probably to give me the opportunity for an esoteric connection with him; but, just flipping through the pages, I was not too convinced of their content. In truth I did not read the book at all and after a fortnight gave it back to Evola, avoiding telling him that I was not interested. I noticed, however, in Evola a minimal expression of disappointment. Later, however, I carefully read Evola and Meyrink.

The true meaning of what had driven me inwardly toward him, became clear to me with the passing of time: it was the meeting with expert

disciples of Steiner, collaborators of Ur (although I was already connected with Giulio Parise and Arturo Reghini through the journal *Ignis*), among whom the significant and decisive one for me had to be Colazza, and the inner encounter with the one whom I came to recognize as the Master of the new age, Rudolf Steiner; in fact, the original edition of Ur contained impartial appreciations of Steiner. Actually, it was not so much the knowledge of Evola's works that united me to him for several years, but rather his lively, exceptionally individual, personality. Of course, I then would examine these works line by line, before making the decision for another path.

The meetings I had with Evola were filled with a Hermetic climate, from which the feeling of magical forces regularly arose, something like what I actually had from the habit from personal meditation. Or else there were Bacchic-gastronomic meetings, based on spirited philosophy and bucatini all'Amatriciana[37], but with the unusual addition of peperoncino. I was struck by the fact that Evola, who was a compelling alcohol supporter, cared to drink very sweet wines such as vino passito[38], or Gaglioppo[39]. He explained it to me, saying, I don't know how jokingly, that, having learned from Colazza that alcohol deadened the I, while sugar was the physical food of the I, he, not to take risks, tried to reconcile them. Moreover, he connected me to him by an inclination that has always guided my action, to support the one against whom everyone, the *koinonia ton kakon* communion of evil , manages to feel themselves sympathetic: so-called "public opinion", or Phariseeism, whose hypocrisy I have always felt. At that time Evola had only adversaries, even if, truth be told, he did everything to provoke them.

The idea that the truth was from the party against whom everyone

[37] https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Amatriciana_sauce

[38] http://italian-flavor.com/notes/passito.php

[39] http://drinks.seriouseats.com/2011/01/calabrias-gaglioppo-grape-wine-southern-italy.html

lined up in solidarity, in a certain sense corresponded for me to a specific supersensible law. On the other hand, Evola today is translated into the major languages of the world, and he has a following even in Asia. However Evola never assumed the role of the "master": guidance counselor, instigator, yes, but not the master. Sometimes when I had problems with respect to the method, and I turned to him, he demurred, recommending Colazza or Bonabitacola to me, that is, Steiner's disciple or Kremmerz' disciple. Evola found Bonabitacola interesting especially because he received all insults like a Zen master; while Colazza was the character for whom he professed the utmost deference, because he recognized him as an outstanding investigator of the "occult".

Colazza also had respect for Evola as a strong personality: he reproached him only for his yoga and the fact that he wrote books. "One of us", he said to me one day, "must not write books. Books occultly bind the author, they bind him to his present thought, preventing him from opening himself up to the new, to the unknown, to what he still is not capable of thinking. Besides, whoever plays the role of teacher, loses the opportunity to be a disciple."

Something substantially true can be recognized with this thought of Colazza. Nevertheless, you cannot help but consider in Evola's case the mission of sacrifice by the word: namely the compromise of one's own way, on the dialectical level, for the way of others. The snare that he throws would not be necessary if the initiatory path were not in relation to a free choice, to self-determination, that is a determination that is not fated to occur, otherwise it would not be free. This can sufficiently explain his dominant and bold reconciliation of Buddha with Nietzsche; for us it is valid, even if only introductory to the true sadhana. When esoterism is realized, it ceases to be mental position.

The enigma of Evola'a inner personality and his relationship with Tradition remains. In truth, the traditional form cannot conceal the powerful thrust of his anti-traditional system of thought. If you observe, Evola

makes use of the traditional element for building his own absolutely personal spiritual cosmos. He uses the value of Tradition as the aristocratic touchstone, that is, as the opposite to the modern world. He seems to propose a return to Tradition, but in fact, he wants something that is not Tradition, indeed positively against it. And this is what we can recognize as important in Evola.

Guenon is in Tradition, Evola leaves it all the time, while appealing to it: it is a juxtaposition, a dialectical theme, a *habitus cogitandi* habit of thinking. From Novalisian "magical idealism" to Tantrism, from the Nietzschean formulation of Mahayana to the "pagan" interpretation of Alchemy and the Grail, to the sympathy for Michelstaedter and Meyrink, Nietzsche, Kremmerz and Crowley, the imperious authority of thinking is clear, that makes everything subject to an intimate personal vision, to an individual, determined "will to power", ultimately, to an impulse of freedom that subordinates everything to self-affirmation.

Evola succeeds in making his own world real through the power of thought. This is the aspect that could give real help to those who want to follow his path, not as a follower dazzled by his light, but as a conqueror of the Light. It does not matter whether the thinking is correct or not, it becomes correct when it is powerful. It is undeniably true: error, immorality, is weak thinking, or merely dialectical, or reflexive. The power of thought is the truth: the truth that coincides with reality. But only a free man can realize it and make it his own. Those who believe in that thought as a content that comforts him, excites him or hypnotizes him, is not free, he is not in the current of reality. He believes he is in Tradition, but he is against it in the worst form, that of dogmatism and mystical subjection. So we said, at the beginning of this essay, that Evola is a strong medicine, a shock treatment: a discipline that it is necessary to possess. If you do not possess yourself, you actually betray yourself, because you act with respect to it as one who is subjugated.

The living element of Evola's work is the idea of liberation, which

requires, however, pure recognition, the decision of self-knowledge, by the person who encounters it. This is the demand and the virtue of his system, but also the real thrust of his personality, which can be seen as a synthesis of what he is individually with that which the real Guides of humanity implant in him, despite himself. Certain inspirations in the ascetic become operatively individual, even as they draw on the Super-individual. Julius Evola points out a direction that, to become creative in the esoteric sense, requires its separation from its phenomenology, that is, from *maya*, from the *ethos* resulting from it in a social, political sense: especially from this. Certain mixtures betray the spiritual proposition: the worst disasters always come from the collusion of the Sacred with the profane. A similar separation, just like the assumption of the discrimination of *subtile a spisso* the subtle from the dense, is about Evola's own karmic direction. You can metaphysically become aware of his cosmic-spiritual future. It will be determined by how much independence he has achieved from the written works. The possibility will be decisive that he not be identified with his own doctrinaire expression, i.e., with the mythical and mystical world of his followers.

Posted on 2015-03-10 by Aeneas

* * *

White Rabbit on 2015-03-11 at 23:56 said:

It is interesting how Evola's path of negation and tearing down ideas can also be described as one of faith. For a thinker I'm sure it would require a strong intellectual propulsion from the start, at least.

Scaligero says that that way wasn't for him. A puzzle: is someone who tends to "question everything" fitted for the cognitive way, or Evola's way of demolishing all intellectual supports?

David R on 2015-03-12 at 22:21 said:

Thank you for this translation. There is alot to pounder about. Might I ask, if you know, if Scaligero is of any worth in himself ? Does this text renders him justice ? Thank you.

Tom Blanchard on 2015-03-13 at 11:20 said:

Scaligero has a truly unique perspective on Evola. His idea of Evola as a kind of "titan" seems accurate – Evola frequently mentioned that Olympian heroes often came from titanic stocks/backgrounds, almost as titanism was a sort of prior phase or necessary pre-requisite state that nevertheless had to be wholly overcome and transformed.

Scaligero's description of Evola as a man whose style and approach was a "necessary discipline" but whom he nevertheless had to leave behind (without repudiation) is slightly reminiscent of Dante's relationship with Virgil in the Divine Comedy. This is even reinforced by his reflection that he for some time thought of Evola as an appropriate "master".

Cologero on 2015-03-13 at 23:41 said:

David R: As Scaligero wrote, for a time he followed Evola, but then left him to develop his own idiosyncratic brand of Anthroposophy. We'll be making use of some of those earlier writings over time. As for his second phase, that is up to your own interests; I know that the Anthroposophists think highly of him.

Aeneas on 2015-03-13 at 23:47 said:

Mr Blanshard, not only was Evola a "master" but according to Scaligero he also had spirit Guides. The Comedy is a good analogy; Evola just couldn't "get" the Logos.

Am I the only one who was more interested in the pasta and wine? BTW, the pasta recipe should be made with bucatini rather than spaghetti. If anyone makes it to South Beach, look me up and perhaps I'll cook it up.

9.17 The Esoteric Origin of the Species

This essay originally appeared in the *Introduction to Magic*, volume 3. It was published under the name "Avro", which I believe to be **Julius Evola**.

Part I The reader will not fail to notice that in one particular point among others, the esoteric teachings have a distinctly counter-current character: this is in regards to "evolution".

Evolution is a type of obsession of the modern mind. It is a true psychological complex that, in the middle of the "logic of the subsoil"

about which Iagla Evola wrote (Vol 2, ch 2), directs the minds of many of those who presume that they were using the "scientific method" and objective research. Here it would be necessary to be convinced of what is also of value for many other things: or else that certain possibilities of understanding, seeing, and controlling are the effect of a certain change of attitude: and not vice versa, as rationalism would like.

Regarding evolution, it could, for example, have caused surprise about what we said about the Hyperborean tradition. In effect, the idea that previously in the interglacial and paleolithic period, a great unitary civilization existed, to which the fundamental symbols, the roots of language, and the graphism[40] are related to the oldest cultures — a similar idea must arise as revolutionary in respect to modern opinions, which are believed to have been proved once and for all on a positive basis. And it is not only a question of simple evolutionism in the history of civilization: even parts of science begin to be touched where, in one form or another, the Darwinian hypothesis on the origins of the species and on the descent of man from animals is current even now.

So the problem must be confronted as a whole. We will therefore mention what the esoteric teaching say about it, without going into details that could take me rather far: beyond the extent it can be usefully discussed in this journal.

Although not stopping myself here, I have to emphasize first of all that in the same field of profane science today it is no longer about the evolutionism that Darwin announced in his time. The Darwinian hypotheses, ever since, has undergone numerous criticisms, and real difficulties, previously not seen, have compelled it to be modified.

Where it is especially shown to be weak, is in its attempt to deduce the variety of the species from an almost automatic play of material conditions of the environment, of natural selection, and of inherited transmission of acquired characteristics. The vitalistic point of view, which

[40] https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Graphism

asserts precedence and an excess of vital energy over all the conditions, must instead acquire a greater significance.

Bergson is among those who have come into play in strictly scientific terrains against Darwinian evolutionism, showing through its insufficiencies that have left the field free for the hypothesis of an evolutionism of a no longer bio-materialistic, but of a creative, character.

The same biologists after all recognized how much the variety of species resists the attempt of that simple and linear deduction, the one from the other, that Darwin conjectured; they were led to admit "quasi-jumps" from some species to others, so that the hypothesis most in vogue today is that of De Vries, who appeals to unpredictable and essential internal mutations precisely to explain those jumps within the scheme of evolutionism.

This, nevertheless, is one hypothesis like any other, which is of interest only for the difficulty that it calls attention to, and that in a great part exists even after the introduction of enigmatic concept of mutation. I note in passing that the difficulty finds an exact comparison in what physics has recently chanced upon, when, with the theory of quanta (Planck) and the principle of indeterminism (Heisenberg), it has had to stop in the face of finite quantities of "action", without being able to explain, and without being able to point out a continuous process that leads from one to the other.

Moreover, since the evolutionistic hypothesis continues to be in force in biology as far as it has been modified and revised, it is necessary to examine its general foundations. We know the impressive bounty of facts Darwin and his school have gathered in the field of morphology, embryology, paleontology, and even geology. No one would consider denying these facts. What there is to discuss, and to indicate as arbitrary or, at least, as one-sided, is in the interpretation, through which in Darwinism these facts become proofs to support the materialist evolutionistic concept. Without postponing any longer, I will go directly to the fundamental

argument.

When they had just succeeded in establishing a continuity of forms and rings, permitting the passage from one species to another, up to man, with that, one line remains simply established, and no one tells us in what direction it has traversed. Hence, a priori, every fact adopted to uphold evolutionism could be simultaneously adopted to sustain the opposite thesis: the *involutionistic* thesis: neither more nor less. As true that the lower species are the levels preceding the higher—it is as true that they are instead *degenerative involutions* of the latter. *The presence of intermediate stages* (when they are also transitional stages)—and not from *crossbreeding* or from *selection*: other possibilities that the evolutionists don't consider) *cannot tell me, by themselves, in what direction the march happened*.

That is the fundamental point. Let's now see what can be added to it.

Let us begin with the peoples called backward from the point of view of their mentality and their civilization. Who tells us that they represent the primitive states of present humanity rather than involutive forms and residues of an even older humanity? The fact that the backward peoples are more likely to disappear than to "evolve", should make us reflect. Besides, one must consider that an even more ancient humanity could have been *different*, as much from not leaving traces where forms of civilization closer to us were successful and superimposed: from leaving instead traces of them precisely in their degenerating origins, but only of the same trunk. Modern ethnological studies on presumed "primitives" have ascertained in them not a lower level of the same mentality, but rather of another mentality, another civilization. From them, through integration, one can reach back to an even older humanity. Modern explorers of prehistory, like Frobenius and Wirth, for example, have followed this method.

Part II Moving from primitive man to the anthropoid and the ape, and presuming the jumps are surmountable, which therefore must be made in order to reach the other animal forms according to transformist models, we can say the same thing: as far as being able to consider many animal species as degenerations or degradations of still older non-animal forms. Our point of view is exactly this: *Man does not derive from the animal but, if ever, it is the various animal species that derive from man, in a sense that we now try to explain.*

The principle difficulty that this point of view encounters lies in the fact that the traces of man end at a given geological period: while the traces of prehistoric animals continue up to a much older period. But this same fact is susceptible to different interpretations, for those who can consider the idea of transformations with sufficient breadth: *that the mineral traces of man are more recent, could mean only that man was the last to come into that process, under a certain involutional aspect, through which it is precisely possible that they exist as fossils and therefore those traces are retrievable.*

The misunderstanding about "cavemen" comes from not thinking that it is natural that certain very old traces are still found in the caves, because, for multiple factors, they have not been preserved elsewhere. The idea of the recent appearance of man on the earth is based on a lack of vision of the same type; I certainly am not asking anyone to admit the fall of man from the sky: it is enough to surpass the *mineral*, but not the material, concept of corporality; it suffices to think of the possibility of a body whose most physical element (which today is the skeletal system) was composed by a substance unsusceptible to self-conservation through the process of fossilization—to remain indifferent in the face of the fact of the lack of traces in the most remote geologic periods, and to be able to admit the existence of primordial human stocks (of which the anthropoids would be the first degenerating materializations) coexisting among more driven forms of the involutive process, which would be represented

by the oldest animals of prehistory. This concept has nothing absurd in itself. Analogically, every manifestation has of necessity an inversive character: whatever stands more to the origin, more to the internal, more to the center, can only be the last to appear in the movement toward the external. And at the center and at the origin, according to esoteric teaching, would exactly be Man.

NOTE: What happens to the rest in every finalistic process: the goal, the end precedes as idea all those conditions that are necessary to actualize it, and as reality it appears as the last, after them.

This Man naturally does not correspond to the man of today: but he corresponds to them in the sense that man of today can be considered as the most approximate manifestation and the most direct lineage of primordial Man. As such, he represents the origin, the axis, while the other species represent lateral or divergent directions, if not to say, byproducts.

With an image previously used by "Ea", I can perhaps indicate better what otherwise would require a long detour of concepts in order to be understood.

Let us imagine something like an assault, like an undertaking of conquest. A group of tightly unified forces confront the danger, they approach the goal. A battle is undertaken. On the defenseless front some begin to fall back, others advance. The resistance is met, the clash begins. The empire bends. Few succeed in maintaining the original direction – like the wake of a boat, they leave behind them, dispersed, stopped, sacrificed or beaten, the greater part of those, with whom they were together at the beginning of the undertaking. The group of survivors hold firm, advance again: always fighting, they succeeds in opening a way, they finally reach the position that it was the goal of the undertaking, they conquers it, they maintain it, they planted their own banner in it. In all the other directions, the aborted, frustrated, arrested attempts of the same will lag behind on the way without exit.

We mean now by "conquest", the achievement of the physical state

of existence in the conditions well-known to us today; we mean that those who have reached the end are men and others who were defeated or have deviated, are the various animal species. Man, as known today, expresses the form in which the stock of a primordial humanity is conserved and still standing in the conditions of materiality, in which various animal species were included in the beginning, certainly not in the forms that appear to us today, but rather in the principles of them, which have taken their origin biologically from a degenerative specialization, from a ramification of the original direction into divergent directions, each one expressing the exhaustion of an attempt, the arrest of a surge of assault from which those who have "broken down" are separated and that they left behind themselves.

It is interesting to notice that ideas of this type were also put forward at the fringes of modern culture, without a connection with traditional teaching. In the works of **Edgar Dacqué** Leben als Symbol, Urwelt, Sage und Menschheit I find, for example, a rather similar conception, and an illustration that makes very clear the concept discussed above.

Conclusion

> The Diagram discussed is by **Edgar Dacqué**. He was a German paleontologist who was a devout Lutheran, a Theosophist, and was involved with the OTO.
>
> In this conclusion, Avro explains how man arises from the collective. He makes use of the Aristotelean-Thomist teaching in an interesting way. The weakness of the A-T system is that it does not take the individual into account. Here Avro expands on that teaching, with the person as the form or idea and the genotype as the material or matter.

In U, where it runs in the central direction, there is man as we know him. A, B, etc., can be considered as the nearest attempts, e.g., the diluvial

man, the anthropoid, the ape-man. Further down and backward in time, there are the other, more elementary and divergent, attempts, the first to appear in the completely "densified" form of existence that we know, accessible to paleontology and whose region extends to the outside of the circular line marked in the figure. The individual points of exit on this line from which then a group of vectors and secondary deviations starts in turn, represent the "types" of each species; and these secondary deviations (which are, in the figure, the vectors U'U", A'A", B'B", F'F", etc., in respect to the directions U, A, B, F, which also continue to the outside the vector that comes from the axis) are the transformation that each species has undergone in a partial battle, in the middle of adaptation, selection, etc.: that is to say, in the middle of the factors to which Darwin wanted to reduce the whole. Instead, the passage from one species to another does not happen at the periphery: at the periphery only hybrids (as in Z and Y) can be verified, erroneously interpreted by evolutionists as "transitional forms". The "passage" is instead determined by the issuing and from the emerging of a new branch that departs from the central direction (which goes toward man) to the head of a new impulse, at the failure of what preceded.

Here we can also take into account the true meaning of another of the facts that would seem to prove evolutionism, summarized in the idea that ontogeny repeats phylogeny. That man, in his development from the embryo, through a series of phases which have a certain resemblance with the animal forms of life, from our point of view, means only this: that each human realization includes in brief and retraces the attempts, whose possibility was included in the original stock: *but to retrace them exactly on the base of the original impulse, that goes beyond them all*; something evident in itself, insofar as an embryo stopped in any phase you want, always remains just a human embryo, not that of a fish or another animal species.

It is in a very special sense, not material and not valid for biological

consideration, that one can say that to the extent the central line UU passes through the origin of the various types of animality, man, before appearing as such in this world, lived in the hierarchy of animal forms. It is not a question, moreover, of any of the animal forms that are terrestrial and historical manifestations anterior to man: instead it is about that which corresponded to the "sacred animals" in the ancient mystery traditions. In the cult of such "animals", that in an involutive and restricted form often are found again in certain primitive peoples, that conceal the record of this knowledge, of this co-essentiality, being related to other planes or states of existence. The sacred animals are powers of life that made up part of primordial man, and from which he separated to go beyond; they are not individual animals, but the "group soul" *anima di gruppo* , daemons, whose body is the total life of a given animal species—and, each one, a transcendent experience, used up and abandoned in the wake of the past through a type of catharsis or purification. But, as I said, they were in origin parts of universal man, and terrestrial man was the most direct expression of the origin the relationships, the hidden correspondence, will remain: those that esoterism considers as marking the limbs, the functions, and the energies of the human body with the zodiac symbols or other equivalents.

Our figure corresponds, more or less, to the model of a branched tree which should be conceived in its external part as a continuous movement of expansion and return, similar to that produced by a heart: that, in order to indicate the appearance of the individuals of each species and their reabsorption into the original stocks to which they belong, and in which the dark will is conserved that continues to be blindly asserted in the dead-end efforts that constitutes it.

And as each one of these efforts constitutes, less a factor of fall and deviation, an approximation of the central will that reaches its realization only in man; equally humanity itself is an endless reiteration of attempts and approximations that achieves a prefect realization of the type only

in very rare men. In a certain way, the battle expressed in the preceding image is still open: if man represents, at least on earth, the last conquered position, as the most advanced position, is the most difficult to maintain. The drifters, the fallen, the deserters, those who are overwhelmed by animal passions are again aspirated and redissolved in forces that bring them back, through contacts with the hidden forces of animality, are without number.

The doctrine of metempsychosis comes into play here in its correct light. It is true in the sense that the possibility of an involutive process is real, for which there is not—as in the vulgar interpretation—the passing of the soul of a man into the body of an *individual* animal: but there is instead its reabsorption into the being or archetype that constitutes the form of the animals born of a given species, whose hidden direction is similar to what informed the whole life of such a man.

Recalling what was said many times in these pages, we can moreover think that, also apart from such "sacrifices" of men to "sacred animals", other possibilities exist and places of reabsorption. In general, the measure in which the human life receives collective influences, likewise indicates that of the reabsorption and the refoundation in the matrix of humanity, the individual serving as the material for other attempts, other blows, that more or less can happen at the center of the target.

In this regard, many things could be said to clarify the esoteric view about conditioned immortality and reincarnation, if only to interpret phenomena correctly, like those of certain "inheritances": which—I give it a quick look—do not have for their basis the transmission from individual to individual, but instead a type of "habit" picked up from the "*genius*" or "*manes*" of a given stock: from where every individual who is enucleated in it brings, at the most, a determined characteristic attribute that refers back to a collective influence.

Perhaps I will give myself the opportunity to add something about this. Here, I will conclude by mentioning that the Aristotelian-scholastic

terminology, through which the "genus" is the *matter* and the individual is the *form*—the more there is individuation, the more there is form and perfection—it is that which best reflects our ideas.

Everything in life that is still collective, shows how much there is in man that is still unaccomplished. Separating himself from all that is not himself, individuating himself absolutely from being only himself, and only himself, man goes beyond the destiny of rebirth, because he accomplishes the goal of that very rebirth. Without further variations and deviations, he then incarnates the pure central vector by "not having more daemons" and by doing a single thing on earth with his "idea" and his "Name".

Posted on 2013-04-14 by Aeneas

* * *

Mercurius on 2013-04-16 at 08:14 said:

Recently, Evola's review of Berdyaev's "Meaning of History" was published on Gornahoor; there are likewise some similarities between Evola and Berdyaev's ideas regarding evolution. Bedyaev neither dismisses nor argues against biological data or "fact"–for him as well, all of the biological and chronological data could very well be accurate, it is the interpretation that differs. Unlike Evola, Berdyaev does not however discuss a "devolution", or difference in "direction"; rather, he stresses that despite bio/morphological changes, teleology is the best argument contra evolution, "This does not imply the acceptance of man's destiny as the theme of the metaphysics of history. For to admit the manifestation of man's destiny in world history, it is also necessary to admit his preworld existence;that his destiny originated and was determined prior to the establishment of that world of reality where occur all those processes of evolution and development by which evolutionary theory tries to explain both man's origins and his further development". Somewhere on Gornahoor seemed to be a very similar excerpt from Solovyov, although it is being allusive right now.

Ammonius420 on 2013-04-17 at 02:04 said:

How do the Yugas described by Guénon and Hindu tradition relate to geological time? I recall that Fulcanelli wrote a book that in part touched on fossilized lifeforms and their relation to cosmic cycles, has this been found?

Boreas on 2014-11-19 at 00:47 said:

Ammonius, regarding the geological record and the Yuga cycles, there is an excellent article at Cakravartin about the more recent past; the second part of the article especially deals with the geological facts in relation to the cycles. Here's the link:

http://www.cakravartin.com/archives/the-end-of-the-kali-yuga-in-2025-unraveling-the-mysteries-of-the-yuga-cycle-by-bibhu-dev-misra

taivasvaeltaja on 2023-09-23 at 11:08 said:

https://taivaanmalja.com/2023/09/23/kaannos-esoteerinen-lajien-alkupera/

Mihai on 2013-04-18 at 04:58 said:

Evola introduces here some complications which are certainly not sustainable by traditional doctrine. From a Christian point of view, at least, Each species manifest a given aspect of the Logos, being, thus, fixed, each having its own reason for existence, separated to the others. Man is the only one who manifests the Image in its entirety.

Transformism is as much a problem when conceived both evolutionary and involutionary, since it introduces a confusion between the various 'logoi', making only a difference of degree between one species and another. Nature, however, is a hierarchical order, with essential differences between the four levels of mineral, vegetal, animal and human.

Now if the Image of God in man, no matter the degradation, can never be annulled, and if animals derive from man in an involutionary process, than we are either forced to admit that the animals also have the Image of God within them, or that, somehow, that Image has been along the way annulled.

So this is going to far. It is enough to say that man can degenerate to such a degree that he comes to resemble the animal, but it is only caused by the fact that he reaches the outer limit of the human domain and the features of the inferior one (that of the animals) begin to be reflected on him, especially since he has strayed so far away from the primordial origin. However, between the two domains there remains an impassable limit.

As to the various geological records:

1. They are extremely controversial
2. They are actually quite smaller than the mainstream authorities try to make us think
3. Their 'history' is built through a very procroustean method
4. They, themselves, can account for multiple theories.

Cologero on 2013-04-18 at 12:48 said:

You bring up interesting points, Mihai, but as the text says, Evola perhaps means by "derive" something different from what you express. In the process of involution, the idea of Man comes first. So these "derivations" are actually successive attempts to lead up to the appearance of man in his corporeality. Several of the attempts branched off into different directions, or went extinct. One path led to man. Thus, they are not physical human beings who were degraded. There are two questions, then.

(1) Does this theory accord with the facts as we know them?

(2) Does this theory explain how it leads to Man?

Darwinism answers (1) but not (2), since there is no necessary reason for Man to arise within that theory.

The essential differences between the four kingdoms of mineral, vegetable, animal and human are not absolute. The higher stage is related to the lower stage as genus and differentia. So, while man is an "animal with reason", it would not be correct to understand an animal as a "man without reason"; I think that is the point you are getting at? But I don't see Evola denying that.

You may want to go back and read the essay on Plotinus from the UR group that was published on Gornnahoor a few weeks ago, since a similar them arises. Plotinus claimed that evil was "derived" through "degradation" and "dissolution". So there is a convergence of ideas, as one would expect.

`Pickman on 2013-04-20 at 21:55 said:`

So what came first, the chicken or the egg? Certainly in respect to Darwinism "there is no necessary reason for Man to arise within that theory" as the lower does not give birth to the higher and we are left to ponder the "why" behind the theory – since basic bio-determinism, within the limits of a materialist theory or survival of the fittest is ill-equipped to answer what is essentially spiritual.

The goal of the universe was to lead the material to it's superior form of spiritual transgression. Yet we are left with questions as to how the original manifestation began (a fall?). This I find the most difficult part to grasp of the involution theory.

So how did man first appear?

I will leave that question open to others before I venture to offer my own theories on this subject.

`Cologero on 2013-04-21 at 11:18 said:`

Yes, Pickman, that would be a good discussion. Perhaps it should wait until the rest of the essay is made available. Perhaps this idea can be pondered in the meantime. When you consider any of your own projects, the idea of it is formulated and a plan adopted. Then there is the effort to materialize it. Here is where the difficulties arise. Certain aspects of the plan

may hit roadblocks or veer into dead ends. A "feedback loop" is necessary to continuously alter the plan to take extenuating circumstances into account. The "material" world, dominated as it is by the principle of Destiny, or determinism, is resistant to anything. new. It is a measure of one's will to power to be able to overcome such obstacles in order to realize one's ideas in the material world; in this case, essence and existence become a unity. Guenon refers to that as the self-manifestation of one's possibilities. So the "goal" of the universe is not really so much to lead the material (which really does not exist at all independently) to the spiritual, but rather to materialize all the possibilities of manifestation.

Sigurd on 2017-07-07 at 11:32 said:

"essence and existence become a unity. Guenon refers to that as the self-manifestation of one's possibilities. So the "goal" of the universe is not really so much to lead the material (which really does not exist at all independently) to the spiritual, but rather to materialize all the possibilities of manifestation."

Cologero, could you elaborate on this? It appears very nebulous to me. I presume you aren't referring to some "horizontal" application of possibilities; lest you fall into some justification to "realize" all sorts of abominations, their very possibility demanding it. You're aware of this, I'm sure: can you edify me on what it means to "realize" the spiritual? Is this related to the so-called "resurrection resolution of the flesh"?

If I'm on the right track, I can employ certain terms to ask for clarification as well, at the risk of misusing them due to my nascent understanding of tradition and philosophy: the essence (eidos), that is virtual, becomes actual or "substantial" (ousia) through participation in being (on), its "material" side (materia secunda) then giving rise to specific accidents in time.

Cologero on 2017-07-07 at 22:22 said:

It's interesting to me, Sigurd, that you even noticed that. It is hard to accept, although I'm not offering it as a *justification* for abominations, but simply as an observable fact. I can outline a little syllogism, and then you can decide if it makes any sense, or might require some refinements (if not outright rejection).

1) We can stipulate that in God, essence and existence are identical.

2) We can stipulate that, although man is both a spiritual and material being, his essence and existence are not identical.

3) Rather, man is a privation, i.e., he has possibilities of being that are not actualized.

4) That is clearly, if trivially, true in the growth and development from infancy to adulthood.

5) I tried to get at this in the *Meditation on the washing of the feet*[41]. This should be more than a philosophical exercise, but needs to be contemplated. (I.e., raised to the level of

[41] http://www.meditationsonthetarot.com/death-and-resurrection

"intellectus" from the "ratio".)

6) I think this is in accord with your third paragraph, isn't it? This is unlike some eastern or gnostic systems which attempt to flee the world, rather than to tend and transform it.

7) As for the "horizontal" possibilities that may lead to abominations: are they truly my possibilities? They may be infernal possibilities, i.e., ideas that don't arise from my own Being, but rather are imposed from the outside. As such their "actualization" represents a privation of my being, not its actualization. This may be true of seemingly "good" accidents, such as one's family, culture, race, etc., insofar as they represent a blind collectivity.

On the cosmic scale, it does indeed seem that all possibilities are being manifested, either in a positive sense or most often as a privation. If Guenon is correct that no possibilities, like snowflakes, are ever exactly the same, then things repeat over and over, just with very subtle variations. For example, how many ways can people die or be tortured? How many ways can humans engage in sex? How many variations in food, clothing, etc. are there? Everything just nauseatingly repeats itself with small changes. And people go wild for it, believing in the novelty of their little variation. The world will end when there has been enough.

So, yes, there is participation in being when the essence becomes actual, but privation is non-being, merely appearance. But the appearances are horrifying.

Caveman on 2017-12-07 at 19:22 said:

How should the Neanderthal be understood in this anthrogonic framework? This question is perhaps all the more relevant as it is scientifically alleged today that there occurred some interbreeding between Neanderthals and Cro Magnon man, leaving DNA traces in the modern genome which peaks in Caucasians (and is absent in sub-Saharan Africans). Would they be considered the fallen and deteriorated remnants of some pre-Adamic man? Their apparent practice of cultic rites indicates that some intuition of spiritual reality survived in them, which means that they must probably be considered human, albeit a less central manifestation thereof than their Cro Magnon contemporaries.

J. R. R. Tolkien on 2020-09-17 at 08:23 said:

As much as I enjoy Evola's writings, I think he is wrong here.

In the first place, he didn't know that the Neanderthal man was not an "anthropoid ape like figure", but was fully human, there were many frauds that were only uncovered recently.

Also the many huge skulls and bones that were found, making the "evolutionist" hypothesis even more incredible, bones of giants for example.

To finish it off, Michael Behe proved in solid biological grounds, that mutations cannot construct irreducibly complex forms, because they need all parts at once to work. Not only that, he proved that species tend to devolve, that mutations are actually changes in existing genes, not the creation of new ones.

Lucy, the astrolapithecus, and many other fossils, have been shown to be fully apes. There were many other frauds, that are inummerable. Transitory forms have actually been shown to be very problematic, species appear in the geological record suddenly, as he himself noticed.

Now, to say that there has been a material that made the substance of humans and it doesn't fossilize or show in the geological record is to invent something based on imagination, because there is no proof of that, even though we can clearly see in many ways how the modern life is a degeneration in many ways from the profound ancient wisdom. But there have been improvements too, as in medicine, so there is no progress, nor regression depending on the point of view.

Obviously, spirituality is that which is the highest, so in general one could say that there has been a regression.

But that there were simpler forms to appear I don't think can be denied, again, this only shows that the things more steeped in materiality appeared first, while man appeared last being crowned, there are other elements that will never be known to us regarding the giants, the gigantic skulls, the humans that appear to have degenerated from the primordial stock early on, all we can do is to make up hypothesis that will never lead really anywhere, since the events cannot be brought back, maybe there was an age of gods and men, but how will we know? What about the huge animals that appear in the fossil record, why are there trees that live over thousands of years? Humans have no natural defence against the natural world, no instincts, could it be that humans struggled like beasts in order to "conquer" mother Earth? The order of things indicates that humans were given from the beginning the means to achieve his final destination, which is a high spirituality that leads to ecstasy and self-mastery. As soon as they appeared, they were given all of these gifts, but they already existed ideally celestially, in the eternal idea, according to the myths of all traditional peoples they were immortals from the beginning.

J. R. R. Tolkien on 2020-09-17 at 08:36 said:

Buried Alive: The Startling Untold Story About Neanderthal Man Jack Cuozzo

The author is an orthodontist who measured the dental arch of the Neanderthals in a Paris museum and found that they had all been assembled wrong, so they looked chinless, he was persecuted fiercely after showing the fraud, this myth of the anthropoid neanderthal is still being told this very day.

Ciência Aristocrata on 2020-09-18 at 06:17 said:

The great myths recall divine origins, not animalistic origins. But the Bible speaks of lower races that mingled with the human race, which is curious, the Bible mentions a race of giants, and today we find the fossils of these giants. It is not possible to understand a perfect history of the past with horizontal science, because the history of origins is a metahistory, only a vertical

science could say anything about this type of history.

We find human fossils huge and inexplicable skulls, of which ufologists say they are aliens.

But this idea of highly technological aliens is part of the modern myth of progress, which has already been demonstrated by Guénon to be fallacious, the modern myth is ingrained in the modern mind.

If there is purpose in the causes, first humans were given the means to reach their purpose, the purpose of humans is to reach the contemplation of truth.

Materialists who deny the finality of the causes claim that they were like beasts that suffered by dying and attempting to dominate mother nature, in a blind, brute way, this is because the highest thing for materialists is the dominion of matter, they don't see that this actually doesn't satisfy the human will.

Indeed, human beings have no natural defenses, unlike birds that when released into nature know how to distinguish good fruits from poisonous fruits, there is nothing in humans that allow them to distinguish the bad from the good things for their survival, they have no protections against the various dangers of nature, no fur, no shells, nothing, if no science was given to them from the start, not only would they not be able to reach their finality, nor would they be able to survive, it is absolutely necessary that the first humans were aware of the means of protection and to reach the end that is proper only to man, which is contemplation.

Cologero on 2013-04-22 at 08:44 said:

On page 180 of the American edition of Revolt, the reference to Dacque was dropped and only the reference to The Transformist Illusion by Douglas Dewar was retained. That whole paragraph has some errors, which are even misleading. E.g., the original text does not contain the phrase "man is not alone". One would wonder then who else is far from being the product of evolution. I will be providing a revised translation in this space soon.

Max on 2015-07-24 at 06:22 said:

Evola says this: "... humanity itself is an endless reiteration of attempts and approximations that achieves a perfect realization of the type only in very rare men."

I interpret it as that the race is not necessarily what determines a person, but on the contrary a person possibly determines the race. The other individuals who belong to the same race are "approximations" to its fullest expression. From this it follows that there are guiding ideas of races. He writes that races and species are different "directions". I think we could characterize the horizontal direction in a race, species or type as a sort of general will, a kind of inertia in movement that steams along quite unconsciously in many cases. The vertical descent of will in a particular person is able influence this direction. Some may not keep up or agree to the change of direction, perhaps they drop off and become another race with another destiny. These ideas are connected to the idea of kingship and hierarchy. If the king legitimately decides "this

is the direction", those who oppose that can not be part of the community. Something to note here is that if we have a goal in mind, the direction has to be changed during the course of travel depending on what is encountered, so it is important to interpret the signs. Nowadays however, we have a situation where there is not much hierarchy, and people become subjected to unhealthy influences instead.

J. R. R. Tolkien on 2020-09-17 at 08:58 said:

What else is far from being the product of the evolution of animal species? Tigers? Why do you think they removed the reference to Dacque?

J. R. R. Tolkien on 2020-09-17 at 09:22 said:

As we see modern man becoming more and more like an animal, proves that in the beginning man was more and more like a god.

10

Translated Correspondence

10.1 The Correspondence Project

Beginning tonight, on on successive Mondays, we plan to make available selected correspondence between the various men of tradition. Our initial efforts will include letters from **Rene Guenon** to **Guido de Giorgio** (the letters in the opposite direction are missing) as well as the exchanges between **Mircea Eliade** and **Julius Evola**. We will learn, for example, that Guenon was in touch with the three advocates of Romanity, albeit with quite different approaches: De Giorgio, Evola, and Reghini. The letters to De Giorio are instructive since they often offer critiques of the other two.

I know from the statistics that our texts by De Giorgio are among the least read. That is unfortunate for, as we shall see, Guenon, unlike the other two, treats him as an equal, a peer. Tradition is much more than discussing what some king may have said to a priest three millennia ago; it is nothing if it is not accompanied by a change of consciousness, the recovery and re-creation of Traditional modes of thinking and expe-

riencing the world in one's very being. De Giorgio accomplished that, he internalized Tradition. He did not always explicitly "spell it out", but it is obvious to the discerning reader. Besides absorbing the two Traditions of Rome, he brings in elements of the Vedanta and Sufism into his meditations.

The exchanges between Guenon and De Giorgio take place between 1925 and and 1930, just prior to Guenon's relocation to Cairo, Egypt. We can therefore account for Guenon's whereabouts during this period. We will see his true opinion of Evola. We will learn of a Sufi center for initiation in Paris, but not in Rome. This should silence our critics who claim we just fabricate facts. Gornahoor is a center for cooperation, and those who only understand *strife* place themselves outside. They are simply fighting the wrong battle, but we pray they will eventually engage in the greater and lesser Holy Wars.

Posted on 2012-06-18 by Admin

* * *

Justin on 2012-06-18 at 08:27 said:
A tantalising prospect!

golgonooza on 2012-06-18 at 12:29 said:
On the subject of things to read, and knowing that you intend this summer to read The Divine Comedy as an initiatic text – I was thinking of reading it (only in translation unfortunately) for the first time but wanted to be have some kind of esoteric guide (aside from Virgil!) – is there any commentary on it you recommend? (Sorry this is a bit off-topic)

Cologero on 2012-06-18 at 18:34 said:
The first goal is to understand the literal meaning of the text which is hardly possible today because of all the allusions to ancient mythology, poetry, and historical events. I use the Charles Singleton prose translation and commentary. The penguin translation by Musa also has excellent notes.

As for an "esoteric" guide, try Guenon's book on Dante. Dante starts by indicating he is taking the journey of "our" life, so he is inviting us to participate, not to be mere observers or

curiosity seekers. He makes the journey as a "living man", so we shouldn't read it as a "hell and brimstone" sermon about our future fate. Rather, we need to look at the spiritual tendencies he describes in our own consciousness. "Fear" holds us back, since we don't want to face such things; after all, we tend to think more highly of ourselves than is warranted. Least of all, should we read it as a theological treatise, describing God's justice, etc., as is commonly done. Nor is it a travelogue or a vision of the fate of specific persons, who really represent "types" or symbols, of certain states of consciousness.

It must also be read in the light of the goals of the "Fedeli d'Amore", those men faithful to love (of which "sex magick" is a corruption). This tradition is mostly lost in the West, so some familiarity with the Sufi version (e.g., Rumi, Hafiz, Ibn Arabi) may be helpful.

10.2 From Guénon to Evola

10.2.1 First Letter

We have 11 letters from **Rene Guenon** to **Julius Evola** in the span from 1930 to 1951. In earlier letters to **Guido de Giorgio**, we saw Guenon's frustration with some of Evola's views. Here, Guenon confronts Evola directly, although more politely than in his letters to de Giorgio. Evola claims to have read all of Guenon's books; nevertheless, it seems he either misunderstood or rejected some significant aspects of Guenon's view. I believe there is some of both.

For example, Evola does not seem to understand Guenon's notion of the Intellect and thus shows little interest in ideas like the Supreme Identity. On the other hand, Evola is committed to his own philosophical system which differs from Guenon's metaphysical writings in important ways. In a letter to Mircea Elide, as we will soon see, Evola points out indeed that his doctrine is contained in his philosophy of the Absolute Individual.

The first of the letters follows:

24 August 1930

Cairo, Egypt

You must have thought that I would not respond to your letter, which reached me in Paris a little more than a year ago.

The truth is that at that time I was quite ill and, subsequently, different unforeseen difficulties and commitments of every type made me always delay every correspondence that was not absolutely urgent. Time flew by quickly and I never succeeded in doing everything I wanted to. I'm taking advantage of the fact that I am close to a little office in this residence to finally write you, asking you to excuse this excessive delay.

I have to tell you how little I was able to understand at all the interest that you showed in the reading of my books.

Obviously, the point of view you are assuming is quite distinctive and certainly cannot be mine, but I am pleased to see that that has not prevented you from getting rid of the anti-Oriental prejudice that, by your own admission, you used to hold. I wish that many others in the West would have the same attitude and come to understand the ancient doctrines of the Orient.

You ask me about [Jacques] Maritain; notwithstanding everything, I have always had friendly relations with him; as to ideas, we are in agreement especially on a negative point of view, that is, on "anti-modernity". Apart from that, even he, disgracefully, is full of prejudices against the Orient; at least he was, because it seems that those prejudices since a short time ago have been attenuated; but, something strange, it is fed by a type of fear in the face of what one does not know, and it is a disagreeable thing, because it prevents him from broadening his own point of view.

But permit me to point out to you, from the moment that you read all my books that, after The Crisis of the Modern World, there is another, Spiritual Authority and Temporal Power, what was published last year.

Currently, I am working on The Symbolism of the Cross that will definitely be published toward the end of this year.

Excuse the briefness of my letter; I would like to be able to more or

less get up to date with our correspondence.

Posted on 2012-07-16 by Cologero

* * *

`Avery on 2012-07-17 at 00:38 said:`

It is surprising that Evola would have once held a prejudice against the East, since his work ends up being much more relevant to East Asian traditions than Guenon's.

`Cologero on 2012-07-17 at 07:12 said:`

It's true that Evola adopted aspects of Tantrism, Buddhism, and Taoism into his own system but, unlike Guenon, Evola's integration of those Eastern doctrines was idiosyncratic. I suspect Guenon was referring to Evola's Euro-centrism and white supremacism; after all, Evola continued to support European colonialism.

`Umisumi on 2015-12-20 at 09:47 said:`

Good work of translation. May i ask you where you obtained these letters? Do you have copies or scans of the originals?

`Cologero on 2015-12-20 at 10:09 said:`

`http://www.libreriaeuropa.it/scheda.asp?id=5216&ricpag=1`

Evola saved all his correspondence, unlike Guenon, so we just have one half of the correspondence. That was the era before photocopy machines. The letters were handwritten, apparently, so Evola didn't keep carbon copies of his side (if anyone still remembers those). Evola wrote in Italian; Guenon responded in French.

An interesting point that people today tend to overlook is that even photos were had to come by. After years of correspondence and even Evola's translations of Guenon into Italian, Evola had no idea what Guenon looked like.

10.2.2 Second Letter

The Truth is too high to receive the least insult.

> It is unfortunate that we don't have Evola's letter to Guenon, although we can surmise what it contained. We see in this dialog, that Guenon is always the master. We have to agree with

Guenon that Evola misunderstands certain principles that discolor his work in unfortunate ways. As for the inability to clearly distinguish the esoteric, or metaphysical/initiatic aspects from the religious/exoteric, Evola has created confusion in those whose understanding of Tradition is limited to Evola. It is not a matter of choosing or preferring one exoteric form over another. Hence, there are the mindless debates of paganism vs Christianity that are pervasive in counter-Traditional circles; the very fact of debating is itself an indication of the counter-Tradition.

It also makes Evola's understanding of the Middle Ages quite confused, since he admires that period as Traditional, yet fails to adequately grasp its spiritual foundation. Yet Evola makes it very clear that what is required is an inner transformation, so this corrective would not radically alter his overall project.

Evola apparently wasn't clear about the distinction between mysticism and the ascetic or initiatic path, although he referred often to it. For Guenon, they belong to different spheres, so there is no point in criticizing mysticism, if that path is proper for a given person. This is also related to the distinction between salvation, which is meant for the many, and liberation which is restricted to the few. Again, there is no value in disputing this question.

In practice, Evola's choice seems to lead to a dead end, viz. to "ride the tiger". Yet that is not at all the goal of an ascetic, heroic, or initiatic path. Rather, it seems to me, a man should devote his efforts toward Liberation, the Supreme Identity, that is, an overcoming of the modern world, rather than an uneasy accommodation to it. The rest of the letter speaks for itself, although I do not know who "P. A." is.

Added 22 July MMXX

(1) Re Guenon's aphorism: in the *Act of Contrition*, the fear of hell or the desire for Heaven are considered imperfect motives. Make of that what you will.

(2) Re RTT: The comments were harsh on this point. The question is does it proceed beyond individual possibilities or not.

23 February 1934

Cairo, Egypt

Forgive me once again for being so late in responding to your letter that I received with pleasure after such a long silence. But I have suffered from an acute eyesight weakness, and your letter reached me exactly at the moment when I was able to read it only after a very long time. The quantity of things of every type that had accumulated while I found myself in that impossible situation of working is such that, ever since, I have not yet succeeded in freeing myself from it and to regain that lost time.

I thank you for all your appreciations in regard to my works; and I think that in effect we can find ourselves in agreement, at least, on what concerns the conditions of the current world and the necessity of a return to the tradition and spirituality, if indeed it is still possible for the West, at the point in which things have currently reached.

As far as living far from Europe, I cannot perhaps precisely take into account certain tendencies; I must confess that I do not excessively trust in a "renewal" that, as much as I know of it, remains up to this point very superficial and somewhat confused: above all, except for rare exceptions, it is about vague and poorly defined aspirations, and it is very difficult to say what will result from it. But what is certain, is that we notice in very general lines how the people are no longer so satisfied with their own modern "civilization", and that some begin to doubt the "progressive" pretense: as far as that goes, it is insufficient, nevertheless it is already at least something …

Regarding the problems brought up in your letter, permit me to tell you with great frankness that these difficulties appear to me especially to derive from the fact that you do not make a very clear distinction between the religious point of view of the one hand, and the metaphysical or initiatic, on the other. Whatever their relationships might be in certain

respects, it is never necessary to confuse or mix them, since they refer to totally different domains, and they cannot consequently interfere with each other. The domain that defines religious truth belongs to what Hindu doctrine calls "non-supreme" knowledge; it is sufficient to put everything in its place and in its order because there is no conflict possible. Above all, it is necessary not to forget that mysticism belongs totally to the religious ambit; any comparison is therefore not possible between mysticism and metaphysics.

The two ways, without considering the very relevant differences of their modalities, are not, in reality, absolutely marked out to reach the same goal; and the "mystical union" is not the *jivan mukta*, no more than "salvation" is "Liberation".

Everything that is religious, including mysticism, concerns individual possibilities, in the indefinite extension of which they are susceptible and does not go beyond them; on the other hand that is its reason for being. On the contrary, the reason for metaphysical realization is to proceed beyond [individual possibilities]; and this is why the one can serve as the base of the other. Nor was it the case for Christian esoterism of the Middle Ages, as it was always for Islamic esoterism; and, in this regard, I cited this aphorism that seems to me to be perfectly adapted to the argument: "As long as a man desires Paradise or has fear of Hell, he will not be able to aspire to the least grade of initiation".

I must moreover bring to your attention the fact that the religious point of view is necessarily tied to certain historical contingencies, while the metaphysical point of view refers exclusively to the order of principles. To speak of "multiple *avatars*", is to stick to the domain of appearances; nevertheless, in absolute reality, they are "the same thing"; the Christ principle is not multiple, whatever it can be made of its terrestrial manifestations or other types. The "Mediator", according to all traditions, is the "Universal Man", which is also the Christ; whatever the name by which he is called changes nothing, and I do not see what difficulty there

can be in regard to this.

The "ascetic" way would be, in its type, more comparable to the initiatic way of what is not mysticism, if only in that it implies a method and a positive effort. Mysticism, for its part, is instead totally the opposite because of it passive character. The ascetic way can therefore be a preparation for a realization of another order, much more that the mystical way, which would even seem even incompatible with that goal.

But I do not think on the other hand that we can assert that some of what passes beyond elementary religion is open to all; asceticism belongs only to some, and mysticism to some other. As to what is beyond the religious domain, it is obvious that it concerns a much more restricted number of persons. Whoever finds his fulfillment at a certain level would make a very great error to try to pass beyond it. That concerns the question of a necessary hierarchy, against which all sophisms of democratic egalitarianism are impotent, though many of Catholics themselves today unfortunately are affected by it: and there are perhaps still a few of them who even suspect it.

In regard to your objection inherent to the domain of pure intellectuality, is it quite certain that it is even what it has as a goal? In that case it is still necessary to make an essential distinction: the texts that you cite are revolts against profane knowledge, not against sacred knowledge; and we absolutely do not confuse what is simply rational with what is purely intellectual. When I speak of profane knowledge, I understand by it, naturally, everything that is philosophy; the less the spirit is blocked from all those things, the better, certainly, and from the initiatic point of view even more than the religious. It would be necessary perhaps to include also a good part of theology, insofar as it contains many useless subtleties and is of a still quasi-philosophical nature. In any case, everything that is discussion and controversy is of a purely profane spirit. That said, it is necessary to add that pure intellectuality eludes on the other hand the religious domain; this is another thing and it stands to reason that sen-

timent and action have their part in it. Yet again, it is necessary to put all things in the place that belongs to them, without allowing them any influence over a domain that is not their own.

Finally, pure intellectuality is in the same way indifferent in regards both to pride and humility, two opposed notions that are of a sentimental order in the same manner; those who pretend the contrary show clearly in that case that they do not have the least idea of what is truly intellectuality.

I see that you consider as valuable the incomprehension of P. A.; it would be somewhat difficult to find a more limited spirit than his. Moreover, what a fine way of defending Christianity by continuing to deny that its doctrine reaffirms a higher meaning, instead of the nonsense of moral and social character that one admits to often see in it! I don't see in what a similar vulgarity would presuppose the intervention of a superhuman principle; fortunately, I have for my part a better idea of Christianity than his.

It is sad to see how persons of this type look to diminish all that is higher than them … The Truth is too high to receive the least insult.

Posted on 2012-07-22 by Cologero

* * *

Aghorable on 2012-07-23 at 04:38 said:

"So long as a man desire Paradise or fear Hell, he cannot aspire to the least grade of initiation"

Cf. Evola's statement that the aspirant must be able to sustain "severe blows upon one's self, without being hurt thereby."

P.S. Thanks for the articles and translations.

Mihai on 2012-07-24 at 01:30 said:

"In practice, Evola's choice seems to lead to a dead end, viz. to "ride the tiger" "

To ride the tiger doesn't have to be an "uneasy accomodation to the modern world". It is a necessary step to take in the disordered, anti-spiritual world of today, for the person who cannot yet escape it, until the conditions for an effective initiation can be reached. There are not really

many options for the western man, so riding the tiger can also be seen as a challenge of worth, of patience, and of serious orientation.

Mihai on 2012-07-24 at 06:08 said:

PS: Who is the P.A. that Guenon refers to in the last part of the letter ?

Avery on 2012-07-24 at 07:52 said:

Cologero doesn't know. Obviously it would have had to have been someone in the circles of both Guenon and Evola in 1934.

Cologero on 2012-07-24 at 08:25 said:

That is the point, Mihai. If it is a necessary "step", what, then, is the next step after it?

It has been 50 years since "ride the tiger" was published, so it is time to move beyond. Certainly, there should be agreement by now about what is the opposite of the "disordered, anti-spiritual world", but, due to the great influence of pseudo-Traditionalists, that is not the case. Unfortunately, there is a rather vocal segment who know nothing of Tradition except what they find in Evola.

That is why this letter is important. It is the only time when Guenon provides a clear critique of what is lacking in Evola's perspective. And Guenon's points are necessary and fundamental. Properly understood, they make most of Evola's points stronger, not weaker.

The task now is no longer just to criticize the modern world, but rather to describe what comes next in terms of order and spirit.

Mihai on 2012-07-24 at 10:27 said:

"It has been 50 years since "ride the tiger" was published, so it is time to move beyond."

For us, who live in the modern world, Ride.. is an important principle to understand and apply. It is about living in the modern world, participating in some of its activities because of necessity without letting this brake your will and right orientation.

This is most important from the spiritual point of view. Nowadays, all that is left to western man is a formalized and bureaucratic Christinity, almost entirely devoid of its deeper, intellectual elements. It is not easy to find one's path under such conditions. So until the path reveals itself, one will have to keep one's cool amidst the chaos and survive it without despairing. This is why I consider this to be Evola's most important work.

Also, it is important to realize that Evola refined and deepened his views with the passage of time. However, he lacked a participation to a spiritual path, as far as I know he had no initiation, so it is obvious that he couldn't penetrate into the deepest meanings of symbolism and Tradition as Guenon did.

Cologero on 2012-07-24 at 12:44 said:
I have been revealing a path, Mihai. Do you think I do this for fun and profit?

Mihai on 2012-07-24 at 15:25 said:
I would never have thought of accusing you of anything like this, nor did I ever say anything that would hint such a thing, so I don't know why you made this assumption.

As for the path, I think it is necessary to clear up what I mean by this. I am referring to an active participation to a traditional spiritual path. This is a personal quest and the answer to it certainly cannot be found on the internet.

I think the website provides a starting point in seeking and an orientation.

Cologero on 2012-07-24 at 21:02 said:
Transcendence, by definition, means to be above the forces of the world, whether destructive or positive. If you cannot abandon the world, you lack power. If you do not wish to abandon the world, then you are still attached to it.

But as a preparatory stage, the neutralizing of negative forces, otherwise called drinking poison, handling snakes, or transmuting lead into gold, is certainly necessary. But it is likewise necessary to understand it is still far from the ultimate goal.

10.2.3 Guenon/Evola Letter 7 Introduction

The correspondence between Rene Guenon and Julius Evola was broken after 1934 and resumed in 1948, where there was a regular and frequent correspondence between them. Letters 3 through 6 and the first several paragraphs of Letter 7 were concerned primarily with topics only of interest to authors: books in progress, reprints, translations, etc. The second part of Letter 7, however, addresses several important topics. Unfortunately, we don't have Evola's letter which I am sure would be of great interest. We can only infer its contents, based on Guenon's responses. Here we see some significant differences between the two, and Guenon is taking the teaching role. My opinion is that Evola's works would be even stronger had he been able to absorb some of Guenon's corrections.

Guenon can be curt and often shows impatience with Evola's views. The points addressed are important and need to be taken seriously. There

should be ample material for those interested in a discussion. but for those concerned about our comments policy, bear in mind we are not interested in infinite discussion, but in coming to a decision. Please try to understand what Guenon is saying, either by reading our material on the topics, or better, his directly if you have the time. By coming to terms with their fundamental principles, one's understanding of both Guenon and Evola can only be deepened.

Since the letter is rather long, it won't be published until tomorrow evening. But, in anticipation, the following topics will be addressed:

- whether the metaphysical identity of the possible and the real is an error
- the esoteric character of early Christianity
- whether Masonry has a true initiation
- the current existence of Christian Hermetic orders that go back to the Middle Ages
- discussion of Eliphas Levi, Meyrink, Bo Yin Ra, and Kremmerz
- the difference between the true man and the transcendent man (jivan-mukti), a topic recently addressed here
- Guenon took several initiations at a young age
- Evola was still looking for a valid initiation (so much for the "Sufi of Rome")

Posted on 2012-07-29 by Cologero

10.2.4 Seventh Letter

Here we find Rene Guenon admitting the existence of initiatic organizations in the West, whether derived from Masonry or the Christian Hermetism of the Middle Ages. He himself was "initiated" in a Western form. These organizations may not be known, but it is not out of the question for them to reveal certain things from time to time.

Obviously, Julius Evola was interested in the four men discussed (Eliphas Levi, Meyrink, Bo Yin Ra, and Kremmerz), all of whom Guenon dismisses. (Eckhart Tolle was inspired by Bo Yin Ra.) Even at the age of 50, after some 25 years of correspondence with Guenon, Evola does not understand some metaphysical teachings and seems to still be searching for some "initiation".

Guenon is not taking into account that Hermetists are often tricksters, with a cultivated public persona that may be quite different from their real understanding. Esoteric writings are couched in symbols and often contain deliberate contradictions and hyperboles. This was often necessary, in fact, when there was danger of crossing political and religious authorities, to hide the true meaning from outsiders, while being understood by initiates.

Unfortunately, Guenon's obsession with initiation has in practice been deleterious since every Tom, Dick, and Harry believes he knows which "organization" is valid. Instead, they should follow Guenon's advice: learn the "theoretical knowledge" either from his writings or, even better, from the sources from which he himself got his theoretical knowledge. Once you have that knowledge, only then can you determine where to find its practical application. As he hinted, there are still initiatic organizations in the West based on Christian Hermetism; they just don't advertise on Craigslist for obvious reasons.

"Schuon's book" is The Transcendent Unity of Religion, which

was published in French in 1948..

See Guenon/Evola Letter 7 Introduction for a more complete introduction.

18 April 1949

Cairo, Egypt

About what you say in regards to Schuon's book, I don't see exactly how the affirmation of the metaphysical identity of the possible and the real could be an "error", actually just the opposite. Nevertheless, if there is anyone to whom this should be attributed, it was I and not he, since, long before him, I devoted a whole chapter (the second) of the *Multiple States of Being* to this problem.

As to the esoteric character of early Christianity, of which later Christianity was only an exteriorization (i.e., no longer having anything initiatic about it); we have no doubt about that, all the more since the Islamic tradition asserts it explicitly, claiming that Christianity, in its origins, was *tariqa* [way] and not *sharia* [law]. The absence of sharia is in fact evident from the moment that it had to supply it through an adaption of Roman law (whence "canon law" was derived), therefore with the contribution of something that was completely unrelated to Christianity (and it is necessary to note in this regard that the word in Arabic *aqnun* is still used today, in contrast to sharia, to define every law that is not integrated in the tradition).

After my latest books (especially the Perspectives on Initiation and the Reign of Quantity, since in the Great Triad I only used two or three articles), there currently remain very few of my articles, as you noted, that have not yet been republished, at least among those that were intended to be copied in Ur. As for the articles on the **Fedeli d'Amore**, I must say that I had the intention for a long time to include them in a new edition of the Esoterism of Dante; I was not able to find the time to systematize it, but I did not abandon them and moreover it is likely that the edition is about to go out of print very quickly.

On the problem of Masonry, I believe that it will truly be very difficult for us to agree; but there are a few things that astonish me about what you say in this question. First of all, you make me say (without any qualification, for I had made quite clear that it concerned only the West) that "the only initiatic traditional organizations existing are the Compagnonnage[1] and Masonry, and then you assert that I should not logically write that some Masons would seem to not take into account Oriental initiatic organizations, that otherwise exist and among which some have more or less numerous members in Europe itself. It stands to reason that it can at least write also for them. I add, to finish with this subject once and for all, that my writings can furnish to some people, unless they are associated with an initiatic organization, a theoretical knowledge of traditional doctrine that in itself is not unimportant. As to the Masons, they have had in this circle, in recent times, many more results than I myself had hoped.

Another thing: I said that in the Western world itself there still survive certain organization tied to Christian Hermetism and dating from the Middle Ages. If I have not stressed this more strongly, it is because they are so closed (one of those that I knew more in depth restricted its membership to just twelve) that the possibility of being admitted is in practice not even to be considered.

I come to another problem; if you take Masonry to be considered, or rather its origin, as an idea similar to what you express, I ask myself how you could have once had, as you had told me some time ago, the intention of developing a work on the rituals aimed at eliminating its anti-traditional elements that were introduced into it. Under these conditions it would be a totally useless task, and there is in that, I confess, something that is absolutely incomprehensible to me. [Before he was injured in Austria, Evola had been doing research on a book on Masonic rituals.]

[1] https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Compagnons_du_Devoir

However, what I would like you to take notice is this: the date of 1717 does not mark the origin of Masonry, but the beginning of its degeneration, something that is quite different. Furthermore, because we can speak of a utilization of "psychic residues" in this time, it would be necessary to suppose that operative Masonry had then ceased to exist, something not true, from the moment that it subsists still today in different countries, and that in England, between 1717 and 1813, it participated effectively to complete certain things and to straighten up others, at least in the measure in which that was still possible in a Masonry reduced to being only speculative. In reality, the schism of 1717 involved just four Lodges, while there still existed a number of much higher Lodges that did not take part in it. On the other hand, where a regular and continuous filiation exists, the degeneration did not interrupt the initiatic transmission; it only reduced its efficacy, at least in general lines, because in spite of everything there could always be exceptions. As to the anti-traditional action of which you speak, it would be necessary in this regard to make some precise distinctions, e.g., between the Anglo-Saxon and Latin Masons; but, in any case, that only proves the incomprehension of the great part of the members of one or another Masonic organization, simply a question of fact and not of principle. Fundamentally, what could be said is that Masonry was the victim of infiltrations of the modern spirit, as in the exoteric order even the Catholic Church is in its current state even to a greater degree.

Of course, it is that I do not want at all to attempt to persuade you or anybody, only to make you see that the problem is much more complex than what you seem to believe.

Regarding the "initiatic strains" you mention, without denying at all their existence (and what I just said of certain existent Hermetic groups could otherwise be connected to them), I have to say that, for many reasons, I am very skeptical in the great number of cases, and that even the examples you cited are among those that seem to me to be more than

dubious. **Eliphas Levi** was a Mason, and certain English circles with which he was in relationship were, to summarize, study groups, without a proper initiatic character, and were reserved exclusively to Masons. Apart from that, I never found the least proof that he had received any other regular initiation, and all the stories that some have told about this can only be placed in the category of occultist fables.

Meyrink was certainly in the current of very numerous traditional ideas, especially of a Jewish source; but, not to mention that this presupposes precisely an initiation (I do not think that he was able to receive a truly Cabalistic initiation, the only thing without doubt to be taken in consideration in a case of the type), the burlesque manner and caricature with which he often presented these ideas leaves a truly sinister impression (a shame that I cannot tell you by letter all the efforts that I made to remediate certain detrimental consequences of The Green Face). Besides, his relations with the school of **Bo Yin Ra** (whose true origin I am probably the only one who knows, because I noticed that his own disciples did not know it) are not certainly a very favorable indication.

As for **Kremmerz**, there would be much to say, and it would require too much time. But what I saw of his writings and even certain rituals that were too clearly "fabricated", gave me the impression of something of rather scant consistency, and that recalls the worst parts of Eliphas Levi's work; in any case, the different groups into which his disciples split give the impression of not knowing absolutely how to direct themselves, and some admit to finding themselves at a true impasse.

I will add that, every time that it concerned self-styled Egyptian organizations, there were more serious reasons to be suspicious of them, because nothing authentic is found there and not even, quite often, of any consistency. As for an initiation received outside of the ordinary way of joining a known organization, there are certainly some examples of them, but in these cases it was a question of extremely rare exceptions, and no one can be confident of finding himself in a similar condition to

avoid a normal tie; to think of it differently would be self-delusion in a very serious way. As for me, since the age of 22 or 23, I have been attached with some initiatic organization both Oriental and Western, from which you can take account that the supposition you advanced could not in any way be applied to my situation.

The doctrinal question that you speak about at the end of your letter is, fundamentally, less difficult than what it seems at first view: every "true man" has instead realized all the possibilities of the human state, but each one following a way that is congenial to him and thanks to which he differentiates himself from the others. Moreover, if it were not so, how could there be a place here, in our world, also for other beings that have not reached this level? The same thing can also be applied, at another level, for the "transcendent man" or the *jivan mukta*; but then it is a matter of the totality of the possibilities of all the states.

Only, what is real, as weird as it can seem, is in fact that beings who have reached the same level can then be, in a certain sense, "indistinguishable" from the outside, as far as it concerns corporeal appearance. It happens in effect that they encompass a "type" that no longer has any individuality, and that occurs above all for those who carry out certain special functions: the "type" is then that of the same function, something can make one believe that it is always the same being to exercise it over the course of a period of several centuries, while the reality is something completely different.

Posted on 2012-07-30 by Cologero

* * *

Mihai on 2012-07-31 at 03:19 said:

I intend to read a book by Meyrink- Der Engel vom westlichen Fenster. I am curious to draw some conclusions on the character, or at least his ideas. Evola certainly held him in high regard, but he is not the only one. Vasile Lovinescu, a Romanian follower of Guenon, who was also initiated on a Sufi path, mentions Der Engel vom… several times in his writings, calling it one time as "one of the few worthy esoteric novels of the 20th century".

I am wandering about what was the western initiation that Guenon received. I am only aware of the Sufi one.

Also, I am wandering if there are any such Hermetic organizations, that he mentioned, still existing in Europe today.

logres on 2012-07-31 at 06:27 said:

The Simple Life of R. (P Charconac) claims Bo Yin Ra was the only European member of the Teshu-Maru, a Mongolian order.

Cologero on 2012-07-31 at 08:17 said:

Mihai, have you read the Green Face? Guenon makes this strange statement: "a shame that I cannot tell you by letter all the efforts that I made to remediate certain evil consequences of The Green Face." How bad can a novel be?

And it is not as though Guenon was casually dismissing Meyrink et al off the cuff; apparently he was deeply involved in investigating some of those figures.

Guenon was involved at that time of his life (22 or 23) with the French Hermetic school (e.g., Papus, Josephin Peladan, Fabre d'Olivet etc.). I assume that is the Western initiation he is referring to.

I believe that the major books of Valentin Tomberg and Boris Mouravieff are evidences of a Hermetic school; I have already pointed out some coincidences in their publication that cannot be coincidences. Tomberg traces back to an obscure Russian Hermetist (his name escapes me at the moment); Mouni Sadhu worked with the same teacher. Since the Rosicrucians escaped to the "East", it should not be surprising that Russia maintained that tradition. The life and work of Joseph de Maistre in Russia attests to that.

Michael on 2012-07-31 at 11:08 said:

I believe the Russian esotericist was G.O. Mebes.

Mihai on 2012-07-31 at 16:57 said:

Cologero, I have not read any work by Meyrink until now. However, in the volume "Introduction to magic", which contains some of the articles published by the Ur group there is an article called "The path of awakening according to Gustave Meyrink"- a collection of excerpts claimed to be taken from Der Golem and Das grüne Gesicht. In those excerpts there are clearly some equivocal expressions and attitudes mixed with, what I perceive to be, authentic esoteric thought. Of course, it is hard to pronounce a judgement basing oneself solely on a few excerpts.

In Lovinescu's works (I did have not read all his works) I only came across praises and references on Der Engel vom westlichen Fenster. Perhaps this particular book is above the

others, maybe Meyrink deepened his understanding over time (although I do not know the order in which his books appeared). I can only see when I will read some myself.

Avery Morrow on 2012-07-31 at 23:13 said:

Bo Yin Ra is really an odd duck. His writing suggests a Theosophical connection; it's unclear what Guenon could have meant by his "true origin".

http://www.kober.com/name.php

http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Joseph_Anton_Schneiderfranken

Mihai on 2012-08-01 at 04:45 said:

I think he meant his country of origin or something.

logres on 2012-08-07 at 08:08 said:

http://www.alexandrededanann.net/boyinra_fr.htm

If anyone reads French, English still under construction – Bo Yin Ra and the "White Lodge" (which I think Guenon had a low view of).

Cologero on 2012-08-07 at 08:52 said:

So the Dalai Lama was Bo Yin Ra's master whose portrait Guenon recognized? If so, what was Guenon's objection?

Cologero on 2012-08-08 at 13:09 said:

Bo Yin Ra's master was Swami Narad Mani aka Hiran Singh. More later …

logres on 2012-08-09 at 17:54 said:

Just got a Bo Yin Ra book today in the mail, so am anticipating your comments rather keenly. I must say that the excerpts of his on the official website don't strike me as typical Theosophical jargon.

Mr Zero on 2013-12-15 at 19:32 said:

The society with only 12 members was called L'estoile internelle and was brought to Guenon's attention after he had left to Cairo in his correspondence with Reyor who was the editor of Etudes Traditionelles at the time. It is described in pages 80-82 of Sedgwick's book, they are previewable for free on google books. His sources are in the endnotes.

Cologero on 2020-08-01 at 18:04 said:

My copy is in storage, so I assume the book referred to is "The Transcendent Unity of Religion", which was published in French in 1949. Evola's confusion may be due to the word

"possible" instead of "potential". The Arabian commentators on Aristotle made that change, so that "potential existence" became the "possibility of being", which Guenon and Schuon adapted. The latter way of expressing it seems to imply something contingent, i.e., it may or may not be; so how could that be equivalent to the real? On the other hand, Potential existence and actual existence are intimately related, when the potential is actualized. That makes it easier to see that potential is just as much being as is the actual.

10.2.5 Eighth letter

Letter VIII repeats the same topics discussed in Letter VII. I'm sure that Evola's letters would be more interesting, but they are unavailable, presumably because Guenon's family was not forthcoming about releasing his personal papers. We still see Guenon's often curt and condescending tone in addressing Evola.

Evola still does not grasp the notions of the possible and the real; this will need to be explored. We see that Evola was still interested in certain marginal figures (from Guenon's point of view). Curiously, Evola was interested in Eliphas Levi. Equally curious is Guenon's admission about the existence of Hermetic organizations and his own "Western" initiation (Letter VII)[2]; in East and West, Guenon denied any existence of initiation in the West. My guess is that Evola was fishing for such organizations, but Guenon was not forthcoming on the grounds that (1) he does not give personal advice and (2) his own experience is of no interest to anyone else. Yet, it strains credulity to believe there were only 12 Hermetists in Europe.

Once again, I have omitted discussions about publishing, etc.

13 June 1949

Cairo, Egypt Discussions about publishing, etc. omitted As you imagine, it's been quite some time since I had a chance to read your Revolt

[2] https://gornahoor.net/?p=4559

against the Modern Word. I will therefore make an effort to reread it when I can find some free time, in order to see if there are some points to make as you requested.[3]

According to what you explained to me this time, it seems that you consider the words "possible" and "real" in the sense of "non-manifested" and "manifested"; if that were so, one could say that it is merely a question of terminology and that, in spite of this expressive difference, we are basically in agreement on the point in question. However, such a use of the words "possible" and "real", in a sense much different from how we use it, does not seem to be acceptable, because the non-manifested is not only just as real, but even more real than the manifested.

What I said last time regarding my ties with initiatic organizations (even though I don't really like to speak of these things that ultimately can be of interest to no one outside of myself) was in response to what you wrote: "most often out of that secret society those capable of greater comprehension with respect to initiatic things were found, something that perhaps was verified in your own situation."

That made me think you gave yourself the idea that, in my case, it could be a question of one of those pretended initiations without any regular ties, which, in my opinion, I could consider only purely imaginary. By the way, I will point out to you that, in Perspectives, I dedicated an entire chapter to explain the reasons why the word "secret society" is absolutely unacceptable in cases of the type of those which you referred to.

You think that, in Perspectives, we do not speak of Christian Hermetic organizations; but to the contrary, I expressly mentioned them even in the note to which you referenced and, if I didn't talk about it more, it is because those whose existence I was able to come to know admits such a restricted number of members that they can be considered

[3] Evola, at that time, was revising Revolt to be republished in a new edition. More discussions about publishing, etc. omitted.

as inaccessible for all practical purposes. I also see that you have not well understood in what sense I spoke of "complex problems". I only wanted to say with what in reality they have many more elements than what can be known through a study made "from the outside"; it is therefore totally contrary to something that could be defined as you thought.

As for the source itself of the question concerning Masonry, I clearly mean that I do not at all claim to convince you, and that otherwise you would have no interest in it. You say that in that case, it is a question for you only of the truth, but it is also the same even for me. You know moreover that I have never been concerned to entice anyone to join one or another organization, no more than to distance him from them. I only said in a very clear way that that could not be my role. I never had the time nor the interest to be concerned with individual cases and I always refused to give particular advise to anyone, for this thing as for any other. That said, I must however make two or three observations on what you tell me this time, and first of all on what concerns the side degrees, since the true nature of the relationship between those and Masonry seems to elude you. When I speak of Masonry without further clarifications, it is always about Masonry properly called, including only the three degrees of Apprentice, Fellow Craft, and Master Mason, to which can only be added the English degrees of Mark and Royal Arch, totally unknown in "continental" Masonry.

Regarding the many other degrees like those you refer to, it is obvious that internally there are some things of a quite different character, and that the connection which you wanted to establish between the different "systems" is completely artificial. I am furthermore less inclined to question what I myself wrote formally in a recent article; but, as that is the way with which all these things ended up by agglomerating themselves around Masonry, they do not form an integral part of it to any qualification and consequently it is not what is in question. Another point on which I would like to bring your attention is that when you say that

the Lodges that had not adhered to the "speculative" schisms were not able to do anything to stop or rectify its consequences, it seems that you do not take into account things that nevertheless cover a certain importance, like the reestablishment of the degree of Master, totally unknown by those of 1717, or the action of the "Ancients' Great Lodge", whose independent existence continued up until 1813. To say so frankly, I have the impression that you always think only of what Masonry became at a certain period in Italy and France, and that you have no idea at all what concerns Anglo-Saxon Masonry.

To move on to other issues, I confess that I do not understand at all what realizations you mean concerning Eliphas Levi; in fact, like his filiation (or rather like drawing inspirations in his writings, since he himself died before that), there was nothing other than the occultist French movement of the end of the XIX century and the beginning of the XX, on whose insignificance I think we find ourselves in agreement.

For Kremmerz, I know well that a very unclear story is concealed underneath, but that it gives rise to many doubts, at least because I was never able to find any proof about the real existence of the organization to which he would have belonged. In any case, even if he had personally received an authentic initiation, that would still demonstrate nothing for the organization he founded, insofar as there were other cases of the same type (e.g., that of Inayat Khan, who belonged to a regular tariqa in India, but whose self-styled "Order of Sufis" corresponded absolutely to nothing); everything that I can say, is that his rituals are more or less "Egyptian" like those of Cagliostro[4]!

There could nevertheless be certain realizations totally within that circle, as you say, but they do not go beyond the psychic domain, something that entails nothing of the truly initiated. I add that, after Kremmerz' death, the different groups into which his organization divided appear absolutely not to know where to turn. I notice that, concerning

[4] https://gornahoor.net/?p=764

Eliphas Levi, I forgot to cite the use of his works by Albert Pike; but in that case it is a matter of an influence exercised (otherwise indirectly) on the interpretation of the side degrees of the Scottish Rite, something that does not proceed even in the direction you have seen.

There are certainly cases in which an influence of the counter-initiation is quite visible, and among them, it is necessary to include those in which traditional information is present in a manner of a willful parody. This is above all Meyrink's case, something that, well intended, does not mean that he was perforce conscious of the influence that was exercised over him. Here is why I am amazed that you seem to have a certain esteem in regard to Meyrink, and all the more so, since he had belonged to Bo Yin Ra's movement, for which you clearly had no regard.[5]

In this regard, it is necessary on the other hand for me to make a rectification: certainly there was in Bo Yin Ra a little bit of charlatanism and mystification, but there was at least still more to him, because he was connected with a very strange organization that had its own headquarters in parts of Turkestan and represented a more or less deviant type of Tantrism. About that, I can certainly be certain (and perhaps I am the only one), at the time when the future Bo Yin Ra was still called Joseph Schneider and studied painting in Paris, some members of the organization in discussion made it known to me one day that he was the only European to be a part of it. Later, I also saw the portrait that Bo Yin Ra had made of his "Master" and that it was perfectly recognizable for me; in such occasions, I was able on the other hand to question whether even his most intimate disciples knew absolutely anything at all about that, and I was very aware of letting them in on what I myself knew of it.

Posted on 2012-08-06 by Cologero

[5]As long ago as 1924, Evola reviewed some of Bo Yin Ra's works. Although Evola did not render a fully positive judgment, he conceded that his doctrine had some interesting points.

* * *

Mihai on 2012-08-07 at 04:51 said:

"Yet, it strains credulity to believe there were only 12 Hermetists in Europe."

He didn't say that there were only 12 in Europe, but that a particular organization only admitted a maximum of 12 members. Which means (and it is implied) that there were others, but who had a similarly exclusive membership.

10.2.6 Ninth Letter

Main points:

- Guenon gets a little snarky about the possible and the real
- Guenon considers Inayat Khan to be absurd, demonstrating that a "legitimate" initiation offers no guarantee
- Guenon teaches Evola about Islam, including role of Melchizedek, the coming Imam, El-Khidr, and the meaning of infallibility and impeccability
- Guenon had high regard for **Mircea Eliade**.
- He tells a strange story about a spell cast on **Leon de Poncins**. We will have more to say about the latter at some other point.
- Guenon tells an even stranger story about a Jewish lawyer, but we are left hanging.
- Guenon explains why he never allows photos to be taken of him.
- Since Evola neither knew Guenon's age nor had ever seen a photograph of him, it proves that they had never met each other in person, no matter what others might claim.

2 August 1949

Cairo, Egypt

[Discussions about publishing, translations, and the proofs of Revolt omitted]

Regarding *Revolt*, you are doubtlessly correct: it will be simpler if you send me the proofs and I send back my observations after reading them, because otherwise you may have already modified something that I had noted.

Inayat Khan, whom I also knew, was regularly associated with the tariqah Chishtiya, one of the most widespread in India and totally orthodox; something that did not prevent the organization he founded to be completely the fruit of his fantasy and lacking any value; the name, "order of Sufis" that he gave it is also truly absurd.

As for the Masonic question, I think like you that it is useless to revisit it again. I only point out that as you say yourself this time, it is good to understand how it is not possible to speak of "Masonry" meaning a type of global entity, that in reality does not exist, or rather, if you prefer, exists only in the line of principle and which one cannot attribute it to any more or less exterior action: the refusal by some of its branches to recognize others whose deviations they criticize sufficiently proves on the other hand that there is no unity in this regard.

The problem of the possible and the real seems very simple and obvious to me, but, of course, under the condition of examining it from the metaphysical point of view. It is obvious that, from the philosophical point of view, one can always think anything whatsoever and discuss a problem endlessly without ever reaching a conclusion; it is even what characterizes profane speculation, and I have never been able to entertain any interest for those so-called "problems" that fundamentally have only a verbal existence.

Melchizedek corresponds, in Islamic esoterism, to the function of the Qutb, as I have otherwise explained in *King of the World*. On the other

hand, El-Khider is the Master of the Afrad, which are found outside the jurisdiction of the Qutb and is said that they are not even known by it; in this regard, the Koranic story of the meeting between El-Khidr and Moses (Surat El-Kalif) is otherwise very significant. The way of the Afrad is something absolutely exceptional, and no one can choose it on his own initiative. It is about an initiation received beyond the ordinary means and belongs in reality to another chain (perhaps you can find an article of Abdul-Hadi in which he deals with these two chains, even if his definitions are not perhaps very clear).

In the Jewish Kabbalah, the same distinction is found expressed through the duality of Metatron and Sandalphon.

The hidden Imam is something completely different: those who admit his existence generally think that it is he who has to appear as the Mahdi. He is on the other hand defined as "el-Muntazer", that could mean, the "expected one", but that is interpreted almost always as "he who waits".

Doctrinal infallibility belongs to whoever exercises legitimately a traditional function, naturally within the limits of that same function.

The issue of "impeccability" is quite different, and it is usually considered, at least in orthodox tradition, as reserved to the Prophet: if it happens that he sometimes performs some acts that could seem reprehensible from an exterior point of view, it is only a question of an appearance, and such actions should in reality justify for the reason that elude the understanding of ordinary men.

I can provide yew some news about **Mircea Eliade**: he published, as you might know, three articles from his journal *Zalmoxis*, the last of which in 1942. After that, he spent the rest of the war in Portugal, and subsequently he returned to Paris where he still is today. He has had many items published recently: *Yoga: Immortality and Freedom*, the *Myth of the Eternal Return*, and the *History of Religious Ideas* (which I have not yet had time to read), without mentioning the many important articles

in the *Revue de l'Histoire des Religions*. I don't have his address, but I think I can easily find it out and will then let you know.

As for **Leon de Poncins**, it is a matter of a rather unpleasant story. Shortly before the war, a certain Eve Louguet was his secretary who took part in a group of dangerous sorcerers. He himself was a victim of these people and concerning the people who by chance saw him again around 1940, they reported to me that he seemed to have undergone a true collapse. I never knew what became of him since, but, in such conditions, I have many doubts that he can still be alive. [He actually outlived both Guenon and Evola.

ED.]

What is strange is that in the same period, one of the individuals in question tried to start a correspondence with me for some reason. At that time I did not know what it was about, but very soon the affair appeared suspicious to me, so that I immediately gave him a clean break.

I recently had the chance to speak about you with Mr. M., who has for more than a year been representing Argentina in Cairo and he informed me that he had known you at one time.

He intends to translate *Man and his Becoming* into Spanish; up until now, only the *General Introduction* has been translated into that language, in a version published in Buenos Aires during the war.

Since you asked me my age, I am 62 years old; I knew that you had to be younger than I, but I didn't think that the difference was so great. [Evola was 51 at the time.] As for my photograph, I am sorry that I cannot satisfy your request, but the truth is that I don't have any, and for many reasons. In fact, first of all what could be called a matter of principle that commits me, as you say, to give no importance to anything that is of a simply individual character. But, beyond that, I am also cautious that it could present some danger. About 15 years ago, I was informed that a certain Jewish lawyer was poking all around here to procure one of my

photographs, claiming to be willing to pay any price. I never knew what he truly wanted to do with it, but what is certain in any case is that his intentions were not at all benevolent. Since one never knows where a photograph can end up, I concluded from the episode that it was much more prudent to not take one.

Posted on 2012-08-13 by Cologero

* * *

Ali Alavi on 2012-08-13 at 14:32 said:

Would I be wrong to suppose that the Abdul Hadi Guénon mentions and refers to, is none other than Ivan Aguéli?

Cologero on 2012-08-13 at 17:53 said:

Ali Alavi, thank you for pointing that out as I neglected to include that in a note. Here is the note from the collection of letters:

> Abdul-Hadi, i.e., John Gustav Agelii (1869-1917), also called Ivan Aguéli, a painter, was the one who connected Rene Guenon to Islamic esoterism through the tariqa of sheik Ilaysh el-Kebir.

Dominion on 2012-08-13 at 22:53 said:

Not having read about Leon de Poncins before, does this account fit with what is known about his life before and after said period? And if this is his response to a single picture, I can only imagine how Guenon would have viewed Facebook and the internet…

Cologero on 2012-08-13 at 23:03 said:

I did a google search, Dominion, on Leon de Poncins and Eva Louguet; Gornahoor showed up first, so it wasn't very helpful.

Leon de Poncins was a counter-revolutionary Catholic who saw Masonry and Judaism as hidden forces in Europe; actually not unlike Evola.

The notes point out that Leon lived another 25 years or so; hence, Guenon overestimated the negative effects. I have no idea why Leon's secretary would try psychic attacks against him.

As for the Internet, there may be safety in numbers. There are so many images, and not enough Jewish lawyers to use them for their own purposes.

Aghorable on 2012-08-14 at 10:07 said:

Regarding how G. might view pervasive "social networking", recall his describing a world where everything was made public as a "monstrosity" (ROQ). Even then he had surmised enough to acknowledge this trend in the possibility of its full extension, and look around you now; yet another instance of a terminal approach to the limit in a particular domain (spearheaded by a nontraditional Jew).

For me, it necessitates a serious redefinition of where one invests oneself; the greater the encroachment, the more one is forced to redirect his essence, away from the glare of whatever fumbling hunchback's shoulders our world is currently resting on.

Concerning the psychic attacks from the secretary, it could have been a case of her mainly serving as a conduit for lower forces by her involvement in some peculiar group, without her necessarily knowing entirely what is going on. Damn, I bet she friend-zoned him too.

Generally, anyone with a practical interest in initiation does well to consider just what it would mean to a person living in, say, a typical metropolis of the modern West to suddenly gain a direct perception of their inner being, without the supports that existed in regularly organized dominions. Such an operation would imply, at some point, an unguarded opening to the psychic plane, and the lower forces that inevitably converge upon one are exceedingly difficult to detect as something extrinsic at first, perhaps because they are not entirely so. This is why G. mentions, more than once, the importance of theoretical preparation; should one face a collapse, he would need tools and strength to dig himself out and rebuild. And then he might find himself in a new state where he directly perceives the very forces that are behind the events, both petty and great, that are taking place every day in the corporeal realm, especially wherever he is situated. This is the 'world as power'. and as you might imagine, living a life with such awareness is not for the faint hearted.

For the majority who have no idea of what is really at work when they are hit by forces of a similar kind, many end up in the hands of their local psychiatric team, which profession has apparently undergone a curious retreat from its previous position at the avant-garde of the psychic incursion, to the reassuring illusions of security in materialism and its favourite panacea, the chemical dose. Still others end up dead, often in grotesque circumstances (search your local Coroner's reports for particulars), hence G.'s doubts about the Vicomte de Poncins's survival.

Cologero on 2012-08-14 at 22:08 said:

I haven't found anything about Poncin's personal life other than he was from an old aristocratic family and was a Catholic counter-revolutionary along the lines of Joseph de Maistre and Donoso Cortes. I have some old books that reference his works and confirm that point of view. Furthermore, in the Italian edition of Evola's Revolt, Poncin's work, the Hidden (or Occult) War, is referred to twice. The references are not included in the English translation, nor are the

references to Donoso. Evola himself described Poncin as a Traditionalist.

Lucio on 2016-06-28 at 21:28 said:
"I recently had the chance to speak about you with Mr. M., who has for a time more than a year been representing Argentina in Cairo and he informed me that he had known you at one time".
Who is this Mr. M.?

Cologero on 2016-06-28 at 22:55 said:
Lucio: I assume it was a Maxim Montoto who translated "Man and his Becoming" into Spanish (as Guenon indicated). However, I can't find out anything about him.

Lucio on 2016-06-29 at 02:33 said:
Thanks, I consider important to know who the translators are, and I assume that the edition I have of "General Introduction" is from him, though I cannot tell for sure.

10.2.7 Tenth Letter

- Guenon explains more about impeccability
- Guenon expands on the powers of sorcerers and that no one is safe from their spells
- Guenon offers opinions on Thomas Palamidessi, Carl Jung, Meher Baba, the Golden Dawn, and Aleister Crowley
- Kerenyi sided with the liberals in Hungary during WW II. That may explain his change of attitude towards Guenon
- Evola translated Leon de Poncins' book on the occult war into Italian. Both Guenon and Evola believed in conspiracies, aka "counter initiation", which may explain their mutual interest in Poncins.

29 October 1949
Cairo, Egypt

I received your letter of 4 September about eight days ago; I wonder if you were able to reach **Eliade**, since I rushed to send you his address in

Capri. A short time after I wrote you, I knew that he had already returned to Paris; it seems that he did not take a very long vacation.

[Discussions and complaints about publishing and editors omitted]

Abdul-Hadi's article, which I spoke about, entitled *Pages dedicated to Mercury*, was republished in "Etudes Traditionnelles", but I realized that occurred only after the war, which explains the reason why you aren't familiar with him.

As for "impeccability", it goes without saying that it must belong equally to all who have reached a certain spiritual level. But, excluding the case of the prophetic mission, the possession of such a state concerns only the person who received it, and no one else can speak of its merit or care about it, hence the absence of every explicit affirmation in this regard in orthodox doctrine.

If I learn something about **Leon de Poncins**[6], I will let you know, but I still don't know what happened to him. I believed, I no longer know exactly why, that he had to retreat to Switzerland during the war, but I was not able to confirm that.

Regarding evil spells, there is a great difference between true sorcerers like those with whom he had to deal and simple occultists. The latter, notwithstanding all their pretenses, never reach any effective result. There have often been some of them who attempted to do something against me and, also like you, I never heard anything about it at all.

On the other hand, when you think that things of that type should not be able to strike those who have a true spiritual vocation (however I don't think that can be said to have been that the case of Leon de Poncins), it is also necessary to make a distinction: if you want to speak of the psychic and mental side, you are absolutely correct, but things are quite different from the corporeal point of view and anyone can always be struck in this regard. Furthermore, since it has been passed down that some sorcerers succeeded in sickening the Prophet himself, I don't even

[6] https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/L%C3%A9on_de_Poncins

see who could boast of being secure from their attacks.

Thomas Palamidessi, whose writings you inserted into your letter, is again obviously another charlatan of the type of those who currently abound everywhere. But what is astonishing is that he again appropriated ideas found in your and other's books, to use them in a way that can only discredit them; in such conditions, the works that he publishes should not require much effort to write.

I heard about **Meher Baba** in the past and his vow of silence, which does not seem to prevent him from responding in other ways to the questions that are asked of him, but I did not know that he has reappeared in recent times. I do not know if he ever was associated with any regular initiatic organization, but it seems dubious to me because he is a Parsi. Nothing of the type seems to exist among the Parsis of India, who moreover have conserved only rather incomplete fragments of their tradition (I speak of the Parsis of India, because those of central Asia have quite other knowledge, even if they keep it hidden).

I am quite astonished about how much you tell me in regards to **Karoly Kerenyi**[7], because I remember that in the past he had spoken very favorably about me; it had to be in 1939 or 1940, and at that occasion he had sent me his book *Religion in Antiquity*. On the other hand I reviewed it, but because of the suspension of "Etudes Traditionnelle", I was able to publish it only after its resumption.

As for **Carl Jung**, his influence unfortunately is gaining ground everywhere, in France as in Italy and Switzerland, and he seems to me still more dangerous than Freud because of his pseudo-spiritual pretense. Recently I had to write an article about the deformations of the very idea of Tradition provoked by his theory of the "collective unconscious".

The Golden Dawn[8] was a self-styled Hermetic organization that fundamentally did not seem to have a very serious character, because it was

[7] https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/K%C3%A1roly_Ker%C3%A9nyi

[8] https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Hermetic_Order_of_the_Golden_Dawn

from its beginnings an authentic mystification. It is true that this could serve to conceal some rather suspect things. Internally, the principle role was developed by MacGregor and his wife (Bergson's sister). Only much later was Crowley introduced to it, as he also did in many other things. Even when it was not about rather insignificant pseudo-initiations (perhaps that was not at all the case for the Golden Dawn), his involvement introduced truly sinister influences into it, if only making of it something much more dangerous. The Golden Dawn has ceased to exist, following a misunderstanding among its members, but a part of them followed it up under the name of Stella Matutina[9].

To come back to **Aleister Crowley**[10], what you told me reminds me of the story that turned up in 1931 (I believe at least that was the exact date): while he was in Portugal, he suddenly disappeared. They found his clothes on the border of the sea, something that made them believe he had drowned. But it was only a simulated death, since they were no longer concerned about him and did not try to find out where he had gone. Actually, he went to Berlin to play the role of secret adviser to Hitler who was then at his beginning. It is probably this that had given rise to certain tales about the Golden Dawn, but in reality it was only about Crowley, because it does not seem that a certain English colonel named Etherton, who was then his "colleague", had ever had the least relationship with that organisation.

A little later, Crowley founded the Saturn Lodge in Germany; have you ever heard of it? There he called himself Master Therion, and his signature was *to mega Therion* (the Great Beast), something that in Greek gives exactly the numeric value 666.

Posted on 2012-08-20 by Cologero

* * *

[9] https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Stella_Matutina

[10] https://gornahoor.net/?p=6789

Charlotte on 2012-08-20 at 14:16 said:

I'm somewhat loathe to comment again as I'm genuinely perturbed and often exasperated – to the point of intense sighing and face-palming – by some of what I've seen and heard on this website, albeit some very interesting subjects are covered. However, I feel this is an important matter for the esoteric community and want to say that I'm glad reservations about AC have been raised. Throughout my life, even since before I became consciously Christian, I have been intensely wary of him. I and was once told by a (male) witch to not even physically touch one of AC's books because his works are so intensely charged with 'black magic'. (We were in a bookshop together and saw a upside-down pentacle-adorned tome looming in sinister fashion from the bottom shelf). I do realise that he is a very complex character – and pioneering in his own right – but his identification with the number of the beast says it all really. I also agree about the damage that can be inflicted by a sorcerer given the right conditions to work in – it would be possible to see the precarious state of the world and human spirituality as having been partially brought about by the nefarious actions of determined black magicians(I could name names in this regard but don't want to draw the wrong sort of attention to anyone here). AC's involvement in the war is a curious subject. Paradoxically in this context, I actually heard that he taught Churchill the famous 'V' sign in order to counterbalance the dark magic of Hitler's gestures, but I'm not sure if that's just a legend. Chances are he was an Agent ZigZag character who worked for both sides. Either way he appears not to have won much respect for his contribution. Other magus-type characters, such as Gurdjieff, couldn't stand him, but magus types are notorious for not getting along – not enough space for more than one mammoth ego in one room I should imagine.

zero is zero on 2012-08-20 at 16:56 said:

All this stuff is cool but where is the article on game Cologero? I can't wait. Is it going to be called "Game and Sex Magic as Authentic Initiatory Tradition"?

Cologero on 2012-08-20 at 17:30 said:

Mr. Zero, you need to check the poll results, which were overwhelmingly opposed to posts on Game.

Nevertheless, since I am not much of a fan of the democratic method, I wrote a sample article anyway, which was rejected by our Board. They felt it would be unwise to reveal publicly such intimate details of female psychology. I may try to rework it to get it approved.

In the meantime, while you're waiting, I suggest taking matters into your own hands.

Cologero on 2012-08-20 at 17:35 said:

Thank you for your continued interest and valuable insights, Charlotte. Yet, I have no idea why you would be perturbed or exasperated by someone else's opinions. Enjoy what you find

interesting and ignore the rest.

Perhaps Crowley is as evil as you say, but real evil seldom announces itself so clearly. It typically hides behind bright smiles and chatter about "love", much like a wolf in sheep's clothing.

Charlotte on 2012-08-20 at 18:28 said:

Well I haven't tended to think Gornahoor is about opinions, I think it is a group of people presenting their views as the wholly representative of the 'primordial tradition'. which I do not necessarily see in the same way. Certainly many things are presented far more forcefully than as 'opinions'. but there are nonetheless things we can agree on, if not all things.

I know what you mean about wolves in sheep's clothing, opposites and mirrors, etc, there are even those who say that entities appearing 'white' (in terms of colour) in the spiritual dimensions, including dreams, are in fact luciferic and manifesting evil. Personally I do not agree with this (not that I've been given many instances where the issue cropped up at all), although I WILL admit that the most evil entity I have ever encountered was indeed white, although this may be because it was translucent (ie, of no colour at all).

Recently, in the interests of objectivity, I have tried to listen to some fans of Crowley and I can see that he did impart some truth within his body of work so I am not meaning to be overly judgmental, simply conveying what my own impression has been. I also really enjoyed his biography by Lawrence Sutin I think it was, as at the very least the man had a fascinating life and certainly did a lot for gay rights! The 'evil sorcerer' I was referring to however, is not him, it is someone who was leader of the Temple of Set in the US. I don't really want to talk much further about that, especially here where there is the potential for the dark energy to be attracted, I just thought it was worth clarifying in case people thought I meant AC. In my opinion this (the activities of the temple leader) goes right to the dark heart of dark occultism in the modern world, but getting one's head around it, apart from being subjectively horrific, is so unbelievably complicated it's probably best left aside unless absolutely necessary.

It's also interesting what is said about Jung, as in the past few weeks I've been given cause to have doubts about him for the first time, although more for accusations of anti-semitism than anything else. As I think you know, I am anything but anti-semitic, so even a hint of anti-semitism is like anathema to me. Anyway, possibly Jung doesn't deserve that criticism, I didn't look any further into it but I was surprised.

Charlotte on 2012-08-20 at 18:32 said:

details on female psychology!!! you fellas may need some help with that as it is not your strongest point (male psychology isn't my strong point either by the way) talk about a way to start a holy war.… :-))

Avery Morrow on 2012-08-20 at 18:34 said:

I agree about Crowley: he is a charlatan and dangerous only insofar as he will waste people's time with false initiation. The real demons Charlotte should be looking out for are those like Screwtape, the henchmen of the occult war who work on our souls, notwithstanding Guénon's somewhat weird claim that wizards are attacking him.

Charlotte on 2012-08-20 at 18:57 said:

I'm not looking!!! trying not to anyway. What led me to even try to learn something about AC was a decision I took to somehow resolve – as far as I might be able – the terrible situation so far as magic is concerned that was brought about during and around the World Wars. It seemed very clear to me that the present day spiritual dangers – and especially the impasse – would never be resolved until that particular 'knot' was untied. To say I wasn't prepared for what I saw would be an understatement, Guenon isn't the only one who reckons he's had wizard's past, present and/or future attacking him! (although voodoo, of course, requires compliance on the part of the victim, which is why hypnotism is so widely employed as a dark art). What you say about the henchmen who work on our souls is very true, terrifyingly so, it's important to be protected, the armour of God is necessary. I also should say that certain spiritual states of being make one more vulnerable to 'attack' from 'wizards'. with relative degrees of manifestation that can come right through to the physically injurious. In very heightened states thought becomes so much more powerful – what might otherwise be 'undesirable' but 'harmless' thoughts – anger with another, or lust, for example – take on a terrifying potential when you're in astral/etheric realms. If the 'victim' and 'attacker' are both – possibly inadvertently – at a very high stage of spiritual development or psychic awareness then you can quadruple it all again or thereabouts. look into the abyss and it looks back etc.…

This is also the reason why 'wizard' or would-be-wizard types, for want of a better term, speak in a certain way about their exploits and or experiences, as if they were as tangibly real in a scientific and objective sense as someone eating an apple. T

Charlotte on 2012-08-20 at 19:05 said:

To give a more concrete example of what Guenon may be referring to: I know a woman who had a relationship with a Muslim man a few years ago. Unbeknownst to my friend, it turns out there was a Muslim woman vying for his attention, who went to an Imam in her home country and confided to him her problem. If I remember rightly she was given some sort of bracelet, something with three beads, each of which represented a misfortune that was to befall her love rival. Sure enough, my friend duly lost around half her body weight, almost all of her hair and fell into a deep depression that was only alleviated when she converted to Islam (via a different man, who would become her husband) and found her own Imam to lift the spell…

zero is zero on 2012-08-20 at 19:06 said:

Haha good answer Cologero.

Re Crowley it's very obvious that something went wrong somewhere along the road with him, someone who bases his whole philosophy around Will but dies as a heroin addict, I think anyone can see there is a major problem involved. That doesn't mean that nothing worthwhile can be gained from some of his writings. My feeling is that we are doomed to find knowledge in this way, making a collage from scatttered sources, finding kernels of truth hidden here and there, there is no unified body of knowledge to act as a whole source in sight.

Charlotte on 2012-08-20 at 19:24 said:

The only way is by revelation from the Holy Spirit and it's probably best if one can be satisfied with that gift rather than trying to understand from an intellectual point of view. To take the life rather than the knowledge, as it were. However human beings are curious by nature and it appears to be almost impossible for almost anyone to stay firm in this respect (the trouble being that the mind is where doubt can be instilled).

Charlotte on 2012-08-20 at 19:33 said:

By the way I DO think evil tends to appear as it is – just that, Evil – but the trouble is knowing how, when and why it appears. I have never heard evil chattering about love, although I do know someone who often talks about love to mask her own despair. Nobody need be fooled by smiles – in Thailand, for instance, if you get into an argument with someone and they start smiling then watch out, they may be about to kill you.

Cologero on 2012-08-20 at 22:53 said:

Charlotte, with all the time you have allegedly spent reading Gornahoor, you still think it is all about the "mind". Shame on you.

Cologero on 2012-08-20 at 23:01 said:

Au contraire, ma chère Charlotte, I do understand female psychology, inasmuch as I knew you would come back.

Charlotte on 2012-08-21 at 05:02 said:

I had to give you the pleasure of sticking the knife in one more time, eh! pride thankfully isn't my main vice…you might have been able to judge my reaction, seeing as you know how much I care, but you will never be able to understand the reasons why. Enjoy the Miami sun, it's raining here in England but at least we've not dried out!

Charlotte on 2012-08-21 at 05:37 said:

By the way, where did I say I thought Gornahoor was 'all about the mind'. it was YOU who suggested it was a mere collection of opinions, I actually gave it more credence than that, but perhaps I shouldn't have?

While I am here, I may as well say I couldn't help noticing that people have been confused about 'Guenon's Western Initiation' and which 'school' it might have been. Well, he may have joined some other organisation in England or wherever – Druidism, perhaps – but at least I can tell you that Sufism IS a fundamental aspect of the western mystery tradition, along with Christianity and Judaism. It's easiest to see them as three interlocking circles if one would like a symbol representing how they fit together.

The 'Eastern' tradition is along the Buddhist lines. The fundamental difference is that the Western mysteries are revealed from the Holy Spirit and keep with the idea of a Creator God that is distinct from the creation, whereas the Eastern view sees Creator and Created as being one, without distinction.

This is a particularly important difference when you start looking at concepts of eternity, of which there are more than one.

Michael on 2012-08-21 at 11:35 said:

By the way Cologero, I second Zero's request for Game posts. It seems that most of the commenters are far along reading works of Tradition, but more practical posts will help novices, such as myself, come up to speed faster.

Cologero on 2012-08-21 at 12:45 said:

Michael, the Board has approved my posts conditionally, provided I file them under "fiction". They may not be what you expect.

The Board also suggested we wait until Charlotte goes away again, lest things get out of hand.

Cologero on 2012-08-21 at 13:03 said:

No, Charlotte, there was a "West" long before Christianity or Islam came on the scene, and Judaism–whatever that is–had no influence on it. Repeating some nonsense from a Karen Armstrong book is not going to cut it here.

Does "the Eastern view sees Creator and Created as being one"? Perhaps in the sense that Nirvana and Samsara are one? How about the Thomist view that for God, Essence and Existence are one?

Either all is one and there are no important differences, or all is not one, which makes one true and the other false.

As for your other point, there is only one concept of eternity, but many ways to misunderstand it.

I am asking you nicely, Charlotte, to focus on what is said here. If anything gets you emotionally worked up, that is because you are experiencing resistance, more precisely, resistance to gnosis. The first task for any reader here is to clear his mind of all personal opinion in order to hear something new.

That is also the requirement of the second Arcana: the mind must be freed of all perturbations, specifically including strong negative emotional reactions, as well as the putrefaction of useless opinions. Only then can the Holy Spirit be heard.

Charlotte on 2012-08-21 at 15:29 said:

I haven't read a Karen Armstrong book, but you clearly have – what does she write about?

I did focus on what was said here, which was Guenon's point about Crowley. It was YOU who chose to make inaccurate assessments of comments I'd written by wrongly saying I thought Gornahoor was all about the mind – again your assumptions, not my words. You can be as unpleasant towards me as you like – nothing new there – but it won't make what you say true. Your personal dislike of me is clouding your judgment. Far from being over emotional, I was at least capable of rising above my own reservations by agreeing with something that was presented here when I felt it was important enough to merit comment.

The western mystery tradition, having evolved over many years, IS informed by Sufism, Judaism and Christianity. Like it or not.

Go ahead and print your article about women, none are likely to dare comment so yourself and the 'Board' need never by any the wiser. Why don't you become a closed group if you wish to avoid attracting unwanted attentions from those you see as lesser mortals?

Charlotte on 2012-08-21 at 16:19 said:

Seeing as you wrongly assumed I'd been quoting an author I barely know, here is some pertinent information from Gareth Knight (a living male authority on the western mystery tradition, no less!). He talks more about the difference between West and East so far as mysteries are concerned, it's been up on my blog for ages:

The pendulum has swung back again—or at any rate is about to start its swing. In speaking of 'the unity of the world and all things in it'. we must, however, avoid the error of oriental monism which denies the dual existence of Creator and created. According to this view the universe and all the inner worlds therein have been self-created, or at best emanated from a central source.

This means that God is in everything, in the holiest of holies and in the dust on the sandals of the worshipper at the temple gate. As a child of an acquaintance put it with devastating childlike logic. 'When I stamp on the ground am I stamping on God?' To this the monist would rush to reply 'Yes'. but the theist would say 'No'. The monist would go on to say that as God is also in the child's foot, sock and shoe, God was stamping on God. The theist would go on to say

that although God is not in everything He is omniscient as far as the creation is concerned and is therefore aware of the child stamping and in empathy with both the child and the ground.

All this is not academic, theological or philosophical hair splitting, for the consequences of believing one thing or the other are profound. If we are going to build a philosophical or theological edifice we need to be very certain of the rock upon which it is founded. To believe that all things unfurl of their own accord from nothing is to assume that man is capable of expanding his consciousness until he comes eventually as God, comprehending all – and that animals expand their consciousness to become humans, plants likewise to become animals, even minerals to become plants.

This is a theory that is, in fact, held by many students of the occult, based on the monist philosophical assumptions of the East It has its superficial attraction as a logical sounding kind of arrangement. It takes in the ideas of human progress and general life evolution that were newly formulated and current in the nineteenth century, and it is hardly surprising that these ideas in occult form were first promulgated in the West in the late nineteenth century by the efforts of the newly formed Theosophical Society.

What Madame Blavatsky, its founder, did really was to take nineteenth-century materialist evolutionary theory as formulated by Darwin and stand it on its head as a spiritual evolutionary theory, in much the same way that

Marx had inverted the spiritual dialectic of Hegel to form the dialectical materialism of Marxism. Both Marxism and Theosophy have a great spurious appeal as seeming to answer many questions by this agile topsy-turveydom. Unfortunately both are wrong – though this does not alter the fact that Marxism as a political philosophy came to dominate a third of the world and Theosophical monism dominates much of modern occult thought.

It is not our task to try to judge why certain particular nineteenth-century philosophical ideas should retain such a hold into modern times, though in the case of oriental monism and occultism its influence spread because a whole generation of occult students sat at the feet of Madame Blavatsky and imbibed her principles even if they later rejected some of the superstructure of her philosophy. They later taught others and so the basic assumptions spread – with various modifications to and arguments about the superstructure, but with the entire theological foundations taken for granted and accepted unchallenged.

The whole Western occult tradition, which had followed an underground course for centuries, burst out into the open, only to be thoroughly mixed, swamped and diluted with Eastern ideas deriving from Hinduism and Buddhism. The true occult heritage of the West stems, however, along with the religion of the West, from Christian and Judaic tradition – or rather from revealed as opposed to natural religion.

Gareth Knight, Experience of the Inner Worlds, The Sphere of Light

Charlotte on 2012-08-21 at 16:44 said:

Now I will quote you, Cologero:

"Judaism – whatever that is"

Shame on YOU. Avery was right to caution about Screwtapes, casual readers beware.

Cologero on 2012-08-22 at 07:34 said:

Charlotte, Judaism has a long history. At one time there were priests, temples and animal sacrifice. That judaism no longer exists. Rabbinic judaism is different. Orthodox Jews are different from Reformed Jews. And so on.

The same for Christianity … that word means very little today as a guide to what someone believes or how he acts.

You persist, Dear Charlotte, in finding the worse possible interpretation of what you read. St. Ignatius Loyola recommended the opposite, i.e., first consider the best interpretation of what you read before you judge.

It is time for you to leave us in peace, Charlotte, your sort of cattiness is not welcome here.

harlotte on 2012-08-22 at 07:47 said:

I'm afraid you have again misjudged me Charles, the cattiness and unpleasant comments came from you. The actual decision to repost here, apart from the interesting comment about black sorcerers, was following a family funeral where a conversation with my catholic cousin gave me hope for the first time in months that not all is lost for the church. My tentative venture here proved once again how highly unpleasant and totally unreasonable professed 'traditionalists' can be. I'm sorry you can't handle the truth I bring you.

Cologero on 2012-08-22 at 08:00 said:

Thanks for clearing that up, Charlotte, and I am sorry for your loss.

Should you ever decide to comment on what is actually written here, you will be most welcome.

Charlotte on 2012-08-22 at 08:19 said:

That's alright,you're not expected to know the ins and outs of my life. But please see that I WAS actually commenting on what is written here (Guenon on Crowley), not just turning up to be difficult – you can't seriously imagine I would subject myself to running the gauntlet on a whim, for the sake of being shot down!

The truth is I thought this was something that we were able to agree upon and therefore a 'safe topic'. In my view it was worth highlighting as it touches on matters pertinent to the 'occult war'. I know that email/internet makes it very difficult to judge people's tone or the manner in which comments are intended, but please be assured that cattiness and sarcasm are simply not

my style, although I can't help being ironic at times…i guess what is blatantly obvious to one person (any person), is shrouded in obscurity for another, we all see what we see.

As for 'western initiations'. I will concede that it is fair to say there are a number of takes on what this entails. As far as I'm concerned it encompasses the revealed religion of Judaism, Christianity and Islam, which as you point out have all been through various changes and interpretations over the centuries. However, others see the 'western mysteries' as a more recent phenomena, a Golden Dawn term, or see it primarily in terms of Egypt, for example. So there is potential for confusions, certainly.

It just seemed to me that so much is made of Guenon being Sufi that it was logical to assume this constituted his 'western initiation'. but maybe there was another. Given his feelings on Crowley it seems unlikely it was Golden Dawn or such like, but other may know better. There were plenty of occult societies in those days so I guess it could have been anything…

Andrew on 2012-08-23 at 06:26 said:

I honestly think we should just ban women. This is typical, and it's not Charlotte's fault, but…she is a woman, and we can't expect any better.

Cologero on 2012-08-23 at 08:27 said:

On the other hand, Andrew, there are Buddhist texts, at least in the Vajrayana scriptures, in which women appear as teachers. So I suggest we take this opportunity to recognize and eradicate ignorance, irrationality, and unjustified aggression within ourselves.

Aghorable on 2012-08-23 at 10:02 said:

Were I chief of a bricks-and-mortar club, I would perhaps adopt Andrew's suggestion, tempering it slightly to allow women with special skills to join us on certain nights.

Skills, for instance, belly dancing, harp playing, tea brewing, rhythmic gymnastics etc. They would only be permitted to indulge us in romantic discourse, no crusty erudition or intellectual posturing, but they would need to express a basic familiarity with metaphysical concepts to gain admittance, in order to appreciate the elevated states of our being.

And there would be hashish and opium and wine, and the finest blends of tobacco known to man, and sturdy eunuchs from barbarous corners of the world tending to our vagaries, with water flowing perpetually from a hidden mountain spring, and soft cushions of fine silk sent us by the Thai royal family; juicy fruit and tropical birds tamed into submission by our otherworldly song, and unlimited broadband internet to facilitate our studies, powered by thorium reactors…

Ah, Captain Nemo, my old friend.

Charlotte on 2012-08-23 at 11:02 said:

Oh I forgot to mention the Rishis and Dakinis, that was somewhat remiss of me!

Gosh what a dull world it would be without them…

Matt on 2012-08-23 at 20:00 said:

….Yikes. To bring this back to Guenon's letter (the original topic at hand for this discussion), Guenon's judgement of Palamidessi is rather noteworthy…if only because Palamidessi's writings were the subject of a couple of posts on gornahoor by Logres. If I remember correctly Logres was planning on writing some more posts on this particular figure's writings, though they never materialized.

I wonder if Evola may have eventually come to share Guenon's view on Thomas, though I think Evola wrote a relatively cordial letter to Palamidessi late in his life…..so maybe not.

Logres on 2013-07-14 at 10:22 said:

I was doing some rethinking the other day, and realized that Palamidessi's conversion to Christianity was in the 1960s: this letter is from substantially earlier. Is it possible that Tomasso was a charlatan, but one who converted and repented? Not necessarily so, just because he was formally a Christian later in life, but a possibility.

Sy on 2017-06-23 at 08:02 said:

the "article about the deformations of the very idea of Tradition provoked by his theory of the collective unconscious" would be interesting. has anyone found it?

Cologero on 2017-06-23 at 14:53 said:

@Sy, see Chapter 5, "Tradition and the Unconscious" in Guenon's *Symbols of Sacred Science*.

10.3 From Guénon to Guido de Giorgio

10.3.1 First Letter

This is the first of **Rene Guenon**'s letters to **Guido de Giorgio**. It shows how things were done prior to Internet blogs and e-mail. The letters were written in French; Guenon was not fluent enough in Italian to write in that language. The criticism of Evola is pretty severe, but Evola was about 27 years old at the time and just transitioning to Guenon style Tradition after several years

studying German philosophy. I have left out the salutations and the flowery, but affectionate, closings common at that time

Paris, 20 November 1925

I was beginning to get a little nervous since I hadn't received anything from you since your postcard in July, and, fearing that you were still suffering, I thought to write you some words to ask you for some news, when your letter reached me. Since then, I put off writing to you from one day to the next, because I was always very busy since my return here, so that it is I who, in turn, am late answering you. I address this letter to you to Varazze where, I think you told me, you must be settled for some time already.

Thanks for the good idea that you had to invite me to go to meet up with you; however, unfortunately, trips are quite costly at the moment; I hope all the same that we will end up meeting some other day.

What you say about Vulliaud's Kabbalah is quite correct, although perhaps a little severe; basically, it is pretty much what I wrote myself in a more attenuated form. I spoke of that work with different persons who had read it; their assessments agree with ours and are even less enthusiastic. I didn't have a chance to read Vulliaud's new book on the "Song of Songs", which appeared three or four months ago; it seems to contain fewer discussions and critiques that the Kabbalah, but still too much.

Thanks for the issue of Bilychnis that you sent me; since then, I received from Evola himself a full packet of other reviews containing some of his articles. In acknowledging its reception, I told him that I had several reservations to make on his point of view which seemed to me overly philosophic. He wrote me a rather long and confused letter in which he protested that the philosophical form which he used is for him only a simple means of exposition which does not affect his doctrine itself. I believe none of it, and I persist in thinking that he is really too imbued with philosophy, and especially German philosophy. In an article published by the review Ultra, he alluded to me in a note, in regards to East

and West, in terms that prove that he did not understand very much of what I explained; he even went so far as to describe me as a "rationalist", which is really ridiculous (all the more so since it concerns a book where I expressly asserted the falsity of rationalism!), and that shows clearly that he is one of those who cannot get rid of philosophical labels and who feel the need to apply them wrongly and haphazardly. He told me his intention to write an article on Man and his becoming; I ask myself what that could possibly be; we will certainly see at some point.

Since we are still on Evola, it is still necessary that I tell you that he was hurt by Reghini's criticisms, however, in a very moderate way. He must be rather vain and would like to have nothing but praise; it is true that he is very young. Vulliaud, who doesn't have the same excuse, is almost as susceptible; it appears that he also was rather unhappy with my article; he imagines that only he knows the Kabbalah and is capable of speaking about it. It is to be feared that Evola is soon doing as much for the Tantras, of which he is, however, not very qualified to be dealing with them; he sees all that through his philosophy, from where a type of deformation in the German manner; the true conception of Shakti is a completely different thing from "voluntarism".

I am happy that you are very interested by the articles of Gnose; the inferiority of the first issues come from the time when I had only a nominal direction; I even had some trouble subsequently clearing out some troublesome people; it would be too long to tell you in detail.

What is that recent book which contains some fragments from the Zohar from Jean de Pauly's translation? I didn't hear anything about it.

I finally made Massignon's acquaintance; he talks a lot, and there is in him a certain affectation, which otherwise is revealed also in his style. It is true that his works are rather difficult to read, and on the other hand, if he has assuredly understood certain things, he has not however penetrated the heart of Muslim esoterism. As for Carra de Vaus, he understands still less, and even from the point of view of exoterism, he ends up committing

some gross errors; he is above all a compiler, and the principal utility of his works consists in what in them is brought together of the teachings which are found scattered a little everywhere.

For the Vedanta, up to now, there have not yet been any reviews in the journals; that will always require some time, and furthermore there have been the holidays. Nothing from Masson-Oursel; I don't know if he will speak about it nor what he will say, but I will be quite astonished if it would be better that what he wrote for my earlier book. There were some notes in the journals; I am attaching to this letter copies of the principle ones; you will see that they are not bad. Last month, there was also a long article about me, by Gonzague Truc, in "Candide"; I currently have a single copy; but I will try to get another one to send you.

Don't delay too long this time in sending back to me news about you.

Posted on 2012-06-18 by Cologero

* * *

Audrey on 2012-09-17 at 21:15 said:
You mean there was a time with no internet blogs and e-mail?

Saladin on 2013-02-14 at 21:22 said:
I liked the jab at Massignon but was quite uncomfortable reading his views on Evola. I think later on his impression of Evola somehow improved.

10.3.2 Second Letter

In this letter, **Rene Guenon** chit chats about some of their reading material. He also quotes a long passage from one of **Julius Evola**'s essays in which Evola again accused Guenon of rationalism, at least by his own definition. Evola insists the principle of the absolute is Power, or Shakti. It is curious that Evola exalts the

feminine element above the masculine. Guenon seems annoyed about what he regards as a misunderstanding. Evola also distances himself from Guenon by praising science as the consequence of self-assertion.

Paris, 26 January 1926

Dear Sir,

I believe I am getting later and later with my correspondence; I would have rather liked to give you my wishes for better health since, after you told me in your last letter, you were still suffering.

I am happy that you were satisfied with reading about **Milarepa**; besides, the contrary would have certainly astonished me. In the same collection, there is another of Bacot's transations: *Three mysterious Tibetans*: that is also good, but these are texts of a somewhat literary character, therefore of much less interest for us.

I suppose that P. Huc's book that you told me about is the republication which was recently made about his travels in Tibet and China; it contains nothing about doctrines; there are in it some curious descriptions, but that is all.

Boehme's work which was translated into Italian must be *De signature rerum*: it seems to me that the meaning of the title was not made very exactly. As to Campanella's book, I am not familiar with it; I have only read a review in the last issues of "Ignis". The fragments of the Zohar published by Rieder are in effect only extracts from Jean de Pauly's translation; I haven't seen them, but I hear that they were rather well chosen.

As to Mead, his books are so impregnated with Theosophy that I strongly doubt that anything good can be pulled from them.

As for Theosophy, do you know that the solemn proclamation of the new Messiah (Krishnamurti) has to take place very soon with an extraordinary mise en scene? None of that can be taken seriously.

You ask me about the journal "Ultra"; it defines itself as "independent theosophical", that is, it is the organ of a group which has separated from Annie Besant's Theosophical Society. Here is the copy of Evola's note which appeared in that review (in an article titled *The Problem of the East and West*), which is about me.

> It is clear here that we speak of the East and the West as two ideal types which, if they belong to the general character of the two cultures, cannot belong to their details. Presently, for example, currents like intuitionalism, actual idealism, irrationalism are as a general rule justifiable by the principle of *eros*. We must on the contrary have reservations about pragmatism. Consequently, we can't agree with the thesis held by Rene Guenon (East and West), that "scientism" and sensual life are the hidden elements connecting them together.
>
> It is correct that western science is used for practical ends. But it is not necessary to confuse the two things: without simple desires and needs which would have remained such, scientific comprehension of nature would not have advanced one step. The accomplishment of science is linked in fact, as we have already noted, to a first manifestation of the positive principle of domination and assertion of the Self—which constitutes a *metaphysical value*. What was made possible by such a principle superior in itself both to the life of needs and to the sentiment that 'pure intellectuality' which Guenon, as the good rationalist that he is, has as a superstition—whether it was utilized by elements which are alien to it, is a totally different question. In itself it remains a value that confers on western culture its significance and originality. We assert with Guenon that the principle of the absolute has nothing to do with the sentimental, moralist, and abstractly rational element; but we assert against Guenon that it has nothing to do with that "pure intellectually" or 'metaphysic' that he speaks about, and, emphatically, we *know* what it is. It is for that reason precisely that

> we dispute, from a higher point of view, that such 'metaphysic' can be distinguished from the rational as it was defined by Hegel, for example Venunft opposed to Verstand. And we assert therefore that the *principle of the absolute is power* (**Shakti**) and whatever system that in the metaphysical order puts something before or above power is rationalistic (in the pejorative sense used by Guenon) and abstract.

Evola does not lack any pretentions as you can see; but, for my part, I still think that he doesn't understand at all what we mean by "intellectuality", "knowledge", "contemplation", etc., and he can't even make the distinction between the "initiatic" and "profane" points of view. It appears that he intends to publish a review of my work on the Vedanta in the journal *L'Idealismo Realistico*; we will see what that will be like. In any case, in spite of everything that we tried to explain to him, he persists in finding "rationalism" in the Vedanta, all while being compelled to recognize that he then takes the word "rationalism" in a rather different sense from what is usually meant by it.

You must have seen that the publication of *Ignis* was interrupted; Reghini could no longer manage to do it all on his own or pretty much so, or it was clearly necessary that he had to be concerned only with that, which is not possible for him with the conditions of current life. There are certainly people who had promised to help him, but who have done nothing; it is often that way, unfortunately. I think that you would have seen, in the last issue, my article on **Joseph de Maistre**, concerning the books of Emile Dermenghem[11].

I am going to send you the issue of *Candide* containing the article about me which I told you about in my preceding letter. Apart from that, I don't have much of anything new to tell you; the reviews in the journals are a long time coming; and then it must be that people feel some

[11] https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Aissawa

difficulty speaking of my last book. When I have something which will be worth the trouble, I will tell you.

What you say about the conception of Dharma among the Jains seems to me correct, and I don't believe anymore that we can find an essential difference with orthodox doctrine in it. On the contrary, the meaning they give the words *loka* and *aloka* is rather particular; it seems to be quite exact to translate the first, in this case, by the "world of forms" as you do.

As to *sphota*[12], it is a conception typical of certain grammarians, and whose discussion which you allude to shows its uselessness. Naturally, the point of view of the grammarians can only be exterior and analytic; it relates uniquely to the form of the word, in as much as this is constituted by the assemblage of certain phonetic elements; the word is not taken there in itself and synthetically. It is well that there is something artificial in the point of view which necessitates the intervention of the *sphota*; you are therefore completely correct. It is also certain that this discussion has much more importance than one could believe when envisaged superficially; but it is not to the current philologists that we can hope make that understood; everything that concerns the true nature of the language eludes them entirely.

Last month I lectured on Oriental metaphysics[13] to a study group which meets at the Sorbonne; I will send it to you when it is published. Before me, Masson-Oursel had made two; he said some implausible things there, and he presented a veritable caricature of Hindu doctrines; if that interests you, I could give you some examples the next time I write you.

Posted on 2012-07-09 by Cologero

* * *

[12] https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Spho%E1%B9%ADa

[13] https://www.gornahoor.net/library/OrientalMetaphysics.pdf

Avery on 2012-07-09 at 08:27 said:

I wonder what Guenon thought when the World-Teacher Krishnamurti turned out to be a genius teacher… mired in powerless existentialism.

http://www.kinfonet.org/krishnamurti/excerpts/11/parts

Cologero on 2012-07-09 at 12:16 said:

I don't recall that Guenon ever wrote anything about the mature Krishnamurti. Perhaps, because Krishnamurti did not achieve any influence until years later (than the 1920s). I doubt, in any case, that Guenon would have approved of Krishnamurti due to his rejection of traditional forms.

10.3.3 Third Letter

> Looking back from 1949 to 1927, I wonder about some things. De Giorgio and Guenon often complain about health problems. In this case, there is no implication that De Giorgio's illness is the result of sorcery. Actually, Guenon brings up that topic only after having relocated to Cairo. Something was going on with him that he never made clear.
>
> Another point is that Guenon always apologizes for being "busy". Does anyone else wonder about that? I'm sure he was doing a lot of research, working on his books, raising a family, etc.
>
> Once again, the topic of a Western initiatic group comes up. There is no mention of that mysterious group of twelve. Perhaps Guenon discovered them subsequent to 1927.
>
> My comments are inside footnotes.

Paris, 12 June, 1927

What must you be thinking of my silence? I am truly sorry for leaving your last letter without a response, and I blame myself so much more since you have not been feeling well. I want to think that your health will improve before long.

I went to the Bosse bookstore right away as you requested; they couldn't tell me if your money order had arrived, because it appears that that they had failed to do the research. Nevertheless, they tell me that you needn't worry about it and they will issue a refund.

The Italian translation of the King of the World has appeared; I recently received it. I don't know if you know M. Hackin[14]; we spoke of you last time that I saw him. He also sent me Stcherbatsky's[15] book, but until now, I never had time to read it. It has been a long time since that translation was made.

I saw Masson-Oursel[16] some time ago; he told me that he has been coming closer and closer to my point of view and that he took account that the orientalists had certainly committed many errors. After all that he has written up until now, I was somewhat surprised by this declaration. I ask myself if he will have the courage to say that publicly someday. He is truly too indecisive and fears being jeopardized by clear-cut affirmations.

Did you ever receive a response from **Tahar Kheireddine**?[17]

Here is the explanation that you had asked me on the subject of Avalokitesvara. This name literally means "the Lord (Ishwara) seen from below"; but, in spite of the use of the past participle *lokita*, it is most often interpreted as if it meant "the Lord looking down". In reality, these two interpretations, far from being contradictory or excluding each other, complement each other perfectly, because there is somehow a reciprocity

[14] Specialist in Oriental art.

[15] `https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Fyodor_Shcherbatskoy`. Probably Stcherbatsky's *The Conception of Buddhist Nirvana*, published in 1927. Guenon took little interest in Buddhism, as this comment shows. However, note below re Avalokitesvara.

[16] Masson-Oursel was a positivist in the Comtean tradition. To adopt Guenon's perspective would indeed have been quite a conversion, and its public revelation undoubtedly would have destroyed his reputation.

[17] A sheik greatly respected by Guido de Giorgio, and who apparently initiated him into Sufism in Tunisia.

of relationship.

One could speak in this regard to a longing from the lower to the higher, prompting the descent of spiritual influences. It is that descent that represents the symbolism of Avalokitesvara; it is that which can be called "Cosmic Love" (certain Muslim schools also use an expression with that meaning), while employing, of course, this word "love" outside of every sentimental meaning of the word. One of the most used symbols, and which is found again almost everywhere, is the triangle whose apex is pointing down. The comparison which was sometimes made of Avalokitesvara to a feminine principle is also in connection with the same idea and the same symbolism: in India, the inverted or descending triangle is one of the signs of the Shakti.

The Rex Nemorensis which you speak to me about must be the same person who is often called the "priest of Nemi" (I believe that Renan wrote something under that title [true]). I know that there exists a lake of Nemi, but I don't know exactly in what region of Italy it is found. In any case, it is Nemi which is the current name of the locality; but at its origin, that could not be a proper name, because it is simply the Latin word *nemus*, which means "woods", and especially "sacred woods". This word is closely related to the Celtic *nemeton*, and also, by inversion to the Greek *temenos*, which means some "consecrated place". The roots of these words, like those of *templum* and *sacratum* express principally the idea of putting apart, of separating from the profane world.

I haven't had the chance to see Mardrus' translations but based on what I know of him, I mistrust him a little; furthermore, I don't believe that the Koran is truly translatable.[18]

Evola always sends me his journal; he would really like me to give him an article, but I have hardly any time for it. There are things in it of

[18]The translation was commissioned by the French government. In general, any translation of the Koran is considered an "interpretation" at best. The mistrust probably arises from Mardrus' less than faithful translation of *1001 Nights*.

rather uneven interest, yet there is much less of "philosophy" than I had feared. Moreover, Evola wrote me that he would soon leave aside that "philosophical" form that he had adopted up until this point. I can only applaud that intention, but I fear the influence he underwent will persist in spite of everything, although he defends himself and claims to have had special reasons to adopt this language and mode of exposition.

Everything you tell me on the subject of magic is completely right; it seems that Evola takes this word in a somewhat different sense from what it normally has, and the way he employs it has some drawbacks. In the proper meaning of the word, it is, after all, only a science of the experiential order. It can in effect serve as the point of departure for something else, but that is true of all traditional sciences, such as they are, and I would even say willingly that they are especially made for that. Only the sciences conceived in the modern Western way can lead to nothing else and which are constituted in a way that do not permit the passage to knowledge of a higher order.

As for what Evola wrote you, I agree with him that there used to exist a Western initiatic tradition; but, unfortunately, I strongly doubt that it can be considered as still currently living. I certainly encounter, from time to time, the assertion of the existence of spiritual centres in this or that region of Europe, but, up until now, I have had no proof that that assertion is justifiable.

Posted on 2012-08-27 by Cologero

10.3.4 Fifth letter

In this letter from **Rene Guenon** to **Guido de Giorgio**, we learn:

- Guenon was ignorant of Buddhism, specifically *Vajrayana*[19].

[19] `http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Vajrayana`

- Initiation is connected to the Kali Yuga.
- **Dante**'s symbolism is equivalent to Eastern symbolism. This explains some observations:
  - Westerners who don't understand Dante are unlikely to understand Eastern religions.
  - Modern scholars are unlikely to understand Dante.
- Hermetic symbolism is close to Oriental symbolism.
- Historic facts have a symbolic value completely different from what they have in themselves.
- Guenon believes Evola is intelligent but his prejudices often prevent him from seeing things truly.

Blois, 15 August, 1927

I am sorry to see from your last letter that your health is still far from being good; I hope however it will improve. Unfortunately, the weather is very bad since we have been here: storms, gales, almost continual rain; it is truly not summer weather. However, here, it typically gets much better, and the sky is not at all the same as in the region of Paris, but this year, the sun is almost always absent. There are neither mountains nor hills, at most some vineyards; but there are forests very close to Blois, and we can go for a number of hikes nearby. This is, I believe, the information that you asked me about; in any case, if you decide to come, don't do it before the first days of September because we are going to be away. I would be very happy to have the chance to finally get acquainted with you, if your health permits you at that time to make the trip without tiring yourself.

Vajra is a thunderbolt, but I must warn you that I myself would be currently at pains to say exactly what *Vajrayana* is. I will have to research that on my return to Paris, not having here the necessary information.

I totally agree with your opinion about the current state of humanity in relation to the Kali Yuga. Moreover, it is what I explain in the book

that I just completed[20]. Moreover, it is quite certain that "initiation" is understood only by the special conditions of the Kali Yuga, outside of which it would not have its *raison d'être*. It is not less true that it is necessary, in fact, to take these conditions into consideration. That is why, while being perfectly in agreement with you in principle, I must however maintain everything that I said about the role of the elite. This role, moreover, is not at all typical of traditions in their religious form. The example of Taoism is a sufficient proof of it, and the same thing is found everywhere, although sometimes in a way less defined (in India, for example). Since the Kali Yuga, "initiation" exists in the East as well as it used to exist in the West; there it is as a necessity of fact.

Likewise for symbolism: the use of symbols comparable to Hermetic symbols is also totally general, and these symbols are not opposed at all to natural symbols, but, on the contrary, they are connected very normally. Furthermore, the symbolic character of all manifestation permits us to give to historic facts, as well as to all the rest, a value completely different from what they have in themselves. As for what you say about Dante; his symbolism is, if you wish, Western in is exterior form, but it is totally equivalent to Oriental symbolism. Moreover, there arose a true opposition between the East and the West only when the West lost its tradition, including the meaning of symbolism. Hermetism is much closer to the Oriental spirit than to the modern Western spirit. Perhaps we will soon have the opportunity to talk about all of this in more depth.

I received a letter from Evola yesterday, who still insists that I send him something for Ur. I surely believe that I would have to end things by deciding to give him satisfaction. He tells me that he had published the first volume of his Theory of the Absolute Individual, but that he didn't send it to me because of its overly philosophical character, and that he thinks his *Pagan Imperialism*[21], which is due to appear in the autumn,

[20] From the date of the letter, this must be *The Crisis of the Modern World*.

[21] `https://www.amazon.com/Pagan-Imperialism-Julius-Evola/dp/0999`

will be liable to interest me more. It is in the same vein of the book I just wrote; I suppose that it is you who spoke to him about it, because I never wrote to anyone else in Italy since I began to prepare it. That is of no importance, since I have already announced it to many other people. I expedited the manuscript to the publisher last week. I am not sorry that this has been completed because until that point, I was unable to take any rest.

It is not Evola, but Reghini, who told me that his attitude toward Catholicism had changed recently. I believe that I explained myself poorly in my last letter, or that perhaps I wrote one name for the other due to a distraction. It is moreover possible, according to what you say, that the same thing is true for both of them. In any case, if you can have any influence on Evola, that would be very felicitous. I believe him to be intelligent, but filled with prejudices of all types. I also think he aspires to a university position and that also can hinder him from many points of view.

Posted on 2012-09-10 by Cologero

* * *

Avery on 2012-09-11 at 01:09 said:

"I also think he aspires to a university position and that also can hinder him from many points of view."

I don't know if that guess is correct, but the warning about the limiting nature of the academic mindset is very real. I wonder how Guenon came to this conclusion about Evola.

Jason-Adam on 2012-09-11 at 01:35 said:

The remark Guenon made about opposition between East & West only being a conflict modernity vs Tradition is one to be meditated on. Guenon believes that all traditional civilisations are similar. But do they still conflict with each other ? traditional Catholic Europe contended with traditional Islam. So is it possible there can be a conflict between East & West even when

both are Traditional ? Evola certainly saw the west and east as being different (actions vs contemplation) which Guenon disagreed with.

Mihai on 2012-09-11 at 09:37 said:

They are similar in essence, but different in form.

So even though they may have "internal" unity, the "external" differences still exist on their own level, sometimes having the aspect of an apparent opposition. It is very normal for different civilizations and traditions to be opposed one another, as different persons are opposed one another, otherwise there would be no history and no manifestation.

The symbolism of chess may help here. Even tough both armies are, in essence, similar, in order to exist a game they need to be opposed one another.

10.3.5 Sixth letter

This letter was written shortly after **Guido de Giorgio**'s visit to **Rene Guenon** in Blois.

Curiously, the sniping against the young Evola continues. Notice that Guenon treats de Giorgio as a peer while in his letters to Evola, he is always lecturing. Guenon indicates he and de Giorgio are totally in accord regarding their understanding of Tradition. Knowing this, it is clearly a mistake to ignore our translations of de Giorgio and *a fortiori* to ignorantly criticize them as some have.

The Tunisian tariqa of Sheik Ahmad al-Alawi has great significance for Tradition. Besides de Giorgio, Frithjof Schuon was also initiated there. Guenon himself, as this letter shows, was also in communication with that tariqa.

Note, too, that Guenon contributed to the Catholic periodical Regnabit for two years; these articles eventually were included in his Symbols of Sacred Science. Unfortunately, he was forced out by the circle around Jacques Maritain, with whom Guenon had previously engaged in discussions. That has had deleterious consequences for the recovery of Tradition in the West.

Paris, 1 November 1927

We had learned with pleasure, from your card sent on your arrival at Varazze, that your return trip went quite well; but following your letter, which reached us before our departure from Blois, brought us unfortunately much less good news. However, as you don't speak again of your health in your last letter, we like to believe that it has now been restored.

In spite of everything that I know of Evola, especially from you, I was a little surprised by his refusal to use your article[22]. I ask myself, under these conditions, why he is so insistent that I send him something, because he must certainly think what I would write would also be totally traditional, and consequently, would not satisfy him at all. I see that obviously there is nothing to do with him; also, I am going to write him very gladly in the way that you ask me, all the more reason so that will cut short (at least I think so) a new insistence of his part and will give me a decisive reason to not collaborate in his journal. Besides, I owe him a response, having received from him, about a month ago, a letter in which he asked me for some information on a point which I believe that he had already spoken to you about. I am going to enclose my letter with this one, while asking you to then send it to him from there. I apologize for being unable to stamp it, not having any Italian stamps at my disposal.

I would be happy to read your article if Evola returned it to you and if you want to send it to me; but I am sure in advance that I would be completely in accord with you.

What is the Latin text for which Reghini's translation seems doubtful to you?

I am curious to know what Evola might say about Milarepa; he will certainly be scandalized by the totally inferior place that is given to magic, however well it suits him in reality.

I do not know at all Ashtavakra's poem[23] that you mention. If you

[22] For Ur.

[23] Ashtavakra Gita

would like, as you tell me, to send me the translation that you have, although it is rather an adaptation, that will interest me and will give me at least an idea of what the poem is about.

Here is the address you asked about: [24]

The booklet that [Gustave-Henri] Jossot sent me hardly contains anything of interest except the summary of some interviews with Kheireddine and an outline on the doctrine of the Alouites to which he is now associated as I told you. It seems that this brotherhood has been expanding; I just learned that it has a zawiya[25] in Paris, on Blvd St Germain, close to here. That makes me fear that it may become too open and deviate just like so many others. It also appears that it is working, in Algeria, to promote a rapprochement between Christians and Muslims, which is definitely very laudable, but will these efforts lead to an appreciable result?

The journal Parise alluded to is Regnabit. I actually collaborated in it regularly from August 1925 until May 1927, and I had always forgotten to tell you about it. But see how history is told: this journal is as little directed by the Jesuits as they did everything they could to prevent it from appearing. Moreover, I had to end this collaboration following certain machinations which had their origins in [Jacques] Maritain's entourage. It would take too long to tell you about it and moreover rather less interesting au fond. I intend to take up again someday the questions of symbolism that I had begun to treat in that journal in order to create a book out of it; but when will I get to it?

I finished correcting the proofs of the Crisis of the Modern World. I think that it will appear around mid-November.

Posted on 2012-09-17 by Cologero

[24] G. provides the Tunisian address of Eugene Taillard, who was affiliated with the tariqa of Sheik Ahmad al-Alawi.

[25] Islamic religious school.

* * *

Graham on 2012-09-17 at 21:49 said:

" … without forgetting the little piece of perfectly gratuitous sarcasm …"

His opinion of Evola has been consistent low over the course of this correspondance. But this was during the 20s. Do we know if it changed during the 30s and 40s, and if so, for what reason, or reasons?

Cologero on 2012-09-17 at 22:23 said:

We have documented much of this already. Guenon gave a generally positive review of "Revolt against the modern World" after its publication. After the 1920s, there was limited contact between Evola and Guenon aside from exchanging books or articles. Evola translated Guenon's works in the 30s. Correspondence resumed after Evola's recuperation; we have made several of those letters available. Again, there was some disagreement between them, but relations were cordial.

10.3.6 Seventh letter

A few quick points about this letter. Masson-Oursel was mentioned in Letter III[26]. Apparently he did an about-face and severely criticizes Guenon. Guenon's response is instructive; it shows how to deal with criticism.

Guenon and de Giorgio clearly have a wide range of interests. The topic of Virgil is interesting, since Guenon indicates there is deeper meaning to him. Although Guenon never did write about Virgil, De Giorgio did through his ideas of the two Romes and the influence of Dante. I don't know which book by Wallace he is referring to.

At this early date, we can see that De Giorgio is pushing Guenon into the topic of Buddhism. Regarding the Sufi group in question, please see the comment by Saladin below.

It is curious that Guenon would not attend a tariqa that accommodated Europeans. So much for tying him to European

[26] https://gornahoor.net/?p=4739

racism or white nationalism. He claims their presence would distort the teachings. We see something similar today with all the Tibetan Buddhist centers in the West, in which the tenets of Buddhism are distorted if not ignored altogether.

Paris, 31 December 1927

I received your two letters and I had wanted to respond to them sooner; but I have less and less free time, so that I've had to postpone until now, all the more reason that I intend to write you at length. I believe that, even today, I am going to be obliged to respond only to part of what you tell me and to put off the rest until another time.

First of all, Evola wrote to me twice recently and, according to what you tell me, I see what he tells me is pretty much the same that he wrote to you. I ask myself what can be that "action" that he counts on to lead with his journal and book, not only in Italy but also in neighboring countries; we will certainly see in the end.

He also sent me an article titled "Anti-philosophical Fascism and Mediterranean Tradition" that he published in the "Critica Fascista"; perhaps you have seen it. There are some correct things, especially in the first part, but then his "anti-Christianity" reappears so that the editors of the journal had to add a note making some reservations on this point. On the other hand, I do not see very clearly what he means by the "Mediterranean Tradition", and I fear that, in the idea that he makes of it, there was a certain element of fantasy. I haven't had the time to respond to him. It is necessary all the same that I do so one of these days. As to the question of the collaboration with "Ur", I think just like you, so I am no more inclined than you to accept the limits that he wants to impose on us. Moreover, as he sees "polemics" in those things where my intention was quite otherwise, I don't know what I could do in order to remove those limits, which correspond only to a more questionable evaluation.

In the last number of *Voile d'Isis*, there is a short note on "Ur", in which it is said that that journal is dedicated to the study of psychology!

I don't know who wrote that, but it is certainly someone who has not read a single one of its articles. It is likely that the expression "science of the I" led to that misunderstanding. If Evola saw that, he must not have been very satisfied.

Two or three days ago, I received a card from Reghini who had not given me any sign of life for close to a year. He told me that he is going to write me before long and that he will explain the reasons for his silence.

My new book arrived two weeks ago, although it was due to appear in November. It would have been quite astonishing had the printer not been so late, because that is their habit. Also it was decided to publish the volume in January after the holidays because this period of gift giving is totally unfavorable.

We saw Hacking recently and we told him that you were in Blois for vacation. He regretted that you could not stop by Paris because he would have been very happy to see you again.

Masson-Oursel gave in the "Revue Critique" (I do not know too much about that publication, having received only a clipping) a short review of the *King of the World* that I will have to quote it literally for you since it is worth the trouble:

> Leibniz loved to say that there is gold in the manure of scholasticism; he probably finds in it — even among the alchemists — that universal symbolic that the Gnostics, Hindus, Chinese, Kabbalists had advocated. Unfortunately, R. Guenon does not try to extract that gold; only criticism could claim that. He takes everything in good faith, provided that it is a traditional fact and he does not doubt that everything corresponds to everything; by that he proves himself to be in the line of the symbolists. He possesses the information but he accepts it does not matter what. Criticism would be to his eyes a poor enterprise which would discredit the seeker and be superfluous for an author who believes he has the metaphysical truth! We know him enough by his other works.

> What he takes for strength and lucidity, to our eyes impairs the value of too extensive knowledge. We are frightened that in a hundred small tidy pages, he claims to reveal the ultimate knowledge on the swastika, Aum and Manu, the luz and the Shekinah, the Graal, the Mages, and the Old Man of the Mountain, and enigmas without number. Even if he divines something correct here or there, what does the result matter without demonstration? And the proof that there is only one symbolic among the diversity of religions and philosophies?

What do you say about that? What is most stupefying is that he assured me a few months ago that he was coming around more and more to my point of view! It seems that he is on the contrary further from it than ever; he is obviously incapable of understanding. Nothing counts for him outside of "criticism" and analysis, that is, what I consider precisely as non-existent. He imagines, like all his colleagues, that volumes of heavy erudition are necessary to treat the least point of detail. If I had believed it useful to answer him, I would have been able to draw his attention that I am quite far from accepting no matter what information as he claims, since I refuse to hold the least account of that which comes from official orientalists. But that would have been perfectly useless. One cannot change the mentality of those people, and the best thing is to continue on one's way without worrying about what they say or think.

I haven't had the chance to take up Virgil for quite a while; it is certain that things are found in him that it is rather difficult to understand now, but I am convinced that, if one had the time, it would be useful to do some research into the point of view that interests us. In any case, the few interpretations that you indicate to me seem totally justified.

I was not able to find in the passages that you point out to me in P. Wallace's book, because I loaned it to someone who hasn't returned it to me yet. Thus, I will have to look again a little later and then I will speak to you about it again. For the reflection that I made to you another time

on this subject and what you tell me, what you formulate corresponds actually very well to what I had meant.

I spoke to Bacot about the German translation of the *Songs of Milarepa*. He knows it, but, not knowing German very well, he was unable to examine it too closely to see what it precisely meant. Moreover, it appears to be very incomplete. The passages that you cite for me do not seem very clear and it was lacking any notes to explain them; but is the translator capable of doing it? You are certainly correct re the central artery, which can only be *sushumna* and it is more than probable that the "wind" is *prana*. I ask myself even if, where it is a question of the "five winds", there would have been a connection to make with the five *vayus* which are the modalities of *prana*. The meanings of mudra are certainly what you indicate. As to Dharmadhatu, literally "seed of the Law", I know it is a designation of Buddha, but that does not clarify at all the meaning of the phrase where this word is found. You know that Vajra means at once "lightning" and "diamond"; there would be a lot of research to do regarding that.

I haven't yet had the time to look for the text in the *Bhagavad Gita*. I take note of the passage which you spoke to me about and will try to verify it one of these days.

Thanks in advance for the Vedantic poem *Ashtavakra Gita* that you promised to send me; I think that you will not be too much in a hurry for me to return it to you, because at this moment I can't even read what I have. Thanks also for the information you give me on the topic of the texts in its translation into prose; but it will be difficult for me to find that because I never go into any bookstores.

The meaning of *sakshi* is "witness" or "observer"; I think that *sakshipurusha* must be taken as an equivalent of the "two birds in the tree", one who "looks without eating", and who is actually the personality, while the other, who eats (that is, who is engaged in actions and its consequences), is jivatma or the individuality. The translation of the shloka

couplet in the poem in question seems to be exact at first glance. When I have a moment, I will look again more closely.

The letter Kha symbolizes the atmosphere and even the sky, rather than air as an element. The designation of "triform" Agni can have several meanings; it is possible that, in the case here, it is related to the celestial fire, to the terrestrial fire and the vital fire. The three colours that you mention are more customarily related to the *gunas* than to the elements: *sattwa*, white: *rajas*, red (it is even the meaning proper to the root rauf); *tamas*, black (obscurity). For the 0 between 3 and 2 (in place of unity), what you say appears to me totally correct, or in any case very plausible as the interpretation. As to the passages of the commentary indicating the definition of the mukti following different schools, it is still a thing that I have to put off to the next time, not wanting to give you a translation that would risk being inexact.

I am happy that Taillard responded to you and that he was able to send you a photograph of Kheireddine. If you happen to make a copy as you hope, I would be very happy to have it. A peculiar thing, the same day that I received your letter, I got one from Jossot who also spoke to me about Kheireddine. He says that he is dead even though he arranged to instruct him; but I don't really know if Jossot would be able to profit much from his teachings. You will be very kind to tell me if you get a new response from Tallard. The Sheik of which he spoke to you is certainly Sheik Mostafa ben Alioua, the head of the Alawis. I have a summary of the teachings from that school, written by the Sheik Si Mohammed El Aïd's secretary, with a French translation made by Taillard, and a copy of which I could send you if that interests you. I believe you said that the Alawis now have a center in Paris, intended exclusively for Arabs and Kabyles. Although they have tried to put me in touch with than, I have not had the time for it, though it is really close to here. I will certainly have to go see it, because it would be more interesting than the branch which is being formed and into which Europeans will be admitted, as it

seems to me you also said. The introduction of Western elements is too easily a cause for deviation.

Excuse my incomplete response; I will try to not wait so long to write to you.

I think that you are not in the mountains at the time of cold weather; haven't you suffered too much from it?

P.S. I almost forgot to thank you for your gracious gift of stamps.

> Update 24 September 2022.
>
> H/T Saladin on 2012-09-25 at 21:04 said:
>
> Dear Cologero,
>
> The Alawi order mentioned by Guenon in the letter is not the same as the Alwai sect to which Assad family of Syria belongs. The former is a Sufi order whereas the latter is sect (one which many muslims believe is heretical) mainly predominant in western Asia (Syria, Kurdistan, etc.) Here is a link for the sufi order: `https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Ahmad_al-Alawi`
>
> This is a link for the sect: `https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Alawi`

Posted on 2012-09-24 by Cologero

* * *

`Avery on 2012-09-25 at 01:27 said:`

"Nothing counts for him outside of 'criticism' and analysis, that is, what I consider precisely as non-existent; he imagines, like all his colleagues, that volumes of heavy erudition are necessary to treat the least point of detail. "

A damning indictment of the cult-crit impulse then and now, which one has to keep in mind whenever your reading passes from the metaphysical world into the modern academic one.

`Saladin on 2012-09-25 at 21:04 said:`

Dear Cologero,

The Alawi order mentioned by Guenon in the letter is not the same as the Alwai sect to which Assad family of Syria belongs. The former is a Sufi order whereas the latter is sect (one which many muslims believe is heretical) mainly predominant in western Asia (Syria, Kurdistan, etc.) Here is a link for the sufi order: `http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Ahmad_al-Alawi`

This is a link for the sect: `https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Alawi`

`Cologero on 2012-09-25 at 22:03 said:`

Thanks, Saladin, for pointing that out. I'll make the correction.

`Cologero on 2012-09-26 at 00:17 said:`

Someone recommended to me the following authors as sources for an understanding of Virgil. Since I don't know that he wants his name to appear here, I shall leave it as anonymous.

A short addition on the commentators of Virgil which merit being read for highlighting the intentions of the Latin poet:

It is worth the effort to study the alchemical exegesis proposed by Petrus Bonus (XV century), Bracesco (XVI), d'Espagnet (XVII), Thomas Vaughan (XVII), Maïer (XVII), dei Conti (XVII), Pernety (XVIII), and more recently, by d'Hooghvorst (XX).

10.3.7 Eighth Letter

This letter was written by **Rene Guenon** to **Guido de Giorgio** shortly after the death of Guenon's wife. After some personal reflections, Guenon returns to some of the common themes in earlier letters: the Sufis in Tunisia, the *Ashtavakra Gita*, and, of course, some gossip about **Julius Evola**. We see the mutual interest of the two men in **Dante**. We also see that Guenon and de Giorgio were in complete agreements on esoteric topics, even without consulting with each other before hand. This, I hope, demonstrates to everyone the importance of understanding sound principles; once so understood, the rest just follows. As Guenon suggests, "it is not the result of chance." Obviously, he would have no sympathy for the "Infinite Monkey Theorem."

The book that Guenon referred to is most likely *Crisis in the Modern World*, which had just been published in 1927.

Blois, 6 April 1928

I am embarrassed to be so late with you; I had wanted to thank you again sooner for the expression of sympathy that you gave me in these sad circumstances, but I didn't have the energy to write to anyone for a long time. Your last letter arrived in Paris, and I had wanted to respond right away, but I couldn't find even a few minutes, all my time was taken by lessons and other less interesting, although necessary, tasks. I'm benefitting from the few days that we spent here to finally write to you; we were obliged to come to Blois on business, otherwise, we would probably not have decided to leave Paris at this time.

I was going to thank you for your parcel that I received with great pleasure when the misfortune happened, and that in the most sudden and least expected way: a few days of illness at most, but an illness against which they can do nothing, cerebral-spinal meningitis. There was then a veritable epidemic in Paris: some people were taken in a few hours! Since then, my health hasn't been very good, and there is nothing astonishing about that after such a hard blow. However, I needed to take up again almost right away some forced tasks, but there is a little else that I was able to do up until now.

We will return to Paris at the end of next week, that is, the 13th or 14th of April; perhaps it would be better for you to wait until then to send me Taillard's letter which you told me about and which will surely interest me. On my return to Paris, I will have to look again for the summary of the doctrine of the Alawis that he translated, in order to send you a copy of it as I had promised you.

All the same, one of these days I will have to write to Evola whose several letters I have always left without response. As of now, I have not received his *Pagan Imperialism*, although he told me that he would send it to me some time ago. Perhaps he will do it after I write him. In any case,

if I receive nothing, I will tell you, and then you will be able to lend me your copy as you suggested.

I was able to read the *Ashtavakra Gita* a little quickly; it seems quite good to me. Even in this adaptation which is surely imperfect (all the more so that the preface, as I remember, does not show much comprehension by its author); I will have to resume it again more attentively when I have a little free time.

I received the first number of the second year of *Ur*; has another one appeared since? I did not notice, on the whole, a very big change from the first year, except that those histories of the "magical chain" seem to take on more and more importance, and also the "Science of the I" disappeared from the title. Is it the "psychological" interpretation which I had told you about that influenced Evola to suppress that expression, which he nevertheless seemed to be attached to? I considered all the reflections that you made in one of your letters from the beginning of January to be spot on, regarding the subject of the preceding issue. When I write to Evola, you can be sure that I would take account of what you said to me then, for I am convinced that you are totally correct.

Were you able to see the new work on Dante that you had spoken to me about? If yes, you will be quite kind, some time, to tell me a little about what it is and of what type of symbolism is in it.

I carried out, some time ago, the favour which you asked me to do for Bossard; I was going to forget to tell you and to send you the note, postmarked on the payment date.

I was happy to see that you are completely in agreement with everything that I wrote in my last book[27]; furthermore, the contrary would have really astonished me. The coincidences that you pointed out to me with the things that you yourself had written earlier are actually very remarkable; these agreements are certainly not the result of chance (besides which, I don't believe at all).

[27] Most likely *Crisis in the Modern World*, published in 1927.

I hope that I will have one day the time to take up all your recent letters and respond at least to the most important of the diverse questions that you pose.

I have at this moment a very disagreeable task: it is the correction of the English translation of *Man and his Becoming*; that translation was horribly done, there are some mistranslations on every page. Furthermore, instead of sending me the manuscript as I had counted on, they typeset it and only sent me the proofs, with the result that the editors were very unhappy when I wrote them that there were many changes to make; that is nevertheless not my fault if they did something silly.

I like to believe that your health is not too bad now and that you haven't had another attack since your last letter.

Posted on 2012-10-08 by Cologero

* * *

`Cologero on 2012-10-09 at 12:28 said:`

An accessible rendition of the Ashtavakra Gita is "A Duet of One" by Ramesh S. Balsekar, a follower of Nisargadatta. His commentary is antinomian, even somewhat Spinozist.

10.4 From Evola to Eliade

10.4.1 First Letter

> **Julius Evola** first met the young **Mircea Eliade** during a trip to Bucharest to meet Corneliu Codreanu[28]. Evola refers to that meeting decades later in his spiritual autobiography, *The Cinnabar Path*. By that time, Eliade had become a widely respected historian of religions in the West and kept his early affiliations a secret.

[28] `https://gornahoor.net/?p=4303`

Henceforth, Eliade cut off contact with Evola, which they had maintained sporadically until the 1960s.

Nevertheless, Eliade kept up with all of Evola's (and Guenon's) writings as they were published. We translated Eliade's review of Revolt against the Modern World[29].

In this letter Evola makes the rather surprising admission that he had been considering moving permanently to India to undergo some spiritual practice, believing he had accomplished all he could in the West. Evola brings up an important point which should be heeded by all. The most authentic centers in India are remote, difficult to find, and closed to foreigners. India today is replete with spiritual frauds and charlatans which makes it extremely difficult for Westerners to encounter a fully traditional teaching; besides, they are prone to be "gamed", much like Margaret Mead. Those Hindus who come to the West[30] are often suspect.

28 May 1930

Rome

I received your letter. I remember you perfectly. One of your friends here in Rome had already told me that you had gone to India in November 1928 .

I would very much like to know what you found there in the natural order of things that are of interest to us: that of practice, more than that of doctrine or metaphysics.

I was thinking, and am still thinking (since I am at the point of having finished what I had attempted to do in the West) of going to India to stay there. One of my correspondents convinced me that it would not be worth the trouble, unless I go to Kashmir or Tibet and I have a way to

[29] https://gornahoor.net/?p=4303

[30] http://www.religioperennis.org/documents/rcoomaraswy/HINDU.PDF

introduce myself into some of the rarest centers that still conserve the Tradition but are excessively suspicious of any foreigners.

Nevertheless, I would be grateful if you could inform me of what you found in addition, with the understanding not from the cultural or metaphysical point of view.

I am sending you:

- One of the last existing copies of the complete *Ur* collection from 1928.
- The complete *Krur* collection from 1929.
- My book on Tantra Man as power

My books that have appeared since then are:

- *Pagan Imperialism*
- *Theory of the Absolute Individual*
- *Phenomenology of the Absolute Individual*

The last two constitute the systematic and definitive exposition of my doctrine. Currently, I am editor of "La Torre", two issues of which I include. I didn't edit any journals before *Ur*.

Aside from what you received, there is only the Ur collection of 1927 which is out of print. If you want, I can let you know if there is anyone who can sell it and at what price.

If professor Dasgupta[31], with whom you stayed January to September 1930, is the author of the books on Hindu philosophy, please ask him if Sir Douglas Ainslie[32], whom he knows very well and is my friend, remembered to write to him—as he had promised me—so that he has his

[31] https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Surendranath_Dasgupta

[32] https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Douglas_Ainslie

publisher send me the two volumes that have already appeared, which I could talk about in Italy or Germany.

Posted on 2012-09-03 by Cologero

* * *

cosmodromium on 2012-09-03 at 09:32 said:

Interesting to read Dasgupta was also familiar with Evola.

Thank You.

Mihai on 2012-09-04 at 05:51 said:

I agree with Evola.

Besides, I really believe that if one were to practice a Hindu path, it would be impossible to do so without actually living, permanently, in India.

Although the possibility of actually coming into contact with an authentic spiritual center are very dim, while the possibility for frauds is immense, especially given the guilability of modern westerners.

The chances were scant in the 1930s. Imagine how much so they are today.

Avery on 2012-09-04 at 11:43 said:

I also agree with Evola. Recently we have seen the chief editor of a certain publishing company move to India to live with the Gaudiya Vaishnavas. If that group can perform a Guenonian initiation they are doing a funny job showing it.

Cologero on 2012-09-04 at 12:53 said:

One likely reason, Avery, is that the Gaudiya Vaishnava is open to foreigners and not restricted to Indians of a specific caste.

fraktal on 2013-04-01 at 18:15 said:

Try to PODCAST this article :

The difficult encounter in Rome. Mircea Eliade's post-war relation with Julius Evola–new letters and data–

because we couldn' t … .

Mark Citadel on 2015-04-13 at 17:31 said:

I'm sure I'm not the only one who would kill for a transcript of Evola and Codreanu's discussion together.The ascetic meets the hero. Unfortunately, I highly doubt one was taken. Lost to the passage of history now, since both men are dead.

`Cologero on 2015-04-14 at 21:48 said:`

While not exactly a transcript, Evola wrote about his meeting with Codreanu in an article published in La Vita Italiana in 1938. Don't know if there is much interest in it (and I believe variations of it are available online).

You may also be interested in Evola's impressions of *José Antonio Primo de Rivera*[33]. Evola recognizes the spiritual impulse common to both Codreanu and Primo de Rivera, while rejecting it in his own case.

`Mark Citadel on 2015-04-16 at 17:50 said:`

I'll be sure to check that out! Codreanu fascinates me, and I'm just starting to familiarize myself with Primo De Rivera.

Yes, Evola's article on the meeting was called 'The Tragedy of Romania's Iron Guard' or something to that effect. In it he speaks very highly of the Capitanul, who seems to have spellbound him, as he did a Hungarian Jewish historian whom I can't remember the name of, but who met Codreanu as a young boy. It seems fair to call the man a Reactionary martyr. Tragic arc of struggle for unflinching principles.

10.4.2 Second letter

> **Julius Evola** was reestablishing his relationship with **Mircea Eliade** after the war and his own health and legal problems. It is clear that Evola had been keeping up with Eliade's published works. Knowing Eliade's true interests and background, Evola questions Eliade's failure to quote Rene Guenon, and, by implication, his own work. Beside the obvious desire to avoid professional suicide, Eliade intended his works to be scientific, in the objective sense of being free of political or religious partisanship. It is curious that Evola had never read Georges Dumezil before and it seems to have had little influence on his later work. That is unfortunate.

[33] `http://www.gornahoor.net/?page_id=1202`

15 Dec 1951

Enough time has passed since I received your last letter and our relation was reestablished after the war. In this period I often heard talk about you and your activity. Naturally I read, with interest, the works that you courteously sent me and I did not miss notifying my friends who could be interested in them and probably they have also written to you.

Recently a newly revised and expanded edition of my *Revolt against the Modern World* appeared and I think it was mentioned in it your *Treatise on the History of Religions*[34]. But about this, and I say it a little tongue in cheek, one should employ some *Vergeltungen*[35]. The fact is striking that your works are so overly concerned to not mention any author who does not strictly belong to the official university literature; in your works, e.g., that lovable good man Pettazzoni[36] is abundantly cited, while not a single word is found about Guenon, and not even other authors whose ideas are much closer to those that permit you to certainly orient yourself in the material that you write about. It stands to reason that this is something that concerns only you, but it would be the chance to ask yourself if, all things considered, if imposing these "academic" limitations is a game that is worth the candle. I hope that you will not resent these friendly observations.

I've been told that some difficulties arose for Enaudi[37] about your translations due to a ridiculous communist veto. Is it true? If so, will these translations be sold again? (I believe they are the *Treatise* and *Yoga*.) It is possible that in this case I can be useful, even if you are already arranging with sufficiently effective relations, like those around Giuseppe Tucci and over Pettazzoni's objection.

[34] Not true.

[35] Revenge.

[36] Italian professor of religion.

[37] The Italian publisher.

As far as it concerns me, in your letter of last year you were so kind to give me the address of a man of your acquaintance, who, you said, could be useful for marketing the French translations of my books. To tell the truth, I wrote him once, but without receiving a response. Now I would like to make other attempts for the same goal. While some relations were already able to be established with other countries, for France still nothing; Mr. Gallimard had taken himself the initiative to ask Laterza for the rights for two of my books after the war, but I have not heard anything more from him since. I permit myself to ask you, dear sir, if you could and would give me some advice in this regard. I would value especially the translation of Revolt which was already accepted by De Noel), and I wondered if the same publisher of your Treatise could be interested in it. Possibly you could introduce me to Mr. Dumezil, who is one of your friends and must exercise an important role with this publisher. Moreover, I now intend to learn more about the work of this author, whom I have read little, because I've been told that he made some interesting contributions to a line of research in which I myself am particularly interested (warrior initiation).

I've also been told that one of your new books, on Shamanism, was just published; if the publisher is still distributing some samples via post, perhaps you will have the courtesy to provide them with my address. Where is your work on sacred orgies found? I have been gathering some material for an essay on sex magic.

I have returned to Rome for good[38] at my old address. Should you ever come to Italy, I hope that we will be able to meet each other here.

Posted on 2012-12-17 by Cologero

* * *

Avery on 2012-12-18 at 18:25 said:

[38] After his convalescence and brief imprisonment.

Guenon has some amusing things to say about the "academic" in *Traditional Forms & Cosmic Cycles*. Unfortunately he does not explicitly explain the main problem with modern humanities studies: writers obsess over making their subject a product of their circumstances, and refuse to admit the influence of anything that could stand above history. In order to fit into that model, Eliade thus made a devilish parody of the Traditionalist thesis, castrating the work of Guenon and Evola by turning it into a psychiatric complex.

Mihai on 2012-12-19 at 04:17 said:

Actually, Eliade stood his position quite well inside the academic community, to the extent that he could be considered a trojan horse. Though he never directly admitted a supra-human origin of Tradition (obviously), he did quite a nice job in proving that religion is irreducible to factors such as sociology and psychology- see the opening part of his Traité d'histoire des religions.

His work suffered an obvious decline in quality after he became involved with the University of Chicago, but his works published until then offer a great many insights and introductory keys of understanding to various traditional cosmologies, symbols and rites.

The depth of his work is, of course, limited because of the academical environment, but it is no "devilish parody"

Mihai on 2012-12-19 at 04:18 said:

By the way, Guenon's review from TFACC is by no means negative (though, true, it isn't very enthusiastic either).

Ea Lord of the Deeps on 2013-09-29 at 19:35 said:

Evola actually read and used Dumezil original thesis source is in this book:

http://edicionesnuevarepublica.wordpress.com/2010/01/03/%C2%ABel-misterio-hiperboreo-escritos-sobre-los-indoeuropeos-1934-1970%C2%BB/

10.4.3 Third Letter

This letter was written at the end of 1951, the year of Guenon's death. It is clear that the several letters between Evola and Guenon in the preceding months had changed little in the disagreements between them.

At the beginning of the letter, Evola is referring to Eliade's response to Evola's previous question about Eliade's lack of references to Evola or Guenon in his books. At his post at the Sorbonne, Eliade seems to be hiding his past association with esoterism and right wing movements. Evola is concerned about the negative psychic forces in this choice, but assumes Eliade is still involved in some groups that would prevent that. In contrast, Evola was invited to teach courses on race at two Italian universities, although Evola did not like academic life. If Eliade was truly acting as a Trojan horse to inject certain ideas into Academia, its effects have been nil.

After 25 years, we see Evola is still attached to his system of Absolute Idealism. That system is not fully compatible with Guenon's metaphysical system derived from the Vedanta and other Traditional sources. Those differences affect their respective worldviews in significant ways. Both Evola and Guenon want to "move beyond" philosophy; for Guenon, that means the Intellect, but for Evola, that is the Will. I should remind readers that 20 years earlier, the young Eliade had written an unpublished commentary on Evola's philosophical system of Absolute Idealism.

Evola's closing to the letter is interesting and out of character. Perhaps it was related to the time of year the letter was written … the Unconquerned Sun was celebrated on Christmas Day.

31 Dec 1951

Many thanks for your courteous letter and thanks also for having arranged the sending of your new book [*Shamanism*], that I will read with particular interest. Then I will tell you what are the possibilities at Laterza [a publisher]; it stands to reason that I will do my best to be useful.

Regarding your clarifications about your relations with academic "masonry", I find them somewhat satisfactory. It would therefore be less a

question about methodology than pure tactic, and there would be nothing to say against the attempt to introduce any Trojan horse into the university citadel. The important thing would be to not let yourself take part, in any way, in a deception, because a sort of "psychic current" meets in academic circles, with the possibility of a subtle deforming and contaminating influence. But I think that, both as the interior foundation, and through your probable relations with circles qualified in a different way, you can defend yourself from this danger.

As to "methodology", you well know that I seek to follow a middle way since, differently from most "esoterists", I am also concerned to produce research satisfactory from the "scientific" point of view. What you undertake in the fields of the science of religions and mythology, I undertook many years ago, but in the field of academic philosophy that was then absolute idealism. The direction was the same: to show that the most important problems of this philosophy cannot be resolved, if it does not go beyond "philosophy" *tout court*. But after this contribution, expressed in three books (I recently revised one, the *Theory of the Absolute Individual*, and I think it useful for have it republished as an account of it), I had enough of it. I don't know the environment of the Sorbonne. As it concerns Italy, at least until recently it was not necessary to disguise oneself too much, since I myself had received the assignment to teach some courses in the universities of Milan and Florence. But my conclusion was that the game is not worth the candle; and the repulsion for the types and the cabals of the university world is for me physiological.

Since you mention Mr. Guenon in particular, I think that a useful action would consist in developing certain aspects of his doctrine that suffer from a fundamentally arbitrary dogmatism since, all things considered, the mixing of traditional data with individual points of view was inevitable even in his case. So much more in France, but also in Italy, groups were formed that follow the master as though the "head of the class", redoubling the dogmatic certainty and claiming to be the only

ones to administer "orthodoxy"; that thing is somewhat tiresome and can only be harmful to what is best in Guenon.

I am very obligated to you for your intention to help me get some of my books published in French. With Gallimard and De Noel the thing is only interrupted; as for the latter publisher, the person who mediated and had already begun the translation of *Revolt* has vanished. Regarding the former, after the attempt he made at Leterza, no one any longer knows what happened and although I had written myself, they gave no response. In any case, I think that Payot has some book series in which the two books you mention (*Revolt against the Modern World* and *Doctrine of Awakening*) would fit in rather well, since they would be among the works that are certainly no more "scientific" than mine. The important thing is that they do not encounter prejudices of principle; these, moreover, could be reduced through the fact that the German and English translations appeared in very "respectable" publishers. In any case, I think that the best thing is to wait for your return to Paris, before making any attempts and before I send the books. Consequently, I ask you to write me a few words when you return to Paris.

It pleases me to learn that you will come again to Italy. Since I would not want to lose the opportunity for a meeting, I ask you to alert me when your plans are definitive, so I can adjust my schedule, since it is possible that I will leave Rome in the spring for a certain period.

With my best wishes – *in signo solis invicti* – for the new cycle, very cordially yours …

Posted on 2012-10-01 by Cologero

* * *

Avery on 2012-10-01 at 11:20 said:

FWIW:

Doctrine of Awakening was published in 1948 by the orientalist publisher "Luzac & Co." in London.

Revolt was first published in German by the mainstream house Deutsche Verlags-Anstalt of Stuttgart in 1935.

Revolt against the Modern World was first published in English by IT.

Doctrine has never been published in German: `http://www.oocities.org/capitolhill/6890/evolabib.html`.

`cosmodromium on 2012-10-01 at 11:41 said:`

Excellent! Thank You. My Bollingen English trans. of Eliade's YOGA (1958, originally 1954 in French) includes Evola in the index with 5 entries, all footnotes, to Evola's Doctrine of Awakening; Yoga of Power; and The Hermetic Tradition. With the exception of the first, the notes are concentrated in Eliade's chapter on Tantra.

`Izak on 2012-10-02 at 18:23 said:`

Thanks for the translation.

Evola's point about wanting to convey tradition through a means which is valid from the aspect of the "sciences" is pretty interesting.

I don't know a lick of Italian, but I'm assuming that the language distinguishes between "sciences" (as just general knowledge disciplines) and "natural sciences" the same way that German does, which is why Evola then goes on to discuss his philosophy.

But does Evola's claim mean that he is still deeply attached to his brand of magical idealism, or that he just agrees with its very basic purpose, from a more superficial stance?

It seems to me that the chief distinction here is that Evola wants to find a way to translate the language of tradition into a more contemporary language of disciplined discourse, so the real question is one more of language than content.

`Cologero on 2012-10-02 at 19:19 said:`

It's possible to a certain extent, Izak. Yes, by "scientific", he means in the university sense of an organized body of objective knowledge. That is how he identifies Eliade's approach, although he knows Eliade is holding back. Obviously, Evola's system is not strictly speaking mere philosophy, because it requires a certain spiritual attainment to understand. Keep in mind, too, as we have documented previously, the young Eliade wrote a never-published commentary on Evola's magical idealism.

It is also the case that Evola developed his philosophical system before his encounter with Guenon and tradition. Italy was the center of philosophical idealism at the time and Evola had done an intense study of German and Italian idealism. Now I don't know what the original system was because Evola had revised it for later publications. I have the final edition which does, indeed, contain references to more traditional persons who are not typically found in

philosophical treatises. So perhaps, over time, he sought to create a Western philosophical system compatible with Traditional metaphysics.

I agree that is something that needs to be done. I could point out that from a personal point of view, based on my background and education, I am actually closer to Evola's approach. Guenon's metaphysics often seems alien; however, it is necessary to meditate on it to make it come alive.

If there is sufficient interest, I will try to extract relevant passages from Evola's philosophical works for translation. As you can imagine, that is not a trivial task. In the meantime, our translation and commentaries on his The Individual and the Becoming of the World will provide an entry point into his thought.

Izak on 2012-10-02 at 20:43 said:

Yes, if you're up for the challenge of translating Evola's more idealist-oriented stuff, that would be great!

My only exposure to his "idealist" period has been in his autobiography, and in a discussion by the scholar Paul Furlong (Avery reviewed that book over at Amerika.org, so I read it shortly afterward). Furlong's depiction of Evola's early days is interesting, and he admirably understands both idealistic philosophy as a whole and Evola's relationship to Gentile and Croce. But he also makes some claims/insinuations which I'm not terribly sure about.

I also wonder about the degree to which his theory of the "absolute individual" does permeate his later work, and the exact moment at which it begins to break off, if ever. Both The Hermetic Tradition and The Yoga of Power do both seem fairly close to what little I know of his school-philosophy days, that is if his ideas have been portrayed accurately in the scholarship.

In the meantime, I'll check out The Individual and the Becoming of the World.

Cologero on 2012-10-02 at 20:57 said:

In the Gornahoor Forum, Graham has made available our commentaries on IABW. If you do a search here on the Individual and the Becoming of the World, you can find most of it translated. I don't know if the Rune Guild is still selling the pdf version of it.

Although I assert the right to offer my own commentaries, unlike "scholars", I try to also provide translations. That way readers can judge for themselves.

The books you mentioned were certainly early works. As you see from this letter, as late as 1951, after years of correspondence with Guenon, he still regarded absolute idealism as fundamental to his world view. Shortly before his death, he republished the texts in 1973 after extensive revisions. So, the inference must be that he still considered it valid. The only book that Evola did renounce was "Pagan Imperialism".

Izak on 2012-10-02 at 22:32 said:

Yes, and I've been wondering for a while just what his revisions are like, especially considering that The Yoga of Power was originally called Man as Power, so even the titles have different implications (and I'll add that upon your recommendation, I've read Woodroffe's The World As Power, so I at least have that point of reference).

If mainstream academics like the guy I mentioned were really worth their salt, they would provide translated editions of these books with commentaries containing extensive footnotes, maybe describing the differences between the first edition and later editions, or pointing out factual errors, providing exegetical notes, noting manuscript changes, or whatever else might be relevant. After all, they're getting paid to do this stuff! But I guess they are put in a strange political position, where they must assume no prior knowledge of his work, and to posture themselves as people who are there to put Evola to rest once and for all, often fairly clumsily, for the ideologically innocent academic community of moral do-gooders. This is all quite funny to me, because in the last year, there've been more scholarly attempts in English to grapple with his work than there ever have been before.

But that guy's view and yours seem to be the same, which is that Evola didn't change too much from his original philosophical position. And the letter seems to suggest as much, too.

Thanks for the info!

10.5 From Evola to Carl Schmitt

10.5.1 First Letter

> Among the 19,000 pieces of correspondence found in **Carl Schmitt**'s personal library, there were eight letters from Julius Evola over a period of several years. There were none found in the opposite direction. From the letters, it is obvious that Evola was very interested in Schmitt's book on **Donoso Cortes**, whom they both regarded quite highly. As a public service, we have made available Donoso's book, *Essays on Catholicism, Liberalism, and Socialism*[39]. Since it is hardly likely that Evola was interested in Donoso's take on Catholicism, we can assume the other essays are more pertinent. At the very least, they are a counter-balance to the absurd meme floated by the Nouvelle Droite regarding the

[39] `https://www.gornahoor.net/library/CortesEssays.pdf`

intellectual source of liberalism. More likely, Evola and Schmitt were impressed by Donoso's defense of authoritarianism.

The letters were written in German, using the polite form of "you". The translations here derive from an Italian translation of the original. Evola's first letter to Schmitt follows:

15 December 1951

Dear Professor!

I owe your address to Dr. Mohler; therefore, I am able to take the initiative—which I gave been thinking about for some time — *après le déluge*. I have often requested news about you:

primarily, our common friend, Prince Rohan, has assured me that you have at least physically moved beyond the period of the fall. Subsequently, I learned of your controversial "reappearance" and new works. Regarding this, I thank you very much for the booklet "Recht und Raum", that I received hear in Rome.

As far as my own person, things have not always gone the best for me: a war wound prevents me from walking and I can remain seated only for a few hours a day. I returned to Italy in 1948, but I've had to stay in nursing homes, so that I returned to my former home in Rome only last May. Subsequently a strange thing happened: I was ... arrested. At the margins of so-called "neofascism" (MSI — **Movimento Sociale Italiano**) groups were formed that committed some foolish acts (bombings). Since my writings were read in those circles with great frequency and my person was rather highly regarded as a "spiritual father", they wanted to attribute to me the responsibility of a movement of which I knew almost nothing, and they accused me of the alleged defense of "fascist" ideas ("apologist for Fascism"). The story ended last month with my complete innocence; the only consequences were free publicity in my favour and a bad impression for the imposing, farsighted state police.

Apart from this, after my return I took up again unchanged my old activity in the teaching and politico-cultural fields (conservative revolu-

tionary, as Dr. Mohler would say). Nevertheless, the situation here is not very easy and not only because of the Christian-social democracy, but also for the heavy legacy of the so-called "second Fascism" (republican and "social") of the neo-Fascists.

A short time ago Revolt against the Modern World was published in a new and expanded edition. The same for my works of a spiritual and "esoteric" character that had gone out of print and in the meantime other translations were published in English (The Doctrine of Awakening). It is a way of trifling the time.

After having briefly told you about me, I would be happy to know something of you and your projects, since I would give great value to remaining in contact with you. I would also have to ask you one thing: could you possibly procure for me a copy of your new writing on Donoso Cortes? I myself, in fact, am interested in this author and intend to deal with him in an essay — Menschen und Trummer — on which I am currently working.

Well, I offer you my best wishes for the upcoming Holiday.

I remain with old friendship.

P.S. Did something happen to your old house in Dahlem?

I will send you a pamphlet, Orientamenti *Orientations*, which constituted the principle *corpus delicti* body of the crime, evidence of my trial.

Posted on 2012-06-25 by Cologero

10.6 Other letters

10.6.1 Julius Evola and Lourdes

Letter to Fr. Clemente Rebora (May 14, 1949)

I thank you sincerely both for the trouble that you took in coming to visit me and for the concern that your offer of a visit to Lourdes shows me.

About the visit, I don't believe that it makes any sense, not because there are prejudices on my part, but for reasons, let us say, so technical that whoever takes the point of view not only of faith but moreover of knowledge could easily recognize. I will point out that at Lourdes I would have to go to ask, in the state of grace, that the physical disability be removed. Now, I have already told you how little this thing means to me, and even if the illness were more serious, a man worthy of this name should not turn to the supernatural for things of this type.

First of all, the basic premise, which is that of a burning desire for a healing, is lacking. If you have to ask for a favour, it should instead be that of understanding the *meaning* of what happened in the spiritual realm – the thing remains or it does not; furthermore, there is the favour of understanding the reason for my continuing to live. I have already noted that the accident was like an enigmatic answer to my asking – through exposing myself to danger – if my earthly life could come to an end.

In the second place, I must say that among the symbols of Christianity even that of the "Mother of God" is among those that speak the least to me, that are the most strange to me; finally, that all my psychic constitution leaves precious few possibilities to processes that involve emotional and affective factors, starting with those that stand at the base of the very element of "believing" in general. Given these circumstances, at Lourdes what would have to happen is something similar to a mechanical action, completely external, that is barely conceivable in itself – and moreover – how much of the spiritual design that always accompanies every true "miracle". *Being "cured" in such a manner would change nothing in me; the true problem, that is the increase of interior light, would not result.* In my gift, of being absolutely sincere with myself, Father, this is what I must tell you. In every way, for the disposition that your proposal reveals, I am grateful to you.

Sincerely,

J. Evola

> Subsequently Fr. Rivora wrote to Pittoni: A supernatural tenderness for him grows in my heart. He told me of an inner fact necessary for him in the bombardment at Vienna and he added that his ongoing test still remained mysterious to him. I believe instead I notice a decisive and providential act for his soul. He thinks that this morning I wrote to him suggesting that he come to Lourdes with the hospital train ...

Posted on 2009-03-19 by Cologero

10.7 Letter to Palamidessi

Rome, January 20, 1972

Dear Dr. Palamidessi,

I got your letter, for which I thank you.

I already told you that a treatise on initiatic astrology would be an important work and would fill a gap; and it would also be interesting to treat, in accordance with its aim, a typology of inner races with the utilization of the astrological element. In my book, there is only a sketch of it that needs to be adequately developed. A publisher in Germany had encouraged me to dedicate myself to this research, but I had to pass it up. Moreover, it would, above all, be about an *a priori* morphology, not on an empirical base. Because of that, whether pure types currently exist, conformed completely to that fundamental structure, has no importance, and even lacks practical value. So, for example, the defining of the absolute woman and the absolute man, who are almost non-existent empirically, is of great utility for the analysis of those women and men who are such only approximately, and with admixtures (Weininger).

The temperamental knowledge of oneself in the deepest states would be an important possibility offered by such investigations. I don't see, on the other hand, possible connections to that "awakening of the Eu-

ropean race", which you noted. An earlier work, although without utilizing any astrological contributions, could be my friend L. W. Clauss' Rassenseelekunde racial psychology (the study of the soul or the souls of race); I believe that I mentioned him in my book. If you want, you can include me in those figure sketches that you intend to treat, provided that you exclude every exaggeration, as the English would say. One of my accounts of the "absolute individual", for example, would only be humorous.

Unfortunately, I forgot to give you directly, on the occasion of your visit, the book L'Arco e la Clava. We will see how it can be done: either on the next meeting or if the publisher provides the service of sending right to a private home, the postal services particularly for the stamps have become infamous. However, a copy is reserved for you.

Another thing. One of my (female) friends, belonging to my faithful guard-house, having known of your visit and knowing your name, makes my life impossible because she would like to have from you an astrological chart of her character and her "destiny". If, by chance, you have a little time to waste for a little more than summary investigation, the dates are: born February 25, 1945 at 15:20 in Venice.

Cordially yours,

J. Evola

Posted on 2012-04-30 by Cologero

* * *

Angolmois on 2012-04-30 at 01:48 said:

Thanks for this one, it made my day, haha!

Seriously, when reading Evola and Guénon and others of their ilk only from their theoretical writings, one gets easily the impression that they are some kind of mythological heroes who perhaps never even lived in the first place. When one sees Evola discussing postal costs of stamps and talking in an embarrasing way about astrological charts etc., it kind of brings him as a human being more down to earth without making his writings any less lofty. I can only imagine him trading tapes of rare traditionalist BM bands with his UG friends. :-)

Matt on 2012-04-30 at 07:10 said:

Yes, I thought the same thing when I watched the video of Evola being interviewed on the history of Italy's Dada movement. Evola the author comes across as being aloof and distant, but Evola in-person comes across as quite friendly and close.

Cologero on 2012-04-30 at 07:28 said:

Yes, Angolmois, every man puts on his pants, one leg at a time. The caretaker story is curious, too, that he would make the effort to get a private astrological reading for her.

But it also shows his consistency over the course of his life, unlike many men I know who go through a major conversion every few years. He still refers, in a positive way, to Weininger's *Sex and Character*[40], which was one of his earliest influences. I know Evola "scholars" who prefer to ignore Weininger.

We get an insight, too, about Evola's method and way of thinking. The Absolute Man or Woman is an *a priori* metaphysical category; actually existing men and women are to be compared to that standard. This is the opposite approach of empirical science, which would first do a study of men and women as they are; then, they would formulate a theory of what is a man or a woman. It seems to me that post-modern science has brought much more confusion than clarity to that question.

The methods are clearly incompatible and lead to much different results. Note, too, that those on the "right wing" today try to employ biological arguments to demonstrate intrinsic differences between men and women. This approach has proved less than effective as it falls far short of an intellectual conversion to a metaphysical and transcendental world view.

There are other questions, if you read between the lines. Why would Evola be embarrassed by his writings on the absolute individual, one of very earliest conceptions? There is also the reference in passing to the relationship of astrology to race; was Evola thinking that had something to do with the problem of births?

Perhaps Logres can shed some light on these questions:

1. Did P. ever publish his sketch of Evola?
2. Did P. ever publish anything on "awakening the European race"?

Angolmois on 2012-05-01 at 05:41 said:

Good points, both of you. The concept of the absolute man brought to my mind Guénon's "nickname" which was 'an intellectual function'. What is man and how we should jugde him

[40] http://www.gornahoor.net/library/SexAndCharacter.pdf

according to his accidental traits is certainly a lost call, yet in differentiated men it does also shed some light upon the personality behind the reflection and the mask / per-sona.

Evola liked talking about his 'personal equation' although he scorned his own personality to the borders of sanity. Quite telling again, isn't it? We all have our shadows to deal with.

logres on 2012-05-01 at 08:14 said:

This is probably the book of interest: *Astrologia mondiale: il destino dei popoli rivelato dal corso degli astri*, Turin: T. Palamidessi, 1941 (2nd ed. Archeosofica 1985).

(The destiny of people revealed by the course of the stars, I think). I'll have to look for more. Many thanks to Cologero for translating this letter, which has piqued an interest in some of his posts on cosmology and the zodiac (although there are fewer of them). "We are underlings to the stars", except for our will, if it awakens.

Charlotte on 2012-05-01 at 08:27 said:

the astrological tangent puts me in mind of the words of a truly catholic author along the lines of Justin or Origen, who wrote something along the lines of (quoted in MoTT) – 'When we were children, under compulsion from the stars'.

This has always struck me as one of the most poignant phrases I've read in any book anywhere – the innocence of the child who is both protected and controlled by these cosmic forces, while the adult man or woman must master those same forces in order to attain the truth contained in another wonderful phrase from MoTT – the stars incline, they do not compel.

That probably tells us all we need to know about astrological sciences, which certainly doesn't stop me gazing at the planets and stars as often as possible, especially Venus, which is monumentally huge right now – the biggest it will EVER appear to us in fact, so far as I know (last night) :-)

Angolmois on 2012-05-03 at 01:35 said:

Charlotte: I think that the two influences of Venus and Jupiter, and later on Saturn, can be traced to the beginnings of the new age in astrological terms. The conjunction of Venus and Jupiter marks the birth of the Christ, and they have both been active during this year. There is also the issue of the comet that stroke the sky into the direction of the constellation Draco which marked the birth of the year of the Dragon. We are currently witnessing the inauguration of the reign of Saturn and the age of Aquarius; this is the very thing in which the new agers are certainly right, only their conclusions and the applications seem to be often quite fantastic and utopian. The major star Betelgeuse has also activated, which can be linked to the emergence of 'the true will' in highly developed humanity.

Personally I have found the Bailey book on esoteric astrology quite helpful, although I can't be completely in agreement with Bailey's conclusions or theories.

As regards the 'enslavement under the stars', this is mostly a problem for mass minded humanity. For every disciple and initiate the birth chart and astrological researches must be made according to their point in the path of return together with other issues to be examined, to be able to tell one's exact point.

In whole I think that the (esoteric) teachings and interpretations of Jesus Christ are the most helpful in "surmounting the archons", especially the teachings found from the apocryphic writings and Pistis Sophia, which might just be the most neglected "christic" work of all times.

Charlotte on 2012-05-03 at 06:30 said:

yes Angolmois, I spent a fascinating month in the highlands of Guatemala, from a wonderful natural observatory, watching the conjunctions, comets and other incredible astronomical phenomena you mention. Betelgeuse does indeed appear very red nowadays (all the more obvious in a clear sky) and it struck me for the first time that it might indeed go (or already be going) supernova as expected. Imagine Orion without his left arm! I totally agree that the cosmos has been behaving in an unusual way – or a way not seen in my liftime before – since at least last September, when I saw Jupiter looking so enormous it stunned me. Now Venus is doing the same, and as you pointed out, they have already conjuncted. I have mentioned to people a few times that early in October I saw literally the most amazing night sky I've ever witnessed in my life, it had both myself and my neighbour out on the balcony with our jaws on the floor. It only lasted for about 10 minutes, but for that time every single star and planet seemed about 10 times closer, you could see every colour – red, blue, green, orange – and they weren't just twinkling in the usual fashion, Jupiter for instance was slowly pulsating as if it was actually turning on and off. Anyone who denies there are signs in the skies these days either hasn't been looking up or they live in a zone where there's too much ambient light and air pollution to see properly. What it all means, as you also rightly pointed out, is a matter of interpretation. Clearly this IS the start of the age of Aquarius, that's just a fact connected with our cosmos... I am also with you 100% on the Pistis Sophia and often recommend it to people. I broke my foot last January (over a year ago) , tripping over in towering heels on a slippy floor, and it gave me perfect occasion to contemplate the fall of man and womankind with the most tragic of attitudes, I can tell you! Joking aside, this was a very dark and difficult period of my life that caused me to examine myself thoroughly and face up to things that hitherto I'd been unwilling or unable to deal with, but reading the Pistis Sophia for the first time was definitely a silver lining in this cloud... .it is an incredible work, it is of so much help to anyone contemplating the problem of the Fall, a truly magical text. I posted this extract on my blog at the time – looking back now I can see that I began reading it about 3 days after my tumble, something must have been guiding me for me to have found it soo soon after!

http://alchemical-weddings.com/alchemical-weddings/the-ineffable

Back to the sky for a moment, we have a red supermoon in Scorpio coming on Saturdady, I'd say that's a biggie. It's the Beltane full moon and also around the time of Buddha's enlightenment... .got to be a good time to meditate by any estimation?! Cx

Charlotte on 2012-05-03 at 06:35 said:

yes it is curious that Pistis Sohpia has been so neglected... ..just like Mary Magdalene in exoteric religion

Angolmois on 2012-05-03 at 13:27 said:

The neglection of Pistis Sophia among 'orthodox' believers and exoteric christianity must have something to do with the 'egyptian' and other influences in it. Amenti etc. Early Christians around the years 100-300 did quite a good job of kicking off almost all universal esoterism and twisting the words of Jesus, if I'm right. It all started from 'Paul the theologian' and 'Peter the denier'. Origen and few others are quite good, but even they saw gnosticism as their enemy becase they thought it leads men towards over-blown intellectual pride. On the other hand they were right, but on the other hand they were quite wrong.

AS regarding Mary Magdalene, I think this neglection has to do with too much Solarism understood in a unilateral way among the early christians and the desert fathers. The Eternal Feminine has certainly been neglected in the exoteric monotheism, yet its resurgence can be seen in the 'wholly pagan' worship of the black virgin.

http://www.sophiaperennis.com/books/christianity/the-black-virgin/

Charlotte on 2012-05-03 at 15:14 said:

Yes... .

The book sounds very interesting thank you for the link. In fact I was thinking of the Black Virgin in the bath earlier today, wondering if I should mention this. I had tended to see her as more equivalent to Mary Magdalene, but who knows?

The negation of Mary Magdalene – or marginalisation, perhaps – is definitely one of the main reasons I have felt unable to fully sign up to the catholic church. Peter and Paul have an awful lot of truth between them, but not a monopoly, although catholicism does more for the divine feminine than most other exoteric Christian denominations.

Funny you mentioned Amenti... .you know I keep on discovering things that are meant to be taboo! It reminds me of a poem or something else I have read, would that be the Emerald Tablet perhaps. Could be. Halls of Amenti. We've been there haven't we, isn't that where one of the schoolrooms is?!

10.7.1 Letter from Guenon to AKC 24VI1935

In 1935, **Rene Guenon** and **Ananda Coomaraswamy** began a correspondence that lasted 12 years. This letter shows their common mind, although their respective intellectual paths were quite different. An important point he makes regards the relationship between historical events and metaphysical principles; neither necessarily excludes the other. He also alludes what is called the "Aryan Invasion Theory" which brought the Primordial Tradition from the Arctic region to India in the form of Hinduism. To avoid confusion, keep in mind that Guenon emphasizes that the word "Aryan" does not designate a race.[41]

Cairo, 24 June 1935

Thank you for your letter and your shipment, which reached me at the same time.

There are some very interesting indications in "The Darker Side of the Dawn", which suggest many parallels with those found also in other traditions; it would be desirable if you get the opportunity to further develop these considerations later. As for your study of medieval aesthetics, the ideas you express fully coincide with what I think myself.

I am pleased to see that we are also in full agreement on the meaning of the words "Aryan" and "non-Aryan", which I could never consider as designating races.

As for the "pre-Hindu" traditions in India, without doubt, I have not sufficiently explained myself. It is well understood that all people are or have been in possession of traditions derived from a single source, but in a more or less distinct way. The Sumerian, Dravidian traditions, etc., seem to be based on forms most especially coming from certain secondary centers, whereas the "Hindu" tradition, which came from the north, is the one that comes most directly from the Primordial Tradi-

[41]The essay, "The Darker Side of the Dawn", can be found online.

tion (for our Manvantara), shown everywhere as "polar" in origin. This of course has a direct link with the question of the "Terrestrial Paradise" which you alluded to, and which I mentioned in my book "The King of the World"; this won't stop me from coming back to this topic again as you suggest. Concerning the analogy of historical events with the principles from which come their symbolic value (which does not exclude at all their factual reality), I often insisted on it; this is something that Westerners seem to have much difficulty in understanding in general.

I'm sorry to answer so briefly today but I hope now that our correspondence does not stay there.

Thank you again for what you tell me of my works and for making my works known in your circles.

Please accept, dear sir, my best wishes.

Posted on 2013-08-05 by Cologero

* * *

Avery Morrow on 2013-08-06 at 05:59 said:
Here we are.
http://www.scribd.com/doc/87506844/Coomaraswamy-The-Darker-Side-of-Dawn
Whatever parallels Guenon was thinking of are beyond me on this early morning.

John Curley on 2013-08-06 at 06:23 said:
Thank you for this link, Avery.